1. In 2026, the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) signed an MoU with which central bank to promote cross-border QR code-based merchant payments and digital payment connectivity?

A.Bank of Thailand

B.State Bank of Vietnam

C.Monetary Authority of Singapore

D.Bank of Indonesia

E.People's Bank of China

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** and the **State Bank of Vietnam (SBV)** signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** with an aim to strengthen bilateral cooperation in **financial innovation** and **digital payments** between India and Vietnam.

The agreement was signed after receiving approval from the **Union Cabinet of India**.

The MoU focuses on promoting **cross-border QR Code-based merchant payments** between the two countries.

The partnership aims to improve **payment system connectivity** and facilitate **seamless cross-border transactions**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** and the **State Bank of Vietnam (SBV)** signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** with an aim to strengthen bilateral cooperation in **financial innovation** and **digital payments** between India and Vietnam.

The agreement was signed after receiving approval from the **Union Cabinet of India**.

The MoU focuses on promoting **cross-border QR Code-based merchant payments** between the two countries.

The partnership aims to improve **payment system connectivity** and facilitate **seamless cross-border transactions**.

The MoU provides a framework for **information sharing**, **regulatory coordination**, and **implementation support**.

Areas of cooperation include sharing information on **emerging market trends**, **digital payment technologies**, best practices, and regulatory frameworks.

The agreement also supports cooperation in **fast payment systems**, **messaging systems**, and **card switch mechanisms**.

The MoU allows the possibility of launching **joint innovation programmes** and **digital payment projects** between RBI and SBV.

One major objective is to make cross-border transactions more **transparent, real-time, convenient, and cost-efficient**.

The system will provide **upfront display of charges**, improving transparency in international payments.

2. In 2026, the Department of Financial Services (DFS) launched the Common Landing Portal for Unclaimed Financial Assets in collaboration with which organisation?

A.RBI
B.SEBI
C.PSB Alliance
D.NABARD
E.IRDAI
Answer: C
Short Explanation:
The **Department of Financial Services (DFS)**, under the **Ministry of Finance**, launched the **Common Landing Portal for Unclaimed Financial Assets** on **29 May 2026**.
The portal was developed in collaboration with the **PSB Alliance** to provide easier access to information related to **unclaimed financial assets**.
The portal was launched by **M. Nagaraju, Secretary, DFS**, during the review meeting of **Public Sector Banks (PSBs)**.
Detailed Explanation:
The **Department of Financial Services (DFS)**, under the **Ministry of Finance**, launched the **Common Landing Portal for Unclaimed Financial Assets** on **29 May 2026**.
The portal was developed in collaboration with the **PSB Alliance** to provide easier access to information related to **unclaimed financial assets**.
The portal was launched by **M. Nagaraju, Secretary, DFS**, during the review meeting of **Public Sector Banks (PSBs)**.
The portal is accessible through the official website: **Unclaimed Financial Assets Portal**
The platform serves as a **unified portal** for searching unclaimed financial assets across the **financial ecosystem**.
The portal provides access to search facilities for **unclaimed bank deposits, insurance claims, shares, dividends, and mutual funds**.
The initiative is an extension of the nationwide campaign **"आपकी पूँजी, आपका अधिकार (Your Money, Your Right)"**

3. In 2026, as per the Department of Financial Services (DFS) review of Public Sector Banks (PSBs), what was the Gross Non-Performing Assets (GNPA) level reported?
A.2.93%
B.1.93%
C.3.39%
D.0.39%
E.2.13%
Answer: B
Short Explanation:
During the meeting, a **Coffee Table Book** titled **"आपकी पूँजी, आपका अधिकार (Your Money, Your Right)"** was unveiled.
The campaign focused on helping citizens identify and reclaim **unclaimed financial assets**.
Over the last six months, more than **₹6,800 crore** was restituted to nearly **29 lakh claimants** across India.
The new DFS website is available in **23 regional languages** and includes **accessibility features** for visually impaired persons.

Aggregate business of PSBs reached around **₹283.3 lakh crore** as of 31 March 2026.
Aggregate net profit of PSBs increased to approximately **₹1.98 lakh crore**, marking the **highest-ever annual net profit** in PSB history.
Gross Non-Performing Assets (GNPA) declined to a **historic low of 1.93%**.
Net Non-Performing Assets (NNPA) reduced further to **0.39%**.
Detailed Explanation:
Secretary, Department of Financial Services (DFS), M. Nagaraju, chaired a review meeting of **Public Sector Banks (PSBs)** to assess their performance during **FY 2025–26**.
The meeting was attended by senior **DFS officials**, the **Chairman of State Bank of India**, and **MDs, CEOs, and Executive Directors** of PSBs.
During the meeting, a **Coffee Table Book** titled **"आपकी पूँजी, आपका अधिकार (Your Money, Your Right)"** was unveiled.
The campaign focused on helping citizens identify and reclaim **unclaimed financial assets**.
Over the last six months, more than **₹6,800 crore** was restituted to nearly **29 lakh claimants** across India.
The **revamped website** of the Department of Financial Services was also launched with a **citizen-centric approach**.
The new DFS website is available in **23 regional languages** and includes **accessibility features** for visually impaired persons.
The review assessed PSB performance in areas such as **business growth, profitability, asset quality, financial inclusion, digital banking, MSME credit, cyber resilience, and risk management**.
Aggregate business of PSBs reached around **₹283.3 lakh crore** as of 31 March 2026.
Aggregate net profit of PSBs increased to approximately **₹1.98 lakh crore**, marking the **highest-ever annual net profit** in PSB history.
Gross Non-Performing Assets (GNPA) declined to a **historic low of 1.93%**.
Net Non-Performing Assets (NNPA) reduced further to **0.39%**.
The improvement reflected **stronger balance sheets** and **prudent risk management practices**.

4. In Mar'26, according to RBI data, overseas travel spending by Indians declined to which amount?

A.USD 1.29 billion
B.USD 0.99 billion
C.USD 1.09 billion
D.USD 2.59 billion
E.USD 1.19 billion
Answer: C
Short Explanation:
According to data released by the **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)**, **overseas travel spending** by Indians declined to **USD 1.09 billion** in **March 2026**.

Overseas travel expenditure decreased by nearly **USD 212 million** compared to February 2026.

The decline reflects **reduced spending on foreign travel** by Indian residents.

Under the **Liberalised Remittance Scheme (LRS)**, Indians can remit up to **USD 2,50,000 per financial year** for permitted transactions.

Detailed Explanation:

According to data released by the **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)**, **overseas travel spending** by Indians declined to **USD 1.09 billion** in **March 2026**.

Overseas travel expenditure decreased by nearly **USD 212 million** compared to February 2026.

The decline reflects **reduced spending on foreign travel** by Indian residents.

Under the **Liberalised Remittance Scheme (LRS)**, Indians can remit up to **USD 2,50,000 per financial year** for permitted transactions.

The LRS allows remittances for purposes such as **foreign travel, education, investments, and maintenance of relatives abroad**.

Total outward remittances under the LRS stood at **USD 2.59 billion** in March 2026.

Travel remained the **largest component of outward remittances**, accounting for **USD 1.09 billion** of the total remittances.

5. In 2026, the SkyCast Aviation Weather Monitoring System inaugurated at IGI Airport, New Delhi, has been developed under which flagship programme?

A.Mission Vayu Suraksha

B.Mission SkyNet

C.National Aviation Mission

D.Mission Mausam

E.IMD Aviation Initiative

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

Union Minister Dr. Jitendra Singh inaugurated the **SkyCast Aviation Weather Monitoring System** at **Indira Gandhi International (IGI) Airport, New Delhi**.

The system has been developed under the Government of India's flagship **Mission Mausam** programme.

SkyCast is an advanced aviation weather intelligence platform that provides **real-time atmospheric information** to enhance aviation safety and operational efficiency.

Detailed Explanation:

Union Minister Dr. Jitendra Singh inaugurated the **SkyCast Aviation Weather Monitoring System** at **Indira Gandhi International (IGI) Airport, New Delhi**.

The system has been developed under the Government of India's flagship **Mission Mausam** programme.

SkyCast is an advanced aviation weather intelligence platform that provides **real-time atmospheric information** to enhance aviation safety and operational efficiency.

The system continuously monitors:

Fog formation

Visibility levels

Wind speed and direction

Turbulence
Moisture content
Atmospheric temperature
Aerosol concentration
It will help **pilots, air traffic controllers, and airport authorities** make informed decisions during critical flight operations, especially **take-offs and landings**.

6. In 2026, the Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs approved which scheme for strengthening India's Public Distribution System (PDS) with an outlay of ₹25,530 crore?
A.SARTHAK-PDS
B.NFSA Support Scheme
C.SMART-PDS
D.Anna Suraksha Yojana
E.Ration Mitra Scheme
Answer: A
Short Explanation:
The **Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs (CCEA)**, chaired by **Prime Minister Narendra Modi**, has approved the **Scheme for Assistance in Ration Transport and Handling-Income with Automation in Public Distribution System (SARTHAK-PDS)** for a period of **5 years**.
The scheme has an outlay of **₹25,530 crore** and aims to strengthen **food security** across the country.
The scheme covers the entire **Public Distribution System (PDS)** value chain, including **foodgrain distribution, logistics, transportation, material handling, and grievance redressal mechanisms**.
Detailed Explanation:
The **Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs (CCEA)**, chaired by **Prime Minister Narendra Modi**, has approved the **Scheme for Assistance in Ration Transport and Handling-Income with Automation in Public Distribution System (SARTHAK-PDS)** for a period of **5 years**.
The scheme has an outlay of **₹25,530 crore** and aims to strengthen **food security** across the country.
The scheme covers the entire **Public Distribution System (PDS)** value chain, including **foodgrain distribution, logistics, transportation, material handling, and grievance redressal mechanisms**.
It is an **umbrella scheme** that integrates:
Assistance to State Agencies for Intra-State Movement of Foodgrains and Fair Price Shop Dealers' Margin under the National Food Security Act (NFSA).
Scheme for Modernisation and Reforms through Technology in Public Distribution System (SMART-PDS).
The integration of these schemes is expected to strengthen the implementation of the **National Food Security Act (NFSA), 2013** under a **single administrative framework**.

7. In 2026, the Chhattisgarh Government launched the 'Adarsh Shahar Samriddhi

Yojana' with an initial allocation of_____

A.₹150 crore

B.₹250 crore

C.₹300 crore

D.₹200 crore

E.₹500 crore

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

The **Chhattisgarh Government** will launch the **'Adarsh Shahar Samriddhi Yojana'** to equip emerging towns and urban centres with **modern civic infrastructure and public facilities**.

The state government has allocated **₹200 crore** for the scheme in the **2026–27 Budget**.

The scheme has been conceptualised on the lines of the **'Mukhyamantri Nagarotthan Yojana'**, which was introduced for **municipal corporations**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Chhattisgarh Government** will launch the **'Adarsh Shahar Samriddhi Yojana'** to equip emerging towns and urban centres with **modern civic infrastructure and public facilities**.

The state government has allocated **₹200 crore** for the scheme in the **2026–27 Budget**.

The scheme has been conceptualised on the lines of the **'Mukhyamantri Nagarotthan Yojana'**, which was introduced for **municipal corporations**.

In the first phase, the **Urban Administration and Development Department** has selected **32 Urban Local Bodies (ULBs)** across the state's **five revenue divisions**:

Bilaspur – 9

Bastar – 6

Surguja – 6

Raipur – 6

Durg – 5

The **Chief Engineer of the Mechanical Cell of the Directorate** has been appointed as the **Nodal Officer** for all five revenue divisions to ensure effective implementation and monitoring.

8. In 2026, India's first municipality-developed Special Economic Zone (SEZ) has been approved in which Union Territory?

A.Puducherry

B.Lakshadweep

C.Goa

D.Andaman & Nicobar Islands

E.Daman & Diu

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

The **Government of India** has notified **two new Special Economic Zones (SEZs)** in the **Union Territory of Puducherry**.

The approvals were granted during the **137th Meeting of the Board of Approval (BoA)** under the **Department of Commerce**, held on **27 February 2026**.

The projects are expected to attract investments of nearly **₹1,975 crore** and generate around **8,500 employment opportunities**.

One of the SEZs will be developed by **Oulgaret Municipality** at **Thattanchavady village, Oulgaret Taluk**, making it **India's first municipality-developed SEZ**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Government of India** has notified **two new Special Economic Zones (SEZs)** in the **Union Territory of Puducherry**.

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One of the SEZs will be developed by **Oulgaret Municipality** at **Thattanchavady village, Oulgaret Taluk**, making it **India's first municipality-developed SEZ**.

The municipality-developed SEZ will focus on **Information Technology (IT)** and **Information Technology Enabled Services (ITeS)** activities.

The second SEZ will be established by the **Pondicherry Industrial Promotion Development and Investment Corporation (PIPDIC)** at **Karasur village, Villianur Taluk**.

The **multi-sector SEZ** will support industries across **manufacturing, services, and export-oriented businesses**.

9. In 2026, India signed a bilateral framework with which country to strengthen cooperation in critical minerals and rare earth elements supply chains?

A.Japan

B.Australia

C.United States of America

D.United Kingdom

E.Germany

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

India and the **United States of America (USA)** have signed a **bilateral framework** to strengthen cooperation in the **supply, mining, and processing of critical minerals and rare earth elements**.

The agreement was signed on the sidelines of the **11th Quad Foreign Ministers' Meeting**.

The framework covers cooperation in **mining, processing, recycling, and related investments** across the critical minerals value chain.

It builds upon ongoing **India–United States** efforts to strengthen **supply chain security** in critical and strategic sectors.

Detailed Explanation:

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The agreement was signed on the sidelines of the **11th Quad Foreign Ministers' Meeting**.

The framework covers cooperation in **mining, processing, recycling, and related**

investments across the critical minerals value chain.

It builds upon ongoing **India–United States** efforts to strengthen **supply chain security** in critical and strategic sectors.

On **20 February 2026**, India became a signatory to the **United States-led Pax Silica Initiative**.

Critical minerals and rare earth elements are essential for:

High-tech electronics

Clean energy technologies

Defence systems

Electric vehicles

The partnership aims to reduce supply chain vulnerabilities and enhance access to critical resources required for emerging technologies and strategic industries.

China currently accounts for around 90% of global critical mineral processing, highlighting the importance of diversifying supply chains.

10. In 2026, the National Skill Development Corporation (NSDC) partnered with which country's organisation Fourth Valley Concierge Corporation (FVCC) to enhance workforce mobility for Indian talent?

A.South Korea

B.Germany

C.Singapore

D.Japan

E.Australia

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

The **National Skill Development Corporation (NSDC)** has partnered with **Fourth Valley Concierge Corporation (FVCC), Japan**, to strengthen and facilitate **workforce mobility opportunities for Indian talent in Japan**.

The collaboration will leverage the **'Credibility Check' framework** provided by **NSDC Trust**, a group organisation of the **National Skill Development Corporation (NSDC)**.

The initiative aims to establish a **structured and reliable verification mechanism** for Indian candidates travelling to Japan through **Fourth Valley Concierge Corporation (FVCC)**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **National Skill Development Corporation (NSDC)** has partnered with **Fourth Valley Concierge Corporation (FVCC), Japan**, to strengthen and facilitate **workforce mobility opportunities for Indian talent in Japan**.

The collaboration will leverage the **'Credibility Check' framework** provided by **NSDC Trust**, a group organisation of the **National Skill Development Corporation (NSDC)**.

The initiative aims to establish a **structured and reliable verification mechanism** for Indian candidates travelling to Japan through **Fourth Valley Concierge Corporation (FVCC)**.

The verification process may include:

Identity verification

Educational and qualification credential verification

Employment history verification

Criminal background checks (where legally permissible)

Consistency checks of submitted documents
Other credibility assessment parameters
India and Japan have also outlined an **Action Plan for Human Resource Exchange and Cooperation**.
The broader objective is to facilitate the movement of at least **50,000 skilled Indian professionals to Japan over the next five years**.

11. In 2026, the WhatsApp-based citizen services in Gujarat under the MoU with Meta are being integrated into which platform?
A.Digital India Portal
B.e-Governance Gujarat Hub
C.Gujarat e-Seva Portal
D.Bharat Citizen Connect
E.Sugam Digital Gujarat platform
Answer: E
Short Explanation:
The **Government of Gujarat** and **Meta Platforms Inc. (Meta)** have signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** in **Gandhinagar** to provide **WhatsApp-based access to government services** across the state.
Under the initiative, around **20 citizen services** from **five major departments** will be integrated into the **Sugam Digital Gujarat** platform.
Citizens will be able to access these services through a **single WhatsApp number**.
The services will be delivered through a **chatbot available in Gujarati and English**.
Detailed Explanation:
The **Government of Gujarat** and **Meta Platforms Inc. (Meta)** have signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** in **Gandhinagar** to provide **WhatsApp-based access to government services** across the state.
Under the initiative, around **20 citizen services** from **five major departments** will be integrated into the **Sugam Digital Gujarat** platform.
Citizens will be able to access these services through a **single WhatsApp number**.
The services will be delivered through a **chatbot available in Gujarati and English**.
Key services proposed under the platform include:
Grievance redressal assistance
Income Certificate issuance
Caste Certificate issuance
Economically Weaker Section (EWS) Certificate issuance
Ration Card updates
Access to revenue records
Official affidavits
The platform is expected to improve **real-time application status tracking** and strengthen **last-mile delivery of public services** in both urban and rural areas.
The initiative aims to enhance **digital governance, citizen convenience, and accessibility of government services**.

12. In 2026, Odisha signed a tripartite MoU with Intel Corporation and 3D Glass Solutions Inc. (3DGS) to establish an Advanced Packaging Glass Core Substrate Manufacturing Facility in which region?

A.Rourkela–Sundargarh

B.Cuttack–Jajpur

C.Bhubaneswar–Khurda

D.Ganjam–Berhampur

E.Sambalpur–Jharsuguda

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The **Government of Odisha**, **Intel Corporation**, and **3D Glass Solutions Inc. (3DGS)** signed a **tripartite Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)**.

The agreement aims to establish an **Advanced Packaging Glass Core Substrate Manufacturing Facility** in the **Bhubaneswar–Khurda region of Odisha**.

The project involves an estimated investment of **$3.3 billion**, making it one of the largest semiconductor-related investments in India.

The initiative is expected to strengthen India's semiconductor ecosystem and support the **India Semiconductor Mission (ISM)**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Government of Odisha**, **Intel Corporation**, and **3D Glass Solutions Inc. (3DGS)** signed a **tripartite Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)**.

The agreement aims to establish an **Advanced Packaging Glass Core Substrate Manufacturing Facility** in the **Bhubaneswar–Khurda region of Odisha**.

The project involves an estimated investment of **$3.3 billion**, making it one of the largest semiconductor-related investments in India.

The initiative is expected to strengthen India's semiconductor ecosystem and support the **India Semiconductor Mission (ISM)**.

The signing ceremony was attended by **Union Minister for Electronics and Information Technology Ashwini Vaishnaw**, **Odisha Chief Minister Mohan Charan Majhi**, and **Intel Chief Executive Officer (CEO) Lip-Bu Tan**.

The upcoming facility will manufacture:

Advanced Packaging Glass Core Substrates
High-Density Interconnect (HDI) Substrates
Advanced Semiconductor Components
Next-Generation Packaging Solutions

Intel Corporation will provide technical expertise, process support, and advanced manufacturing knowledge for the project.

13. In 2026, the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) extended the tenure of Ketan Merchant as Interim CEO of which bank for three months (effective from 27 May 2026)?

A.Paytm Payments Bank

B.Fino Payments Bank

C.Airtel Payments Bank

D.India Post Payments Bank

E.NSDL Payments Bank

Answer: B

The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** approved a **three-month extension** for **Ketan**

Merchant to continue as the **Interim Chief Executive Officer (CEO)** of **Fino Payments Bank**.

The extended tenure became effective from **27 May 2026**.

The disclosure regarding the extension was made under **Regulation 30** of the **Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI)** (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements – LODR) Regulations, 2015.

14. In 2026, Bassirou Diomaye Faye appointed which person as the new Prime Minister of Senegal?

A.Ahmadou Al Aminou Lo

B.Macky Sall

C.Ousmane Sonko

D.Abdoulaye Wade

E.Cheikh Tidiane Gadio

Answer: A

Bassirou Diomaye Faye, **President of Senegal**, appointed **Ahmadou Al Aminou Lo** as the new **Prime Minister (PM)** of Senegal.

Ahmadou Al Aminou Lo is a veteran **central banker**, **economist**, and member of the **Pastef party**.

The **political transition** occurred **three days** after President Bassirou Diomaye Faye **dissolved the government** and dismissed former Prime Minister **Ousmane Sonko**.

About Senegal :

Capital : Dakar

Currency : West African CFA franc

15. In 2026, the 16th India–Singapore Defence Policy Dialogue was co-chaired by India's Defence Secretary Rajesh Kumar Singh and which Singapore official?

A.Chan Chun Sing

B.Joseph Leong

C.Ng Eng Hen

D.Lawrence Wong

E.Teo Chee Hean

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The **16th India-Singapore Defence Policy Dialogue** was held in **Singapore** on **28 May 2026**.

The dialogue was co-chaired by **Rajesh Kumar Singh**, **Defence Secretary of India**, and **Joseph Leong**, **Permanent Secretary (Defence) of Singapore**.

Both sides reviewed the progress of ongoing defence engagements and discussed key areas of **defence cooperation**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **16th India-Singapore Defence Policy Dialogue** was held in **Singapore** on **28 May 2026**.

The dialogue was co-chaired by **Rajesh Kumar Singh**, **Defence Secretary of India**, and **Joseph Leong**, **Permanent Secretary (Defence) of Singapore**.

Both sides reviewed the progress of ongoing defence engagements and discussed key areas of **defence cooperation**.

Major discussion areas included **military engagements**, **defence industry**

collaboration, **capacity building**, and **regional security issues**.

India and Singapore explored new avenues to strengthen their **strategic defence partnership** and expand cooperation in areas of mutual interest.

The two countries also discussed enhancing cooperation in **emerging and niche sectors** such as **cyber security**, **artificial intelligence (AI)**, **maritime security**, **unmanned systems**, and **advanced defence technologies**.

The dialogue highlighted the importance of **innovation-driven partnerships** to address evolving regional and global security challenges.

About Singapore :

President : Tharman Shanmugaratnam

Prime Minister : Lawrence Wong

Currency : Singapore dollar

16. In 2026, the Indian Coast Guard, in a joint operation with ATS Gujarat, seized approximately how much cocaine off the Mundra coast?

A.105 kg

B.115 kg

C.125 kg

D.150 kg

E.95 kg

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The Indian Coast Guard (ICG) seized approximately **115 kg of Cocaine** during a joint anti-smuggling operation conducted with the **Anti-Terrorism Squad Gujarat (ATS Gujarat)**.

The operation was carried out from **25–26 May 2026** off the **Mundra coast in Gujarat**.

The estimated international market value of the seized narcotics is around **₹1150 crore**.

Detailed Explanation:

The Indian Coast Guard (ICG) seized approximately **115 kg of Cocaine** during a joint anti-smuggling operation conducted with the **Anti-Terrorism Squad Gujarat (ATS Gujarat)**.

The operation was carried out from **25–26 May 2026** off the **Mundra coast in Gujarat**.

The estimated international market value of the seized narcotics is around **₹1150 crore**.

The operation was launched based on **specific and actionable intelligence** shared by **ATS Gujarat**.

Indian Coast Guard interceptor boats, along with ATS personnel onboard, conducted an extensive search operation in the **Mundra anchorage area**.

During the operation, **suspicious activity** was detected onboard a **container vessel**.

17. In 2026, the 4th Lavender Festival organised by CSIR-IIIM is being held under which theme?

A.Purple Revolution India

B.Aroma of Kashmir

C.Lavender for Rural Growth

D.Lavender goes global

E.Aroma Innovation Mission

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

CSIR-Indian Institute of Integrative Medicine (CSIR-IIIM Jammu) will organize the **4th Lavender Festival** on **6–7 June 2026** at **Government Degree College, Bhaderwah, Doda** under the theme **"Lavender goes global"**.

The festival celebrates the success of the **Purple Revolution** and lavender-based **rural entrepreneurship** in Jammu and Kashmir.

Detailed Explanation:

CSIR-Indian Institute of Integrative Medicine (CSIR-IIIM Jammu) will organize the **4th Lavender Festival** on **6–7 June 2026** at **Government Degree College, Bhaderwah, Doda** under the theme **"Lavender goes global"**.

The festival celebrates the success of the **Purple Revolution** and lavender-based **rural entrepreneurship** in Jammu and Kashmir.

The event will be inaugurated by **Dr. Jitendra Singh**, Union Minister of State (Independent Charge) for Science & Technology, Earth Sciences, PMO, Atomic Energy, and Space, and Vice President of Council of Scientific and Industrial Research (CSIR).

Dr. Zabeer Ahmed, Director of CSIR-IIIM, announced the details during a curtain raiser press conference.

CSIR-IIIM has expanded lavender cultivation to **Uttarakhand, Himachal Pradesh, and the North-Eastern States** through scientific interventions and entrepreneurship support.

18. In 2026, Google launched the "Google for Education Schoolers (GES)" programme at the Education World Forum in which city?

A.New York

B.Paris

C.Tokyo

D.Geneva

E.London

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

Google announced the **Google for Education Schoolers (GES)** programme at the **Education World Forum 2026** held in **London, United Kingdom**.

GES is a **free Artificial Intelligence (AI) training programme** designed for **school and higher education teachers across India**.

The initiative aims to provide **mobile-first AI training** on the **responsible use of AI tools**, including **Gemini**, in classrooms and academic environments.

Detailed Explanation:

Google announced the **Google for Education Schoolers (GES)** programme at the **Education World Forum 2026** held in **London, United Kingdom**.

GES is a **free Artificial Intelligence (AI) training programme** designed for **school and higher education teachers across India**.

The initiative aims to provide **mobile-first AI training** on the **responsible use of AI tools**,

including **Gemini**, in classrooms and academic environments.

The programme has been launched in collaboration with **various state governments** and the **United Nations Children's Fund (UNICEF)**.

In the **initial phase**, the programme will be implemented with the governments of **Maharashtra, Chhattisgarh, and Assam**.

The initiative will also cover the **Ladakh Union Territory** and the **Punjab School Education Board (PSEB)**.

19. In 2026, under the ICMR Innovators-to-Industry (I2I) Connect programme, how many public health technologies were transferred to industry partners?

A.35

B.38

C.40

D.41

E.45

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

The **Indian Council of Medical Research (ICMR)**, under the **Department of Health Research (DHR)**, organised the **"Medical Innovations Patent Mitra: Innovators-to-Industry (I2I) Connect"** event.

A major highlight of the event was the launch of the first-of-its-kind **Innovator–Industry Platform**.

Through this platform, **41 public health technologies** were transferred from ICMR institutes and innovators to industry partners.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Indian Council of Medical Research (ICMR)**, under the **Department of Health Research (DHR)**, organised the **"Medical Innovations Patent Mitra: Innovators-to-Industry (I2I) Connect"** event.

The event was held at the **Manekshaw Centre** in **New Delhi**.

Indian Council of Medical Research functions under the **Ministry of Health and Family Welfare (MoHFW)**.

The programme was inaugurated by **Prataprao Ganpatrao Jadhav**, Union Minister of State in the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare.

Gobardhan Das, Member of **NITI Aayog**, was present during the event.

The primary objective of the **Innovators-to-Industry (I2I) Connect** programme is to accelerate **technology transfer** and **commercialisation** of indigenous healthcare innovations through industry partnerships.

A major highlight of the event was the launch of the first-of-its-kind **Innovator–Industry Platform**.

Through this platform, **41 public health technologies** were transferred from ICMR institutes and innovators to industry partners.

20. In 2026, Nibe Group signed a Joint Venture with which company to establish

advanced energetic materials and propellant manufacturing facilities in India?

A.Rafael Advanced Defense Systems

B.Lockheed Martin

C.BAE Systems

D.Boeing Defence

E.Elbit Systems

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

Nibe Group and **Elbit Systems** signed a **Joint Venture (JV)** agreement to establish advanced **energetic materials** and **propellant manufacturing facilities** in India.

The strategic partnership supports the Government of India's **'Make in India'** and **'Atmanirbhar Bharat'** initiatives.

The proposed defence products to be manufactured under the JV include **Nitro Cellulose**, **Nitro Glycerine**, and **various propellant bases**.

Detailed Explanation:

Nibe Group and **Elbit Systems** signed a **Joint Venture (JV)** agreement to establish advanced **energetic materials** and **propellant manufacturing facilities** in India.

The strategic partnership supports the Government of India's **'Make in India'** and **'Atmanirbhar Bharat'** initiatives.

The proposed defence products to be manufactured under the JV include **Nitro Cellulose**, **Nitro Glycerine**, and **various propellant bases**.

The propellant products include **single-base propellant**, **double-base propellant**, and **triple-base propellant**.

Under the JV arrangement, **Elbit Systems** will provide **technical assistance** and related support.

Nibe Group will be responsible for **establishment, investment, and operational management** of the manufacturing facilities in India.

21. In 2026, Raja Randhir Singh, who recently passed away, was associated with which sport?

A.Boxing

B.Shooting

C.Hockey

D.Athletics

E.Wrestling

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Renowned Indian shooter, **five-time Olympian**, and veteran sports administrator **Raja Randhir Singh** passed away at the age of **79** in **New Delhi**.

Raja Randhir Singh was born on **18 October 1946** in **Patiala, Punjab**.

He was honoured with the prestigious **Arjuna Award** in **1979** by the **Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports (MYAS)** for his outstanding contribution to shooting sports.

Detailed Explanation:

Renowned Indian shooter, **five-time Olympian**, and veteran sports administrator **Raja Randhir**

Singh passed away at the age of **79** in **New Delhi**.

Raja Randhir Singh was born on **18 October 1946** in **Patiala, Punjab**.

He was honoured with the prestigious **Arjuna Award** in **1979** by the **Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports (MYAS)** for his outstanding contribution to shooting sports.

Raja Randhir Singh was a five-time Olympian, **Asian Games gold medallist**, former **Secretary General of the Indian Olympic Association (IOA)**, and the first Indian to become **President of the Olympic Council of Asia (OCA)**.

He specialised in **trap and skeet shooting** events during his shooting career.

He represented India in **five Olympic Games**: **Mexico City 1968**, **Munich 1972**, **Montreal 1976**, **Moscow 1980**, and **Los Angeles 1984**.

Raja Randhir Singh also served as the **reserve shooter** for the **1964 Summer Olympics** held in **Tokyo, Japan**.

22. In 2026, World No Tobacco Day is observed annually on which date?

A.30 May

B.31 May

C.1 June

D.29 May

E.2 June

Answer: B

World No Tobacco Day is observed every year on **31 May** to raise awareness about the harmful effects of tobacco consumption and promote tobacco-free lifestyles.

The day is organized by the **World Health Organization (WHO)** and is also known as **World Anti-Tobacco Day**.

About World Health Organization (WHO)

Headquarters: Geneva, Switzerland

Director-General: Tedros Adhanom Ghebreyesus

Established: **1948**

The World Health Organization (WHO) has 194 member

23. In Mar'26, according to RBI data on outward remittances, which category accounted for the largest share within travel spending?

A.Education-related travel

B.Overseas business travel

C.Pilgrimage and medical travel

D.Other travel (holidays & credit card settlements)

E.Work-related travel

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

Travel remained the **largest component of outward remittances**, accounting for **USD 1.09 billion** of the total remittances.

Within the travel category, the **"other travel" segment** accounted for **USD 623.05 million**, representing nearly **57% of total travel spending**.

The "other travel" category includes **holiday trips and international credit card settlements**.

Detailed Explanation:

Travel remained the **largest component of outward remittances**, accounting for **USD 1.09 billion** of the total remittances.

Within the travel category, the **"other travel" segment** accounted for **USD 623.05 million**, representing nearly **57% of total travel spending**.

The "other travel" category includes **holiday trips and international credit card settlements**.

Spending on **education-related travel** amounted to **USD 450.16 million** during March 2026.

Expenditure on **overseas business travel, pilgrimage, and medical treatment** together totalled **USD 21.39 million**.

24. In 2026, India hosted which Session of the Asian Productivity Organization (APO) Governing Body at Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi?

A.66th Session

B.67th Session

C.69th Session

D.68th Session

E.70th Session

Answer: D

India hosts the 68th Session of the Asian Productivity Organization (APO) Governing Body from the 20th to 22nd May, 2026. This high level international gathering will take place at the Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi and it will bring together the policymakers, productivity experts and delegates from across the Asia-Pacific region.

25. In 2026, the 'Adarsh Shahar Samriddhi Yojana' launched by the Chhattisgarh Government has been conceptualised on the lines of which scheme?

A.Smart City Mission

B.AMRUT Scheme

C.Mukhyamantri Nagarotthan Yojana

D.Swachh Bharat Mission

E.Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana

Answer: C

The **Chhattisgarh Government** will launch the **'Adarsh Shahar Samriddhi Yojana'** to equip emerging towns and urban centres with **modern civic infrastructure and public facilities**.

The state government has allocated **₹200 crore** for the scheme in the **2026–27 Budget**.

The scheme has been conceptualised on the lines of the **'Mukhyamantri Nagarotthan Yojana'**, which was introduced for **municipal corporations**.

In the first phase, the **Urban Administration and Development Department** has selected **32 Urban Local Bodies (ULBs)** across the state's **five revenue divisions**:

Bilaspur – 9

Bastar – 6

Surguja – 6

Raipur – 6

Durg – 5

26. In June 2026, the Central Government revised export levies on petroleum products for the fortnight beginning 1 June 2026. What is the export duty fixed on Diesel?

A.₹1.5 per litre

B.₹5.5 per litre

C.₹9.5 per litre

D.₹13.5 per litre

E.₹15.5 per litre

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

Export levies [Special Additional Excise Duty (SAED) / Road and Infrastructure Cess (RIC)] on exports of **Petrol, Diesel, and Aviation Turbine Fuel (ATF)** were introduced with effect from **27 March 2026**.

For the fortnight beginning **1 June 2026**, the Central Government notified **revised export duty rates** on petroleum products.

The export duty on **Petrol** has been fixed at **Rs. 1.5 per litre** (SAED: Rs. 1.5; RIC: Nil).

The export duty on **Diesel** has been fixed at **Rs. 13.5 per litre** (SAED: Rs. 13.5; RIC: Nil).

The export duty on **Aviation Turbine Fuel (ATF)** has been fixed at **Rs. 9.5 per litre** (SAED only).

Detailed Explanation:

Export levies [Special Additional Excise Duty (SAED) / Road and Infrastructure Cess (RIC)] on exports of **Petrol, Diesel, and Aviation Turbine Fuel (ATF)** were introduced with effect from **27 March 2026**.

The export duties were imposed to **ensure domestic availability** of petroleum products by discouraging exports amid the **West Asia crisis**.

The rates of export levies are **reviewed and revised on a fortnightly basis** based on average international prices of crude oil, petrol, diesel, and ATF.

The last revision of export duty rates was undertaken on **16 May 2026**.

For the fortnight beginning **1 June 2026**, the Central Government notified **revised export duty rates** on petroleum products.

The export duty on **Petrol** has been fixed at **Rs. 1.5 per litre** (SAED: Rs. 1.5; RIC: Nil).

The export duty on **Diesel** has been fixed at **Rs. 13.5 per litre** (SAED: Rs. 13.5; RIC: Nil).

The export duty on **Aviation Turbine Fuel (ATF)** has been fixed at **Rs. 9.5 per litre** (SAED only).

The revised duties will come into force from **1 June 2026** and remain applicable for the **next fortnight**.

27. As of June 2026, the Central Government has exempted all customs duties on cotton imports for a specified period to support the textile industry. The exemption will remain in force until which date?

A.31 August 2026

B.30 September 2026

C.31 October 2026

D.31 December 2026

E.31 March 2027

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The Central Government has **temporarily exempted all customs duties on cotton imports** from **1 June 2026 to 31 October 2026**.

The decision was announced by the **Ministry of Textiles** to augment the availability of cotton for the **Indian textile sector**.

The duty exemption has been introduced during the **cotton off-season** to ensure adequate supply of cotton to domestic industries.

Detailed Explanation:

The Central Government has **temporarily exempted all customs duties on cotton imports** from **1 June 2026 to 31 October 2026**.

The decision was announced by the **Ministry of Textiles** to augment the availability of cotton for the **Indian textile sector**.

The duty exemption has been introduced during the **cotton off-season** to ensure adequate supply of cotton to domestic industries.

The primary objective of the measure is to **ensure better availability of cotton**, **reduce raw material shortages**, and support the growth of the textile industry.

The exemption is expected to **reduce input costs** for manufacturers across the textile and apparel sector.

The initiative will provide significant support to **Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises (MSMEs)** operating in the textile value chain.

28. As of 2026, which country surpassed India to become the world's 5th largest stock market by market capitalization?

A.Japan

B.South Korea

C.Hong Kong

D.Taiwan

E.Singapore

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

Taiwan Stock Exchange surpassed **India** to become the **world's 5th largest stock market** by market capitalization in **2026**.

Taiwan's market capitalisation reached approximately **USD 4.95 trillion**, while India's market capitalisation stood at around **USD 4.92 trillion**.

The rise of Taiwan was primarily driven by the **Artificial Intelligence (AI)-led semiconductor boom** spearheaded by **Taiwan Semiconductor Manufacturing Company (TSMC)**.

Detailed Explanation:

Taiwan Stock Exchange surpassed **India** to become the **world's 5th largest stock market** by market capitalization in **2026**.

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The rise of Taiwan was primarily driven by the **Artificial Intelligence (AI)-led semiconductor boom** spearheaded by **Taiwan**

Semiconductor Manufacturing Company (TSMC).

Despite Taiwan overtaking India in stock market size, India continues to have a **higher Gross Domestic Product (GDP)**.

According to the **Global Stock Market Rankings 2026**, the leading equity markets are **USA, China, Japan, Hong Kong, Taiwan, India, and South Korea**.

TSMC played a crucial role in Taiwan's rally, with its shares rising by approximately **45–50% during 2026**.

TSMC accounts for nearly **42% of the Taiex Index**, making it the **dominant driver** of Taiwan's stock market performance.

29. As of 2026, the National Institute of Securities Markets (NISM) signed a strategic partnership with which university to strengthen education in securities markets, fintech, and risk management?

A.Amity University

B.Galgotias University

C.Lovely Professional University

D.Sharda University

E.Bennett University

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The National Institute of Securities Markets (NISM), an educational and capacity-building institution established by **SEBI**, has entered into a strategic partnership with **Galgotias University, Uttar Pradesh**, to strengthen learning in **securities markets, financial services, derivatives, fintech, and risk management**.

The collaboration aims to enhance the university's **industry-linked learning ecosystem**, startup engagement, and **applied financial training programmes**, promoting entrepreneurship and fintech-oriented education.

Detailed Explanation:

The National Institute of Securities Markets (NISM), an educational and capacity-building institution established by **SEBI**, has entered into a strategic partnership with **Galgotias University, Uttar Pradesh**, to strengthen learning in **securities markets, financial services, derivatives, fintech, and risk management**.

The collaboration aims to enhance the university's **industry-linked learning ecosystem**, startup engagement, and **applied financial training programmes**, promoting entrepreneurship and fintech-oriented education.

The university's **School of Business** and **Centre for Capital Market Simulation** will provide students exposure to real-time market scenarios through the **SMART Lab** using the **NSMART platform**, enabling **simulation-based financial learning**.

Students will gain access to **NISM certifications**, e-learning modules, and **certification-linked learning pathways**, strengthening **employability in capital markets and financial services**.

Academic support will be provided in key areas such as **securities markets, mutual funds,**

equity derivatives, and portfolio management.

30. In 2026, who was appointed as the Chairman of the High-Level Committee constituted by the Government of India to study demographic changes arising from illegal immigration and other abnormal reasons?

A.Justice Prakash Prabhakar Navlekar (Retd.)

B.Justice Ranjan Gogoi (Retd.)

C.Justice U.U. Lalit (Retd.)

D.Durga Shankar Mishra

E.Balaji Srivastava

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

Government of India constituted a **High-Level Committee** to study demographic changes arising from **illegal immigration and other abnormal reasons**, and recommend measures to address them.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi announced the **High-Powered Demography Mission** on **15 August 2025**; **Union Cabinet** approved the proposal on **11 September 2025**.

Justice Prakash Prabhakar Navlekar (Retired) appointed as **Chairman** of the Committee.

Detailed Explanation:

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Prime Minister Narendra Modi announced the **High-Powered Demography Mission** on **15 August 2025**; **Union Cabinet** approved the proposal on **11 September 2025**.

Justice Prakash Prabhakar Navlekar (Retired) appointed as **Chairman** of the Committee.

Members of the Committee include **Census Commissioner**, **Durga Shankar Mishra**, **Balaji Srivastava**, **Dr. Shamika Ravi**.

Joint Secretary (Foreigners-I), Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA) appointed as **Member Secretary**.

Committee to submit its report within **1 year**, **Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA)** may extend the tenure by up to **6 months**, if required.

Terms of Reference include, **studying challenges arising from demographic changes and illegal immigration**, **examining causes such as cross-border activities, economic opportunities and socio-environmental factors**, **identifying factors behind illegal immigration, abnormal settlement patterns and orchestrated migration**.

31. In 2026, which institution conducted the National Family Health Survey-6 (NFHS-6) released by the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare?

A.National Statistical Office (NSO)

B.NITI Aayog

C.Registrar General of India

D.Indian Council of Medical Research (ICMR)
E.International Institute for Population Sciences (IIPS)
Answer: E
Short Explanation:
The **Ministry of Health and Family Welfare (MoHFW)** released the **National Family Health Survey-6 (NFHS-6)**, conducted during **2023-24**. The survey covered approximately **6.79 lakh households** across **715 districts** and serves as one of India's most important sources of **health and demographic data**.
The survey was conducted by the **International Institute for Population Sciences (IIPS), Mumbai**, the nodal agency for NFHS.
Detailed Explanation:
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The survey was conducted by the **International Institute for Population Sciences (IIPS), Mumbai**, the nodal agency for NFHS.
Maternal Healthcare Improvements: Antenatal Care (ANC) Coverage increased from **92.6% to 95.9%**, **First Trimester ANC Registration** from **70.0% to 76.2%**, **Four or More ANC Visits** from **58.5% to 65.2%**, **Institutional Deliveries** from **88.6% to 90.6%**, **Skilled Birth Attendance** from **89.4% to 91.3%**, **Postnatal Care within Two Days** from **79.1% to 85.3%**.
Institutional Deliveries reached a record high of **90.6%**, indicating improved access to healthcare facilities and skilled medical care.
Child Immunisation Improvements: Full Immunisation Coverage among children aged **12–23 months** increased from **83.8% to 87.1%**, **Any Vaccine Coverage** remained above **96%**, **95.6%** of vaccinations were administered through public health facilities, **Rotavirus Vaccine Coverage** increased from **36.4% to 85.4%**, **Second Dose of Measles Vaccine** increased from **58.6% to 71.8%**.

32. In April 2026, which airport became India's second-busiest domestic airport by overtaking Mumbai's Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj International Airport?
A.Indira Gandhi International Airport, Delhi
B.Rajiv Gandhi International Airport, Hyderabad
C.Kempegowda International Airport, Bengaluru
D.Chennai International Airport
E.Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose International Airport, Kolkata
Answer: C
Short Explanation:
Kempegowda International Airport, Bengaluru has overtaken **Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj International Airport, Mumbai** to become **India's second-busiest domestic airport**.

In **April 2026**, Bengaluru airport handled approximately **3.28 million domestic passengers**, compared to **2.89 million domestic passengers** at Mumbai airport.

The achievement reflects Bengaluru's growing importance as a major **technology, startup, and business hub**, driving strong demand for domestic air travel.

Detailed Explanation:

Kempegowda International Airport, Bengaluru has overtaken **Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj International Airport, Mumbai** to become **India's second-busiest domestic airport**.

In **April 2026**, Bengaluru airport handled approximately **3.28 million domestic passengers**, compared to **2.89 million domestic passengers** at Mumbai airport.

The achievement reflects Bengaluru's growing importance as a major **technology, startup, and business hub**, driving strong demand for domestic air travel.

Bengaluru airport benefits from **modern infrastructure, higher operational capacity, and a parallel runway system**, enabling airlines to increase flight frequencies and connectivity.

Airlines have expanded their domestic networks from Bengaluru, contributing to the airport's rapid growth in passenger traffic.

Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj International Airport, Mumbai, continues to face **capacity constraints, congestion, and slot saturation**, limiting the addition of new domestic services

33. As of 1 June 2026, South Coast Railway (SCoR), headquartered at Visakhapatnam, was created as which numbered Railway Zone of Indian Railways?

A.16th Railway Zone

B.17th Railway Zone

C.19th Railway Zone

D.18th Railway Zone

E.20th Railway Zone

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

Indian Railways unveiled a redesigned logo featuring **18 red stars**, marking the creation of **South Coast Railway (SCoR)** as India's **18th Railway Zone**, effective **1 June 2026**.

The revised logo was approved by the **Chairman and Chief Executive Officer (CEO), Railway Board**.

The **Ministry of Railways** issued a gazette notification on **4 May 2026** under the **Railways Act, 1989**, announcing the formation of **South Coast Railway (SCoR)**.

South Coast Railway (SCoR) has been formed through the reorganisation of parts of **East Coast Railway (ECoR)** and **South Central Railway (SCR)**.

Headquarters: Visakhapatnam, Andhra Pradesh. Headquarters project details: **Mudasarlova, Visakhapatnam**, **52.2 acres**, **₹183.58 crore** estimated cost.

Detailed Explanation:

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Headquarters: Visakhapatnam, Andhra Pradesh.

Headquarters project details: **Mudasarlova, Visakhapatnam**, **52.2 acres**, **₹183.58 crore** estimated cost.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi laid the foundation stone for the headquarters on **8 January 2025**.

Railway divisions under **South Coast Railway (SCoR)**: **Guntakal Division, Guntur Division, Vijayawada Division, Visakhapatnam Division**.

The existing **Waltair Division** will be bifurcated, one part will become **Visakhapatnam Division** under **South Coast Railway (SCoR)**, while the other part will merge with the newly created **Rayagada Division** under **East Coast Railway (ECoR)**.

34. In May 2026, who assumed charge as the Flag Officer Commanding-in-Chief (FOC-in-C) of the Western Naval Command?

A.Vice Admiral Krishna Swaminathan

B.Vice Admiral Sanjay Vatsayan

C.Vice Admiral Dinesh K. Tripathi

D.Vice Admiral Rajesh Pendharkar

E.Vice Admiral Tarun Sobti

Answer: B

Vice Admiral Sanjay Vatsayan, PVSM, AVSM, NM assumed charge as the **Flag Officer Commanding-in-Chief (FOC-in-C), Western Naval Command** on **30 May 2026** at a ceremonial parade held in **Mumbai, Maharashtra**.

Before this appointment, he served as the **Vice Chief of the Naval Staff (VCNS)** at Naval Headquarters, New Delhi.

On assuming charge, he paid tribute to the nation's martyrs at **Gaurav Stambh**, located in **Naval Dockyard, Mumbai**.

35. As of 2026, who was elected as the Prime Minister of Slovenia for a fourth term, succeeding Robert Golob?

A.Borut Pahor

B.Robert Golob

C.Janez Janša

D.Nataša Pirc Musar

E.Marjan Šarec

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

Detailed Explanation:

Nationalist politician **Janez Janša**, leader of the **Slovenian Democratic Party (SDS)**, was elected as the **Prime Minister (PM) of Slovenia** for a **fourth term**.

Janez Janša secured **51 votes** in the 90-member **National Assembly (Parliament)**, obtaining the required support to form a new government.

He succeeded **Robert Golob** as the Prime Minister of Slovenia.

The **Parliamentary Approval with 51 votes** paved the way for the formation of a **new coalition government** in Slovenia.

36. In June 2026, the second India–Australia Defence Ministers' Dialogue was co-chaired by Raksha Mantri Rajnath Singh and which Australian leader?

A.Anthony Albanese

B.Penny Wong

C.David Littleproud

D.Peter Dutton

E.Richard Marles

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

The **second edition** of the **India–Australia Defence Ministers' Dialogue** was co-chaired by Raksha Mantri **Shri Rajnath Singh** and Australian Deputy Prime Minister & Defence Minister **Mr Richard Marles** at the **Manekshaw Centre, New Delhi** on **01 June 2026**.

Both sides reviewed significant progress in bilateral defence relations, building on enhanced consultations since the first dialogue held on **09 October 2025**.

The Ministers reaffirmed their commitment to advancing the vision of their respective Prime Ministers to strengthen **defence cooperation, collective security, and regional peace** in the **Indo-Pacific**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **second edition** of the **India–Australia Defence Ministers' Dialogue** was co-chaired by Raksha Mantri **Shri Rajnath Singh** and Australian Deputy Prime Minister & Defence Minister **Mr Richard Marles** at the **Manekshaw Centre, New Delhi** on **01 June 2026**.

Both sides reviewed significant progress in bilateral defence relations, building on enhanced consultations since the first dialogue held on **09 October 2025**.

The Ministers reaffirmed their commitment to advancing the vision of their respective Prime Ministers to strengthen **defence cooperation, collective security, and regional peace** in the **Indo-Pacific**.

They welcomed progress toward updating the **Joint Declaration on Defence and Security Cooperation**, aimed at deepening long-term strategic alignment.

Both sides focused on strengthening maritime security cooperation, including finalisation of a **Joint Maritime Security Collaboration Roadmap**.

They agreed to enhance **Maritime Domain Awareness (MDA)** through maritime patrol

aircraft operations and explore improved undersea domain awareness capabilities.

37. In May 2026, which Indian Air Force (IAF) aircraft transported the sacred relics of Arahant Sariputta and Arahant Mahamoggallana from India to Mongolia?

A.C-17 Globemaster III

B.C-130J Super Hercules

C.AN-32

D.IL-76 Gajraj

E.Dornier Do-228

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

An **Indian Air Force (IAF) IL-76 strategic airlift aircraft**, **Gajraj**, transported the **sacred relics of Arahant Sariputta and Arahant Mahamoggallana**, the chief disciples of Gautama Buddha, from **Delhi to Mongolia** on **30 May 2026**.

The mission was carried out using the **IL-76 Gajraj**, one of the IAF's key **strategic airlift aircraft**.

Detailed Explanation:

An **Indian Air Force (IAF) IL-76 strategic airlift aircraft**, **Gajraj**, transported the **sacred relics of Arahant Sariputta and Arahant Mahamoggallana**, the chief disciples of Gautama Buddha, from **Delhi to Mongolia** on **30 May 2026**.

The mission was carried out using the **IL-76 Gajraj**, one of the IAF's key **strategic airlift aircraft**.

The aircraft undertook an **overnight flight** and landed in Mongolia at **1125 hrs IST**.

Arahant Sariputta and Arahant Mahamoggallana are revered as the **chief disciples of Gautama Buddha** in Buddhist tradition.

The airlift mission was undertaken in support of India's **cultural diplomacy** efforts and to **strengthen ties with friendly nations**.

38. In June 2026, Dr. Jitendra Singh launched the AI-enabled CPGRAMS Voice Chatbot developed by DARPG in collaboration with Bhashini. What is the name of the chatbot?

A.Jan Mitra

B.Samadhan Didi

C.Seva Sakhi

D.Grievance Mitra

E.Pragati Didi

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The Union Minister of State (Independent Charge) for Science and Technology and Earth Sciences, and Minister of State for PMO, Department of Atomic Energy, Department of Space, and Personnel, Public Grievances and Pensions, **Dr. Jitendra Singh** launched the **CPGRAMS AI-enabled Voice Chatbot "Samadhan Didi"** at **Kartavya Bhawan, New Delhi**.

The chatbot was developed by the **Department of Administrative Reforms and Public Grievances (DARPG)** in collaboration with **Bhashini**.

Dr. Jitendra Singh described the initiative as the **"Democratization of the Public Grievance Mechanism"**, aimed at enhancing the **Ease of Using** public services for citizens.

Detailed Explanation:

The Union Minister of State (Independent Charge) for Science and Technology and Earth Sciences, and Minister of State for PMO, Department of Atomic Energy, Department of Space, and Personnel, Public Grievances and Pensions, **Dr. Jitendra Singh** launched the **CPGRAMS AI-enabled Voice Chatbot "Samadhan Didi"** at **Kartavya Bhawan, New Delhi**.

The chatbot was developed by the **Department of Administrative Reforms and Public Grievances (DARPG)** in collaboration with **Bhashini**.

Dr. Jitendra Singh described the initiative as the **"Democratization of the Public Grievance Mechanism"**, aimed at enhancing the **Ease of Using** public services for citizens.

The chatbot leverages **Artificial Intelligence (AI)** to make **grievance redressal** more accessible, responsive, efficient, and citizen-centric.

Samadhan Didi enables citizens to **register grievances simply by speaking in their own language**, without needing to know the concerned ministry, department, category, or sub-category.

The chatbot can understand the grievance, **ask relevant follow-up questions**, and **automatically identify** the appropriate Ministry, Department, category, and sub-category before filing the complaint.

The system combines the **language capabilities of Bhashini** with **grievance-classification models** trained on CPGRAMS data.

The platform has been developed within **secure Government infrastructure**, ensuring **data privacy and security**.

39. In 2026, India became the world's 5th country with indigenous stratospheric balloon capability following the launch of which Super Pressure Balloon (SPB) under Mission SANA?

A.VISTA

B.GARUDA

C.AKASHA

D.UDAAN

E.PRAGYAN

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

Red Balloon Aerospace Private Limited, an Indian space startup, launched India's first indigenous **Stratospheric Super Pressure Balloon (SPB)** named **"VISTA"** under **Mission SANA** from **Indira Gandhi Stadium, Vijayawada, Andhra Pradesh (AP)**.

With this achievement, India became the **5th country in the world** with indigenous stratospheric balloon capability, joining the **United States (USA), France, Japan, and China**.

Detailed Explanation:

Red Balloon Aerospace Private Limited, an Indian space startup, launched India's first indigenous **Stratospheric Super Pressure Balloon (SPB)** named **"VISTA"** under **Mission SANA** from **Indira Gandhi Stadium, Vijayawada, Andhra Pradesh (AP)**.

With this achievement, India became the **5th country in the world** with indigenous stratospheric balloon capability, joining the **United States (USA), France, Japan, and China**.

Red Balloon Aerospace is a **Vijayawada-based space-tech company** founded in **May 2025** by two former executives of **Skyroot Aerospace**.

The **VISTA Super Pressure Balloon Platform** ascended to an altitude of approximately **25 kilometres (km)** above the Earth.

The mission carried **payloads from 7 national and international partners**, demonstrating India's growing capabilities in near-space technologies.

The payloads were designed to test **biological experiment systems, propulsion technologies, earth observation sensors, onboard computing platforms, and navigation validation systems**.

40. As of 2026, which Indian city was awarded the hosting rights for the 2028 Asian Indoor Athletics Championships by the Asian Athletics Association (AAA)?

A.New Delhi

B.Chennai

C.Chandigarh

D.Bhubaneswar

E.Hyderabad

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

The **Asian Athletics Association (AAA)** awarded hosting rights for the **Asian Relays 2027** to **Chandigarh** and the **Asian Indoor Athletics Championships 2028** to **Bhubaneswar** during its Executive Council meeting in **Hong Kong, China**.

Chandigarh will host the **3rd edition of the Asian Relays**.

The **inaugural Asian Relays** was held in **Bangkok, Thailand, in 2024**.

The **2nd Asian Relays** will be held in **Shaoxing, China**, from **20–21 June 2026**.

Bhubaneswar will host the **Asian Indoor Athletics Championships 2028** at the **Kalinga Stadium**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Asian Athletics Association (AAA)** awarded hosting rights for the **Asian Relays 2027** to **Chandigarh** and the **Asian Indoor Athletics Championships 2028** to **Bhubaneswar** during its Executive Council meeting in **Hong Kong, China**.

Chandigarh will host the **3rd edition of the Asian Relays**.

The **inaugural Asian Relays** was held in **Bangkok, Thailand, in 2024**.

The **2nd Asian Relays** will be held in **Shaoxing, China**, from **20–21 June 2026**.

Bhubaneswar will host the **Asian Indoor Athletics Championships 2028** at the **Kalinga Stadium**.

The **Kalinga Stadium, Bhubaneswar**, will also host the **World Indoor Championships 2028** from **3–5 March 2028**.

Earlier in 2026, the **inaugural National Open Indoor Athletics Championships** was organised at the **Kalinga Stadium Indoor Facility**.

During the event, Gurindervir Singh set a new Men's 60-metre National Record by clocking 6.60 seconds.

41. In 2026, who authored the book "India's Olympic Gold: Hockey Triumph at Amsterdam", released to commemorate India's first Olympic hockey gold medal?

A.K. Arumugam

B.Harbinder Singh

C.Ashok Kumar

D.Zafar Iqbal

E.P.T. Usha

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

Indian Olympic Association (IOA) President P.T. Usha and **Hockey India President Dr. Dilip Tirkey** released the book **"India's Olympic Gold: Hockey Triumph at Amsterdam"** in **New Delhi.**

The book has been authored by K**. Arumugam, a renowned hockey historian**.

The publication was released by **Hockey India** and **Stick2Hockey** to mark the **98th anniversary of India's first Olympic Gold Medal in hockey**.

Detailed Explanation:

Indian Olympic Association (IOA) President P.T. Usha and **Hockey India President Dr. Dilip Tirkey** released the book **"India's Olympic Gold: Hockey Triumph at Amsterdam"** in **New Delhi.**

The book has been authored by K**. Arumugam, a renowned hockey historian**.

The publication was released by **Hockey India** and **Stick2Hockey** to mark the **98th anniversary of India's first Olympic Gold Medal in hockey**.

The book commemorates India's historic victory at the **1928 Amsterdam Olympics**, where the **Indian Men's Hockey Team** won its first Olympic gold medal.

India defeated the **Netherlands** in the final to secure the gold medal during the British colonial period.

The event was attended by noted hockey legends, including Harbinder Singh, Jagbir Singh, Zafar Iqbal, and Ashok Kumar.

The book is the **16th publication** authored by **K. Arumugam**, highlighting his significant contribution to documenting the history of Indian hockey.

42. In IPL 2026, Vaibhav Sooryavanshi broke whose record for the most sixes in a single Indian Premier League season?

A.AB de Villiers

B.Virat Kohli

C.Andre Russell

D.Chris Gayle

E.Rohit Sharma

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

Vaibhav Sooryavanshi, the **15-year-old Rajasthan Royals opener**, created history during the **Indian Premier League (IPL) 2026 Eliminator** against **Sunrisers Hyderabad** at the **Maharaja Yadavindra Singh International Cricket Stadium, New Chandigarh**.

He broke **Chris Gayle's** record for the **most sixes in a single Indian Premier League season**, surpassing Gayle's tally of **59 sixes** set in **2012**.

Detailed Explanation:

Vaibhav Sooryavanshi, the **15-year-old Rajasthan Royals opener**, created history during the **Indian Premier League (IPL) 2026 Eliminator** against **Sunrisers Hyderabad** at the **Maharaja Yadavindra Singh International Cricket Stadium, New Chandigarh**.

He broke **Chris Gayle's** record for the **most sixes in a single Indian Premier League season**, surpassing Gayle's tally of **59 sixes** set in **2012**.

Vaibhav achieved the milestone by hitting his **61st six** and later extended his tally to **65 sixes** in the season.

He also became the **youngest player in Indian Premier League history** to score **600 runs in a single season**.

The previous record was held by Rishabh Pant, who achieved the feat in **2018** while playing for **Delhi Daredevils**.

43. As of 2026, World Milk Day is observed annually on which date?

A.22 April

B.5 June

C.1 June

D.16 October

E.10 July

Answer: C

World Milk Day is observed every year on **1 June** to recognize the importance of milk and the dairy sector in nutrition, livelihoods, and sustainable development.

The day was established by the **Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO) of the United Nations (UN)** and was first celebrated globally on **1 June 2001**.

The observance highlights milk as a **globally important food** and acknowledges the contribution of the dairy industry to economic growth, food security, and nutrition.

The **Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO)** coordinates and promotes World Milk Day celebrations worldwide.

44. In which year did the United Nations General Assembly (UNGA) proclaim 1 June as the annual Global Day of Parents?

A.2008

B.2010

C.2011

D.2012
E.2015
Answer: D
Global Day of Parents is observed every year on **1 June** to honour parents worldwide for their selfless commitment, sacrifice, and lifelong dedication to nurturing and supporting their children.
The day recognizes the critical role of parents in the upbringing, protection, education, and overall development of children.
In **2012**, the **United Nations General Assembly (UNGA)** proclaimed **1 June** as the **Global Day of Parents**, to be observed annually.

45. In news, International Sex Workers' Day (International Whores' Day) is observed annually on which date?
A.2 June
B.15 May
C.1 June
D.8 March
E.10 December
Answer: A
International Sex Workers' Day is observed annually on **2 June** to highlight the rights, dignity, safety, and working conditions of sex workers around the world.
The day is also known as **International Whores' Day** and commemorates the struggle against discrimination, stigma, violence, and exploitation faced by sex workers.
The observance traces its origins to **2 June 1975**, when approximately **100 sex workers in France** occupied **Saint-Nizier Church in Lyon** to protest against the criminalisation of their work and poor living conditions.

46. As per the news, Telangana Formation Day is observed every year on 2 June to commemorate the creation of Telangana as the 29th state of India in which year?
A.2009
B.2011
C.2013
D.2012
E.2014
Answer: E
Telangana Formation Day is observed every year on **2 June** to commemorate the formation of **Telangana** as the **29th state of India** in **2014**.
The day marks the separation of Telangana from the erstwhile **Andhra Pradesh** after a prolonged statehood movement.
Telangana officially came into existence on **2 June 2014** under the provisions of the **Andhra Pradesh Reorganisation Act, 2014**.
On **1 November 1956**, the Telangana region of the former **Hyderabad State** was merged with **Andhra State** to form the unified state of **Andhra Pradesh** for Telugu-speaking people.

47. Renowned Urdu poet Bashir Badr, who passed away in 2026, was primarily associated with which language of poetry?

A.Hindi
B.Persian
C.Punjabi
D.Urdu
E.Sanskrit
Answer: D
Short Explanation:
Renowned Urdu poet, **Padma Shri awardee**, **Bashir Badr** passed away at the age of **91** in **Bhopal, Madhya Pradesh (MP)**.
Bashir Badr was born in **1935** in **Ayodhya, Uttar Pradesh (UP)**.
He served as a faculty member at **Meerut College** until **1990**, a period considered the most significant phase of his literary and poetic career.
The Government of India (GoI) conferred the **Padma Shri** on Bashir Badr in **1999** for his outstanding contribution to **Literature and Education**.
Detailed Explanation:
Renowned Urdu poet, **Padma Shri awardee**, **Bashir Badr** passed away at the age of **91** in **Bhopal, Madhya Pradesh (MP)**.
Bashir Badr was born in **1935** in **Ayodhya, Uttar Pradesh (UP)**.
He served as a faculty member at **Meerut College** until **1990**, a period considered the most significant phase of his literary and poetic career.
During his teaching career, he gained recognition both in India and internationally for his **distinctive contribution to Urdu poetry**.
Bashir Badr is credited with giving Urdu poetry a **modern identity** through his use of **simple, everyday language**, making his poetry accessible to a wider audience.
The Government of India (GoI) conferred the **Padma Shri** on Bashir Badr in **1999** for his outstanding contribution to **Literature and Education**.
He was also awarded the **Sahitya Akademi Award (Urdu)** in **1999** for his celebrated poetry collection **Aas**, which contains 69 ghazals and is regarded as one of his finest works.

48. As of 2026, what is the capital of Slovenia?
A.Zagreb
B.Bratislava
C.Ljubljana
D.Belgrade
E.Sofia
Answer: C
About Slovenia :
President : Nataša Pirc Musar
Capital : Ljubljana
Currency : Euro

49. As of 2026, what is the currency of Mongolia?
A.Yuan
B.Tenge
C.Som
D.Tögrög
E.Ruble
Answer: D

About Mongolia :

President : Ukhnaagiin Khürelsükh

Prime Minister : Nyam-Osoryn Uchral

Capital : Ulaanbaatar

Currency : Tögrög

50. As of 2026, which airport remains India's busiest airport in both domestic and overall passenger traffic categories?

A.Indira Gandhi International Airport, New Delhi

B.Kempegowda International Airport, Bengaluru

C.Rajiv Gandhi International Airport, Hyderabad

D.Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj International Airport, Mumbai

E.Chennai International Airport

Answer: A

Navi Mumbai International Airport is rapidly expanding its domestic connectivity and is expected to handle a growing share of passenger traffic from the **Mumbai Metropolitan Region**.

Despite Bengaluru's rise, **Indira Gandhi International Airport, New Delhi**, remains **India's busiest airport** in both **domestic and overall passenger traffic** categories.

Delhi's leadership is supported by **high passenger volumes, extensive domestic and international connectivity, and strong infrastructure capacity**.

51. Which insurance company partnered with West Bengal Gramin Bank (WBGB) to leverage its network of 960 branches across West Bengal for expanding life insurance coverage in rural and semi-urban areas?

A.HDFC Life Insurance

B.SBI Life Insurance

C.ICICI Prudential Life Insurance

D.Canara HSBC Life Insurance

E.Bajaj Allianz Life Insurance

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

West Bengal Gramin Bank (WBGB), one of India's largest Regional Rural Banks (RRBs), partnered with **Canara HSBC Life Insurance Company Limited** to expand life insurance coverage across **rural and semi-urban areas of West Bengal**.

The collaboration was formalized in the presence of **Alok K. Goel** (Chairman of WBGB) and **Soly Thomas** (Deputy CEO and Chief Distribution Officer (CDO) of Canara HSBC Life Insurance).

Detailed Explanation:

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The collaboration was formalized in the presence of **Alok K. Goel** (Chairman of WBGB) and **Soly Thomas** (Deputy CEO and Chief Distribution Officer (CDO) of Canara HSBC Life Insurance).

Under the partnership, Canara HSBC Life Insurance will leverage WBGB's network of **960**

branches across West Bengal to distribute its insurance products.

The collaboration aims to **enhance insurance penetration** and improve **financial security** among customers in rural and semi-urban regions.

The partnership will provide access to a wide range of life insurance products, including solutions for **protection, savings, long-term wealth creation, and family financial security**.

The initiative is expected to strengthen **financial inclusion** by making insurance services more accessible to **underserved communities**.

52. Which premier educational institute partnered with Bajaj Finserv Limited to launch the "Bajaj Finserv Intelligence" initiative focusing on AI, cybersecurity, quantum technologies, and retail innovation systems?

A.Indian Institute of Technology Delhi

B.Indian Institute of Technology Madras

C.Indian Institute of Technology Bombay

D.Indian Institute of Technology Kanpur

E.Indian Institute of Technology Kharagpur

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

Bajaj Finserv Limited (BFS), one of India's leading diversified financial services companies, in partnership with **Indian Institute of Technology Bombay**, has launched a new initiative called **"Bajaj Finserv Intelligence"** in **Mumbai, Maharashtra**.

The initiative aims to strengthen India's **Artificial Intelligence (AI) and deep technology research and innovation ecosystem**.

Finserv Intelligence is designed as a **long-term strategic programme (5–10 years horizon)** focused on building next-generation technologies.

The company has committed an investment of **₹1,500–₹2,000 crore over 5 years** in **AI innovation startups**.

Detailed Explanation:

Bajaj Finserv Limited (BFS), one of India's leading diversified financial services companies, in partnership with **Indian Institute of Technology Bombay**, has launched a new initiative called **"Bajaj Finserv Intelligence"** in **Mumbai, Maharashtra**.

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Finserv Intelligence is designed as a **long-term strategic programme (5–10 years horizon)** focused on building next-generation technologies.

The company has committed an investment of **₹1,500–₹2,000 crore over 5 years** in **AI innovation startups**.

A **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** and **Master Collaboration Agreement** have been signed with **IIT Bombay** to establish a **joint research centre**.

The collaboration will focus on key emerging technologies including **Artificial Intelligence**

(AI), cybersecurity, quantum technologies, and retail innovation systems.

Beyond financial services, the initiative will also expand into sectors such as **digital financial inclusion, health technology, preventive healthcare, and climate solutions**.

53. Which Japanese financial institution entered into a strategic partnership with HDFC Capital Advisors Limited to invest in affordable and mid-income housing projects in India, marking its first-ever real estate investment in the country?

A.Japan Bank for International Cooperation (JBIC)

B.Sumitomo Mitsui Banking Corporation (SMBC)

C.Mizuho Bank

D.Development Bank of Japan (DBJ)

E.Norinchukin Bank

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

Japanese financial institution **Development Bank of Japan (DBJ)** entered into a strategic partnership with **HDFC Capital Advisors Limited** to invest in **affordable and mid-income housing projects** in India.

The partnership aims to create a total targeted investment corpus of **USD 1 billion** for supporting residential real estate development across India.

This collaboration marks **DBJ's first-ever real estate investment in India**, making it a significant milestone in **India–Japan investment relations**.

Under the partnership, DBJ has committed capital to the **HDFC Capital Development of Real Estate Affordable and Mid-Income Fund (H-DREAM Fund)**.

Detailed Explanation:

Japanese financial institution **Development Bank of Japan (DBJ)** entered into a strategic partnership with **HDFC Capital Advisors Limited** to invest in **affordable and mid-income housing projects** in India.

The partnership aims to create a total targeted investment corpus of **USD 1 billion** for supporting residential real estate development across India.

This collaboration marks **DBJ's first-ever real estate investment in India**, making it a significant milestone in **India–Japan investment relations**.

Under the partnership, DBJ has committed capital to the **HDFC Capital Development of Real Estate Affordable and Mid-Income Fund (H-DREAM Fund)**.

The **H-DREAM Fund** is managed by **HDFC Capital Advisors Limited**, one of India's largest real estate private equity fund managers.

The fund is focused on accelerating the development of **affordable housing and mid-income housing projects** in India.

The H-DREAM Fund has a **target corpus of USD 500 million**, along with a **USD 500 million green shoe option**, taking the potential total size to **USD 1 billion**.

The fund has already secured more than **USD 350 million** in investment commitments from investors.

54. As per the Supreme Court Bench comprising Justice Manoj Misra and Justice Manmohan, who will head the committee constituted to prepare the Yamuna Action Plan?

A.Union Home Secretary

B.Chief Secretary of Delhi

C.Union Minister of Jal Shakti

D.Chairman of the Central Pollution Control Board

E.Secretary, Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

Supreme Court Bench comprising **Justice Manoj Misra** and **Justice Manmohan** constituted a committee to prepare a **Yamuna Action Plan**.

Committee to be headed by the **Union Home Secretary**.

Members will include the **Chief Secretaries of all States and Union Territories through which the Yamuna River flows**.

Supreme Court directed the committee to submit a **comprehensive action plan within 8 weeks**.

Detailed Explanation:

Supreme Court Bench comprising **Justice Manoj Misra** and **Justice Manmohan** constituted a committee to prepare a **Yamuna Action Plan**.

Committee to be headed by the **Union Home Secretary**.

Members will include the **Chief Secretaries of all States and Union Territories through which the Yamuna River flows**.

Supreme Court directed the committee to submit a **comprehensive action plan within 8 weeks**.

Plan must clearly specify **objectives, implementation strategy, roles and responsibilities of agencies, budgetary allocations, and timelines**.

Court directed that **coordination and monitoring should be entrusted to a single authority**.

Aim is to strengthen efforts for **cleaning, rejuvenation, and sustainable management of the Yamuna River**.

Yamuna River serves as a lifeline for more than **57 million people in the National Capital Region (NCR)**.

55. Which African organization received emergency medical assistance from India, including diagnostic kits, therapeutic medicines, and protective equipment, to support Ebola response efforts in affected areas such as the Democratic Republic of the Congo (DRC)?

A.African Union (AU)

B.World Health Organization Africa Office (WHO AFRO)

C.United Nations Economic Commission for Africa (UNECA)

D.East African Community (EAC)

E.Africa Centres for Disease Control and Prevention (Africa CDC)

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

India has provided emergency medical assistance to the **Africa Centres for Disease Control and Prevention (Africa CDC)** to support efforts against the ongoing Ebola outbreak in Africa.

The first tranche of medical supplies and protective equipment was handed over by **Upender Singh Rawat**, India's High Commissioner to Uganda.

The assistance was delivered to the **Eastern Africa Regional Coordinating Centre** of Africa CDC in Uganda.

The supplies will support Ebola response operations in affected areas, particularly in the **Democratic Republic of the Congo (DRC)**.

Detailed Explanation:

India has provided emergency medical assistance to the **Africa Centres for Disease Control and Prevention (Africa CDC)** to support efforts against the ongoing Ebola outbreak in Africa.

The first tranche of medical supplies and protective equipment was handed over by **Upender Singh Rawat**, India's High Commissioner to Uganda.

The assistance was delivered to the **Eastern Africa Regional Coordinating Centre** of Africa CDC in Uganda.

The supplies will support Ebola response operations in affected areas, particularly in the **Democratic Republic of the Congo (DRC)**.

The emergency consignment includes **diagnostic kits, therapeutic medicines, infection prevention and control materials, protective equipment, and case management supplies**.

The aid is aimed at strengthening local healthcare systems and supporting frontline healthcare workers.

The **Ministry of External Affairs (MEA)** stated that India remains committed to providing further support as the situation evolves.

External Affairs Minister S. Jaishankar reaffirmed India's commitment to assisting African nations during the health emergency.

Africa CDC welcomed India's contribution and acknowledged its role in supporting health security across the continent.

56. What was the total number of Padma Awards approved by the President of India for the year 2026, as announced on the eve of Republic Day?

A.66

B.100

C.121

D.131

E.150

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

President **Droupadi Murmu** conferred **Padma Awards 2026** on **66 distinguished personalities** during the **First Civil Investiture Ceremony** held at **Rashtrapati Bhavan, New Delhi**.

The ceremony recognised outstanding contributions in **art, sports, medicine, public affairs, trade and industry, and other fields**.

Awards presented during the first phase included **2 Padma Vibhushan, 6 Padma Bhushan, and 58 Padma Shri** awards.

The **Padma Awards** are announced annually on the eve of **Republic Day** and recognise exceptional achievements across various fields.

For **2026**, the President approved a total of **131 Padma Awards**, comprising:

Padma Vibhushan – 5

Padma Bhushan – 13

Padma Shri – 113

Detailed Explanation:

President **Droupadi Murmu** conferred **Padma Awards 2026** on **66 distinguished personalities** during the **First Civil Investiture Ceremony** held at **Rashtrapati Bhavan, New Delhi**.

The ceremony recognised outstanding contributions in **art, sports, medicine, public affairs, trade and industry, and other fields**.

Awards presented during the first phase included **2 Padma Vibhushan, 6 Padma Bhushan, and 58 Padma Shri** awards.

The ceremony was attended by **Prime Minister Narendra Modi**, **Vice President C. P. Radhakrishnan**, **Union Home Minister Amit Shah**, and other senior dignitaries.

Padma Vibhushan Awardees

Late Dharmendra Singh Deol (Posthumous) – Art (Indian Cinema).

Dr. N. Rajam – Indian Classical Music.

Padma Bhushan Awardees

Bhagat Singh Koshyari – Public Affairs.

Dr. R. Ganesh – Art.

Uday Suresh Kotak – Trade and Industry.

Dr. Kallipatti Ramasamy Palanisamy – Medicine.

Padma Shri Awardees

Harmanpreet Kaur – Sports.

Taga Ram Bheel – Art.

Ratilal Mohanlal Borisagar.

Swami Brahmdev.

Kumar Bose.

Along with several other distinguished personalities.

The **Padma Awards** are announced annually on the eve of **Republic Day** and recognise exceptional achievements across various fields.

For **2026**, the President approved a total of **131 Padma Awards**, comprising:

Padma Vibhushan – 5

Padma Bhushan – 13

Padma Shri – 113

The remaining awardees will be honoured during the **Second Civil Investiture Ceremony** later in 2026.

57. Which special award was conferred upon Dr. Shaya Mohsin Zindani, Prime Minister

and Minister of Foreign Affairs and Expatriates of Yemen, by the World Health Organization on World No Tobacco Day 2026?

A.WHO Lifetime Achievement Award
B.WHO Tobacco Control Excellence Award
C.WHO Director-General Special Award
D.WHO World No Tobacco Day Gold Medal
E.WHO Global Health Leadership Award

Answer: C

The **World Health Organization (WHO)** announced the **World No Tobacco Day 2026 Awards**, recognising individuals, government agencies, researchers, and organisations for outstanding contributions to tobacco control.

The awards honour efforts in reducing tobacco consumption, strengthening tobacco-control policies, promoting public awareness, and supporting smoking cessation initiatives.

The awards cover recipients from all **six WHO regions**.

WHO Director-General Special Award 2026

Dr. Shaya Mohsin Zindani, Prime Minister and Minister of Foreign Affairs and Expatriates of Yemen, received the **WHO Director-General Special Award**.

About World Health Organization (WHO)

Established: 7 April 1948

Headquarters: Geneva

Parent Organization: United Nations

Director-General: Tedros Adhanom Ghebreyesus

About World No Tobacco Day

World No Tobacco Day: Observed annually on **31 May**.

Objective of World No Tobacco Day: Raise awareness about the harmful effects of tobacco use and encourage effective tobacco-control policies.

58. What is the name of the biodegradable material, made from tamarind seed powder, developed by Indian teenagers Vivaan Chhawchharia, Ariana Agarwal, and Avyana Mehta that won The Earth Prize 2026 for removing microplastics from contaminated water?

A.Plas-Stick
B.Tamri-Clean
C.GreenStick
D.Eco-Plast
E.MicroBind

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

Indian teenagers **Vivaan Chhawchharia**, **Ariana Agarwal**, and **Avyana Mehta** won **The Earth Prize 2026**, becoming the **first team from India** to secure the global award.

The students developed **Plas-Stick**, a biodegradable material made from **tamarind seed powder** that can effectively remove **microplastics from contaminated water**.

Detailed Explanation:

Indian teenagers **Vivaan Chhawchharia**, **Ariana Agarwal**, and **Avyana**

Mehta won **The Earth Prize 2026**, becoming the **first team from India** to secure the global award.

The students developed **Plas-Stick**, a biodegradable material made from **tamarind seed powder** that can effectively remove **microplastics from contaminated water**.

The Earth Prize is an international competition that recognises innovative environmental solutions developed by young people.

The global winners were selected through **public voting**, with nearly **23,000 votes** cast worldwide among seven regional finalists.

Plas-Stick is produced from tamarind seed powder, an agricultural by-product that is widely available in India.

59. Which initiative inspired Valluvan, the 58-year-old farmer from Pollachi, Tamil Nadu, to adopt tree-based agriculture and agroforestry practices, ultimately leading to his recognition as a UN FAO Soil Farmer Hero?

A.National Mission for Sustainable Agriculture

B.Cauvery Calling Initiative

C.Green India Mission

D.Soil Health Card Scheme

E.Paramparagat Krishi Vikas Yojana

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Valluvan, a **58-year-old farmer from Pollachi, Tamil Nadu**, has been recognised as a **United Nations Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO) Soil Farmer Hero** for adopting sustainable agricultural practices.

He transformed a loss-making coconut farm into a profitable **multi-crop agroforestry enterprise**, improving both income and soil health.

Before **2009**, Valluvan spent around **₹500 per coconut tree annually** but earned only about **₹300**, resulting in continuous losses.

Inspired by the **Cauvery Calling Initiative**, he adopted **tree-based agriculture and agroforestry practices** as a sustainable farming model.

Detailed Explanation:

Valluvan, a **58-year-old farmer from Pollachi, Tamil Nadu**, has been recognised as a **United Nations Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO) Soil Farmer Hero** for adopting sustainable agricultural practices.

He transformed a loss-making coconut farm into a profitable **multi-crop agroforestry enterprise**, improving both income and soil health.

Before **2009**, Valluvan spent around **₹500 per coconut tree annually** but earned only about **₹300**, resulting in continuous losses.

Inspired by the **Cauvery Calling Initiative**, he adopted **tree-based agriculture and agroforestry practices** as a sustainable farming model.

Earlier cultivating only **three crop varieties**, he now grows more than **14 crops**, including **coconut, nutmeg, pepper, turmeric,**

elephant yam, curry leaves, and seven varieties of banana.

Crop diversification created multiple income streams, reducing dependence on a single crop and improving resilience against market and climate-related risks.

His annual income increased significantly from around **₹30,000 per acre** to between **₹2.5 lakh and ₹3 lakh per acre**.

About The Food and Agriculture Organization

Headquartered in Rome, Italy

Date of Formation: October 16, 1945

The Director-General: Dr. QU Dongyu

60. Which position did Air Marshal Tarun Chaudhry assume on 01 June 2026, succeeding Air Marshal Balakrishnan Manikantan upon his superannuation after 40 years of service?

A.Chief of the Air Staff (CAS)

B.Deputy Chief of the Air Staff (DCAS)

C.Air Officer Commanding-in-Chief (AOC-in-C), Central Air Command

D.Commandant of the National Defence Academy (NDA)

E.Director General of Air Operations (DGAO)

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

Air Marshal Tarun Chaudhry, AVSM, VSM assumed charge as the **Air Officer Commanding-in-Chief (AOC-in-C), Central Air Command** on **01 June 2026**.

He succeeds **Air Marshal Balakrishnan Manikantan, PVSM, AVSM, VM**, who superannuated on **31 May 2026** after 40 years of distinguished service.

Detailed Explanation:

Air Marshal Tarun Chaudhry, AVSM, VSM assumed charge as the **Air Officer Commanding-in-Chief (AOC-in-C), Central Air Command** on **01 June 2026**.

He was commissioned into the **Fighter stream** of the **Indian Air Force (IAF)** in **December 1989**, marking over three decades of distinguished service.

He is an alumnus of premier military institutions including **National Defence Academy (NDA), Defence Services Staff College (DSSC), College of Air Warfare, and National Defence College (NDC)**.

During his career, he has held key operational, staff, and diplomatic appointments, reflecting a wide-ranging professional experience in the IAF.

He succeeds **Air Marshal Balakrishnan Manikantan, PVSM, AVSM, VM**, who superannuated on **31 May 2026** after 40 years of distinguished service.

61. Which 1989-batch IAS officer of the Kerala cadre, currently serving as Defence Secretary, was assigned the additional charge of Secretary, Department of Defence Research and Development (DDR&D) and Chairman of DRDO on 31 May 2026, succeeding Dr. Samir V. Kamat?

A.Ajay Kumar Singh

B.Rajesh Kumar Singh
C.Rajiv Gauba
D.Sanjay Malhotra
E.T. V. Somanathan
Answer: B
Short Explanation:
Defence Secretary, Ministry of Defence (MoD) Rajesh Kumar Singh has been assigned the **additional charge** of **Secretary, Department of Defence Research and Development (DDR&D)** and **Chairman of Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO)**, in addition to his existing responsibilities.
He assumed the additional charge on **31 May 2026**, after the completion of the tenure of **Dr. Samir V. Kamat**.
Detailed Explanation:
Defence Secretary, Ministry of Defence (MoD) Rajesh Kumar Singh has been assigned the **additional charge** of **Secretary, Department of Defence Research and Development (DDR&D)** and **Chairman of Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO)**, in addition to his existing responsibilities.
He assumed the additional charge on **31 May 2026**, after the completion of the tenure of **Dr. Samir V. Kamat**.
He is a **1989-batch Indian Administrative Service (IAS) officer** of the **Kerala cadre**.
He earlier served as **Officer on Special Duty (Defence Secretary-designate)** on **20 August 2024**, before formally becoming the Defence Secretary.
He previously held the position of **Secretary, Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT)** under the Ministry of Commerce and Industry (MoC&I) from **April 2023 to August 2024**.
He also served as **Secretary, Department of Animal Husbandry and Dairying** under the Ministry of Fisheries, Animal Husbandry and Dairying (MoFAHD).

62. What is the name of the Open-Air Display Museum inaugurated by Raksha Mantri Rajnath Singh and Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath in Lucknow on 30 May 2026, dedicated to showcasing the valour and maritime heritage of the Indian Navy?
A.Bharat Naval Sangrahalaya
B.Samudra Gaurav Vatika
C.Veer Nausena Udyaan
D.Jal Sena Smriti Van
E.Nausena Shaurya Vatika
Answer: E
Short Explanation:
Raksha Mantri Rajnath Singh and **Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath** jointly inaugurated **'Nausena Shaurya Vatika'** in **Lucknow, Uttar Pradesh** on **30 May 2026**.
Nausena Shaurya Vatika is an **Open-Air Display Museum** dedicated to showcasing the

valour, courage, and **maritime heritage of the Indian Navy**.

The museum was constructed at a cost of **₹19 crore** and spread across an area of more than **two acres**.

Detailed Explanation:

Raksha Mantri Rajnath Singh and **Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath** jointly inaugurated **'Nausena Shaurya Vatika'** in **Lucknow, Uttar Pradesh** on **30 May 2026**.

Nausena Shaurya Vatika is an **Open-Air Display Museum** dedicated to showcasing the valour, courage, and **maritime heritage of the Indian Navy**.

The museum was constructed at a cost of **₹19 crore** and spread across an area of more than **two acres**.

The museum displays artifacts and weapon systems of **INS Gomati**, which was decommissioned on **29 May 2022** after 34 years of distinguished service.

During the inauguration, Rajnath Singh highlighted that India's **defence production** increased from ₹46,000 crore in 2014 to over **₹1.51 lakh crore in 2026**.

He stated that India's defence production is expected to soon reach a new milestone of **₹1.75 lakh crore**.

63. From which source was water sourced for the Bambi Bucket operations conducted by the Indian Air Force to combat the forest fire near Kasauli, Himachal Pradesh, with each sortie carrying approximately 2,000–2,500 litres of water?

A.Sukhna Lake

B.Gobind Sagar Lake

C.Bhakra Dam

D.River Sutlej

E.Renuka Lake

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

The **Indian Air Force (IAF)** received information about a **forest fire near Kasauli, Himachal Pradesh**, and immediately deployed a **Cheetah helicopter** to assess the situation.

The IAF helicopters carried out extensive **Bambi Bucket operations** to contain and extinguish the fire.

Water for the operation was sourced from **Sukhna Lake, Chandigarh**, with each sortie carrying approximately **2,000–2,500 litres of water**.

The operation involved continuous day-and-night aerial firefighting missions, demonstrating the IAF's **rapid response and operational capability**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Indian Air Force (IAF)** received information about a **forest fire near Kasauli, Himachal Pradesh**, and immediately deployed a **Cheetah helicopter** to assess the situation.

Following the assessment, **Mi-17 V5 Medium Lift Helicopters** were deployed under the **Aid to Civil Authorities** framework to combat the massive forest fire.

The fire spread across nearly **10 hectares** in the **Kasauli Beat area of Solan district**, Himachal Pradesh, threatening residential areas, critical civil infrastructure, and military establishments.

The firefighting operation was conducted in close coordination with the **State Administration, State Forest Department, Indian Army**, and local authorities.

The IAF helicopters carried out extensive **Bambi Bucket operations** to contain and extinguish the fire.

Water for the operation was sourced from **Sukhna Lake, Chandigarh**, with each sortie carrying approximately **2,000–2,500 litres of water**.

The operation involved continuous day-and-night aerial firefighting missions, demonstrating the IAF's **rapid response and operational capability**.

64. Which ₹200-crore mission was launched under the Anusandhan National Research Foundation (ANRF) and the Ministry of Jal Shakti, aimed at strengthening innovation and startups in the water sector by integrating science, technology, industry, and government collaboration?

A.Jal Shakti Abhiyan

B.National Water Mission

C.AMRUT Water Mission

D.MAHA Water Mission

E.Jal Jeevan Innovation Mission

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

The **₹200-crore ANRF–Ministry of Jal Shakti MAHA Water Mission** was launched to strengthen innovation and startups in the water sector, under the leadership of **Dr. Jitendra Singh and Shri C.R. Patil**.

The mission is implemented under the **Anusandhan National Research Foundation (ANRF)** to promote mission-driven scientific research and innovation in India.

The initiative aims to **democratise research funding**, expanding access for **startups, MSMEs, universities, and innovators**, beyond elite institutions.

Earlier, research funding was concentrated in a few institutions, but ANRF now ensures **inclusive participation** in national research ecosystems.

ANRF has launched **MAHA (Missions for Advancement in High-Impact Areas)** in sectors such as **Electric Vehicles, Drones, Medical Technologies, 6G, and Water**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **₹200-crore ANRF–Ministry of Jal Shakti MAHA Water Mission** was launched to strengthen innovation and startups in the water sector, under the leadership of **Dr. Jitendra Singh and Shri C.R. Patil**.

The mission is implemented under the **Anusandhan National Research Foundation (ANRF)** to promote mission-driven scientific research and innovation in India.

The initiative aims to **democratise research funding**, expanding access for **startups,**

MSMEs, universities, and innovators, beyond elite institutions.

Earlier, research funding was concentrated in a few institutions, but ANRF now ensures **inclusive participation** in national research ecosystems.

ANRF has launched **MAHA (Missions for Advancement in High-Impact Areas)** in sectors such as **Electric Vehicles, Drones, Medical Technologies, 6G, and Water**.

The **MAHA Water Mission** is designed to integrate science, technology, startups, industry, and government collaboration for solving water-related challenges.

The mission aligns with the vision of **Prime Minister Narendra Modi** for using science and innovation for national development priorities.

India's startup ecosystem has grown significantly from 350–400 startups a decade ago to **over 2 lakh startups**, generating **20–24 lakh jobs**.

The mission supports **end-to-end innovation**, from research and development to validation and field deployment.

65. Which of the following initiatives, launched by Dr. Jitendra Singh during the 150th anniversary celebrations of Indian Association for the Cultivation of Science (IACS) in Kolkata?

A.PECVD

B.RAMAN

C.SRISTI

D.RETINA

E.Both 1 and 4

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

Union Minister of State (Independent Charge) **Dr. Jitendra Singh** inaugurated two major initiatives – **Plasma Enhanced Chemical Vapor Deposition (PECVD) System** and **Research Entrepreneurship for Translation, Innovation and NAvigation (RETINA)** during the **150th anniversary celebrations** of the **Indian Association for the Cultivation of Science (IACS)** in **Kolkata, West Bengal**.

IACS is one of India's most prestigious scientific institutions and holds historic importance as the **birthplace of the Raman Effect**.

The **Raman Effect** was discovered by **Sir C. V. Raman** on **28 February 1928**, a discovery that later earned him the **Nobel Prize in Physics**.

Detailed Explanation:

Union Minister of State (Independent Charge) **Dr. Jitendra Singh** inaugurated two major initiatives – **Plasma Enhanced Chemical Vapor Deposition (PECVD) System** and **Research Entrepreneurship for Translation, Innovation and NAvigation (RETINA)** during the **150th anniversary celebrations** of the **Indian Association for the Cultivation of Science (IACS)** in **Kolkata, West Bengal**.

IACS is one of India's most prestigious scientific institutions and holds historic importance as the **birthplace of the Raman Effect**.

The **Raman Effect** was discovered by **Sir C. V. Raman** on **28 February 1928**, a discovery that later earned him the **Nobel Prize in Physics**.
The **PECVD** (Plasma Enhanced Chemical Vapor Deposition) System was **developed indigenously** at the IACS campus.
The system is intended for the **fabrication of India's first amorphous silicon solar cell**, representing a major achievement in indigenous renewable energy technology.
The development of the PECVD system reflects the Government of India's **Atmanirbhar Bharat vision** and commitment to scientific **self-reliance**.
The project was developed under the leadership of **Ashok Kumar Barua**.

66. Which Indian multi-national company signed a multi-million-dollar agreement with Swedish industrial manufacturing company SKF to implement a next-generation ERP platform and integrate AI across SKF's global operations?

A.Infosys
B.Wipro
C.HCL Technologies
D.Tata Consultancy Services (TCS)
E.Tech Mahindra

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

Tata Consultancy Services (TCS), India's leading Multi-National Company (MNC), signed a **multi-million-dollar agreement** with Swedish industrial manufacturing company **SKF**.
The agreement aims to implement a next-generation **Enterprise Resource Planning (ERP)** platform across SKF's global operations.
The collaboration will leverage **Artificial Intelligence (AI)** across Information Technology (IT) systems and business operations to **improve efficiency and customer experience**.

Detailed Explanation:

Tata Consultancy Services (TCS), India's leading Multi-National Company (MNC), signed a **multi-million-dollar agreement** with Swedish industrial manufacturing company **SKF**.
The agreement aims to implement a next-generation **Enterprise Resource Planning (ERP)** platform across SKF's global operations.
The collaboration will leverage **Artificial Intelligence (AI)** across Information Technology (IT) systems and business operations to **improve efficiency and customer experience**.
A key objective of the partnership is to **enhance customer experience**, **optimize operations**, and support SKF's **long-term business growth**.
Under the strategic partnership, TCS will help SKF build a **future-ready digital enterprise** through the integration of **centralized AI-enabled systems**.

67. Which institute under the Department of Science and Technology (DST) conducted the scientific study reconstructing nearly 4,000 years of climate and vegetation history

of Majuli Island by collecting a 150 cm deep sediment core from Sakali Wetland?

A.Indian Institute of Tropical Meteorology (IITM)

B.Wadia Institute of Himalayan Geology (WIHG)

C.Birbal Sahni Institute of Palaeosciences (BSIP)

D.National Institute of Oceanography (NIO)

E.Physical Research Laboratory (PRL)

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

A new scientific study has reconstructed nearly **4,000 years of climate and vegetation history** of **Majuli Island**, the world's largest inhabited river island, located in **Assam**.

Majuli Island is culturally significant as a centre of **Neo-Vaishnavite culture** (a reformist Vaishnavism movement) and is also a key tribal settlement region.

The research was conducted by the **Birbal Sahni Institute of Palaeosciences (BSIP)** under the **Department of Science and Technology (DST)**.

Detailed Explanation:

A new scientific study has reconstructed nearly **4,000 years of climate and vegetation history** of **Majuli Island**, the world's largest inhabited river island, located in **Assam**.

Majuli Island is culturally significant as a centre of **Neo-Vaishnavite culture** (a reformist Vaishnavism movement) and is also a key tribal settlement region.

The study provides a long-term reconstruction of **climate variability, vegetation change, and flood dynamics**, offering insights for climate adaptation and disaster planning in flood-prone regions.

Majuli is situated between the **Brahmaputra River** (south and east), **Subansiri River** (west), and a northern branch of the Brahmaputra, and is highly vulnerable to **flooding and riverbank erosion**.

The region previously lacked a comprehensive palaeoecological reconstruction, which was addressed using **pollen (palynological) and sediment-based analysis**.

The research was conducted by the **Birbal Sahni Institute of Palaeosciences (BSIP)** under the **Department of Science and Technology (DST)**.

Scientists collected a **150 cm deep sediment core** from **Sakali Wetland**, Majuli Island, to analyse fossil pollen and grain-size data.

68. Under which initiative did India reaffirm Myanmar's importance, alongside the Neighbourhood First Policy and Act East Policy, during President Min Aung Hlaing's visit to India from 30 May to 3 June 2026?

A.SAGAR Initiative

B.MAHASAGAR Initiative

C.Indo-Pacific Vision

D.Asia-Africa Growth Corridor

E.BIMSTEC Charter

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Myanmar President **Min Aung Hlaing** visited India from **30 May to 3 June 2026**,

strengthening bilateral cooperation across multiple sectors.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi and President Min Aung Hlaing reviewed bilateral, regional, and global issues of mutual interest.

India reaffirmed Myanmar's importance under its **Neighbourhood First Policy**, **Act East Policy**, and **MAHASAGAR (Mutual and Holistic Advancement for Security and Growth Across Regions) Initiative**.

Detailed Explanation:

Myanmar President **Min Aung Hlaing** visited India from **30 May to 3 June 2026**, strengthening bilateral cooperation across multiple sectors.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi and President Min Aung Hlaing reviewed bilateral, regional, and global issues of mutual interest.

India reaffirmed Myanmar's importance under its **Neighbourhood First Policy**, **Act East Policy**, and **MAHASAGAR (Mutual and Holistic Advancement for Security and Growth Across Regions) Initiative**.

Both countries reiterated their commitment to deepening cooperation in **trade, connectivity, security, education, and cultural exchanges**.

The **Rupee–Kyat Settlement Mechanism**, operational since **May 2024**, was highlighted as a key initiative to facilitate bilateral trade in local currencies.

India increased **Mekong-Ganga Indian Council for Cultural Relations (ICCR) Scholarships** for Myanmar students from **36 to 100 annually** from **2026**.

Both countries reaffirmed their commitment to **sovereignty, territorial integrity, border management, and regional security cooperation**.

India reiterated support for Myanmar-led efforts towards **peace, stability, national reconciliation, and socio-economic development**.

About Myanmar

Capital: Naypyidaw

Currency: Myanmar Kyat (MMK)

President: Min Aung Hlaing

About Indian Council for Cultural Relations (ICCR)

Established: April 9,1950

Founder: Maulana Abul Kalam Azad

Headquarters: New Delhi

Ministry: Ministry of External Affairs

Purpose: Promotes India's cultural diplomacy and strengthens cultural, educational, and academic relations with other countries.

69. Which Indian badminton pair won the Singapore Open 2026 Men's Doubles title, defeating Indonesia's Fajar Alfian and Muhammad Shohibul Fikri in a thrilling 73-minute final?

A.Dhruv Kapila and M. R. Arjun

B.Satwiksairaj Rankireddy and Chirag Shetty

C.Krishna Prasad Garaga and Vishnuvardhan Goud

D.Pranaav Jerry Chopra and N. Sikki Reddy

E.B. Sumeeth Reddy and Manu Attri

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Indian badminton pair **Satwiksairaj Rankireddy** and **Chirag Shetty** won the **Singapore Open 2026 Men's Doubles title**, becoming the **first Indian doubles pair** to win the prestigious tournament.

In the final, the Indian duo defeated Indonesia's **Fajar Alfian** and **Muhammad Shohibul Fikri**, ranked World No. 3, in a thrilling **73-minute match**.

Final Score: Satwiksairaj Rankireddy/Chirag Shetty defeated Fajar Alfian/Muhammad Shohibul Fikri **18-21, 21-17, 21-16**.

Detailed Explanation:

Indian badminton pair **Satwiksairaj Rankireddy** and **Chirag Shetty** won the **Singapore Open 2026 Men's Doubles title**, becoming the **first Indian doubles pair** to win the prestigious tournament.

In the final, the Indian duo defeated Indonesia's **Fajar Alfian** and **Muhammad Shohibul Fikri**, ranked World No. 3, in a thrilling **73-minute match**.

Final Score: Satwiksairaj Rankireddy/Chirag Shetty defeated Fajar Alfian/Muhammad Shohibul Fikri **18-21, 21-17, 21-16**.

After losing the opening game, the Indian pair staged a remarkable comeback by winning the next two games.

The victory ended their **two-year wait for a Badminton World Federation (BWF) World Tour title**.

Their previous **BWF World Tour** title came at the **Thailand Open 2024**.

The Singapore Open triumph marked their **ninth BWF World Tour title** overall.

About Badminton World Federation (BWF)

Founded: 1934 (as International Badminton Federation)

Renamed as BWF: 2006

Headquarters: Kuala Lumpur

President: Khunying Patama Leeswadtrakul of Thailand

70. As of June 2026, K. P. Dhanapalan, the senior Congress leader who passed away at the age of 76, served as a Member of Parliament in which Lok Sabha and from which constituency?

A.14th Lok Sabha (2004) from Ernakulam constituency

B.12th Lok Sabha (1998) from Kottayam constituency

C.16th Lok Sabha (2014) from Thrissur constituency

D.13th Lok Sabha (1999) from Alappuzha constituency

E.15th Lok Sabha (2009) from Chalakudy constituency

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

Senior Congress leader and former Member of Parliament **K. P. Dhanapalan** passed away at the age of **76** in **Paravur, Ernakulam district, Kerala**.

He was born on **14 April 1950** in **Ernakulam, Travancore-Cochin** (present-day Kerala).

He began his political journey through student politics with the **Kerala Students Union (KSU)** and rose to become a prominent leader in the **Indian National Congress** in central Kerala.
In his parliamentary career, he was elected to the **15th Lok Sabha (2009)** from the **Chalakudy constituency** and served as Member of Parliament till 2014.
Detailed Explanation:
Senior Congress leader and former Member of Parliament **K. P. Dhanapalan** passed away at the age of **76** in **Paravur, Ernakulam district, Kerala**.
He was born on **14 April 1950** in **Ernakulam, Travancore-Cochin** (present-day Kerala).
He began his political journey through student politics with the **Kerala Students Union (KSU)** and rose to become a prominent leader in the **Indian National Congress** in central Kerala.
His entry into electoral politics began in **1979** when he became a **North Paravur Municipal Councillor**.
He served as the **President of the Ernakulam District Congress Committee (DCC)** and held important positions in the **Kerala Pradesh Congress Committee (KPCC)**.
He was also a member of the **All India Congress Committee (AICC)**, contributing to national-level party organisation.
In his parliamentary career, he was elected to the **15th Lok Sabha (2009)** from the **Chalakudy constituency** and served as Member of Parliament till 2014.
He also served as the **Chairman of MILMA (Kerala Co-operative Milk Marketing Federation)** and contributed to local governance and regional cooperative development.

71. Who initiated the movement for a dedicated World Bicycle Day(June 3), publishing a World Bank blog titled "Cycling Is Everyone's Business" in February 2015 advocating the benefits of cycling?

A.Leszek Sibilski
B.Ban Ki-moon
C.Tedros Adhanom Ghebreyesus
D.Michael Bloomberg
E.Jan Gehl
Answer: A
Short Explanation:
World Bicycle Day 2026 was observed across the globe **on 3 June 2026** to recognize the bicycle as a simple, affordable, reliable, and sustainable mode of transportation.
The movement for a dedicated World Bicycle Day was initiated by **Leszek Sibilski, a sociology professor**, cycling advocate, and physical education activist.
In February **2015, Sibilski published a World Bank blog titled "Cycling** Is **Everyone's Business**", advocating the benefits of cycling.
Detailed Explanation:
World Bicycle Day 2026 was observed across the globe **on 3 June 2026** to recognize the bicycle as a simple, affordable, reliable, and sustainable mode of transportation.

The day highlights the bicycle's contribution to health, education, environmental sustainability, and social inclusion.

The movement for a dedicated World Bicycle Day was initiated by **Leszek Sibilski, a sociology professor**, cycling advocate, and physical education activist.

In February **2015, Sibilski published a World Bank blog titled "Cycling** Is **Everyone's Business**", advocating the benefits of cycling.

72. In which year was Canara HSBC Life Insurance established as a joint venture between Canara Bank and HSBC Insurance (Asia Pacific) Holdings Limited?

A.2005

B.2006

C.2007

D.2008

E.2009

Answer: C

Canara HSBC Life Insurance was established in **2007** as a joint venture between **Canara Bank** and **HSBC Insurance (Asia Pacific) Holdings Limited**.

The company offers a diverse range of **life insurance solutions** to customers across India.

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73. Where is the headquarters of the Africa Centres for Disease Control and Prevention (Africa CDC) located?

A.Nairobi, Kenya

B.Johannesburg, South Africa

C.Dakar, Senegal

D.Abuja, Nigeria

E.Addis Ababa, Ethiopia

Answer: E

About Africa Centres for Disease Control and Prevention (Africa CDC)

Established: 2017

Headquarters: Addis Ababa, Ethiopia

Director General: Jean Kaseya

Objective: Strengthen public health institutions and disease surveillance systems across Africa.

74. Which is the third-highest civilian award in India, presented annually by the President of India at Rashtrapati Bhavan?

A.Bharat Ratna

B.Padma Vibhushan

C.Padma Bhushan

D.Padma Shri

E.Ashoka Chakra

Answer: C

About Padma Awards

Instituted: 1954

Presented By: President of India at **Rashtrapati Bhavan**.

Civilian Awards Hierarchy:

Bharat Ratna – Highest Civilian Award.

Padma Vibhushan – Second-Highest Civilian Award.

Padma Bhushan – Third-Highest Civilian Award.

Padma Shri – Fourth-Highest Civilian Award.

Fields Covered: Art, Literature & Education, Sports, Medicine, Science & Engineering, Public

Affairs, Social Work, Civil Service, Trade & Industry, and others.

Nodal Ministry: Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA).

75. In 2026, World No Tobacco Day is observed annually on which date to raise awareness about the harmful effects of tobacco use and encourage effective tobacco-control policies?

A.30 May

B.31 May

C.1 June

D.5 June

E.7 June

Answer: B

About World No Tobacco Day

World No Tobacco Day: Observed annually on **31 May**.

Objective of World No Tobacco Day: Raise awareness about the harmful effects of tobacco use and encourage effective tobacco-control policies.

76. Which entity was penalized ₹1 crore by IRDAI for violations related to insurance distribution norms and MISP guidelines following an onsite inspection in September 2024?

A.Tata Motors Finance Limited

B.SBI Bank

C.Nissan Renault Financial Services India Private Limited

D.Maruti Suzuki Insurance Brokers

E.HDFC Bank

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The **Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (IRDAI)** imposed a **penalty of ₹1 crore** on **Nissan Renault Financial Services India Private. Limited.** for violations related to **insurance distribution norms** and **Motor Insurance Service Provider (MISP) guidelines**.

The regulatory action followed an **onsite inspection** conducted by **IRDAI in September 2024**, which revealed multiple compliance and governance deficiencies in the company's insurance operations.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (IRDAI)** imposed a **penalty of ₹1 crore** on **Nissan Renault Financial Services India Private. Limited.** for violations related to **insurance distribution norms** and **Motor Insurance Service Provider (MISP) guidelines**.

The regulatory action followed an **onsite inspection** conducted by **IRDAI in September 2024**, which revealed multiple compliance and governance deficiencies in the company's insurance operations.

The company was found to have violated provisions governing the functioning of **Corporate Agents** and adherence to **motor insurance service regulations**.

IRDAI directed the company to **strengthen its compliance framework** and ensure strict

adherence to applicable insurance regulations and guidelines.

The regulator instructed that the order be placed before the **Board of Directors of the Corporate Agent** in its upcoming board meeting for **review and discussion**.

The company has been directed to **submit a copy of the board meeting minutes to IRDAI** after the matter is discussed.

IRDAI further ordered the Corporate Agent to submit an **Action Taken Report (ATR) within 90 days** from the date of the order.

77. Which of the following statements about the Reserve Bank of India's (RBI) Annual Report 2025–26 is correct as per the given data?

A.The RBI's balance sheet decreased by 20.6% during FY26 due to a reduction in foreign investments.

B.The RBI transferred ₹1.09 lakh crore to the Contingency Fund (CF) to strengthen its financial resilience.

C.Domestic investments recorded the highest growth among all assets, increasing by 63.8%.

D.The size of RBI's balance sheet as on 31 March 2026 stood at ₹76.25 lakh crore.

E.Gold holdings increased by 44.9% to ₹22.59 lakh crore during FY26.

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** released its **Annual Report 2025–26** and submitted it to the Central Government under **Section 53(2) of the RBI Act, 1934**.

The report contains the Central Board of Directors' review of the working of the **RBI** for the year ended **31 March 2026**.

The **Balance Sheet (BS) of RBI expanded by 20.6%** during **FY26**, reflecting significant growth in the central bank's assets and investments.

The size of **RBI's balance sheet increased** from **Rs 76.25 lakh crore in FY25 to Rs 91.97 lakh crore** as on **31 March 2026**, registering an increase of **Rs 15.72 lakh crore**.

RBI transferred Rs 1.09 lakh crore to the **Contingency Fund (CF)** as a provision to strengthen its financial resilience.

On the asset side, the increase was primarily driven by a sharp rise in **domestic investments**, **gold holdings**, and **foreign investments**.

Domestic investments increased by 44.9%, rising to **Rs 22.59 lakh crore** during **FY26**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** released its **Annual Report 2025–26** and submitted it to the Central Government under **Section 53(2) of the RBI Act, 1934**.

The report contains the Central Board of Directors' review of the working of the **RBI** for the year ended **31 March 2026**.

The **Balance Sheet (BS) of RBI expanded by 20.6%** during **FY26**, reflecting significant growth in the central bank's assets and investments.

The size of **RBI's balance sheet increased** from **Rs 76.25 lakh crore in FY25 to**

Rs 91.97 lakh crore as on **31 March 2026**, registering an increase of **Rs 15.72 lakh crore**.

RBI transferred Rs 1.09 lakh crore to the **Contingency Fund (CF)** as a provision to strengthen its financial resilience.

On the asset side, the increase was primarily driven by a sharp rise in **domestic investments**, **gold holdings**, and **foreign investments**.

Domestic investments increased by 44.9%, rising to **Rs 22.59 lakh crore** during **FY26**.

RBI's gold holdings recorded the highest growth, **increasing by 63.8% to Rs 10.94 lakh crore**.

Foreign investments rose by 7.9% and reached **Rs 52.68 lakh crore** as of **31 March 2026**.

The report highlighted that the **amount involved in banking fraud cases increased significantly by 46%**, reaching **Rs 48,021 crore in FY26** compared to **Rs 32,803 crore in FY25**.

Despite the increase in the fraud amount, the **number of fraud cases** reported by the banking sector **declined sharply**.

The **total number of fraud cases decreased** from **23,722 cases in FY25 to 10,114 cases in FY26**.

78. In 2026, how much amount was transferred by the Government of India to State Governments as devolution of share in central taxes during FY 2025–26 (Provisional Accounts)?

A.₹12,42,575 crore

B.₹13,92,971 crore

C.₹10,69,119 crore

D.₹6,78,961 crore

E.₹4,53,854 crore

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The **Accounts of the Government of India** for the **Financial Year 2025–26 (Provisional/Unaudited)** have been consolidated and published, presenting key fiscal highlights.

During **2025–26**, the **Government of India** received a total **₹33,85,982 crore**, which is **99.4%** of the **Revised Estimates (RE) 2025–26** for total receipts.

The **total receipts** comprise **Net Tax Revenue to Centre (₹26,23,264 crore)**, **Non-Tax Revenue (₹6,78,961 crore)**, and **Non-Debt Capital Receipts (₹83,757 crore)**.

The **Non-Debt Capital Receipts** include **Recovery of Loans (₹24,617 crore)** and **Miscellaneous Capital Receipts (₹59,140 crore)**.

The Government transferred **₹13,92,971 crore** to **State Governments** as **devolution of share in central taxes**, which is **₹1,06,086 crore higher** than the previous year.

The **total expenditure** of the Government of India stood at **₹49,05,151 crore**, which is **98.8%** of the corresponding **RE 2025–26**.

Out of total expenditure, **₹38,36,032 crore** was spent on the **Revenue Account**,

while **₹10,69,119 crore** was on the **Capital Account**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Accounts of the Government of India** for the **Financial Year 2025–26 (Provisional/Unaudited)** have been consolidated and published, presenting key fiscal highlights.

During **2025–26**, the **Government of India** received a total **₹33,85,982 crore**, which is **99.4%** of the **Revised Estimates (RE) 2025–26** for total receipts.

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The **total expenditure** of the Government of India stood at **₹49,05,151 crore**, which is **98.8%** of the corresponding **RE 2025–26**.

Out of total expenditure, **₹38,36,032 crore** was spent on the **Revenue Account**, while **₹10,69,119 crore** was on the **Capital Account**.

Within **Revenue Expenditure**, **₹12,42,575 crore** was incurred on **Interest Payments**, reflecting the cost of government borrowing.

Additionally, **₹4,53,854 crore** was spent on **Major Subsidies**, supporting welfare and economic support measures

79. As of 2026, the newly launched joint underwater drone programme for developing advanced Uncrewed Undersea Vehicles (UUVs) is being undertaken under which security alliance?

A.QUAD

B.NATO

C.AUKUS

D.Five Eyes

E.ASEAN Defence Forum

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The **AUKUS security alliance** comprising **Australia**, the **United Kingdom (UK)**, and the **United States of America (USA)** launched a **joint underwater drone programme** under **AUKUS Pillar Two**.

The programme aims to co-develop advanced **Uncrewed Undersea Vehicles (UUVs)** and related technologies to strengthen the maritime capabilities of the three partner nations.

The announcement was made by **Richard Marles**, **Pete Hegseth**, and **John Healey** at the **IISS Shangri-La Dialogue** in **Singapore**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **AUKUS security alliance** comprising **Australia**, the **United Kingdom (UK)**, and the **United States of**

America (USA) launched a **joint underwater drone programme** under **AUKUS Pillar Two**.
The programme aims to co-develop advanced **Uncrewed Undersea Vehicles (UUVs)** and related technologies to strengthen the maritime capabilities of the three partner nations.
The announcement was made by **Richard Marles**, **Pete Hegseth**, and **John Healey** at the **IISS Shangri-La Dialogue** in **Singapore**.
The initiative seeks to develop a suite of highly adaptable, **multi-mission UUV payloads** capable of supporting a wide range of undersea military operations.
A major objective of the programme is to help AUKUS partners maintain their **collective strategic advantage** in the maritime domain amid evolving security challenges.
The **first delivery of UUV technology** under the programme is expected by **2027**.
The project falls under **AUKUS Pillar Two**, which focuses on cooperation in **advanced defence and emerging technologies** beyond nuclear-powered submarines.
About Australia :
Prime Minister : Anthony Albanese
Capital : Canberra
Currency : Australian dollar
About United Kingdom :
Prime Minister : Keir Starmer
Capital : London
Currency : Pound sterling
About USA :
President : Donald Trump
Capital : Washington, D.C.
Currency : U.S. dollar ($)

80. In 2026, consider the following statements regarding West Bengal's Annapurna Yojana:
Eligible women will receive ₹3,000 per month as financial assistance.
The scheme is applicable to women aged 25 to 60 years.
Permanent government employees and income-tax payers are eligible for the scheme.
Which of the above statements is/are correct?
A.1 and 2 only
B.2 and 3 only
C.1 and 3 only
D.1, 2 and 3
E.3 only
Answer: A
Short Explanation:
The **Government of West Bengal** has begun the enrolment process for the **Annapurna Yojana**.
Under the scheme, eligible women will receive **₹3,000 per month** as financial assistance,
The existing **Lakshmir Bhandar scheme** will continue until the full implementation of the Annapurna Yojana,
The scheme is applicable to **women aged 25 to 60 years**,

Eligibility criteria include women who are **not permanent government employees, not receiving salaries or pensions, and not paying income tax**,

Detailed Explanation:

The **Government of West Bengal** has begun the enrolment process for the **Annapurna Yojana**.

Under the scheme, eligible women will receive **₹3,000 per month** as financial assistance,

The existing **Lakshmir Bhandar scheme** will continue until the full implementation of the Annapurna Yojana,

The scheme is applicable to **women aged 25 to 60 years**,

Eligibility criteria include women who are **not permanent government employees, not receiving salaries or pensions, and not paying income tax**,

The West Bengal government has initiated a **verification and database cleansing exercise** for beneficiaries of the proposed scheme,

Existing beneficiaries of the **Lakshmir Bhandar scheme will be migrated** to the Annapurna Yojana, except:

Dead beneficiaries

Shifted beneficiaries

Deleted beneficiaries

Absentee electors identified during **Special Intensive Revision 2026**

Cases marked as **ASDD (Absent, Shifted, Dead or Duplicate)**

An **online application portal will be launched on 1 June 2026** for fresh applicants,

The initiative aims to streamline beneficiary identification and ensure targeted delivery of benefits,

81. In 2026, which indigenously developed system was inaugurated by Union Minister Dr. Jitendra Singh at the Indian Association for the Cultivation of Science (IACS), Kolkata?

A.Light Detection and Ranging (LiDAR) System

B.Quantum Communication Network System

C.Cryogenic Propulsion Test Facility

D.Plasma Enhanced Chemical Vapour Deposition (PECVD) System

E.Advanced Synchrotron Radiation Facility

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

Union Minister of State (Independent Charge) for Science and Technology **Dr Jitendra Singh** participated in the **150-year celebrations of the Indian Association for the Cultivation of Science (IACS)** in Kolkata.

During the event, he inaugurated an indigenously developed **Plasma Enhanced Chemical Vapour Deposition system (PECVD)** at the Indian Association for the Cultivation of Science,

Detailed Explanation:

Union Minister of State (Independent Charge) for Science and Technology **Dr Jitendra Singh** participated in the **150-year celebrations**

of the Indian Association for the Cultivation of Science (IACS) in Kolkata.

During the event, he inaugurated an indigenously developed **Plasma Enhanced Chemical Vapour Deposition system (PECVD)** at the Indian Association for the Cultivation of Science,

The system has been developed for the fabrication of **India's first amorphous silicon solar cell**,

He also inaugurated Research Entrepreneurship for Translation, Innovation and Navigation, a centre aimed at connecting fundamental research with entrepreneurship, startups and societal applications.

The institute is known as the cradle of eminent scientists including **Jagadish Chandra Bose, Meghnad Saha, Satyendra Nath Bose and Sir C V Raman**,

Sir C V Raman conducted his research on the **Raman Effect** at the Indian Association for the Cultivation of Science,

About Indian Association for the Cultivation of Science

Founded: 1876

Founder: Dr Mahendralal Sircar

Location: Kolkata, West Bengal

First Indian Nobel Prize in Science: Sir C V Raman (1930)

82. In 2026, the Portal for National e-Governance Service Delivery Assessment (NeSDA) 2025 was launched by which department?

A.Department of Administrative Reforms and Public Grievances (DARPG)

B.Department of Telecommunications (DoT)

C.Department of Personnel and Training (DoPT)

D.Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY)

E.National Informatics Centre (NIC)

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

The **Department of Administrative Reforms and Public Grievances** has launched the **Portal for National e-Governance Service Delivery Assessment, 2025**

The National e-Governance Service Delivery Assessment is a **biennial assessment framework** developed by the Department of Administrative Reforms and Public Grievances to measure the effectiveness of **electronic governance service delivery from the citizen's perspective**,

Detailed Explanation:

The **Department of Administrative Reforms and Public Grievances** has launched the **Portal for National e-Governance Service Delivery Assessment, 2025**

The National e-Governance Service Delivery Assessment is a **biennial assessment framework** developed by the Department of Administrative Reforms and Public Grievances to measure the effectiveness of **electronic governance service delivery from the citizen's perspective**,

The framework is based on the **Online Service Index of the United Nations Electronic**

Government Survey and is customised for India's federal structure,

It evaluates the **availability, accessibility and maturity of online service delivery** across States, Union Territories and Central Ministries and Departments,

Government portals are classified into two categories: **State, Union Territory, City and Central Ministry Portals** and **State, Union Territory, City and Central Ministry Service Portals**,

The framework covers both **Government-to-Citizen services** and **Government-to-Business services**,

83. In 2026, which institution released the roadmap report titled "Future of India's Semiconductor Industry" outlining a vision for the sector up to 2035?

A.Reserve Bank of India (RBI)

B.Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY)

C.NITI Aayog

D.Semiconductor Laboratory (SCL)

E.National Skill Development Corporation (NSDC)

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

NITI Aayog has released a roadmap report titled **"Future of India's Semiconductor Industry"**, outlining a vision for the sector up to 2035.

The report was prepared by the **Frontier Tech Hub** of NITI Aayog.

According to the report, India currently imports **90–95% of the semiconductors** it consumes.

India spent nearly **$150 billion** on semiconductor imports between **Financial Year 2017 and Financial Year 2025**.

If current trends continue, annual semiconductor import costs could rise to around **$240 billion by 2035**.

Detailed Explanation:

NITI Aayog has released a roadmap report titled **"Future of India's Semiconductor Industry"**, outlining a vision for the sector up to 2035.

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According to the report, India currently imports **90–95% of the semiconductors** it consumes.

India spent nearly **$150 billion** on semiconductor imports between **Financial Year 2017 and Financial Year 2025**.

If current trends continue, annual semiconductor import costs could rise to around **$240 billion by 2035**.

India's semiconductor demand is projected to grow at a **Compound Annual Growth Rate of 19%**, reaching around **$90 billion by 2030** and exceeding **$200 billion by 2035**.

The roadmap aims to build a semiconductor value chain worth **$120–150 billion by 2035**, accounting for **10–13% of the global semiconductor market**.

It also targets achieving **35–50% self-sufficiency** in domestic semiconductor demand by 2035.

About NITI Aayog

Headquarters: New Delhi

Chairperson: Narendra Modi

Vice Chairman: Ashok Lahiri

Chief Executive Officer: Nidhi Chhibber

Established: 1 January 2015

Full Form: National Institution for Transforming India Aayog.

84. In 2026, which company became the first to receive approval for a Strategic Investment Plan under the Pradhan Mantri Skilling and Employability Transformation through Upgraded Industrial Training Institutes (PM-SETU) Scheme?

A.Tata Steel Limited

B.JSW Steel Limited

C.Jindal Steel and Power Limited

D.Steel Authority of India Limited (SAIL)

E.ArcelorMittal Nippon Steel India

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

ArcelorMittal Nippon Steel India has become the first company to receive approval for a **Strategic Investment Plan** under the **Pradhan Mantri Skilling and Employability Transformation through Upgraded Industrial Training Institutes (PM-SETU) Scheme**.

The approval was granted by the **National Steering Committee**, chaired by **Debashree Mukherjee**, Secretary, Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship, during its third meeting held at **Kaushal Bhawan, New Delhi**.

The approved Strategic Investment Plan covers the **Visakhapatnam Industrial Training Institute Cluster** in Andhra Pradesh.

Detailed Explanation:

ArcelorMittal Nippon Steel India has become the first company to receive approval for a **Strategic Investment Plan** under the **Pradhan Mantri Skilling and Employability Transformation through Upgraded Industrial Training Institutes (PM-SETU) Scheme**.

The approval was granted by the **National Steering Committee**, chaired by **Debashree Mukherjee**, Secretary, Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship, during its third meeting held at **Kaushal Bhawan, New Delhi**.

The approved Strategic Investment Plan covers the **Visakhapatnam Industrial Training Institute Cluster** in Andhra Pradesh.

With this approval, **Andhra Pradesh** has become the first state to operationalise an industry partnership under the Pradhan Mantri Skilling and Employability Transformation through Upgraded Industrial Training Institutes Scheme.

Andhra Pradesh has also become the first state to formally onboard an **Anchor Industry Partner**, enabling industry-led management of government Industrial Training Institutes.

The initiative is expected to strengthen industry participation in vocational education and improve employability outcomes.

The **Pradhan Mantri Skilling and Employability Transformation through Upgraded Industrial Training Institutes Scheme** was approved by the Union Cabinet in 2025.

The scheme has a total outlay of **₹60,000 crore**.

It aims to upgrade **1,000 government Industrial Training Institutes** across India through a **hub-and-spoke model**.

85. 2026, the Logistics Port Performance Index (LPPI) for FY25 was launched under which framework to assess and improve the operational performance of Indian ports?

A.Sagar Aankalan Framework

B.Maritime India Vision Framework

C.Sagarmala Framework

D.PM Gati Shakti Framework

E.National Logistics Policy Framework

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

Union Minister of Ports, Shipping and Waterways **Sarbananda Sonowal** launched the **Logistics Port Performance Index (LPPI) for FY25** during the 37th Foundation Day celebrations of the **Jawaharlal Nehru Port Authority (JNPA)** in Mumbai.

LPPI has been developed under the **'Sagar Aankalan' framework** as a national benchmarking mechanism to assess and improve the operational performance of Indian ports.

The index evaluates ports across three cargo segments: **dry bulk, liquid bulk, and container cargo**.

Detailed Explanation:

Union Minister of Ports, Shipping and Waterways **Sarbananda Sonowal** launched the **Logistics Port Performance Index (LPPI) for FY25** during the 37th Foundation Day celebrations of the **Jawaharlal Nehru Port Authority (JNPA)** in Mumbai.

LPPI has been developed under the **'Sagar Aankalan' framework** as a national benchmarking mechanism to assess and improve the operational performance of Indian ports.

The index evaluates ports across three cargo segments: **dry bulk, liquid bulk, and container cargo**.

Performance is measured using indicators such as cargo handled, vessel turnaround time, berth idle time, pre-berthing waiting time, container dwell time, and ship berth day output.

The framework assigns equal weightage to both absolute performance and year-on-year improvement.

The Minister also launched four digital initiatives developed by the **Directorate General of Shipping (DGS)**.

These include a **24x7 grievance redressal module under the e-Navik platform**, a **ship registration module on the e-Samudra platform**, a **medical practitioner module**, and a **unified ship recycling credit note module**.

He also unveiled the **Unified Ship Recycling Portal** under the Ship Recycling Credit Scheme.

86. In 2026, the Indian Haj Mission won two Labbaytum Awards in which category?

A.Best Pilgrim Welfare Initiative

B.Best Digital Haj Services

C.Best Haj Coordination and Communication

D.Best International Pilgrim Management

E.Best Health and Safety Services

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

For the first time, the **Indian Haj Mission**, under the Ministry of Minority Affairs (Minority Affairs Minister Kiren Rijiju), won **two Labbaytum Awards** in the **Best Haj Coordination and Communication** category.

The awards were presented during the **Khitamahu Misk Ceremony** held in Saudi Arabia, marking the formal conclusion of the **2026 Haj season**.

Consul General Fahad Ahmed Khan Suri and **Consul Haj Sadaf Choudhary** represented India at the award ceremony.

The **Indian Haj Mission 2026** was led by **Dr. Suhel Ajaz Khan**, Ambassador of India to Saudi Arabia, and **Fahad Ahmed Khan Suri**, Consul General of India in Jeddah.

Detailed Explanation:

For the first time, the **Indian Haj Mission**, under the Ministry of Minority Affairs (Minority Affairs Minister Kiren Rijiju), won **two Labbaytum Awards** in the **Best Haj Coordination and Communication** category.

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The **Indian Haj Mission 2026** was led by **Dr. Suhel Ajaz Khan**, Ambassador of India to Saudi Arabia, and **Fahad Ahmed Khan Suri**, Consul General of India in Jeddah.

Approximately **175,000 Indian pilgrims** performed Haj in 2026.

The **Labbaytum Awards** are presented annually by the Saudi Ministry of Haj and Umrah to recognise excellence in pilgrim services and management.

The awards highlight India's effective coordination, communication, and service delivery for Haj pilgrims.

The recognition reflects the efforts of the Indian Haj Mission in ensuring a smooth and efficient pilgrimage experience for Indian pilgrims.

About Saudi Arabia

Capital: Riyadh

Currency: Saudi Riyal

Prime Minister: Mohammed bin Salman Al Saud

King: Salman bin Abdulaziz Al Saud

87. In 2026, the sanctioned strength of the Supreme Court of India was increased from 34 to how many judges (including the Chief Justice of India) through the Supreme Court (Number of Judges) Amendment Ordinance, 2026?

A.35

B.36

C.37

D.38

E.40

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

Chief Justice of India (CJI) Surya Kant administered the oath of office to **five new judges** of the **Supreme Court of India** on **02 June 2026**.

The five newly appointed judges are **Justice Sheel Nagu, Justice Shree Chandrashekhar, Justice Sanjeev Sachdeva, Justice Arun Palli, and Senior Advocate Venkita Subramani (V.) Mohana**.

The **sanctioned strength** of the Supreme Court was increased from **34 to 38 judges** (including the Chief Justice of India).

Detailed Explanation:

Chief Justice of India (CJI) Surya Kant administered the oath of office to **five new judges** of the **Supreme Court of India** on **02 June 2026**.

The five newly appointed judges are **Justice Sheel Nagu, Justice Shree Chandrashekhar, Justice Sanjeev Sachdeva, Justice Arun Palli, and Senior Advocate Venkita Subramani (V.) Mohana**.

The appointments were approved by the **Central Government** based on the recommendations of the **Supreme Court Collegium**, made during its meetings on **22 May 2026 and 27 May 2026**.

President Droupadi Murmu appointed the five judges under **Article 124(2) of the Constitution of India**, after consultation with the Chief Justice of India.

Union Minister for Law and Justice Arjun Ram Meghwal officially announced the appointments through a social media post.

The oath ceremony took place shortly after the promulgation of the **Supreme Court (Number of Judges) Amendment Ordinance, 2026**, which increased the sanctioned strength of the Supreme Court.

The **sanctioned strength** of the Supreme Court was increased from **34 to 38 judges** (including the Chief Justice of India).

88. In 2026, who assumed charge as the 20th Commander-in-Chief of the Andaman & Nicobar Command (ANC)?

A.Vice Admiral Dinesh K. Tripathi

B.Vice Admiral Rajesh Pendharkar

C.Vice Admiral Vineet McCarty

D.Vice Admiral Sanjay J. Singh

E.Vice Admiral Tarun Sobti

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

Vice Admiral Vineet McCarty assumed charge as the **20th Commander-in-Chief of the Andaman & Nicobar Command (ANC)** at **Sri Vijaya Puram** on **01 June 2026**.

He was commissioned into the **Indian Navy** on **01 July 1989** and is a specialist in **Gunnery and Missiles**.

Vice Admiral McCarty is an alumnus of the **Defence Services Staff College, Wellington** and the **National Defence College, New Delhi**.

He brings over **36 years** of distinguished naval service across operational, staff, training, and tri-service domains.

Detailed Explanation:

Vice Admiral Vineet McCarty assumed charge as the **20th Commander-in-Chief of the Andaman & Nicobar Command (ANC)** at **Sri Vijaya Puram** on **01 June 2026**.

He was commissioned into the **Indian Navy** on **01 July 1989** and is a specialist in **Gunnery and Missiles**.

Vice Admiral McCarty is an alumnus of the **Defence Services Staff College, Wellington** and the **National Defence College, New Delhi**.

He brings over **36 years** of distinguished naval service across operational, staff, training, and tri-service domains.

His sea tenures include serving as a member of the commissioning crew of **INS Delhi** and completing all specialist appointments onboard the frontline destroyer.

He has commanded three major Indian Naval warships: **INS Ajay, INS Khanjar, and INS Shivalik**.

His important training and staff appointments include **Training Commander at the Indian Naval Academy**, **Command Plans Officer at Headquarters Eastern Naval Command**, and **Commodore Naval Plans at Naval Headquarters**.

After promotion to **Flag Rank in 2020**, he served as **Assistant Chief of Naval Staff (Staff Requirements)** and **Controller of Personnel Services**.

In **2023**, he commanded the **Western Fleet as Flag Officer Commanding Western Fleet (FOCWF)**, one of the most important operational fleet commands of the Indian Navy.

89. In 2026, the Indian Army successfully completed operational trials of which indigenous AI-powered tactical loitering munition system developed by Lucknow-based startup Hoverit?

A.Rudrastra Mk-1

B.Agnishakti UAV

C.Vajra Loitering Munition

D.Garud Strike System

E.Divyastra Mk-1

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

The **Indian Army** successfully completed operational trials of the **Divyastra Mk-1**, an indigenous **AI-powered tactical loitering munition system**, in **Jodhpur, Rajasthan**.

Divyastra Mk-1 was developed by **Hoverit**, a Lucknow-based defence technology startup, with approximately **95% indigenous content**.
The system has been designed to strengthen **Intelligence, Surveillance and Reconnaissance (ISR)** capabilities and enhance **operational effectiveness** along India's border regions.
Detailed Explanation:
The **Indian Army** successfully completed operational trials of the **Divyastra Mk-1**, an indigenous **AI-powered tactical loitering munition system**, in **Jodhpur, Rajasthan**.
Divyastra Mk-1 was developed by **Hoverit**, a Lucknow-based defence technology startup, with approximately **95% indigenous content**.
The system has been designed to strengthen **Intelligence, Surveillance and Reconnaissance (ISR)** capabilities and enhance **operational effectiveness** along India's border regions.
Divyastra Mk-1 is an **AI-powered tactical Unmanned Aerial Vehicle (UAV)** developed for intelligence gathering, surveillance, reconnaissance, and **precision strike missions**.
The system has an **operational range of up to 500 km**, making it suitable for long-range tactical missions.
It offers an **endurance of up to 5 hours**, enabling prolonged surveillance and target monitoring operations.
The UAV can achieve an **attack speed of 300–400 km per hour** and carry a **payload of up to 15 kg**.

90. In 2026, the Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO) and the Indian Air Force (IAF) successfully flight-tested which indigenously developed Air-to-Surface Missile?
A.Astra Mk-II
B.Pralay
C.RudraM-II
D.Akash-NG
E.BrahMos-NG
Answer: C
Short Explanation:
Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO) and the **Indian Air Force (IAF)** successfully conducted flight-tests of the indigenously developed **RudraM-II Air-to-Surface Missile** from an airborne platform.
The **RudraM-II missile** tests were conducted under extreme release conditions and along a critical flight trajectory, successfully validating the performance of all onboard subsystems.
After launch, the missiles accurately navigated to a predefined target with **pinpoint precision**, demonstrating the effectiveness of their guidance and navigation systems.
Detailed Explanation:
Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO) and the **Indian Air Force (IAF)** successfully conducted flight-tests of the

indigenously developed **RudraM-II Air-to-Surface Missile** from an airborne platform.

The **RudraM-II missile** tests were conducted under extreme release conditions and along a critical flight trajectory, successfully validating the performance of all onboard subsystems.

After launch, the missiles accurately navigated to a predefined target with **pinpoint precision**, demonstrating the effectiveness of their guidance and navigation systems.

All the test objectives were successfully achieved, as confirmed through flight data collected by the **Integrated Test Range (ITR), Chandipur**.

RudraM-II is an indigenously developed **Air-to-Surface Missile** designed to enhance the Indian Armed Forces' capability to engage and neutralize enemy ground-based targets.

The missile has been developed by **Research Centre Imarat (RCI), Hyderabad**, which served as the nodal DRDO laboratory for the project.

91. In 2026, the Indian Air Force (IAF) signed three contracts with which institution for the indigenous development of AI-driven predictive maintenance technologies for the Sukhoi Su-30MKI fleet?

A.IIT Delhi

B.IIT Madras

C.IIT Kanpur

D.IIT Bombay

E.IISc Bengaluru

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

Indian Air Force (IAF) signed **three contracts** with **Indian Institute of Technology Bombay (IIT Bombay)** for the indigenous development of **Artificial Intelligence (AI)-driven predictive maintenance technologies**.

The partnership aims to develop a **Digital Diagnostic Health Index** for the **Sukhoi Su-30MKI** fighter aircraft fleet.

The signing ceremony was presided over by **Air Marshal KAA Sanjeeb** (DG (Aircraft), IAF) and **Shireesh B Kedare** (Director of IIT Bombay).

Detailed Explanation:

Indian Air Force (IAF) signed **three contracts** with **Indian Institute of Technology Bombay (IIT Bombay)** for the indigenous development of **Artificial Intelligence (AI)-driven predictive maintenance technologies**.

The partnership aims to develop a **Digital Diagnostic Health Index** for the **Sukhoi Su-30MKI** fighter aircraft fleet.

The signing ceremony was presided over by **Air Marshal KAA Sanjeeb** (DG (Aircraft), IAF) and **Shireesh B Kedare** (Director of IIT Bombay).

The collaboration focuses on implementing **predictive, prognostic, and prescriptive maintenance technologies** for the Su-30MKI fleet using indigenous expertise developed at IIT Bombay.

The **AI-based maintenance system** is expected to **enhance aircraft availability**, improve operational efficiency, and reduce maintenance-related downtime.

The initiative will help **reduce service and maintenance costs** while strengthening the **mission readiness** of the IAF's frontline fighter aircraft fleet.

92. In 2026, the Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO) successfully conducted a high-calibre conventional bomb trial at which facility in Haryana?

A.Terminal Ballistics Research Laboratory (TBRL), Ramgarh Range

B.Integrated Test Range (ITR), Chandipur

C.Proof and Experimental Establishment (PXE), Chandipur

D.Defence Metallurgical Research Laboratory (DMRL), Hyderabad

E.Armament Research and Development Establishment (ARDE), Pune

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

The **Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO)** under the **Ministry of Defence** successfully conducted a **high-calibre conventional bomb trial** at the **Terminal Ballistics Research Laboratory (TBRL)** located at **Ramgarh Range, Panchkula, Haryana**.

The trial was carried out to validate **advanced munitions and defence capabilities**, highlighting India's ongoing efforts to strengthen its **indigenous defence technologies**.

The high-powered explosive test was conducted in accordance with **Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs)** and under the supervision of senior **Indian Air Force (IAF)** officials and **DRDO scientists**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO)** under the **Ministry of Defence** successfully conducted a **high-calibre conventional bomb trial** at the **Terminal Ballistics Research Laboratory (TBRL)** located at **Ramgarh Range, Panchkula, Haryana**.

The trial was carried out to validate **advanced munitions and defence capabilities**, highlighting India's ongoing efforts to strengthen its **indigenous defence technologies**.

The high-powered explosive test was conducted in accordance with **Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs)** and under the supervision of senior **Indian Air Force (IAF)** officials and **DRDO scientists**.

The successfully tested high-calibre bomb has been designed to serve as a **warhead for Indian Air Force missiles** and other **air-dropped munitions**, enhancing the operational capability of the armed forces.

The test was conducted at **TBRL, Ramgarh**, a premier DRDO facility specializing in **terminal ballistics, explosives, and weapon-effect studies**.

According to officials, the bomb trial was successfully executed while maintaining strict adherence to established **safety and security protocols**.

Prior to the trial, **TBRL, the District Administration, and the Police Administration** issued a **high alert** to ensure public safety and smooth conduct of the operation.

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93. In 2026, the Circulating Water Tunnel Facility launched by IIT Madras near Chennai was established with CSR funding from which Navratna Defence PSU?

A.Bharat Electronics Limited (BEL)

B.Hindustan Aeronautics Limited (HAL)

C.Garden Reach Shipbuilders & Engineers (GRSE)

D.Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders Limited (MDL)

E.Bharat Dynamics Limited (BDL)

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

Indian Institute of Technology Madras (IIT-M), Chennai, Tamil Nadu, launched the **Circulating Water Tunnel Facility** at **Thaiyur near Chennai,TN** strengthening India's maritime research infrastructure.

The **advanced hydrodynamic testing facility** is designed to enhance **indigenous ship design**, **ocean engineering research**, and **hydrodynamic testing capabilities** in India.

The facility was established with **₹4.5 crore** in **Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) funding** from **Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders Limited (MDL)**.

MDL is a **Navratna Defence Public Sector Undertaking (PSU)** under the Government of India.

Detailed Explanation:

Indian Institute of Technology Madras (IIT-M), Chennai, Tamil Nadu, launched the **Circulating Water Tunnel Facility** at **Thaiyur near Chennai,TN** strengthening India's maritime research infrastructure.

The **advanced hydrodynamic testing facility** is designed to enhance **indigenous ship design**, **ocean engineering research**, and **hydrodynamic testing capabilities** in India.

The facility was established with **₹4.5 crore** in **Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) funding** from **Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders Limited (MDL)**.

MDL is a **Navratna Defence Public Sector Undertaking (PSU)** under the Government of India.

The **Circulating Water Tunnel Facility** will strengthen India's capabilities in **ocean engineering**, **ship design**, **naval architecture**, **hydrodynamics**, and **offshore engineering research**.

The facility will support **research, testing, and development** related to **ships, marine vehicles, naval technologies, offshore structures, fluid dynamics, hydrodynamics, and ocean engineering systems**.

The project is expected to contribute significantly to **self-reliance in maritime technologies** and

the development of advanced naval and marine systems.

IIT Madras and **MDL** are also exploring future collaborations in **advanced maritime technologies** and **naval engineering research**

94. In 2026, which mobile application was launched by Union Minister Manohar Lal Khattar to enable citizens to report cleanliness and sanitation issues through geo-tagged photographs?

A.Swachh Mitra App

B.Swachha App

C.Clean India Connect App

D.SBM Citizen App

E.Nagar Seva App

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Union Minister Manohar Lal Khattar launched the **'Swachha App'**, a **geo-tagged mobile application** for cleanliness and sanitation monitoring in municipal areas, in **Kolkata, West Bengal**.

The app was launched in the presence of **Suvendu Adhikari**, Chief Minister of West Bengal, marking a significant step towards technology-enabled urban governance.

The launch was undertaken by the **Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs (MoHUA)** to strengthen the objectives of the **Swachh Bharat Mission (SBM)**.

Detailed Explanation:

Union Minister Manohar Lal Khattar launched the **'Swachha App'**, a **geo-tagged mobile application** for cleanliness and sanitation monitoring in municipal areas, in **Kolkata, West Bengal**.

The app was launched in the presence of **Suvendu Adhikari**, Chief Minister of West Bengal, marking a significant step towards technology-enabled urban governance.

The launch was undertaken by the **Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs (MoHUA)** to strengthen the objectives of the **Swachh Bharat Mission (SBM)**.

The primary objective of the Swachha App is to promote **citizen participation** in urban cleanliness and sanitation management through a digital platform.

The app enables citizens to upload **geo-tagged photographs** of civic issues such as stagnant water, garbage accumulation, drainage problems, uncleared dustbins, and sanitation-related concerns directly to municipal authorities.

The complaints submitted through the app are **automatically forwarded** to the concerned municipality for prompt action and resolution.

95. In 2026, RITES Limited signed a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) with which organisation to jointly offer integrated, data-driven infrastructure solutions in India and overseas?

A.India Ratings and Research (Ind-Ra)

B.ICRA Limited

C.CRISIL Limited

D.CARE Ratings

E.National Institute of Public Finance and Policy (NIPFP)

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

RITES Limited has signed a **Memorandum of Understanding** with **Credit Rating Information Services of India Limited (CRISIL)** to jointly offer **integrated, data-driven infrastructure solutions** in India and overseas.

The partnership combines **RITES Limited's expertise in transport infrastructure and engineering consultancy** with **Credit Rating Information Services of India Limited's capabilities in data intelligence, analytics, research and advisory services**.

Detailed Explanation:

RITES Limited has signed a **Memorandum of Understanding** with **Credit Rating Information Services of India Limited (CRISIL)** to jointly offer **integrated, data-driven infrastructure solutions** in India and overseas.

The partnership combines **RITES Limited's expertise in transport infrastructure and engineering consultancy** with **Credit Rating Information Services of India Limited's capabilities in data intelligence, analytics, research and advisory services**.

The collaboration will explore consultancy opportunities across multiple sectors including **railways,** metro rail, highways, expressways, airports, ports, ropeways, bridges, tunnels, urban transport, energy, water resources, hydropower, wastewater management and industrial infrastructure.

The partnership aims to strengthen **analytical and advisory support for infrastructure projects** through **market intelligence, data validation, financial due diligence, valuation support and development of analytical models**,

The initiative is designed to improve **decision-making, planning efficiency and execution of infrastructure projects**,

96. In 2026, the Government of Odisha signed an MoU with Intel Corporation and 3DGS Inc. to establish an Advanced Packaging Glass Core Substrate Manufacturing Facility in which region of Odisha?

A.Cuttack–Jagatpur

B.Sambalpur–Jharsuguda

C.Berhampur–Ganjam

D.Rourkela–Sundargarh

E.Bhubaneswar–Khordha

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

Government of Odisha, **Intel Corporation** and **3DGS Inc. (USA)** signed a **Memorandum of Understanding** to set up an **Advanced Packaging Glass Core Substrate Manufacturing Facility** in **Bhubaneswar–Khordha region of Odisha**.

The MoU was witnessed by **Union Minister for Electronics and Information Technology Ashwini Vaishnaw**, **Odisha Chief Minister**

Mohan Charan Majhi and **Intel Chief Executive Officer Lip-Bu Tan**.

The project involves an estimated investment of around **$3.3 billion**, making it one of the largest high-technology manufacturing investments in India,

The facility will focus on **advanced packaging glass core substrates, high-density interconnect substrates and semiconductor technologies**,

Intel Corporation will provide **technology know-how and process expertise**,

The project will be implemented in **phases over 5–6 years**,

Detailed Explanation:

Government of Odisha, **Intel Corporation** and **3DGS Inc. (USA)** signed a **Memorandum of Understanding** to set up an **Advanced Packaging Glass Core Substrate Manufacturing Facility** in **Bhubaneswar–Khordha region of Odisha**.

The MoU was witnessed by **Union Minister for Electronics and Information Technology Ashwini Vaishnaw**, **Odisha Chief Minister Mohan Charan Majhi** and **Intel Chief Executive Officer Lip-Bu Tan**.

The project involves an estimated investment of around **$3.3 billion**, making it one of the largest high-technology manufacturing investments in India,

The facility will focus on **advanced packaging glass core substrates, high-density interconnect substrates and semiconductor technologies**,

Intel Corporation will provide **technology know-how and process expertise**,

The project will be implemented in **phases over 5–6 years**,

The initiative builds on the **India Semiconductor Mission** and the existing approved project of **3D Glass Solutions Inc.** in **Info Valley, Khordha district**,

Odisha has become the **only state in India** hosting both a **commercial compound semiconductor fabrication unit** and an **advanced 3D glass substrate packaging facility**,

About Odisha

Capital: Bhubaneswar,

Chief Minister: Mohan Charan Majhi,

Governor: Dr. Hari Babu Kambhampati,

About Intel Corporation

Headquarters: California, United States of America,

CEO: Lip-Bu Tan,

Founded: 1968,

About 3D Glass Solutions Inc.,

Headquarters: Albuquerque, United States of America,

CEO: Mark Popovich,

Founded: 2005

97. In 2026, Tata Consultancy Services (TCS) entered into a strategic partnership with which French artificial intelligence company,

becoming the first global systems integrator partner for the Mistral Forge platform?

A.Hugging Face

B.Mistral AI

C.Dataiku

D.LightOn

E.Owkin

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Tata Consultancy Services has entered a strategic partnership with French artificial intelligence company **Mistral AI**.

With this collaboration, Tata Consultancy Services has become the **first global systems integrator partner** for **Mistral Forge**, an enterprise artificial intelligence platform.

Mistral Forge enables the development of frontier-grade artificial intelligence models using proprietary enterprise knowledge and domain-specific data.

Under the partnership, Tata Consultancy Services will use Mistral Forge to build **custom artificial intelligence models for enterprises**.

Detailed Explanation:

Tata Consultancy Services has entered a strategic partnership with French artificial intelligence company **Mistral AI**.

With this collaboration, Tata Consultancy Services has become the **first global systems integrator partner** for **Mistral Forge**, an enterprise artificial intelligence platform.

Mistral Forge enables the development of frontier-grade artificial intelligence models using proprietary enterprise knowledge and domain-specific data.

Under the partnership, Tata Consultancy Services will use Mistral Forge to build **custom artificial intelligence models for enterprises**.

These models will help organisations integrate enterprise data and context to improve business decision-making.

The initial focus sectors include:

Banking, Financial Services and Insurance

Manufacturing

Healthcare

Public sector

Tata Consultancy Services will also establish a **Centre of Excellence for Mistral AI**.

The Centre of Excellence will focus on developing industry-specific solutions, supporting project delivery, and accelerating customer adoption through early access to beta models.

About Tata Consultancy Services

Headquarters: Mumbai, Maharashtra

Chief Executive Officer: K. Krithivasan

Founded: 1968

Parent Company: Tata Group

About Mistral AI

Headquarters: Paris, France

Chief Executive Officer: Arthur Mensch

Founded: 2023

98. In 2026, how many medals did India win at the Under-23 Asian Wrestling Championships held in Da Nang, Vietnam?

A.21

B.23
C.2527
D.27
E.29
Answer: D
Short Explanation:
India's Under-23 wrestlers won a **record 27 medals** (11 gold, 7 silver and 9 bronze) at the **Under-23 Asian Wrestling Championships 2026** held in **Da Nang, Vietnam**.
The medals were won across **Freestyle, Women's Wrestling and Greco-Roman categories**.
Both the **Men's Freestyle team** and the **Women's Wrestling team** won the **overall team titles**,
Kyrgyzstan finished second and **Kazakhstan** finished third in the overall standings,
Detailed Explanation:
India's Under-23 wrestlers won a **record 27 medals** (11 gold, 7 silver and 9 bronze) at the **Under-23 Asian Wrestling Championships 2026** held in **Da Nang, Vietnam**.
The medals were won across **Freestyle, Women's Wrestling and Greco-Roman categories**.
Both the **Men's Freestyle team** and the **Women's Wrestling team** won the **overall team titles**,
Kyrgyzstan finished second and **Kazakhstan** finished third in the overall standings,
In **Men's Freestyle**, gold medals were won by **Akshay T Dhere (57 kilogram), Mohit Kumar (65 kilogram), Chandermohan (79 kilogram) and Vicky Hooda (97 kilogram)**,
In **Women's Wrestling**, gold medals were won by **Muskan (53 kilogram), Bhagyashree (62 kilogram), Tapasya (57 kilogram), Pulkit (67 kilogram), Mansi (68 kilogram) and Kajal (76 kilogram)**,
In the **Greco-Roman category**, **Sumit** won the gold medal in the **63 kilogram division**,

99. In 2026, which Indian shooter won the gold medal in the Women's 25 metre pistol event at the ISSF World Cup in Munich and set a new world record with 43 points in the final?
A.Esha Singh
B.Rhythm Sangwan
C.Manu Bhaker
D.Sift Kaur Samra
E.Elavenil Valarivan
Answer: A
Short Explanation:
Indian shooter **Esha Singh** won the **gold medal** in the **Women's 25 metre pistol event** at the **International Shooting Sport Federation World Cup 2026** held in **Munich, Germany**,
She created a **new world record by scoring 43 points out of 50 in the final**, surpassing the previous record of **42 points held by South Korea's Kim Yeji**,

This was India's **first individual shooting medal** of the International Shooting Sport Federation World Cup 2026 season across **rifle, pistol and shotgun events**,

Detailed Explanation:

Indian shooter **Esha Singh** won the **gold medal** in the **Women's 25 metre pistol event** at the **International Shooting Sport Federation World Cup 2026** held in **Munich, Germany**,

She created a **new world record by scoring 43 points out of 50 in the final**, surpassing the previous record of **42 points held by South Korea's Kim Yeji**,

This was India's **first individual shooting medal** of the International Shooting Sport Federation World Cup 2026 season across **rifle, pistol and shotgun events**,

The gold medal secured her a **direct qualification for the International Shooting Sport Federation World Cup Final 2026**, scheduled in **Rome, Italy in December 2026**, **Doreen Vennekamp of Germany** won the silver medal with **38 points**, while **Miroslava Mincheva of Bulgaria** won the bronze medal with **31 points**,

Overall, this was India's **third medal across rifle, pistol and shotgun events** in the ongoing World Cup season,

100. In 2026, the International Cricket Council (ICC) suspended the membership of which country's cricket board due to serious breaches of governance and membership obligations?

A.Cricket Scotland

B.Cricket Ireland

C.Cricket Netherlands

D.Cricket Namibia

E.Cricket Canada

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

The **International Cricket Council** has suspended the membership of **Cricket Canada** with immediate effect due to serious breaches of governance and membership obligations.

The decision was taken during the **International Cricket Council Board meeting held in Ahmedabad.**

The International Cricket Council stated that the suspension follows concerns regarding governance standards, administrative functioning, and compliance with membership requirements.

Detailed Explanation:

The **International Cricket Council** has suspended the membership of **Cricket Canada** with immediate effect due to serious breaches of governance and membership obligations.

The decision was taken during the **International Cricket Council Board meeting held in Ahmedabad.**

The International Cricket Council stated that the suspension follows concerns regarding governance standards, administrative

functioning, and compliance with membership requirements.

The action comes after increased scrutiny of Cricket Canada's administration, including allegations highlighted in a report by the **Canadian Broadcasting Corporation** in April 2026.

The allegations included governance irregularities, administrative misconduct, concerns over match manipulation, and threats involving certain officials and players.

The **suspension will remain in effect until Cricket Canada** fulfills the conditions prescribed by the International Cricket Council for reinstatement.

101. In 2026, veteran Indian playback singer Suman Kalyanpur, who passed away at the age of 89, was born with which name?

A.Suman Mukherjee

B.Suman Hemmady

C.Suman Deshpande

D.Suman Rao

E.Suman Kulkarni

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Veteran Indian playback singer Suman Kalyanpur passed away at the age of **89** in **Mumbai, Maharashtra**, marking the end of an illustrious era in Indian music.

She was born as **Suman Hemmady** on **28 January 1937** in **Dhaka, Bengal Presidency, British India** (present-day Dhaka, Bangladesh).

In **January 2023**, she was honoured with the **Padma Bhushan**, India's third-highest civilian award, by the **Government of India (GoI)** in the field of **Arts** for her outstanding contribution to Indian music.

Detailed Explanation:

Veteran Indian playback singer Suman Kalyanpur passed away at the age of **89** in **Mumbai, Maharashtra**, marking the end of an illustrious era in Indian music.

She was born as **Suman Hemmady** on **28 January 1937** in **Dhaka, Bengal Presidency, British India** (present-day Dhaka, Bangladesh).

Suman Kalyanpur was one of India's most celebrated playback singers, renowned for her melodious voice and immense contribution to **Hindi, Marathi, and several regional film industries**.

She began her playback singing career in **1954** with the films **Shukrachi Chandini and Mangu**, laying the foundation for a distinguished musical journey.

She rose to prominence during the **1950s and 1960s**, earning widespread recognition for her soulful songs and memorable duets with legendary playback singer **Mohammed Rafi**.

In **January 2023**, she was honoured with the **Padma Bhushan**, India's third-highest civilian award, by the **Government of India (GoI)** in the field of **Arts** for her outstanding contribution to Indian music.

102. In 2026, the International Day of Innocent Children Victims of Aggression was observed globally on which date every year?

A.4 June

B.3 June

C.12 June

D.19 August

E.20 November

Answer: A

The **International Day of Innocent Children Victims of Aggression 2026** was observed globally on **4 June 2026** as an awareness day

The day is observed every year on **4 June** to acknowledge the suffering faced by children worldwide

The observance highlights children who are victims of **physical, mental and emotional abuse**

The International Day of Innocent Children Victims of Aggression was established by the **United Nations General Assembly on 19 August 1982**

103. In 2026, what is the total outlay of the Pradhan Mantri Skilling and Employability Transformation through Upgraded Industrial Training Institutes (PM-SETU) Scheme?

A.₹40,000 crore

B.₹50,000 crore

C.₹55,000 crore

D.₹60,000 crore

E.₹75,000 crore

Answer: D

The **Pradhan Mantri Skilling and Employability Transformation through Upgraded Industrial Training Institutes Scheme** was approved by the Union Cabinet in 2025.

The scheme has a total outlay of **₹60,000 crore**.

It aims to upgrade **1,000 government Industrial Training Institutes** across India through a **hub-and-spoke model**.

The scheme seeks to modernise vocational training infrastructure and align skill development programmes with industry requirements.

104. As of 2026, who is the Vice Chairman of NITI Aayog?

A.Suman Bery

B.Rajiv Kumar

C.Ashok Lahiri

D.Amitabh Kant

E.Arvind Panagariya

Answer: C

About NITI Aayog

Headquarters: New Delhi

Chairperson: Narendra Modi

Vice Chairman: Ashok Lahiri

Chief Executive Officer: Nidhi Chhibber

Established: 1 January 2015

Full Form: National Institution for Transforming India Aayog.

105. In 2026, the Indian Association for the Cultivation of Science (IACS) is located in which city?

A.Chennai
B.Bengaluru
C.Hyderabad
D.Kolkata
E.Mumbai
Answer: D
About Indian Association for the Cultivation of Science
Founded: 1876
Founder: Dr Mahendralal Sircar
Location: Kolkata, West Bengal
First Indian Nobel Prize in Science: Sir C V Raman (1930)

106. In 2026, India launched the first phase of a cross-border QR payment linkage with which country, enabling Indian travellers to use UPI to scan KHQR for payments?
A.Thailand
B.Cambodia
C.Malaysia
D.Indonesia
E.Vietnam
Answer: B
Short Explanation:
India and Cambodia launched the **first phase** of a **cross-border QR payment linkage**, enabling Indian users to make digital payments in Cambodia using Unified Payments Interface (UPI).
Under the arrangement, Indian travellers can use **UPI-enabled applications** to scan **KHQR (Khmer QR)**, Cambodia's national interoperable QR code system, for seamless payments.
The facility is available at more than **4.5 million merchant outlets** across Cambodia, including tourist attractions, restaurants, retail stores, and other commercial establishments.
The initiative is being implemented by **NPCI International Payments Limited (NIPL)** in partnership with **ACLEDA Bank Plc**.
NIPL is a wholly owned subsidiary of the **National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI)** and is responsible for the international expansion of **UPI and RuPay**.
Detailed Explanation:
India and Cambodia launched the **first phase** of a **cross-border QR payment linkage**, enabling Indian users to make digital payments in Cambodia using Unified Payments Interface (UPI).
Under the arrangement, Indian travellers can use **UPI-enabled applications** to scan **KHQR (Khmer QR)**, Cambodia's national interoperable QR code system, for seamless payments.
The facility is available at more than **4.5 million merchant outlets** across Cambodia, including tourist attractions, restaurants, retail stores, and other commercial establishments.
The initiative is being implemented by **NPCI International Payments Limited (NIPL)** in partnership with **ACLEDA Bank Plc**.
NIPL is a wholly owned subsidiary of the **National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI)** and is responsible for the international expansion of **UPI and RuPay**.
In the **second phase**, Cambodian visitors will be able to make payments at **UPI-enabled**

merchant locations across India using their Cambodian banking and payment applications.
The initiative strengthens **cross-border digital payment connectivity**, promotes **tourism**, and enhances **financial integration** between India and Cambodia.
UPI (Unified Payments Interface) is already operational in **eight countries**: **Bhutan, Nepal, Singapore, Sri Lanka, Mauritius, France, Qatar, and the United Arab Emirates (UAE)**.
NPCI is also exploring bilateral **UPI linkages** with **Indonesia, Malaysia, and Thailand**.
Future plans include operationalising **UPI** in **Japan, Maldives, and Greece**.
International UPI transaction volume crossed the **one million mark** for the first time in **FY26**.

107. In 2026, Karur Vysya Bank (KVB) launched a new premium credit card portfolio on which payment network platform?

A.RuPay
B.MasterCard
C.Visa
D.American Express
E.Discover

Answer: C

Short Explanation:
Karur Vysya Bank Limited (KVB) launched a new **premium credit card portfolio** on the **Visa platform** to strengthen its offerings for affluent and lifestyle-focused customers.
The newly launched portfolio consists of **four credit card variants: Aura (Visa Platinum), Samara (Visa Signature), Altura (Visa Infinite), and Eternis (Visa Infinite)**.
The initiative is part of KVB's strategy to expand its presence in the **premium banking and lifestyle segment** and cater to the evolving needs of high-value customers.
Detailed Explanation:
Karur Vysya Bank Limited (KVB) launched a new **premium credit card portfolio** on the **Visa platform** to strengthen its offerings for affluent and lifestyle-focused customers.
The newly launched portfolio consists of **four credit card variants: Aura (Visa Platinum), Samara (Visa Signature), Altura (Visa Infinite), and Eternis (Visa Infinite)**.
The initiative is part of KVB's strategy to expand its presence in the **premium banking and lifestyle segment** and cater to the evolving needs of high-value customers.
The credit cards are targeted at **emerging affluent and affluent customers**, including salaried professionals, self-employed individuals, and business owners.
The cards provide benefits across multiple categories such as **travel, dining, entertainment, online shopping, lifestyle services, airport lounge access, hotel partnerships, rewards programmes, OTT subscriptions, and foreign transactions**.

108. In FY 2025–26, which country lost its position as the second-largest source of

Foreign Direct Investment (FDI) into India after changes in the India–Mauritius Tax Treaty framework?

A.Singapore

B.United States

C.Japan

D.Mauritius

E.United Kingdom

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

The **United States (US)** overtook Mauritius to become the **second-largest source of Foreign Direct Investment (FDI)** into India in **FY 2025-26**.

Singapore remained the **largest source of FDI** into India, accounting for nearly **one-third** of India's total equity inflows.

Equity inflows from the **United States** more than doubled to over **USD 11 billion** in FY 2025-26.

Following amendments to the **India–Mauritius Tax Treaty**, Singapore emerged as the **most preferred investment route** for investments into India.

Mauritius lost its position as the second-largest FDI source after changes in the **tax treaty framework**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **United States (US)** overtook Mauritius to become the **second-largest source of Foreign Direct Investment (FDI)** into India in **FY 2025-26**.

Singapore remained the **largest source of FDI** into India, accounting for nearly **one-third** of India's total equity inflows.

Equity inflows from the **United States** more than doubled to over **USD 11 billion** in FY 2025-26.

Following amendments to the **India–Mauritius Tax Treaty**, Singapore emerged as the **most preferred investment route** for investments into India.

Mauritius lost its position as the second-largest FDI source after changes in the **tax treaty framework**.

Japan recorded strong growth in FDI inflows, mainly driven by investments in the **Financial Services Sector**.

Computer Hardware and Software emerged as the **largest recipient sector of FDI**, surpassing the Services Sector.

Increased investments in **Data Centres** and **Digital Infrastructure** were the major reasons for the rise in FDI inflows into the Computer Hardware and Software Sector.

109. In 2026, under the PM SVANidhi Scheme, street vendors who successfully repay the second loan tranche become eligible for which financial facility?

A.Gold loan facility up to ₹1 lakh

B.Insurance-linked savings account

C.Direct equity support from banks

D.Housing loan subsidy under PMAY

E.RuPay Credit Card linked with UPI up to ₹30,000

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

The **Pradhan Mantri Street Vendor's AtmaNirbhar Nidhi (PM SVANidhi)**

Scheme completed **six years of operation in June 2026**.

The scheme was launched on **1 June 2020** by the **Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs** as a first-of-its-kind micro-credit initiative for street vendors affected by the COVID-19 pandemic,

Street vendors successfully repaying the second loan tranche are eligible for **Unified Payments Interface-linked RuPay Credit Cards** with limits up to **₹30,000**,

Detailed Explanation:

The **Pradhan Mantri Street Vendor's AtmaNirbhar Nidhi (PM SVANidhi) Scheme** completed **six years of operation in June 2026**.

The scheme was launched on **1 June 2020** by the **Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs** as a first-of-its-kind micro-credit initiative for street vendors affected by the COVID-19 pandemic,

Since its launch, more than **1.12 crore loans** worth over **₹17,800 crore** have been disbursed to more than **75.5 lakh beneficiaries** across cities and towns.

The scheme provides **collateral-free working capital loans** in three progressive tranches of **₹15,000, ₹25,000 and ₹50,000**.

Beneficiaries receive **interest subsidy and credit guarantee support**, while timely repayment makes them eligible for higher loan tranches,

Street vendors successfully repaying the second loan tranche are eligible for **Unified Payments Interface-linked RuPay Credit Cards** with limits up to **₹30,000**,

More than **55 lakh beneficiaries** have been digitally onboarded under the scheme,

The **SVANidhi se Samriddhi** sub-component undertakes socio-economic profiling of beneficiaries and their families,

110. In 2026, India will host the 13th BRICS Urbanisation Forum in New Delhi under its BRICS Chairship. What is the theme of the Forum?

A.Cities for Growth: BRICS Urban Expansion Strategy

B.Smart Cities for Sustainable Development

C.Urban India 2030: Innovation and Infrastructure

D.Cities for People: BRICS Cooperation for Inclusive and Resilient Urban Futures

E.BRICS Cities for Digital Transformation

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

India will host the **13th BRICS Urbanisation Forum** on **11–12 June 2026** in **New Delhi**.

The announcement was made by **Union Minister for Housing and Urban Affairs Manohar Lal**,

The theme of the Forum is **"Cities for People: BRICS Cooperation for Inclusive and Resilient Urban Futures"**,

Detailed Explanation:

India will host the **13th BRICS Urbanisation Forum** on **11–12 June 2026** in **New Delhi**.

The announcement was made by **Union Minister for Housing and Urban Affairs Manohar Lal**,

The theme of the Forum is **"Cities for People: BRICS Cooperation for Inclusive and Resilient Urban Futures"**,

The Forum is a key ministerial event under **India's BRICS Chairship 2026**, guided by Prime Minister Narendra Modi's vision of **"Humanity First"**,

India's BRICS Chairship theme is **"Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability"**,

With the 2026 edition, **India will host the BRICS Urbanisation Forum for the fourth time**,

The Forum focuses on **Inclusive Urban Development, Climate and Disaster-Resilient Infrastructure, Stronger Municipal Institutions, and Digital Innovation for Better Urban Governance**,

111. With reference to India's seafood exports in FY 2025–26, consider the following statements:

India's seafood exports reached 19.72 million metric tonnes valued at ₹73,890.46 crore.

Frozen shrimp was the largest export item, contributing over 40% of total export volume.

Dried seafood was the fastest-growing segment in terms of export growth.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

A.1 and 2 only

B.2 and 3 only

C.1 and 3 only

D.1, 2 and 3

E.2 only

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

India's **seafood exports** reached an **all-time high** in **Financial Year 2025-26**, recording **19,72,018 Metric Tonnes** valued at **₹73,890.46 crore (8.46 billion United States dollars)**.

Frozen shrimp accounted for **40.19% of total export volume** and **66.52% of total export earnings in dollar terms**.

Frozen fish was the second-largest export item, with exports worth **₹5,658.37 crore (643.70 million United States dollars)** and volume increasing **4.68% to 3,55,581 Metric Tonnes**.

Dried seafood emerged as the fastest-growing segment, with exports increasing **62.25% in volume** to **4,10,410 Metric Tonnes** and **69.46% in dollar value** to **577.44 million United States dollars**.

Detailed Explanation:

India's **seafood exports** reached an **all-time high** in **Financial Year 2025-26**, recording **19,72,018 Metric Tonnes** valued at **₹73,890.46 crore (8.46 billion United States dollars)**.

The exports registered a **year-on-year growth of 16.13% in volume, 18.4% in rupee value and 13.44% in dollar value.**

The achievement was announced by **Marine Products Export Development Authority Chairman P. Jawahar**.

The **unit value per kilogram declined by 2.31% in dollar terms.**

Frozen shrimp remained the leading export item, contributing **7,92,647 Metric Tonnes** valued at **₹49,037.93 crore (5,624.48 million United States dollars)**.

Frozen shrimp accounted for **40.19% of total export volume** and **66.52% of total export earnings in dollar terms**.

Frozen fish was the second-largest export item, with exports worth **₹5,658.37 crore (643.70 million United States dollars)** and volume increasing **4.68% to 3,55,581 Metric Tonnes**.

Dried seafood emerged as the fastest-growing segment, with exports increasing **62.25% in volume** to **4,10,410 Metric Tonnes** and **69.46% in dollar value** to **577.44 million United States dollars**.

About Marine Products Export Development Authority

Headquarters: Kochi, Kerala,

Chairman: P. Jawahar,

Parent Ministry: Ministry of Commerce and Industry

Established: 1972.

112. With reference to the Sagar Aankalan Award 2024–25 for port performance in India, consider the following statements:

Deendayal Port Authority (Kandla) received the award in the category "Handling of Container Cargo – less than 0.5 million TEUs."

Mundra Port ranked first among ports handling more than 0.5 million TEUs in the Container Cargo category.

Paradip Port Authority secured the top position in the Liquid Bulk Cargo category.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

A.1 and 2 only

B.2 only

C.1 and 3 only

D.1, 2 and 3

E.3 only

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

Deendayal Port Authority (DPA), Kandla received the **Sagar Aankalan Award** as the best-performing port under the category **"Handling of Container Cargo – Less than 0.5 million Twenty-foot Equivalent Units"** for **Financial Year 2024-25**.

Paradip Port Authority emerged as the top performer in the **Dry Bulk Cargo** category among ports handling more than **5 million tonnes** of cargo,

Sikka Port and Terminals ranked first in the **Liquid Bulk Cargo** category.

Visakhapatnam Port Authority secured the **second position** in handling liquid bulk cargo among ports handling **5 million tonnes and above**.

Detailed Explanation:

Deendayal Port Authority (DPA), Kandla received the **Sagar Aankalan Award** as the best-performing port under the category **"Handling of Container Cargo – Less than 0.5 million Twenty-foot Equivalent Units"** for **Financial Year 2024-25**.

The award was received by **Deputy Chairman Nilabhra Dasgupta** in Mumbai.

Paradip Port Authority emerged as the top performer in the **Dry Bulk Cargo** category among ports handling more than **5 million tonnes** of cargo,

Paradip Port Authority also secured the **third position in India for Container Cargo Performance**.

Sikka Port and Terminals ranked first in the **Liquid Bulk Cargo** category.

Visakhapatnam Port Authority secured the **second position** in handling liquid bulk cargo among ports handling **5 million tonnes and above**.

Mundra Port emerged as the highest-ranked port in the **Container Cargo** category among ports handling more than **0.5 million Twenty-foot Equivalent Units.**

Jawaharlal Nehru Port Authority secured the **second position** among major container ports in the same category.

113. In 2026, Brajesh Kumar Singh was appointed as the Managing Director (MD) and Chief Executive Officer (CEO) of which public sector bank?

A.Punjab National Bank

B.Canara Bank

C.Indian Bank

D.Bank of Baroda

E.Union Bank of India

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Brajesh Kumar Singh has assumed charge as the **Managing Director (MD) and Chief Executive Officer (CEO)** of **Canara Bank** following his appointment by the Central Government of India.

Prior to this appointment, he served as **Executive Director of Indian Bank** from **March 2024**.

Detailed Explanation:

Brajesh Kumar Singh has assumed charge as the **Managing Director (MD) and Chief Executive Officer (CEO)** of **Canara Bank** following his appointment by the Central Government of India.

Prior to this appointment, he served as **Executive Director of Indian Bank** from **March 2024**.

His tenure as **MD & CEO of Canara Bank** will continue until **30 April 2029**, the date of his superannuation, or until further orders, whichever is earlier.

The position of **MD & CEO of Canara Bank** had remained vacant since the retirement of **K. Satyanarayana Raju** in **December 2025**.

Brajesh Kumar Singh is an **Agriculture Graduate** from **Allahabad Agricultural Institute**.

114. In 2026, Maj Gen Rachel Thomas assumed charge as the Additional Director General of which service in the Indian Armed Forces?

A.Army Medical Corps

B.Defence Nursing Service

C.Armed Forces Medical Services Headquarters
D.Military Nursing Service
E.Indian Army Medical Branch
Answer: D
Maj Gen Rachel Thomas assumed charge as the **Additional Director General, Military Nursing Service (MNS)** on **June 01, 2026**. She succeeds **Maj Gen Lissamma PV**, who **superannuated on May 31, 2026** after **four decades of distinguished service** to the nation.
Maj Gen Rachel Thomas was commissioned into the **Military Nursing Service (MNS)** on **June 01, 1988**, marking the beginning of her long and distinguished military nursing career.

115. In 2026, Project UDAYAK of the Border Roads Organisation (BRO) celebrated its 37th Raising Day at which location in Assam?
A.Tinsukia
B.Tezpur
C.Doomdooma
D.Dibrugarh
E.Silchar
Answer: C
Border Roads Organisation (BRO) celebrated the **37th Raising Day of Project UDAYAK** on **01 June 2026** at **Doomdooma, Assam**, marking more than three decades of service in developing strategic infrastructure in North-East India.
Project UDAYAK is entrusted with the development and maintenance of over **1,457 km of road network** in the easternmost parts of **Arunachal Pradesh** and parts of **Assam**. The project's area of responsibility includes the districts of **Anjaw, Lohit, Dibang Valley, Longding, Tirap, and Changlang**, making it one of the most strategically important BRO projects in the North-East.
Detailed Explanation:
Border Roads Organisation (BRO) celebrated the **37th Raising Day of Project UDAYAK** on **01 June 2026** at **Doomdooma, Assam**, marking more than three decades of service in developing strategic infrastructure in North-East India.
Project UDAYAK is entrusted with the development and maintenance of over **1,457 km of road network** in the easternmost parts of **Arunachal Pradesh** and parts of **Assam**. The project's area of responsibility includes the districts of **Anjaw, Lohit, Dibang Valley, Longding, Tirap, and Changlang**, making it one of the most strategically important BRO projects in the North-East.
Project UDAYAK plays a crucial role in enhancing connectivity along the **Line of Actual Control (LAC)** and the **Indo–Myanmar Border**, thereby strengthening national security and border infrastructure.
The project is currently engaged in the construction of strategic roads and **border fencing infrastructure** along the **India–**

Myanmar border, improving accessibility in remote border regions.

In **2025**, Project UDAYAK completed **12 bridges, one road, and one helipad**, all of which were inaugurated by **Defence Minister Rajnath Singh**.

116. In 2026, India signed a BrahMos missile export agreement with which country, making it the second overseas buyer of the system after the Philippines?

A.Vietnam

B.Indonesia

C.Malaysia

D.Thailand

E.Sri Lanka

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

The **Government of India (GoI)** signed a **BrahMos missile export agreement** with **Vietnam** worth approximately **Rs 60 billion (USD 629 million)**, marking a significant milestone in India's defence exports.

The agreement further strengthens **India–Vietnam bilateral defence and strategic cooperation**, particularly in the field of maritime and regional security.

The announcement was made by **Rajesh Kumar Singh**, Secretary, **Ministry of Defence (MoD)**, during the **Shangri-La Dialogue** held in **Singapore**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Government of India (GoI)** signed a **BrahMos missile export agreement** with **Vietnam** worth approximately **Rs 60 billion (USD 629 million)**, marking a significant milestone in India's defence exports.

The agreement further strengthens **India–Vietnam bilateral defence and strategic cooperation**, particularly in the field of maritime and regional security.

The announcement was made by **Rajesh Kumar Singh**, Secretary, **Ministry of Defence (MoD)**, during the **Shangri-La Dialogue** held in **Singapore**.

The **Shangri-La Dialogue** is an annual security summit organized by the **International Institute for Strategic Studies (IISS)**.

The BrahMos export contract includes the supply of **BrahMos missile systems**, along with training, maintenance assistance, and logistical support.

Vietnam has become the **second overseas buyer** of the BrahMos supersonic cruise missile system, enhancing India's position as a global defence exporter.

The **Philippines** was the **first foreign customer** of the BrahMos missile after signing a **USD 375 million deal** with India in **2022**.

About Vietnam :

Prime Minister : Lê Minh Hưng

Capital : Hanoi

Currency : Vietnamese đồng

117. In 2026, Hindustan Unilever Limited (HUL) inaugurated the Unilever Fragrance Hub (UFH) in collaboration with which institution?

A.Indian Institute of Science (IISc), Bengaluru

B.Indian Institute of Technology Delhi (IIT-D)

C.Indian Institute of Technology Bombay (IIT-B)

D.National Institute of Industrial Engineering (NITIE), Mumbai

E.Indian Institute of Technology Madras (IIT-M)

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

India's largest Fast-Moving Consumer Goods (FMCG) company, **Hindustan Unilever Limited (HUL)** inaugurated the **Unilever Fragrance Hub (UFH)** at the **Indian Institute of Technology Bombay (IIT-B)** campus in **Mumbai, Maharashtra**.

The newly inaugurated **UFH** is the **third global Unilever Fragrance Hub**, following similar facilities in the **United Kingdom (UK)** and the **United States of America (USA)**.

Detailed Explanation:

India's largest Fast-Moving Consumer Goods (FMCG) company, **Hindustan Unilever Limited (HUL)** inaugurated the **Unilever Fragrance Hub (UFH)** at the **Indian Institute of Technology Bombay (IIT-B)** campus in **Mumbai, Maharashtra**.

The newly inaugurated **UFH** is the **third global Unilever Fragrance Hub**, following similar facilities in the **United Kingdom (UK)** and the **United States of America (USA)**.

The facility has been established under **HUL's EUR 100 million investment programme**, aimed at strengthening **in-house, digitally enabled fragrance creation capabilities**.

The **Unilever Fragrance Hub** has been developed with an estimated investment of **Rs 95 crore**.

The centre integrates **consumer insights**, **advanced scientific research**, and **Artificial Intelligence (AI)** to drive innovation in **fragrance development** across multiple product categories.

The facility will support the creation of **next-generation fragrances** by combining **data-driven insights**, **sensory science**, and **AI-powered innovation tools**.

118. In 2026, India's first DORIS (Doppler Orbitography and Radiopositioning Integrated by Satellite) ground beacon was installed at which institution?

A.ISRO Satellite Centre, Bengaluru

B.IIT Delhi

C.IIT Kanpur

D.IISc Bengaluru

E.IIT Bombay

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

Indian Institute of Technology Kanpur (IIT Kanpur) has become the host of India's first **DORIS (Doppler Orbitography and Radiopositioning Integrated by Satellite)** ground beacon, joining a global network of **high-precision geodetic stations**.

DORIS is a French satellite tracking and positioning system used to determine **satellite position and velocity with centimetre-level accuracy**.

The **DORIS ground beacon at IIT Kanpur** is part of the worldwide network of DORIS ground stations that support **precise satellite orbit determination**.

Detailed Explanation:

Indian Institute of Technology Kanpur (IIT Kanpur) has become the host of India's first **DORIS (Doppler Orbitography and Radiopositioning Integrated by Satellite)** ground beacon, joining a global network of **high-precision geodetic stations**.

DORIS is a French satellite tracking and positioning system used to determine **satellite position and velocity with centimetre-level accuracy**.

The **DORIS ground beacon at IIT Kanpur** is part of the worldwide network of DORIS ground stations that support **precise satellite orbit determination**.

DORIS works on the principle of the **Doppler Effect**, where changes in signal frequency caused by the movement of a satellite are used to calculate its exact position and speed.

Satellites equipped with **DORIS receivers** use signals transmitted from ground beacons to determine their location with **extremely high precision**.

The system measures **Doppler frequency shifts** from multiple beacons around the world to calculate satellite position and velocity accurately.

IIT Kanpur was selected by the **International DORIS Service (IDS)** in 2022 due to its **strategic location on the Indian tectonic plate** and its **expertise in space geodesy**.

119. In 2026, scientists from the Zoological Survey of India (ZSI) discovered a new lizard species named Mesalina bishnoi in which Indian state?

A.Gujarat

B.Punjab

C.Haryana

D.Madhya Pradesh

E.Rajasthan

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

Scientists from the **Zoological Survey of India (ZSI)** discovered a new **lizard species** named **Mesalina bishnoi** near **Gajner, Bikaner district, Rajasthan**.

The discovery marks the **first confirmed record** of the genus **Mesalina** in India, making it an important addition to the country's **reptile biodiversity**.

The species was discovered during field surveys conducted in **August 2025** and was formally validated through **morphological and genetic analysis**.

Detailed Explanation:

Scientists from the **Zoological Survey of India (ZSI)** discovered a new **lizard**

species named **Mesalina bishnoi** near **Gajner, Bikaner district, Rajasthan**.

The discovery marks the **first confirmed record** of the genus **Mesalina** in India, making it an important addition to the country's **reptile biodiversity**.

The species was discovered during field surveys conducted in **August 2025** and was formally validated through **morphological and genetic analysis**.

Mesalina bishnoi belongs to the family **Lacertidae** and is classified as an **arid-adapted lacertid lizard** suited to **desert environments**.

The species was named in honour of the **Bishnoi community** in recognition of its long-standing commitment to **environmental conservation** and **wildlife protection**.

Mesalina bishnoi is a **small, fast-moving, diurnal (day-active)** lizard with a **snout-vent length** of approximately **39.2 millimetres (mm)**.

The species was discovered in the **Thar biogeographic province (Thar Desert)** of Rajasthan, highlighting the rich but often underexplored biodiversity of the **desert ecosystem**.

120. In 2026, Mahindra Manulife Insurance Limited (MMIL) was approved as a 50:50 joint venture between the Mahindra Group and which foreign financial corporation?

A.Allianz SE

B.Prudential plc

C.Manulife Financial Corporation

D.AXA Group

E.MetLife Inc.

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The **Ministry of Corporate Affairs (MCA)** approved the incorporation of **Mahindra Manulife Insurance Limited (MMIL)**, a new life insurance joint venture between the **Mahindra Group** and **Manulife Financial Corporation (MFC)**.

MMIL has been established as a **50:50 joint venture** between India's **Mahindra Group** and Canada's **Manulife Financial Corporation**.

The company aims to provide **AI-native, digitally-led insurance solutions** across rural, semi-urban, and urban India in line with the vision of **"Insurance for All."**

Detailed Explanation:

The **Ministry of Corporate Affairs (MCA)** approved the incorporation of **Mahindra Manulife Insurance Limited (MMIL)**, a new life insurance joint venture between the **Mahindra Group** and **Manulife Financial Corporation (MFC)**.

MMIL has been established as a **50:50 joint venture** between India's **Mahindra Group** and Canada's **Manulife Financial Corporation**.

The company aims to provide **AI-native, digitally-led insurance solutions** across rural, semi-urban, and urban India in line with the vision of **"Insurance for All."**

The joint venture combines Mahindra's **extensive domestic distribution network** with Manulife's **global expertise** in

insurance product innovation, underwriting, and agency-led distribution.

Suresh Agarwal has been appointed as the **Managing Director (MD) and Chief Executive Officer (CEO)-designate** of Mahindra Manulife Insurance Limited (MMIL).

MMIL is positioned as an **AI-native, customer-first insurer**, leveraging **Artificial Intelligence (AI)**, **data-driven underwriting**, and **digital engagement platforms** to improve insurance accessibility and customer experience.

121. In 2026, which entity offloaded a 1.34% stake in One97 Communications (Paytm) through open market transactions worth approximately ₹963 crore?

A.Goldman Sachs

B.SAIF Partners

C.SoftBank Group

D.Temasek Holdings

E.BlackRock

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Global investment banks and **Foreign Institutional Investors (FIIs)** acquired a **1.34% stake** in **One97 Communications (Paytm)** through open market transactions worth approximately **₹963 crore**.

The stake sale was carried out by **SAIF Partners** through its affiliates **SAIF III Mauritius Company Ltd** and **SAIF Partners India IV Ltd**.

SAIF Partners offloaded a combined **80.08 lakh shares** of **Paytm** through the open market transaction.

Detailed Explanation:

Global investment banks and **Foreign Institutional Investors (FIIs)** acquired a **1.34% stake** in **One97 Communications (Paytm)** through open market transactions worth approximately **₹963 crore**.

One97 Communications Limited is the parent company of **Paytm**, one of India's leading fintech and digital payments platforms.

Major **foreign institutional buyers** included **Goldman Sachs**, **Societe Generale**, **BNP Paribas**, **Citigroup Global Markets**, **Ghisallo Capital Management**, **Copthall Mauritius Investment**, and **Viridian Asset Management**.

Among **domestic institutional investors**, **Sundaram Mutual Fund**, **Nippon India Mutual Fund**, **Edelweiss Mutual Fund**, and **India Acorn ICAV** participated in the share purchase.

The stake sale was carried out by **SAIF Partners** through its affiliates **SAIF III Mauritius Company Ltd** and **SAIF Partners India IV Ltd**.

SAIF Partners offloaded a combined **80.08 lakh shares** of **Paytm** through the open market transaction.

122. In 2026, the India–Oman Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement (CEPA) entered into force on 1 June 2026. Which of the following best describes Oman's tariff offer under the agreement?

A.Zero-duty access on 85% of tariff lines

B.Zero-duty access on 90% of tariff lines

C.Zero-duty access on 95% of tariff lines
D.Zero-duty access on 98.08% of tariff lines
E.Zero-duty access on 100% of tariff lines
Answer: D
Short Explanation:
The **India-Oman Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement (CEPA)** entered into force on **1 June 2026**.
The agreement was signed on **18 December 2025 in Muscat** in the presence of **Prime Minister Narendra Modi**,
Oman has offered **zero-duty access on 98.08% of its tariff lines**, covering **99.38% of India's exports to Oman**, with benefits effective from **Day One**,
Detailed Explanation:
The **India-Oman Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement (CEPA)** entered into force on **1 June 2026**.
The agreement was signed on **18 December 2025 in Muscat** in the presence of **Prime Minister Narendra Modi**,
The agreement was operationalised in New Delhi in the presence of **Union Minister Piyush Goyal** and **Issa Saleh Al Shibani, Ambassador of Oman to India**,
The first consignments of **agriculture products and gems and jewellery exports** availing preferential tariff benefits were flagged off from **Mumbai, Kolkata and Chennai**,
The India-Oman Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement is India's **second Free Trade Agreement signed within six months after the India–United Kingdom Free Trade Agreement**,
Oman has offered **zero-duty access on 98.08% of its tariff lines**, covering **99.38% of India's exports to Oman**, with benefits effective from **Day One**,
About Oman
Capital: Muscat,
Currency: Omani Rial,
Prime Minister: Sultan Haitham bin Tarik,
Ambassador of Oman to India: Issa Saleh Al Shibani,

123. In June 2026, under Jal Jeevan Mission 2.0, the Central Government signed MoUs with which set of states/UTs to strengthen rural drinking water supply systems?
A.Kerala, Goa, Bihar, Assam, Delhi
B.Arunachal Pradesh, Jharkhand, Tamil Nadu, Nagaland, Puducherry
C.Madhya Pradesh, Odisha, Gujarat, Punjab, Chandigarh
D.Karnataka, West Bengal, Rajasthan, Himachal Pradesh, Ladakh
E.Uttar Pradesh, Maharashtra, Chhattisgarh, Telangana, Sikkim
Answer: B
Short Explanation:
The **Central Government** has signed **Memorandums of Understanding** with **Arunachal Pradesh, Jharkhand, Tamil Nadu, Nagaland and the Union Territory of Puducherry** under **Jal Jeevan Mission 2.0**,

The initiative aims to strengthen **safe drinking water supply across rural India**,
The reform-linked Memorandums of Understanding promote a **Gram Panchayat-led, service-based and community-centred approach** to rural water governance,
Detailed Explanation:
The **Central Government** has signed **Memorandums of Understanding** with **Arunachal Pradesh, Jharkhand, Tamil Nadu, Nagaland and the Union Territory of Puducherry** under **Jal Jeevan Mission 2.0**,
The initiative aims to strengthen **safe drinking water supply across rural India**,
The reform-linked Memorandums of Understanding promote a **Gram Panchayat-led, service-based and community-centred approach** to rural water governance,
The initiative is aligned with the objectives of **Jal Jeevan Mission 2.0**, which seeks to ensure that every rural household receives **quality drinking water in adequate quantity on a regular basis**,
The mission emphasizes **community participation and local ownership** in managing rural water supply systems,
In **March 2026**, the **Union Cabinet** approved the extension of the **Jal Jeevan Mission** up to **December 2028**,
The extended mission has an enhanced **total financial outlay of ₹8.69 lakh crore**,
The new phase, known as **Jal Jeevan Mission 2.0**, aims to provide **Functional Household Tap Connections** to all **19.36 crore rural households** by **December 2028**,

124. In 2026, at the Under-17 Asian Wrestling Championships held in Da Nang, Vietnam, how many medals did India's women's wrestling team win in total?

A.8
B.9
C.10
D.11
E.12

Answer: C

Short Explanation:
India's **women's wrestling team** won a total of **10 medals** at the **Under-17 Asian Wrestling Championships 2026** held in **Da Nang, Vietnam**.
The medal tally included **2 gold medals, 3 silver medals and 5 bronze medals**,
With medals in all weight categories contested by Indian wrestlers, the team achieved a **100% podium success rate**,
Detailed Explanation:
India's **women's wrestling team** won a total of **10 medals** at the **Under-17 Asian Wrestling Championships 2026** held in **Da Nang, Vietnam**.
The medal tally included **2 gold medals, 3 silver medals and 5 bronze medals**,
With medals in all weight categories contested by Indian wrestlers, the team achieved a **100% podium success rate**,

Diksha won the **gold medal** in the **43-kilogram** category,
Garima secured the **gold medal** in the **73-kilogram** category,
Nikita (49 kilogram), **Antra (65 kilogram)** and **Taniya (69 kilogram)** won **silver medals**,
Palak (40 kilogram), **Anamika (46 kilogram)**, **Akshra (53 kilogram)**, **Sakshi (57 kilogram)** and **Manya (61 kilogram)** secured **bronze medals**,
The performance highlighted India's growing strength in women's wrestling at the junior international level,

125. In 2026, which country originally proposed to the United Nations the idea of holding an international conference on environmental issues, leading to the later establishment of World Environment Day (on June 5)?
A.Norway
B.Denmark
C.Sweden
D.Finland
E.Switzerland
Answer: C
World Environment Day 2026 is observed globally on **5 June 2026**.
The day is dedicated to raising awareness about **environmental protection and sustainable development**.
It highlights key environmental challenges such as **deforestation, climate change, biodiversity loss, pollution and ecosystem degradation**,
In **1968**, **Sweden** proposed to the **United Nations** the idea of holding an international conference focused on environmental issues,

126. In FY 2026–27, the Government of India increased the investment limit for an individual Person Resident Outside India (PROI) under the Portfolio Investment Scheme (PIS) from 5% to what percentage in any listed Indian company?
A.6%
B.8%
C.10%
D.15%
E.24%
Answer: C
Short Explanation:
The **Ministry of Finance (MoF)** announced a series of reforms to strengthen **India's position as a global investment destination**, deepen capital markets, and attract stable long-term foreign capital flows.
In the **Union Budget FY 2026-27**, the Government announced that **individual Persons Resident Outside India (PROIs)** will be allowed to invest in equity instruments of listed Indian companies through the **Portfolio Investment Scheme (PIS)**.
Earlier, the **Portfolio Investment Scheme (PIS)** was available only to **Non-Resident Indians (NRIs)** and **Overseas Citizens of India (OCIs)**.

The investment limit for an **individual PROI** under the Portfolio Investment Scheme (PIS) has been increased from **5% to 10%** in any listed Indian company.

The **overall investment limit** for all individual PROIs under the scheme has been increased from **10% to 24%**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Ministry of Finance (MoF)** announced a series of reforms to strengthen **India's position as a global investment destination**, deepen capital markets, and attract stable long-term foreign capital flows.

The reforms aim to enhance the **ease of investment** for **Persons Resident Outside India (PROIs)** and **Foreign Portfolio Investors (FPIs)**.

These measures are designed to make foreign investment in **Indian Equities** and **Government Securities (G-Secs)** more accessible, efficient, and globally competitive.

In the **Union Budget FY 2026-27**, the Government announced that **individual Persons Resident Outside India (PROIs)** will be allowed to invest in equity instruments of listed Indian companies through the **Portfolio Investment Scheme (PIS)**.

Earlier, the **Portfolio Investment Scheme (PIS)** was available only to **Non-Resident Indians (NRIs)** and **Overseas Citizens of India (OCIs)**.

The investment limit for an **individual PROI** under the Portfolio Investment Scheme (PIS) has been increased from **5% to 10%** in any listed Indian company.

The **overall investment limit** for all individual PROIs under the scheme has been increased from **10% to 24%**.

To implement these changes, the **Department of Economic Affairs (DEA)** is notifying the **Foreign Exchange Management (Non-Debt Instruments) (Third Amendment) Rules, 2026**.

The reform will facilitate greater **mobilization of foreign portfolio capital** through existing onboarding systems available for NRI and OCI investors.

127. In June 2026, the Asian Development Bank (ADB) and Standard Chartered Bank signed a Risk Participation Arrangement (RPA) through GIFT City primarily to support which type of transactions?

A.Euro-denominated transactions

B.Yen-denominated transactions

C.USD-denominated transactions

D.Cryptocurrency transactions

E.Domestic INR cash transactions

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

Asian Development Bank (ADB) and **Standard Chartered Bank** signed agreements to strengthen **Supply Chain Finance** in India through **risk-sharing arrangements**.

The partnership covers both **United States Dollar (USD)** and **Indian Rupee (INR)** transactions.

The agreements were signed in Mumbai by **Bhargav Dasgupta**, Vice-President of ADB, and **P. D. Singh**, CEO of Standard Chartered Bank India & South Asia.

Detailed Explanation:

Asian Development Bank (ADB) and **Standard Chartered Bank** signed agreements to strengthen **Supply Chain Finance** in India through **risk-sharing arrangements**.

The partnership covers both **United States Dollar (USD)** and **Indian Rupee (INR)** transactions.

The agreements were signed in Mumbai by **Bhargav Dasgupta**, Vice-President of ADB, and **P. D. Singh**, CEO of Standard Chartered Bank India & South Asia.

The main objective of the partnership is to **address financing gaps** and strengthen **risk-sharing mechanisms** in India's supply chain finance ecosystem.

The partnership includes a **Risk Participation Arrangement (RPA)** through **GIFT City** to support **USD-denominated transactions**.

It also includes a **Partial Guarantee Facility (PGF)** agreement to facilitate **onshore INR transactions**.

The RPA and PGF arrangements are designed to **expand access to Trade Finance and Supply Chain Finance** for businesses in India.

The partnership will support the smooth flow of both **Domestic Trade and Cross-Border Trade**.

128. According to the OECD Economic Outlook: Under Pressure – June 2026 report, what is the revised GDP growth forecast for India for FY 2026–27 (FY27)?

A.5.8%

B.6.3%

C.6.2%

D.6.4%

E.7.6%

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD) released its latest report titled **"OECD Economic Outlook: Under Pressure – June 2026"**.

The OECD raised **India's GDP Growth Forecast for FY 2026-27 (FY27)** by **20 basis points (bps) to 6.3%**, up from its earlier estimate of 6.1% released in March 2026.

Detailed Explanation:

The Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD) released its latest report titled **"OECD Economic Outlook: Under Pressure – June 2026"**.

The OECD raised **India's GDP Growth Forecast for FY 2026-27 (FY27)** by **20 basis points (bps) to 6.3%**, up from its earlier estimate of 6.1% released in March 2026.

India's **Gross Domestic Product (GDP) growth** is projected at **7.6% in FY26**.

The report noted that **higher energy prices** are expected to influence India's economic outlook.
India's **GDP Growth Rate** is projected to increase marginally to **6.4% in FY28**.
According to the OECD, India's **Inflation Rate** is expected to rise from **2.1% in FY26 to 4.8% in FY27**.
The projected **4.8% inflation rate** is lower than the OECD's previous estimate of **5.1%**.

129. In June 2026, India's first-ever export of botanical-infused ready-to-cook millet functional foods to New Zealand was facilitated by which organization?

A.Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI)
B.National Bank for Agriculture and Rural Development (NABARD)
C.Indian Council of Agricultural Research (ICAR)
D.Agricultural and Processed Food Products Export Development Authority (APEDA)
E.Small Farmers' Agribusiness Consortium (SFAC)

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

The **Agricultural and Processed Food Products Export Development Authority (APEDA)** facilitated **India's first-ever export of botanical-infused ready-to-cook millet functional foods** to **New Zealand**.
The shipment was dispatched from **Karnataka**, marking a significant milestone in India's millet export journey.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Agricultural and Processed Food Products Export Development Authority (APEDA)** facilitated **India's first-ever export of botanical-infused ready-to-cook millet functional foods** to **New Zealand**.
The shipment was dispatched from **Karnataka**, marking a significant milestone in India's millet export journey.
The consignment consisted of **one metric tonne of value-added millet products** exported by **M/s Infini Agrotek LLP, Bengaluru**.
The export showcases the growing global demand for **millet-based and value-added food products**.
Botanical-infused millet functional foods combine the nutritional benefits of millets with plant-based botanical ingredients to provide additional health benefits.
These products align with global trends such as **healthy eating, plant-based nutrition, functional foods, sustainable agriculture and natural ingredients**.
APEDA played a key role in facilitating market access and export promotion for the company.

About Agricultural and Processed Food Products Export Development Authority

Established: **1986**
Parent Ministry: **Ministry of Commerce and Industry**,
Headquarters: **New Delhi**,
Chairman: **Abhishek Dev**

About New Zealand

Capital: **Wellington**,
Currency: **New Zealand Dollar**,
Prime Minister: **Christopher Luxon**

130. Which wetland in Uttar Pradesh was designated as India's 100th Ramsar Site on World Environment Day 2026?

A.Nawabganj Bird Sanctuary
B.Saman Bird Sanctuary
C.Sur Sarovar Wetland
D.Bakhira Wildlife Sanctuary
E.Jai Prakash Narayan Bird Sanctuary (Surha Tal)

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

Jai Prakash Narayan Bird Sanctuary (Surha Tal) in **Ballia district, Uttar Pradesh**, has been designated as **India's 100th Ramsar Site.**

The announcement was made on **World Environment Day 2026**, marking a significant milestone in India's wetland conservation efforts.

With this recognition, the total number of **Ramsar Sites in India has reached 100**.

Detailed Explanation:

Jai Prakash Narayan Bird Sanctuary (Surha Tal) in **Ballia district, Uttar Pradesh**, has been designated as **India's 100th Ramsar Site.**

The announcement was made on **World Environment Day 2026**, marking a significant milestone in India's wetland conservation efforts.

With this recognition, the total number of **Ramsar Sites in India has reached 100**.

The site was designated under the **Ramsar Convention on Wetlands**, an international treaty for the conservation and wise use of wetlands.

The sanctuary, popularly known as **Surha Tal**, serves as an important habitat for numerous migratory and resident bird species.

The wetland plays a crucial role in **biodiversity conservation, ecological balance, water regulation and providing breeding and feeding grounds for birds**.

About Uttar Pradesh

Capital: Lucknow,
Chief Minister: Yogi Adityanath,
Governor: Anandiben Patel

131. Which United Kingdom university received a Letter of Approval from the Ministry of Education to establish its campus in Bengaluru, Karnataka, in 2026?

A.University of Liverpool
B.University of Cambridge
C.University of Manchester
D.University of Oxford
E.King's College London

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

The **University of Liverpool**, one of the United Kingdom's leading universities, has received a **Letter of Approval (LoA)** from the **Ministry of Education** to establish its campus in **Bengaluru, Karnataka**.

The approval marks another significant step in implementing the **National Education Policy 2020**, which promotes the internationalisation of higher education in India.

The **Letter of Approval** was handed over by **Dr. Vineet Joshi**, Secretary, Department of Higher Education and Chairman of the **University Grants Commission**, to **Professor Richard Grose**, Provost of the University of Liverpool Bengaluru.

Detailed Explanation:

The **University of Liverpool**, one of the United Kingdom's leading universities, has received a **Letter of Approval (LoA)** from the **Ministry of Education** to establish its campus in **Bengaluru, Karnataka**.

The approval marks another significant step in implementing the **National Education Policy 2020**, which promotes the internationalisation of higher education in India.

The **Letter of Approval** was handed over by **Dr. Vineet Joshi**, Secretary, Department of Higher Education and Chairman of the **University Grants Commission**, to **Professor Richard Grose**, Provost of the University of Liverpool Bengaluru.

The event was witnessed by **Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan**, **External Affairs Minister S. Jaishankar**, and **United Kingdom Foreign Secretary Yvette Cooper.**

The campus is expected to improve access to **global-quality education**, enhance **student mobility**, strengthen **international research collaboration**, and boost **academic competitiveness**.

About University Grants Commission

Established: **1956**

Headquarters: **New Delhi**

Chairman: **Dr. Vineet Joshi**

Parent Ministry: **Ministry of Education**

132. From which date will the standardized vegan logo introduced by the Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI) become mandatory for all approved vegan food products?

A.1 August 2026

B.1 July 2027

C.1 January 2027

D.1 July 2026

E.1 January 2028

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The **Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI)** has introduced a **standardized vegan logo** for approved vegan food products in India.

The logo will become **mandatory from 1 July 2027** for all approved vegan food products.

The initiative aims to provide consumers with a **clear and reliable method of identifying vegan foods**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI)** has introduced a **standardized vegan logo** for approved vegan food products in India.

The logo will become **mandatory from 1 July 2027** for all approved vegan food products.

The initiative aims to provide consumers with a **clear and reliable method of identifying vegan foods**.

The requirement has been introduced under the amended **Food Safety and Standards (Vegan Foods) Regulations**.

All approved vegan food packages must display the logo in the prescribed format.

The logo has been designed as a **green square-framed symbol featuring a stylized letter "V" and a sprouting leaf**, representing sustainability and plant-based foods.

The logo certifies that the product is **free from animal-derived ingredients, additives and processing aids**.

133. Recently, the First World Yogasana Championship 2026 was inaugurated by Prime Minister Narendra Modi in which city?

A.New Delhi

B.Bengaluru

C.Ahmedabad

D.Hyderabad

E.Jaipur

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

Prime Minister Narendra Modi inaugurated the **First World Yogasana Championship 2026** in **Ahmedabad, Gujarat** through a video message.

The championship is the **first international event dedicated exclusively to Yogasana** and aims to establish Yogasana as a competitive sport at the global level.

Detailed Explanation:

Prime Minister Narendra Modi inaugurated the **First World Yogasana Championship 2026** in **Ahmedabad, Gujarat** through a video message.

The championship is the **first international event dedicated exclusively to Yogasana** and aims to establish Yogasana as a competitive sport at the global level.

Athletes from several countries are participating in the event, showcasing skills such as **flexibility, balance, discipline, endurance and technical excellence**.

The event reflects India's efforts to promote **yoga beyond wellness and fitness** and position it as a recognized international sporting discipline.

The championship is being held ahead of **International Day of Yoga 2026**, celebrated annually on **21 June**.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi described the championship and International Day of Yoga celebrations as a **"double dose of health and wellness"**.

134. Which country was elected to the United Nations Security Council (UNSC) as a Non-Permanent Member for the first time since joining the United Nations in 1992?

A.Austria

B.Portugal

C.Zimbabwe

D.Kyrgyzstan

E.Trinidad and Tobago

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

The **United Nations General Assembly** elected **Austria, Kyrgyzstan, Portugal, Trinidad and Tobago, and Zimbabwe** as **Non-Permanent Members** of the **United Nations Security Council (UNSC)**.
The election was held at the **United Nations Headquarters in New York, USA**.
The newly elected countries will serve a **two-year term** on the **15-member United Nations Security Council (UNSC)**.
Their term will begin on **1 January 2027** and continue until **31 December 2028**.
Kyrgyzstan secured its **first-ever term** on the UNSC since becoming a member of the United Nations in **1992**.
Detailed Explanation:
The **United Nations General Assembly** elected **Austria, Kyrgyzstan, Portugal, Trinidad and Tobago, and Zimbabwe** as **Non-Permanent Members** of the **United Nations Security Council (UNSC)**.
The election was held at the **United Nations Headquarters in New York, USA**.
The newly elected countries will serve a **two-year term** on the **15-member United Nations Security Council (UNSC)**.
Their term will begin on **1 January 2027** and continue until **31 December 2028**.
Kyrgyzstan secured its **first-ever term** on the UNSC since becoming a member of the United Nations in **1992**.
The five newly elected countries will replace **Denmark, Greece, Pakistan, Panama, and Somalia**, whose terms end on **31 December 2026**.
A total of **7 countries contested** the election for **5 non-permanent UNSC seats**.

135. By how much have the financial powers for Indigenisation and Research & Development (R&D) been increased under the revised Delegation of Financial Powers for the Defence Services released in June 2026?
A.25%
B.50%
C.75%
D.100%
E.150%
Answer: D
Short Explanation:
Raksha Mantri Rajnath Singh released the revised **Delegation of Financial Powers for the Defence Services** on **4 June 2026**.
The Financial Powers have been **enhanced by up to 100%**, and in some cases by **more than double**.
The revised powers aim to improve the **operational efficiency of field commanders** and ensure **faster contract finalisation and project execution**.
Financial powers for **Indigenisation and Research & Development (R&D)** have been **doubled** to promote **Aatmanirbharta in Defence**.

The move seeks to **reduce dependence on Foreign Original Equipment Manufacturers (OEMs)**.

Detailed Explanation:

Raksha Mantri Rajnath Singh released the revised **Delegation of Financial Powers for the Defence Services** on **4 June 2026**.

The Financial Powers have been **enhanced by up to 100%**, and in some cases by **more than double**.

The revised powers aim to improve the **operational efficiency of field commanders** and ensure **faster contract finalisation and project execution**.

Financial powers for **Indigenisation and Research & Development (R&D)** have been **doubled** to promote **Aatmanirbharta in Defence**.

The move seeks to **reduce dependence on Foreign Original Equipment Manufacturers (OEMs)**.

The revised delegation will facilitate defence procurement worth more than **₹1.25 lakh crore** through the **revenue route**.

Special Financial Powers of Army, Air Force, and Naval Commanders have been **significantly increased**.

The ceiling for meeting **urgent operational requirements** has been **enhanced by 100%**.

136. Who has been appointed as Executive Director at the World Bank Headquarters in Washington, D.C., for a three-year tenure as approved by the Appointments Committee of the Cabinet (ACC) in 2026?

A.Parameswaran Iyer

B.Neelkanth Mishra

C.Amitabh Kant

D.Rajiv Kumar

E.Subhash Chandra Garg

Answer: B

The **Appointments Committee of the Cabinet (ACC)** approved the appointment of **Neelkanth Mishra** as **Executive Director at the World Bank Headquarters, Washington, D.C., USA**.

Neelkanth Mishra has been appointed for a **tenure of three years** from the date of assuming charge.

He will succeed **Parameswaran Iyer**, a retired 1981-batch IAS officer of the Uttar Pradesh cadre.

The ACC also approved the **extension of Parameswaran Iyer's tenure** until Neelkanth Mishra assumed charge.

137. Who was sworn in as the 25th Chief Minister of Karnataka in 2026 after Siddaramaiah stepped down?

A.G. Parameshwara

B.Basavaraj Bommai

C.R. Ashoka

D.Priyank Kharge

E.D.K. Shivakumar

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

D. K. Shivakumar of the **Indian National Congress (INC)** was sworn in as the **25th Chief**

Minister of Karnataka after **Siddaramaiah** stepped down following directions from the Congress high command.

The swearing-in ceremony was held at the **Raj Bhavan, Bengaluru**.

Thawar Chand Gehlot administered the **Oath of Office and Secrecy** under **Article 164** of the Constitution of India.

Detailed Explanation:

D. K. Shivakumar of the **Indian National Congress (INC)** was sworn in as the **25th Chief Minister of Karnataka** after **Siddaramaiah** stepped down following directions from the Congress high command.

The swearing-in ceremony was held at the **Raj Bhavan, Bengaluru**.

Thawar Chand Gehlot administered the **Oath of Office and Secrecy** under **Article 164** of the Constitution of India.

D.K. Shivakumar represents the **Kanakapura Assembly Constituency** in Karnataka.

G. Parameshwara was sworn in as the **Deputy Chief Minister of Karnataka**.

Dr. G. Parameshwara previously held the **Home Portfolio** in the Siddaramaiah-led cabinet.

Along with the Chief Minister and Deputy Chief Minister, **12 legislators** were sworn in as **Cabinet Ministers**.

138. Who secured a third consecutive term as Prime Minister of Denmark after forming a new centre-left coalition government following the March 2026 parliamentary elections?

A.Mette Frederiksen

B.Helle Thorning-Schmidt

C.Lars Løkke Rasmussen

D.Jakob Ellemann-Jensen

E.Troels Lund Poulsen

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

Mette Frederiksen secured a **third consecutive term** as **Prime Minister (PM) of Denmark** after forming a new **centre-left coalition government** following the **March 2026 parliamentary elections**.

Mette Frederiksen is the leader of the **Social Democrats**, Denmark's major centre-left political party.

Detailed Explanation:

Mette Frederiksen secured a **third consecutive term** as **Prime Minister (PM) of Denmark** after forming a new **centre-left coalition government** following the **March 2026 parliamentary elections**.

Mette Frederiksen is the leader of the **Social Democrats**, Denmark's major centre-left political party.

Before entering politics, **Mette Frederiksen** worked as a **trade unionist**, gaining experience in **labour and social welfare issues**.

She was elected to the **Danish Parliament (Folketing)** for the first time in **2001**.

She served as **Minister of Employment in 2011** under Prime Minister **Helle Thorning-Schmidt**.

In **2014**, she became **Minister of Justice** in the government of **Helle Thorning-Schmidt**.

About Denmark :

Capital : Copenhagen

Currency : Danish krone

139. As of 2026, Mera Yuva Bharat (MY Bharat) received a Guinness World Records title for achieving the highest number of users completing an online quiz in one week through which initiative?

A.Fit India Quiz

B.Yuva Utsav Quiz

C.Viksit Bharat Young Leaders Dialogue (VBYLD) Quiz

D.Khelo India Knowledge Challenge

E.National Youth Parliament Quiz

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

Mera Yuva Bharat (MY Bharat) has been awarded a **Guinness World Records** title for the **highest number of users completing an online quiz within one week**.

The record was achieved through the **Viksit Bharat Young Leaders Dialogue (VBYLD) Quiz**, a nationwide youth engagement initiative.

Detailed Explanation:

Mera Yuva Bharat (MY Bharat) has been awarded a **Guinness World Records** title for the **highest number of users completing an online quiz within one week**.

The record was achieved through the **Viksit Bharat Young Leaders Dialogue (VBYLD) Quiz**, a nationwide youth engagement initiative.

390,812 participants successfully completed the full quiz during the official assessment period, setting the new world record.

The achievement was recognized under the category **"Most Users to Take an Online Quiz in One Week"**.

The **Guinness World Records** certificate was presented at **Shram Shakti Bhawan, New Delhi**.

The event was attended by **Union Minister for Youth Affairs and Sports Dr. Mansukh Mandaviya**, **Minister of State Raksha Nikhil Khadse**, senior ministry officials and representatives of Guinness World Records.

About Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports

Union Minister: Dr. Mansukh Mandaviya.

Minister of State: Raksha Nikhil Khadse

140. Which bank won the Gold Award at the Finacle Innovation Awards 2026 in the category "Modern Technologies-led Innovation – Data Insights and Analytics Platform"?

A.Punjab National Bank

B.Bank of Baroda

C.Union Bank of India

D.Canara Bank

E.Jammu and Kashmir Bank

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

Jammu and Kashmir Bank Limited won the **Gold Award** at the **Finacle Innovation Awards 2026**

The bank received the award in the category **"Modern Technologies-led Innovation – Data Insights and Analytics Platform"**.

The award was presented during the **Finacle India Connect 2026** event organized by **Infosys Finacle** in Mumbai.

Detailed Explanation:

Jammu and Kashmir Bank Limited won the **Gold Award** at the **Finacle Innovation Awards 2026**

The bank received the award in the category **"Modern Technologies-led Innovation – Data Insights and Analytics Platform"**.

The award was presented during the **Finacle India Connect 2026** event organized by **Infosys Finacle** in Mumbai.

The recognition highlights the bank's adoption of **Artificial Intelligence, Machine Learning and advanced data analytics** to improve operational efficiency, customer experience and decision-making.

The award was received by **Managing Director and Chief Executive Officer Amitava Chatterjee** and **General Manager (Strategy and Information Technology/Chief Information Officer) Mohammad Muzaffar Wani**.

The bank's **Data Insights and Analytics Platform** integrates **Business Intelligence, Advanced Analytics, Reporting Systems, Artificial Intelligence applications and Machine Learning models**.

About Jammu and Kashmir Bank Limited

Headquarters: Srinagar, Jammu and Kashmir.

Managing Director and Chief Executive Officer: Amitava Chatterjee.

Established: 1 October 1938

Tagline: Serving to Empower

141. As of 2026, India jointly launched the Critical Minerals Global Supply Chain Observatory (GSCO) with which country?

A.Australia

B.United States

C.Japan

D.Germany

E.United Kingdom

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

India and the United Kingdom jointly launched the **India–United Kingdom Critical Minerals Global Supply Chain Observatory (GSCO)** in **New Delhi**.

The initiative was launched by **Union Minister of Coal and Mines G. Kishan Reddy** and **United Kingdom Foreign Secretary Yvette Cooper**.

Detailed Explanation:

India and the United Kingdom jointly launched the **India–United Kingdom Critical Minerals Global Supply Chain Observatory (GSCO)** in **New Delhi**.

The initiative was launched by **Union Minister of Coal and Mines G. Kishan Reddy** and **United Kingdom Foreign Secretary Yvette Cooper**.

The observatory aims to strengthen cooperation between the two countries in the field of **critical minerals**, which are essential for clean energy technologies and advanced manufacturing.

The initiative reflects the growing strategic partnership between India and the United Kingdom in ensuring **secure and resilient critical mineral supply chains**.

Critical minerals play a vital role in **electric vehicle batteries, renewable energy systems, semiconductor manufacturing, defence technologies, advanced electronics and telecommunications infrastructure**.

About United Kingdom

Capital: London.

Currency: Pound Sterling.

Prime Minister: Keir Starmer.

Foreign Secretary: Yvette Cooper.

142. Recently, West Bengal became which numbered Legislature in India to join the National e-Vidhan Application (NeVA) initiative after signing an MoU in 2026?

A.30th

B.31st

C.32nd

D.33rd

E.34th

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

The **West Bengal Legislative Assembly** has signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** for the implementation of the **National e-Vidhan Application (NeVA)**.

With this, **West Bengal** has become the **33rd Legislature** in India to join the NeVA initiative.

Detailed Explanation:

The **West Bengal Legislative Assembly** has signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** for the implementation of the **National e-Vidhan Application (NeVA)**.

With this, **West Bengal** has become the **33rd Legislature** in India to join the NeVA initiative.

The tripartite MoU was signed in the presence of **Union Minister of Parliamentary Affairs Kiren Rijiju**, **Minister of State Arjun Ram Meghwal**, **Minister of State L. Murugan**, and the Speaker of the West Bengal Legislative Assembly.

NeVA is a **Mission Mode Project** of the **Ministry of Parliamentary Affairs** aimed at digitising and modernising the functioning of Parliament and State Legislatures through a common digital platform.

The initiative supports the vision of **"One Nation – One Application"** and promotes **paperless, transparent, efficient and citizen-centric legislative governance**.

According to the Ministry of Parliamentary Affairs, **21 Legislatures have already transitioned to fully digital functioning** through the NeVA platform.

About Ministry of Parliamentary Affairs

Union Minister: **Kiren Rijiju**

Ministers of State: **Arjun Ram Meghwal and L. Murugan**

About West Bengal

Capital: **Kolkata**

Chief Minister: **Suvendu Adhikari**

Governor: **R. N. Ravi**

143. Which investment firm acquired a 1.85% stake in GMR Airports Limited (GAL) from GQG Partners through an open market transaction in 2026?

A.BlackRock

B.Vanguard Group

C.Fidelity International Limited

D.Morgan Stanley

E.Temasek Holdings

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

GQG Partners, a US-based investment firm, sold a **1.85% stake in GMR Airports Limited (GAL)** through **Open Market Operations (OMOs)**.

The total value of the transaction was approximately **₹1,906 crore**.

The stake sale was executed through **GQG Partners Emerging Markets Equity Fund**, an affiliate of GQG Partners.

The buyer in the transaction was **Fidelity International Limited (FIL)**.

The stake was acquired through **Fidelity Investment Trust – Fidelity International Small Cap Fund**, an affiliate of Fidelity International.

Detailed Explanation:

GQG Partners, a US-based investment firm, sold a **1.85% stake in GMR Airports Limited (GAL)** through **Open Market Operations (OMOs)**.

The total value of the transaction was approximately **₹1,906 crore**.

The stake sale was executed through **GQG Partners Emerging Markets Equity Fund**, an affiliate of GQG Partners.

Under the deal, **19.50 crore equity shares** of GMR Airports Limited (GAL) were sold.

The shares represented **1.85% ownership** in GMR Airports Limited.

The transaction was carried out at an average price of **₹97.75 per share**.

The buyer in the transaction was **Fidelity International Limited (FIL)**.

The stake was acquired through **Fidelity Investment Trust – Fidelity International Small Cap Fund**, an affiliate of Fidelity International.

The transaction was completed through **block deals/open market transactions** on the **National Stock Exchange (NSE)**.

Rajiv Jain-backed GQG Partners reduced its holding in GMR Airports Limited through this stake sale.

144. Which organization is supporting the newly announced digital portal that will provide patent filing support and research paper writing assistance to researchers, students, and innovators across India?

A.Anusandhan National Research Foundation (ANRF)
B.Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO)
C.Council of Scientific and Industrial Research (CSIR)
D.Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO)
E.Indian Council of Agricultural Research (ICAR)
Answer: A
Short Explanation:
Dr. Jitendra Singh, Union Minister of State (Independent Charge) for **Science & Technology** and **Earth Sciences**, announced an **ANRF-supported digital portal** for researchers, students, and innovators across India.
The newly launched portal will provide **training in patent filing support** and **research paper writing assistance**.
The initiative aims to strengthen **India's research ecosystem** by improving access to scientific writing, publication processes, and intellectual property resources.
Detailed Explanation:
Dr. Jitendra Singh, Union Minister of State (Independent Charge) for **Science & Technology** and **Earth Sciences**, announced an **ANRF-supported digital portal** for researchers, students, and innovators across India.
The newly launched portal will provide **training in patent filing support** and **research paper writing assistance**.
The initiative aims to strengthen **India's research ecosystem** by improving access to scientific writing, publication processes, and intellectual property resources.
The announcement was made during a **Joint Review Meeting** of the **Department of Science & Technology (DST)**, **Department of Biotechnology (DBT)**, **Department of Scientific and Industrial Research (DSIR)**, and **Ministry of Earth Sciences (MoES)**.
The portal will serve as a **capacity-building resource** for researchers and young innovators across the country.
The platform will provide structured support in **scientific writing**, **publication processes**, **intellectual property (IP) protection**, and **patent-related procedures**.
The initiative is expected to improve the **quality of research output**, enhance **innovation outcomes**, and facilitate the conversion of scientific work into **publications and patents**.

145. In 2026, the Technology Development Board (TDB) extended support to Bioneemtec India Private Limited for a project focused on strengthening India's pharmaceutical manufacturing capabilities. Bioneemtec India Private Limited is based in which city?
A.Hyderabad
B.Bengaluru
C.Ahmedabad
D.Chennai
E.Pune

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

The **Technology Development Board (TDB)** under the **Department of Science & Technology (DST)** has extended support to **Bioneemtec India Private Limited, Chennai** for a project aimed at strengthening India's pharmaceutical manufacturing capabilities.

The project is titled **"Manufacturing of Minoxidil, Tranexamic Acid, Dequalinium Chloride, their Intermediates and Drug Liposomes."**

The initiative focuses on commercializing **indigenous green chemistry technologies** for the production of critical pharmaceutical ingredients and advanced drug delivery systems.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Technology Development Board (TDB)** under the **Department of Science & Technology (DST)** has extended support to **Bioneemtec India Private Limited, Chennai** for a project aimed at strengthening India's pharmaceutical manufacturing capabilities.

The project is titled **"Manufacturing of Minoxidil, Tranexamic Acid, Dequalinium Chloride, their Intermediates and Drug Liposomes."**

The initiative focuses on commercializing **indigenous green chemistry technologies** for the production of critical pharmaceutical ingredients and advanced drug delivery systems.

The project supports national objectives such as **Import Substitution**, **Sustainable Manufacturing**, and **Healthcare Security**.

The project aims to establish advanced manufacturing capabilities for **Pharmaceutical Intermediates**, **Active Pharmaceutical Ingredients (APIs)**, and **Novel Drug Delivery Systems**.

The manufacturing process will utilize **Batch Chemistry** and **Continuous-Flow Chemistry Technologies** to improve efficiency and sustainability.

The initiative is designed to enhance **production efficiency**, **product quality**, **operational safety**, and **environmental sustainability**.

146. As of 2026, the 3rd Cohort of ORBIT, an Atal Innovation Mission (AIM)-supported Space-Tech Accelerator Programme, inducted how many Space-Tech startups in 2026?

A.10

B.11

C.12

D.14

E.13

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

Startup incubator Technology Hub**(T-Hub)** launched the **3rd Cohort of ORBIT**, the **Atal Innovation Mission (AIM)**-

supported **Atal Innovation Incubation Centre (AIC)-T-Hub Space-Tech Accelerator Programme**.

The 3rd Cohort of ORBIT inducted **13 Space-Tech Startups** focused on developing innovative solutions for the **Space Sector**.

With the launch of Cohort 3, ORBIT has supported a total of **36 Space-Tech Startups**.

Through its broader Space-Tech Initiatives, T-Hub has engaged with **more than 100 Startups**.

Detailed Explanation:

Startup incubator Technology Hub**(T-Hub)** launched the **3rd Cohort of ORBIT**, the **Atal Innovation Mission (AIM)**-supported **Atal Innovation Incubation Centre (AIC)-T-Hub Space-Tech Accelerator Programme**.

The 3rd Cohort of ORBIT inducted **13 Space-Tech Startups** focused on developing innovative solutions for the **Space Sector**.

With the launch of Cohort 3, ORBIT has supported a total of **36 Space-Tech Startups**.

Through its broader Space-Tech Initiatives, T-Hub has engaged with **more than 100 Startups**.

The selected startups are working in advanced space domains such as **Propulsion Systems, Orbital Servicing, Satellite Intelligence, Sovereign Compute, Space Energy Systems, Satellite Connectivity, and Downstream Geospatial Technologies**.

The **13 selected startups** are **Sanyak Space Technologies, Trishul Space, Kessler Dynamics, Velotrax, Zoove Space, Space OS, Humanity Space, Landlens, STAR Labs, Red Balloon Aerospace, Astro Voltaics, Orbit Grid, and Nibiaa Devices**.

147. Which footballer of Indian origin is expected to represent New Zealand at the FIFA World Cup 2026?

A.Sarpreet Singh

B.Nishan Velupillay

C.Samuel Moutoussamy

D.Tahsin Mohammed Jamshid

E.Brandon Fernandes

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

India failed to qualify for the **FIFA World Cup 2026**, finishing third in Group A during the second round of the Asian qualifiers behind **Qatar** and **Kuwait**.

The 2026 edition marks the **first FIFA World Cup to feature 48 teams**, expanded from 32 teams.

Although India will not participate, several footballers of Indian origin are set to represent their respective nations at the tournament, highlighting the growing influence of the Indian diaspora in international football.

Sarpreet Singh is expected to represent **New Zealand**. Born in Wellington, his parents trace their roots to Jalandhar, Punjab. He previously played for **FC Bayern Munich**.

Tahsin Mohammed Jamshid is expected to represent **Qatar**. Born in Doha, his family originates from Kannur, Kerala.

Detailed Explanation:

India failed to qualify for the **FIFA World Cup 2026**, finishing third in Group A during the second round of the Asian qualifiers behind **Qatar** and **Kuwait**.

The 2026 edition marks the **first FIFA World Cup to feature 48 teams**, expanded from 32 teams.

Although India will not participate, several footballers of Indian origin are set to represent their respective nations at the tournament, highlighting the growing influence of the Indian diaspora in international football.

Sarpreet Singh is expected to represent **New Zealand**. Born in Wellington, his parents trace their roots to Jalandhar, Punjab. He previously played for **FC Bayern Munich**.

Tahsin Mohammed Jamshid is expected to represent **Qatar**. Born in Doha, his family originates from Kannur, Kerala.

Nishan Velupillay is expected to represent **Australia**. He has Sri Lankan Tamil and Anglo-Indian heritage and emerged through the youth system of **Melbourne Victory FC**.

Samuel Moutoussamy is expected to represent **Democratic Republic of the Congo**. His Indo-Guadeloupean family traces its ancestry to the Tamil community.

148. Recently, Marcia Lou Griffin, popularly known as Marcia Lucas, who passed away in 2026, was renowned for her contributions in which field?

A.Music Composition

B.Film Editing

C.Screenwriting

D.Cinematography

E.Film Direction

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Marcia Lou Griffin (Marcia Lucas), the **Academy Award-winning film editor** best known for her work on the **original Star Wars trilogy**, passed away at the age of **80** in **Rancho Mirage, California, USA**.

She was born on **04 October 1945** in **Modesto, California, United States of America (USA)**.

Marcia Lucas was a renowned **film editor** and one of the **pioneering women editors** of Hollywood's **New Hollywood era**.

Detailed Explanation:

Marcia Lou Griffin (Marcia Lucas), the **Academy Award-winning film editor** best known for her work on the **original Star Wars trilogy**, passed away at the age of **80** in **Rancho Mirage, California, USA**.

She was born on **04 October 1945** in **Modesto, California, United States of America (USA)**.

Marcia Lucas was a renowned **film editor** and one of the **pioneering women editors** of Hollywood's **New Hollywood era**.

She played a **significant role** in shaping some of the most **influential films of the 1970s and 1980s**, particularly the **original Star Wars trilogy**.

She also received an **Academy Award nomination** for **American Graffiti**.

Marcia Lucas earned a **British Academy of Film and Television Arts (BAFTA) Award nomination** for **Taxi Driver**.

149. As per the news, Standard Chartered Bank was formed in 1969 through the merger of the Standard Bank of British South Africa and which other bank?

A.Chartered Bank of India, Australia and China
B.Bank of England
C.Hongkong and Shanghai Banking Corporation
D.National Westminster Bank
E.Lloyds Bank
Answer: A

Standard Chartered Bank is a British multinational banking and financial services company headquartered in **London**.
It was formed in **1969** through the merger of the **Standard Bank of British South Africa** and the **Chartered Bank of India, Australia and China**.

150. Which wetland was designated as India's 99th Ramsar Site before the inclusion of Jai Prakash Narayan Bird Sanctuary (Surha Tal) as the 100th Ramsar Site?

A.Patna Bird Sanctuary
B.Chhari-Dhand
C.Siliserh Lake
D.Kopra Jalashay
E.Shekha Jheel Bird Sanctuary
Answer: E

Jai Prakash Narayan Bird Sanctuary (Surha Tal) in **Ballia district, Uttar Pradesh**, has been designated as **India's 100th Ramsar Site.**
Recent additions to India's Ramsar List include **Shekha Jheel Bird Sanctuary (99th Ramsar Site), Patna Bird Sanctuary, Chhari-Dhand, Siliserh Lake and Kopra Jalashay**.

151. In 2026, consider the following statements regarding RBI's Currency and Banking Indicators:

1. **RBI's currency printing expenditure declined by 23.5% in FY26 compared to FY25.**
2. **The ₹500 denomination note accounted for 85.5% of the total value of banknotes in circulation.**
3. **India's Currency-to-GDP Ratio declined from 11.7% in FY25 to 10.1% in FY26.**
4. **India's Credit-to-GDP Ratio reached a record 61.8% at the end of March 2026.**

Which of the statements given above are correct?

A.1, 2 and 4 only
B.1 and 3 only
C.2 and 4 only
D.1, 2, 3 and 4
E.1, 3 and 4 only
Answer: A

Short Explanation:
The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** reported that its **Currency Printing Expenditure declined by**

23.5%, falling from **₹6,372.8 Crore in FY25 to ₹4,875.2 Crore in FY26**.

The **₹500 Note accounted for 85.5% of the Total Value** of all banknotes in circulation.

In terms of volume, the **₹500 Note constituted 41.2% of the Total Number of Banknotes** circulating in the economy.

India's **Currency-to-GDP Ratio increased from 11.7% in FY25 to 12.1% in FY26**.

India's **Credit-to-GDP Ratio reached a record 61.8%** at the end of March 2026, compared to **57.4%** a year earlier

Detailed Explanation:

The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** reported that its **Currency Printing Expenditure declined by 23.5%**, falling from **₹6,372.8 Crore in FY25 to ₹4,875.2 Crore in FY26**.

The reduction in printing expenditure was primarily due to a **Lower Indent for Banknotes** during FY26.

Despite lower printing costs, the **Total Value of Banknotes in Circulation increased by 11.8% to ₹41.23 Lakh Crore** as of March 2026.

The increase in the value of banknotes in circulation indicates the continued demand for and usage of **Physical Currency** in the economy.

The **₹500 Denomination Note** remained the most dominant currency note in circulation.

The **₹500 Note accounted for 85.5% of the Total Value** of all banknotes in circulation.

In terms of volume, the **₹500 Note constituted 41.2% of the Total Number of Banknotes** circulating in the economy.

India's **Currency-to-GDP Ratio increased from 11.7% in FY25 to 12.1% in FY26**.

The rise in the Currency-to-GDP Ratio highlights the continued importance of **Cash Transactions** despite rapid growth in **Digital Payments**.

India's **Credit-to-GDP Ratio reached a record 61.8%** at the end of March 2026, compared to **57.4%** a year earlier

152. As of 2026, what was India's rank among the world's most digitalised economies according to the State of India's Digital Economy (SIDE) 2026 report?

A.3rd

B.4th

C.5th

D.6th

E.8th

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The **Indian Council for Research on International Economic Relations–Prosus Centre for Internet and Digital Economy (IPCIDE)** released the report **"State of India's Digital Economy (SIDE) 2026"**.

According to the SIDE 2026 Report, **India has been ranked as the 5th most digitalised economy** in the world.

The SIDE Report is an **annual publication launched in 2023** to assess India's progress in the fields of **Digital Economy and Artificial Intelligence (AI)**.

The report uses the comprehensive **CHIPS Framework**, which stands for **Connect, Harness, Innovate, Protect, and Sustain**.

India secured the **4th position globally** in the CHIPS Index for **Artificial Intelligence (AI)**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Indian Council for Research on International Economic Relations–Prosus Centre for Internet and Digital Economy (IPCIDE)** released the report **"State of India's Digital Economy (SIDE) 2026"**.

According to the SIDE 2026 Report, **India has been ranked as the 5th most digitalised economy** in the world.

The SIDE Report is an **annual publication launched in 2023** to assess India's progress in the fields of **Digital Economy and Artificial Intelligence (AI)**.

The report uses the comprehensive **CHIPS Framework**, which stands for **Connect, Harness, Innovate, Protect, and Sustain**.

India secured the **4th position globally** in the CHIPS Index for **Artificial Intelligence (AI)**.

In the CHIPS AI Rankings, India is behind only the **United States, China, and Singapore**.

India's global ranking improved significantly from **8th position in 2025 to 5th position in 2026**.

The 2025 ranking was based on a sample of 32 countries, while the **2026 ranking covered 71 countries**.

153. In 2026, BharatPe launched "BharatPe Flex", a Credit-on-UPI solution powered by which bank?

A.HDFC Bank

B.ICICI Bank

C.State Bank of India

D.YES Bank

E.Axis Bank

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

BharatPe, a leading Financial Services and UPI Payments Company in India,

launched **"BharatPe Flex"**, a new **Credit-on-UPI Solution**.

BharatPe Flex is powered by **YES Bank Limited** and enables eligible customers to make UPI payments using a **pre-approved credit line**.

The product allows users to make daily payments without immediately using their own **bank balance**.

Detailed Explanation:

BharatPe, a leading Financial Services and UPI Payments Company in India,

launched **"BharatPe Flex"**, a new **Credit-on-UPI Solution**.

BharatPe Flex is powered by **YES Bank Limited** and enables eligible customers to make UPI payments using a **pre-approved credit line**.

The product allows users to make daily payments without immediately using their own **bank balance**.

BharatPe Flex is built around the concept of **"Pay Now, Settle Later"**, offering greater flexibility in digital payments.

The solution provides an **interest-free credit period of up to 45 days** for eligible users.

Users can make payments across all **major UPI payment flows** through BharatPe Flex.

The facility supports **QR Code Payments, Online Transactions, Bill Payments, Mobile Recharges**, and other **Daily Spending Needs**.

154. In 2026, the Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship launched the 'Navachar Mantra' programme at which institution?

A.IIT Bombay

B.IIT Delhi

C.IIT Madras

D.IIM Ahmedabad

E.NIT Tiruchirappalli

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The **Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship** launched **Navachar Mantra** at **Indian Institute of Technology Delhi**.

The initiative was launched by **Jayant Chaudhary**.

Navachar Mantra is a national programme aimed at nurturing **grassroots innovators** and **early-stage entrepreneurs** across India.

The programme focuses on innovators from **Tier-2 cities, Tier-3 cities, rural areas, and aspirational districts**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship** launched **Navachar Mantra** at **Indian Institute of Technology Delhi**.

The initiative was launched by **Jayant Chaudhary**.

Navachar Mantra is a national programme aimed at nurturing **grassroots innovators** and **early-stage entrepreneurs** across India.

The programme focuses on innovators from **Tier-2 cities, Tier-3 cities, rural areas, and aspirational districts**.

It is being implemented by the **National Institute for Entrepreneurship and Small Business Development (NIESBUD)** in partnership with **Foundation for Innovation and Technology Transfer**.

The initiative seeks to bridge the gap between grassroots innovation and national-level entrepreneurship opportunities.

Priority sectors include **Agritech, HealthTech, EdTech and Skilling, Climate and Sustainability, Rural Commerce, and Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises Enablement**.

About NIESBUD

Established: 1983

Headquarters: Noida, Uttar Pradesh

Administrative Ministry: Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship

Objective: Promotion of entrepreneurship and small business development

155. In 2026, which institution became the first private university in India to establish an IndiaAI Data Lab in collaboration with Intel India?

A.Amity University

B.Chandigarh University

C.Lovely Professional University

D.VIT University

E.Manipal University

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Chandigarh University has become the **first private university in India** to establish an **IndiaAI Data Lab** in collaboration with **Intel India.**

The facility has been launched at the **University Institute of Computing (UIC)** of Chandigarh University

The initiative aims to bridge the gap between **academic learning and industry requirements** by providing hands-on experience in **Artificial Intelligence, Data Science, Machine Learning and emerging technologies**

Detailed Explanation:

Chandigarh University has become the **first private university in India** to establish an **IndiaAI Data Lab** in collaboration with **Intel India.**

The facility has been launched at the **University Institute of Computing (UIC)** of Chandigarh University

The initiative aims to bridge the gap between **academic learning and industry requirements** by providing hands-on experience in **Artificial Intelligence, Data Science, Machine Learning and emerging technologies**

The IndiaAI Data Lab will function as a **simulated apprenticeship environment**, enabling students to work on real-world projects and enhance industry readiness

The lab will provide access to **advanced computing resources, Artificial Intelligence-powered tools and industry-aligned projects**

It will support **Artificial Intelligence projects, Data Science research, Machine Learning applications, industry-focused innovation, faculty development programmes, hackathons, competitions and collaborative research initiatives**

The initiative is designed to improve student employability through practical learning and experiential exposure

156. In 2026, consider the following statements regarding the National Panchayat Awards 2025:

1. **The Ministry of Panchayati Raj will confer the awards to 42 outstanding Panchayats.**

2. **The awards are presented under the Rashtriya Gram Swaraj Abhiyan.**
3. **The Deen Dayal Upadhyay Panchayat Satat Vikas Puraskar (DDUPSVP) is awarded to 34 Gram Panchayats.**
4. **The Nanaji Deshmukh Sarvottam Panchayat Satat Vikas Puraskar (NDSPSVP) is awarded to 8 Panchayats for overall excellence.**

Which of the statements given above are correct?

A.1 and 2 only

B.2, 3 and 4 only

C.1, 3 and 4 only

D.All are correct

E.1 and 4 only

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

The **Ministry of Panchayati Raj** will confer the **National Panchayat Awards 2025** to **42 outstanding Panchayats** at a ceremony in New Delhi.

The awards recognise excellence in **local governance, sustainable development, infrastructure creation, social inclusion, and citizen participation**.

The awards are presented under the **Incentivization of Panchayats** component of the **Rashtriya Gram Swaraj Abhiyan**.

The objective is to promote good governance, community-led development, improved public service delivery, democratic decentralisation, and Sustainable Development Goals implementation.

The awards are given under **two categories**: **Deen Dayal Upadhyay Panchayat Satat Vikas Puraskar (DDUPSVP)** – awarded to **34 Gram Panchayats** across **17 States and Union Territories** based on performance under Sustainable Development Goal themes.

Nanaji Deshmukh Sarvottam Panchayat Satat Vikas Puraskar (NDSPSVP) – awarded to **8 Panchayats** for overall excellence at District, Block, and Gram Panchayat levels.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Ministry of Panchayati Raj** will confer the **National Panchayat Awards 2025** to **42 outstanding Panchayats** at a ceremony in New Delhi.

The awards recognise excellence in **local governance, sustainable development, infrastructure creation, social inclusion, and citizen participation**.

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Nanaji Deshmukh Sarvottam Panchayat Satat Vikas Puraskar (NDSPSVP) – awarded to **8 Panchayats** for overall excellence at District, Block, and Gram Panchayat levels.

The **Deen Dayal Upadhyay Panchayat Satat Vikas Puraskar** assessment is linked to the **Panchayat Advancement Index 2.0**.

The evaluation covers **nine themes**: Poverty-Free and Enhanced Livelihoods, Healthy Panchayat, Child-Friendly Panchayat, Water-Sufficient Panchayat, Clean and Green Panchayat, Self-Sufficient Infrastructure, Socially Just and Socially Secured Panchayat, Panchayat with Good Governance, and Women-Friendly Panchayat.

Under the **Nanaji Deshmukh Sarvottam Panchayat Satat Vikas Puraskar**, **Sepahijala (Tripura)** was selected as the Best District Panchayat, **Harippad (Kerala)** as the Best Block Panchayat, and **New Napam (Assam)** as the Best Gram Panchayat.

About Ministry of Panchayati Raj

Union Minister: Rajiv Ranjan Singh

Minister of State: S. P. Singh Baghel

157. In 2026, David Beckham was awarded a star on the Hollywood Walk of Fame under which category?

A.Motion Pictures

B.Television

C.Recording

D.Live Theatre/Performance

E.Sports Entertainment

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

Global football icon **David Beckham** is set to receive a **star on the Hollywood Walk of Fame** in Los Angeles on **12 June 2026**.

The honour coincides with the opening phase of the **FIFA World Cup 2026**, jointly hosted by **United States**, **Canada**, and **Mexico**.

The ceremony will take place on **Hollywood Walk of Fame**, recognising Beckham's contributions to football, sports entertainment, and global popular culture.

Detailed Explanation:

Global football icon **David Beckham** is set to receive a **star on the Hollywood Walk of Fame** in Los Angeles on **12 June 2026**.

The honour coincides with the opening phase of the **FIFA World Cup 2026**, jointly hosted by **United States**, **Canada**, and **Mexico**.

The ceremony will take place on **Hollywood Walk of Fame**, recognising Beckham's contributions to football, sports entertainment, and global popular culture.

Beckham will receive the honour under the **Sports Entertainment** category.

The recognition highlights his role in promoting football globally, particularly in North America.

The event is scheduled just before a FIFA World Cup match between the **United States men's national soccer team** and **Paraguay national football team** in California.

158. In 2026, India held the inaugural meeting of the Joint Defence Committee (JDC) to

strengthen bilateral defence cooperation with which country?

A.Zambia

B.Zimbabwe

C.Botswana

D.Namibia

E.Mozambique

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The **inaugural meeting** of the **India–Zimbabwe Joint Defence Committee (JDC)** was held in New Delhi on **4 June 2026**.

The meeting aimed to **strengthen India–Zimbabwe bilateral defence cooperation** and deepen defence ties between the two countries.

Both sides agreed to **expand cooperation in training, support, and maintenance** of common air assets.

New areas of collaboration identified include **Joint Manufacturing, Counter-Terrorism, Border Management, and Peacekeeping Operations**.

The meeting was co-chaired by **Shri Amitabh Prasad (India)** and **Mr Aaron Daniel Tonde Nhepera (Zimbabwe)**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **inaugural meeting** of the **India–Zimbabwe Joint Defence Committee (JDC)** was held in New Delhi on **4 June 2026**.

The meeting aimed to **strengthen India–Zimbabwe bilateral defence cooperation** and deepen defence ties between the two countries.

Both sides agreed to **expand cooperation in training, support, and maintenance** of common air assets.

New areas of collaboration identified include **Joint Manufacturing, Counter-Terrorism, Border Management, and Peacekeeping Operations**.

The meeting was co-chaired by **Shri Amitabh Prasad (India)** and **Mr Aaron Daniel Tonde Nhepera (Zimbabwe)**.

Mr Aaron Daniel Tonde Nhepera, Permanent Secretary of Zimbabwe, led a **12-member high-level delegation** on a two-day visit to India.

The inaugural JDC meeting **operationalised the MoU on Defence Cooperation** signed by the Defence Ministers of both countries during **Aero India 2025**.

The Zimbabwean delegation visited **DPSU Bhawan, New Delhi**, and discussed **defence industry cooperation** with Indian defence representatives.

Mr Aaron Daniel Tonde Nhepera paid tribute to fallen soldiers by **laying a wreath at the National War Memorial, New Delhi**.

About Zimbabwe :

President : Emmerson Mnangagwa

Capital : Harare

159. In 2026, who was appointed as the new Chairperson of the Central Board of Secondary Education (CBSE)?

A.Rahul Singh

B.Himanshu Gupta

C.Varun Bhardwaj

D.Prashant Sitaram Lokhande

E.Sanjay Kumar

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

The **Appointments Committee of the Cabinet (ACC)**, headed by **Narendra Modi**, approved the appointment of **Prashant Sitaram Lokhande** as the new **Chairperson** of the **Central Board of Secondary Education (CBSE)**.

Prashant Sitaram Lokhande was serving as **Additional Secretary** in the **Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA)** before his appointment as CBSE Chairperson.

He succeeds **Rahul Singh**, who has been transferred to the **Department of Agriculture and Farmers Welfare (DoAFW)** under the **Ministry of Agriculture and Farmers Welfare (MoAFW)** as **Additional Secretary**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Appointments Committee of the Cabinet (ACC)**, headed by **Narendra Modi**, approved the appointment of **Prashant Sitaram Lokhande** as the new **Chairperson** of the **Central Board of Secondary Education (CBSE)**.

Prashant Sitaram Lokhande was serving as **Additional Secretary** in the **Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA)** before his appointment as CBSE Chairperson.

He succeeds **Rahul Singh**, who has been transferred to the **Department of Agriculture and Farmers Welfare (DoAFW)** under the **Ministry of Agriculture and Farmers Welfare (MoAFW)** as **Additional Secretary**.

The **ACC** also appointed **Varun Bhardwaj** as the new **Secretary of CBSE**.

Varun Bhardwaj was previously serving as **Director** in the **Department of Higher Education**, under the **Ministry of Education (MoE)**.

Varun Bhardwaj succeeds **Himanshu Gupta**, who was serving as CBSE Secretary.

The appointments come at a time when **CBSE's On-Screen Marking (OSM) System** for **Class 12 Examinations 2026** has been under scrutiny.

The controversy relates to **scanned answer sheets** and **alleged irregularities** in **private contracts** associated with the **OSM system**.

160. In 2026, who was appointed as the Brand Ambassador of Visa India for its 'Infinitely More' campaign?

A.Shah Rukh Khan

B.Amitabh Bachchan

C.Ranveer Singh

D.Aamir Khan

E.Virat Kohli

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

Visa Incorporated (Visa Inc.), a global digital payments company, launched its new **'Infinitely More' campaign** in India.

Bollywood actor **Shah Rukh Khan** has been appointed as the **Brand Ambassador of Visa India** for the campaign.

The **'Infinitely More' campaign** reflects the growing trend of **experience-led living** among Indian consumers.

Detailed Explanation:

Visa Incorporated (Visa Inc.), a global digital payments company, launched its new **'Infinitely More' campaign** in India.

Bollywood actor **Shah Rukh Khan** has been appointed as the **Brand Ambassador of Visa India** for the campaign.

The **'Infinitely More' campaign** reflects the growing trend of **experience-led living** among Indian consumers.

The campaign focuses on experiences related to **Travel, Lifestyle, Dining, Wellness, and Entertainment**.

Through the campaign, Visa aims to demonstrate how **digital payments** can help consumers access a wider range of experiences in a **seamless and secure manner**.

The initiative highlights a shift from **ownership-driven aspirations to experience-driven lifestyles** among Indian consumers.

161. As of 2026, who was elected as the President of the 81st Session of the United Nations General Assembly (UNGA)?

A.Annalena Baerbock

B.Andreas Kakouris

C.António Guterres

D.Csaba Kőrösi

E.Khalilur Rahman

Answer: E

Khalilur Rahman was elected as the **President** of the **81st Session of the United Nations General Assembly (UNGA)**.

He was elected for a **one-year term** following a **closely contested vote** held at the **United Nations Headquarters** in **New York,** United States of America(USA).

Khalilur Rahman defeated **Andreas Kakouris**, the **Special Envoy of Cyprus's Foreign Minister for Multilateralism**, in the election.

He will succeed **Annalena Baerbock**, whose tenure as **UNGA President** ends in **September 2026**.

162. In 2026, the DRDO and Indian Air Force successfully flight-tested which indigenous air-to-surface missile designed for SEAD/DEAD missions?

A.Astra Mk-I

B.BrahMos

C.RudraM-II

D.Akash-NG

E.Pralay

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The **Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO)** and the **Indian Air Force (IAF)** successfully conducted flight-tests of the **RudraM-II Air-to-Surface Missile (ASM)** from an airborne platform.

The **RudraM-II missile** successfully struck a **predefined target under extreme release conditions**, validating the performance of all **critical subsystems**.

Flight data collected from the **Integrated Test Range (ITR) at Chandipur, Odisha** confirmed the successful achievement of all **mission objectives**.

RudraM-II is an **indigenous air-launched missile** designed for **Suppression/Destruction of Enemy Air Defences (SEAD/DEAD) Missions**.

The missile carries a **200 kg Warhead** and is capable of conducting **precision strikes** against **enemy air-defence assets**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO)** and the **Indian Air Force (IAF)** successfully conducted flight-tests of the **RudraM-II Air-to-Surface Missile (ASM)** from an airborne platform.

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RudraM-II is an **indigenous air-launched missile** designed for **Suppression/Destruction of Enemy Air Defences (SEAD/DEAD) Missions**.

The missile carries a **200 kg Warhead** and is capable of conducting **precision strikes** against **enemy air-defence assets**.

RudraM-II can achieve speeds of up to **Mach 5.5**.

The missile has a **strike range of 300 km**, which is **double the range of RudraM-I (150 km)**.

The missile can be launched from the **Sukhoi Su-30MKI Fighter Aircraft** at altitudes ranging from **3 km to 15 km**.

It enables the **IAF** to engage **enemy Radar Systems and Air-Defence Installations** with **high precision**.

About DRDO:

Founded: 1958

Headquarters: New Delhi, India

Parent Ministry: Ministry of Defence, Government of India

Chairman: Dr. Samir V. Kamat

163. In 2026, Microsoft unveiled which second-generation topological quantum computing chip at the Microsoft Build 2026 event?

A.Majorana

B.Sycamore

C.Willow

D.Condor

E.Eagle

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

Microsoft Corporation unveiled **Majorana 2**, its second-generation **topological quantum computing chip**, during the **Microsoft Build 2026** event.

Majorana 2 was developed with support from **Microsoft Discovery**, the

company's **Agentic Artificial Intelligence (AI) Platform**.

The new chip succeeds **Majorana 1**, Microsoft's first-generation quantum processor launched in **2025**.

Detailed Explanation:

Microsoft Corporation unveiled **Majorana 2**, its second-generation **topological quantum computing chip**, during the **Microsoft Build 2026** event.

Majorana 2 was developed with support from **Microsoft Discovery**, the company's **Agentic Artificial Intelligence (AI) Platform**.

The new chip succeeds **Majorana 1**, Microsoft's first-generation quantum processor launched in **2025**.

Microsoft aims to develop **commercially useful quantum computing systems by 2029**.

Majorana 2 is designed to overcome long-standing **engineering and scalability challenges** in quantum computing.

The chip uses **Lead-Based Materials**, unlike the **Aluminium-Based Designs** used by competitors such as Google and IBM.

The use of **Lead-Based Materials** helps protect **Qubits** from environmental disturbances and **cosmic interference**.

164. In 2026, the VYOMA Innovation Challenge was launched by the Digital India BHASHINI Division to promote the development of which type of AI solutions?

A.Proprietary cloud-based AI solutions

B.Open-source, multilingual, voice-first AI solutions

C.Quantum AI computing systems

D.AI-powered satellite communication systems

E.Blockchain-based AI platforms

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The **Digital India BHASHINI Division (DIBD)**, functioning under the **Digital India Corporation (DIC)** of the **Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY)**, launched the **VYOMA Innovation Challenge**.

The **VYOMA Innovation Challenge** aims to promote the development of **Open-Source, Multilingual, and Voice-First Artificial Intelligence (AI) Solutions**.

The initiative focuses on **AI applications** that can function effectively in **Offline and Low-Connectivity Environments**.

The challenge has been launched in partnership with **Current AI** and **Kalpa Impact**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Digital India BHASHINI Division (DIBD)**, functioning under the **Digital India Corporation (DIC)** of the **Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY)**, launched the **VYOMA Innovation Challenge**.

The **VYOMA Innovation Challenge** aims to promote the development of **Open-Source, Multilingual, and Voice-First Artificial Intelligence (AI) Solutions**.

The initiative focuses on **AI applications** that can function effectively in **Offline and Low-Connectivity Environments**.

The challenge has been launched in partnership with **Current AI** and **Kalpa Impact**.
The challenge is structured around **Sunno Sutra**, a **Multilingual, Voice-First, Open-Source Handheld AI Reference Device**.
Sunno Sutra was jointly developed by **BHASHINI** and **Current AI**.
The device was unveiled at the **IndiaAI Impact Summit 2026**.
Sunno Sutra provides **Conversational AI Services** across **multiple Indian Languages** without relying on **Cloud Infrastructure**.
About Ministry of Electronics & IT :
Cabinet Minister : Ashwini Vaishnaw
Minister of State : Jitin Prasada

165. In 2026, SoftBank Vision Fund II reduced its stake in which Indian company through an open market transaction on the National Stock Exchange?
A.Zomato
B.Paytm
C.Delhivery
D.Nykaa
E.Lenskart
Answer: E
Short Explanation:
SoftBank Group, Japan-based investment giant through its affiliate **SoftBank Vision Fund II (SVF II) Lightbulb (Cayman) Ltd**, divested a **3.25% Stake** in Lenskart Solutions.
The stake sale was executed through an **Open Market Transaction** on the National Stock Exchange.
Detailed Explanation:
SoftBank Group, Japan-based investment giant through its affiliate **SoftBank Vision Fund II (SVF II) Lightbulb (Cayman) Ltd**, divested a **3.25% Stake** in Lenskart Solutions.
The stake sale was executed through an **Open Market Transaction** on the National Stock Exchange.
SoftBank sold **5.65 Crore Shares** of **Lenskart Solutions** in the transaction.
The shares were sold at an average price of **₹508.55 Per Share**.
The total value of the transaction stood at approximately **₹2,873.30 Crore**.
Following the sale, **SoftBank's stake in Lenskart** declined from **13.13% to 9.88%**.

166. In 2026, which Indian Grandmaster became the first Indian player to win the prestigious Norway Chess tournament?
A.D Gukesh
B.Viswanathan Anand
C.Arjun Erigaisi
D.R Praggnanandhaa
E.Pentala Harikrishna
Answer: D
Short Explanation:
Indian chess prodigy **R Praggnanandhaa** became the **first Indian player to win the Norway Chess tournament**,

one of the most prestigious events in world chess.

The 20-year-old Grandmaster from **Chennai** secured the title after defeating **Vincent Keymer** of Germany in the final round.

Detailed Explanation:

Indian chess prodigy **R Praggnanandhaa** became the **first Indian player to win the Norway Chess tournament**, one of the most prestigious events in world chess.

The 20-year-old Grandmaster from **Chennai** secured the title after defeating **Vincent Keymer** of Germany in the final round.

Praggnanandhaa entered the final round with 15 points and finished with **18 points** after earning a crucial classical victory.

He became the first Indian to win the tournament, surpassing previous Indian performances, including those of **Viswanathan Anand** and reigning World Champion **D Gukesh**.

About International Chess Federation (FIDE)

Established: 1924

Headquarters: Lausanne, Switzerland

President: Arkady Dvorkovich

167. In 2026, veteran film producer and former CBFC Chairperson Pahlaj Nihalani, who passed away at the age of 76, is best known for producing which film that marked Govinda's Bollywood debut?

A.Ilzaam

B.Shola Aur Shabnam

C.Aankhen

D.Raja Babu

E.Coolie No. 1

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

Pahlaj Nihalani, veteran film producer and former **Chairperson of the Central Board of Film Certification (CBFC)**, passed away at the age of **76** in **Mumbai, Maharashtra**.

Pahlaj Nihalani was born on **10 January 1950** in **Karachi, Sindh (present-day Pakistan)**.

He was a prominent Indian film producer known for producing several successful **Bollywood films**.

He started his film production career with **"Haathkadi" (1982)**.

He gained major recognition for producing **"Ilzaam" (1986)**, which marked the **Bollywood debut of Govinda**.

Detailed Explanation:

Pahlaj Nihalani, veteran film producer and former **Chairperson of the Central Board of Film Certification (CBFC)**, passed away at the age of **76** in **Mumbai, Maharashtra**.

Pahlaj Nihalani was born on **10 January 1950** in **Karachi, Sindh (present-day Pakistan)**.

He was a prominent Indian film producer known for producing several successful **Bollywood films**.

He started his film production career with **"Haathkadi" (1982)**.
He gained major recognition for producing **"Ilzaam" (1986)**, which marked the **Bollywood debut of Govinda**.
He also produced **"Aag Hi Aag" (1987)**, which introduced **Chunky Panday** to Bollywood.
Pahlaj Nihalani served as **President of the Association of Motion Pictures and TV Programme Producers** for several years.
During his tenure, he played an important role in the growth and development of the **Indian Film and Television Industry**.
In **January 2015**, he was appointed **Chairperson of the CBFC (Central Board of Film Certification)**.

168. As of 2026, World Brain Tumour Day is observed annually on which date?

A.8 June
B.7 June
C.6 June
D.10 June
E.12 June

Answer: A

World Brain Tumour Day 2026 is observed globally on **8 June** to raise awareness about brain tumours and promote education regarding their diagnosis, treatment, and prevention.
The day aims to support **brain tumour patients, survivors, caregivers, and their families** while encouraging early detection and timely medical intervention.
World Brain Tumour Day was established in **2000** by the **Deutsche Hirntumorhilfe (German Brain Tumor Association)**.

169. As of 2026, what is the theme of World Food Safety Day on 7 June 2026?

A.Food Safety: Science in Action
B.Safer Food, Better Health
C.Food Standards Save Lives
D.From burden to solutions – safe food everywhere
E.Safe Food Today for a Healthy Tomorrow

Answer: D

World Food Safety Day 2026 is observed globally on **7 June** to raise awareness about the importance of food safety and the prevention of food-borne diseases.
The **theme for 2026** is **"From burden to solutions – safe food everywhere."** The theme emphasizes the use of data, science, and evidence-based policies to reduce the global burden of foodborne diseases.

About World Health Organization (WHO)

Headquarters: Geneva, Switzerland
Founded: 1948
Parent Organization: United Nations (UN)
Director-General: Tedros Adhanom Ghebreyesus

About Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO)

Headquarters: Rome, Italy
Founded: 1945
Director-General: Qu Dongyu

170. As of 2026, in which year did the United Nations General Assembly (UNGA) officially recognize World Oceans Day and designate 8 June for its annual observance?

A.1992

B.2000

C.2005

D.2008

E.2009

Answer: D

World Oceans Day 2026 is observed globally on **8 June** to raise awareness about the importance of oceans and the need for their conservation.

The concept of World Oceans Day was first proposed at the **Earth Summit held in Rio de Janeiro, Brazil, in 1992**.

The **United Nations General Assembly (UNGA)** officially recognized **World Oceans Day in 2008** and designated **8 June** for its annual observance.

On **8 June 2009**, the observance was formally implemented following **UNGA Resolution 63/111**.

171. In 2026, the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) imposed a monetary penalty of ₹41.80 lakh on which bank for non-compliance with KYC norms and rules relating to unclaimed deposits/inoperative accounts?

A.Punjab National Bank

B.Canara Bank

C.Bank of Baroda

D.Indian Bank

E.Union Bank of India

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** imposed a **monetary penalty of ₹41.80 lakh** on **Canara Bank** on **5 June 2026**.

The penalty was imposed for **non-compliance** with RBI directions relating to **'Know Your Customer (KYC)' norms** and **'Unclaimed Deposits / Inoperative Accounts in Banks'**.

The action was taken under **Section 47A(1)(c)** read with **Sections 46(4)(i) and 51(1)** of the **Banking Regulation Act, 1949**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** imposed a **monetary penalty of ₹41.80 lakh** on **Canara Bank** on **5 June 2026**.

The penalty was imposed for **non-compliance** with RBI directions relating to **'Know Your Customer (KYC)' norms** and **'Unclaimed Deposits / Inoperative Accounts in Banks'**.

The action was taken under **Section 47A(1)(c)** read with **Sections 46(4)(i) and 51(1)** of the **Banking Regulation Act, 1949**.

The violations were identified during the **Statutory Inspection for Supervisory Evaluation (ISE 2025)** conducted by the RBI.

The inspection assessed the bank's financial position as of **31 March 2025**.

RBI issued a **show-cause notice** to the bank after finding supervisory deficiencies and sought an explanation for the non-compliance.

172. In 2026, the Pension Fund Regulatory and Development Authority (PFRDA) launched which platform to simplify and streamline the National Pension System (NPS) subscriber registration process?

A.eNPS Connect

B.Pension Setu

C.StAR NPS

D.NPS Mitra

E.Digi Pension Portal

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

Pension Fund Regulatory and Development Authority (PFRDA), the statutory regulator under the **Ministry of Finance (MoF)**, launched the **'StAR NPS' platform** to simplify and streamline the **National Pension System (NPS)** subscriber registration process.

StAR NPS has been developed by **Bombay Stock Exchange Limited (BSE) Technologies Private Limited (BTPL)**.

The platform provides **technology-enabled assisted onboarding** for NPS subscribers through **Points of Presence (PoPs)** and their network of pension agents.

Detailed Explanation:

Pension Fund Regulatory and Development Authority (PFRDA), the statutory regulator under the **Ministry of Finance (MoF)**, launched the **'StAR NPS' platform** to simplify and streamline the **National Pension System (NPS)** subscriber registration process.

StAR NPS has been developed by **Bombay Stock Exchange Limited (BSE) Technologies Private Limited (BTPL)**.

The platform provides **technology-enabled assisted onboarding** for NPS subscribers through **Points of Presence (PoPs)** and their network of pension agents.

The objective of StAR NPS is to make **subscriber onboarding faster, easier, and more efficient**.

Under the new framework, **Resident Indian individuals aged 18 years and above up to 85 years** are eligible to enroll through the platform.

PFRDA also introduced a **Regulatory Sandbox Framework**, which came into effect on **2 June 2026**.

The Regulatory Sandbox Framework enables **controlled testing of innovative pension-sector solutions** before their wider adoption.

The framework allows **PFRDA-registered intermediaries and eligible non-registered entities**, including fintech firms, to test innovative solutions with a **limited set of users for a specified period**.

173. In 2026, consider the following statements regarding the 61st and 2nd Bi-Monthly Monetary Policy Committee (MPC) Meeting of the Reserve Bank of India (RBI):

1. **The MPC unanimously decided to keep the Policy Repo Rate unchanged at 5.25%.**

2. **The Standing Deposit Facility (SDF) Rate remains at 5.00%.**
3. **The MPC changed its policy stance from 'Neutral' to 'Accommodative'.**

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

A.1 and 2 only

B.2 and 3 only

C.1 and 3 only

D.1, 2 and 3

E.3 only

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** conducted the **61st and 2nd Bi-Monthly Monetary Policy Committee (MPC) Meeting** of **Financial Year 2026-27 (FY27)** from **3–5 June 2026**.

The **Standing Deposit Facility (SDF) Rate** remains **unchanged at 5.00%**.

The **Marginal Standing Facility (MSF) Rate** and the **Bank Rate** continue at **5.50%**.

The MPC decided to maintain its **'Neutral' Stance**, indicating that policy rates may move either upward or downward depending on future economic conditions.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** conducted the **61st and 2nd Bi-Monthly Monetary Policy Committee (MPC) Meeting** of **Financial Year 2026-27 (FY27)** from **3–5 June 2026**.

The meeting was chaired by **Sanjay Malhotra, Governor of the RBI**.

Other **MPC members** who attended the meeting were **Nagesh Kumar, Saugata Bhattacharya, Ram Singh, Poonam Gupta, and Indranil Bhattacharyya**.

The Monetary Policy Committee (MPC) voted unanimously to keep the **Policy Repo Rate** under the Liquidity Adjustment Facility (LAF) **unchanged at 5.25%**.

The **Standing Deposit Facility (SDF) Rate** remains **unchanged at 5.00%**.

The **Marginal Standing Facility (MSF) Rate** and the **Bank Rate** continue at **5.50%**.

The MPC decided to maintain its **'Neutral' Stance**, indicating that policy rates may move either upward or downward depending on future economic conditions.

174. In FY27, the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) announced the expansion of pilot projects for which Central Bank Digital Currency (CBDC) by introducing new domestic and cross-border use cases?

A.Digital Dollar

B.Digital Euro

C.Digital Pound

D.Digital Yen

E.Digital Rupee

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** plans to expand **Central Bank Digital Currency (CBDC)** pilot projects in **FY27** by introducing new **Domestic and Cross-Border Use Cases**.

The central bank will participate in **Multilateral Projects** focused on developing **Technical**

Standards and Governance Frameworks for cross-border CBDC transactions.

The **Digital Rupee (e₹)** pilot will be expanded to include additional **Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT) Schemes** and **Domestic Retail Payment Transactions**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** plans to expand **Central Bank Digital Currency (CBDC)** pilot projects in **FY27** by introducing new **Domestic and Cross-Border Use Cases**.

The RBI will explore **Bilateral and Multilateral Cross-Border CBDC Pilots** to make international payments **faster, cheaper, more Efficient**, and less dependent on traditional payment channels.

The central bank will participate in **Multilateral Projects** focused on developing **Technical Standards and Governance Frameworks** for cross-border CBDC transactions.

The **Digital Rupee (e₹)** pilot will be expanded to include additional **Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT) Schemes** and **Domestic Retail Payment Transactions**.

The move aims to **increase the practical utility and adoption** of the Digital Rupee among individuals and businesses.

The RBI plans to introduce a **CBDC and Asset Tokenization Sandbox Framework** for testing innovative products and services built around CBDC infrastructure.

The central bank will further explore **Tokenisation of Financial Assets** along with **settlement through CBDC**.

175. In 2026, the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) proposed a cooling-off period for digital transactions exceeding what amount to help reduce online payment frauds?

A.₹5,000

B.₹7,500

C.₹15,000

D.₹10,000

E.₹50,000

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** has proposed a **one-hour cooling-off period** for digital transactions **exceeding ₹10,000** to reduce online payment frauds.

The proposal is part of RBI's discussion paper titled **"Exploring Safeguards in Digital Payments to Curb Frauds"**.

The discussion paper seeks **stakeholder feedback** on additional security measures to strengthen the digital payment ecosystem.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** has proposed a **one-hour cooling-off period** for digital transactions **exceeding ₹10,000** to reduce online payment frauds.

The proposal is part of RBI's discussion paper titled **"Exploring Safeguards in Digital Payments to Curb Frauds"**.

The discussion paper seeks **stakeholder feedback** on additional security measures to strengthen the digital payment ecosystem.

Under the proposal, transactions above ₹10,000 will be **provisionally debited** from the payer's account, but the **actual transfer of funds will be delayed by one hour**.

During the cooling-off period, customers will have the **option to cancel the transaction** if they suspect fraud.

The proposed mechanism aims to provide an **additional layer of protection** against unauthorized and fraudulent transactions.

According to RBI, transactions above ₹10,000 account for approximately **45% of fraud cases by volume**.

176. In FY26, consider the following statements regarding banknotes in circulation in India:

1. **The ₹500 denomination banknotes accounted for more than 85% of the total value of currency in circulation.**
2. **In terms of volume, ₹500 notes constituted 41.2% of the total banknotes in circulation.**
3. **The ₹10 denomination note was the second most circulated banknote by volume.**

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

A.1 and 2 only

B.2 and 3 only

C.1 and 3 only

D.All are correct

E.1 only

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

The volume of **₹500 denomination banknotes** in circulation **increased by 11.2% during FY26**, rising from 6,34,458 lakh pieces in FY25 to **7,05,482 lakh pieces**.

₹500 notes continued to dominate India's currency system and remained the **most widely circulated denomination**.

In value terms, **₹500 banknotes** in circulation increased from ₹31.72 lakh crore in FY25 to **₹35.27 lakh crore in FY26**.

₹500 notes accounted for **more than 85% of the total value** of currency in circulation during FY26.

In terms of volume, ₹500 notes constituted **41.2% of the total banknotes** in circulation, making them the most widely used denomination in India.

The **₹10 denomination note** was the **second most circulated banknote**, accounting for **16.1% of the total volume** of banknotes in circulation.

Detailed Explanation:

The volume of **₹500 denomination banknotes** in circulation **increased by 11.2% during FY26**, rising from 6,34,458 lakh pieces in FY25 to **7,05,482 lakh pieces**.

₹500 notes continued to dominate India's currency system and remained the **most widely circulated denomination**.

In value terms, **₹500 banknotes** in circulation increased from ₹31.72 lakh crore in FY25 to **₹35.27 lakh crore in FY26**.

₹500 notes accounted for **more than 85% of the total value** of currency in circulation during FY26.

In terms of volume, ₹500 notes constituted **41.2% of the total banknotes** in circulation, making them the most widely used denomination in India.

The **₹10 denomination note** was the **second most circulated banknote**, accounting for **16.1% of the total volume** of banknotes in circulation.

The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** reported an **increase of over 20%** in the number of **counterfeit ₹500 notes detected** during FY26.

The rise in fake ₹500 notes highlights the continuing challenge of **combating counterfeit currency** despite enhanced security features.

The **withdrawal of ₹2,000 denomination banknotes** continued during FY26.

177. In 2026, Prime Minister Narendra Modi inaugurated the new terminal building of which airport in Daman?

A.Veer Savarkar Airport

B.Maharaja Agrasen Airport

C.NAMO Airport

D.Dabolim Airport

E.Birsa Munda Airport

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

Prime Minister Narendra Modi inaugurated the **new terminal building of NAMO Airport, Daman**.

The project aims to enhance **air connectivity, passenger convenience, tourism, and economic development** in the Union Territory of **Dadra and Nagar Haveli and Daman and Diu**.

The new terminal building is part of a broader **₹2,970 crore development package** unveiled during the Prime Minister's visit.

Detailed Explanation:

Prime Minister Narendra Modi inaugurated the **new terminal building of NAMO Airport, Daman**.

The project aims to enhance **air connectivity, passenger convenience, tourism, and economic development** in the Union Territory of **Dadra and Nagar Haveli and Daman and Diu**.

The new terminal building is part of a broader **₹2,970 crore development package** unveiled during the Prime Minister's visit.

The airport project is expected to strengthen Daman's integration with India's growing civil aviation network and improve regional connectivity.

The terminal has been equipped with modern infrastructure and can accommodate approximately **180 passengers at a time**.

Key features include **modern passenger amenities, enhanced passenger handling systems, improved operational efficiency, and better travel experience for tourists and residents**.

Improved air connectivity is expected to boost tourism in Daman, which is known for its **beaches, historical sites, and coastal attractions**.

178. On World Environment Day 2026, how many Namo Oxygen Parks were inaugurated across Delhi by Union Minister Bhupender Yadav and Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta?

A.10

B.12

C.15

D.20

E.18

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

On **World Environment Day 2026 (5 June)**, **Union Minister for Environment, Forest and Climate Change Bhupender Yadav** and **Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta** inaugurated **18 Namo Oxygen Parks** across Delhi.

The parks have been developed under the **'Ek Ped Maa Ke Naam'** campaign to increase green cover and improve urban environmental sustainability.

The flagship event was held at the **Namo Oxygen Park, Maidangarhi, Delhi**.

Detailed Explanation:

On **World Environment Day 2026 (5 June)**, **Union Minister for Environment, Forest and Climate Change Bhupender Yadav** and **Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta** inaugurated **18 Namo Oxygen Parks** across Delhi.

The parks have been developed under the **'Ek Ped Maa Ke Naam'** campaign to increase green cover and improve urban environmental sustainability.

The flagship event was held at the **Namo Oxygen Park, Maidangarhi, Delhi**.

The Namo Oxygen Parks are designed to function as **urban green lungs**, helping improve air quality, enhance biodiversity, and provide recreational green spaces for citizens.

The initiative aims to **improve urban air quality, increase green cover, promote biodiversity conservation, encourage community participation, and create recreational spaces**.

179. In 2026, the Regional Meteorological Centre (RMC) inaugurated in Jammu became which Regional Meteorological Centre under the India Meteorological Department (IMD)?

A.7th

B.6th

C.5th

D.8th

E.9th

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

Union Minister Dr. Jitendra Singh inaugurated the **Regional Meteorological Centre (RMC)** in **Jammu**.

The facility becomes **India's seventh Regional Meteorological Centre** under the **India Meteorological Department (IMD)**.

The centre will provide meteorological services to **Jammu & Kashmir, Ladakh, and Himachal Pradesh**.

It is expected to strengthen **weather monitoring, forecasting accuracy, climate services, and disaster early-warning systems** in the Himalayan region.

Detailed Explanation:

Union Minister Dr. Jitendra Singh inaugurated the **Regional Meteorological Centre (RMC)** in **Jammu**.

The facility becomes **India's seventh Regional Meteorological Centre** under the **India Meteorological Department (IMD)**.

The centre will provide meteorological services to **Jammu & Kashmir, Ladakh, and Himachal Pradesh**.

It is expected to strengthen **weather monitoring, forecasting accuracy, climate services, and disaster early-warning systems** in the Himalayan region.

The Regional Meteorological Centre will provide **district-level weather forecasts, mountain weather forecasts, tourist advisories, city-specific forecasts, flash-flood warnings, avalanche alerts, cloudburst warnings, landslide warnings, thunderstorm alerts, and heavy snowfall forecasts**.

The centre will benefit **pilgrims, farmers, disaster management agencies, hydropower projects, tourism operators, transport services, and security forces** operating in high-altitude areas.

Pilgrims visiting **Amarnath Cave Shrine** and **Vaishno Devi** will receive timely weather updates and safety advisories.

180. Recently, India's launch of E85 fuel in 2026 marked the next phase of the ethanol blending programme following the nationwide implementation of which fuel?

A.E10

B.E15

C.E20

D.E50

E.E100

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

India has launched **E85 fuel**, a petrol blend containing approximately **85% ethanol and 15% petrol**, to reduce dependence on imported crude oil and promote cleaner transportation.

The fuel was launched by **Union Minister for Petroleum and Natural Gas Hardeep Singh Puri** on **World Environment Day (5 June 2026)**.

E85 fuel is specifically designed for **Flex-Fuel Vehicles (FFVs)**, which can operate on varying blends of ethanol and petrol.

The launch marks the next phase of India's ethanol blending programme following the nationwide implementation of **E20 fuel**.

Detailed Explanation:

India has launched **E85 fuel**, a petrol blend containing approximately **85% ethanol and 15%**

petrol, to reduce dependence on imported crude oil and promote cleaner transportation.

The fuel was launched by **Union Minister for Petroleum and Natural Gas Hardeep Singh Puri** on **World Environment Day (5 June 2026)**.

E85 fuel is specifically designed for **Flex-Fuel Vehicles (FFVs)**, which can operate on varying blends of ethanol and petrol.

The launch marks the next phase of India's ethanol blending programme following the nationwide implementation of **E20 fuel**.

The initiative aims to **reduce crude oil imports, strengthen energy security, lower greenhouse gas emissions, support domestic ethanol production, and increase farmers' income**.

Ethanol used in E85 fuel is produced from renewable agricultural feedstocks such as **sugarcane, maize, rice, agricultural residues, and biomass resources**.

The rollout has begun in a phased manner and is initially available at around **48–50 fuel stations**.

181. In 2026, which initiative of the Ministry of Panchayati Raj won the Gold Award at the National e-Governance Awards 2026?

A.e-Gram Swaraj

B.Panchayat Advancement Index (PAI)

C.SVAMITVA Scheme

D.Gram Manchitra

E.AuditOnline

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The **Panchayat Advancement Index (PAI)**, a flagship initiative of the **Ministry of Panchayati Raj**, has won the **Gold Award** at the **National e-Governance Awards 2026**.

The award has been conferred under **Category VII – Digital Transformation through the Use of Data Analytics in Digital Platforms by Central Ministries, States and Union Territories**.

The award will be presented during the **29th National Conference on e-Governance**, scheduled to be held on **1–2 July 2026 in Jaipur, Rajasthan**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Panchayat Advancement Index (PAI)**, a flagship initiative of the **Ministry of Panchayati Raj**, has won the **Gold Award** at the **National e-Governance Awards 2026**.

The award has been conferred under **Category VII – Digital Transformation through the Use of Data Analytics in Digital Platforms by Central Ministries, States and Union Territories**.

The award will be presented during the **29th National Conference on e-Governance**, scheduled to be held on **1–2 July 2026 in Jaipur, Rajasthan**.

The **Gold Award** comprises a **Trophy, Citation, and a cash incentive of ₹10 lakh**.

The recognition highlights the Government's efforts to promote **innovation, transparency, accountability, and data-driven decision-making** in local governance.

The **Panchayat Advancement Index** is India's first comprehensive data-driven framework for assessing the performance of **more than 2.6 lakh Gram Panchayats** across the country.

182. In 2026, how many distinguished artistes were honoured by the Uttar Pradesh Sangeet Natak Akademi (SNA) at the SNA Samman Ceremony held in Lucknow?

A.41

B.45

C.48

D.51

E.55

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

The **Uttar Pradesh Sangeet Natak Akademi (SNA)** honoured **51 distinguished artistes** at the **SNA Samman Ceremony 2026** held at **Gandhi Auditorium, Jan Bhavan, Lucknow**.

The awards recognized outstanding contributions in **Classical Music, Folk Music, Dance, Theatre, and Traditional Folk Arts**.

The awardees were selected for the years **2021, 2022, 2023, and 2024**.

Governor Anandiben Patel emphasized the importance of preserving India's cultural heritage and stated that **"Culture is not only an inheritance but also a responsibility."**

Detailed Explanation:

The **Uttar Pradesh Sangeet Natak Akademi (SNA)** honoured **51 distinguished artistes** at the **SNA Samman Ceremony 2026** held at **Gandhi Auditorium, Jan Bhavan, Lucknow**.

The awards recognized outstanding contributions in **Classical Music, Folk Music, Dance, Theatre, and Traditional Folk Arts**.

The awardees were selected for the years **2021, 2022, 2023, and 2024**.

Governor Anandiben Patel emphasized the importance of preserving India's cultural heritage and stated that **"Culture is not only an inheritance but also a responsibility."**

The Governor cited the growing popularity of **"Bhajan Clubbing"** as an example of how traditional cultural expressions can adapt to modern platforms while retaining their original essence.

The ceremony was attended by several dignitaries, including **Prof. Jayant Khot (Chairman, Uttar Pradesh Sangeet Natak Akademi), Vibha Singh (Vice-Chairperson), Sanjay Kumar Singh (Special Secretary, Culture), and Dr. Shobhit Kumar Nahar (Director, Uttar Pradesh Sangeet Natak Akademi).**

183. In 2026, the Central Government re-appointed whom as Deputy Governor of the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) for a period of two years?

A.Swaminathan Janakiraman

B.Shirish Chandra Murmu

C.Rohit Jain

D.Poonam Gupta

E.Michael Debabrata Patra

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

The **Central Government** has re-appointed **Shri Swaminathan Janakiraman** as **Deputy Governor of the Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** for a period of **two years**.

The re-appointment will take effect from **26 June 2026** or until further orders, whichever is earlier.

Swaminathan Janakiraman was **first appointed** as Deputy Governor of RBI in **June 2023**.

Before joining the RBI, he served as **Managing Director (MD)** of the **State Bank of India (SBI)**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Central Government** has re-appointed **Shri Swaminathan Janakiraman** as **Deputy Governor of the Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** for a period of **two years**.

The re-appointment will take effect from **26 June 2026** or until further orders, whichever is earlier.

Swaminathan Janakiraman was **first appointed** as Deputy Governor of RBI in **June 2023**.

Before joining the RBI, he served as **Managing Director (MD)** of the **State Bank of India (SBI)**.

As Deputy Governor, he oversees several important functions, including the **Department of Supervision** and the **Inspection Department**.

The re-appointment ensures **continuity** in the RBI's **regulatory and supervisory responsibilities**.

The **Governor of RBI** is **Sanjay Malhotra**.

The RBI currently has **four Deputy Governors**: **Swaminathan Janakiraman**, **Poonam Gupta**, **Shirish Chandra Murmu**, and **Rohit Jain**.

184. In 2026, how many Additional Judges of the Bombay High Court were appointed as Permanent Judges by the President of India?

A.4

B.5

C.6

D.7

E.8

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The President of India appointed **Six Additional Judges** of the **Bombay High Court** as **Permanent Judges** under the provisions of the **Constitution of India**.

The appointments were made after **consultation** with the **Chief Justice of India (CJI)** and in accordance with the **Collegium System**.

The move is aimed at **strengthening the Judicial System** and **enhancing the efficiency** of one of India's busiest High Courts.

The **six judges elevated** as Permanent Judges of the Bombay High Court are **Justice Nivedita Prakash Mehta**, **Justice Prafulla Surendrakumar Khubalkar**, **Justice Ashwin Damodar Bhobe**, **Justice Rohit Wasudeo Joshi**, **Justice Advait Mahendra Sethna**, and **Justice Pravin Sheshrao Patil**.

Detailed Explanation:

The President of India appointed **Six Additional Judges** of the **Bombay High Court** as **Permanent Judges** under the provisions of the **Constitution of India**.

The appointments were made after **consultation** with the **Chief Justice of India (CJI)** and in accordance with the **Collegium System**.

The move is aimed at **strengthening the Judicial System** and **enhancing the efficiency** of one of India's busiest High Courts.

The **six judges elevated** as Permanent Judges of the Bombay High Court are **Justice Nivedita Prakash Mehta**, **Justice Prafulla Surendrakumar Khubalkar**, **Justice Ashwin Damodar Bhobe**, **Justice Rohit Wasudeo Joshi**, **Justice Advait Mahendra Sethna**, and **Justice Pravin Sheshrao Patil**.

The appointment of Additional Judges as Permanent Judges follows an **assessment** of their **Judicial Performance**, **Judicial Conduct**, and contribution to the **Administration of Justice**.

Such appointments are **constitutionally made** by the **President of India** based on **recommendations of the Judicial Collegium** and consultation with the Chief Justice of India.

The **Bombay High Court** is one of the **Oldest and Most Prominent** High Courts in India.

185. In 2026, the Indian Air Force (IAF) signed contracts with IIT Bombay to develop an AI-based Health Index System for the engines of which fighter aircraft?

A.Tejas Mk-1A

B.Rafale

C.Mirage 2000

D.Su-30MKI

E.MiG-29

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

The **Indian Air Force (IAF)** has signed **three contracts** with **Indian Institute of Technology Bombay (IIT Bombay)** to develop an **Artificial Intelligence (AI)-based Health Index System** for the engines of **Su-30MKI fighter aircraft** undergoing mid-life maintenance.

The project aims to create a **health index** for every Su-30 MKI engine, helping **reduce service costs**, **improve aircraft availability**, and **extend operational life**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Indian Air Force (IAF)** has signed **three contracts** with **Indian Institute of Technology Bombay (IIT Bombay)** to develop an **Artificial Intelligence (AI)-based Health Index System** for the engines of **Su-30MKI fighter aircraft** undergoing mid-life maintenance.

The project aims to create a **health index** for every Su-30 MKI engine, helping **reduce service costs**, **improve aircraft availability**, and **extend operational life**.

IIT Bombay is developing an **AI Digital Twin Model**, which acts as a **virtual replica** of the aircraft engine.

The AI Digital Twin will provide **real-time diagnostics, prognostics, and predictive maintenance** capabilities for the gas turbine engines of the Su-30 MKI.

The project supports the IAF's vision of **"Minimal Human Intervention, Maximum Combat Potential"** through greater automation and data-driven maintenance.

The initiative is expected to **enhance combat readiness, operational efficiency, and maintenance planning** of the IAF fleet.

186. In 2026, which company launched India's first passenger Flex-Fuel Vehicle (FFV), the Wagon R FFV?

A.Tata Motors

B.Maruti Suzuki

C.Mahindra & Mahindra

D.Hyundai Motor India

E.Honda Cars India

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Union Minister Hardeep Singh Puri launched **India's first passenger Flex-Fuel Vehicle (FFV)**, the **Maruti Suzuki Wagon R**, in New Delhi.

Union Minister Nitin Gadkari launched **Hero MotoCorp's first flex-fuel motorcycles** – **Splendor+ Flex Fuel** and **HF Deluxe Flex Fuel**.

Flex-Fuel Vehicles (FFVs) can run on **ethanol-petrol blends from E20 to E100**.

The Maruti Suzuki Wagon R FFV features an **advanced Engine Control Unit (ECU)**, **modified fuel-system components**, **optimized injection mapping**, and a **cold-start system**.

E85 has been designated as the **mono-fuel standard for FFVs** under **Bureau of Indian Standards (BIS)** specifications.

Detailed Explanation:

Union Minister Hardeep Singh Puri launched **India's first passenger Flex-Fuel Vehicle (FFV)**, the **Maruti Suzuki Wagon R**, in New Delhi.

Union Minister Nitin Gadkari launched **Hero MotoCorp's first flex-fuel motorcycles** – **Splendor+ Flex Fuel** and **HF Deluxe Flex Fuel**.

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E85 has been designated as the **mono-fuel standard for FFVs** under **Bureau of Indian Standards (BIS)** specifications.

NITI Aayog classifies ethanol-based Flex-Fuel Vehicles (FFVs) as **Zero-Emission Vehicles (ZEVs)** due to their **near-zero particulate matter (PM) emissions**.

India's energy strategy is based on three pillars: **Availability, Affordability, and Sustainability**.

India's **domestic LPG production** increased from 32 TMT per day to **nearly 52 TMT per day**.

The Central Government **reduced excise duty on petrol and diesel by ₹10 per litre** to provide relief to consumers.

187. In 2026, India joined Project Glasswing to strengthen cyber resilience and gain access to which AI-powered cybersecurity model developed by Anthropic PBC?

A.Claude Sonnet AI

B.Claude Opus AI

C.Claude Mythos AI

D.Gemini Cyber AI

E.Sentinel AI

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

India has joined **Project Glasswing**, a global cybersecurity initiative led by **Anthropic PBC** to strengthen cyber resilience and protect critical digital infrastructure.

Through Project Glasswing, India will gain access to **Claude Mythos AI**, an advanced Artificial Intelligence (AI) model designed to **identify software vulnerabilities** and **enhance cyber defences**.

Detailed Explanation:

India has joined **Project Glasswing**, a global cybersecurity initiative led by **Anthropic PBC** to strengthen cyber resilience and protect critical digital infrastructure.

Through Project Glasswing, India will gain access to **Claude Mythos AI**, an advanced Artificial Intelligence (AI) model designed to **identify software vulnerabilities** and **enhance cyber defences**.

The primary objective of Project Glasswing is to help participating countries **improve cybersecurity resilience** and **safeguard critical digital infrastructure**.

Claude Mythos AI functions as an **AI-powered security auditor** capable of analysing large software codebases and detecting security vulnerabilities.

Mythos AI can **identify security weaknesses**, **generate remediation patches**, and support faster vulnerability management.

188. In June 2026, consider the following statements regarding the latest Forbes Billionaires Ranking:

1. **Elon Musk retained the position of the world's richest person with a net worth of USD 822.3 billion.**
2. **Larry Page and Larry Ellison secured the second and third positions, respectively.**
3. **Jensen Huang, founder of Nvidia, was ranked first globally due to the Artificial Intelligence boom.**

Which of the statements given above is/are incorrect?

A.2 only

B.2 and 3 only

C.1 and 3 only

D.1 only

E.3 only

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

The latest **Forbes Billionaires Ranking (June 2026)** highlights the growing impact of **Artificial Intelligence (AI), Cloud Computing, and technological innovation** on global wealth creation.

Elon Musk retained the position of the **world's richest person** with a net worth of **USD 822.3 billion**.

Larry Page and **Larry Ellison** secured the second and third positions, respectively.

Jensen Huang, founder of Nvidia, emerged as one of the biggest beneficiaries of the Artificial Intelligence boom, ranking eighth globally.

Bernard Arnault & Family is the highest-ranked non-American entry in the top 10 list.

Detailed Explanation:

The latest **Forbes Billionaires Ranking (June 2026)** highlights the growing impact of **Artificial Intelligence (AI), Cloud Computing, and technological innovation** on global wealth creation.

The **top 10 richest individuals in the world collectively hold nearly USD 2.9 trillion in wealth**.

Technology entrepreneurs continue to dominate the rankings, with major wealth gains driven by advancements in **Artificial Intelligence, cloud infrastructure, digital platforms, and space technology**.

Elon Musk retained the position of the **world's richest person** with a net worth of **USD 822.3 billion**.

Larry Page and **Larry Ellison** secured the second and third positions, respectively.

Jensen Huang, founder of Nvidia, emerged as one of the biggest beneficiaries of the Artificial Intelligence boom, ranking eighth globally.

Bernard Arnault & Family is the highest-ranked non-American entry in the top 10 list.

Warren Buffett remains among the world's wealthiest investors, securing the tenth position.

189. Recently, Former Lok Sabha Secretary-General and Eminent Constitutional Scholar Dr. Subhash C. Kashyap passed away. In which year he was conferred the Padma Bhushan, India's third-highest civilian award, for his contributions to Public Affairs?

A.2012

B.2013

C.2014

D.2015

E.2016

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

Dr. Subhash C. Kashyap, former **Secretary-General of the Lok Sabha**, eminent **Constitutional Expert**, renowned **Author**, and noted scholar, passed away in New Delhi at the age of 97 following a prolonged illness.

Subhash C. Kashyap was born on **10 May 1929** in Chandpur, Bijnor District, present-day **Uttar Pradesh (UP)**.

In **2015**, he was conferred the **Padma Bhushan**, India's **Third-Highest Civilian Award**, in the field of **Public Affairs**.

Detailed Explanation:

Dr. Subhash C. Kashyap, former **Secretary-General of the Lok Sabha**, eminent **Constitutional Expert**, renowned **Author**, and noted scholar, passed away in New Delhi at the age of 97 following a prolonged illness.

Subhash C. Kashyap was born on **10 May 1929** in Chandpur, Bijnor District, present-day **Uttar Pradesh (UP)**.

He joined the **Parliament Secretariat** in **1953** and remained associated with parliamentary affairs for more than three and a half decades.

He served as the **Secretary-General of the Lok Sabha** from **1983 to 1990**, covering the **7th, 8th, and 9th Lok Sabhas**.

In **2015**, he was conferred the **Padma Bhushan**, India's **Third-Highest Civilian Award**, in the field of **Public Affairs**.

190. In 2026, under Mission Mausam, how many additional Doppler Weather Radars have been proposed in the Jammu & Kashmir region?

A.3

B.4

C.5

D.6

E.7

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

At present, **four Doppler Weather Radars** are operational in the region at **Jammu, Srinagar, Leh, and Banihal Top**.

Under **Mission Mausam**, five additional **Doppler Weather Radars** have been proposed at **Anantnag, Rajouri, Baramulla, Kishtwar, and Doda**.

The **Srinagar Meteorological Observatory** has been recognized by the **World Meteorological Organization (WMO)** as a **Centennial Observing Station** for its more than 100 years of contribution to weather observation and climate science.

Detailed Explanation:

At present, **four Doppler Weather Radars** are operational in the region at **Jammu, Srinagar, Leh, and Banihal Top**.

Under **Mission Mausam**, five additional **Doppler Weather Radars** have been proposed at **Anantnag, Rajouri, Baramulla, Kishtwar, and Doda**.

The **Srinagar Meteorological Observatory** has been recognized by the **World Meteorological Organization (WMO)** as a **Centennial Observing Station** for its more than 100 years of contribution to weather observation and climate science.

A **Regional Meteorological Centre** functions as a major forecasting and weather-monitoring hub responsible for **weather forecasting, disaster early-warning services, climate monitoring, aviation meteorology, agro-meteorological advisories, hydrological forecasting, and public weather services**.

191. In 2026, Union Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman met Suvendu Adhikari in New

Delhi to discuss measures for accelerating the development of which state?

A.Odisha

B.Bihar

C.West Bengal

D.Assam

E.Jharkhand

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

Union Minister for Finance and Corporate Affairs Nirmala Sitharaman met **Suvendu Adhikari** in New Delhi to discuss measures for accelerating **West Bengal's development** in line with the vision of Narendra Modi.

The meeting focused on **improving credit availability** across various sectors and **enhancing the implementation of Central Government schemes** in West Bengal.

The Union Finance Minister announced a **renewed saturation drive** to ensure coverage of every eligible beneficiary under major flagship financial inclusion schemes.

Detailed Explanation:

Union Minister for Finance and Corporate Affairs Nirmala Sitharaman met **Suvendu Adhikari** in New Delhi to discuss measures for accelerating **West Bengal's development** in line with the vision of Narendra Modi.

The meeting focused on **improving credit availability** across various sectors and **enhancing the implementation of Central Government schemes** in West Bengal.

The Union Finance Minister announced a **renewed saturation drive** to ensure coverage of every eligible beneficiary under major flagship financial inclusion schemes.

The schemes identified for the saturation drive include **Pradhan Mantri MUDRA Yojana**, **Pradhan Mantri Jan Dhan Yojana**, **Pradhan Mantri Jeevan Jyoti Bima Yojana**, **Pradhan Mantri Suraksha Bima Yojana**, **Atal Pension Yojana**, and **PM SVANidhi**.

To expand access to finance, **roundtable meetings will be organized** across all regions of West Bengal involving **Public Sector Banks (PSBs)**, **industry bodies**, and **MSME associations**.

192. In 2026, under the new tax regime introduced by the Ministry of Finance to boost Foreign Portfolio Investor (FPI) participation in Government Securities (G-Secs), what is the tax rate on interest income earned from G-Secs by FPIs/FIIs?

A.20%

B.12.5%

C.10%

D.5%

E.Nil

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

The **Ministry of Finance (MoF)** introduced major reforms to increase **Foreign Portfolio Investor (FPI)** participation in **Government Securities (G-Secs)** and strengthen India's debt market.

The reforms aim to attract **stable long-term foreign capital**, **deepen the G-Sec market**, and **broaden and diversify the investor base**.
The key measures include **tax exemptions** on interest income, **Long-Term Capital Gains (LTCG)**, **Short-Term Capital Gains (STCG)**, expansion of the **Fully Accessible Route (FAR)**, and streamlined investment norms.
Under the previous tax regime, FIIs and SEBI-registered FPIs were taxed under **Section 210 of the Income-tax Act, 2025**.
Earlier, interest income from G-Secs was **taxed at 20%** for FIIs/FPIs.
Previously, **Short-Term Capital Gains (STCG)** on G-Secs were **taxed at 30%**.
Long-Term Capital Gains (LTCG) on G-Secs were **taxed at 12.5%** under the earlier regime.
Under the **new tax regime**, FPIs/FIIs will pay **Nil tax on interest income** earned from G-Secs.
Detailed Explanation:
The **Ministry of Finance (MoF)** introduced major reforms to increase **Foreign Portfolio Investor (FPI)** participation in **Government Securities (G-Secs)** and strengthen India's debt market.
The reforms aim to attract **stable long-term foreign capital**, **deepen the G-Sec market**, and **broaden and diversify the investor base**.
The key measures include **tax exemptions** on interest income, **Long-Term Capital Gains (LTCG)**, **Short-Term Capital Gains (STCG)**, expansion of the **Fully Accessible Route (FAR)**, and streamlined investment norms.
Greater foreign participation is expected to **support funding for infrastructure**, manufacturing, urban development, climate initiatives, and other national priorities.
The reforms are also expected to **improve market liquidity**, enhance price discovery, develop a smoother yield curve, **reduce government borrowing costs**, and strengthen monetary policy transmission.
The measures are likely to attract **long-term institutional investors** such as **pension funds**, **insurance companies**, and **sovereign wealth funds**.
Under the previous tax regime, FIIs and SEBI-registered FPIs were taxed under **Section 210 of the Income-tax Act, 2025**.
Earlier, interest income from G-Secs was **taxed at 20%** for FIIs/FPIs.
Previously, **Short-Term Capital Gains (STCG)** on G-Secs were **taxed at 30%**.
Long-Term Capital Gains (LTCG) on G-Secs were **taxed at 12.5%** under the earlier regime.
Under the **new tax regime**, FPIs/FIIs will pay **Nil tax on interest income** earned from G-Secs.

193. In 2026, according to SBI Research's latest "Ecowrap" Report, what GDP growth rate was projected for India in FY26?

A.6.5%
B.7.0%
C.7.3%
D.7.7%
E.8.2%

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

State Bank of India (SBI) Research released its latest **"Ecowrap" Report**, which projected **India's** Gross Domestic Product (GDP) **growth for** Financial Year 2025-26 **(FY26) at 7.7%**.

The report attributed the higher growth estimate to the **stronger-than-expected economic performance in Q4 FY26** (January–March 2026).

India's GDP growth accelerated to 7.8% in Q4 FY26, reflecting sustained economic momentum.

According to the report, growth was supported by **strong services sector activity**, **robust industrial performance**, **rising private investments**, and **improving consumption trends**.

Detailed Explanation:

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India's GDP growth accelerated to 7.8% in Q4 FY26, reflecting sustained economic momentum.

According to the report, growth was supported by **strong services sector activity**, **robust industrial performance**, **rising private investments**, and **improving consumption trends**.

The report projected **Nominal GDP Growth in the range of 12.5%–13% for FY27**, higher than the **Budget Estimate (BE) of 10%**.

The higher nominal GDP projection is subject to continued elevation in **inflation and GDP deflator trends**.

Gross Value Added (GVA), a key indicator of economic activity, **expanded by 7.9% in Q4 FY26**.

The **average GVA growth for the full FY26** also stood at **7.9%**.

The report highlighted that **Core GVA recorded a strong growth of 9.7%**.

The **Services Sector** emerged as the major contributor to economic growth, **expanding by 9.9% in Q4 FY26**.

194. In 2026, Reliance Industries Limited (RIL) raised JPY 91.9 billion (approximately USD 625 million), marking the largest-ever borrowing of its kind by an Indian corporate. This borrowing is known as which of the following?

A.Masala Bond

B.Samurai Loan

C.Panda Bond

D.Dim Sum Bond

E.Yankee Bond

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Reliance Industries Limited (RIL) raised **JPY 91.9 billion (approximately USD 625 million)** through a **Samurai Loan**.

The borrowing is the **largest Samurai Loan ever raised by an Indian corporate** and the third-largest Samurai borrowing by an Asian corporate.

A **Samurai Loan** is a **Japanese Yen-denominated cross-border syndicated loan** provided by Japanese lenders to a non-Japanese borrower.

Detailed Explanation:

Reliance Industries Limited (RIL) raised **JPY 91.9 billion (approximately USD 625 million)** through a **Samurai Loan**.

The borrowing is the **largest Samurai Loan ever raised by an Indian corporate** and the third-largest Samurai borrowing by an Asian corporate.

A **Samurai Loan** is a **Japanese Yen-denominated cross-border syndicated loan** provided by Japanese lenders to a non-Japanese borrower.

Samurai Loans enable foreign companies to **access Japan's financial markets** and raise funds in Japanese Yen (JPY).

The transaction involved participation from **10 Japanese and Taiwanese banks**.

The funds were used to **refinance RIL's existing yen-denominated debt** maturing during FY26.

RIL also secured **USD 600 million equivalent financing** through untied facilities backed by **Nippon Export and Investment Insurance (NEXI)**, Japan's export credit agency.

195. As of 2026, which of the following has been identified by the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) as a key regulatory priority for FY27?

A.Customer Protection

B.Expansion of sovereign gold bonds

C.Privatization of public sector banks

D.Introduction of a digital rupee for exports only

E.Merger of regional rural banks

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** has identified **Customer Protection** and **Strengthening the Credit Ecosystem** as its two key regulatory priorities for **FY27**.

To enhance customer protection, RBI plans to **strengthen Know Your Customer (KYC) norms**, review Responsible Business Conduct Guidelines, and **extend the Video Customer Identification Process (V-CIP) facility to Non-Resident Indians (NRIs)**.

RBI's credit-sector reforms will include a review of regulations related to **interest rates**, **credit risk management**, and **loan transfer and distribution mechanisms**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** has identified **Customer Protection** and **Strengthening the Credit Ecosystem** as its two key regulatory priorities for **FY27**.

To enhance customer protection, RBI plans to **strengthen Know Your Customer (KYC) norms**, review Responsible Business Conduct Guidelines, and **extend the Video Customer Identification Process (V-CIP) facility to Non-Resident Indians (NRIs)**.

RBI's credit-sector reforms will include a review of regulations related to **interest rates**, **credit risk management**, and **loan transfer and distribution mechanisms**.

The central bank will introduce a new **Framework for Shared Loan Arrangements** to improve coordination among lenders and strengthen the credit ecosystem.

RBI plans to **rationalise requirements for matters placed before Bank Boards** to enable greater focus on strategy formulation and risk governance.

The supervisory agenda for FY27 will focus on **early identification of emerging risks**, **stronger root-cause analysis**, and **improved consistency in supervisory practices** across regulated entities.

RBI will review the **Risk-Based KYC/Anti-Money Laundering (AML) Supervision Framework** for Scheduled Commercial Banks (SCBs).

196. In 2026, which category accounted for the largest share of banking frauds in India, contributing ₹40,774 crore (84.9% of the total fraud amount) in FY26?

A.Digital Payment Frauds

B.Deposit Account Frauds

C.Foreign Exchange Frauds

D.Card and Internet Banking Frauds

E.Advances (Loan) Category

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

India's banking sector reported **frauds worth ₹48,021 crore in FY26**, registering a **46% increase** over ₹32,694 crore in FY25, the **highest fraud amount recorded in the last three years**.

Despite the rise in fraud value, the **number of fraud cases declined sharply** from 23,722 cases in FY25 to **10,114 cases in FY26**, indicating fewer but higher-value frauds.

Public Sector Banks (PSBs) accounted for nearly **74% of the total fraud amount**, reporting frauds worth **₹35,709 crore across 5,418 cases in FY26**.

Private Sector Banks reported frauds worth **₹11,399 crore involving 3,956 cases** during FY26.

The **Advances (Loan) Category** remained the **largest source of banking fraud**, accounting for **₹40,774 crore**, which constituted **84.9% of the total fraud amount in FY26**.

Detailed Explanation:

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Private Sector Banks reported frauds worth **₹11,399 crore involving 3,956 cases** during FY26.

The **Advances (Loan) Category** remained the **largest source of banking fraud**, accounting for **₹40,774 crore**, which constituted **84.9% of the total fraud amount in FY26**.

Frauds related to **loans and advances increased significantly** from ₹30,367 crore in FY25 to **₹40,774 crore in FY26**.

The number of **loan-related fraud cases also rose** from 7,924 cases in FY25 to **8,640 cases in FY26**.

197. As of FY26, what was the total value of coins in circulation in India, according to the Reserve Bank of India (RBI)?

A.₹36,628 crore

B.₹38,750 crore

C.₹39,920 crore

D.₹40,814 crore

E.₹42,500 crore

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

An Reserve Bank of India (**RBI**) **survey** conducted among households and small retailers revealed that **cash remains the preferred mode of payment** in India despite the rapid growth of digital payment systems.

Reflecting this preference for cash, the **value of banknotes in circulation increased by 11.9% to ₹41.23 trillion** at the end of **March 2026**.

The **volume of banknotes in circulation also grew by 10.5%** during FY26.

The **total value of coins in circulation increased to ₹40,814 crore** in FY26 from ₹36,628 crore in FY25.

Detailed Explanation:

An Reserve Bank of India (**RBI**) **survey** conducted among households and small retailers revealed that **cash remains the preferred mode of payment** in India despite the rapid growth of digital payment systems.

Reflecting this preference for cash, the **value of banknotes in circulation increased by 11.9% to ₹41.23 trillion** at the end of **March 2026**.

The **volume of banknotes in circulation also grew by 10.5%** during FY26.

The **₹500 denomination note** remained the **most widely used currency note** in India during FY26.

In value terms, **₹500 notes accounted for 85.5%** of the total value of banknotes in circulation.

The ₹500 note also held the **highest share in volume terms** among all banknote denominations.

The **total value of coins in circulation increased to ₹40,814 crore** in FY26 from ₹36,628 crore in FY25.

Among coins, the **₹5 coin had the largest share in circulation**, followed by the ₹10 coin

198. As of 2026, according to the Stockholm International Peace Research Institute (SIPRI) Yearbook 2026, how many nuclear warheads does India possess?

A.150

B.170

C.190

D.180

E.210

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The **Stockholm International Peace Research Institute (SIPRI) Yearbook 2026** has reported that India's nuclear arsenal has increased to an estimated **190 warheads**, compared to Pakistan's estimated **170 warheads**.

India now holds an estimated advantage of **20 nuclear warheads** over Pakistan.

The report noted that both India and Pakistan continued to **modernize and strengthen their nuclear capabilities** throughout 2025.

SIPRI observed that India's nuclear strategy is increasingly focused on the development of **longer-range missile systems** to strengthen its strategic deterrence capabilities.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Stockholm International Peace Research Institute (SIPRI) Yearbook 2026** has reported that India's nuclear arsenal has increased to an estimated **190 warheads**, compared to Pakistan's estimated **170 warheads**.

India now holds an estimated advantage of **20 nuclear warheads** over Pakistan.

The report noted that both India and Pakistan continued to **modernize and strengthen their nuclear capabilities** throughout 2025.

SIPRI observed that India's nuclear strategy is increasingly focused on the development of **longer-range missile systems** to strengthen its strategic deterrence capabilities.

While Pakistan remains an important security concern, India's long-term strategic planning is increasingly influenced by evolving challenges related to **China**.

The report highlighted that investments in long-range missile capabilities reflect India's broader approach towards national security and strategic deterrence.

199. As of 2026, West Bengal became the _____State/Union Territory to implement the Ayushman Bharat Pradhan Mantri Jan Arogya Yojana (AB PM-JAY).

A.33rd

B.36th

C.35th

D.38th

E.37th

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

West Bengal is set to become the **36th State/Union Territory** to implement the **Ayushman Bharat Pradhan Mantri Jan Arogya Yojana (AB PM-JAY)**.

The implementation will be formalized through a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** between the **National Health Authority (NHA)** and the Government of West Bengal.
The move marks a significant milestone in India's journey towards **Universal Health Coverage**.
Detailed Explanation:
West Bengal is set to become the **36th State/Union Territory** to implement the **Ayushman Bharat Pradhan Mantri Jan Arogya Yojana (AB PM-JAY)**.
The implementation will be formalized through a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** between the **National Health Authority (NHA)** and the Government of West Bengal.
The move marks a significant milestone in India's journey towards **Universal Health Coverage**.
Ayushman Bharat Pradhan Mantri Jan Arogya Yojana is the world's largest publicly funded health assurance scheme.
The scheme provides **health insurance coverage of up to ₹5 lakh per family per year** for secondary and tertiary hospitalization.
It aims to reduce **out-of-pocket healthcare expenditure** and improve access to quality healthcare services.
About Ayushman Bharat Pradhan Mantri Jan Arogya Yojana
Launch Year: 2018
Implementing Agency: National Health Authority
Type of Scheme: Centrally Sponsored Scheme
Health Coverage: Up to ₹5 lakh per family per year
Coverage: Secondary and Tertiary Hospitalization
Benefits: Cashless treatment and nationwide portability
Objective: Universal Health Coverage and financial protection against healthcare expenses
About Ministry of Health and Family Welfare
Union Minister for Health and Family Welfare: Jagat Prakash Nadda
Chief Executive Officer, National Health Authority: Dr. Sunil Kumar Barnwal

200. In 2026, the National Zoological Park (NZP), New Delhi, launched which mobile application to provide visitors with digital navigation, thematic tours, and information about animals and zoo facilities?
A.Zoo Mitra App
B.Wildlife Guide App
C.NZP Saathi App
D.National Zoo Connect App
E.Eco Tour App
Answer: C
Short Explanation:
The **National Zoological Park (NZP), New Delhi**, has launched the **'NZP Saathi App'** and **Self-Ticketing Kiosks** to enhance visitor convenience and improve the overall zoo experience.
The initiatives were inaugurated by **Union Minister of State for Environment, Forest and Climate Change Kirti Vardhan Singh**.

The **NZP Saathi App** serves as a comprehensive digital guide for zoo visitors and is available on both **Android and iOS platforms**.

The app offers an **interactive digital map**, **smart navigation**, and **real-time guidance** throughout the zoo premises.

Detailed Explanation:

The **National Zoological Park (NZP), New Delhi**, has launched the **'NZP Saathi App'** and **Self-Ticketing Kiosks** to enhance visitor convenience and improve the overall zoo experience.

The initiatives were inaugurated by **Union Minister of State for Environment, Forest and Climate Change Kirti Vardhan Singh**.

The **NZP Saathi App** serves as a comprehensive digital guide for zoo visitors and is available on both **Android and iOS platforms**.

The app offers an **interactive digital map**, **smart navigation**, and **real-time guidance** throughout the zoo premises.

Visitors can easily locate **animal enclosures, washrooms, buggy points, food courts, exits, and other facilities** using the application.

The app also provides **educational information about animals and exhibits**, making zoo visits more informative and engaging.

A key feature of the app is its **thematic tour options**, including:

Express Tour for quick visits

Family Tour for family groups

Grand Zoo Tour covering major attractions

My Tour for personalized itineraries

The zoo has also installed **Self-Ticketing Kiosks** to facilitate faster ticket purchases through **Unified Payments Interface (UPI)-based digital payments**.

201. In 2026, which AI-enabled unified digital platform developed by the Department of Consumer Affairs won the Silver Award at the National Awards for e-Governance (NAeG) 2026?

A.e-Samiksha

B.e-Jagriti

C.e-Grievance Portal

D.Jan Sunwai Platform

E.Consumer Connect

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The **e-Jagriti platform**, developed by the **Department of Consumer Affairs**, has won the **Silver Award** at the **National Awards for e-Governance (NAeG) 2026**.

The award was conferred under the category **"Government Process Re-engineering by Use of Technology for Digital Transformation."**

The platform was selected after a rigorous evaluation process involving **341 nominations** from Central Ministries, Departments, and State Governments.

e-Jagriti is an **Artificial Intelligence-enabled unified digital platform** launched on **1 January 2025** to streamline consumer grievance redressal across India.

Detailed Explanation:

The **e-Jagriti platform**, developed by the **Department of Consumer Affairs**, has won the **Silver Award** at the **National Awards for e-Governance (NAeG) 2026**.

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e-Jagriti is an **Artificial Intelligence-enabled unified digital platform** launched on **1 January 2025** to streamline consumer grievance redressal across India.

The platform integrates four legacy systems into a single ecosystem:

Online Case Monitoring System (OCMS)
e-Daakhil
National Consumer Disputes Redressal Commission Case Management System (NCDRC CMS)
Consumer Online Resource and Empowerment Network (CONFONET)

It provides a **paperless, transparent, and technology-driven mechanism** for filing and resolving consumer disputes.

202. In 2026, CSIR-Central Road Research Institute (CSIR-CRRI) signed an MoA with the Government of Haryana to implement the project titled "Implementation of the Standard Framework for Paving and Greening of Urban Roads" under the guidance of which organization?

A.Commission for Air Quality Management (CAQM)
B.National Green Tribunal (NGT)
C.Central Pollution Control Board (CPCB)
D.Ministry of Road Transport and Highways
E.National Highways Authority of India (NHAI)

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

CSIR-Central Road Research Institute (CSIR-CRRI), New Delhi signed a **Memorandum of Agreement (MoA)** with the **Government of Haryana** for implementing the project titled **"Implementation of the Standard Framework for Paving and Greening of Urban Roads (Haryana State)"**.

The project aims to address **road dust pollution** and promote **sustainable urban road infrastructure** in the **National Capital Region (NCR)**.

The initiative will be **jointly implemented by CSIR-CRRI and School of Planning and Architecture** in collaboration with the Government of Haryana.

The project will be carried out under the guidance of the **Commission for Air Quality Management (CAQM)**.

Detailed Explanation:

CSIR-Central Road Research Institute (CSIR-CRRI), New Delhi signed a **Memorandum of Agreement (MoA)** with the **Government of Haryana** for implementing the project

titled **"Implementation of the Standard Framework for Paving and Greening of Urban Roads (Haryana State)"**.

The project aims to address **road dust pollution** and promote **sustainable urban road infrastructure** in the **National Capital Region (NCR)**.

The initiative will be **jointly implemented by CSIR-CRRI and School of Planning and Architecture** in collaboration with the Government of Haryana.

The project will be carried out under the guidance of the **Commission for Air Quality Management (CAQM)**.

The MoA was exchanged in the presence of senior officials from CAQM, Government of Haryana, CSIR-CRRI, and SPA New Delhi.

Road dust has been identified as a **major contributor to particulate air pollution** in the NCR region.

The CAQM had earlier issued the **Standard Framework and Detailed Guidance Document for Paving and Greening of Urban Roads** based on recommendations developed by CSIR-CRRI.

203. In 2026, the Department of Biotechnology (DBT) observed Swachhata Pakhwada from which dates?

A.1 April – 15 April 2026

B.15 April – 30 April 2026

C.1 May – 15 May 2026

D.15 May – 31 May 2026

E.1 June – 15 June 2026

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The **Department of Biotechnology (DBT)** under the **Ministry of Science & Technology (MoS&T)** observed **Swachhata Pakhwada 2026** from **1 May to 15 May 2026**.

The programme was conducted at the **DBT Headquarters in New Delhi** and across all its **Autonomous Institutions (AIs)** and **Public Sector Undertakings (PSUs)**.

Swachhata Pakhwada 2026 was organized as part of the Government of India's flagship **Swachh Bharat Mission**.

The event was conducted in accordance with the **Guidelines and Calendar of Swachhata Pakhwada 2026** issued by the **Cabinet Secretariat, Government of India**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Department of Biotechnology (DBT)** under the **Ministry of Science & Technology (MoS&T)** observed **Swachhata Pakhwada 2026** from **1 May to 15 May 2026**.

The programme was conducted at the **DBT Headquarters in New Delhi** and across all its **Autonomous Institutions (AIs)** and **Public Sector Undertakings (PSUs)**.

Swachhata Pakhwada 2026 was organized as part of the Government of India's flagship **Swachh Bharat Mission**.

The event was conducted in accordance with the **Guidelines and Calendar of Swachhata Pakhwada 2026** issued by the **Cabinet Secretariat, Government of India**.

The campaign commenced on 1 May 2026 with a **Swachhata Pledge-Taking Ceremony** at the DBT, CGO Complex, New Delhi.

Officers and officials of the DBT participated in the pledge ceremony, reaffirming their commitment to **cleanliness, discipline, and civic responsibility**.

Various **cleanliness and awareness activities** were undertaken during the fortnight with active participation from DBT, its AIs, and PSUs

204. In 2026, Alexander Zverev defeated which player in the Men's Singles final of the French Open (Roland-Garros) to win his maiden Grand Slam title?

A.Carlos Alcaraz

B.Jannik Sinner

C.Novak Djokovic

D.Daniil Medvedev

E.Flavio Cobolli

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

The **French Open 2026 (Roland-Garros)** concluded in **Paris, France**, with several historic achievements across singles and doubles categories.

Alexander Zverev won the **Men's Singles** title, securing the **first Grand Slam title of his career**.

The German star defeated **Flavio Cobolli of Italy** in a thrilling five-set final.

Detailed Explanation:

The **French Open 2026 (Roland-Garros)** concluded in **Paris, France**, with several historic achievements across singles and doubles categories.

Alexander Zverev won the **Men's Singles** title, securing the **first Grand Slam title of his career**.

The German star defeated **Flavio Cobolli of Italy** in a thrilling five-set final.

The victory ended Zverev's long wait for a Grand Slam trophy after previously losing three Grand Slam finals.

Mirra Andreeva won the **Women's Singles** title, claiming her maiden Grand Slam championship.

The 19-year-old Russian defeated **Maja Chwalińska of Poland** in straight sets to lift the **Suzanne-Lenglen Cup**.

Andreeva became one of the youngest French Open women's champions in recent years

205. In 2026, which driver won the Monaco Grand Prix, securing his fifth consecutive Formula One victory of the season?

A.Kimi Antonelli

B.Lewis Hamilton

C.Charles Leclerc

D.Lando Norris

E.Max Verstappen

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

Kimi Antonelli of **Mercedes** won the **Monaco Grand Prix 2026**, one of the most prestigious races in **Formula One**.

The Italian driver secured his **fifth consecutive victory of the season**, strengthening his lead in the **Formula One Drivers' Championship**.

Starting from **pole position**, Antonelli controlled the race throughout and displayed exceptional pace and composure on the streets of **Monte Carlo, Monaco**.

Detailed Explanation:

Kimi Antonelli of **Mercedes** won the **Monaco Grand Prix 2026**, one of the most prestigious races in **Formula One**.

The Italian driver secured his **fifth consecutive victory of the season**, strengthening his lead in the **Formula One Drivers' Championship**.

Starting from **pole position**, Antonelli controlled the race throughout and displayed exceptional pace and composure on the streets of **Monte Carlo, Monaco**.

A late-race red flag erased his comfortable lead and forced a standing restart, but Antonelli maintained control and successfully held off his rivals to claim victory.

Lewis Hamilton of **Ferrari** finished second and secured another podium finish.

Hamilton moved into second place early in the race after **Max Verstappen** suffered an engine failure and retired.

206. In 2026, India defeated which country 3–1 in the final to win the South Asian Football Federation (SAFF) Women's Championship and claim its record-extending sixth title?

A.Nepal

B.Sri Lanka

C.Pakistan

D.Maldives

E.Bangladesh

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

The **Indian Women's Football Team** won the **South Asian Football Federation Women's Championship 2026** by defeating **Bangladesh 3-1** in the final held at **Pandit Jawaharlal Nehru Stadium, Margao, Goa**.

With this victory, India secured a **record-extending sixth South Asian Football Federation Women's Championship title**.

The triumph ended India's **seven-year wait** for the championship, having last won the title in **2019**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Indian Women's Football Team** won the **South Asian Football Federation Women's Championship 2026** by defeating **Bangladesh 3-1** in the final held at **Pandit Jawaharlal Nehru Stadium, Margao, Goa**.

With this victory, India secured a **record-extending sixth South Asian Football Federation Women's Championship title**.

The triumph ended India's **seven-year wait** for the championship, having last won the title in **2019**.

India finished runners-up in the previous two editions before reclaiming the regional crown in 2026.

India took the lead through **Pyari Xaxa** in the **42nd minute**.
Bangladesh equalised through **Ritu Porna Chakma** in the **45+1 minute**.
Sanfida Nongrum restored India's lead just **40 seconds into the second half (46th minute)**.
Substitute **Lynda Kom Serto** scored in the **82nd minute** to seal a **3-1 victory** for India.

207. In 2026, India defeated which country in the final to win the Men's Under-18 Asia Cup title?

A.Japan
B.China
C.Malaysia
D.South Korea
E.Pakistan

Answer: A

Short Explanation:
India emerged as the champions of the **Men's Under-18 Asia Cup 2026** after defeating host nation **Japan** by **4-1** in the final held at **Kakamigahara, Japan**.
The young Indian team delivered a dominant performance in the **Gold Medal Match** to secure the continental title.
India showcased excellent consistency, attacking strength, and defensive discipline throughout the tournament.

Detailed Explanation:
India emerged as the champions of the **Men's Under-18 Asia Cup 2026** after defeating host nation **Japan** by **4-1** in the final held at **Kakamigahara, Japan**.
The young Indian team delivered a dominant performance in the **Gold Medal Match** to secure the continental title.
India showcased excellent consistency, attacking strength, and defensive discipline throughout the tournament.
Facing Japan in front of the home crowd, India maintained control of the match from the opening stages and converted key scoring opportunities effectively.
The Indian defence successfully restricted Japan's attacking threats while the forwards capitalized on scoring chances.
The victory capped an impressive tournament campaign for India and reaffirmed its strength in Asian youth hockey.
The final featured the two strongest teams of the tournament, with India emerging victorious through disciplined defending and effective attacking play.
India finished the tournament undefeated and **secured the coveted continental championship trophy.**

208. In 2026, veteran Malayalam actor Salim Kumar, who passed away at the age of 56, had won the National Film Award for Best Actor in 2010 for which film?

A.Perumazhakkalam
B.Kerala Cafe
C.Adaminte Makan Abu
D.Achanurangatha Veedu
E.Arabikkatha

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

Veteran Malayalam actor and **National Film Award winner Salim Kumar** passed away at the age of **56** in **Kochi**.

Salim Kumar was born on **10 October 1969** in **Chittattukara**.

Apart from Malayalam films, he also appeared in several **Tamil** and **Odia** films.

He won the **National Film Award for Best Actor** in **2010** for his outstanding performance in **Adaminte Makan Abu**.

He received the **Kerala State Film Award for Second Best Actor** for **Achanurangatha Veedu in 2005**.

Detailed Explanation:

Veteran Malayalam actor and **National Film Award winner Salim Kumar** passed away at the age of **56** in **Kochi**.

Salim Kumar was born on **10 October 1969** in **Chittattukara**.

He began his artistic career as a **mimicry artist** and **television comedian** before entering the film industry.

He made his **Malayalam film debut** with **Ishtamanu Nooru Vattam in 1997**.

During his career, Salim Kumar acted in **more than 300 films** and became one of the most popular **comic actors** in **Malayalam cinema**.

Apart from Malayalam films, he also appeared in several **Tamil** and **Odia** films.

He won the **National Film Award for Best Actor** in **2010** for his outstanding performance in **Adaminte Makan Abu**.

He received the **Kerala State Film Award for Second Best Actor** for ***A*chanurangatha Veedu in 2005**.

209. In 2026, Balwinder Singh Dhaliwal ("Baba Dhaliwal"), who passed away at the age of 67, won a bronze medal in shot put at which edition of the Asian Games?

A.1978 Asian Games

B.1982 Asian Games

C.1986 Asian Games

D.1990 Asian Games

E.1994 Asian Games

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Balwinder Singh Dhaliwal, popularly known as **"Baba Dhaliwal"**, passed away in **Chandigarh** at the age of **67**.

He was a renowned **shot put athlete**, **Asian Games medalist**, and recipient of the prestigious **Arjuna Award**.

Balwinder Singh Dhaliwal was conferred the **Arjuna Award in 1987** for his outstanding contribution to Indian athletics.

He was a **10-time National Champion** in shot put, dominating the event from **1981 to 1992**.

Detailed Explanation:

Balwinder Singh Dhaliwal, popularly known as **"Baba Dhaliwal"**, passed away in **Chandigarh** at the age of **67**.

He was a renowned **shot put athlete**, **Asian Games medalist**, and recipient of the prestigious **Arjuna Award**.

Balwinder Singh Dhaliwal was conferred the **Arjuna Award in 1987** for his outstanding contribution to Indian athletics.
He was a **10-time National Champion** in shot put, dominating the event from **1981 to 1992**.
He won a **Bronze Medal** in Shot Put at the **1982 Asian Games**.
At the **Asian Athletics Championships**, he secured a **Silver Medal in 1983**, a **Gold Medal in 1985**, and a **Bronze Medal in 1987**.
In **1986**, he created an **Asian Record** in shot put with a throw of **18.71 metres** at an international meet held in **New Delhi**.
His achievements made him one of the **most successful Indian shot put athletes** of his era.
He was honoured with the **Maharaja Ranjit Singh Award in 1983** for excellence in sports.

210. In 2026, consider the following statements regarding Government Securities (G-Secs) and capital gains taxation:

1. **Government Securities (G-Secs) are tradable debt instruments issued by the Central Government and State Governments.**
2. **Long-Term Capital Gains (LTCG) on listed G-Secs arise when they are held for more than 12 months.**
3. **Short-Term Capital Gains (STCG) on unlisted G-Secs arise when they are held for up to 24 months.**

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

A.1 only
B.1 and 2 only
C.2 and 3 only
D.All are correct
E.3 only
Answer: D
Government Securities (G-Secs) are **tradable debt instruments** issued by the Central Government and State Governments.
The **Bank for International Settlements (BIS)** is an international financial institution owned by central banks and serves as a forum for global monetary and financial cooperation.
Long-Term Capital Gains (LTCG) arise when **listed G-Secs are held for more than 12 months** and unlisted G-Secs for more than 24 months.
Short-Term Capital Gains (STCG) arise when **listed G-Secs are held for up to 12 months** and unlisted G-Secs for up to 24 months.

211. In June 2026, the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) introduced a special USD-Rupee Forex Swap Facility for fresh FCNR(B) deposits. What is the minimum tenor prescribed for these deposits under the scheme?

A.1 year
B.2 years
C.3 years
D.7 years
E.10 years
Answer: C
Short Explanation:

The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** introduced two special **USD-Rupee Forex Swap Facilities** to attract foreign currency inflows and support external financing in India.

The announcement followed the **Monetary Policy Statement** of RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra on **5 June 2026**.

The **first facility** is for fresh **Foreign Currency Non-Resident (Bank) [FCNR(B)] deposits**, while the **second facility** is for eligible **External Commercial Borrowings (ECBs)** and **Overseas Foreign Currency Borrowings (OFCBs)**.

Under the FCNR(B) Swap Facility, fresh deposits must have a **minimum tenor of 3 years** and a **maximum tenor of 5 years**. **Authorised Dealer (AD) Category-I Banks** can avail the swap facility for fresh FCNR(B) deposits raised in any **freely convertible currency**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** introduced two special **USD-Rupee Forex Swap Facilities** to attract foreign currency inflows and support external financing in India.

The announcement followed the **Monetary Policy Statement** of RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra on **5 June 2026**.

The **first facility** is for fresh **Foreign Currency Non-Resident (Bank) [FCNR(B)] deposits**, while the **second facility** is for eligible **External Commercial Borrowings (ECBs)** and **Overseas Foreign Currency Borrowings (OFCBs)**.

Under the FCNR(B) Swap Facility, fresh deposits must have a **minimum tenor of 3 years** and a **maximum tenor of 5 years**. **Authorised Dealer (AD) Category-I Banks** can avail the swap facility for fresh FCNR(B) deposits raised in any **freely convertible currency**.

Although deposits may be mobilised in different currencies, the swap transaction with RBI will be **conducted only in US Dollars (USD)**.

The swap tenor will correspond to the tenor of the underlying FCNR(B) deposit and will **range between 3 years and 5 years**.

The swap will be **conducted at par**, allowing banks to **sell US Dollars to RBI** and **repurchase the same amount** at the end of the swap period.

The FCNR(B) Forex Swap Facility became **effective immediately** and will remain available until **16 October 2026** for deposits mobilised up to **30 September 2026**.

RBI has also introduced a USD-Rupee Forex Swap Facility for eligible **ECBs raised by Public Sector Undertakings (PSUs)** and **OFCBs raised by banks**.

The ECB swap facility is available for External Commercial Borrowings with an **average maturity of 3 years and above**.

212. In June 2026, which organization made its first direct investment in India's green hydrogen sector by committing funds to Hygenco Green Energies Private Limited?

A.Asian Development Bank (ADB)

B.International Finance Corporation (IFC)

C.New Development Bank (NDB)

D.Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank (AIIB)

E.International Monetary Fund (IMF)

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The **International Finance Corporation (IFC)**, the private-sector investment arm of the World Bank Group, along with global investors, committed a total investment of approximately **USD 105 million** in **Hygenco Green Energies Private Limited**.

The investment aims to accelerate the development of **Green Hydrogen projects in India** and support the country's **clean energy transition**.

This transaction marks the **first direct green hydrogen investment in India** by **IFC, Siemens, and Fullerton**.

The **IFC committed a total of USD 50 million**, including **USD 25 million from its own account**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **International Finance Corporation (IFC)**, the private-sector investment arm of the World Bank Group, along with global investors, committed a total investment of approximately **USD 105 million** in **Hygenco Green Energies Private Limited**.

The investment aims to accelerate the development of **Green Hydrogen projects in India** and support the country's **clean energy transition**.

This transaction marks the **first direct green hydrogen investment in India** by **IFC, Siemens, and Fullerton**.

The **IFC committed a total of USD 50 million**, including **USD 25 million from its own account**.

IFC is also managing **two blended finance facilities** to reduce investment risks and attract greater private-sector participation in the green hydrogen sector.

The **Clean Technology Fund (CTF) invested USD 20 million** in the project.

The CTF operates under the **Climate Investment Funds (CIF)** framework and supports climate-friendly technologies.

The **Frontier Opportunities Fund**, backed by the **Government of Germany**, contributed **USD 5 million**.

Siemens committed an investment of **USD 25 million** towards the initiative.

213. As of 31 March 2026, by what percentage did the Reserve Bank of India's (RBI) balance sheet expand compared to the previous year?

A.10.6%

B.15.8%

C.18.4%

D.20.6%

E.26.4%

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** reported that its **balance sheet expanded by 20.6% to**

₹91.97 lakh crore as of **31 March 2026**, compared to ₹76.25 lakh crore a year earlier.
The growth in the RBI's balance sheet was primarily driven by **increases in domestic investments, gold holdings, and foreign investments**.
On the assets side, **domestic investments increased by 44.9%** during FY26.
The value of RBI's **gold holdings rose significantly by 63.8%**.
Foreign investments registered a **growth of 7.9%** during the year.
As of 31 March 2026, **domestic assets constituted 29.1%** of the RBI's total assets.
Detailed Explanation:
The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** reported that its **balance sheet expanded by 20.6% to ₹91.97 lakh crore** as of **31 March 2026**, compared to ₹76.25 lakh crore a year earlier.
The growth in the RBI's balance sheet was primarily driven by **increases in domestic investments, gold holdings, and foreign investments**.
On the assets side, **domestic investments increased by 44.9%** during FY26.
The value of RBI's **gold holdings rose significantly by 63.8%**.
Foreign investments registered a **growth of 7.9%** during the year.
As of 31 March 2026, **domestic assets constituted 29.1%** of the RBI's total assets.
Foreign currency assets, gold (including gold deposits and gold held in India), and **loans and advances to financial institutions outside India** together accounted for **70.9% of total assets**.
The RBI recorded an **overall surplus of ₹2.87 lakh crore** during FY26.
The surplus **increased by 6.7%** compared to ₹2.69 lakh crore reported in FY25.
RBI's **total income increased by 26.4%** during FY26 despite a substantial rise in expenditure.

214. In June 2026, the Government of India placed certain silver imports under the restricted category. Which authority's import authorisation has been made mandatory for these imports?
A.Directorate General of Foreign Trade (DGFT)
B.Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI)
C.Reserve Bank of India (RBI)
D.Central Board of Indirect Taxes and Customs (CBIC)
E.India International Bullion Exchange (IIBX)
Answer: A
Short Explanation:
The **Government of India** has **tightened silver import regulations** by making a **valid import authorisation** from the **Directorate General of Foreign Trade (DGFT)** mandatory for specified import channels.
Imports of **silver grains**, **silver powder**, **semi-manufactured silver forms**, and **silver with 99.9% purity** have been placed under the **restricted category**.
The new restrictions apply to imports made through **RBI-nominated agencies**, **DGFT-**

approved agencies, and **qualified jewellers** importing silver via the **India International Bullion Exchange (IIBX)**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Government of India** has **tightened silver import regulations** by making a **valid import authorisation** from the **Directorate General of Foreign Trade (DGFT)** mandatory for specified import channels.

Imports of **silver grains**, **silver powder**, **semi-manufactured silver forms**, and **silver with 99.9% purity** have been placed under the **restricted category**.

The new restrictions apply to imports made through **RBI-nominated agencies**, **DGFT-approved agencies**, and **qualified jewellers** importing silver via the **India International Bullion Exchange (IIBX)**.

India's silver imports surged to a **record USD 12 billion** in **FY 2025–26**, compared to USD 4.8 billion in the previous financial year.

In **April 2026**, silver imports **increased by 157% year-on-year**, reflecting a sharp rise in import volumes.

India primarily imports silver from the **United Arab Emirates (UAE)**, **United Kingdom (UK)**, and **China**.

215. In June 2026, the Ministry of Corporate Affairs (MCA) allowed companies to invest up to what percentage of their annual CSR expenditure in Zero Coupon Zero Principal (ZCZP) instruments issued by eligible NPOs listed on the Social Stock Exchange (SSE)?

A.5%

B.10%

C.15%

D.20%

E.25%

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The **Ministry of Corporate Affairs (MCA)** has brought **Social Stock Exchange (SSE) instruments** under the **Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) framework**.

The MCA has allowed companies to invest a portion of their CSR funds in **Zero Coupon Zero Principal (ZCZP) instruments**.

Companies can allocate **up to 10% of their annual CSR expenditure** towards subscribing to ZCZP instruments issued by eligible **Not-for-Profit Organisations (NPOs)** listed on the Social Stock Exchange (SSE).

The MCA has **amended Schedule VII of the Companies Act, 2013** to recognize subscription to ZCZP instruments as an eligible CSR activity.

The amended rules came into effect from **27 May 2026**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Ministry of Corporate Affairs (MCA)** has brought **Social Stock Exchange (SSE) instruments** under the **Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) framework**.

The MCA has allowed companies to invest a portion of their CSR funds in **Zero Coupon Zero Principal (ZCZP) instruments**.

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The MCA has **amended Schedule VII of the Companies Act, 2013** to recognize subscription to ZCZP instruments as an eligible CSR activity.

The amended rules came into effect from **27 May 2026**.

Zero Coupon Zero Principal (ZCZP) instruments are fundraising instruments that **do not offer interest payments or principal repayment**, and are designed to support social impact projects.

Only eligible **Not-for-Profit Organisations (NPOs) listed on the Social Stock Exchange (SSE)** can issue ZCZP instruments.

NPOs issuing ZCZP instruments must utilize the funds for projects with a **maximum duration of three financial years**.

Upon delisting of a ZCZP instrument, any **unspent amount must be transferred to a Schedule VII fund**.

216. In June 2026, the Ministry of Home Affairs amended the Immigration and Foreigners Rules, 2025. Under the new provisions, foreigners holding visas and seeking an extension must complete registration before the expiry of which period?

A.30 days

B.90 days

C.120 days

D.180 days

E.365 days

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

The **Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA)** has notified the **Immigration and Foreigners (Amendment) Rules, 2026**, with immediate effect.

The rules have been issued under Section 30 of the **Immigration and Foreigners Act, 2025**.

The amendment introduces **four major changes** to the **Immigration and Foreigners Rules, 2025**.

Foreigners holding visas valid for **180 days or less** and seeking an extension must now complete registration before the expiry of the 180-day period through the designated online portal or mobile application.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA)** has notified the **Immigration and Foreigners (Amendment) Rules, 2026**, with immediate effect.

The rules have been issued under Section 30 of the **Immigration and Foreigners Act, 2025**.

The amendment introduces **four major changes** to the **Immigration and Foreigners Rules, 2025**.

Foreigners holding visas valid for **180 days or less** and seeking an extension must now complete registration before the expiry of the 180-day period through the designated online portal or mobile application.

Earlier, registration was permitted within **14 days after the expiry of the 180-day period**.

Foreigners on long-term visas carrying a condition that each stay shall not exceed **180 days** must also register before the expiry of the permitted stay if they wish to remain longer. Late registration beyond the 180-day period will now be allowed only in **emergent circumstances**.

217. According to the International Renewable Energy Agency (IRENA), which country became the world's second-largest solar growth market in 2025 by surpassing the United States in annual solar capacity additions?

A.India
B.Japan
C.Germany
D.Brazil
E.Australia

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

According to the **International Renewable Energy Agency (IRENA)**, India became the **world's second-largest solar growth market** in 2025 for the first time.

India surpassed the **United States** in annual solar capacity additions during 2025.

India added more than **37 GW** of solar capacity in 2025, compared to **34 GW** added by the United States.

China remained the global leader, adding nearly **315 GW** of solar capacity during the year.

India's installed solar capacity increased from **98.5 GW in 2024** to **135.5 GW in 2025**.

Detailed Explanation:

According to the **International Renewable Energy Agency (IRENA)**, India became the **world's second-largest solar growth market** in 2025 for the first time.

India surpassed the **United States** in annual solar capacity additions during 2025.

India added more than **37 GW** of solar capacity in 2025, compared to **34 GW** added by the United States.

China remained the global leader, adding nearly **315 GW** of solar capacity during the year.

India's installed solar capacity increased from **98.5 GW in 2024** to **135.5 GW in 2025**.

The United States expanded its solar capacity from **177.6 GW** to **211.6 GW** during the same period.

Globally, solar power capacity increased by **512 GW**, rising from **1,880 GW in 2024** to **2,392 GW in 2025**.

According to the Ministry of New and Renewable Energy (MNRE), India also surpassed **Japan** to become the **world's third-largest solar power producer** in 2025

218. In June 2026, the Government of India approved the revision of the Wholesale Price Index (WPI) base year from 2011-12 to which year?

A.2018-19
B.2019-20
C.2020-21
D.2021-22
E.2022-23

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

The Government of India has approved the revision of the **Wholesale Price Index (WPI)** base year from **2011-12 to 2022-23**.

The decision was taken by the **Office of Economic Adviser (OEA)** under the **Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT)**.

The revised **WPI series (2022-23 = 100)** and three new **Producer Price Indices (PPIs)** will be released simultaneously on **15 June 2026**.

Detailed Explanation:

The Government of India has approved the revision of the **Wholesale Price Index (WPI)** base year from **2011-12 to 2022-23**.

The decision was taken by the **Office of Economic Adviser (OEA)** under the **Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT)**.

The revised **WPI series (2022-23 = 100)** and three new **Producer Price Indices (PPIs)** will be released simultaneously on **15 June 2026**.

The three new PPI series are **Output Producer Price Index (OPPI)**, **Input Producer Price Index (IPPI) (Trial Series)**, and **Service Producer Price Index (Service PPI)**.

In the first phase, the Service PPI will cover **Banking, Securities Transactions, Insurance, Management of Pension Funds, Railways, Air Passenger Transport, and Telecommunications**.

During the transition period, both **WPI and OPPI** will be compiled and released on a monthly basis.

219. In June 2026, which state police launched "Operation Delta Hunt" to crack down on illegal Bangladeshi nationals residing in the state?

A.Assam

B.West Bengal

C.Tripura

D.Gujarat

E.Odisha

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

The **Gujarat State Police** launched **"Operation Delta Hunt"**, a statewide crackdown against illegal Bangladeshi nationals residing in the state.

The operation was announced by **Harsh Sanghavi**.

Within the first **72 hours**, police arrested **362 illegal Bangladeshi nationals**, including **103 men, 188 women, and 71 children**.

More than **782 suspected individuals** were placed under interrogation for verification of their nationality and legal status.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Gujarat State Police** launched **"Operation Delta Hunt"**, a statewide crackdown against illegal Bangladeshi nationals residing in the state.

The operation was announced by **Harsh Sanghavi**.

Within the first **72 hours**, police arrested **362 illegal Bangladeshi nationals**, including **103 men, 188 women, and 71 children**.

More than **782 suspected individuals** were placed under interrogation for verification of their nationality and legal status.

The highest number of arrests were reported from **Ahmedabad City (155)**, followed by **Surat City (84)**, **Ahmedabad Rural (34)**, **East Kutch-Gandhinagar (13)**, and **Bharuch (12)**.

The operation targets not only illegal immigrants but also networks and individuals providing shelter, documentation, or other assistance to them.

The Gujarat Government stated that all confirmed illegal Bangladeshi nationals will be deported to Bangladesh following legal procedures.

220. During the 2026–27 Rabi Marketing Season (RMS), at what Minimum Support Price (MSP) did the Food Corporation of India (FCI) and state agencies procure wheat?

A.₹2,275 per quintal

B.₹2,350 per quintal

C.₹2,425 per quintal

D.₹2,500 per quintal

E.₹2,575 per quintal

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The **Government of India procured 35 million tonnes (MT)** of wheat during the **2026-27 Rabi Marketing Season (RMS)**, marking a **5-year high**.

Wheat procurement increased by **17% year-on-year**, compared to **30 MT** procured during the **2025-26 season**.

The procurement exceeded the revised seasonal target of **34.5 MT**.

Procurement operations have been completed in all major wheat-producing states.

The **Food Corporation of India (FCI)** and state procurement agencies purchased wheat at the **Minimum Support Price (MSP) of ₹2,425 per quintal** for the 2026-27 season.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Government of India procured 35 million tonnes (MT)** of wheat during the **2026-27 Rabi Marketing Season (RMS)**, marking a **5-year high**.

Wheat procurement increased by **17% year-on-year**, compared to **30 MT** procured during the **2025-26 season**.

The procurement exceeded the revised seasonal target of **34.5 MT**.

Procurement operations have been completed in all major wheat-producing states.

The **Food Corporation of India (FCI)** and state procurement agencies purchased wheat at the **Minimum Support Price (MSP) of ₹2,425 per quintal** for the 2026-27 season.

The MSP for 2026-27 was increased by **₹160 per quintal** over the previous year's MSP of **₹2,275 per quintal**.

Higher procurement was supported by mandi prices remaining below the MSP, encouraging

farmers to sell their produce to government procurement agencies.

India's wheat production for the **2025-26 crop year (July–June)** stood at **120.65 million tonnes** despite localized crop damage caused by unseasonal rainfall and hailstorms

221. Under the Vibrant Village Programme (VVP), India's first Model Border Village is being developed at which village in Ladakh?

A.Chumur

B.Hanle

C.Demchok

D.Nyoma

E.Durbuk

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

Lieutenant Governor **Vinai Kumar Saxena** laid the foundation stone for **India's first Model Border Village** at **Chumur** under the **Vibrant Village Programme (VVP)**.

Chumur is a remote settlement located at an altitude of **16,700 feet** along the **India–China border** in Ladakh.

The village has **24 households** with a population of **91 people**, primarily engaged in **Pashmina rearing and production**.

Detailed Explanation:

Lieutenant Governor **Vinai Kumar Saxena** laid the foundation stone for **India's first Model Border Village** at **Chumur** under the **Vibrant Village Programme (VVP)**.

Chumur is a remote settlement located at an altitude of **16,700 feet** along the **India–China border** in Ladakh.

The village has **24 households** with a population of **91 people**, primarily engaged in **Pashmina rearing and production**.

The project is the first among **10 border villages** identified for development as Model Border Villages during the first phase of the Vibrant Village Programme in Ladakh.

The initiative is based on four pillars: **Infrastructure Development, Employment and Livelihood Creation, All-Weather Functionality, and Civilian-Defence Integration**.

Under the project, **24 modern climate-resilient houses** will be constructed for local residents

222. In June 2026, consider the following statements regarding the newly inaugurated Regional Meteorological Centre (RMC) in Lucknow:

The centre was inaugurated by Union Minister Dr. Jitendra Singh and Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath.

The RMC will provide weather forecasting and climate services only for Uttar Pradesh.

Under Mission Mausam, an additional 50 Doppler Weather Radars (DWRs) are planned across India.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

A.1 and 3 only

B.2 and 3 only

C.1 and 2 only

D.1 only

E.1, 2 and 3

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

Union Minister **Shri Jitendra Singh** and Chief minister of Uttar Pradesh, S**hri Yogi Adityanath** inaugurated the new **Regional Meteorological Centre (RMC)** in Lucknow, Uttar pradesh.

The centre will strengthen weather forecasting, climate services, and disaster management across **Uttar Pradesh, Uttarakhand, and adjoining regions**.

India's network of **Doppler Weather Radars (DWRs)** has expanded from **17 in 2014 to 50 operational radars** at present.

Under **Mission Mausam**, an additional **50 Doppler Weather Radars** are planned, taking the total close to 100 in the coming years.

Detailed Explanation:

Union Minister **Shri Jitendra Singh** and Chief minister of Uttar Pradesh, S**hri Yogi Adityanath** inaugurated the new **Regional Meteorological Centre (RMC)** in Lucknow, Uttar pradesh.

The centre will strengthen weather forecasting, climate services, and disaster management across **Uttar Pradesh, Uttarakhand, and adjoining regions**.

It will provide localized weather forecasts, early warnings, and climate-related services to government agencies, farmers, aviation authorities, and the public.

The facility is expected to improve preparedness for floods, thunderstorms, lightning, heatwaves, cloudbursts, avalanches, and landslides.

The inauguration marks an important step towards decentralizing India's weather forecasting system.

India's network of **Doppler Weather Radars (DWRs)** has expanded from **17 in 2014 to 50 operational radars** at present.

Under **Mission Mausam**, an additional **50 Doppler Weather Radars** are planned, taking the total close to 100 in the coming years.

Uttar Pradesh's meteorological infrastructure has expanded significantly, with **Automatic Weather Stations increasing from 59 to 107**, **Automatic Rain Gauge Stations from 132 to 140**, and **Lightning Sensors from 0 to 7**.

223. In June 2026, consider the following statements regarding the Pradhan Mantri Surakshit Matritva Abhiyaan (PMSMA):

PMSMA was launched on 9 June 2016 by the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare.

Free antenatal care services under PMSMA are provided on the 9th day of every month to pregnant women in their second and third trimesters.

The Extended PMSMA Strategy was launched in January 2022 for continuous monitoring of high-risk pregnancies until safe delivery.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

A.1 only
B.1 and 2 only
C.2 and 3 only
D.1 and 3 only
E.1, 2 and 3
Answer: E
Short Explanation:
The **Pradhan Mantri Surakshit Matritva Abhiyaan (PMSMA)** has completed **10 years** of providing quality antenatal healthcare services to pregnant women across India.
PMSMA was launched on **9 June 2016** by the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare to ensure safe pregnancy and childbirth outcomes.
Under PMSMA, free antenatal care services are provided to pregnant women in their **second and third trimesters** on the **9th day of every month** at designated government health facilities.
To strengthen follow-up care, the government launched the **Extended PMSMA Strategy** in **January 2022** for continuous monitoring of high-risk pregnancies until safe delivery.
Detailed Explanation:
The **Pradhan Mantri Surakshit Matritva Abhiyaan (PMSMA)** has completed **10 years** of providing quality antenatal healthcare services to pregnant women across India.
PMSMA was launched on **9 June 2016** by the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare to ensure safe pregnancy and childbirth outcomes.
Over the last decade, more than **7.5 crore pregnant women** have received specialized antenatal care services under the programme.
Under PMSMA, free antenatal care services are provided to pregnant women in their **second and third trimesters** on the **9th day of every month** at designated government health facilities.
The programme focuses on the early identification and management of **High-Risk Pregnancies (HRPs)** to reduce maternal and neonatal complications.
Pregnant women receive services such as clinical examinations, diagnostic tests, ultrasonography, essential medicines, nutritional counselling, and birth preparedness guidance.
The scheme screens women for **25 high-risk conditions**, including severe anaemia, gestational diabetes, hypertension, HIV, syphilis, hypothyroidism, tuberculosis, and multiple pregnancies.
To strengthen follow-up care, the government launched the **Extended PMSMA Strategy** in **January 2022** for continuous monitoring of high-risk pregnancies until safe delivery

224. In June 2026, the BRICS Agriculture Working Group and Agriculture Ministers Meeting under India's BRICS Presidency is being hosted in which state?
A.Gujarat
B.Maharashtra
C.Madhya Pradesh

D.Rajasthan

E.Uttar Pradesh

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

In**dore, Madhya Pradesh, w**ill host the **BRICS Agriculture Working Group and Agriculture Ministers Meeting** from **9–13 June 2026** under India's BRICS Presidency.

The event will comprise a **three-day Agriculture Working Group Meeting (9–11 June)** followed by a **two-day BRICS Agriculture Ministers Meeting (12–13 June)**.

The announcement was made by Union Agriculture Minister **Shivraj Singh Chouhan**.

Detailed Explanation:

In**dore, Madhya Pradesh, w**ill host the **BRICS Agriculture Working Group and Agriculture Ministers Meeting** from **9–13 June 2026** under India's BRICS Presidency.

The event will comprise a **three-day Agriculture Working Group Meeting (9–11 June)** followed by a **two-day BRICS Agriculture Ministers Meeting (12–13 June)**.

The announcement was made by Union Agriculture Minister **Shivraj Singh Chouhan**.

The meeting will bring together representatives and agriculture ministers from BRICS member nations to discuss key agricultural challenges and opportunities.

Major areas of discussion include **food security, nutrition security, farmer welfare, climate-resilient agriculture, smart farming, digital agriculture, artificial intelligence (AI), robotics, agricultural trade, and supply chain resilience**.

The discussions are expected to generate policy recommendations to improve agricultural productivity, sustainability, and resilience against climate change.

BRICS countries account for nearly **50% of the world's population**, around **42% of global agricultural land**, and over **42% of global agricultural production**.

Approximately **70% of the world's small and marginal farmers** reside in BRICS nations

225. As of 2026, India's continued market access to the European Union (EU) beyond September 2026 for aquaculture products, honey, eggs, and animal casings was secured under which regulation?

A.Regulation (EU) 2020/852

B.Regulation (EU) 2021/1119

C.Regulation (EU) 2024/1689

D.Regulation (EU) 2023/955

E.Commission Implementing Regulation (EU) 2026/1189

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

India has secured continued market access to the **European Union (EU)** for **aquaculture products, honey, eggs, and animal casings** beyond **September 2026**.

The approval follows amendments to the EU's import regulations aimed at addressing concerns related to **Antimicrobial Resistance (AMR)** and strengthening food safety standards.

India has been included in the list of authorized exporting countries under **Commission Implementing Regulation (EU) 2026/1189**, which updates **Regulation (EU) 2021/405**.

Detailed Explanation:

India has secured continued market access to the **European Union (EU)** for **aquaculture products, honey, eggs, and animal casings** beyond **September 2026**.

The approval follows amendments to the EU's import regulations aimed at addressing concerns related to **Antimicrobial Resistance (AMR)** and strengthening food safety standards.

India has been included in the list of authorized exporting countries under **Commission Implementing Regulation (EU) 2026/1189**, which updates **Regulation (EU) 2021/405**.

The decision ensures uninterrupted exports of specified animal-origin products from India to one of the world's largest and most lucrative markets.

The approval reflects the EU's confidence in India's food safety, inspection, and certification systems.

The EU is a major export destination for India's agricultural and marine products, making the decision significant for exporters and producers.

India's exports of fish and fishery products to the EU are currently valued at approximately **USD 1.59 billion**

226. In June 2026, which Indian Air Force officer and Gaganyaan astronaut-designate was conferred the Kirti Chakra during the Defence Investiture Ceremony 2026?

A.Group Captain Angad Pratap

B.Group Captain Ajit Krishnan

C.Wing Commander Shubhanshu Shukla

D.Air Commodore Prasanth Balakrishnan Nair

E.Group Captain Prashanth Nair

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

President Droupadi Murmu conferred **07 Kirti Chakras**, **15 Vir Chakras**, and **29 Shaurya Chakras** during Phase-I of the **Defence Investiture Ceremony 2026** held at **Rashtrapati Bhawan, New Delhi** on **8 June 2026**.

The **gallantry awards** were presented to personnel of the **Armed Forces**, **Central Armed Police Forces (CAPFs)**, and **State/Union Territory Police** for displaying exceptional courage, bravery, and devotion to duty.

Among the awardees, **Air Commodore Prasanth Balakrishnan Nair** of the **Indian Air Force (IAF)**, a **Gaganyaan astronaut-designate**, was honoured with the **Kirti Chakra**.

Detailed Explanation:

President Droupadi Murmu conferred **07 Kirti Chakras**, **15 Vir Chakras**, and **29 Shaurya Chakras** during Phase-I of the **Defence Investiture Ceremony 2026** held at **Rashtrapati Bhawan, New Delhi** on **8 June 2026**.

The **gallantry awards** were presented to personnel of the **Armed Forces**, **Central**

Armed Police Forces (CAPFs), and **State/Union Territory Police** for displaying exceptional courage, bravery, and devotion to duty.

Among the awardees, **Air Commodore Prasanth Balakrishnan Nair** of the **Indian Air Force (IAF)**, a **Gaganyaan astronaut-designate**, was honoured with the **Kirti Chakra**.

Air Commodore Prasanth Balakrishnan Nair served as a **backup astronaut for the Axiom-4 mission** to the International Space Station (ISS) in June 2025 and is one of the selected astronauts for India's **Gaganyaan Human Spaceflight Programme**.

The **Kirti Chakra** is India's **second-highest peacetime gallantry award**, ranking below the **Ashoka Chakra**, which is the highest peacetime gallantry award.

The Kirti Chakra was **instituted in 1952** and is awarded for courage, distinguished service, and devotion to duty.

The **Vir Chakra** is one of India's important wartime gallantry awards, while the **Shaurya Chakra** is a **peacetime gallantry award**.

Of the 07 Kirti Chakras, **02 were awarded posthumously** to **Sepoy Janjal Pravin Prabhakar** and **Lieutenant Shashank Tiwari**.

227. In June 2026, the Ministry of Defence approved the establishment of its first large-scale solar power project with an integrated Battery Energy Storage System (BESS) on defence land. What is the planned capacity of this solar power project?

A.100 MW

B.150 MW

C.200 MW

D.250 MW

E.500 MW

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

Raksha Mantri Rajnath Singh approved the establishment of a **250 MW Solar Power Project** with an integrated **Battery Energy Storage System (BESS)** at **Sitapur,**Uttar Pradesh **(UP)**.

The project will be developed on approximately **850 acres** of **vacant defence land** located in the **Sitapur Ex-Cantonment area** of **Uttar Pradesh**.

This is the **first-of-its-kind project** undertaken by the **Ministry of Defence (MoD)** involving a **large-scale solar power generation facility** with integrated BESS support on defence land.

Detailed Explanation:

Raksha Mantri Rajnath Singh approved the establishment of a **250 MW Solar Power Project** with an integrated **Battery Energy Storage System (BESS)** at **Sitapur,**Uttar Pradesh **(UP)**.

The project will be developed on approximately **850 acres** of **vacant defence land** located in the **Sitapur Ex-Cantonment area** of **Uttar Pradesh**.

This is the **first-of-its-kind project** undertaken by the **Ministry of Defence (MoD)** involving a **large-scale solar power generation**

facility with integrated BESS support on defence land.

The initiative aims to **enhance energy security**, **promote renewable energy**, and ensure **optimal utilisation** of vacant defence land.

The project reflects the **Government of India's commitment** to **clean energy**, **environmental sustainability**, and reducing dependence on conventional energy sources.

The solar project is expected to **strengthen long-term energy security** for the **Defence Forces** and **reduce reliance** on conventional grid power.

The initiative will help achieve **significant savings** in government expenditure by **lowering the cost of power procurement** for defence establishments over the project's lifecycle.

NTPC Limited has been entrusted with **implementing the project** through a **competitive bidding process** to secure optimal energy pricing

228. Who was appointed as the Managing Director (MD) of Indraprastha Gas Limited (IGL) with effect from 5 June 2026?

A.Kamal Kishore Chatiwal

B.Sandeep Kumar Gupta

C.Kumar Shanker

D.Sanjay Kumar

E.Manoj Jain

Answer: C

Kumar Shanker was appointed as the **Managing Director (MD)** of **Indraprastha Gas Limited (IGL)** with effect from **5 June 2026**.

He succeeded **Kamal Kishore Chatiwal**, who returned to **GAIL (India) Limited** after completing a three-year tenure at IGL.

Prior to this appointment, Kumar Shanker served as the **Managing Director** of **Maharashtra Natural Gas Limited (MNGL), Pune**.

229. Who was unanimously elected as the President of Bharatiya Vidya Bhavan on 7 June 2026?

A.Surendralal Mehta

B.Banwarilal Purohit

C.Deepak Parekh

D.N. R. Narayana Murthy

E.Kumar Mangalam Birla

Answer: B

Banwarilal Purohit was unanimously elected **President** of **Bharatiya Vidya Bhavan** on **7 June 2026** during a joint meeting of the Executive Committee and the Board of Trustees.

Deepak Parekh, a renowned veteran of India's finance sector, was elected as the **Vice-President** of **Bharatiya Vidya Bhavan** on the same date.

The election was conducted following the resignation of **Surendralal Mehta** from the post of President due to health reasons

230. Which organization under the Department of Science & Technology (DST)

extended support to TIEA Connectors Pvt. Ltd. for the commercialization of airborne connectors and EV charging connectors?

A.Technology Development Board (TDB)

B.Council of Scientific and Industrial Research (CSIR)

C.Technology Information, Forecasting and Assessment Council (TIFAC)

D.Biotechnology Industry Research Assistance Council (BIRAC)

E.Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO)

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

The **Technology Development Board (TDB)** under the **Department of Science & Technology (DST)**, Government of India, has extended support to **TIEA Connectors Pvt. Ltd., Bengaluru** for the project titled **"Commercialization of Airborne Connectors for Aerospace, Defense & Charging Connectors for EV."**

The project aims to strengthen India's **indigenous capabilities** in the design and manufacture of **high-reliability electrical interconnect systems** for aerospace, defence, space, and electric mobility sectors.

Electrical connectors are critical components that ensure uninterrupted transmission of **power, signals, and data** in electronic and electromechanical systems.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Technology Development Board (TDB)** under the **Department of Science & Technology (DST)**, Government of India, has extended support to **TIEA Connectors Pvt. Ltd., Bengaluru** for the project titled **"Commercialization of Airborne Connectors for Aerospace, Defense & Charging Connectors for EV."**

The project aims to strengthen India's **indigenous capabilities** in the design and manufacture of **high-reliability electrical interconnect systems** for aerospace, defence, space, and electric mobility sectors.

Electrical connectors are critical components that ensure uninterrupted transmission of **power, signals, and data** in electronic and electromechanical systems.

In sectors such as aerospace, defence, and space, connectors must perform reliably under **extreme vibration, shock, temperature variations, and environmental stress conditions**.

The technology developed by TIEA Connectors Pvt. Ltd. is based on an **advanced vibration-resistant contact architecture** designed for stable electrical performance in highly dynamic environments.

231. Which NASA mission, launched in November 2013 to study the Martian atmosphere and climate evolution, was officially ended after losing contact with the spacecraft in December 2025?

A.Juno

B.Perseverance

C.Curiosity

D.MAVEN

E.InSight

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

The **National Aeronautics and Space Administration (NASA) officially ended the MAVEN mission** after losing contact with the spacecraft on **6 December 2025**, and concluded after nearly six months of radio silence that the orbiter could not be recovered.

MAVEN (Mars Atmosphere and Volatile Evolution) was launched in **November 2013** and successfully entered orbit around Mars on **21 September 2014**.

The mission was designed to **study the Martian atmosphere, ionosphere, and interactions with the Sun**, helping scientists understand how Mars transformed from a warm and wet planet into the cold and dry world seen today.

Detailed Explanation:

The **National Aeronautics and Space Administration (NASA) officially ended the MAVEN mission** after losing contact with the spacecraft on **6 December 2025**, and concluded after nearly six months of radio silence that the orbiter could not be recovered.

MAVEN (Mars Atmosphere and Volatile Evolution) was launched in **November 2013** and successfully entered orbit around Mars on **21 September 2014**.

The mission was designed to **study the Martian atmosphere, ionosphere, and interactions with the Sun**, helping scientists understand how Mars transformed from a warm and wet planet into the cold and dry world seen today.

The primary objective of MAVEN was to **investigate the loss of Mars' atmosphere to space** and its implications for the planet's climate, liquid water, and habitability.

Although originally planned as a one-year mission, **MAVEN operated successfully for more than 11 years**, exceeding its primary mission duration by over a decade.

Before communication was lost, telemetry data showed that **all spacecraft subsystems were functioning normally**.

After passing behind Mars on 6 December 2025, **NASA's Deep Space Network (DSN)** failed to detect a signal from the spacecraft.

Analysis of recorded radio signals indicated that **MAVEN had entered safe mode and was rotating at an unusually high rate**, suggesting a disruption in its orbital trajectory.

The anomaly review board concluded that the **excessive rotation caused the spacecraft's batteries to drain**, leading to a loss of power in the communication system and rendering the spacecraft unrecoverable.

NASA convened an **Anomaly Review Board in February 2026** to evaluate recovery efforts and assess the spacecraft's condition.

232. In June 2026, consider the following statements regarding the Zojila Tunnel:

The Zojila Tunnel is a 13.153 km road tunnel being constructed at an altitude of about 3,000 metres above sea level.
The tunnel will provide all-weather connectivity between Baltal (J&K) and Meenamarg in Ladakh.
It is being developed by the Border Roads Organisation (BRO) under the Ministry of Defence.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

A.1 and 2 only
B.2 and 3 only
C.1 and 3 only
D.1 only
E.1, 2 and 3

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

The **Zojila Tunnel** is a **13.153-kilometre road tunnel** being constructed in the Himalayas at an altitude of approximately **11,578 feet** (about 3,000 metres above sea level).

The **final breakthrough** of the tunnel is scheduled for **9 June 2026**, while **full operational completion** is expected by **February 2028**.

The tunnel is being developed to provide **all-weather road connectivity** between **Baltal near Sonamarg (Jammu & Kashmir)** and **Meenamarg in the Drass-Kargil region of Ladakh**.

The project is being executed by **Megha Engineering & Infrastructures Limited (MEIL)** for the **National Highways and Infrastructure Development Corporation Limited (NHIDCL)**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Zojila Tunnel** is a **13.153-kilometre road tunnel** being constructed in the Himalayas at an altitude of approximately **11,578 feet** (about 3,000 metres above sea level).

The **final breakthrough** of the tunnel is scheduled for **9 June 2026**, while **full operational completion** is expected by **February 2028**.

The tunnel is being developed to provide **all-weather road connectivity** between **Baltal near Sonamarg (Jammu & Kashmir)** and **Meenamarg in the Drass-Kargil region of Ladakh**.

The existing **Zojila Pass route** remains closed for several months every year due to **heavy snowfall and avalanches**, making year-round connectivity difficult.

The project is being executed by **Megha Engineering & Infrastructures Limited (MEIL)** for the **National Highways and Infrastructure Development Corporation Limited (NHIDCL)**.

Construction of the Zojila Tunnel began in **October 2020** at an estimated cost of **₹6,809.69 crore** (around USD 815 million).

Upon completion, the Zojila Tunnel will become the **world's longest single-tube bi-directional road tunnel** at such a high altitude.

233. In June 2026, who became World No. 1 in the 57 kg category in the World Boxing Rankings?

A.Minakshi Hooda

B.Priya Ghanghas

C.Preeti

D.Nikhat Zareen

E.Jaismine Lamboria

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

India maintained a strong presence in the **World Boxing Rankings** released on **4 June 2026**, covering performances from **July 2024 to May 2026**.

Indian boxers featured in the **top 10 of 9 out of 10 women's weight categories** and **8 out of 10 men's weight categories**.

India ranked **3rd globally** in terms of the number of top-10 ranked boxers and **2nd in women's boxing worldwide**.

Jaismine Lamboria climbed to **World No. 1** in the **57 kg category** after winning a silver medal at the Asian Championships.

Detailed Explanation:

India maintained a strong presence in the **World Boxing Rankings** released on **4 June 2026**, covering performances from **July 2024 to May 2026**.

Indian boxers featured in the **top 10 of 9 out of 10 women's weight categories** and **8 out of 10 men's weight categories**.

India ranked **3rd globally** in terms of the number of top-10 ranked boxers and **2nd in women's boxing worldwide**.

The rankings considered performances at major events, including the **Asian Boxing Elite Championships 2026** held in **Ulaanbaatar** and the **World Boxing Cup: Brazil 2026** held in **Foz do Iguaçu**.

Jaismine Lamboria climbed to **World No. 1** in the **57 kg category** after winning a silver medal at the Asian Championships.

Minakshi Hooda retained her **World No. 1** ranking in the **48 kg category** following her gold medal at the Asian Championships.

Priya Ghanghas, the Asian champion in the **60 kg category**, entered the **top three** of her division.

Preeti rose to **World No. 3** in the **48 kg category**.

234. In June 2026, consider the following statements regarding the inaugural World Yogasana Championship:

The championship was held at EKA Arena, Ahmedabad, Gujarat from 4–8 June 2026.

India won 102 Gold medals and finished at the top of the medal tally.

Nepal finished second in the medal tally with the highest number of Gold medals.

Which of the statements given above is/are incorrect?

A.1 and 2 only

B.2 and 3 only

C.3 only

D.1 and 3 only

E.1, 2 and 3

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

India emerged as the champion at the **inaugural World Yogasana Championship 2026**, finishing at the top of the medal tally.

The championship was held at **EKA Arena, Ahmedabad, Gujarat**, from **4 to 8 June 2026**.

India delivered a dominant performance by winning **114 medals**, including **102 Gold, 9 Silver, and 3 Bronze medals**.

Japan secured the second position in the medal standings with **3 Gold, 3 Silver, and 5 Bronze medals**.

Detailed Explanation:

India emerged as the champion at the **inaugural World Yogasana Championship 2026**, finishing at the top of the medal tally.

The championship was held at **EKA Arena, Ahmedabad, Gujarat**, from **4 to 8 June 2026**.

A total of **522 athletes from 79 countries** participated in the five-day global event.

India delivered a dominant performance by winning **114 medals**, including **102 Gold, 9 Silver, and 3 Bronze medals**.

India finished far ahead of all other participating nations, highlighting its strength and long-standing tradition in yoga and Yogasana.

The event witnessed strong international participation, with **31 countries winning at least one medal** and **10 countries securing at least one gold medal**.

Japan secured the second position in the medal standings with **3 Gold, 3 Silver, and 5 Bronze medals**.

Argentina finished third, aided by the outstanding performance of **Nabila Barraza**, who emerged as the most successful individual competitor of the championship.

Nepal finished fifth in the medal tally but recorded the second-highest total medal count with **52 medals** (1 Gold, 36 Silver, and 15 Bronze).

235. In June 2026, the Asian Boxing Elite Championships and the World Boxing Cup: Brazil 2026 were held in which of the following city pairs respectively?

A.Beijing — Rio de Janeiro

B.Tokyo — São Paulo

C.Ulaanbaatar — Foz do Iguaçu

D.Bangkok — Brasília

E.Jakarta — Salvador

Answer: C

India maintained a strong presence in the **World Boxing Rankings** released on **4 June 2026**, covering performances from **July 2024 to May 2026**.

Indian boxers featured in the **top 10 of 9 out of 10 women's weight categories** and **8 out of 10 men's weight categories**.

India ranked **3rd globally** in terms of the number of top-10 ranked boxers and **2nd in women's boxing worldwide**.

The rankings considered performances at major events, including the **Asian Boxing Elite Championships 2026** held in **Ulaanbaatar** and the **World Boxing Cup: Brazil 2026** held in **Foz do Iguaçu**.

236. In 2026, Viyona Fintech India Private Limited received certification under the Bharat Bill Payment System (BBPS) to onboard service providers (billers) onto the interoperable bill payment network. Which of the following entities performs this role?

A.Bharat Interface for Money (BHIM)

B.Payment Aggregator (PA)

C.Biller Operating Unit (BOU)

D.Account Aggregator (AA)

E.Prepaid Payment Instrument (PPI)

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

Viyona Fintech India Private Limited, an National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI)-certified Technology Service Provider, received certification as a **Biller Operating Unit (BOU)** under the **Bharat Bill Payment System (BBPS)**.

The BBPS is operated by **NPCI Bharat BillPay Limited (NBBL)**, a subsidiary of the **National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI)**.

A **Biller Operating Unit (BOU)** is a licensed entity authorized to **onboard service providers (billers)** onto a centralized and **interoperable bill payment network**.

In India, the BOU framework primarily operates under the **Bharat Bill Payment System (BBPS)**, also known as **Bharat Connect**.

Detailed Explanation:

Viyona Fintech India Private Limited, an National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI)-certified Technology Service Provider, received certification as a **Biller Operating Unit (BOU)** under the **Bharat Bill Payment System (BBPS)**.

The BBPS is operated by **NPCI Bharat BillPay Limited (NBBL)**, a subsidiary of the **National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI)**.

A **Biller Operating Unit (BOU)** is a licensed entity authorized to **onboard service providers (billers)** onto a centralized and **interoperable bill payment network**.

In India, the BOU framework primarily operates under the **Bharat Bill Payment System (BBPS)**, also known as **Bharat Connect**.

A BOU enables billers to join the BBPS network and offer **standardized bill collection services** to customers.

BOUs serve as a crucial bridge between **utility/service providers** and the **digital payment ecosystem**.

The **BOU certification** enables Viyona Fintech to officially operate as a Biller Operating Unit on the Bharat BillPay network.

With this certification, billers across sectors such as **utilities, education, insurance, and financial services** can collect payments through the BBPS platform.

Viyona is now authorized to **onboard billers** onto the BBPS network through a compliant and integration-ready platform.

The certification provides billers with access to one of India's largest **interoperable digital bill payment networks**.

237. In June 2026, Fitch Ratings revised India's GDP growth forecast for FY27 downward to what rate in its Global Economic Outlook (GEO) report?

A.5.8%

B.6.4%

C.6.5%

D.6.7%

E.7.0%

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Fitch Ratings, an American credit rating agency, released its **June 2026 Global Economic Outlook (GEO)** and revised **India's** Gross Domestic Product (**GDP) growth forecast for** Financial Year 2026-27 **(FY27)** downward by **30 basis points (bps) to 6.4%**, from its earlier estimate of 6.7%.

According to the report, **India's GDP growth** is projected to improve to **6.7% in FY28**, supported by **strong consumer spending** and **robust investment activity**.

For **FY29**, **Fitch forecasts** that India's GDP growth rate will moderate to **6.4%**.

The report noted that **Wholesale Prices in India** increased by **8.3% Year-on-Year (Y-o-Y)** in **April 2026**.

Detailed Explanation:

Fitch Ratings, an American credit rating agency, released its **June 2026 Global Economic Outlook (GEO)** and revised **India's** Gross Domestic Product (**GDP) growth forecast for** Financial Year 2026-27 **(FY27)** downward by **30 basis points (bps) to 6.4%**, from its earlier estimate of 6.7%.

According to the report, **India's GDP growth** is projected to improve to **6.7% in FY28**, supported by **strong consumer spending** and **robust investment activity**.

For **FY29**, **Fitch forecasts** that India's GDP growth rate will moderate to **6.4%**.

The report noted that **Wholesale Prices in India** increased by **8.3% Year-on-Year (Y-o-Y)** in **April 2026**.

India's **Consumer Price Index (CPI) inflation** stood at **3.5%** in **April 2026**.

Fitch projects that India's **inflation rate** will rise to **5.3%** by the end of **Calendar Year 2026 (CY26)**.

At the global level, **Fitch Ratings** revised its **global growth forecast** downward by **20 basis points (bps) to 2.4%** for **CY26**.

238. In June 2026, which organisation was recognised by the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) as the Self-Regulatory Organisation (SRO) for India's Account Aggregator (AA) ecosystem?

A.National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI)

B.Sahamati Foundation

C.Fintech Association for Consumer Empowerment (FACE)

D.Reserve Bank Innovation Hub (RBIH)

E.Digital India Corporation

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** recognised **Sahamati Foundation** as the **Self-Regulatory Organisation (SRO)** for India's **Account Aggregator (AA) ecosystem**, creating a formal industry-led governance framework for the country's **consent-based financial data-sharing network**.

The recognition was granted after evaluating Sahamati's application under the **RBI's March 2025 framework** for recognising SROs in the AA ecosystem.

As the recognised **SRO-AA**, **Sahamati Foundation** will serve as the **representative body** for participants in the Account Aggregator ecosystem, fostering collaboration among **financial institutions, Account Aggregators, FinTech companies**, and other stakeholders.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** recognised **Sahamati Foundation** as the **Self-Regulatory Organisation (SRO)** for India's **Account Aggregator (AA) ecosystem**, creating a formal industry-led governance framework for the country's **consent-based financial data-sharing network**.

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As the recognised **SRO-AA**, **Sahamati Foundation** will serve as the **representative body** for participants in the Account Aggregator ecosystem, fostering collaboration among **financial institutions, Account Aggregators, FinTech companies**, and other stakeholders.

In its regulatory role, **Sahamati** will help develop **industry standards**, promote **best practices**, resolve **operational challenges**, and strengthen **compliance and governance** across the ecosystem.

The **Account Aggregator (AA) framework** is a **consent-based digital financial data-sharing system** regulated by the **RBI**, enabling individuals and businesses to **securely share financial information** with authorised institutions.

The **AA ecosystem** currently comprises **1,120 regulated entities**, including **17 operational Account Aggregators (AAs)**.

239. In June 2026, Prime Minister Narendra Modi and French President Emmanuel Macron jointly inaugurated which event in Nice, France, aimed at strengthening collaboration among startups, innovators, investors, and technology leaders of both countries?

A.India–France Tech Summit

B.Startup Connect Europe

C.Digital India Global Forum

D.Bharat Innovates

E.Indo-French Innovation Dialogue

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** will undertake a **six-day visit to France and Slovakia from**

13–18 June 2026 to strengthen India's strategic partnerships with European countries.

In France, Prime Minister Modi will visit **Nice**, where both leaders will review the full spectrum of India–France relations under the **India–France Special Global Strategic Partnership**.

Prime Minister Modi and President Macron will jointly inaugurate the **"Bharat Innovates"** event, which aims to strengthen collaboration among startups, innovators, investors, and technology leaders from India and France.

Detailed Explanation:

Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** will undertake a **six-day visit to France and Slovakia from 13–18 June 2026** to strengthen India's strategic partnerships with European countries.

During the visit, he will hold bilateral meetings with French President **Emmanuel Macron** and Slovak Prime Minister **Robert Fico**.

In France, Prime Minister Modi will visit **Nice**, where both leaders will review the full spectrum of India–France relations under the **India–France Special Global Strategic Partnership**.

Discussions are expected to focus on **defence cooperation, artificial intelligence, clean energy, space, trade, investment, and emerging technologies**.

Prime Minister Modi and President Macron will jointly inaugurate the **"Bharat Innovates"** event, which aims to strengthen collaboration among startups, innovators, investors, and technology leaders from India and France.

The event will highlight cooperation in areas such as **Artificial Intelligence (AI), deep technology, fintech, healthcare innovation, digital technologies, and green technologies**.

240. In June 2026, Union Home Minister Amit Shah launched a digital platform for integrated management of cargo, passengers, vehicles, and inter-agency coordination at India's land ports. What is the name of this platform?

A.VINIMAY

B.SARATHI

C.PARIVAHAN

D.ULIP Connect

E.ICEGATE Plus

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

Union Home Minister **Amit Shah** launched the **Land Port Management System (LPMS) 'VINIMAY'** in New Delhi.

LPMS VINIMAY is a digital platform developed to enable integrated management of **cargo, passengers, vehicles, and inter-agency coordination** at India's land ports.

The initiative is part of the Government of India's **Smart Border Strategy** aimed at strengthening security, facilitating trade, and improving cross-border connectivity.

Detailed Explanation:

Union Home Minister **Amit Shah** launched the **Land Port Management System (LPMS) 'VINIMAY'** in New Delhi.

LPMS VINIMAY is a digital platform developed to enable integrated management of **cargo, passengers, vehicles, and inter-agency coordination** at India's land ports.

The initiative is part of the Government of India's **Smart Border Strategy** aimed at strengthening security, facilitating trade, and improving cross-border connectivity.

The platform integrates various agencies and digital systems, including:

Indian Customs Electronic Gateway (ICEGATE)

Central Board of Indirect Taxes and Customs (CBIC)

Border Security Force (BSF)

Directorate General of Foreign Trade (DGFT)

Unique Identification Authority of India (UIDAI)

Unified Logistics Interface Platform (ULIP)

Motor Vehicle Systems

LPMS introduces features such as a **Single Electronic Window, Automatic Number Plate Recognition (ANPR)-based gate operations, real-time data sharing, and integrated processing of cargo, vehicles, and passengers**.

The system is expected to reduce paperwork by around **90%**, truck waiting time by **40–60%**, and gate processing time by **22–35%**.

241. In June 2026, the Uttar Pradesh Government launched an initiative to provide high-speed internet connectivity in rural areas and bridge the digital divide. What is the name of this initiative?

A.Project Ganga

B.Digital UP Mission

C.Project BharatNet

D.Gram Connect Scheme

E.Rural Broadband Initiative

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

The **Uttar Pradesh Government** launched **'Project Ganga'** to provide high-speed internet connectivity in rural **areas and bridge the digital divide.**

The project was launched by Chief Minister **Yogi Adityanath** in Lucknow.

The initiative aims to establish a network of **Digital Service Providers (DSPs)** who will act as local digital entrepreneurs and provide internet and digital services in villages.

Under the project, around **20 lakh rural families** will receive high-speed internet connectivity.

The government aims to create around **8,000–10,000 Digital Service Providers (DSPs)** and generate over **one lakh direct and indirect employment opportunities**.

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The government aims to create around **8,000–10,000 Digital Service Providers (DSPs)** and generate over **one lakh direct and indirect employment opportunities**.

The first phase of Project Ganga will cover **21 districts** of Uttar Pradesh, with gradual expansion to other regions.

The project will promote digital education, telemedicine, e-governance services, and technology-based entrepreneurship in rural areas.

Hinduja OneOTT Intertainment Limited, the broadband arm of the Hinduja Group, has been designated as the Knowledge Partner and Implementation Enabler for the project.

242. In June 2026, APEDA flagged off the first commercial consignment of fresh mangoes from Jharkhand to the United Kingdom. Which variety of mango was exported?

A.Alphonso

B.Dashehari

C.Langra

D.Amrapali

E.Kesar

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

The **Agricultural and Processed Food Products Export Development Authority (APEDA)** under the **Ministry of Commerce and Industry** flagged off the **first commercial consignment of fresh mangoes from Jharkhand to the United Kingdom (UK)** at a ceremony held in Kolkata.

The **Amrapali variety of mango** grown in Jharkhand is known for its superior quality characteristics and strong market acceptance.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Agricultural and Processed Food Products Export Development Authority (APEDA)** under the **Ministry of Commerce and Industry** flagged off the **first commercial consignment of fresh mangoes from Jharkhand to the United Kingdom (UK)** at a ceremony held in Kolkata.

The consignment consists of **1.5 metric tonnes (MT) of fresh Amrapali mangoes** sourced from **Beura Farmer Producer Company Limited (FPC)**, an all-women Farmer Producer Company located in **Bano Block of Simdega district, Jharkhand**.

The mangoes are being exported by **M/s JGB Agrofresh Private Limited, Kolkata**, to **London, United Kingdom**.

The export was facilitated through APEDA's **Export-Oriented Capacity Building Programme**, which trained Farmer Producer Companies (FPCs), Farmer Producer Organisations (FPOs), and progressive farmers on export standards, quality requirements, and international market opportunities.

The **Amrapali variety of mango** grown in Jharkhand is known for its superior quality characteristics and strong market acceptance.

243. In June 2026, which State became the 36th and final State/Union Territory to join the Ayushman Bharat Pradhan Mantri Jan Arogya Yojana (AB PM-JAY)?

A.Kerala

B.Tamil Nadu

C.West Bengal

D.Punjab

E.Telangana

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The Government **of West Bengal** signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** with the **National Health Authority (NHA)** under the **Ministry of Health and Family Welfare** for the implementation of **Ayushman Bharat Pradhan Mantri Jan Arogya Yojana (AB PM-JAY)**.

With this agreement, West Bengal became the **36th and final State/Union Territory (UT)** to join the world's largest publicly funded health assurance scheme.

With the inclusion of West Bengal, all **28 States and 8 Union Territories** of India are now implementing **AB PM-JAY**.

The MoU ceremony was presided over by Union Health Minister **J. P. Nadda**.

West Bengal had earlier implemented its own health insurance scheme **'Swasthya Sathi'**, launched in **2016**, and had not adopted AB PM-JAY under the previous state government.

Detailed Explanation:

The Government **of West Bengal** signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** with the **National Health Authority (NHA)** under the **Ministry of Health and Family Welfare** for the implementation of **Ayushman Bharat Pradhan Mantri Jan Arogya Yojana (AB PM-JAY)**.

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West Bengal had earlier implemented its own health insurance scheme **'Swasthya Sathi'**, launched in **2016**, and had not adopted AB PM-JAY under the previous state government.

Delhi became the **35th State/Union Territory** to implement AB PM-JAY in **March 2026**.

Ayushman Bharat Pradhan Mantri Jan Arogya Yojana (AB PM-JAY) was launched by Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** on **23 September 2018** from **Ranchi**.

The scheme provides **cashless and paperless treatment up to ₹5 lakh per family per year** for secondary and tertiary healthcare services at empanelled public and private hospitals

244. In June 2026, Canada proposed new digital safety legislation to strengthen online child protection. Under the proposed law, children below what age could be prohibited from having social media accounts unless platforms demonstrate adequate safety safeguards?

A.13 years
B.14 years
C.15 years
D.16 years
E.18 years

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

Canada has introduced new **digital safety legislation** that could prohibit **children below 16 years of age** from having **social media accounts** unless companies can demonstrate that their platforms are **safe for young users**.
Under the proposed law, social media companies must obtain an **exemption** by proving that they have implemented **adequate child safety safeguards** on their platforms.
The legislation aims to **strengthen online child protection** and **reduce exposure to harmful digital content**.
The proposed law targets **seven categories of harmful content**, including content that **encourages self-harm**, **incites violence**, **promotes hatred**, and involves **non-consensual intimate images**.

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The proposed law targets **seven categories of harmful content**, including content that **encourages self-harm**, **incites violence**, **promotes hatred**, and involves **non-consensual intimate images**.
The bill proposes the establishment of a **Digital Safety Commission of Canada**, which will oversee the **implementation and regulation** of online safety measures.
According to **Culture Minister Marc Miller**, setting up the **Digital Safety Commission** may take up to **18 months**.
Platforms offering **adult content** will **not be eligible for exemptions** under the proposed legislation.

245. In June 2026, during Nepal Foreign Minister Shisir Khanal's visit to India, a Person-to-Person (P2P) digital payment linkage was launched between India's UPI and which country's National Payments Interface (NPI)?

A.Bhutan
B.Bangladesh
C.Maldives
D.Sri Lanka
E.Nepal
Answer: E
Short Explanation:
Shisir Khanal, **Foreign Minister of Nepal**, paid a **3-day official visit to India** from **5–7 June 2026** at the invitation of **Dr. S. Jaishankar**, **Union Minister of External Affairs (MEA)**.
During the visit, **Shisir Khanal** held **bilateral talks** with **External Affairs Minister Dr. S. Jaishankar** in **New Delhi**, where both sides reviewed the entire spectrum of **India–Nepal bilateral relations**.
The discussions covered key areas including **development cooperation**, **connectivity**, **trade and transit**, **energy cooperation**, and **people-to-people ties**.
Detailed Explanation:
Shisir Khanal, **Foreign Minister of Nepal**, paid a **3-day official visit to India** from **5–7 June 2026** at the invitation of **Dr. S. Jaishankar**, **Union Minister of External Affairs (MEA)**.
During the visit, **Shisir Khanal** held **bilateral talks** with **External Affairs Minister Dr. S. Jaishankar** in **New Delhi**, where both sides reviewed the entire spectrum of **India–Nepal bilateral relations**.
The discussions covered key areas including **development cooperation**, **connectivity**, **trade and transit**, **energy cooperation**, and **people-to-people ties**.
The **Nepalese Foreign Minister** also held a **high-level meeting** with **Ajit Doval**, **National Security Advisor (NSA) of India**, to discuss matters of **mutual interest**.
A major outcome of the visit was the launch of **Person-to-Person (P2P) linkage** between India's **Unified Payments Interface (UPI)** and Nepal's **National Payments Interface (NPI)**, strengthening **cross-border digital payments**.

246. As of June 2026, Prime Minister Narendra Modi surpassed the record of which former Prime Minister to become the second-longest-serving Prime Minister of India in consecutive days in office?
A.Indira Gandhi
B.Atal Bihari Vajpayee
C.Manmohan Singh
D.Jawaharlal Nehru
E.Morarji Desai
Answer: D
Short Explanation:
Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** achieved a historic milestone by completing **4,399 consecutive days in office**.
With this achievement, he surpassed the record of **Jawaharlal Nehru**, who served **4,398 consecutive days as an elected Prime Minister** from **13 May 1952 to 27 May 1964**.

Narendra Modi assumed office as Prime Minister on **26 May 2014** after leading the **Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP)** to victory in the Lok Sabha elections.

He became the **first non-Congress Prime Minister to complete two consecutive full-majority terms**.

He is also the first Prime Minister after Jawaharlal Nehru to win **three consecutive Lok Sabha elections as the incumbent leader** in **2014, 2019, and 2024**.

Detailed Explanation:

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With this achievement, he surpassed the record of **Jawaharlal Nehru**, who served **4,398 consecutive days as an elected Prime Minister** from **13 May 1952 to 27 May 1964**.

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He became the **first non-Congress Prime Minister to complete two consecutive full-majority terms**.

He is also the first Prime Minister after Jawaharlal Nehru to win **three consecutive Lok Sabha elections as the incumbent leader** in **2014, 2019, and 2024**.

Earlier, in **July 2025**, Prime Minister Modi surpassed the uninterrupted tenure record of **Indira Gandhi**, who served continuously for **4,077 days** from **24 January 1966 to 24 March 1977**.

In **March 2026**, Narendra Modi became the **longest-serving head of an elected government in India**, surpassing **Pawan Kumar Chamling** with a combined tenure as Gujarat Chief Minister and Prime Minister.

Narendra Modi served as the Chief Minister of Gujarat from **October 2001 to May 2014** before becoming the Prime Minister.

247. In June 2026, Reliance Industries Limited (RIL) and Meta Platforms announced a strategic partnership to develop an AI-enabled hyperscale data centre in which city?

A.Jamnagar

B.Hyderabad

C.Bengaluru

D.Ahmedabad

E.Pune

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

Reliance Industries Limited (RIL) and **Meta Platforms** have announced a strategic partnership to develop an **AI-enabled hyperscale data centre** in **Jamnagar**.

The upcoming facility will have an initial capacity of **168 megawatts (MW)** and is expected to be completed within the next **two years**.

The project will be **Meta's first built-to-suit data centre in India**, specifically designed to meet the company's Artificial Intelligence (AI) and high-performance computing requirements.

Detailed Explanation:

Reliance Industries Limited (RIL) and **Meta Platforms** have announced a strategic partnership to develop an **AI-enabled hyperscale data centre** in **Jamnagar**.

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The project will be **Meta's first built-to-suit data centre in India**, specifically designed to meet the company's Artificial Intelligence (AI) and high-performance computing requirements.

Meta will lease capacity from the data centre to support its expanding AI workloads, cloud services, and data processing needs.

The project is one of India's largest AI infrastructure investments and highlights India's growing role in the global Artificial Intelligence ecosystem.

Jamnagar has been chosen due to advantages such as availability of renewable energy, access to desalinated water, proximity to western submarine cable landing stations, and connectivity through Jio's fibre network.

248. In June 2026, the Himachal Pradesh Government signed an MoU with which organisation to promote climate-resilient, inclusive, and sustainable development in the state?

A.United Nations Environment Programme (UNEP)

B.World Bank

C.United Nations Development Programme (UNDP)

D.Asian Development Bank (ADB)

E.International Union for Conservation of Nature (IUCN)

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The **Himachal Pradesh Government** signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** with the **United Nations Development Programme (UNDP)** to promote **climate-resilient, inclusive, and sustainable development** across the state.

The partnership will focus on key areas such as circular economy, waste management, electric mobility for waste collection, biodiversity conservation, ecosystem restoration, and sustainable livelihoods.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Himachal Pradesh Government** signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** with the **United Nations Development Programme (UNDP)** to promote **climate-resilient, inclusive, and sustainable development** across the state.

The partnership will focus on key areas such as circular economy, waste management, electric mobility for waste collection, biodiversity conservation, ecosystem restoration, and sustainable livelihoods.

The initiative aims to strengthen **ecological governance** and ensure the participation of **women, marginalised communities, and**

informal workers in sustainable development activities.

Chief Minister **Sukhvinder Singh Sukhu** launched the **'Safai Mitra Scheme'** to empower informal waste management workers and improve their dignity, safety, and socio-economic conditions.

249. In June 2026, Air India signed an MoU with which airline to enhance connectivity between India, Saudi Arabia, and other global destinations?

A.Saudia

B.Riyadh Air

C.Qatar Airways

D.Emirates

E.Etihad Airways

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Air India and **Riyadh Air** signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** to establish a strategic partnership aimed at enhancing connectivity between **India, Saudi Arabia, and other global destinations**.

The partnership will leverage the strategic locations of the airlines' hubs in **Delhi, Mumbai, and Riyadh**.

Subject to regulatory approvals, both airlines plan to introduce **interline and codeshare agreements** to provide seamless travel across their networks.

Detailed Explanation:

Air India and **Riyadh Air** signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** to establish a strategic partnership aimed at enhancing connectivity between **India, Saudi Arabia, and other global destinations**.

The partnership will leverage the strategic locations of the airlines' hubs in **Delhi, Mumbai, and Riyadh**.

Subject to regulatory approvals, both airlines plan to introduce **interline and codeshare agreements** to provide seamless travel across their networks.

The arrangements will allow passengers to travel on a **single booking** with smoother onward connections through their respective hubs.

The two airlines will also explore cooperation in:

Reciprocal loyalty programme benefits

Cargo services

Operational support

Digital and technology initiatives

Customer experience enhancement

The partnership is expected to strengthen air connectivity, boost tourism, and facilitate business travel between India and Saudi Arabia.

Since its privatization in **2022**, Air India has established **25 codeshare partnerships** and more than **120 interline agreements** with airlines worldwide.

250. As of June 2026, South Korean President Lee Jae Myung nominated Han Seong-sook for which position, making her potentially the second woman to hold the office in South Korea's history?

A.Deputy Prime Minister

B.Foreign Minister
C.Minister of Economy and Finance
D.Speaker of the National Assembly
E.Prime Minister
Answer: E
South Korean President Lee Jae Myung has nominated **Han Seong-sook** as the country's next **Prime Minister (PM)**, following reports that incumbent PM Kim Min-seok is stepping down from the position.
If approved by the **National Assembly of South Korea**, **Han Seong-sook** will become the **second woman Prime Minister** in South Korea's history.
She will follow **Han Myeong-sook**, who served as South Korea's **first female Prime Minister** from **2006 to 2007**.

251. In June 2026, Union Minister Piyush Goyal launched the BHAVYA Portal to operationalise which scheme aimed at developing 100 world-class investment-ready industrial parks across India?
A.PM Gati Shakti Yojana
B.National Industrial Corridor Programme
C.Bharat Audyogik Vikas Yojana (BHAVYA)
D.Make in India Industrial Parks Scheme
E.Industrial Infrastructure Development Mission
Answer: C
Short Explanation:
Union Minister Piyush Goyal, **Ministry of Commerce & Industry (MoC&I)**, launched the **BHAVYA Portal** in **New Delhi** to operationalise the **Bharat Audyogik Vikas Yojana (BHAVYA)**.
The **BHAVYA Scheme** has a total outlay of **₹33,660 crore** and aims to develop **100 world-class investment-ready industrial parks** across India over a period of **six years**.
The portal will serve as a **single digital interface** for **Detailed Project Report (DPR)** submission, **project appraisal**, **evaluation**, **monitoring**, and **reporting** throughout the project lifecycle.
National Industrial Corridor Development Corporation (NICDC) has been designated as the **Project Management Agency (PMA)** for implementation and monitoring of the scheme.
Detailed Explanation:
Union Minister Piyush Goyal, **Ministry of Commerce & Industry (MoC&I)**, launched the **BHAVYA Portal** in **New Delhi** to operationalise the **Bharat Audyogik Vikas Yojana (BHAVYA)**.
The **BHAVYA Scheme** has a total outlay of **₹33,660 crore** and aims to develop **100 world-class investment-ready industrial parks** across India over a period of **six years**.
The portal will serve as a **single digital interface** for **Detailed Project Report (DPR)** submission, **project appraisal**, **evaluation**, **monitoring**, and **reporting** throughout the project lifecycle.
National Industrial Corridor Development Corporation (NICDC) has been designated as the **Project Management Agency (PMA)** for implementation and monitoring of the scheme.

The scheme is being implemented under the **Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT)** through a **51:49 Centre–State partnership model**.

State Governments will provide **land** for industrial parks, while the **Government of India** will support **infrastructure development** through **NICDC**.

The scheme follows a **challenge-based competitive selection model**, encouraging **States and Union Territories** to submit proposals based on **industrial strengths**, **land availability**, **investor interest**, and **sectoral potential**.

The **Government of India** will provide support of **up to ₹1 crore per acre** for **core infrastructure**, **value-added infrastructure**, and **social infrastructure** within industrial parks.

252. In June 2026, all 24 Indian crew members of the Palau-flagged tanker MT Marivex, which was hit by a missile attack off Masirah, were rescued by helicopters of which country's Navy?

A.Pakistan

B.United Arab Emirates

C.Saudi Arabia

D.Bahrain

E.Oman

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

The Maritime Rescue Coordination Centre (MRCC), Mumbai of the **Indian Coast Guard (ICG)** received information about a **missile attack** on the **Palau-flagged tanker MT Marivex** at approximately **1420 hours on 8 June 2026**.

The **MT Marivex** was anchored **off Masirah** and had **24 Indian crew members** on board at the time of the incident.

Following the alert, **MRCC Mumbai** immediately established communication with the **Oman Maritime Search and Rescue Centre (OMSC)** and closely monitored the situation.

Detailed Explanation:

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The **MT Marivex** was anchored **off Masirah** and had **24 Indian crew members** on board at the time of the incident.

Following the alert, **MRCC Mumbai** immediately established communication with the **Oman Maritime Search and Rescue Centre (OMSC)** and closely monitored the situation.

The **Indian Coast Guard** maintained **continuous coordination with OMSC Oman** and other relevant stakeholders to ensure the safety of the Indian crew members.

At approximately **1700 hours**, **OMSC Oman confirmed** that all **24 Indian crew members** had been **successfully rescued by helicopters of the Oman Navy**.

The rescue operation was completed **without any casualties or injuries**, and all rescued personnel were reported to be **safe**.

The **MT Marivex remained anchored off Masirah, Oman**, following the rescue operation.

253. In June 2026, the Combined Graduation Parade (CGP) of 217 Course at the Air Force Academy (AFA), Dundigal, marked the commissioning of the first batch of women cadets from which institution?

A.Indian Military Academy (IMA), Dehradun

B.Officers Training Academy (OTA), Chennai

C.National Defence Academy (NDA), Pune

D.Air Force Technical College, Bengaluru

E.Rashtriya Indian Military College (RIMC), Dehradun

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The **Combined Graduation Parade (CGP)** of **217 Course** will be held at the **Air Force Academy (AFA), Dundigal, Hyderabad** on **13 June 2026**, marking the successful completion of pre-commissioning training of **Flight Cadets** of the **Indian Air Force (IAF)**.

Raksha Mantri Rajnath Singh will be the **Reviewing Officer (RO)** and will confer the **President's Commission** to the graduating trainees during the parade.

The ceremony will include the presentation of **'Wings' and 'Brevets'** to IAF Flight Cadets, as well as officers and trainees of the **Indian Navy**, **Indian Coast Guard**, and the **Socialist Republic of Vietnam**.

The **CGP 2026** will mark the **commissioning of the first batch of women cadets** from the **National Defence Academy (NDA), Pune**, who passed out on 30 May 2025 and subsequently underwent branch-specific training at AFA.

Detailed Explanation:

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The **CGP 2026** will mark the **commissioning of the first batch of women cadets** from the **National Defence Academy (NDA), Pune**, who passed out on 30 May 2025 and subsequently underwent branch-specific training at AFA.

The **President's Plaque** will be awarded to the Flight Cadets securing **first position** in the

overall order of merit in the **Flying, Navigation Stream, and Ground Duty branches**.

The event will begin with special performances by the **Akash Ganga Team** and the **Air Warrior Drill Team (AWDT)**, showcasing military precision and discipline.

The **fly-past** will be led by the **Chief of the Air Staff (CAS), Air Chief Marshal A.P. Singh**, highlighting the operational and training capabilities of the IAF.

254. In June 2026, scientists published a study in the journal Icarus examining Uranus' moon system to understand the early evolution of the Solar System. Uranus belongs to which class of planets?

A.Terrestrial Planet

B.Ice Giant

C.Gas Giant

D.Dwarf Planet

E.Exoplanet

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Scientists in June 2026 studied **Uranus' moon dynamics**, **ring structure**, and **planetary formation models** to examine whether the **early Solar System** contained **additional giant planets** that were later **ejected into interstellar space**.

The research, published in the peer-reviewed journal **Icarus**, used **122 simulations** of Solar System evolution and compared them with the present-day arrangement of Uranus and its moons.

Uranus is the **seventh planet from the Sun** and is one of the **four outer giant planets** of the Solar System.

Uranus belongs to the **Ice Giant class of planets**, along with **Neptune**.

A **2026 study** by **Yamila Miguel** and other researchers examined whether the outer shells of Uranus and Neptune contain significant amounts of **rock, hydrogen, and helium gas**.

Uranus has **29 known moons**, with major moons including **Miranda, Ariel, Umbriel, Titania, and Oberon**.

Detailed Explanation:

Scientists in June 2026 studied **Uranus' moon dynamics**, **ring structure**, and **planetary formation models** to examine whether the **early Solar System** contained **additional giant planets** that were later **ejected into interstellar space**.

The research, published in the peer-reviewed journal **Icarus**, used **122 simulations** of Solar System evolution and compared them with the present-day arrangement of Uranus and its moons.

Uranus is the **seventh planet from the Sun** and is one of the **four outer giant planets** of the Solar System.

Uranus belongs to the **Ice Giant class of planets**, along with **Neptune**.

A **2026 study** by **Yamila Miguel** and other researchers examined whether the outer shells of Uranus and Neptune contain significant amounts of **rock, hydrogen, and helium gas**.

Uranus has **29 known moons**, with major moons including **Miranda, Ariel, Umbriel, Titania, and Oberon**.

The planet has an unusual **axial tilt of about 98 degrees**, making it one of the most distinctive planets in the Solar System and causing **extreme seasonal variations**.

The simulations suggested that the **Uranian moon system** would likely have been **disrupted** unless one or more giant planets were removed from the Solar System during its early history.

Miranda, one of Uranus' major moons, is particularly important for research because its surface shows **evidence of past disruption and reassembly**

255. In June 2026, which fund acquired the 3.65% stake in Capital Small Finance Bank (SFB) that was sold by Oman India Joint Investment Fund II (OIJIF II)?

A.Lyptus Punch-Card Fund

B.SBI Mutual Fund

C.Nippon India Growth Fund

D.HDFC Balanced Advantage Fund

E.ICICI Prudential Equity Fund

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

Oman India Joint Investment Fund II (OIJIF II), a private equity fund promoted by the **sovereign wealth fund of the Sultanate of Oman** and the **State Bank of India (SBI)**, sold its **3.65% stake** in **Capital Small Finance Bank (SFB)**.

Capital Small Finance Bank (SFB) is one of India's leading Small Finance Banks, with a strong focus on **Retail Banking** and **Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises (MSMEs)**.

As part of the transaction, **Lyptus Punch-Card Fund** acquired the entire **3.65% stake** divested by OIJIF II.

Detailed Explanation:

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Capital Small Finance Bank (SFB) is one of India's leading Small Finance Banks, with a strong focus on **Retail Banking** and **Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises (MSMEs)**.

As part of the transaction, **Lyptus Punch-Card Fund** acquired the entire **3.65% stake** divested by OIJIF II.

The deal involved the sale of approximately **1.36 million shares** of Capital SFB.

The shares were sold at a price of **₹270 per share**.

The **total transaction value** of the stake sale was approximately **₹36.79 crore**.

The **block deal** was executed through the **National Stock Exchange of India Limited (NSE)**.

256. In June 2026, veteran Tamil filmmaker Bharathiraja, who passed away at the age of

85, made his directorial debut with which landmark Tamil film in 1977?

A.Mullum Malarum

B.16 Vayathinile

C.Apoorva Raagangal

D.Bhuvana Oru Kelvi Kuri

E.Uthiripookkal

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Veteran Tamil filmmaker, director, producer, screenwriter, and actor Bharathiraja passed away at the age of **85 in Chennai, Tamil Nadu (TN)**.

Bharathiraja was born as **Chinnasamy** on **17 July 1941** in **Theni Allinagaram, Tamil Nadu**.

He was honoured with the **Padma Shri**, India's fourth-highest civilian award, in **2004** by the Government of India (GoI) for his contribution to the field of **Arts**.

Bharathiraja made his directorial debut with **"16 Vayathinile" (1977)**, a landmark film in Tamil cinema.

Detailed Explanation:

Veteran Tamil filmmaker, director, producer, screenwriter, and actor Bharathiraja passed away at the age of **85 in Chennai, Tamil Nadu (TN)**.

Bharathiraja was born as **Chinnasamy** on **17 July 1941** in **Theni Allinagaram, Tamil Nadu**.

He was honoured with the **Padma Shri**, India's fourth-highest civilian award, in **2004** by the Government of India (GoI) for his contribution to the field of **Arts**.

Bharathiraja made his directorial debut with **"16 Vayathinile" (1977)**, a landmark film in Tamil cinema.

During his illustrious career, he directed **more than 40 films** across **Tamil, Telugu, and Hindi cinema**.

Apart from directing, Bharathiraja also had a **successful acting career** in the Indian film industry.

His **last released film** as an actor was **"Thudarum"**, while **"Pulavar"** remains his **final unreleased project**.

He won **six National Film Awards** in the years **1982, 1986, 1988, 1995, 1996, and 2001**.

He received **three Filmfare Awards South** in **1978, 1987, and 1994** for **Best Director** and **Best Film** categories.

Bharathiraja was also honoured with several **Tamil Nadu State Film Awards**, including the prestigious **Arignar Anna Award in 2001**.

257. In June 2026, scientists highlighted the importance of studying one of Uranus' major moons because its surface shows evidence of past disruption and reassembly. Which moon is it?

A.Ariel

B.Miranda

C.Oberon

D.Umbriel

E.Titania

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Miranda, one of Uranus' major moons, is particularly important for research because its surface shows **evidence of past disruption and reassembly**.

The **moons of Jupiter and Uranus** are frequently used in **comparative studies of planetary migration and orbital instability** during the first 3–4 billion years of Solar System history.

Uranus possesses a **system of narrow rings**, which were **first discovered in 1977** through Earth-based observations.

Detailed Explanation:

Miranda, one of Uranus' major moons, is particularly important for research because its surface shows **evidence of past disruption and reassembly**.

The **moons of Jupiter and Uranus** are frequently used in **comparative studies of planetary migration and orbital instability** during the first 3–4 billion years of Solar System history.

Uranus possesses a **system of narrow rings**, which were **first discovered in 1977** through Earth-based observations.

Observations conducted in 2026 indicated that the **outer rings of Uranus** may contain **evidence of additional undiscovered moons**, as small satellites can influence ring edges and gaps through gravitational interactions.

Planetary rings are composed of **ice, dust, and rocky particles**, and their structure is often shaped by the **gravity of nearby moons**.

Uranus is the **only planet** whose rings were **discovered from Earth** before being visited by a spacecraft.

258. As of 2026, who is the Governor of Himachal Pradesh?

A.Shiv Pratap Shukla

B.Bandaru Dattatreya

C.Kavinder Gupta

D.Sukhvinder Singh Sukhu

E.Gulab Chand Kataria

Answer: C

About Himachal Pradesh

Capital: Shimla (Summer) and Dharamshala (Winter)

Chief Minister: Sukhvinder Singh Sukhu

Governor: Kavinder Gupta

259. In March 2026, Prime Minister Narendra Modi became the longest-serving head of an elected government in India, surpassing whom in terms of combined tenure as Chief Minister and Prime Minister?

A.Jyoti Basu

B.Naveen Patnaik

C.Sheila Dikshit

D.Manik Sarkar

E.Pawan Kumar Chamling

Answer: E

In **March 2026**, Narendra Modi became the **longest-serving head of an elected government in India**, surpassing **Pawan Kumar Chamling** with a combined tenure as Gujarat Chief Minister and Prime Minister.

Narendra Modi served as the Chief Minister of Gujarat from **October 2001 to May 2014** before becoming the Prime Minister.

260. As of 2026, who is the Prime Minister of Nepal?

A.K. P. Sharma Oli

B.Pushpa Kamal Dahal

C.Sher Bahadur Deuba

D.Balendra Shah

E.Ram Chandra Paudel

Answer: D

About Nepal:

Capital: Kathmandu

Currency: Nepalese rupee (NPR)

President: Ram Chandra Paudel

Prime Minister: Balendra Shah

261. In 2026, India and Nepal launched a Peer-to-Peer (P2P) Cross-Border Remittance Mechanism by linking which two payment systems?

A.UPI (India) and NPI (Nepal)

B.UPI (India) and PayNow (Singapore)

C.RuPay (India) and NPI (Nepal)

D.BHIM (India) and Fonepay (Nepal)

E.IMPS (India) and NPI (Nepal)

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

India and Nepal officially launched a **Peer-to-Peer (P2P) Cross-Border Remittance Mechanism** on **6 June 2026**.

The new system establishes a direct linkage between India's **Unified Payments Interface (UPI)** and Nepal's **National Payments Interface (NPI)**.

The **UPI-NPI Integration** enables **seamless, Real-Time, Secure, and Instant Money Transfers** between citizens of both countries through **Mobile Banking Applications** and **Digital Wallets**.

The initiative is a major step towards enhancing **Digital Financial Connectivity**, **Financial Inclusion**, and **Neighbourhood Cooperation**.

The linkage strengthens the **Economic, Financial, and Digital Relationship** between India and Nepal.

Detailed Explanation:

India and Nepal officially launched a **Peer-to-Peer (P2P) Cross-Border Remittance Mechanism** on **6 June 2026**.

The new system establishes a direct linkage between India's **Unified Payments Interface (UPI)** and Nepal's **National Payments Interface (NPI)**.

The **UPI-NPI Integration** enables **seamless, Real-Time, Secure, and Instant Money Transfers** between citizens of both countries through **Mobile Banking Applications** and **Digital Wallets**.

The initiative is a major step towards enhancing **Digital Financial Connectivity**, **Financial Inclusion**, and **Neighbourhood Cooperation**.

The linkage strengthens the **Economic, Financial, and Digital Relationship** between India and Nepal.

The technical integration was implemented through collaboration between **NPCI International Payments Limited (NIPL)** and **Nepal Clearing House Limited (NCHL)**.

NIPL is the international arm of the **National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI)**.

The new payment corridor supports the regional objective of providing **Accessible, Safe, Affordable, and Efficient** Cross-Border Payments.

The mechanism enables **Real-Time Direct Transfers**, reducing dependence on traditional banking channels.

262. In June 2026, the Emergency Credit Line Guarantee Scheme (ECLGS) 5.0 crossed 1 lakh guarantees. What is the credit infusion target under ECLGS 5.0?

A.₹1,00,000 Crore

B.₹1,55,000 Crore

C.₹2,00,000 Crore

D.₹2,55,000 Crore

E.₹3,00,000 Crore

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

The **Emergency Credit Line Guarantee Scheme (ECLGS) 5.0** was approved by the Union Cabinet on **05 May 2026** to provide additional credit support to businesses affected by the **West Asia Crisis**.

As of **09 June 2026**, the total number of guarantees issued under ECLGS 5.0 crossed the **1 lakh mark**, reaching **1,06,549 guarantees**.

The total amount of guarantees issued under the scheme stands at **₹48,484.26 Crore**.

The **MSME Sector** is the major beneficiary, accounting for **96% of guarantees by number** and **86% of the total guaranteed amount**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Emergency Credit Line Guarantee Scheme (ECLGS) 5.0** was approved by the Union Cabinet on **05 May 2026** to provide additional credit support to businesses affected by the **West Asia Crisis**.

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The total amount of guarantees issued under the scheme stands at **₹48,484.26 Crore**.

The **MSME Sector** is the major beneficiary, accounting for **96% of guarantees by number** and **86% of the total guaranteed amount**.

Public Sector Banks (PSBs) played a key role in implementation, accounting for **96% of the guarantees** issued under the scheme.

The scheme provides **100% Guarantee Coverage for MSMEs** and **90% Guarantee Coverage for Non-MSME Sectors**, encouraging financial institutions to extend credit.

ECLGS 5.0 aims to infuse an additional **₹2,55,000 Crore of credit** to existing borrowers facing liquidity challenges.

The scheme was launched to help businesses overcome **Liquidity Constraints** arising from the West Asia Crisis.

263. In 2026, the Government of India extended the Credit Guarantee Scheme for Microfinance Institutions (CGSMFI-2.0) until 31 August 2026 or until guarantees of what amount are issued, whichever is earlier?

A.₹5,000 Crore

B.₹10,000 Crore

C.₹15,000 Crore

D.₹20,000 Crore

E.₹25,000 Crore

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

The **Government of India (GoI)** has approved the extension of the **Credit Guarantee Scheme for Microfinance Institutions (CGSMFI-2.0)** until **31 August 2026** or until guarantees worth **₹20,000 Crore** are issued, whichever is earlier.

The Government has also increased the **Maximum Loan Amount Cap** for Large-Sized NBFC-MFIs/MFIs from **₹300 Crore to ₹1,000 Crore**, subject to the overall ceiling of **20% of Assets Under Management (AUM)**.

The extension and enhanced loan limit are expected to improve **Scheme Utilisation** and facilitate greater **Credit Flow to the Microfinance Sector**.

CGSMFI-2.0 was launched by the Central Government on **20 March 2026**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Government of India (GoI)** has approved the extension of the **Credit Guarantee Scheme for Microfinance Institutions (CGSMFI-2.0)** until **31 August 2026** or until guarantees worth **₹20,000 Crore** are issued, whichever is earlier.

The Government has also increased the **Maximum Loan Amount Cap** for Large-Sized NBFC-MFIs/MFIs from **₹300 Crore to ₹1,000 Crore**, subject to the overall ceiling of **20% of Assets Under Management (AUM)**.

The extension and enhanced loan limit are expected to improve **Scheme Utilisation** and facilitate greater **Credit Flow to the Microfinance Sector**.

CGSMFI-2.0 was launched by the Central Government on **20 March 2026**.

The scheme provides **Credit Guarantee Cover** to Banks and Financial Institutions (FIs) through the **National Credit Guarantee Trustee Company Limited (NCGTC)**.

The objective of the scheme is to protect lenders against expected losses on financial assistance provided to **Non-Banking Financial Company-Microfinance Institutions (NBFC-MFIs)** and **Microfinance Institutions (MFIs)**.

These institutions use the funds for **On-Lending to Small Borrowers**, thereby improving financial inclusion.

As of the latest update, loans totaling **₹770 Crore** have been sanctioned under the scheme

264. As of 2026, the new arrangement under Viksit Bharat – Gramin Bharat (VBG) is scheduled to come into effect from which date?

A.1 April 2026

B.1 June 2026

C.1 July 2026

D.15 August 2026

E.2 October 2026

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

Union Minister for Agriculture & Farmers Welfare and Rural Development **Shivraj Singh Chouhan** chaired a meeting of State Rural Development Ministers through video conferencing regarding the implementation of **Viksit Bharat – Gramin Bharat (VBG)**.

The new arrangement under **Viksit Bharat – Gramin Bharat** will come into effect from **1 July 2026**, aiming to strengthen rural employment, workers' welfare, and overall village development.

Detailed Explanation:

Union Minister for Agriculture & Farmers Welfare and Rural Development **Shivraj Singh Chouhan** chaired a meeting of State Rural Development Ministers through video conferencing regarding the implementation of **Viksit Bharat – Gramin Bharat (VBG)**.

The new arrangement under **Viksit Bharat – Gramin Bharat** will come into effect from **1 July 2026**, aiming to strengthen rural employment, workers' welfare, and overall village development.

The Central Government emphasized that there should be **no disruption in employment generation, wage payments, or workers' rights** during the transition.

The Government has already allocated **₹30,000 crore under the Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act (MGNREGA)**.

An additional **interim allocation of ₹95,692.31 crore** was released to States and Union Territories, taking the total allocation to over **₹1.25 lakh crore**.

The funds will reach around **2.80 lakh Gram Panchayats** to support employment generation and creation of durable rural assets

265. In 2026, the Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act (MGNREGA), enacted in 2005, was implemented from which date?

A.26 January 2006

B.2 February 2006

C.1 April 2006

D.15 August 2006

E.2 October 2006

Answer: B

Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act (MGNREGA)

Launched: 2005 (Implemented from 2 February 2006)

Ministry: Ministry of Rural Development

Objective: To provide a legal guarantee of 100 days of wage employment annually to rural households willing to undertake unskilled manual work.
Coverage: All rural districts across India

266. In 2026, Prime Minister Narendra Modi chaired which Governing Council Meeting of NITI Aayog at the Rashtrapati Bhavan Cultural Centre, New Delhi?

A.8th
B.9th
C.10th
D.12th
E.11th

Answer: E

Short Explanation:
Prime Minister Shri **Narendra Modi** chaired the **11th Governing Council Meeting of NITI Aayog** at the **Rashtrapati Bhavan Cultural Centre, New Delhi**.
The theme of the meeting was **"Inclusive Human Development for Viksit Bharat@2047."**

Detailed Explanation:
Prime Minister Shri **Narendra Modi** chaired the **11th Governing Council Meeting of NITI Aayog** at the **Rashtrapati Bhavan Cultural Centre, New Delhi**.
The theme of the meeting was **"Inclusive Human Development for Viksit Bharat@2047."**
The meeting was attended by **Chief Ministers, Lieutenant Governors, and Administrators from 28 States and 5 Union Territories**.
It marked the **first time that Chief Ministers of all 28 States participated** in the Governing Council meeting.
The Prime Minister emphasized that the vision of **Viksit Bharat@2047** should become a collective mission for every State, district, block, and village through the spirit of **cooperative federalism**.

267. In 2026, IIT Bhubaneswar developed a portable device for detecting arsenic contamination in drinking water. What is the name of the device?

A.ArsenSafe
B.AquaSense
C.JalSuraksha
D.WaterGuard
E.ArsenAlert

Answer: A

Short Explanation:
The **Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) Bhubaneswar** developed **'ArsenSafe'**, a portable device capable of detecting **arsenic contamination in drinking water without the need for laboratory facilities**.
The technology was developed by the **Sensors and Spectroscopy Research Group of IIT Bhubaneswar** in collaboration with **Nano Semic Private Limited**, a startup incubated at the institute's Research and Entrepreneurship Park.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) Bhubaneswar** developed **'ArsenSafe'**, a portable device capable of detecting **arsenic contamination in drinking water without the need for laboratory facilities**.

The technology was developed by the **Sensors and Spectroscopy Research Group of IIT Bhubaneswar** in collaboration with **Nano Semic Private Limited**, a startup incubated at the institute's Research and Entrepreneurship Park.

ArsenSafe provides a **rapid, affordable, and highly sensitive on-site testing solution**, especially useful for rural and resource-constrained areas.

The device uses an advanced **reduced graphene oxide (rGO)-based sensing platform** and a **liquid-gated reduced graphene oxide field-effect transistor (rGO-FET) sensor** to detect extremely low concentrations of arsenic.

The technology combines **nanotechnology, reduced graphene oxide (rGO), graphene oxide (GO) dielectric layers, and machine learning** to improve the sensitivity and accuracy of water quality monitoring.

268. In 2026, who paid a 5-day working visit to India from 3–7 June with a focus on strengthening India–Venezuela energy cooperation?

A.Nicolás Maduro

B.Yván Gil Pinto

C.Delcy Eloína Rodríguez Gómez

D.Jorge Arreaza

E.Diosdado Cabello

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

Delcy Eloína Rodríguez Gómez, Acting President of Venezuela, paid a **5-day working visit to India** from **3–7 June 2026** with a primary focus on strengthening **India–Venezuela energy cooperation**.

This was her **sixth visit to India**, having previously visited as Foreign Minister (2015) and as Vice President (2019, 2023, 2024 and 2025).

Detailed Explanation:

Delcy Eloína Rodríguez Gómez, Acting President of Venezuela, paid a **5-day working visit to India** from **3–7 June 2026** with a primary focus on strengthening **India–Venezuela energy cooperation**.

This was her **sixth visit to India**, having previously visited as Foreign Minister (2015) and as Vice President (2019, 2023, 2024 and 2025).

During the visit, Delcy Rodríguez held **bilateral talks with Prime Minister Narendra Modi** at **Hyderabad House, New Delhi**, where both leaders reviewed the entire spectrum of India–Venezuela relations.

The discussions focused on enhancing cooperation in **energy security, trade and investment, pharmaceuticals, healthcare, transportation, and renewable energy**

269. In June 2026, the Ministry of Defence signed a ₹449 crore contract with Accord

Software and Systems Private Limited (ASSPL) for the procurement of how many Enhanced Capability Global Navigation Satellite System (ECGNSS) Jammers for the Indian Navy?

A.10

B.15

C.25

D.20

E.30

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

The **Ministry of Defence (MoD)** signed a contract with **Accord Software and Systems Private Limited (ASSPL), Bengaluru** for the procurement of **20 Enhanced Capability Global Navigation Satellite System (ECGNSS) Jammers** for the **Indian Navy**.

The total value of the contract is **₹449 Crore** with a minimum **75% Indigenous Content**.

The contract was signed under the **Buy (Indian–Indigenously Designed, Developed and Manufactured-IDDM)** category.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Ministry of Defence (MoD)** signed a contract with **Accord Software and Systems Private Limited (ASSPL), Bengaluru** for the procurement of **20 Enhanced Capability Global Navigation Satellite System (ECGNSS) Jammers** for the **Indian Navy**.

The total value of the contract is **₹449 Crore** with a minimum **75% Indigenous Content**.

The contract was signed under the **Buy (Indian–Indigenously Designed, Developed and Manufactured-IDDM)** category.

The agreement was signed in the presence of **Rajesh Kumar Singh, Defence Secretary**, in New Delhi on **10 June 2026**.

The ECGNSS Jammers are advanced **Electronic Warfare (EW) Systems** designed to disrupt, degrade, and manipulate enemy satellite navigation signals.

The system can degrade **satellite signal acquisition and tracking performance** of adversary **Global Navigation Satellite System (GNSS) Receivers**.

270. In June 2026, a workshop on Defence Procurement, iDEX, TPCR, and Testing Procedures for MSMEs & Start-ups was jointly organised by HQ IDS and which organisation?

A.DRDO

B.Society of Indian Defence Manufacturers (SIDM)

C.Centre for Joint Warfare Studies (CENJOWS)

D.Directorate General of Quality Assurance (DGQA)

E.Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO) Academy

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

A **Workshop on Defence Procurement, Innovations for Defence Excellence (iDEX), Technology Perspective Capability Roadmap (TPCR), and Testing Procedures for MSMEs**

& Start-ups is being held at **Manekshaw Centre, Delhi Cantt** on **11–12 June 2026**.

The workshop is jointly organised by the **Indigenisation Directorate, Headquarters Integrated Defence Staff (HQ IDS)** and the **Centre for Joint Warfare Studies (CENJOWS)**.

The primary objective of the event is to enhance awareness and encourage greater participation of **Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises (MSMEs) and Start-ups** in the **Defence Ecosystem**.

Detailed Explanation:

A **Workshop on Defence Procurement, Innovations for Defence Excellence (iDEX), Technology Perspective Capability Roadmap (TPCR), and Testing Procedures for MSMEs & Start-ups** is being held at **Manekshaw Centre, Delhi Cantt** on **11–12 June 2026**.

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The primary objective of the event is to enhance awareness and encourage greater participation of **Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises (MSMEs) and Start-ups** in the **Defence Ecosystem**.

The workshop provides an interactive platform for industry representatives to gain insights into **Defence Procurement Procedures**, **Indigenisation Initiatives**, **iDEX Framework**, **Testing & Certification Processes**, and **TPCR**.

Senior officers and experts from **HQ IDS**, **Service Headquarters**, **Directorate General of Quality Assurance (DGQA)**, **iDEX-Defence Innovation Organisation (DIO)**, and other stakeholder organisations are participating in the event.

The inaugural session features addresses by **Praveen Keshav Vohra**, Deputy Chief of Integrated Defence Staff (Policy Planning & Force Development).

271. In 2026, the Indian Navy successfully carried out a high-risk Explosive Ordnance Disposal (EOD) operation involving the recovery of an unexploded missile warhead from which vessel?

A.MT New Diamond

B.MT Olympic Life

C.MT Suez Rajan

D.MT Chem Pluto

E.MT Front Altair

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The **Indian Navy** successfully completed a **High-Risk Explosive Ordnance Disposal (EOD) Operation** involving the recovery of an **Unexploded Missile Warhead** from the crude oil tanker **MT Olympic Life**.

The **Marshall Islands-flagged** tanker was sailing from **Fujairah, UAE, to Kochi** when it reported an explosion in its hull on **26 May 2026** while off the coast of **Oman**.

The vessel had **No Indian Nationals Onboard** and later reported the presence of an **Unexploded Ordnance (UXO)** during its transit towards Kochi.

The information was received through the **Information Fusion Centre – Indian Ocean Region (IFC-IOR)**, following which the Indian Navy initiated a coordinated response.

Detailed Explanation:

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The information was received through the **Information Fusion Centre – Indian Ocean Region (IFC-IOR)**, following which the Indian Navy initiated a coordinated response.

The **Southern Naval Command**, based in **Kochi**, deployed a specialist **Explosive Ordnance Disposal (EOD) Team** to assess the situation.

The EOD team confirmed that a **Projectile** had penetrated the ship's hull, passed through multiple structural compartments, and become lodged inside a **Fuel Tank**.

Due to the presence of an **Unexploded Missile Warhead** inside a fuel storage compartment, the operation required extreme caution to ensure the safety of the ship, crew, and port infrastructure.

272. In 2026, the Indian Chamber of Commerce (ICC) delegation informed the Union Minister about its plan to facilitate investments worth how much in West Bengal?

A.₹50,000 Crore

B.₹75,000 Crore

C.₹1 Lakh Crore

D.₹1.25 Lakh Crore

E.₹2 Lakh Crore

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

An **Indian Chamber of Commerce (ICC)** delegation led by its President **Brij Bhushan Aggarwal** met **Jitendra Singh** in New Delhi.

During the meeting, the ICC apprised the Minister about its **Investment Initiatives in West Bengal** and expressed its willingness to collaborate with both the **Central Government** and the **Government of West Bengal**.

The chamber informed that it is working towards facilitating investments worth **₹1 Lakh Crore** in West Bengal through its member companies.

Detailed Explanation:

An **Indian Chamber of Commerce (ICC)** delegation led by its President **Brij**

Bhushan Aggarwal met **Jitendra Singh** in New Delhi.

During the meeting, the ICC apprised the Minister about its **Investment Initiatives in West Bengal** and expressed its willingness to collaborate with both the **Central Government** and the **Government of West Bengal**.

The chamber informed that it is working towards facilitating investments worth **₹1 Lakh Crore** in West Bengal through its member companies.

The proposed **₹1 Lakh Crore Investment Plan** reflects strong **Industry Confidence** in the state's economic potential and future growth prospects.

According to the ICC, West Bengal is witnessing a **Renewed Sense of Optimism** and **Positive Economic Momentum**, which could help accelerate industrial and economic growth.

273. In 2026, Union Minister Dr. Jitendra Singh launched three new research clusters at IIT Gandhinagar under DST funding. Which of the following is NOT one of these clusters?

A.Advanced Materials Research Cluster (AMRC)

B.Energy Research Cluster (ERC)

C.Healthcare & MedTech Research Cluster (HMRC)

D.Quantum Computing Research Cluster (QCRC)

E.None of the above

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

Union Minister Dr. Jitendra Singh addressed the programme **"Advancing Research & Innovation Towards Viksit Bharat"** at the **Indian Institute of Technology Gandhinagar (IIT Gandhinagar)** and emphasized that the true value of scientific research lies in creating **societal and economic impact**, not just research publications.

The Minister launched the **DST-funded Central Instrumentation Facility (CIF)** and **three new research clusters** at IIT Gandhinagar.

The three newly launched research clusters are the **Advanced Materials Research Cluster (AMRC)**, **Energy Research Cluster (ERC)**, and **Healthcare & MedTech Research Cluster (HMRC)**.

Detailed Explanation:

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The three newly launched research clusters are the **Advanced Materials Research Cluster (AMRC)**, **Energy Research Cluster (ERC)**, and **Healthcare & MedTech Research Cluster (HMRC)**.

These research clusters are designed to transform cutting-edge research into deployable solutions for national development through a **translational research approach**.

Important national initiatives highlighted include the **National Quantum Mission** and the **IndiaAI Mission**, which aim to strengthen India's technological capabilities.

The newly inaugurated **Central Instrumentation Facility (CIF)** will provide researchers, startups, and industries access to **advanced scientific infrastructure** and sophisticated research equipment.

During the visit, he interacted with **startups and faculty-led technology demonstrations** at the **IIT Gandhinagar Research Park**.

274. In 2026, Adani Ports and Special Economic Zone Limited (APSEZ) entered South America by securing a marine services contract for Argentina's first LNG export project. The contract is associated with which project?

A.Vaca Muerta LNG Project

B.Southern Energy Floating LNG Project

C.Patagonia LNG Terminal Project

D.Rio Grande LNG Project

E.San Jorge LNG Project

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Adani Ports and Special Economic Zone Limited (APSEZ) secured a **10-year marine services contract** for **Argentina's first Liquefied Natural Gas (LNG) export project**, marking the company's entry into **South America**.

The contract, valued at approximately **USD 70 million**, was awarded to **Adani Harbour International Free Zone Company (FZCO)**, a subsidiary of APSEZ, in partnership with the Argentina-based **Meridian Group**.

The **Southern Energy FLNG Project** is located in the **San Matías Gulf, Argentina**, and is scheduled to commence operations in **September 2027**.

Detailed Explanation:

Adani Ports and Special Economic Zone Limited (APSEZ) secured a **10-year marine services contract** for **Argentina's first Liquefied Natural Gas (LNG) export project**, marking the company's entry into **South America**.

The contract, valued at approximately **USD 70 million**, was awarded to **Adani Harbour International Free Zone Company (FZCO)**, a subsidiary of APSEZ, in partnership with the Argentina-based **Meridian Group**.

The project will be executed through **Meridian Transportes Marítimos S.A.**, a **Joint Venture (JV)** in which **Adani Harbour International FZCO holds 51% stake** and **Meridian Group holds 49% stake**.

The **Adani–Meridian consortium** will provide comprehensive **marine services** for the **Southern Energy Floating Liquefied Natural Gas (FLNG) Project**.

The **marine support fleet** will include **four tugboats**, **one Anchor Handling Tug Supply (AHTS) vessel**, and **one crew boat**.
The **Southern Energy FLNG Project** is located in the **San Matías Gulf, Argentina**, and is scheduled to commence operations in **September 2027**.

275. In 2026, Russia offered India the joint production of which fifth-generation stealth fighter aircraft along with full technology transfer?
A.F-35 Lightning II
B.Chengdu J-20
C.Sukhoi Su-30MKI
D.MiG-35
E.Sukhoi Su-57
Answer: E
Short Explanation:
Russian President Vladimir Putin offered **India** the advanced **Sukhoi Su-57 stealth fighter aircraft** and proposed its **joint production in India**, strengthening **defence cooperation** between the two countries.
In **2007**, **India and Russia** launched the **Fifth Generation Fighter Aircraft (FGFA) Programme** to jointly develop an advanced stealth fighter based on the **Sukhoi Su-57 platform**.
Detailed Explanation:
Russian President Vladimir Putin offered **India** the advanced **Sukhoi Su-57 stealth fighter aircraft** and proposed its **joint production in India**, strengthening **defence cooperation** between the two countries.
The announcement was made on the sidelines of the **St. Petersburg International Economic Forum** held in **St. Petersburg, Russia**.
The proposal includes **full technology transfer (ToT)** and the establishment of **manufacturing facilities in India**, supporting the Government's **Make in India** and **defence indigenisation** initiatives.
In **2007**, **India and Russia** launched the **Fifth Generation Fighter Aircraft (FGFA) Programme** to jointly develop an advanced stealth fighter based on the **Sukhoi Su-57 platform**.
India formally withdrew from the **FGFA Programme in 2021** due to concerns regarding **high costs**, **technology transfer issues**, and **aircraft performance requirements**.

276. In 2026, the Competition Commission of India (CCI) approved the acquisition of what percentage of expanded equity capital in Shriram Life Insurance Company Limited by Sanlam Emerging Markets (Mauritius) Ltd.?
A.1.80%
B.2.50%
C.2.80%
D.3.20%
E.4.00%
Answer: C
Short Explanation:

The **Competition Commission of India (CCI)** has approved the acquisition of a certain shareholding in **Shriram Life Insurance Company Limited** by **Sanlam Emerging Markets (Mauritius) Ltd. (SEMM)**.

The proposed transaction involves the acquisition of **2.80% of the Expanded Equity Capital** of Shriram Life Insurance Company Limited through a **Preferential Issue**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Competition Commission of India (CCI)** has approved the acquisition of a certain shareholding in **Shriram Life Insurance Company Limited** by **Sanlam Emerging Markets (Mauritius) Ltd. (SEMM)**.

The proposed transaction involves the acquisition of **2.80% of the Expanded Equity Capital** of Shriram Life Insurance Company Limited through a **Preferential Issue**.

The acquiring entity, **Sanlam Emerging Markets (Mauritius) Ltd.**, is incorporated in Mauritius.

SEMM is a part of the **Sanlam Group**, a leading financial services group based in **South Africa**.

Sanlam Group is a long-standing **Strategic Partner of the Shriram Group** and has investments in several Shriram Group companies in India.

277. In 2026, the Department of Drinking Water and Sanitation (DDWS) signed a reform-linked MoU with which state to strengthen rural water supply under Jal Jeevan Mission 2.0?

A.Assam

B.Sikkim

C.Himachal Pradesh

D.Uttarakhand

E.Meghalaya

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The **Department of Drinking Water and Sanitation** (DDWS) under the Ministry of Jal Shakti (MoJS) and the **Government of Sikkim** signed a reform-linked **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** to strengthen rural water supply infrastructure under **Jal Jeevan Mission 2.0 (JJM 2.0)**.

The MoU was signed in the presence of Union Minister of Jal Shakti C. R. Patil and Sikkim Chief Minister Prem Singh Tamang.

The MoU promotes a **Gram Panchayat-led, service-based and community-centric model** of rural water governance, ensuring stronger community participation and sustainable operation and maintenance of rural water supply systems.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Department of Drinking Water and Sanitation** (DDWS) under the Ministry of Jal Shakti (MoJS) and the **Government of Sikkim** signed a reform-linked **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** to strengthen rural water supply infrastructure under **Jal Jeevan Mission 2.0 (JJM 2.0)**.

The MoU was signed in the presence of Union Minister of Jal Shakti C. R. Patil and Sikkim Chief Minister Prem Singh Tamang.

The MoU promotes a **Gram Panchayat-led, service-based and community-centric model** of rural water governance, ensuring stronger community participation and sustainable operation and maintenance of rural water supply systems.

The initiative aims to provide every rural household with **safe, adequate, and prescribed quality drinking water on a regular basis**.

In March 2026, the Union Cabinet approved the extension of **Jal Jeevan Mission (JJM)** till **December 2028** with an enhanced total outlay of **₹8.69 lakh crore**.

Jal Jeevan Mission 2.0 (JJM 2.0) aims to certify all Gram Panchayats as **'Har Ghar Jal'** by providing **functional household tap connections** to all **19.36 crore rural households** by December 2028.

278. In 2026, Roppen Transportation Services (Rapido) partnered with MoRTH to promote which government scheme focused on assisting road accident victims during the Golden Hour?

A.Rahveer Scheme

B.Raksha Setu Scheme

C.Suraksha Bandhan Scheme

D.Jeevan Raksha Scheme

E.Road Mitra Scheme

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

Roppen Transportation Services Private Limited, operating under the brand name **Rapido** has partnered with the **Ministry of Road Transport & Highways (MoRTH)** to promote nationwide awareness and citizen participation in the Government of India's **Rahveer Scheme**.

As part of the campaign, more than **4 lakh Rapido captains** across India took the **Rahveer Pledge** through the company's platform, creating a **Guinness World Record**.

The agreement was signed in the presence of **Union Minister Nitin Gadkari** and **Aravind Sanka**, **Co-founder of Rapido**

Detailed Explanation:

Roppen Transportation Services Private Limited, operating under the brand name **Rapido** has partnered with the **Ministry of Road Transport & Highways (MoRTH)** to promote nationwide awareness and citizen participation in the Government of India's **Rahveer Scheme**.

As part of the campaign, more than **4 lakh Rapido captains** across India took the **Rahveer Pledge** through the company's platform, creating a **Guinness World Record**.

The agreement was signed in the presence of **Union Minister Nitin Gadkari** and **Aravind Sanka**, **Co-founder of Rapido**

The initiative aims to enhance **road safety awareness** and encourage citizens to assist road accident victims without hesitation.

The **Rahveer Scheme** promotes immediate assistance to accident victims during the **Golden Hour**, the critical period immediately after an accident when timely medical help can

significantly improve survival and recovery chances.

The **RahVeer Scheme** was launched by the **Ministry of Road Transport & Highways (MoRTH)** in **April 2025** as a **reward-based initiative** to encourage bystanders to help road accident victims

279. In 2026, Invest India signed a strategic partnership with which state to attract higher Foreign Direct Investment (FDI) and accelerate industrial development?

A.Maharashtra

B.Tamil Nadu

C.Karnataka

D.Gujarat

E.Uttar Pradesh

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

Invest India and **Invest UP** signed a strategic partnership to attract higher **Foreign Direct Investment (FDI)** and accelerate industrial development in **Uttar Pradesh**.

The partnership was formalised during a high-level meeting held in **Lucknow** with senior officials from both organisations.

Detailed Explanation:

Invest India and **Invest UP** signed a strategic partnership to attract higher **Foreign Direct Investment (FDI)** and accelerate industrial development in **Uttar Pradesh**.

The partnership was formalised during a high-level meeting held in **Lucknow** with senior officials from both organisations.

The collaboration aims to convert investment commitments into operational projects by improving investor facilitation, project execution, and global investment outreach.

The initiative supports Uttar Pradesh's vision of becoming a **$1 trillion economy**.

280. In 2026, which Indian port emerged as the highest-performing container port in the CPPI 2025 and secured 22nd rank globally?

A.Mundra Port

B.Visakhapatnam Port

C.Chennai Port

D.Jawaharlal Nehru Port Authority (JNPA)

E.Kolkata Port

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

Jawaharlal Nehru Port Authority (JNPA) emerged as India's highest-performing container port in the **Container Port Performance Index (CPPI) 2025**, jointly published by the **World Bank** and **S&P Global Market Intelligence**.

JNPA secured the **22nd position globally** in CPPI 2025, improving by one rank compared to the previous edition.

Among Indian ports, **Pipavav Port** ranked **28th,** overtaking **Mundra Port** (30th) to become the highest-ranked private container port in India, while **Visakhapatnam Port** secured the **104th position.**

Detailed Explanation:

Jawaharlal Nehru Port Authority (JNPA) emerged as India's highest-performing container port in the **Container Port Performance Index (CPPI) 2025**, jointly published by the **World Bank** and **S&P Global Market Intelligence**.

JNPA secured the **22nd position globally** in CPPI 2025, improving by one rank compared to the previous edition.

It continued its position as India's leading container port and was recognised among the world's most improved ports over the last six years.

The achievement reflects improvements in vessel turnaround time, cargo handling efficiency, and overall operational performance.

Among Indian ports, **Pipavav Port** ranked **28th,** overtaking **Mundra Port** (30th) to become the highest-ranked private container port in India,

while **Visakhapatnam Port** secured the **104th position.**

The **Container Port Performance Index (CPPI)** assesses ports based on factors such as vessel turnaround time, cargo handling speed, operational efficiency, and supply chain performance

281. In 2026, India won 2 gold medals at the New Taipei City Athletics Open. Who won gold in the women's long jump event held at Banqiao Stadium, Chinese Taipei?

A.Ancy Sojan

B.Shaili Singh

C.Jyothi Yarraji

D.Pooja Singh

E.Murali Sreeshankar

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

India finished with **4 medals (2 gold and 2 silver)** at the **New Taipei City Athletics Open 2026** held at **Banqiao Stadium, Chinese Taipei**.

The tournament was a **World Athletics Continental Tour Silver-level event**, upgraded from Bronze category in 2026.

Shaili Singh won the **gold medal in the women's long jump** with a jump of **6.24 metres**, defeating Vietnam's **Tran Thi Loan (6.23 m)** by one centimetre.

Detailed Explanation:

India finished with **4 medals (2 gold and 2 silver)** at the **New Taipei City Athletics Open 2026** held at **Banqiao Stadium, Chinese Taipei**.

The tournament was a **World Athletics Continental Tour Silver-level event**, upgraded from Bronze category in 2026.

Shaili Singh won the **gold medal in the women's long jump** with a jump of **6.24 metres**, defeating Vietnam's **Tran Thi Loan (6.23 m)** by one centimetre.

Shaili Singh's **season-best performance is 6.58 metres** (Federation Cup 2026), while her **personal best and Under-20 Indian national record is 6.76 metres**, achieved in 2023.

India's women's **4×100 metre relay team** of **SS Sneha, Srabani Nanda, Sudeshna Shivankar, and Tamanna** won the **gold medal** by clocking **44.07 seconds** and equalled the meet record.

282. In 2026, India won 8 gold medals at the Ulaanbaatar Open Wrestling Tournament. Who won the gold medal in the Greco-Roman 87 kg category?

A.Deepak
B.Sunil Kumar
C.Sagar Jaglan
D.Nitesh Kumar
E.Kajal Dhochak

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

India delivered an impressive performance at the **Ulaanbaatar Open 2026 Wrestling Tournament** held in **Mongolia**, securing a total of **17 medals**, including **8 gold and 9 bronze medals**.

The medals were won across **men's freestyle, women's freestyle, and Greco-Roman wrestling categories**.

Gold Medal Winners:

Men's Freestyle: Deepak (61 kg), Sagar Jaglan (74 kg), and Dinesh Dhankhar (125 kg)

Women's Freestyle: Manisha Bhanwala (57 kg), Neha Sangwan (59 kg), and Kajal Dhochak (76 kg)

Greco-Roman: Sunil Kumar (87 kg) and Nitesh Kumar (97 kg)

Detailed Explanation:

India delivered an impressive performance at the **Ulaanbaatar Open 2026 Wrestling Tournament** held in **Mongolia**, securing a total of **17 medals**, including **8 gold and 9 bronze medals**.

The medals were won across **men's freestyle, women's freestyle, and Greco-Roman wrestling categories**.

The tournament was the **3rd United World Wrestling (UWW) Ranking Series event of the season** and served as an important preparation event for the **2026 Asian Games**.

Gold Medal Winners:

Men's Freestyle: Deepak (61 kg), Sagar Jaglan (74 kg), and Dinesh Dhankhar (125 kg)

Women's Freestyle: Manisha Bhanwala (57 kg), Neha Sangwan (59 kg), and Kajal Dhochak (76 kg)

Greco-Roman: Sunil Kumar (87 kg) and Nitesh Kumar (97 kg)

283. In 2026, World Day Against Child Labour is observed every year on which date?

A.5 June
B.10 June
C.13 June
D.12 June
E.20 June

Answer: D

World Day Against Child Labour is observed every year on **12 June** to raise awareness about child labour and promote efforts to eliminate it worldwide.

The day was launched by the **International Labour Organization (ILO)** in **2002** to draw global attention to the exploitation of children and the need to protect their rights.

284. In 2026, International Albinism Awareness Day is observed every year on which date?

A.10 June

B.11 June

C.12 June

D.9 June

E.13 June

Answer: E

International Albinism Awareness Day is observed every year on **13 June** to raise awareness about the rights, dignity, and inclusion of persons with albinism and to combat discrimination and violence against them.

In **2013**, the **United Nations Human Rights Council (UNHRC)** adopted a resolution calling for the prevention of discrimination and protection of the human rights of persons with albinism.

On **18 December 2014**, the **United Nations General Assembly (UNGA)** adopted a resolution proclaiming **13 June as International Albinism Awareness Day**, with the first observance held in **2015**.

285. As of 2026, what is the currency of Mongolia?

A.Yen

B.Tögrög

C.Won

D.Taka

E.Som

Answer: B

About Mongolia

Capital: Ulaanbaatar

Currency: Mongolian Tögrög

President: Ukhnaagiin Khürelsükh

Prime Minister: Nyam-Osoryn Uchral

286. In 2026, according to the RBI's report "Developments in India's Balance of Payments during Q4 (January–March) FY 2025-26", India recorded a Current Account Surplus (CAS) of how much during Q4 FY26?

A.US$ 1.0 Billion (0.1% of GDP)

B.US$ 4.2 Billion (0.4% of GDP)

C.US$ 7.1 Billion (0.7% of GDP)

D.US$ 12.0 Billion (1.2% of GDP)

E.US$ 25.2 Billion (0.6% of GDP)

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

India recorded a Current Account Surplus (CAS) of US$ 7.1 Billion, equivalent to **0.7% of GDP**, during the **Fourth Quarter (Q4: January–March) of FY 2025-26**.

This marks a significant improvement from the **Current Account Deficit (CAD) of US$ 13.2 Billion** recorded in the previous quarter.

The surplus was primarily driven by **Strong Growth in Services Exports** and a substantial increase in **Remittances from Indians Working Abroad**.

Detailed Explanation:

India recorded a Current Account Surplus (CAS) of US$ 7.1 Billion, equivalent to **0.7% of GDP**, during the **Fourth Quarter (Q4: January–March) of FY 2025-26**.

This marks a significant improvement from the **Current Account Deficit (CAD) of US$ 13.2 Billion** recorded in the previous quarter.

The surplus was primarily driven by **Strong Growth in Services Exports** and a substantial increase in **Remittances from Indians Working Abroad**.

According to the **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** report titled **"Developments in India's Balance of Payments during the Fourth Quarter (January–March) of 2025-26"**, **Net Services Receipts** increased to **US$ 60.4 Billion in Q4 FY26** from US$ 53.3 Billion in the corresponding quarter of the previous year.

Despite the current account surplus, **India's Merchandise Trade Deficit widened sharply to US$ 83.4 Billion in Q4 FY26** from US$ 59.3 Billion a year earlier due to higher imports.

For the **entire FY 2025-26**, India's **Current Account Deficit (CAD) stood at US$ 25.2 Billion**, equivalent to **0.6% of GDP**, compared to US$ 22.9 Billion in FY25.

Foreign Direct Investment (FDI) recorded a **Net Inflow of US$ 4.2 Billion** during **Q4 FY26**.

On an annual basis, **Net FDI Inflows increased significantly to US$ 6.9 Billion in FY26**, compared to US$ 1.0 Billion in FY25.

Foreign Portfolio Investment (FPI) witnessed a **Net Outflow of US$ 12.0 Billion** during **Q4 FY26**.

287. In 2026, the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) imposed a monetary penalty of ₹3.90 lakh on which company for violations of KYC Directions and Fraud Risk Management in NBFCs Directions?

A.Repco Home Finance Limited

B.True Credits Private Limited

C.IIFL Samasta Finance Limited

D.Bajaj Finance Limited

E.Muthoot Finance Limited

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) imposed a **Monetary Penalty of ₹3.90 Lakh** on **IIFL Samasta Finance Limited** for violations of **Know Your Customer (KYC) Directions** and **Fraud Risk Management in NBFCs Directions**.

RBI found that **IIFL Samasta Finance Limited** failed to implement a **Robust Software System** for effective identification and reporting of **Suspicious Transactions**.

The company also failed to disclose the **Correct Details of Frauds** reported during **FY 2024-25** in its **Financial Statements (Notes to Accounts)**.

Detailed Explanation:

The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) imposed a **Monetary Penalty of ₹3.90 Lakh** on **IIFL Samasta Finance Limited** for violations

of **Know Your Customer (KYC) Directions** and **Fraud Risk Management in NBFCs Directions**.

RBI found that **IIFL Samasta Finance Limited** failed to implement a **Robust Software System** for effective identification and reporting of **Suspicious Transactions**.

The company also failed to disclose the **Correct Details of Frauds** reported during **FY 2024-25** in its **Financial Statements (Notes to Accounts)**.

RBI imposed a separate **Penalty of ₹3.10 Lakh** on **True Credits Private Limited** for **Non-Compliance with KYC Regulations**.

True Credits Private Limited failed to carry out **Enhanced Due Diligence (EDD)** for certain customers onboarded through **Non-Face-to-Face Modes**, as mandated under **RBI's KYC Directions**.

RBI also imposed a **Penalty of ₹70,000** on **Repco Home Finance Limited** for violating **Fair Practice Code (FPC) Guidelines**.

288. In 2026, Bank of India (BOI) inaugurated a dedicated Strategic Business Branch (SBB) at which location to strengthen its Digital and Partnership-Led Financing Business?

A.Bandra Kurla Complex, Mumbai

B.Nariman Point, Mumbai

C.Connaught Place, New Delhi

D.GIFT City, Gandhinagar

E.Salt Lake, Kolkata

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Bank of India (BOI) inaugurated a dedicated **Strategic Business Branch (SBB)** at **Nariman Point, Mumbai, Maharashtra** to strengthen its **Digital and Partnership-Led Financing Business**.

The newly launched **Strategic Business Branch (SBB)** will function as a specialized hub for **Innovative Financing Solutions** and strategic business partnerships.

The branch will focus on major financing segments such as **Pool Buyout, Co-Lending, Trade Receivables Discounting System (TReDS)**, and **Supply Chain Finance**.

Detailed Explanation:

Bank of India (BOI) inaugurated a dedicated **Strategic Business Branch (SBB)** at **Nariman Point, Mumbai, Maharashtra** to strengthen its **Digital and Partnership-Led Financing Business**.

The newly launched **Strategic Business Branch (SBB)** will function as a specialized hub for **Innovative Financing Solutions** and strategic business partnerships.

The branch will focus on major financing segments such as **Pool Buyout, Co-Lending, Trade Receivables Discounting System (TReDS)**, and **Supply Chain Finance**.

The initiative is aimed at enhancing collaboration with **Non-Banking Financial Companies (NBFCs), Fintech Companies, Corporates**, and **Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises (MSMEs)**.

The dedicated branch is expected to improve access to **Technology-Driven Financial**

Solutions and support the evolving financing requirements of businesses.

According to BOI, the **Strategic Business Branch** will act as a **Centre of Excellence for Partnership-Led Financing**, promoting sustainable business growth.

The branch will help enhance **Scalability, Portfolio Monitoring**, and **Operational Efficiency** while ensuring strong **Governance and Risk Controls**.

289. As of 2026, according to the RBI's Survey of Professional Forecasters (SPF), what is the projected Real GDP Growth rate for India in FY 2026-27 (FY27)?

A.5.8%

B.6.1%

C.6.6%

D.6.5%

E.6.9%

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) Survey of Professional Forecasters (SPF) projected **India's Real GDP Growth at 6.5% for FY 2026-27 (FY27)**.

The **SPF GDP Growth Forecast of 6.5%** is slightly lower than the **RBI's Official Projection of 6.6%** for FY27.

The survey projected **Consumer Price Index (CPI) Inflation at 4.9% for FY27**, indicating a relatively optimistic inflation outlook.

The **SPF Inflation Forecast of 4.9%** is lower than the **RBI's CPI Inflation Projection of 5.1%** for FY27.

Detailed Explanation:

The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) Survey of Professional Forecasters (SPF) projected **India's Real GDP Growth at 6.5% for FY 2026-27 (FY27)**.

The **SPF GDP Growth Forecast of 6.5%** is slightly lower than the **RBI's Official Projection of 6.6%** for FY27.

The survey projected **Consumer Price Index (CPI) Inflation at 4.9% for FY27**, indicating a relatively optimistic inflation outlook.

The **SPF Inflation Forecast of 4.9%** is lower than the **RBI's CPI Inflation Projection of 5.1%** for FY27.

For **FY 2027-28 (FY28)**, the survey projected **GDP Growth at 6.9%** and **CPI Inflation at 4.5%**.

According to the survey, the **Highest Probability** assigned by professional forecasters is for **GDP Growth to remain in the range of 6.5%–6.9%** during both FY27 and FY28.

The **Current Account Deficit (CAD) is projected at 2.1% of GDP in FY27**, higher than the previous estimate of 1.5% of GDP.

For **FY28**, the **Current Account Deficit (CAD) is expected to moderate to 1.2% of GDP**.

290. In 2026, consider the following statements regarding the RBI's US Dollar–

Rupee Swap Facility for External Commercial Borrowings (ECBs):

1. **The facility is available to PSUs and AD Category-I Banks raising Overseas Foreign Currency Borrowings (OFCBs).**
2. **Eligible borrowings must have a minimum maturity period of 3 years.**
3. **The swap carries a fixed premium of 1.5% per annum, compounded semi-annually.**

Which of the above statements is correct?

A.Only Statement 1 is correct

B.Only Statements 1 and 2 are correct

C.Only Statements 2 and 3 are correct

D.All Statements are Correct

E.None of the Statements are Correct

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

The **ECB Swap Facility** is available to **Public Sector Undertakings (PSUs)** and **Authorised Dealer Category-I (AD Category-I) Banks** raising **Overseas Foreign Currency Borrowings (OFCBs)**.

Eligible borrowings must have a **Minimum Maturity Period of 3 Years**.

Under the facility, banks can **Sell US Dollars to RBI and Repurchase Them** at the End of the Swap Period.

The swap carries a **Fixed Premium of 1.5% Per Annum**, compounded **Semi-Annually**.

The **Maximum Swap Tenor is 5 Years**, aligned with the repayment schedule of the borrowing.

The operations will be overseen by **RBI's Financial Markets Operations Department (FMOD)**.

Detailed Explanation:

US Dollar–Rupee Swap Facility for ECBs

The **ECB Swap Facility** is available to **Public Sector Undertakings (PSUs)** and **Authorised Dealer Category-I (AD Category-I) Banks** raising **Overseas Foreign Currency Borrowings (OFCBs)**.

Eligible borrowings must have a **Minimum Maturity Period of 3 Years**.

The facility will remain open until **15 January 2027**, covering eligible drawdowns and inflows received up to **31 December 2026**.

The scheme also covers the **Undrawn Portions of Existing ECBs**, but **excludes** borrowings raised for **Refinancing** and those containing **Embedded Options**.

Under the facility, banks can **Sell US Dollars to RBI and Repurchase Them** at the End of the Swap Period.

The swap carries a **Fixed Premium of 1.5% Per Annum**, compounded **Semi-Annually**.

The **Maximum Swap Tenor is 5 Years**, aligned with the repayment schedule of the borrowing.

The operations will be overseen by **RBI's Financial Markets Operations Department (FMOD)**.

291. In 2026, regarding the RBI's Swap Window for Fresh FCNR(B) Deposits, which of the following statements is INCORRECT?

A.The swap window is available for fresh FCNR(B) deposits mobilised between 8 June 2026 and 30 September 2026.
B.Eligible FCNR(B) deposits must have a maturity period ranging from 3 years to 5 years.
C.Deposits can be mobilised in any freely convertible currency
D.The swap facility with RBI is available only in US Dollars
E.The deposits can be prematurely withdrawn at any time without any lock-in period.
Answer: E
Short Explanation:
RBI has also launched a **Swap Window for Fresh FCNR(B) Deposits** mobilised between **8 June 2026 and 30 September 2026**.
The facility will remain available until **16 October 2026**.
Eligible **FCNR(B) Deposits** must have a maturity period ranging from **3 Years to 5 Years**.
The deposits will have a **One-Year Lock-in Period**, after which premature withdrawal may be allowed.
Detailed Explanation:
RBI has also launched a **Swap Window for Fresh FCNR(B) Deposits** mobilised between **8 June 2026 and 30 September 2026**.
The facility will remain available until **16 October 2026**.
Eligible **FCNR(B) Deposits** must have a maturity period ranging from **3 Years to 5 Years**.
Deposits can be mobilised in **Any Freely Convertible Currency**, but the swap facility with RBI is available **only in US Dollars**.
Banks must convert non-dollar deposits into **Equivalent US Dollar Amounts** using prevailing market exchange rates.
The swap will be conducted **At Par** using the **Financial Benchmark India Private Limited (FBIL) Reference Rate** for both legs of the transaction.
Each bank can access the facility **Once a Week**, subject to limits based on fresh deposits mobilised.
The deposits will have a **One-Year Lock-in Period**, after which premature withdrawal may be allowed.

292. In 2026, India had earlier planned a pilot project to introduce ₹10 Polymer Banknotes in selected cities in which year?
A.2012
B.2010
C.2011
D.2014
E.2016
Answer: A
Short Explanation:
Sanjay Malhotra, **Governor of the Reserve Bank of India (RBI)**, stated that the proposal to introduce **Polymer Banknotes** in India is currently under consideration and is at a **Preliminary Evaluation Stage**.

The **RBI** is assessing the **Advantages and Disadvantages** of polymer currency before taking a final decision on its implementation.
India had earlier planned a **Pilot Project in 2012** to introduce **₹10 Polymer Notes** in selected cities, but the initiative was later shelved due to **Technological Challenges**.
Detailed Explanation:
Sanjay Malhotra, **Governor of the Reserve Bank of India (RBI)**, stated that the proposal to introduce **Polymer Banknotes** in India is currently under consideration and is at a **Preliminary Evaluation Stage**.
The **RBI** is assessing the **Advantages and Disadvantages** of polymer currency before taking a final decision on its implementation.
Polymer Banknotes are made from a **Flexible Plastic Substrate** and are considered more **Durable**, **Long-Lasting**, and **Counterfeit-Resistant** than traditional paper notes.
At present, **Indian Banknotes** are printed on paper made from **100% Cotton**, which has been the standard material for currency production in India.
Despite the rapid growth of digital payments, **Cash** continues to remain a **widely preferred mode of payment** for many people across India.
India had earlier planned a **Pilot Project in 2012** to introduce **₹10 Polymer Notes** in selected cities, but the initiative was later shelved due to **Technological Challenges**.

293. In 2026, Air India launched its first "Easy Connect" flights under the Government of India's hub-and-spoke aviation model from which city?

A.Lucknow
B.Varanasi
C.Jaipur
D.Indore
E.Bhubaneswar
Answer: B
Short Explanation:
Air India has launched its first **"Easy Connect" flights** under the Government of India's **hub-and-spoke aviation model**, with services from **Varanasi scheduled to commence on 25 June 2026**.
The **Easy Connect** service aims to simplify international travel for passengers from **Tier 2 and Tier 3 cities** by allowing them to complete **baggage check-in and immigration formalities at their departure airport** before connecting through a major hub airport.
Detailed Explanation:
Air India has launched its first **"Easy Connect" flights** under the Government of India's **hub-and-spoke aviation model**, with services from **Varanasi scheduled to commence on 25 June 2026**.
The **Easy Connect** service aims to simplify international travel for passengers from **Tier 2 and Tier 3 cities** by allowing them to complete **baggage check-in and immigration formalities at their departure airport** before connecting through a major hub airport.

Under the **hub-and-spoke model**, cities like **Varanasi act as 'spokes'** connected to hub airports such as **Delhi**, enabling passengers to access Air India's international network through coordinated flight schedules and seamless transit processes.

The designated **Easy Connect flight from Varanasi to Delhi** will operate daily as **flight AI1111**.

The flight schedule has been aligned to provide onward international connectivity within **4 hours** to **17 international destinations** across **Europe, Southeast Asia, and West Asia**.

294. In 2026, who was present at the launch of Assam's first "Blue Valley Cluster", an industrial hub focused on flavours, fragrances, and AYUSH?

A.Ursula von der Leyen

B.Charles Michel

C.Hervé Delphin

D.Josep Borrell

E.Kaja Kallas

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

Assam's first "Blue Valley Cluster", an industrial hub focused on **flavours, fragrances, and AYUSH**, was launched in the presence of the **Ambassador of the European Union (EU) to India, Hervé Delphin**, and **Assam Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma**.

AYUSH stands for **Ayurveda, Yoga and Naturopathy, Unani, Siddha, and Homoeopathy**.

The **Blue Valley Cluster** is led by the **Government of Assam** and aligns with the priorities outlined in the **EU-India Comprehensive Strategic Agenda**, adopted during the **EU-India Summit held in January 2026**.

Detailed Explanation:

Assam's first "Blue Valley Cluster", an industrial hub focused on **flavours, fragrances, and AYUSH**, was launched in the presence of the **Ambassador of the European Union (EU) to India, Hervé Delphin**, and **Assam Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma**.

AYUSH stands for **Ayurveda, Yoga and Naturopathy, Unani, Siddha, and Homoeopathy**.

The **Blue Valley Cluster** is led by the **Government of Assam** and aligns with the priorities outlined in the **EU-India Comprehensive Strategic Agenda**, adopted during the **EU-India Summit held in January 2026**.

The initiative aims to promote **inclusive livelihoods, skill development, and employment generation**, while strengthening Assam's role as a strategic gateway for sustainable trade, investment, and innovation partnerships between Northeast India and Europe.

To strengthen business cooperation, the **Assam Industrial Development Corporation Ltd**

(AIDC) and the **Federation of European Businesses in India (FEBI)** signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)**.

295. In 2026, the Government of Andhra Pradesh launched the statewide yoga promotion campaign "Yogandhra-2026" at which location?

A.Tirumala Temple, Tirupati
B.Kanaka Durga Temple, Vijayawada
C.Veerabhadra Swamy Temple, Lepakshi
D.Simhachalam Temple, Visakhapatnam
E.Srisailam Temple, Nandyal

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The **Government of Andhra Pradesh** launched **"Yogandhra-2026"**, a statewide **yoga promotion and awareness campaign**, at the **Veerabhadra Swamy Temple premises in Lepakshi, Sri Sathya Sai district**.

The **14-day programme** is being organised from **7 June to 20 June 2026** and will culminate with a grand celebration of **International Yoga Day on 21 June 2026 in Amaravati** with mass participation.

The campaign is being conducted across all **28 districts of Andhra Pradesh** with a target to involve **1 crore (10 million) participants**.

Online registrations for the campaign began on the **Yogandhra Portal on 7 June 2026**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Government of Andhra Pradesh** launched **"Yogandhra-2026"**, a statewide **yoga promotion and awareness campaign**, at the **Veerabhadra Swamy Temple premises in Lepakshi, Sri Sathya Sai district**.

The **14-day programme** is being organised from **7 June to 20 June 2026** and will culminate with a grand celebration of **International Yoga Day on 21 June 2026 in Amaravati** with mass participation.

The campaign is being conducted across all **28 districts of Andhra Pradesh** with a target to involve **1 crore (10 million) participants**.

Online registrations for the campaign began on the **Yogandhra Portal on 7 June 2026**.

The portal recorded **25,000 registrations on the first day**, while the total registrations crossed **5 lakh within three days** of launch.

Guntur district recorded the highest registrations with **98,000 participants**, followed by **Nellore, Nandyal, Kurnool, and Palnadu districts**.

296. In 2026, the University of New South Wales (UNSW) received approval to establish its India campus, UNSW Bengaluru, at which location?

A.Electronic City, Bengaluru
B.Whitefield, Bengaluru
C.HITEC City, Hyderabad
D.GIFT City, Gandhinagar
E.Manyata Business Park, Bengaluru

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

The **Ministry of Education (MoE)** has issued **3 Letters of Approval (LoAs)** to three globally reputed **Foreign Higher Education Institutions**

(FHEIs)—University of Bristol, University of York, and University of New South Wales (UNSW)—to establish campuses in India.

The **University of New South Wales (UNSW)** will establish **UNSW Bengaluru** at **Manyata Business Park, Bengaluru**, scheduled to open from **August 2026**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Ministry of Education (MoE)** has issued **3 Letters of Approval (LoAs)** to three globally reputed **Foreign Higher Education Institutions (FHEIs)—University of Bristol, University of York, and University of New South Wales (UNSW)**—to establish campuses in India.

The **University of Bristol** will establish its **Mumbai Enterprise Campus**, offering programmes in **Immersive Arts, Finance, Data Science, Economics, Business Management, Entrepreneurship, and Innovation**.

The **University of York** will establish its **first overseas campus in Mumbai**, with proposed courses in **Finance, Computer Science with Artificial Intelligence (AI), Cyber Security, Business, Economics, Creative Industries, and Management**.

The **University of New South Wales (UNSW)** will establish **UNSW Bengaluru** at **Manyata Business Park, Bengaluru**, scheduled to open from **August 2026**.

The **UNSW Bengaluru** campus will offer programmes in **Business, Computer Science, and Cyber Security**, and support collaboration in **renewable energy, health, transport, and education** sectors.

297. In 2026, who was appointed by the Government of India as the Next Chief of the Army Staff (COAS), effective from 30 June 2026?

A.Lieutenant General Pushpendra Singh

B.Lieutenant General NS Raja Subramani

C.Lieutenant General MV Suchindra Kumar

D.Lieutenant General Dhiraj Seth

E.Lieutenant General RC Tiwari

Answer: D

The Government of India (GoI) has appointed **Lieutenant General Dhiraj Seth** as the **Next Chief of the Army Staff (COAS)** with effect from the afternoon of **30 June 2026**.

Lieutenant General Dhiraj Seth is currently serving as the **Vice Chief of the Army Staff (VCOAS)**.

He will succeed **General Upendra Dwivedi**, who is scheduled to retire on **30 June 2026**.

298. In 2026, who was nominated by the Central Government as a Director on the Central Board of the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) with effect from 11 June 2026?

A.Nagaraju Maddirala

B.Tuhin Kanta Pandey

C.Sanjay Malhotra

D.Sanjay Lohiya

E.M. Nagaraju

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

The **Central Government** has nominated **Sanjay Lohiya** as a **Director** on the **Central Board of the Reserve Bank of India (RBI)**, with effect from **11 June 2026**. **Sanjay Lohiya** was appointed in place of **Nagaraju Maddirala**, who retired as **Secretary, Department of Financial Services (DFS)** on **31 May 2026**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Central Government** has nominated **Sanjay Lohiya** as a **Director** on the **Central Board of the Reserve Bank of India (RBI)**, with effect from **11 June 2026**. **Sanjay Lohiya** was appointed in place of **Nagaraju Maddirala**, who retired as **Secretary, Department of Financial Services (DFS)** on **31 May 2026**.

The Government has also nominated **Sanjay Lohiya** as a **Director** on the **Central Board of the State Bank of India (SBI)**, with immediate effect and until further orders.

He is currently serving as **Secretary, Department of Financial Services (DFS)**, **Ministry of Finance**, and assumed charge on **1 June 2026**.

299. In 2026, the first batch of women cadets trained at the National Defence Academy (NDA) joined the NDA as part of which course?

A.146th Course

B.147th Course

C.148th Course

D.149th Course

E.150th Course

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The First Batch of Women Cadets Trained at the National Defence Academy (NDA) has been **Commissioned as Officers in the Indian Defence Forces**, marking a historic milestone in **Women's Participation in Military Service**. A total of **17 Women Cadets** joined the **NDA in August 2022** as part of the **148th Course** and successfully completed their **Pre-Commission Training** at their respective Service Academies. In the **Indian Army**, **9 Women Officers** were commissioned during the Passing Out Parade of the **158th Regular Course** held at the **Indian Military Academy (IMA), Dehradun, Uttarakhand on 13 June 2026**.

Detailed Explanation:

The First Batch of Women Cadets Trained at the National Defence Academy (NDA) has been **Commissioned as Officers in the Indian Defence Forces**, marking a historic milestone in **Women's Participation in Military Service**. A total of **17 Women Cadets** joined the **NDA in August 2022** as part of the **148th Course** and successfully completed their **Pre-Commission Training** at their respective Service Academies. In the **Indian Army**, **9 Women Officers** were commissioned during the Passing Out Parade of the **158th Regular Course** held at the **Indian Military Academy (IMA), Dehradun, Uttarakhand on 13 June 2026**.

The **158th Regular Course Passing Out Parade at IMA** was reviewed by **Droupadi Murmu, the President of India**.

In the **Indian Air Force (IAF)**, **5 Women Officers** were commissioned during the Combined Graduation Parade of the **217th Course** at the **Air Force Academy, Dundigal, Hyderabad, Telangana, on 13 June 2026**.

The **217th Course Combined Graduation Parade** was reviewed by **Rajnath Singh, the Raksha Mantri (Defence Minister)**.

300. In 2026, who reviewed the Passing Out Parade (POP) of Batch 01/26 at INS Chilka as the Chief Guest?

A.Vice Admiral Sanjay Vatsayan

B.Vice Admiral Krishna Swaminathan

C.Admiral Dinesh K. Tripathi

D.Commodore B Deepak Aneel

E.Admiral R. Hari Kumar

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

INS Chilka witnessed the **Passing Out Parade (POP) of Batch 01/26 on 12 June 2026**, marking the successful completion of **16 Weeks of Rigorous Ab-Initio Naval Training** by **3,011 Trainees**.

The batch comprised **2,746 Agniveers of the Indian Navy**, including **116 Women Agniveers**, and **265 Naviks of the Indian Coast Guard**.

The parade was reviewed by **Vice Admiral Sanjay Vatsayan**, Flag Officer Commanding-in-Chief (FOC-in-C), **Western Naval Command**, who attended as the **Chief Guest**.

Detailed Explanation:

INS Chilka witnessed the **Passing Out Parade (POP) of Batch 01/26 on 12 June 2026**, marking the successful completion of **16 Weeks of Rigorous Ab-Initio Naval Training** by **3,011 Trainees**.

The batch comprised **2,746 Agniveers of the Indian Navy**, including **116 Women Agniveers**, and **265 Naviks of the Indian Coast Guard**.

The **Passing Out Parade** symbolized the transformation of recruits into **Disciplined, Motivated, and Professionally Trained Personnel** ready for naval service.

The parade was reviewed by **Vice Admiral Sanjay Vatsayan**, Flag Officer Commanding-in-Chief (FOC-in-C), **Western Naval Command**, who attended as the **Chief Guest**.

Commodore B Deepak Aneel, Station Commander, **INS Chilka**, served as the **Conducting Officer** of the parade.

301. In 2026, according to the Global Peace Index (GPI) 2026, which of the following countries was ranked as the most peaceful, and which was ranked as the least peaceful country in the world, respectively?

A.Iceland and Russia

B.New Zealand and Sudan

C.Switzerland and Yemen

D.Ireland and Afghanistan

E.Slovenia and Ukraine

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

The **Global Peace Index (GPI) 2026** was released by the **Institute for Economics and Peace (IEP)**, ranking **163 countries** based on their levels of **safety, security, ongoing conflict, and militarisation**.

Iceland retained its position as the **world's most peaceful country for the 19th consecutive year**.

Russia was ranked as the **least peaceful country** in the GPI 2026.

India ranked 127th among 163 countries with a score of **2.409**, with the ranking affected by internal security challenges, regional tensions, and unrest in certain regions.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Global Peace Index (GPI) 2026** was released by the **Institute for Economics and Peace (IEP)**, ranking **163 countries** based on their levels of **safety, security, ongoing conflict, and militarisation**.

The **2026 edition** marks the **20th edition** of the index and assesses countries using **23 indicators** across three domains: **societal safety and security, ongoing domestic and international conflict, and militarisation**.

The report stated that **global peacefulness declined for the 12th consecutive year**, with **99 countries** recording deterioration in peace levels.

The number of **active state-based conflicts reached 61**, the highest level recorded since **World War II**.

Iceland retained its position as the **world's most peaceful country for the 19th consecutive year**.

TOP 5 COUNTRIES

1. **Iceland**
2. **New Zealand**
3. **Switzerland**
4. **Slovenia**
5. **Ireland**

Russia was ranked as the **least peaceful country** in the GPI 2026.

India ranked 127th among 163 countries with a score of **2.409**, with the ranking affected by internal security challenges, regional tensions, and unrest in certain regions.

302. In 2026, Assam and Nagaland signed a tripartite MoU for the joint exploration and production of crude oil and natural gas along their shared border. Under the agreement, revenue generated from extraction will be shared in what ratio between the two states?

A.60:40

B.70:30

C.55:45

D.50:50

E.75:25

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

Assam and Nagaland signed a tripartite **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** for the joint exploration and production

of **crude oil and natural gas** along their shared border.

Under the agreement, revenue generated from oil and natural gas extraction will be shared between Assam and Nagaland through a **50:50 revenue-sharing arrangement**.

Detailed Explanation:

Assam and Nagaland signed a tripartite **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** for the joint exploration and production of **crude oil and natural gas** along their shared border.

The MoU was signed in **New Delhi** in the presence of **Union Home Minister Amit Shah** and **Union Minister of Petroleum and Natural Gas Hardeep Singh Puri**.

The agreement covers **six hydrocarbon-rich disputed fields** spread across more than **1,000 square kilometres** of the Assam–Nagaland border area.

The MoU establishes a formal framework for **coordinated petroleum exploration activities** in regions where exploration had remained limited since the **mid-1990s** due to boundary disputes.

Under the agreement, revenue generated from oil and natural gas extraction will be shared between Assam and Nagaland through a **50:50 revenue-sharing arrangement**.

303. In 2026, how many technology companies were empanelled by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY) through the National e-Governance Division (NeGD) to develop and deploy AI, ML, and Data Science solutions across government departments?

A.4

B.5

C.6

D.8

E.10

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The **Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY)**, through the **National e-Governance Division (NeGD)**, has empanelled **Six Technology Companies** to develop and deploy **Artificial Intelligence (AI)**, **Machine Learning (ML)**, and **Data Science Solutions** across government departments.

The **Six Empanelled Firms** are **Tata Consultancy Services (TCS)**, **NEC Corporation India**, **Kyndryl Solutions**, **Innefu Labs**, **CoRover**, and **Cactus Communications**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY)**, through the **National e-Governance Division (NeGD)**, has empanelled **Six Technology Companies** to develop and deploy **Artificial Intelligence (AI)**, **Machine Learning (ML)**, and **Data Science Solutions** across government departments.

The **Six Empanelled Firms** are **Tata Consultancy Services (TCS)**, **NEC**

Corporation India, **Kyndryl Solutions**, **Innefu Labs**, **CoRover**, and **Cactus Communications**.
These companies were selected from a competitive pool of **More Than 80 Participating Firms**.
Other notable participants in the selection process included **Deloitte**, **Ernst & Young (EY)**, **Fractal Analytics**, **PwC**, and **KPMG**.
The empanelment creates a **Ready Pool of AI Service Providers** that can be utilized by **Central Ministries**, **State Governments**, **Public Sector Undertakings (PSUs)**, and other government agencies.
The initiative marks a **significant shift** from merely building AI Infrastructure to **deploying AI Solutions at Scale** across governance and public service sectors.
The empanelled firms will support projects related to **Citizen Services**, **Analytics**, **Process Optimization**, **Automation**, and **Digital Governance**.

304. In 2026, Vaibhav Sooryavanshi became the youngest player ever selected for the Indian men's cricket team at what age?

A.14 years and 250 days
B.15 years and 71 days
C.15 years and 205 days
D.16 years and 71 days
E.16 years and 205 days
Answer: B
Short Explanation:
Vaibhav Sooryavanshi, born on **27 March 2011** in **Tajpur, Samastipur district, Bihar**, became the **youngest player ever selected for the Indian men's cricket team** at the age of **15 years and 71 days**.
He broke the **36-year-old record** of **Sachin Tendulkar**, who made his India debut against **Pakistan in 1989** at the age of **16 years and 205 days**.
Sooryavanshi was selected for India's **T20 squad for the tours of Ireland and England**, and also for the **Asian Games 2026**.
Detailed Explanation:
Vaibhav Sooryavanshi, born on **27 March 2011** in **Tajpur, Samastipur district, Bihar**, became the **youngest player ever selected for the Indian men's cricket team** at the age of **15 years and 71 days**.
He broke the **36-year-old record** of **Sachin Tendulkar**, who made his India debut against **Pakistan in 1989** at the age of **16 years and 205 days**.
Sooryavanshi was selected for India's **T20 squad for the tours of Ireland and England**, and also for the **Asian Games 2026**.
His selection came after a remarkable **IPL 2026 season with Rajasthan Royals**, where he won **five individual awards**.
He secured the **Orange Cap** by scoring **776 runs in 16 matches** and also won the awards for **Most Valuable Player (MVP), Emerging Player of the Season, Super Striker, and Super Sixes**.

305. In 2026, World Blood Donor Day was observed globally on which date?

A.14 June

B.8 May

C.7 April

D.1 July

E.29 September

Answer: A

World Blood Donor Day 2026 was observed globally on **14 June 2026** to raise awareness about the importance of **safe blood and blood products** and to thank **voluntary, unpaid blood donors** for their life-saving contributions.

The day is observed on the birth anniversary of **Karl Landsteiner**, who was born on **14 June 1868**.

He was awarded the **Nobel Prize in Physiology or Medicine in 1930** for his discovery of the **ABO blood group system**, which made safe blood transfusion possible.

306. In 2026, the first Wind Day (now observed as Global Wind Day) was organised by the European Wind Energy Association (EWEA) in which year?

A.2005

B.2006

C.2009

D.2008

E.2007

Answer: E

Global Wind Day 2026 was observed globally on **15 June 2026** to raise awareness about the importance of **wind energy** and its potential to transform sustainable energy systems.

The day is celebrated every year to highlight the power of **wind as a clean, renewable, and sustainable source of energy**.

The first **Wind Day** was organised in **2007** by the **European Wind Energy Association (EWEA)**.

307. In 2026, World Elder Abuse Awareness Day (WEAAD) was observed globally on which date?

A.1 June

B.5 June

C.12 June

D.15 June

E.21 June

Answer: D

World Elder Abuse Awareness Day (WEAAD) 2026 was observed globally on **15 June 2026** to raise awareness about **elder abuse, neglect, and exploitation**, and to promote the rights, dignity, and well-being of older persons.

World Elder Abuse Awareness Day was first established by the **International Network for the Prevention of Elder Abuse (INPEA)** in **June 2006**.

The day was officially recognised by the **United Nations General Assembly (UNGA)** in **December 2011** through **Resolution 66/127**.

308. As of 2026, who is the Managing Director & CEO of Bank of India (BOI)?

A.Challa Sreenivasulu Setty
B.Rajneesh Karnatak
C.Debadatta Chand
D.A. Manimekhalai
E.Swarup Kumar Saha
Answer: B
About Bank of India:
Founded: 1906
Headquarters: Mumbai, Maharashtra, India
Managing Director & CEO: Rajneesh Karnatak
Tagline: "Relationships Beyond Banking"

309. In 2026, the RBI's exemption of fresh FCNR(B) deposits mobilised under the special scheme from Cash Reserve Ratio (CRR) and Statutory Liquidity Ratio (SLR) requirements will remain valid until which date?
A.30 June 2026
B.31 July 2026
C.31 August 2026
D.30 September 2026
E.16 October 2026
Answer: D
To encourage foreign currency inflows, **RBI has exempted fresh FCNR(B) Deposits** mobilised under the scheme from **Cash Reserve Ratio (CRR)** and **Statutory Liquidity Ratio (SLR)** requirements.
This exemption will remain valid until **30 September 2026**

310. In 2026, polymer banknotes, now used by more than 60 countries worldwide, were first introduced by which country in 1988?
A.Canada
B.United Kingdom
C.Singapore
D.New Zealand
E.Australia
Answer: E
Polymer Banknotes were first introduced by **Australia in 1988** and are now used by **More Than 60 Countries Worldwide**.
The growing global adoption of polymer notes is driven by their **Enhanced Security Features**, **Higher Durability**, and **Lower Long-Term Replacement Costs**

311. In 2026, Nuvama Wealth Management Limited received final approval from which regulatory authority to commence Mutual Fund operations?
A.Reserve Bank of India (RBI)
B.Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (IRDAI)
C.Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI)
D.Pension Fund Regulatory and Development Authority (PFRDA)
E.International Financial Services Centres Authority (IFSCA)
Answer: C
Short Explanation:
Nuvama Wealth Management Limited received **Final Approval** from

the **Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI)** to commence **Mutual Fund (MF) Operations** through its asset management arm, **Nuvama Asset Management Limited**.
The approval marks the **Formal Entry** of Nuvama into India's Mutual Fund Industry and strengthens its presence in the financial services sector.
Nuvama Mutual Fund Trusteeship Services Limited will serve as the **Trustee Company** for the newly established Nuvama Mutual Fund.
Detailed Explanation:
Nuvama Wealth Management Limited received **Final Approval** from the **Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI)** to commence **Mutual Fund (MF) Operations** through its asset management arm, **Nuvama Asset Management Limited**.
The approval marks the **Formal Entry** of Nuvama into India's Mutual Fund Industry and strengthens its presence in the financial services sector.
Nuvama Mutual Fund Trusteeship Services Limited will serve as the **Trustee Company** for the newly established Nuvama Mutual Fund.
With this approval, Nuvama Wealth Management Limited aims to expand its footprint by offering a wider range of investment products to both **Retail and Institutional Investors**.
The company will initially launch products under the **Specialised Investment Fund (SIF) Framework**, leveraging its expertise in differentiated public-market investment strategies.
After obtaining additional regulatory approvals, Nuvama plans to introduce a **Broader Range of Mutual Fund Schemes**.
The approval was announced by **Anshu Kapoor**, President and Head of Nuvama Asset Management.

312. As of June 2026, the World Bank's Global Economic Prospects (GEP) report has projected India's GDP growth at what rate for FY 2026-27 (FY27)?

A.5.8%
B.6.6%
C.6.5%
D.7.1%
E.7.7%

Answer: B

Short Explanation:
The **World Bank (WB)** released the **Global Economic Prospects (GEP), June 2026** report and raised **India's GDP growth forecast for FY 2026-27 (FY27)** by 10 basis points (bps) **to 6.6%**, up from 6.5% projected in January 2026.
According to the report, India's economy is projected to grow by **6.6% in FY27**, moderating from an estimated **7.7% in FY26**.
Detailed Explanation:
The **World Bank (WB)** released the **Global Economic Prospects (GEP), June 2026** report and raised **India's GDP growth forecast for FY 2026-27 (FY27)** by 10 basis points (bps) **to 6.6%**, up from 6.5% projected in January 2026.

According to the report, India's economy is projected to grow by **6.6% in FY27**, moderating from an estimated **7.7% in FY26**.
The World Bank has projected that India's Gross Domestic Product (GDP) growth will **accelerate to 7.2% in FY28**.
India recorded an economic growth rate of **7.1% in FY25**.

313. In 2026, Bandhan Bank partnered with which company to launch an integrated 3-in-1 Account offering Banking, Demat, and Trading Services?

A.Motilal Oswal Financial Services Ltd
B.Zerodha Broking Ltd
C.HDFC Securities Ltd
D.ICICI Securities Ltd
E.Centrum Finverse Ltd

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

Bandhan Bank has partnered with **Centrum Finverse Ltd** to launch an integrated **3-in-1 Account** that combines **Banking, Demat, and Trading Services** on a single platform.
The new 3-in-1 Account enables customers to seamlessly access **Savings Account, Demat Account, and Trading Account** facilities through one integrated solution.

Detailed Explanation:

Bandhan Bank has partnered with **Centrum Finverse Ltd** to launch an integrated **3-in-1 Account** that combines **Banking, Demat, and Trading Services** on a single platform.
The new 3-in-1 Account enables customers to seamlessly access **Savings Account, Demat Account, and Trading Account** facilities through one integrated solution.
Customers can open and operate these accounts through a completely **paperless process**, enhancing convenience and ease of access.
The service will be available through **Bandhan Bank's branch network** as well as its **digital channels**, ensuring wider customer reach.
Partha Pratim Sengupta, Managing Director and CEO of Bandhan Bank, stated that the initiative aims to strengthen **financial inclusion** and expand access to **investment opportunities** for customers.

314. In 2026, the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) issued the Third Amendment Directions, 2026 to regulate bank lending to which of the following entities?

A.Real Estate Investment Trusts (REITs) and Infrastructure Investment Trusts (InvITs)
B.Small Finance Banks (SFBs) and Payments Banks (PBs)
C.Asset Reconstruction Companies (ARCs) and Housing Finance Companies (HFCs)
D.Non-Banking Financial Companies (NBFCs) and Microfinance Institutions (MFIs)
E.Mutual Funds (MFs) and Alternative Investment Funds (AIFs)

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** issued the **Third Amendment Directions, 2026** to regulate **Bank Lending** to **Real Estate Investment Trusts (REITs)** and **Infrastructure Investment Trusts (InvITs)** while strengthening **Risk Management** and **Exposure Norms**.

Under the revised framework, banks can lend only to REITs and InvITs that are **Registered with and Regulated by SEBI** (Securities and Exchange Board of India) and are **Listed on Recognised Stock Exchanges (SEs)**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** issued the **Third Amendment Directions, 2026** to regulate **Bank Lending** to **Real Estate Investment Trusts (REITs)** and **Infrastructure Investment Trusts (InvITs)** while strengthening **Risk Management** and **Exposure Norms**.

Under the revised framework, banks can lend only to REITs and InvITs that are **Registered with and Regulated by SEBI** (Securities and Exchange Board of India) and are **Listed on Recognised Stock Exchanges (SEs)**.

Lending to **REITs** will be permitted only if at least **80% of their Assets** comprise **Cash-Generating Properties** that have been **Operational for More Than One Year**.

Banks may lend only to **Listed InvITs** where a minimum of **80% of Assets** are invested in **Completed and Revenue-Generating Infrastructure Projects**.

The infrastructure assets held by eligible InvITs must have generated **Positive Cash Flows for More Than One Year**.

The revised directions aim to ensure that bank credit is extended primarily to **Mature, Operational, and Income-Generating Assets**, thereby **reducing lending risks** and **enhancing financial stability**.

315. In 2026, the National Stock Exchange (NSE) decided to allocate what percentage of its annual Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) corpus to projects listed on the Social Stock Exchange(SSE)?

A.5%

B.8%

C.10%

D.15%

E.20%

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The **National Stock Exchange (NSE)** has decided to allocate **10% of its annual Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) corpus** to projects listed on the **Social Stock Exchange (SSE)**.

The decision follows recent regulatory changes allowing companies to undertake CSR spending through subscription to **Zero Coupon Zero Principal (ZCZP) instruments** listed on Social Stock Exchanges.

The **NSE CSR Committee** approved the proposal in principle in March 2026, and it became operational after the **Ministry of**

Corporate Affairs (MCA) issued the relevant notification on **27 May 2026**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **National Stock Exchange (NSE)** has decided to allocate **10% of its annual Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) corpus** to projects listed on the **Social Stock Exchange (SSE)**.

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The **NSE CSR Committee** approved the proposal in principle in March 2026, and it became operational after the **Ministry of Corporate Affairs (MCA)** issued the relevant notification on **27 May 2026**.

The **NSE Social Stock Exchange (SSE)** was launched in **February 2023** to facilitate fundraising for social impact projects and non-profit organizations.

Since its launch, the NSE SSE has facilitated fundraising for **16 projects** and mobilised more than **₹44.5 crore**.

The funds raised through the SSE have supported sectors such as **healthcare, education, women empowerment, climate action, poverty alleviation, skilling, and sustainable livelihoods**.

316. As of 2026, how many Indian start-ups were selected in the World Economic Forum (WEF) Technology Pioneers Cohort 2026?

A.6

B.7

C.8

D.9

E.10

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

The **World Economic Forum (WEF)** released its **2026 Technology Pioneers Cohort**, recognizing **100 early-stage companies from 23 countries** for driving transformative innovations across multiple sectors.

The selected companies are working on breakthrough technologies in **Artificial Intelligence (AI), Energy, Quantum Computing, Biotechnology, Climate Innovation, Space Technology, and Advanced Manufacturing**.

India secured representation with **9 start-ups in the 2026 Technology Pioneers Cohort**, compared to 10 Indian start-ups in the 2025 cohort.

Detailed Explanation:

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The selected companies are working on breakthrough technologies in **Artificial Intelligence (AI), Energy, Quantum Computing, Biotechnology, Climate Innovation, Space Technology, and Advanced Manufacturing**.

India secured representation with **9 start-ups in the 2026 Technology Pioneers Cohort**, compared to 10 Indian start-ups in the 2025 cohort.

With the latest additions, the total number of **Indian companies** selected under the WEF Technology Pioneers programme has reached **28**.

Notable Indian firms previously included in the cohort are **Agnikul Cosmos, Cropin, and Digantara**.

The **United States of America (USA) topped** the 2026 Technology Pioneers list with **43 start-ups**, the highest among all countries.

China ranked second with 10 start-ups, while the **United Kingdom (UK) secured third position with 8 start-ups**.

317. In 2026, the Government of Odisha approved the restoration of the original Odia names of how many places across the state and to strengthen "Odia Asmita" (Odia identity)?

A.48

B.52

C.58

D.64

E.72

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

The **Government of Odisha** approved the restoration of the **original Odia names of 64 places** spread across **26 districts** of the state.

The decision was approved by the **Odisha Cabinet** chaired by **Chief Minister Mohan Charan Majhi**.

The initiative aims to replace **colonial-era English spellings** that altered the original Odia pronunciation, identity and cultural significance of various places.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Government of Odisha** approved the restoration of the **original Odia names of 64 places** spread across **26 districts** of the state.

The decision was approved by the **Odisha Cabinet** chaired by **Chief Minister Mohan Charan Majhi**.

The initiative aims to replace **colonial-era English spellings** that altered the original Odia pronunciation, identity and cultural significance of various places.

The move is part of the state government's broader effort to strengthen **"Odia Asmita" (Odia identity)** and promote the use of the **Odia language** in governance and public life.

A **high-level committee headed by eminent writer Pratibha Ray** examined historical records, linguistic evidence and public suggestions before recommending the changes.

318. In 2026, the draft Telecommunications (Television, Radio and Associated Services) Rules were released under which Act to create a common regulatory framework for broadcasting services?

A.Indian Telegraph Act, 1885

B.Cable Television Networks (Regulation) Act, 1995

C.Telecommunications Act, 2023

D.Information Technology Act, 2000

E.Prasar Bharati Act, 1990

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The **Government of India** released the **draft Telecommunications (Television, Radio and Associated Services) Rules, 2026** to establish a **common regulatory framework for television and radio broadcasting services** across the country.

The draft rules were issued by the **Ministry of Information and Broadcasting** under the provisions of the **Telecommunications Act, 2023**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Government of India** released the **draft Telecommunications (Television, Radio and Associated Services) Rules, 2026** to establish a **common regulatory framework for television and radio broadcasting services** across the country.

The draft rules were issued by the **Ministry of Information and Broadcasting** under the provisions of the **Telecommunications Act, 2023**.

The new framework aims to replace multiple existing guidelines governing television and radio broadcasting with a **unified and modern regulatory structure**.

Television channels will be required to broadcast a minimum of **30 minutes of public-interest content every day** between **6:00 AM and 11:00 PM**.

Private **Frequency Modulation (FM) radio stations** will be required to broadcast at least **one hour of public-interest programming daily**.

319. In 2026, Bharat Innovates 2026 is being conducted under which initiative to strengthen cooperation between India and France in innovation and advanced technologies?

A.India-France Year of Innovation 2026

B.India-France Technology Mission 2026

C.India-France Strategic Partnership 2026

D.India-France Startup Bridge Programme 2026

E.India-France Digital Cooperation Framework 2026

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** and French President **Emmanuel Macron** are set to jointly inaugurate **Bharat Innovates 2026** at the **Palais des Expositions in Nice, France**.

The event is organised by the **Ministry of Education, Government of India**, to showcase India's rapidly growing **deep-tech and innovation ecosystem** to global investors, industry leaders and research institutions.

Bharat Innovates 2026 is being conducted under the **India-France Year of Innovation 2026** and aims to strengthen bilateral cooperation in **advanced technologies,**

startups, research and cross-border investments.

Detailed Explanation:

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Bharat Innovates 2026 is being conducted under the **India-France Year of Innovation 2026** and aims to strengthen bilateral cooperation in **advanced technologies, startups, research and cross-border investments**.

The event will bring together around **120 Indian innovators and startups**, approximately **15 Higher Education Institutions**, and more than **500 investors, venture capital firms, corporate leaders and global Chief Executive Officers**.

It will cover **13 strategic sectors**, including:

Semiconductors

Biotechnology

Advanced Computing

Healthcare

Manufacturing

Energy

Space Technology

320. In 2026, what is the name of India's first AI-based WhatsApp tool launched by ICAR to provide advisory services to oilseed farmers?

A.Krishi AI Sahayak

B.Kisan Connect

C.Smart Farmer Connect

D.Agri Mitra AI

E.Oilseeds Kisaan Mitra

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

The **Indian Council of Agricultural Research (ICAR)** launched India's first **AI-based WhatsApp tool "Oilseeds Kisaan Mitra"** to provide **timely, research-based advisory services to oilseed farmers in multiple languages**.

The tool has been developed by the **ICAR-Indian Institute of Oilseeds Research (ICAR-IIOR), Hyderabad**.

Farmers can save the WhatsApp number **+91 4024598180** as **"Oilseeds Kisaan Mitra"** and ask queries in **any Indian language**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Indian Council of Agricultural Research (ICAR)** launched India's first **AI-based WhatsApp tool "Oilseeds Kisaan Mitra"** to provide **timely, research-based advisory services to oilseed farmers in multiple languages**.

The tool has been developed by the **ICAR-Indian Institute of Oilseeds Research (ICAR-IIOR), Hyderabad**.

Farmers can save the WhatsApp number **+91 4024598180** as **"Oilseeds Kisaan Mitra"** and ask queries in **any Indian language**.

The **AI-powered multilingual chatbot** provides instant research-based guidance on **variety selection, crop management, pest and disease control, irrigation, and post-harvest practices**.

The chatbot's knowledge base has been developed in collaboration with:

ICAR-National Soybean Research Institute, Indore

ICAR-Indian Institute of Groundnut Research, Junagadh

ICAR-Indian Institute of Rapeseed and Mustard Research, Bharatpur

PC Unit (Sesame and Niger)

321. In 2026, how many companies have been selected under the third round of the Production Linked Incentive (PLI) Scheme for Textiles by the Ministry of Textiles?

A.72

B.84

C.90

D.96

E.102

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

The **Ministry of Textiles** has selected **96 companies** under the **third round of the Production Linked Incentive (PLI) Scheme for Textiles** with a total **investment commitment of ₹12,822.67 crore** and a projected **turnover of ₹58,294.18 crore**.

In the latest meeting under the **third round of the PLI Scheme**, the Ministry approved **22 new applicants**.

The **22 newly approved companies** are expected to bring a total **investment of ₹2,339.14 crore** and generate a projected **turnover of ₹15,561.34 crore** in notified products.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Ministry of Textiles** has selected **96 companies** under the **third round of the Production Linked Incentive (PLI) Scheme for Textiles** with a total **investment commitment of ₹12,822.67 crore** and a projected **turnover of ₹58,294.18 crore**.

In the latest meeting under the **third round of the PLI Scheme**, the Ministry approved **22 new applicants**.

The **22 newly approved companies** are expected to bring a total **investment of ₹2,339.14 crore** and generate a projected **turnover of ₹15,561.34 crore** in notified products.

The approved companies are from the sectors of **Man-Made Fibre (MMF) apparel, MMF fabrics, and technical textiles**.

The **PLI Scheme for Textiles** was notified on **24 September 2021** with an approved outlay of **₹10,683 crore**.

322. In 2026, Sudarsan Pattnaik became the first Indian to win which award at the

International Festival of Sand Sculpture in Russia?

A.International Sand Art Excellence Award

B.Russia Grand Sand Master Cup 2026

C.Global Sand Sculpture Championship

D.World Sand Art Laureate Award

E.Arctic Sand Creativity Prize

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Sudarsan Pattnaik, a renowned sand artist from **Odisha**, became the **first Indian to win the Russia Grand Sand Master Cup 2026**. He received the prestigious award at the **Second International Festival of Sand Sculpture** held in **Russia**.

The festival brought together **12 leading sand sculptors from different countries** to showcase their creativity and artistic excellence.

Detailed Explanation:

Sudarsan Pattnaik, a renowned sand artist from **Odisha**, became the **first Indian to win the Russia Grand Sand Master Cup 2026**. He received the prestigious award at the **Second International Festival of Sand Sculpture** held in **Russia**.

The festival brought together **12 leading sand sculptors from different countries** to showcase their creativity and artistic excellence.

Sudarsan Pattnaik was honoured for his exceptional contribution to **sand art** and his thought-provoking sculpture based on the theme of **Global Warming and environmental conservation**.

His award-winning sculpture was approximately **3 metres high** and depicted **two contrasting faces of the Earth**, highlighting the impact of environmental degradation and the need for conservation efforts.

323. In 2026, how many eminent personalities were elected as Akademi Fellows (Akademi Ratna) by the Sangeet Natak Akademi?

A.5

B.6

C.9

D.8

E.7

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

The **General Council of Sangeet Natak Akademi**, the **National Academy of Music, Dance and Drama**, unanimously elected **7 eminent personalities** in the field of performing arts as **Akademi Fellows (Akademi Ratna)**.

The selected **Akademi Fellows (Akademi Ratna)** are **Ramlal Bareth, A.V. Anand, Rita Ganguly, Puru Dadheech, Chittaranjan Jyotishi, Pasumarthi Rattaiah Sarma, and Sudharani Raghupathy**.

The **Akademi Fellowship (Akademi Ratna)** is the highest honour of the Akademi and is a prestigious recognition restricted to **only 40 Fellows at any given time**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **General Council of Sangeet Natak Akademi**, the **National Academy of Music,**

Dance and Drama, unanimously elected **7 eminent personalities** in the field of performing arts as **Akademi Fellows (Akademi Ratna)**.

The selected **Akademi Fellows (Akademi Ratna)** are **Ramlal Bareth, A.V. Anand, Rita Ganguly, Puru Dadheech, Chittaranjan Jyotishi, Pasumarthi Rattaiah Sarma, and Sudharani Raghupathy**.

The **Akademi Fellowship (Akademi Ratna)** is the highest honour of the Akademi and is a prestigious recognition restricted to **only 40 Fellows at any given time**.

The General Council also selected **108 artists** from the fields of **Music, Dance, Theatre, Traditional, Folk and Tribal Arts, Puppetry, Overall Contribution and Scholarship** for the **Sangeet Natak Akademi Awards (Akademi Puraskar) for the years 2024 and 2025**.

The Akademi also selected **106 young artists** for the **Ustad Bismillah Khan Yuva Puraskar for the years 2024 and 2025**.

324. In 2026, Gautam Dey and Omaya Dudin were jointly awarded which prestigious European life sciences honour for their research contributions?

A.Nobel Prize in Medicine

B.Lasker Award

C.EMBO Gold Medal

D.Breakthrough Prize in Life Sciences

E.UNESCO Science Prize

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

Gautam Dey, an **Indian-origin scientist** working with the **European Molecular Biology Laboratory (EMBL), Heidelberg, Germany**, was awarded the **European Molecular Biology Organisation (EMBO) Gold Medal 2026** for his exceptional contribution to **life sciences in Europe**.

He shared the award with **Omaya Dudin** from the **University of Geneva, Switzerland**.

Detailed Explanation:

Gautam Dey, an **Indian-origin scientist** working with the **European Molecular Biology Laboratory (EMBL), Heidelberg, Germany**, was awarded the **European Molecular Biology Organisation (EMBO) Gold Medal 2026** for his exceptional contribution to **life sciences in Europe**.

He shared the award with **Omaya Dudin** from the **University of Geneva, Switzerland**.

Gautam Dey received the honour for his outstanding research on the **evolutionary origins of nuclear organisation and cell division**.

Omaya Dudin was recognised for his work on the **evolutionary origins of multicellularity**.

The **European Molecular Biology Organisation (EMBO) Gold Medal** is one of Europe's most prestigious honours in **life sciences** and is awarded annually to scientists in the early stages of their independent research careers.

The award is given to scientists based within the **European Molecular Biology Conference**

(EMBC), an intergovernmental organisation comprising **32 member states**.

325. In 2026, the National Biodiversity Authority (NBA) reconstituted the Expert Committee on Agrobiodiversity under which section of the Biological Diversity Act, 2002?

A.Section 10(1)

B.Section 12(2)

C.Section 14(1)

D.Section 15(3)

E.Section 13(1)

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

The **National Biodiversity Authority (NBA)** has reconstituted the **Expert Committee on Agrobiodiversity** under **Section 13(1) of the Biological Diversity Act, 2002** for a period of **one year**.

The Committee has been reconstituted to provide expert guidance on the **conservation, sustainable use, and Access and Benefit Sharing (ABS)** of agricultural biodiversity and related issues.

Detailed Explanation:

The **National Biodiversity Authority (NBA)** has reconstituted the **Expert Committee on Agrobiodiversity** under **Section 13(1) of the Biological Diversity Act, 2002** for a period of **one year**.

The Committee has been reconstituted to provide expert guidance on the **conservation, sustainable use, and Access and Benefit Sharing (ABS)** of agricultural biodiversity and related issues.

Padma Shri Dr. P. L. Gautam, a renowned agricultural scientist and former Chairperson of both the National Biodiversity Authority (NBA) and the Protection of Plant Varieties and Farmers' Rights Authority (PPVFRA), has been appointed as the **Chairperson of the Committee**.

Dr. P. L. Gautam was recently conferred the **Padma Shri** for his distinguished contributions to **Agricultural Science**.

The **Chairperson of PPVFRA** will serve as the **Co-Chairperson** of the Expert Committee on Agrobiodiversity.

326. In 2026, INS Sharda departed from which country after a successful port call aimed at strengthening maritime cooperation with India?

A.Maldives

B.Myanmar

C.Sri Lanka

D.Bangladesh

E.Indonesia

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

INS Sharda departed from **Colombo, Sri Lanka** on **13 June 2026** after completing a successful **port call**, further strengthening **maritime cooperation and friendship** between India and Sri Lanka.

The visit included a series of **professional interactions, training activities, sporting**

engagements, and cross-deck visits between the **Indian Navy** and the **Sri Lankan Navy**.

As part of **capacity-building initiatives**, personnel of the **Sri Lankan Navy** received training in **small arms handling, basic firefighting, first aid, and rescue procedures**.

Detailed Explanation:

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The visit included a series of **professional interactions, training activities, sporting engagements, and cross-deck visits** between the **Indian Navy** and the **Sri Lankan Navy**.

As part of **capacity-building initiatives**, personnel of the **Sri Lankan Navy** received training in **small arms handling, basic firefighting, first aid, and rescue procedures**.

Rear Admiral (RAdm) Jagath Kumara, Commander, Western Naval Area of the Sri Lanka Navy, visited **INS Sharda** and interacted with the crew, reaffirming the strong **maritime partnership** between the two countries.

During the visit, the **Commanding Officer of INS Sharda** paid a courtesy call on **Santosh Jha**, the **High Commissioner of India to Sri Lanka**.

The port call highlighted the enduring **maritime partnership** between India and Sri Lanka and reinforced their shared commitment to **regional maritime security and cooperation**.

327. In 2026, REC Limited is set to be merged into which public sector financial institution as approved by the President of India?

A.Power Finance Corporation Limited (PFC)

B.Rural Electrification Corporation of India (RECI)

C.State Bank of India (SBI)

D.Indian Renewable Energy Development Agency (IREDA)

E.Power Grid Corporation of India Limited (PGCIL)

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

President of India Droupadi Murmu approved the **merger of REC Limited (REC) into Power Finance Corporation Limited (PFC)**, nearly seven years after PFC acquired the Government's majority stake in REC.

The approval was communicated by the **Ministry of Power (MoP)** through an official letter.

Detailed Explanation:

President of India Droupadi Murmu approved the **merger of REC Limited (REC) into Power Finance Corporation Limited (PFC)**, nearly seven years after PFC acquired the Government's majority stake in REC.

The approval was communicated by the **Ministry of Power (MoP)** through an official letter.

The merger aims to create a **larger, stronger, and more efficient** public sector power financing institution and strengthen **Public**

Sector Non-Banking Financial Companies (NBFCs).

In **March 2019**, PFC acquired the Government of India's **52.63% stake in REC for ₹14,500 crore**, making REC a subsidiary of PFC.

The merger will be carried out under **Sections 230–232 of the Companies Act, 2013**

328. In 2026, National Aeronautics and Space Administration Unveils Four-Member Artemis III Team for Spacecraft and Moon Lander Demonstration Mission. Who has been appointed as the Commander of NASA's Artemis III Mission?

A.Frank Rubio

B.Luca Parmitano

C.Randy Bresnik

D.Andre Douglas

E.Scott Kelly

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The **National Aeronautics and Space Administration (NASA)** announced the **Four-Member Crew** for the **Artemis III Mission**, which is scheduled for a **Late-2027 Low-Earth Orbit (LEO) Mission**.

Randy Bresnik will serve as the **Commander** of the Artemis III Mission.

Andre Douglas has been selected as a **Mission Specialist** and will make his **First Spaceflight**.

Frank Rubio will serve as a **Mission Specialist**; he holds the **United States Record** for the **Longest Continuous Stay** aboard the International Space Station (ISS) at **371 Days**.

Luca Parmitano of the **European Space Agency (ESA)** will serve as the **Pilot** of the mission.

Detailed Explanation:

The **National Aeronautics and Space Administration (NASA)** announced the **Four-Member Crew** for the **Artemis III Mission**, which is scheduled for a **Late-2027 Low-Earth Orbit (LEO) Mission**.

The Artemis III Mission will focus on testing **Docking Mechanisms**, **Interoperability**, and **Operational Readiness** required for future **Crewed Lunar Landings** and long-term lunar operations.

Unlike earlier plans, this version of Artemis III will conduct a **Two-Week Low-Earth Orbit (LEO) Mission** and **Will Not Approach the Moon**.

The mission will demonstrate docking operations between **SpaceX's Starship**, **Blue Origin's Blue Moon Lander**, and **NASA's Orion Capsule**.

The **Orion Spacecraft** will be launched using the **Space Launch System (SLS)**, NASA's heavy-lift launch vehicle.

Randy Bresnik will serve as the **Commander** of the Artemis III Mission.

Andre Douglas has been selected as a **Mission Specialist** and will make his **First Spaceflight**.

Frank Rubio will serve as a **Mission Specialist**; he holds the **United States Record** for

the **Longest Continuous Stay** aboard the International Space Station (ISS) at **371 Days**. **Luca Parmitano** of the **European Space Agency (ESA)** will serve as the **Pilot** of the mission

329. In 2026, which organisation currently hosts over 800 technologies on its Technology Showcase Portal to support industry, startups, and entrepreneurs?

A.ISRO

B.DRDO

C.DST

D.CSIR

E.BARC

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

Union Minister Dr. Jitendra Singh emphasized the need for stronger collaboration between **Research Institutions, Industry, and Startups** to accelerate the conversion of scientific knowledge into **Market-Ready Solutions** and national development outcomes. Speaking during an industry interaction session at the **RISE Conclave 2026**, he stated that scientific progress should increasingly be measured by its **Societal and Economic Impact**.

The **Council of Scientific and Industrial Research (CSIR)** currently hosts over **800 Technologies** on its **CSIR Technology Showcase Portal**, providing industries, entrepreneurs, and startups with easy access to indigenous technologies.

Detailed Explanation:

Union Minister Dr. Jitendra Singh emphasized the need for stronger collaboration between **Research Institutions, Industry, and Startups** to accelerate the conversion of scientific knowledge into **Market-Ready Solutions** and national development outcomes. Speaking during an industry interaction session at the **RISE Conclave 2026**, he stated that scientific progress should increasingly be measured by its **Societal and Economic Impact**.

The **Council of Scientific and Industrial Research (CSIR)** currently hosts over **800 Technologies** on its **CSIR Technology Showcase Portal**, providing industries, entrepreneurs, and startups with easy access to indigenous technologies.

Dr. Singh highlighted that **Industry Collaboration** should begin at the **Research Conceptualisation Stage** rather than after technologies are fully developed, ensuring better alignment with market requirements.

Early industry involvement can **improve Technology Transfer**, accelerate commercialization, and enhance the chances of market success.

Dr. Singh observed that **Deep-Tech Startups** face unique challenges and therefore require **Flexible Policy Frameworks** and sustained institutional support beyond incubation.

330. In 2026, Bharat Sanchar Nigam Limited (BSNL) signed an MoU with which institute for joint development of next-generation telecom technologies?

A.IIT Delhi

B.IIT Bombay

C.IIT Madras

D.IIT Kharagpur

E.IIT Kanpur

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

Bharat Sanchar Nigam Limited and the **Indian Institute of Technology Kanpur** signed a **Memorandum of Understanding** for joint research, development, testing, deployment, and commercialisation of **next-generation telecom technologies**.

The collaboration aims to promote **innovation in telecom networks, indigenous technology development, and future-ready digital infrastructure**, especially to enhance connectivity in **rural areas across India**.

Detailed Explanation:

Bharat Sanchar Nigam Limited and the **Indian Institute of Technology Kanpur** signed a **Memorandum of Understanding** for joint research, development, testing, deployment, and commercialisation of **next-generation telecom technologies**.

The collaboration aims to promote **innovation in telecom networks, indigenous technology development, and future-ready digital infrastructure**, especially to enhance connectivity in **rural areas across India**.

The partnership will focus on **Direct-to-Mobile broadcasting, indigenous Fourth Generation (4G) technology development, and advanced spectrum research** to strengthen India's telecom innovation and digital self-reliance.

Bharat Sanchar Nigam Limited has already undertaken significant work in the **Direct-to-Mobile technology space** and has launched services related to this technology

331. In 2026, Space Exploration Technologies Corporation (SpaceX) launched its Initial Public Offering (IPO) at what price per share?

A.$120

B.$135

C.$130

D.$145

E.$150

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Elon Musk became the **world's first trillionaire** after the successful public listing of **Space Exploration Technologies Corporation (SpaceX)** in **June 2026**.

Space Exploration Technologies Corporation launched its **Initial Public Offering (IPO)** at **135 United States dollars per share**. The stock opened at **150 United States dollars** and closed at approximately **161.11 United States dollars** on its debut trading day.

Detailed Explanation:

Elon Musk became the **world's first trillionaire** after the successful public listing

of **Space Exploration Technologies Corporation (SpaceX)** in **June 2026**.
The company, operating in the fields of **reusable rockets, satellite communications and artificial intelligence**, witnessed a sharp rise in its share price, pushing its valuation beyond **2 trillion United States dollars**.
Space Exploration Technologies Corporation launched its **Initial Public Offering (IPO)** at **135 United States dollars per share**. The stock opened at **150 United States dollars** and closed at approximately **161.11 United States dollars** on its debut trading day.
The record-breaking Initial Public Offering raised nearly **75 billion United States dollars**, making it the **largest public offering in history**, surpassing the previous record set by **Saudi Aramco in 2019**.

332. In 2026, Kane Stuart Williamson announced his retirement from international cricket after representing which country?
A.Australia
B.England
C.South Africa
D.New Zealand
E.West Indies
Answer: D
Kane Stuart Williamson, former captain of **New Zealand**, announced his retirement from **international cricket**, bringing an end to his illustrious **16-year international career** that began in **2010**.
He retired as the **highest Test run-scorer for New Zealand**, scoring **9,515 runs in 110 Test matches** at an impressive average of **54.06**.
Williamson was regarded as one of the **"Fab Four" batters** of modern cricket alongside **Virat Kohli, Steve Smith, and Joe Root**.
In **One Day Internationals (ODIs)**, he scored **7,256 runs in 175 matches**, while in **Twenty20 Internationals (T20Is)**, he accumulated **2,575 runs in 93 matches**.

333. Recently, Thailand's Princess Bajrakitiyabha Mahidol, Renowned UN Goodwill Ambassador, Passed away at 47. She was the eldest child of which monarch?
A.King Bhumibol Adulyadej
B.King Maha Vajiralongkorn
C.King Vajiravudh
D.King Prajadhipok
E.King Ananda Mahidol
Answer: B
Short Explanation:
Princess Bajrakitiyabha Mahidol was the **eldest child of King Maha Vajiralongkorn** and was widely known for her work in **justice reform**, **women's rights**, and **prison rehabilitation initiatives**.
Her full royal title was **Princess Bajrakitiyabha Narendiradebyavati**, and she was popularly known as **"Bha"** or **"Patty"**.
She pursued **Law at Cornell University**, strengthening her legal and diplomatic career.
Detailed Explanation:

Princess Bajrakitiyabha Mahidol was the **eldest child of King Maha Vajiralongkorn** and was widely known for her work in **justice reform**, **women's rights**, and **prison rehabilitation initiatives**.

Her full royal title was **Princess Bajrakitiyabha Narendiradebyavati**, and she was popularly known as **"Bha"** or **"Patty"**.

She pursued **Law at Cornell University**, strengthening her legal and diplomatic career.

She served at **Thailand's Permanent Mission to the United Nations (UN)** in New York City, gaining international diplomatic experience.

334. As of 2026, what is the currency of Thailand?

A.Baht

B.Ringgit

C.Dong

D.Peso

E.Kyat

Answer: A

About Thailand :

Thailand is a country in Southeast Asia with its capital at Bangkok.

Currency : **Thai Baht (THB)**.

Current monarch : **Maha Vajiralongkorn**.

335. As of 2026, which of the following correctly represents one of the institutions of the World Bank Group?

A.International Monetary Fund (IMF)

B.Asian Development Bank (ADB)

C.International Finance Corporation (IFC)

D.World Trade Organization (WTO)

E.Bank for International Settlements (BIS)

Answer: C

About World Bank:

The World Bank is an international financial institution that provides loans and grants to the governments of low and middle-income countries for the purpose of pursuing capital projects.

The World Bank consists of 5 institutions: The International Bank for Reconstruction and Development (IBRD), The International Development Association (IDA), The International Finance Corporation (IFC), The Multilateral Investment Guarantee Agency (MIGA), and The International Centre for Settlement of Investment Disputes (ICSID).

Founded Year: 1944

Headquarters: Washington, D.C., United States

President: Ajay Banga

Members:189 countries

336. In news, the RBI restrictions imposed on Mogaveera Co-operative Bank Limited, which of the following is the maximum withdrawal limit fixed for depositors from their savings accounts, current accounts, or any other deposit account?

A.₹50,000

B.₹75,000

C.₹1,00,000

D.₹2,00,000

E.₹1,50,000

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** imposed several **restrictions on Mogaveera Co-operative Bank Limited**, based in **Mumbai**, for a period of **6 months**.

The restrictions came into effect from the close of business on **12 June 2026**.

Under **RBI directions**, the bank **cannot grant or renew loans and advances** without obtaining prior approval from RBI.

The **maximum withdrawal limit for depositors** has been fixed at **₹1 lakh** from savings accounts, current accounts, or any other deposit account.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** imposed several **restrictions on Mogaveera Co-operative Bank Limited**, based in **Mumbai**, for a period of **6 months**.

The restrictions came into effect from the close of business on **12 June 2026**.

Under **RBI directions**, the bank **cannot grant or renew loans and advances** without obtaining prior approval from RBI.

The bank is also **prohibited from making new investments, incurring new liabilities, borrowing funds, or accepting fresh deposits** without RBI's permission.

RBI clarified that these directions **do not amount to cancellation of the banking licence**, and the bank will continue to operate under the prescribed restrictions.

The **maximum withdrawal limit for depositors** has been fixed at **₹1 lakh** from savings accounts, current accounts, or any other deposit account.

The bank is **permitted to meet essential operational expenses** such as employee salaries, rent, and electricity bills.

337. According to the RBI/Government data for FY26 (2025–26), what was the total amount of workers' remittances received by India, making it the first country to cross the USD 100 billion mark in a single year?

A.USD 87.55 billion

B.USD 95.30 billion

C.USD 110.47 billion

D.USD 124.15 billion

E.USD 31.07 billion

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

Indian workers abroad sent home a **record USD 110.47 billion** in remittances during **FY26 (2025–26)**, making India the **first country to receive more than USD 100 billion** in workers' remittances in a single year.

The remittance inflow **increased by 26%** compared to **USD 87.55 billion in FY25 (2024–25)**, highlighting the growing contribution of overseas Indians to the country's economy.

During the **January–March 2026 quarter**, remittances reached **USD 31.07 billion**, registering a **34% year-on-year growth** and marking the **highest quarterly remittance inflow in the last 13 years**.

Detailed Explanation:

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During the **January–March 2026 quarter**, remittances reached **USD 31.07 billion**, registering a **34% year-on-year growth** and marking the **highest quarterly remittance inflow in the last 13 years**.

Remittances are money transfers sent by migrant workers and overseas nationals to their families in their home country and are a **major source of foreign exchange earnings** for developing economies.

In India's **Balance of Payments (BoP)**, remittances are mainly recorded under the **Current Account** and form an important component of the **Secondary Income Account**.

338. As per the recent news, the following four traditional products from Jharkhand received the Geographical Indication (GI) Tag, EXCEPT_____

A.Bhagaiya Silk

B.Kuchai Silk

C.Munda Jewellery

D.Jharkhand Bamboo Craft

E.Tussar Silk

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

Four traditional products of Jharkhand — Bhagaiya Silk, Kuchai Silk, Munda Jewellery and Jharkhand Bamboo Craft — have received the prestigious **Geographical Indication (GI) Tag**.

The recognition highlights the unique craftsmanship, traditional knowledge and cultural heritage associated with these products and is expected to boost branding, exports and rural development.

Detailed Explanation:

Four traditional products of Jharkhand — Bhagaiya Silk, Kuchai Silk, Munda Jewellery and Jharkhand Bamboo Craft — have received the prestigious **Geographical Indication (GI) Tag**.

The recognition highlights the unique craftsmanship, traditional knowledge and cultural heritage associated with these products and is expected to boost branding, exports and rural development.

The achievement was supported by the sustained efforts of the **National Bank for Agriculture and Rural Development (NABARD)** along with artisans, Self-Help Groups, Farmer Producer Organisations, government departments and local communities.

A **Geographical Indication Tag** is an intellectual property right granted to products having unique qualities, reputation or characteristics linked to a specific geographical region.

339. As per the news, Pluvicto, India's first regulatory authority-approved Radioligand Therapy for advanced prostate cancer, uses which radioactive isotope to enable high-precision identification and destruction of cancer cells?

A.Iodine-131

B.Cobalt-60

C.Technetium-99m

D.Lutetium-177

E.Strontium-89

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

India has entered a new phase of precision cancer treatment with the launch of **Pluvicto**, the country's **first regulatory authority-approved Radioligand Therapy** for advanced prostate cancer.

Pluvicto has been introduced by **Novartis** and delivers targeted radiation directly to cancer cells while minimizing damage to healthy tissues.

It is developed for eligible patients with **Prostate-Specific Membrane Antigen-positive metastatic prostate cancer**, where cancer has spread beyond the prostate gland.

The treatment combines a targeting molecule with the radioactive isotope **Lutetium-177**, enabling high-precision identification and destruction of cancer cells.

Detailed Explanation:

India has entered a new phase of precision cancer treatment with the launch of **Pluvicto**, the country's **first regulatory authority-approved Radioligand Therapy** for advanced prostate cancer.

Pluvicto has been introduced by **Novartis** and delivers targeted radiation directly to cancer cells while minimizing damage to healthy tissues.

It is developed for eligible patients with **Prostate-Specific Membrane Antigen-positive metastatic prostate cancer**, where cancer has spread beyond the prostate gland.

The treatment combines a targeting molecule with the radioactive isotope **Lutetium-177**, enabling high-precision identification and destruction of cancer cells.

Radioligand Therapy is known as a **"guided missile"** approach because it delivers radiation directly to tumour cells.

India records nearly **2.5 lakh prostate cancer cases annually**, with more than half diagnosed at advanced stages.

340. As per the recent developments in India's fisheries sector, which state has risen from the ninth to the fourth position among inland fish-producing states, with its fish production more than doubling over the last eleven years?

A.West Bengal

B.Andhra Pradesh

C.Odisha

D.Uttar Pradesh

E.Bihar

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

Union Minister of Fisheries, Animal Husbandry and Dairying Rajiv Ranjan Singh and **Deputy Chief Minister of Bihar Samrat Choudhary** will lay the foundation stone of the **Integrated Aqua Park at Bhojpur** and inaugurate the **National Fisheries Development Board Regional Centre at Patna**.

The initiatives aim to strengthen inland fisheries infrastructure, promote modern aquaculture technologies and generate employment opportunities in Bihar.

Bihar possesses rich inland fisheries resources, including **1.22 lakh hectares of ponds and tanks, 0.64 lakh hectares of reservoirs, 9.5 lakh hectares of floodplain lakes and wetlands, and over 21,000 kilometres of rivers and canals**.

Detailed Explanation:

Union Minister of Fisheries, Animal Husbandry and Dairying Rajiv Ranjan Singh and **Deputy Chief Minister of Bihar Samrat Choudhary** will lay the foundation stone of the **Integrated Aqua Park at Bhojpur** and inaugurate the **National Fisheries Development Board Regional Centre at Patna**.

The initiatives aim to strengthen inland fisheries infrastructure, promote modern aquaculture technologies and generate employment opportunities in Bihar.

Bihar possesses rich inland fisheries resources, including **1.22 lakh hectares of ponds and tanks, 0.64 lakh hectares of reservoirs, 9.5 lakh hectares of floodplain lakes and wetlands, and over 21,000 kilometres of rivers and canals**.

Major fish species cultivated in Bihar include **Rohu, Catla, Mrigal, Tilapia, Pangasius, Magur, Pabda, Scampi and ornamental fish**.

Over the last eleven years, the Government of India has approved fisheries projects worth **₹902.84 crore** for Bihar, including **₹579.72 crore under the Pradhan Mantri Matsya Sampada Yojana**.

Bihar's fish production has more than doubled, helping the state rise from the **ninth to the fourth position among India's inland fish-producing states** and export around **89,600 metric tonnes of fish annually**.

341. Under the Department of Posts' new drone-based mail transmission service launched in Himachal Pradesh, the drone transports mail and parcels between which two post offices?

A.Shimla Head Post Office and Kullu Branch Post Office

B.Mandi Head Post Office and Rehardhar Branch Post Office

C.Dharamshala Head Post Office and Palampur Branch Post Office

D.Solan Head Post Office and Nahan Branch Post Office

E.Hamirpur Head Post Office and Una Branch Post Office

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The **Department of Posts** has launched a **drone-based mail transmission service** in **Himachal Pradesh**, enabling the transport of mail and parcels between **Mandi Head Post Office** and **Rehardhar Branch Post Office**.

The initiative was announced by **Union Minister for Communications and Development of North Eastern Region Jyotiraditya M. Scindia** and became operational.

The service aims to improve postal connectivity and public service delivery in remote and mountainous regions through the use of emerging technologies.

Rehardhar Branch Post Office, located about **12 kilometres** from **Mandi Head Post Office**, previously required more than **two hours** for mail transportation due to difficult terrain and road conditions.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Department of Posts** has launched a **drone-based mail transmission service** in **Himachal Pradesh**, enabling the transport of mail and parcels between **Mandi Head Post Office** and **Rehardhar Branch Post Office**.

The initiative was announced by **Union Minister for Communications and Development of North Eastern Region Jyotiraditya M. Scindia** and became operational.

The service aims to improve postal connectivity and public service delivery in remote and mountainous regions through the use of emerging technologies.

Rehardhar Branch Post Office, located about **12 kilometres** from **Mandi Head Post Office**, previously required more than **two hours** for mail transportation due to difficult terrain and road conditions.

With drone technology, the same journey can now be completed in approximately **seven minutes**, significantly reducing delivery time.

The **Mandi–Rehardhar route** is the first operational route under the Department of Posts' drone delivery initiative.

The department plans to expand drone-based mail services to around **150 identified routes across Himachal Pradesh and Assam** over the next two to three months.

The initiative is expected to improve the delivery of communication, financial services, government documents and parcels, while enhancing economic opportunities and social inclusion in remote communities.

342. Following the addition of three new chicks to the Project Great Indian Bustard conservation breeding programme, what is the current total captive population of the Great Indian Bustard in India?

A.94

B.91

C.96

D.97

E.18

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

India's conservation efforts for the **Great Indian Bustard (GIB)** achieved a major milestone with the addition of **three new chicks** to the **Project Great Indian Bustard conservation breeding programme**, announced by **Union Minister for Environment, Forest and Climate Change Bhupender Yadav**.

With the new additions, the captive population of the **Great Indian Bustard** has increased to **94 birds**.

The three hatchlings include **one chick from a wild-collected egg and two chicks from captive-laid eggs**.

Detailed Explanation:

India's conservation efforts for the **Great Indian Bustard (GIB)** achieved a major milestone with the addition of **three new chicks** to the **Project Great Indian Bustard conservation breeding programme**, announced by **Union Minister for Environment, Forest and Climate Change Bhupender Yadav**.

With the new additions, the captive population of the **Great Indian Bustard** has increased to **94 birds**.

The three hatchlings include **one chick from a wild-collected egg and two chicks from captive-laid eggs**.

During the fourth year of the conservation breeding programme, **26 chicks** have been hatched so far:

18 chicks through artificial insemination.

4 chicks through natural breeding.

4 chicks from wild-collected eggs.

The programme also follows a **jumpstart intervention strategy**, where selected eggs are collected from the wild and replaced to improve genetic diversity and reduce the risk of predation.

343. In 2026, India's first railway tunnel hood technology was deployed on which high-speed rail corridor to reduce noise, improve passenger comfort, and enhance operational safety for trains travelling above 300 kmph?

A.Delhi-Varanasi High-Speed Rail Corridor

B.Mumbai-Ahmedabad High-Speed Rail Corridor

C.Chennai-Bengaluru High-Speed Rail Corridor

D.Hyderabad-Nagpur High-Speed Rail Corridor

E.Kolkata-Patna High-Speed Rail Corridor

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

India's **Mumbai-Ahmedabad Bullet Train Project** achieved a major engineering milestone with the deployment of the country's first **railway tunnel hood technology**.

The tunnel hoods have been installed at mountain tunnel portals along the high-speed rail corridor to reduce noise, improve passenger comfort and enhance operational safety for trains travelling at speeds above **300 kilometres per hour (kmph)**.

Detailed Explanation:

India's **Mumbai-Ahmedabad Bullet Train Project** achieved a major engineering milestone with the deployment of the country's first **railway tunnel hood technology**.

The tunnel hoods have been installed at mountain tunnel portals along the high-speed rail corridor to reduce noise, improve passenger comfort and enhance operational safety for trains travelling at speeds above **300 kilometres per hour (kmph)**.

Tunnel hoods are specially designed structures installed at the entrances and exits of railway tunnels that regulate sudden air pressure changes when high-speed trains enter tunnels.

The technology reduces the **"tunnel boom"** effect by controlling air compression through pressure-relief vents and ensuring smoother airflow.

The system helps in reducing noise pollution, improving passenger comfort and enhancing the efficiency and safety of high-speed train operations.

The **Mumbai-Ahmedabad High-Speed Rail Corridor** includes **eight mountain tunnels**, with seven in Maharashtra and one in Gujarat, where tunnel hoods are being installed at both ends.

344. The 16th BRICS Agriculture Ministers Meeting, which concluded with the unanimous adoption of a Joint Declaration on food security and sustainable agriculture, was held in which Indian city?

A.New Delhi, Delhi

B.Mumbai, Maharashtra

C.Indore, Madhya Pradesh

D.Bengaluru, Karnataka

E.Hyderabad, Telangana

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The **16th BRICS Agriculture Ministers Meeting** was held **in Indore, Madhya Pradesh**, under India's Presidency.

The meeting concluded with the unanimous adoption of a **Joint Declaration** aimed at strengthening **food security, sustainable agriculture, agricultural innovation and farmer welfare** among BRICS member countries.

Detailed Explanation:

The **16th BRICS Agriculture Ministers Meeting** was held **in Indore, Madhya Pradesh**, under India's Presidency.

The meeting concluded with the unanimous adoption of a **Joint Declaration** aimed at strengthening **food security, sustainable agriculture, agricultural innovation and farmer welfare** among BRICS member countries.

The declaration emphasized the importance of:

Strengthening food security.

Promoting sustainable and climate-resilient agriculture.

Supporting smallholder farmers.

Encouraging agricultural innovation and cooperation.

The meeting approved the establishment of the **BRICS Network of Centres of Excellence on Agroecology and Regenerative Agriculture**.

It will initially be coordinated by the **Indian Council of Agricultural Research – Indian Institute of Farming System Research (ICAR-**

IIFSR), Modipuram, which will serve as India's Centre of Excellence on Natural Farming.
The network will promote sustainable farming practices, regenerative agriculture, collaborative research and knowledge sharing.
The member countries also approved the **BRICS Network on Digital Agriculture**, which will initially be coordinated by the **Indian Institute of Technology (IIT), Delhi**

345. What is the name of the initiative launched by India and France under the India-France Year of Innovation 2026 to connect young innovators from both countries through school-level innovation ecosystems?
A.India-France Innovation Corridor
B.Atal Tinkering Lab (ATL) Bridge
C.Franco-Indian Startup Connect
D.Bharat-France Young Innovators Programme
E.Indo-French Science and Technology Exchange
Answer: B
Short Explanation:
India and France launched the **India-France Atal Tinkering Lab (ATL) Bridge** under the **India-France Year of Innovation 2026** to strengthen cooperation in innovation, education and entrepreneurship.
The initiative aims to connect young innovators from both countries through school-level innovation ecosystems inspired by India's **Atal Tinkering Lab (ATL)** model.
Detailed Explanation:
India and France launched the **India-France Atal Tinkering Lab (ATL) Bridge** under the **India-France Year of Innovation 2026** to strengthen cooperation in innovation, education and entrepreneurship.
The initiative aims to connect young innovators from both countries through school-level innovation ecosystems inspired by India's **Atal Tinkering Lab (ATL)** model.
The initiative was formalised through a **Letter of Intent (LoI)** exchanged between the **Atal Innovation Mission (AIM)** and **La Fondation Dassault Systèmes** on the sidelines of **Bharat Innovates 2026** in Nice, France.
Prime Minister Narendra Modi and **French President Emmanuel Macron** inaugurated Bharat Innovates 2026, highlighting the growing strategic partnership between India and France.
As part of the initiative, France will establish its **first School Innovation Lab based on India's Atal Tinkering Lab framework**.
The India-France ATL Bridge will facilitate **student exchanges, joint innovation projects, entrepreneurship programmes and capacity-building initiatives** between the two nations.

346. As per the news, Platinum Jasmine A 2018 Trust, backed by the Abu Dhabi Investment Authority (ADIA), announced plans to sell a 2.3% stake in Lenskart Solutions Limited through a block deal. What is the floor price fixed for this transaction?
A.₹500 per share

B.₹421 per share

C.₹944 crore per share

D.₹486 per share

E.₹2.8 per share

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

Platinum Jasmine A 2018 Trust, an investment vehicle backed by the **Abu Dhabi Investment Authority (ADIA)**, announced plans to sell a **2.3% Stake** in **Lenskart Solutions Limited** through a **Block Deal**.

The **Floor Price** for the block deal has been fixed at **₹486 per Share**.

The floor price of ₹486 per share is approximately **2.8% Lower** than Lenskart's **Closing Share Price of ₹500.15** per Share.

Detailed Explanation:

Platinum Jasmine A 2018 Trust, an investment vehicle backed by the **Abu Dhabi Investment Authority (ADIA)**, announced plans to sell a **2.3% Stake** in **Lenskart Solutions Limited** through a **Block Deal**.

The proposed stake sale is valued at approximately **₹1,944 Crore ($204 Million USD)**.

The transaction aims to **reduce the holding** of Platinum Jasmine A 2018 Trust in Lenskart Solutions Limited.

IIFL Capital Services Limited has been appointed as the **Sole Placement Agent** for the transaction and will oversee the execution of the stake sale.

The **Floor Price** for the block deal has been fixed at **₹486 per Share**.

The floor price of ₹486 per share is approximately **2.8% Lower** than Lenskart's **Closing Share Price of ₹500.15** per Share.

347. The CSIR–National Institute of Science Communication and Policy Research (CSIR-NIScPR) successfully conducted a three-day offline Skill Training Programme from 10–12 June 2026 at Satsang Vihar, New Delhi. What was the specific topic/focus of this training programme?

A.Basics of Python Programming

B.Basics of Koha Software

C.Basics of Digital Marketing

D.Basics of Data Analytics

E.Basics of Cloud Computing

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

CSIR–National Institute of Science Communication and Policy Research (CSIR-NIScPR) successfully conducted a three-day offline **Skill Training Programme** on **"Basics of Koha Software"** from **10–12 June 2026** at Satsang Vihar, **New Delhi**.

The programme was organized by the **Training Division of CSIR-NIScPR** to strengthen professional competencies in **Open-Source Library Automation** and **Integrated Library Management Systems (ILMS)**.

Detailed Explanation:

CSIR–National Institute of Science Communication and Policy Research (CSIR-NIScPR) successfully conducted a three-day offline **Skill Training Programme** on **"Basics of Koha Software"** from **10–12 June 2026** at Satsang Vihar, **New Delhi**.

The programme was organized by the **Training Division of CSIR-NIScPR** to strengthen professional competencies in **Open-Source Library Automation** and **Integrated Library Management Systems (ILMS)**.

The training focused on **Koha Software**, a globally recognized Open-Source Integrated Library Management System (ILMS) widely used for library automation.

A total of **33 participants** from academic, research, and library institutions across India participated in the programme.

The programme was coordinated by **Ms. Meetali Bharti** (Nodal PI), **Mr. Salim Ansari** (Co-PI), and **Mr. Mukesh A. Pund**, Chief Scientist & Head, Training Division, CSIR-NIScPR.

348. Which commercial arm of the Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) selected the first three Indian Non-Governmental Entities (NGEs) for funding under its Technology Adoption Fund (TAF) Scheme?

A.Indian National Space Promotion and Authorisation Centre (IN-SPACe)

B.Antrix Corporation Limited

C.NewSpace India Limited (NSIL)

D.Physical Research Laboratory (PRL)

E.Vikram Sarabhai Space Centre (VSSC)

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

The **Indian National Space Promotion and Authorisation Centre (IN-SPACe)**, the commercial arm of the Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO), selected the **first three Indian Non-Governmental Entities (NGEs)** for funding under its **Technology Adoption Fund (TAF) Scheme**.

The selected startups are **Astrobase Space Technologies Pvt. Ltd.** (Bengaluru, Karnataka), **SataSure Analytics India Pvt. Ltd.** (Bengaluru, Karnataka), and **TM2SPACE Technologies Pvt. Ltd.** (Hyderabad, Telangana).

Detailed Explanation:

The **Indian National Space Promotion and Authorisation Centre (IN-SPACe)**, the commercial arm of the Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO), selected the **first three Indian Non-Governmental Entities (NGEs)** for funding under its **Technology Adoption Fund (TAF) Scheme**.

The selected startups are **Astrobase Space Technologies Pvt. Ltd.** (Bengaluru, Karnataka), **SataSure Analytics India Pvt. Ltd.** (Bengaluru, Karnataka), and **TM2SPACE Technologies Pvt. Ltd.** (Hyderabad, Telangana).

These startups were chosen through a rigorous **multi-stage evaluation process** conducted by an expert committee

comprising representatives from **ISRO**, the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (**DPIIT**), the Department of Science and Technology (**DST**), and other stakeholders.

Astrobase Space Technologies Pvt. Ltd. has been tasked with developing a **high-thrust reusable closed-cycle liquid rocket engine of 800 kN capacity** for medium- and heavy-lift space launch vehicles.

SataSure Analytics India Pvt. Ltd. will develop **"Dhaarini"**, a **Large Earth Observation Model (LOM)** that will serve as India's foundational **Artificial Intelligence (AI) platform** for remote-sensing applications.

The **Dhaarini platform** will generate actionable insights for sectors such as **agriculture, infrastructure, and disaster management** using satellite and aerial datasets.

349. At the RISE Conclave 2026 held in Bengaluru, Dr. Jitendra Singh highlighted which of the following themes while emphasizing the role of innovation in nation-building?

A.Technology for Inclusive Growth and Sustainable Development

B.Innovation & Entrepreneurship Driven Growth for Viksit Bharat 2047

C.Digital India: Transforming the Future Economy

D.Startup Revolution for Atmanirbhar Bharat

E.Research Excellence for Global Leadership

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Addressing the **RISE Conclave 2026** in **Bengaluru**, **Dr. Jitendra Singh** highlighted the theme **"Innovation & Entrepreneurship Driven Growth for Viksit Bharat 2047"** and emphasized the role of innovation in nation-building.

India's **Startup Ecosystem** has generated nearly **24–25 Lakh Jobs** over the last decade, making it a major driver of employment and economic growth.

The number of startups in India has increased from around 350–400 Startups a decade ago to nearly **2.3 Lakh Ventures**, making India the **World's Third-Largest Startup Ecosystem**.

Narendra Modi's **Startup India Initiative**, launched in **2015**, laid the foundation for a vibrant entrepreneurial culture and innovation-led development.

Detailed Explanation:

Addressing the **RISE Conclave 2026** in **Bengaluru**, **Dr. Jitendra Singh** highlighted the theme **"Innovation & Entrepreneurship Driven Growth for Viksit Bharat 2047"** and emphasized the role of innovation in nation-building.

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the **World's Third-Largest Startup Ecosystem**.

Narendra Modi's **Startup India Initiative**, launched in **2015**, laid the foundation for a vibrant entrepreneurial culture and innovation-led development.

The RISE Conclave was conceived to bring together the **four pillars of Research, Industry, Startups, and Entrepreneurship** on a single platform.

The conclave promotes collaboration among **Scientists, Industry Leaders, Investors, Academia, Policymakers, MSMEs, and Startups** to build a **Self-Reliant** and Innovation-Driven India.

India's first **Public-Private Aerospace Incubation Centre**, CSIR-NAL's **mach33.aero**, has completed **Five Years of Operations** and successfully incubated **34 Startups**.

350. As of 2026, Avataar.ai, with support from the IndiaAI Mission, launched India's first indigenous distilled video story-generating AI model on 12 June 2026 at an event in New Delhi. What is the name of this AI model?

A.BharatGPT

B.Krutrim

C.Sarvam

D.Varya

E.Hanooman

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

Avataar.ai, an Artificial Intelligence (AI)-native transformation company,

launched **'Varya'**, **India's first indigenous distilled video story-generating AI model**, with support from the **IndiaAI Mission**.

The AI model was unveiled on **12 June 2026** at an event in **New Delhi** in the presence of **S. Krishnan, Secretary, Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY)**.

Detailed Explanation:

Avataar.ai, an Artificial Intelligence (AI)-native transformation company,

launched **'Varya'**, **India's first indigenous distilled video story-generating AI model**, with support from the **IndiaAI Mission**.

The AI model was unveiled on **12 June 2026** at an event in **New Delhi** in the presence of **S. Krishnan, Secretary, Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY)**.

Distilled Video Generation is a **machine learning model compression technique** in which a compact **"student" model** learns to replicate the outputs of a larger and more complex **"teacher" model**.

The process transfers the capabilities of the larger model to the smaller model while removing **redundant computations**, resulting in faster and more efficient performance.

Conventional video-generation models typically require **more than 50 iterative noisy steps** to produce a clean video output, making the process computationally intensive.

Varya was developed by **Avataar.ai**, which was selected under the **IndiaAI Mission**, and built

using **national AI compute infrastructure**, strengthening India's indigenous AI and deep-tech ecosystem.

The model enables **AI-powered video creation** across sectors such as **education, e-commerce, and digital content creation** through simple prompt-based story generation.

Varya uses **distilled video generation technology**, reducing the video creation process from **50 steps to just 4 steps**, significantly improving efficiency.

The platform can generate videos at an estimated cost of around **₹0.48 per second** and offers up to **10 times greater efficiency** compared to conventional video-generation methods.

351. In news, the Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO) successfully conducted three consecutive flight-tests on 10–11 June 2026 of which indigenous system, demonstrating India's capability to detect, track, intercept, and neutralise ballistic missile threats?

A.Project Devil

B.Integrated Multi-Layered Ballistic Missile Defence (BMD) System

C.Prithvi Air Defence (PAD) System

D.Advanced Air Defence (AAD) System

E.Surya Missile Defence Shield

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO) under the **Ministry of Defence (MoD)** successfully conducted **three consecutive flight-tests** of India's **Integrated Multi-Layered Ballistic Missile Defence (BMD) System** on **10–11 June 2026**.

The trials demonstrated India's capability to **detect, track, intercept, and neutralise ballistic missile threats**, including **Long-Range Missiles (5,000 km range)** and **Medium-Range Missiles (2,000 km range)**.

The flight-tests of **two advanced interceptor missiles** were conducted from the **Integrated Test Range (ITR), Chandipur, Odisha**.

Detailed Explanation:

Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO) under the **Ministry of Defence (MoD)** successfully conducted **three consecutive flight-tests** of India's **Integrated Multi-Layered Ballistic Missile Defence (BMD) System** on **10–11 June 2026**.

The trials demonstrated India's capability to **detect, track, intercept, and neutralise ballistic missile threats**, including **Long-Range Missiles (5,000 km range)** and **Medium-Range Missiles (2,000 km range)**.

The flight-tests of **two advanced interceptor missiles** were conducted from the **Integrated Test Range (ITR), Chandipur, Odisha**.

DRDO also successfully carried out the **maiden flight-test** of the indigenous **Naval Anti-Ship Missile–Medium Range (NASM-MR)**,

strengthening India's anti-ship warfare capabilities.

The tests formed part of **Phase-II of India's Ballistic Missile Defence (BMD) Programme**, aimed at enhancing protection against advanced missile threats.

During the trial, a **target missile simulating an adversary ballistic missile** was launched from **Launch Complex-IV (LC-IV), Dhamra, Odisha**.

The target missile was **successfully detected by land-based and sea-based radar systems**, and subsequently **intercepted by the air defence interceptor system**.

352. Which multi-level missile defence system, announced by Prime Minister Narendra Modi during his Independence Day Address on 15 August 2025, aims to provide a three-layered protective shield for military installations, critical infrastructure, civil infrastructure, and key establishments across India?

A.Mission Sudarshan Chakra

B.Mission Akash

C.Mission Prithvi Shield

D.Mission Indra Dhanush

E.Mission Surya Kavach

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

Defence Minister Rajnath Singh stated that **Mission Sudarshan Chakra**, announced by Prime Minister Narendra Modi during the Independence Day Address on 15 August 2025, will become a **multi-level missile defence system** of modern India.

Mission Sudarshan Chakra aims to provide a **three-layered protective shield** for military installations, critical infrastructure, civil infrastructure, and key establishments across the country.

Detailed Explanation:

Defence Minister Rajnath Singh stated that **Mission Sudarshan Chakra**, announced by Prime Minister Narendra Modi during the Independence Day Address on 15 August 2025, will become a **multi-level missile defence system** of modern India.

Mission Sudarshan Chakra aims to provide a **three-layered protective shield** for military installations, critical infrastructure, civil infrastructure, and key establishments across the country.

The system is being developed to provide **robust protection**, ensure **citizen safety**, and possess the capability to deliver a **decisive retaliatory punch** whenever required.

The mission is targeted for **full integration by 2035** through collaboration among the **military, research institutions, and private sector**.

Rajnath Singh inaugurated the **Advanced Weapon System Complex** at the **Dr APJ Abdul Kalam Missile Complex** on **12 June 2026**, strengthening India's **indigenous missile development ecosystem**.

353. Following the Ministry of Defence's approval to create two new independent National Cadet Corps (NCC) State Directorates in Andhra Pradesh and Jharkhand, what is the new total number of NCC State Directorates in India?

A.15

B.17

C.18

D.19

E.21

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

The **Ministry of Defence (MoD)** approved the creation of **two new independent National Cadet Corps (NCC) State Directorates** in **Andhra Pradesh and Jharkhand**, increasing the total number of NCC State Directorates from **17 to 19**.

The establishment of **independent directorates in Andhra Pradesh and Jharkhand** will bring the NCC closer to cadets and educational institutions, ensuring **better administration, coordination, supervision, and support** for training activities.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Ministry of Defence (MoD)** approved the creation of **two new independent National Cadet Corps (NCC) State Directorates** in **Andhra Pradesh and Jharkhand**, increasing the total number of NCC State Directorates from **17 to 19**.

The establishment of **independent directorates in Andhra Pradesh and Jharkhand** will bring the NCC closer to cadets and educational institutions, ensuring **better administration, coordination, supervision, and support** for training activities.

The new administrative structure will facilitate **more focused coordination, improved supervision, and enhanced support** for training and developmental programmes.

The decision will provide **greater opportunities for youth** through **improved training infrastructure**, support systems, and expanded participation in NCC activities.

Cadets from these states will gain **increased access to prestigious centrally organised NCC camps** such as the **Republic Day Parade Camp** and the **All India Thal Sainik Camp**.

354. The World Day to Combat Desertification and Drought is observed globally every year on which date to raise awareness about preventing desertification, land degradation, and drought?

A.5 June

B.17 June

C.22 June

D.30 January

E.15 August

Answer: B

World Day to Combat Desertification and Drought are observed globally on **17 June every year** to raise awareness about the need to prevent desertification, land degradation and drought.

The day promotes sustainable land management, community participation and collective action to achieve **Land Degradation Neutrality**.

The **United Nations General Assembly** declared **17 June** as the **World Day to Combat Desertification and Drought** on **30 January 1995**.

355. Which renowned Mand folk singer, known for her iconic rendition of "Kesariya Balam" that became a symbol of Rajasthan's cultural identity and hospitality, passed away at the age of 98 in Pali district, Rajasthan?

A.M.S. Subbulakshmi

B.Gangubai Hangal

C.Gavri Devi

D.Sharda Sinha

E.Malini Awasthi

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

Renowned Mand folk singer Gavri Devi passed away at the age of **98** in **Gavri Nagar, Desuri, Pali district, Rajasthan**.

Gavri Devi was born on **14 April 1928** in **Koran village, Barmer district, Rajasthan**.

She became widely known for her **iconic rendition of the folk song "Kesariya Balam"**, which emerged as a **symbol of Rajasthan's cultural identity and hospitality**.

In **1986**, she was honoured with the prestigious **Sangeet Natak Akademi Award** for her contribution to Indian folk music.

Detailed Explanation:

Renowned Mand folk singer Gavri Devi passed away at the age of **98** in **Gavri Nagar, Desuri, Pali district, Rajasthan**.

Gavri Devi was born on **14 April 1928** in **Koran village, Barmer district, Rajasthan**.

She became widely known for her **iconic rendition of the folk song "Kesariya Balam"**, which emerged as a **symbol of Rajasthan's cultural identity and hospitality**.

In **1986**, she was honoured with the prestigious **Sangeet Natak Akademi Award** for her contribution to Indian folk music.

She received the **Rajasthan Ratna Award in 2013** for her outstanding contribution to the state's cultural heritage.

Gavri Devi was also honoured with the **Veer Durgadas Rathore Lifetime Achievement Award** for preserving and promoting Rajasthan's rich folk traditions.

Mand is a traditional folk music genre of Rajasthan, particularly associated with the **Marwar region**, and is considered one of the **most distinctive musical forms** of the state.

356. As per SEBI's revised trading framework for Exchange Traded Funds (ETFs), exchanges and mutual funds have been directed to adopt T-1 closing NAV as the base price from which date?

A.1 September 2026

B.1 January 2027

C.1 March 2027

D.1 April 2027

E.1 July 2027

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) has revised the trading framework for **Exchange Traded Funds (ETFs)** by introducing dynamic price bands, a new base price determination methodology, and a pre-open call auction mechanism.

The revised ETF trading norms will come into effect from **1 September 2026**.

SEBI has directed exchanges and mutual funds to work towards adopting **T-1 closing NAV** as the base price from **1 April 2027**.

For Equity ETFs and Debt ETFs, the existing fixed 20% price band has been replaced with **dynamic price bands**.

Detailed Explanation:

Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) has revised the trading framework for **Exchange Traded Funds (ETFs)** by introducing dynamic price bands, a new base price determination methodology, and a pre-open call auction mechanism.

The revised ETF trading norms will come into effect from **1 September 2026**.

The objective of the new framework is to align ETF trading prices more closely with the movements of their **underlying assets** and improve **price discovery**.

Under the previous system, ETF price bands were based on the **T-2 day Net Asset Value (NAV)**, which often created a mismatch with current market conditions.

Under the revised framework, exchanges will use the **previous day's closing market price**, calculated through the last 30-minute **Volume Weighted Average Price (VWAP)**, as the base price.

If there is no trading during the final 30 minutes, the **last traded price** will be used as the base price.

In the absence of market prices, the **latest available NAV** will serve as the fallback base price.

SEBI has directed exchanges and mutual funds to work towards adopting **T-1 closing NAV** as the base price from **1 April 2027**.

For Equity ETFs and Debt ETFs, the existing fixed 20% price band has been replaced with **dynamic price bands**.

357. According to the RBI's Consumer Confidence Survey released in May 2026, what was the Current Situation Index (CSI) for urban consumers?

A.85.2

B.90.7

C.94.0

D.100.0

E.118.7

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** released its latest **Consumer Confidence Survey**, which

showed a **decline in consumer confidence** in both urban and rural areas in **May 2026**.
Consumer sentiment weakened due to concerns regarding **inflation, employment conditions, income levels, spending patterns, and overall economic activity**.
The **Current Situation Index (CSI)** for urban consumers **declined to 90.7** in May 2026 from **94.0** in March 2026.
Detailed Explanation:
The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** released its latest **Consumer Confidence Survey**, which showed a **decline in consumer confidence** in both urban and rural areas in **May 2026**.
Consumer sentiment weakened due to concerns regarding **inflation, employment conditions, income levels, spending patterns, and overall economic activity**.
The **Current Situation Index (CSI)** for urban consumers **declined to 90.7** in May 2026 from **94.0** in March 2026.
The fall in the **Urban CSI** indicates a **weaker assessment of the current economic situation** by consumers.
Rural consumer confidence also deteriorated during the survey period.
The **Rural Current Situation Index (CSI) decreased to 95.2** from **100.0** recorded in the previous survey round.
The decline in the **Rural CSI** reflects **growing concerns among rural households** regarding present economic conditions.
The **Future Expectations Index (FEI)** for urban consumers **fell to 118.7** in May 2026 from **120.2** in March 2026.

358. As of 2026, India has introduced a revised Wholesale Price Index (WPI) series with which of the following as the new base year?
A.2011–12
B.2015–16
C.2017–18
D.2020–21
E.2022–23
Answer: E
Short Explanation:
India has introduced the revised **Wholesale Price Index (WPI)** series with the base year **2022-23**, replacing the earlier **2011-12** series.
Along with the revised WPI, the government has launched new **Producer Price Indices (PPIs)**, including the **Output Producer Price Index (OPPI)**, **Trial Input Producer Price Index (IPPI)** and **Service Producer Price Indices (Service PPIs)**.
Detailed Explanation:
India has introduced the revised **Wholesale Price Index (WPI)** series with the base year **2022-23**, replacing the earlier **2011-12** series.
Along with the revised WPI, the government has launched new **Producer Price Indices (PPIs)**, including the **Output Producer Price Index (OPPI)**, **Trial Input Producer Price Index**

(IPPI) and **Service Producer Price Indices (Service PPIs)**.

The initiative marks a major modernization of India's inflation measurement framework and aligns with global statistical practices.

The government aims to gradually transition from WPI to PPIs, which are widely used internationally for measuring producer-level inflation. Both WPI and PPI will be published simultaneously for the next five years.

The revision follows the recommendations of the **International Monetary Fund (IMF)** for adopting Producer Price Indices as a better measure of producer inflation.

The revised WPI has expanded its commodity basket from **697 items to 957 items**, providing wider coverage of the Indian economy.

359. Which provision of the Information Technology Act, 2000 was invoked by the Government of India to temporarily restrict access to Telegram ahead of the NEET (UG) 2026 re-examination?

A.Section 43A

B.Section 66C

C.Section 67B

D.Section 69A

E.Section 72A

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

The **Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY)** temporarily restricted access to the **Telegram** messaging platform across India until **22 June 2026**.

The decision was taken ahead of the **National Eligibility-cum-Entrance Test (Undergraduate) [NEET (UG)] 2026 re-examination**, scheduled to be held, based on recommendations from the **National Testing Agency (NTA)**.

The government invoked **Section 69A of the Information Technology Act, 2000** to impose the temporary restriction on public access to the platform.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY)** temporarily restricted access to the **Telegram** messaging platform across India until **22 June 2026**.

The decision was taken ahead of the **National Eligibility-cum-Entrance Test (Undergraduate) [NEET (UG)] 2026 re-examination**, scheduled to be held, based on recommendations from the **National Testing Agency (NTA)**.

The restriction was imposed as a preventive measure to protect the integrity, fairness and transparency of the examination process.

Authorities expressed concerns that Telegram channels and groups could be misused for circulating alleged question papers, answer keys and misleading examination-related information.

The **National Testing Agency (NTA)** welcomed the move, stating that it would help create a fair and secure examination environment.

The government invoked **Section 69A of the Information Technology Act, 2000** to impose

the temporary restriction on public access to the platform.

360. Recently, a major focus area of the 19th Mumbai International Film Festival (MIFF) 2026 is the integration of which technology in filmmaking and storytelling?

A.Blockchain Technology

B.Quantum Computing

C.Artificial Intelligence (AI)

D.Virtual Banking Systems

E.5G Satellite Communication

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The **19th edition of the Mumbai International Film Festival (MIFF) 2026** commenced **in Mumbai, Maharashtra**.

The festival is organised by the **National Film Development Corporation (NFDC)** under the **Ministry of Information and Broadcasting**.

MIFF is one of **Asia's most prestigious film festivals dedicated to non-feature cinema**, including documentaries, short fiction films, animation and emerging digital storytelling formats.

The inaugural ceremony was held at **Ravindra Natya Mandir, Mumbai**, with the participation of filmmakers, artists, delegates and industry experts.

A major focus of **MIFF 2026** is the integration of **Artificial Intelligence (AI)-based filmmaking and storytelling**, highlighting the increasing role of digital technologies in content creation, visual effects and narrative development.

Detailed Explanation:

The **19th edition of the Mumbai International Film Festival (MIFF) 2026** commenced **in Mumbai, Maharashtra**.

The festival is organised by the **National Film Development Corporation (NFDC)** under the **Ministry of Information and Broadcasting**.

MIFF is one of **Asia's most prestigious film festivals dedicated to non-feature cinema**, including documentaries, short fiction films, animation and emerging digital storytelling formats.

The festival serves as a global platform for documentary filmmakers, animators, short-film creators and emerging storytellers from across the world.

The inaugural ceremony was held at **Ravindra Natya Mandir, Mumbai**, with the participation of filmmakers, artists, delegates and industry experts.

The **Mumbai International Film Festival (MIFF)** promotes dialogue on social, cultural, environmental and technological issues through the medium of cinema.

A major focus of **MIFF 2026** is the integration of **Artificial Intelligence (AI)-based filmmaking and storytelling**, highlighting the increasing role of digital technologies in content creation, visual effects and narrative development.

The festival provides opportunities for filmmakers to showcase their work, interact with audiences, participate in discussions and establish collaborations with industry professionals.

361. Which globally recognised architecture and design award honoured Navi Mumbai International Airport (Terminal 1) and Lokapriya Gopinath Bordoloi International Airport (Terminal 2) by including them in the World's Most Beautiful Airports List 2026?

A.Prix Versailles

B.Aga Khan Award for Architecture

C.Pritzker Architecture Prize

D.Stirling Prize

E.International Architecture Award

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

Navi Mumbai International Airport (Terminal 1) and **Lokapriya Gopinath Bordoloi International Airport, Guwahati (Terminal 2)** have been included in the prestigious **Prix Versailles World's Most Beautiful Airports List 2026**.

The recognition highlights India's growing emphasis on world-class airport architecture, sustainability and passenger-centric infrastructure.

Detailed Explanation:

Navi Mumbai International Airport (Terminal 1) and **Lokapriya Gopinath Bordoloi International Airport, Guwahati (Terminal 2)** have been included in the prestigious **Prix Versailles World's Most Beautiful Airports List 2026**.

The recognition highlights India's growing emphasis on world-class airport architecture, sustainability and passenger-centric infrastructure.

The two airport projects developed by **Adani Airport Holdings Limited (AAHL)** were selected for their excellence in architectural innovation, functionality, sustainability and enhanced passenger experience.

Prix Versailles is a globally recognised architecture and design award presented annually at the **UNESCO Headquarters in Paris, France**, since 2015.

The award honours outstanding contemporary architectural projects across categories such as airports, hotels, museums, campuses, railway stations and sports facilities.

362. As of 2026, Prime Minister Narendra Modi was conferred with The Order of the White Double Cross (1st Class), the highest national honour of which country?

A.Slovenia

B.Slovakia

C.Serbia

D.Croatia

E.Czech Republic

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** was conferred with **The Order of the White Double Cross (1st Class)**, Slovakia's highest national honour, during his official visit to **Bratislava**.

The award was presented by Slovak President **Peter Pellegrini** in recognition of Prime Minister Modi's contribution to

strengthening bilateral relations between India and Slovakia.

Detailed Explanation:

Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** was conferred with **The Order of the White Double Cross (1st Class)**, Slovakia's highest national honour, during his official visit to **Bratislava**.

The award was presented by Slovak President **Peter Pellegrini** in recognition of Prime Minister Modi's contribution to strengthening bilateral relations between India and Slovakia.

The **Order of the White Double Cross** is Slovakia's highest state decoration awarded to foreign nationals for exceptional contributions to international relations, cooperation and mutual understanding.

Accepting the honour, Prime Minister Modi dedicated the award to the people of India and described it as a symbol of the enduring friendship, trust and mutual respect between India and Slovakia.

The honour marks the **33rd international award** conferred upon Prime Minister Narendra Modi by a foreign country.

363. Which ministry launched the Yoga Park Portal to transform public parks into community wellness hubs promoting yoga, meditation, and preventive healthcare?

A.Ministry of Health and Family Welfare

B.Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports

C.Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs

D.Ministry of Rural Development

E.Ministry of Ayush

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

The **Ministry of Ayush** launched the **Yoga Park Portal** to transform existing parks across India into **community wellness hubs** promoting yoga, meditation, preventive healthcare, and healthy lifestyles.

The **Yoga Park Portal** was launched by the Union Minister of State (Independent Charge) for Ayush, **Shri Prataprao Jadhav**, during the **25-day countdown event** for the **International Day of Yoga (IDY) 2026** held at **Khajuraho**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Ministry of Ayush** launched the **Yoga Park Portal** to transform existing parks across India into **community wellness hubs** promoting yoga, meditation, preventive healthcare, and healthy lifestyles.

The **Yoga Park Portal** was launched by the Union Minister of State (Independent Charge) for Ayush, **Shri Prataprao Jadhav**, during the **25-day countdown event** for the **International Day of Yoga (IDY) 2026** held at **Khajuraho**.

The portal was unveiled alongside the **relaunched Yoga Sangam Portal**, reflecting the Ministry's efforts to strengthen the **grassroots reach of yoga** and create **sustainable wellness infrastructure** across the country.

The initiative aims to convert public parks from recreational spaces into **permanent community**

wellness centres that encourage regular yoga practice, meditation, preventive healthcare, and social engagement.

Stakeholders such as **Panchayati Raj Institutions (PRIs), Urban Local Bodies (ULBs), Resident Welfare Associations (RWAs), Non-Governmental Organisations (NGOs), corporate entities**, and other institutions can participate in developing and maintaining Yoga Parks.

364. What is the name of the major healthcare outreach and humanitarian initiative jointly undertaken by the Indian Army and the Indian Air Force (IAF) to provide advanced eye care services?

A.Operation DRISHTI

B.Operation SADBHAVANA

C.Operation SEVA

D.Operation NETRA

E.Operation JEEVAN

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

Operation DRISHTI is a major healthcare outreach and humanitarian initiative undertaken by the **Indian Army** and **Indian Air Force (IAF)** to provide advanced eye care services.

A **Mega Advanced Surgical Eye Camp** is being conducted at **Military Hospital Namkum, Ranchi, Jharkhand**, from **15–19 June 2026**.

The camp aims to restore vision and improve the quality of life of **more than 200 beneficiaries** through **free advanced eye surgeries**.

Detailed Explanation:

Operation DRISHTI is a major healthcare outreach and humanitarian initiative undertaken by the **Indian Army** and **Indian Air Force (IAF)** to provide advanced eye care services.

A **Mega Advanced Surgical Eye Camp** is being conducted at **Military Hospital Namkum, Ranchi, Jharkhand**, from **15–19 June 2026**.

The camp aims to restore vision and improve the quality of life of **more than 200 beneficiaries** through **free advanced eye surgeries**.

The specialised ophthalmic team is led by **Brigadier Dr. Sanjay Kumar Mishra**, Consultant and Head, Department of Ophthalmology, **Army Hospital (Research & Referral), New Delhi**.

The camp provides advanced ophthalmic procedures including **Phacoemulsification for Cataract**, **Minimally Invasive Glaucoma Surgery (MIGS)**, and **Anti-VEGF Intravitreal Injections for Vitreo-Retinal Diseases**.

Comprehensive eye screening is being conducted for **ex-servicemen, serving dependents, and underprivileged civilians**.

To support the mission, **world-class medical equipment** was airlifted to Ranchi using **Indian Air Force service aircraft**.

365. At the first batch of women cadets commissioned into the Indian Armed Forces after training at the National Defence Academy (NDA) joined the NDA as part of which course?

A.146th Course
B.147th Course
C.148th Course
D.149th Course
E.150th Course
Answer: C
Short Explanation:
The **Ministry of Defence (MoD)** commissioned the **first batch of 17 women cadets** trained at the **National Defence Academy (NDA)** into the **Indian Army (IA), Indian Navy (IN), and Indian Air Force (IAF)**, marking a historic milestone in gender inclusion in India's Defence Forces.
The **17 women cadets** joined the NDA in **August 2022** as part of the **148th Course**, becoming the **first women batch to undergo tri-service training** at National Defence Academy.
Detailed Explanation:
The **Ministry of Defence (MoD)** commissioned the **first batch of 17 women cadets** trained at the **National Defence Academy (NDA)** into the **Indian Army (IA), Indian Navy (IN), and Indian Air Force (IAF)**, marking a historic milestone in gender inclusion in India's Defence Forces.
The **17 women cadets** joined the NDA in **August 2022** as part of the **148th Course**, becoming the **first women batch to undergo tri-service training** at National Defence Academy.
The entry of women into NDA followed the **landmark 2021 Supreme Court judgment**, which allowed women candidates to appear for NDA examinations and training.
The **Indian Army commissioned 9 women officers** during the Passing Out Parade at the **Indian Military Academy (IMA)**.
The **Indian Air Force commissioned 5 women officers** at the **Air Force Academy (AFA)**.
The **Indian Navy commissioned 3 women officers** at the **Indian Naval Academy (INA)**.
The **Supreme Court (SC)** ruled that excluding women from NDA admissions violated the constitutional guarantees of equality under **Articles 14 and 16** of the Constitution of India.

366. Which telescopic sight was selected by the Indian Army as the dedicated daytime optic for its in-service NEGEV 7.62×51 mm Light Machine Guns (LMGs) in June 2026?
A.MEPRO X4
B.MEPRO X5
C.MEPRO X8
D.MEPRO X6
E.MEPRO X10
Answer: D
Short Explanation:
The **Indian Army** selected the **MEPRO X6 telescopic sight** as the dedicated daytime optic for its in-service **NEGEV 7.62×51 mm Light Machine Guns (LMGs)** on **15 June 2026**.
The programme supports the **Make in India** and **Atmanirbhar Bharat** initiatives through indigenous manufacturing under a **Transfer of Technology (ToT)** agreement.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Indian Army** selected the **MEPRO X6 telescopic sight** as the dedicated daytime optic for its in-service **NEGEV 7.62×51 mm Light Machine Guns (LMGs)** on **15 June 2026**.

The programme supports the **Make in India** and **Atmanirbhar Bharat** initiatives through indigenous manufacturing under a **Transfer of Technology (ToT)** agreement.

Meprolight (Israel) signed a **Transfer of Technology (ToT)** agreement with **RRP Defense** for local production of the MEPRO X6 in India.

Bharat Electronics Limited (BEL) serves as the **prime contractor** for the programme and will procure the sights from RRP Defense.

The **MEPRO X6** is a compact **fixed 6x magnification telescopic day sight** designed for assault rifles, light machine guns, and other weapon systems.

The sight has a stated **effective range of up to 1,000 metres**, while the Indian Army specification requires an **operational range of 800 metres**.

367. Which AI-driven managed operations platform will Tata Consultancy Services (TCS) deploy under its multiyear transformation agreement with Canada Life?

A.Ignio

B.Cognix

C.BaNCS

D.Quartz

E.MasterCraft

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Tata Consultancy Services (TCS) signed a **multiyear transformation and managed services agreement** with **Canada Life**, a leading life and pensions insurer, to modernise its Information Technology (IT) infrastructure services across its European businesses.

Under the agreement, TCS will leverage its **Artificial Intelligence (AI)** and digital capabilities to modernise and manage Canada Life's data centres, core infrastructure, end-user computing environment and software lifecycle management.

TCS will deploy its **Cognix**, an AI-driven managed operations platform, as part of the transformation and service delivery framework.

Detailed Explanation:

Tata Consultancy Services (TCS) signed a **multiyear transformation and managed services agreement** with **Canada Life**, a leading life and pensions insurer, to modernise its Information Technology (IT) infrastructure services across its European businesses.

Under the agreement, TCS will leverage its **Artificial Intelligence (AI)** and digital capabilities to modernise and manage Canada Life's data centres, core infrastructure, end-user computing environment and software lifecycle management.

TCS will deploy its **Cognix**, an AI-driven managed operations platform, as part of the transformation and service delivery framework.

As part of the partnership, TCS will expand its infrastructure services talent base across the **United Kingdom, Ireland, Isle of Man and Germany**, with investments in employee learning, certification and career development. The agreement strengthens TCS's position in Europe's **Banking, Financial Services and Insurance (BFSI)** technology services market. The partnership also aligns with the **European Union's Digital Operational Resilience Act (DORA)**, which came into force in **January 2025**, aimed at enhancing the digital resilience of financial institutions.

368. During Prime Minister Narendra Modi's historic visit to Slovakia, the first-ever Indian Council for Cultural Relations (ICCR) Chair in Artificial Intelligence (AI) was established at which institution?

A.Comenius University, Bratislava
B.Slovak University of Technology, Bratislava
C.Pavol Jozef Šafárik University, Košice
D.Technical University of Košice
E.University of Žilina

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** paid a historic State Visit to **Slovakia** at the invitation of Slovak Prime Minister **Robert Fico**.

A major achievement was the establishment of the **first-ever Indian Council for Cultural Relations (ICCR) Chair in Artificial Intelligence (AI)** at the **Technical University of Kosice**, highlighting the growing cooperation in advanced technologies and academic research.

Detailed Explanation:

Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** paid a historic State Visit to **Slovakia** at the invitation of Slovak Prime Minister **Robert Fico**.

The visit marked the first-ever visit by an Indian Prime Minister to Slovakia since the country gained independence in **1993**.

During the visit, India and Slovakia elevated their bilateral relations to a **Comprehensive Partnership**, strengthening cooperation across strategic, economic, technological, cultural, trade and investment sectors.

Both countries agreed to expand collaboration in emerging technologies, innovation, security, education, research and people-to-people exchanges.

India and Slovakia signed **11 Agreements and Memorandums of Understanding (MoUs)** covering labour migration, defence cooperation, digital technologies, higher education, scientific research, healthcare, tourism and cultural exchanges.

A major achievement was the establishment of the **first-ever Indian Council for Cultural Relations (ICCR) Chair in Artificial Intelligence (AI)** at the **Technical University of Kosice**, highlighting the growing cooperation in advanced technologies and academic research.

369. The Competition Commission of India (CCI) approved the acquisition of PGIM India Asset Management Pvt. Ltd. and PGIM India

Trustees Pvt. Ltd. by which of the following entities?

A.HDFC Asset Management Company Ltd. and HDFC Trustee Company Ltd

B.Aditya Birla Capital Ltd. and Aditya Birla Sun Life AMC Ltd.

C.TVS Emerald Ltd. and TVS Venu Management and Consultancy Services Pvt. Ltd.

D.Tata Capital Ltd. and Tata Asset Management Pvt. Ltd.

E.ICICI Prudential Asset Management Company Ltd. and ICICI Trusteeship Services Ltd

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The **Competition Commission of India (CCI)** has approved the proposed combination involving the acquisition of **PGIM India Asset Management Private. Limited.** and **PGIM India Trustees Pvt. Ltd.** by **TVS Emerald Ltd.** and **TVS Venu Management and Consultancy Services Pvt. Ltd.**

The proposed transaction involves the acquisition of **100% of the issued, subscribed, and paid-up share capital** of the two target entities.

Acquirers: TVS Emerald Limited and TVS Venu Management and Consultancy Services Private Limited.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Competition Commission of India (CCI)** has approved the proposed combination involving the acquisition of **PGIM India Asset Management Private. Limited.** and **PGIM India Trustees Pvt. Ltd.** by **TVS Emerald Ltd.** and **TVS Venu Management and Consultancy Services Pvt. Ltd.**

The proposed transaction involves the acquisition of **100% of the issued, subscribed, and paid-up share capital** of the two target entities.

Acquirers: TVS Emerald Limited and TVS Venu Management and Consultancy Services Private Limited.

Target Entities: PGIM India Asset Management Private Limited and PGIM India Trustees Private Limited.

TVS Emerald Limited (including its subsidiaries) is engaged in the **real estate development business** in India.

TVS Emerald Limited currently **does not have business operations outside India**.

TVS Venu Management and Consultancy Services Pvt. Ltd. currently **does not undertake any business activities**.

370. During the Technology Transfer and Bharatiya Nirdeshak Document (BND) Release Function organized by CSIR, how many Bharatiya Nirdeshak Dravyas (BNDs) were released?

A.5

B.7

C.8

D.10

E.12

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

The **Council of Scientific & Industrial Research (CSIR)** organized a **Technology Transfer** and **Bharatiya Nirdeshak Document (BND) Release Function** at **CSIR Headquarters, New Delhi**.

The programme was jointly organized by **CSIR–National Physical Laboratory (CSIR-NPL)** and **CSIR–Central Road Research Institute (CSIR-CRRI)**.

The event witnessed the **transfer of 7 technologies** to industry, the **release of 10 Bharatiya Nirdeshak Dravyas (BNDs)**, and the **handing over of critical quantum sensing components to DRDO**.

A major highlight was the release of **10 Bharatiya Nirdeshak Dravyas (BNDs)** consisting of **8 Phytochemical BNDs**, **1 Precious Metal BND**, and **1 Propane Gas BND**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Council of Scientific & Industrial Research (CSIR)** organized a **Technology Transfer** and **Bharatiya Nirdeshak Document (BND) Release Function** at **CSIR Headquarters, New Delhi**.

The programme was jointly organized by **CSIR–National Physical Laboratory (CSIR-NPL)** and **CSIR–Central Road Research Institute (CSIR-CRRI)**.

The event witnessed the **transfer of 7 technologies** to industry, the **release of 10 Bharatiya Nirdeshak Dravyas (BNDs)**, and the **handing over of critical quantum sensing components to DRDO**.

A major highlight was the release of **10 Bharatiya Nirdeshak Dravyas (BNDs)** consisting of **8 Phytochemical BNDs**, **1 Precious Metal BND**, and **1 Propane Gas BND**.

Bharatiya Nirdeshak Dravyas (BNDs) provide **reference materials and measurement standards** for laboratories, industries, and regulatory agencies.

The BNDs help improve **accuracy, traceability, quality assurance, and standardization** across various sectors.

CSIR-NPL handed over **5 Vapor Cells** to the **Solid-State Physics Laboratory (SSPL), DRDO** for **quantum sensing applications**.

371. What is the name of the United States' first dedicated space weather monitoring satellite designed exclusively for continuous operational space weather observation?

A.DSCOVR-2

B.HELIOS-1

C.SOLAR-1

D.SUNWATCH-1

E.AURORA-1

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The **United States (US)** activated **SOLAR-1** (**Space Weather Observations at L1 to Advance Readiness–1**), the country's **first dedicated space weather monitoring satellite** designed exclusively for continuous operational space weather observation.

SOLAR-1 is operated by the **National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration (NOAA)** and provides **faster warnings of solar storms** that can disrupt **GPS, communication networks, satellites, power grids, and space missions**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **United States (US)** activated **SOLAR-1** (**Space Weather Observations at L1 to Advance Readiness–1**), the country's **first dedicated space weather monitoring satellite** designed exclusively for continuous operational space weather observation.

SOLAR-1 is operated by the **National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration (NOAA)** and provides **faster warnings of solar storms** that can disrupt **GPS, communication networks, satellites, power grids, and space missions**.

The satellite was originally named **Space Weather Follow-On–Lagrange 1 (SWFO-L1)** and was later renamed **SOLAR-1**.

SOLAR-1 was launched on **24 September 2025** aboard a **SpaceX Falcon 9 rocket** and became **fully operational** after completing an **eight-month testing and commissioning phase**.

The satellite is positioned at the **Sun–Earth Lagrange Point 1 (L1)**, located about **1.6 million kilometres from Earth** toward the Sun, enabling an **uninterrupted and continuous view** of solar activity.

The **L1 point** provides a **gravitationally stable location**, allowing the spacecraft to maintain its position with **minimal fuel consumption**.

372. Which military transport aircraft, being manufactured under India's first large-scale private-sector military aircraft manufacturing programme, successfully completed its first test flight from the Final Assembly Line (FAL) in Vadodara, Gujarat?

A.C-130J Super Hercules

B.Antonov An-32

C.Dornier Do-228

D.Airbus A400M

E.Airbus C295

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

Tata Advanced Systems Limited (TASL) and **Airbus SE** successfully completed the first test flight of India's first domestically manufactured **Airbus C295 military transport aircraft** from the **Final Assembly Line (FAL)** at **Vadodara, Gujarat**.

The achievement marks India's first **large-scale private-sector military aircraft manufacturing programme**, strengthening the country's **Aatmanirbhar Bharat** and defence manufacturing capabilities.

The project is being executed under a **₹21,935-crore Ministry of Defence (MoD) contract** for the supply of **56 Airbus C295 aircraft** to the **Indian Air Force (IAF)**.

Detailed Explanation:

Tata Advanced Systems Limited (TASL) and **Airbus SE** successfully completed the first test flight of India's first domestically manufactured **Airbus C295 military transport**

aircraft from the **Final Assembly Line (FAL)** at **Vadodara, Gujarat**.

The achievement marks India's first **large-scale private-sector military aircraft manufacturing programme**, strengthening the country's **Aatmanirbhar Bharat** and defence manufacturing capabilities.

The project is being executed under a **₹21,935-crore Ministry of Defence (MoD) contract** for the supply of **56 Airbus C295 aircraft** to the **Indian Air Force (IAF)**.

Under the contract, **16 aircraft** will be delivered in **fly-away condition from Spain**, while **40 aircraft** will be **assembled in India** at the Vadodara facility.

The delivery schedule **begins in 2026** and is expected to be **completed by 2031**.

The C295 India Programme aims to **replace the ageing Avro-748** transport aircraft fleet and gradually **phase out the Antonov An-32** fleet of the IAF

373. As of 2026, Oil India Limited (OIL) signed a collaboration framework agreement with which organization to advance clean energy technologies such as CCUS, geothermal energy, and subsurface energy technologies?

A.International Energy Agency (IEA)

B.Natural Resources Canada (NRCan)

C.Petroleum Technology Research Centre (PRTC)

D.Canadian Energy Research Institute (CERI)

E.World Energy Council (WEC)

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

Oil India Limited (OIL), a **"Maharatna" Central Public Sector Enterprise (CPSE)** under the **Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas (MoPNG)**, signed a **collaboration framework agreement** with the **Petroleum Technology Research Centre (PRTC), Canada** to advance **clean energy technologies**.

The agreement was formalized during the **Global Energy Show 2026** held in **Calgary, Canada**, with the objective of strengthening **India–Canada energy cooperation**.

The partnership will focus on key areas such as **Carbon Capture, Utilisation and Storage (CCUS)**, **Geothermal Energy**, and **Subsurface Energy Technologies**.

Detailed Explanation:

Oil India Limited (OIL), a **"Maharatna" Central Public Sector Enterprise (CPSE)** under the **Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas (MoPNG)**, signed a **collaboration framework agreement** with the **Petroleum Technology Research Centre (PRTC), Canada** to advance **clean energy technologies**.

The agreement was formalized during the **Global Energy Show 2026** held in **Calgary, Canada**, with the objective of strengthening **India–Canada energy cooperation**.

The partnership will focus on key areas such as **Carbon Capture, Utilisation and Storage**

(CCUS), **Geothermal Energy**, and **Subsurface Energy Technologies**.

The collaboration also includes **mc2+**, an **Indian startup platform** supported by **MoPNG**, to promote innovation and accelerate the adoption of emerging clean-energy technologies.

Under the agreement, both organizations will work on the **utilisation and permanent storage of captured Carbon Dioxide (CO_2)** through **Geological Sequestration and Mineralization techniques**.

The framework also provides for the development of **Enhanced Oil Recovery (EOR)** methods to improve hydrocarbon extraction while supporting **sustainability goals**.

Oil India Limited (OIL) and PRTC will explore **new business opportunities** in India and Canada through industry partnerships, research collaborations, and technology networks.

374. What is the name of the world's most detailed 3D atlas of the human brainstem released by IIT Madras?

A.ANCHOR

B.NEUROSCAN

C.BRAINMAP

D.SYNAPSE

E.CORTEX-3D

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

The **Indian Institute of Technology Madras (IIT Madras)** released **ANCHOR** (**Atlas of Neurochemical Characterization of the Human Brainstem with 3D Reconstruction**), recognized as the **world's most detailed 3D atlas of the human brainstem**.

ANCHOR has been developed by the **Sudha Gopalakrishnan Brain Centre (SGBC)** at IIT Madras and represents the most comprehensive **multi-modal 3D mapping and atlas** of the human brainstem created so far.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Indian Institute of Technology Madras (IIT Madras)** released **ANCHOR** (**Atlas of Neurochemical Characterization of the Human Brainstem with 3D Reconstruction**), recognized as the **world's most detailed 3D atlas of the human brainstem**.

ANCHOR has been developed by the **Sudha Gopalakrishnan Brain Centre (SGBC)** at IIT Madras and represents the most comprehensive **multi-modal 3D mapping and atlas** of the human brainstem created so far.

The atlas covers brain development across multiple stages, ranging from the **prenatal period to childhood and adult brains**, providing an extensive understanding of brainstem structure and organization.

ANCHOR maps **more than 200 brainstem nuclei and fiber tracts**, reconstructed from hundreds of serial brain sections, offering unprecedented anatomical and neurochemical detail.

The atlas utilizes a **multimodal framework** integrating **Magnetic Resonance Imaging (MRI), histology, and detailed**

chemo-architecture for highly accurate brain mapping.

It has been reconstructed using **eight complementary immunostains** overlaid across **more than 500 brain sections**, enabling exceptionally detailed visualization and analysis.

375. Who became the World No. 1 in the Under-13 category of the International Tennis Federation (ITF) Junior World Rankings?

A.Maaya Rajeshwaran

B.Vaidehi Chaudhari

C.Shrivalli Bhamidipaty

D.Srishti Kiran

E.Sahaja Yamalapalli

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

Srishti Kiran from **Bengaluru, Karnataka** became the **World No. 1 in the Under-13 category** of the **International Tennis Federation (ITF) Junior World Rankings**.

She achieved the feat after winning **five consecutive ITF junior titles** and finishing as the runner-up at the **ITF World Tennis Tour Juniors J100 Guatemala**.

Detailed Explanation:

Srishti Kiran from **Bengaluru, Karnataka** became the **World No. 1 in the Under-13 category** of the **International Tennis Federation (ITF) Junior World Rankings**.

She achieved the feat after winning **five consecutive ITF junior titles** and finishing as the runner-up at the **ITF World Tennis Tour Juniors J100 Guatemala**.

The 13-year-old reached a career-high **ITF junior ranking of No. 357**, which is the highest ranking achieved among Under-13 players globally.

She attained this milestone by competing in only **eight ranking tournaments**, two fewer than the maximum **10 tournaments** considered for the ITF junior rankings.

Her achievement highlights her exceptional consistency and rapid rise in international junior tennis.

376. Who became the only Indian to be included in the TIME100 Most Influential People in Sports 2026 list?

A.Smriti Mandhana

B.Mithali Raj

C.Harmanpreet Kaur

D.Shafali Verma

E.Jemimah Rodrigues

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

Indian women's cricket vice-captain **Smriti Mandhana** has been included in the **TIME100 Most Influential People in Sports 2026** list, becoming the only Indian to feature in this prestigious global ranking.

The annual **TIME100 Sports List** recognises athletes, coaches, executives, investors and advocates who are shaping the future of global sports.

In the 2026 edition, Mandhana featured alongside global sporting icons such as **Lionel**

Messi, Cristiano Ronaldo, LeBron James, Carlos Alcaraz and Temba Bavuma.

Detailed Explanation:

Indian women's cricket vice-captain **Smriti Mandhana** has been included in the **TIME100 Most Influential People in Sports 2026** list, becoming the only Indian to feature in this prestigious global ranking.

The annual **TIME100 Sports List** recognises athletes, coaches, executives, investors and advocates who are shaping the future of global sports.

In the 2026 edition, Mandhana featured alongside global sporting icons such as **Lionel Messi, Cristiano Ronaldo, LeBron James, Carlos Alcaraz and Temba Bavuma**.

Her inclusion reflects the rising global recognition and popularity of women's cricket.

Smriti Mandhana became the first Indian woman cricketer to score a double century in a domestic one-day match.

She is also the first Indian woman to score centuries in all three international formats — **Test, ODI and T20I** cricket.

Mandhana jointly holds the record for the most centuries in women's international cricket with **17 international hundreds**.

She became the first woman cricketer to score more than **1,000 ODI runs in a single calendar year**.

377. As per the news, Autistic Pride Day 2026 is observed globally on which date?

A.2 April

B.18 June

C.15 June

D.21 June

E.1 July

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Autistic Pride Day 2026 is observed globally on **18 June** to raise awareness about autism and promote acceptance, inclusion and understanding of autistic individuals.

The day emphasizes that **autism is a condition and a form of neurodiversity, not a disease**, encouraging society to view autism as a difference rather than a disorder.

Detailed Explanation:

Autistic Pride Day 2026 is observed globally on **18 June** to raise awareness about autism and promote acceptance, inclusion and understanding of autistic individuals.

The day emphasizes that **autism is a condition and a form of neurodiversity, not a disease**, encouraging society to view autism as a difference rather than a disorder.

The concept of **"Autistic Pride"** promotes respect for autistic identity and highlights the strengths, abilities and unique perspectives of autistic people.

Autistic Pride Day was established in **2005** by **Aspies For Freedom (AFF)**, an autism advocacy and solidarity organization.

378. Recently, Padma Shri Awardee and Former Asian Games Gold Medallist Jaspal Rana Passed Away. In which year was

Padma Shri Jaspal Rana conferred the Padma Shri Award by the Government of India for his contribution to sports and shooting?

A.1998

B.2000

C.2005

D.2008

E.2002

Answer: E

Padma Shri Jaspal Rana, renowned **Indian shooting coach**, former **Asian Games gold medallist**, and one of India's most successful **pistol shooters**, passed away at the age of 49 in New Delhi.

Jaspal Rana was born in **1976** in **Uttarakhand** and built a remarkable legacy in Indian shooting spanning more than **three decades**.

He was a **dominant force** in international pistol shooting during the **1990s and 2000s**, becoming one of the **most decorated shooters** in the country.

The Government of India conferred the **Padma Shri** on Jaspal Rana in **2002** in recognition of his outstanding contribution to sports and shooting.

379. Recently, David Hockney, who passed away in June 2026, was a pioneering figure of which influential art movement that emerged during the 1960s?

A.Cubism

B.Surrealism

C.Impressionism

D.Pop Art Movement

E.Abstract Expressionism

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

David Hockney, one of the most celebrated **British contemporary artists**, passed away on **11 June 2026** at his home in London at the **age of 88**.

He was born on **9 July 1937** in **Bradford, West Yorkshire, England**.

He was among the **pioneers of the 1960s Pop Art Movement**, which emerged as an influential art movement in post-war Britain and the United States.

Detailed Explanation:

David Hockney, one of the most celebrated **British contemporary artists**, passed away on **11 June 2026** at his home in London at the **age of 88**.

He was born on **9 July 1937** in **Bradford, West Yorkshire, England**.

David Hockney was regarded as a **leading figure in Contemporary Art** and played a major role in shaping **modern artistic expression** across the 20th and 21st centuries.

He was among the **pioneers of the 1960s Pop Art Movement**, which emerged as an influential art movement in post-war Britain and the United States.

His artistic career spanned **more than seven decades**, making him one of the **longest-serving and most influential artists** of modern times.

380. What is the capital of Slovakia?

A.Prague

B.Budapest

C.Warsaw

D.Vienna

E.Bratislava

Answer: E

About Slovakia:

Capital: **Bratislava**

Currency: **Euro**

President: **Peter Pellegrini**

Prime Minister: **Robert Fico**

381. Under which section of the Payment and Settlement Systems (PSS) Act, 2007, is it mandated that no entity other than the Reserve Bank of India can operate a payment system without prior authorisation?

A.Section 2

B.Section 4

C.Section 7

D.Section 10

E.Section 18

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** has issued **Master Directions on Authorisation to Operate a Payment System** to create a comprehensive regulatory framework under the **Payment and Settlement Systems (PSS) Act, 2007**.

As per **Section 4 of the PSS Act, 2007**, no entity other than the RBI can operate a payment system without **prior authorisation**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** has issued **Master Directions on Authorisation to Operate a Payment System** to create a comprehensive regulatory framework under the **Payment and Settlement Systems (PSS) Act, 2007**.

The framework governs entities seeking to operate as **Payment System Operators (PSOs)** in India.

A **Payment System Operator (PSO)** is an entity **authorised by the RBI** to operate a system enabling **clearing, payment, or settlement of funds** between participants.

The objective of the directions is to provide a **unified regulatory framework** covering **eligibility criteria, authorisation process, perpetual licence validity, voluntary surrender**, and **cooling-off requirements**.

As per **Section 4 of the PSS Act, 2007**, no entity other than the RBI can operate a payment system without **prior authorisation**

382. As per the news, YES Bank Limited recently partnered with which Non-Banking Finance Company (NBFC) to expand formal credit access, digital lending, and investment opportunities in India?

A.Muthoot Finance Limited

B.Bajaj Finance Limited

C.Northern Arc Capital Limited
D.Shriram Finance Limited
E.L&T Finance Limited
Answer: C
Short Explanation:
YES Bank Limited (Indian private sector bank) and **Northern Arc Capital Limited** (a Non-Banking Finance Company (NBFC)) have formed a **strategic partnership** to expand **formal credit access, digital lending**, and **investment opportunities** in India.
The collaboration supports the vision of **Viksit Bharat 2047** by strengthening **financial inclusion** and improving **technology-driven credit delivery**.
Detailed Explanation:
YES Bank Limited (Indian private sector bank) and **Northern Arc Capital Limited** (a Non-Banking Finance Company (NBFC)) have formed a **strategic partnership** to expand **formal credit access, digital lending**, and **investment opportunities** in India.
The collaboration supports the vision of **Viksit Bharat 2047** by strengthening **financial inclusion** and improving **technology-driven credit delivery**.
The partnership aims to enhance access to **formal credit** for **underserved segments**, including **retail borrowers, Micro, Small & Medium Enterprises (MSMEs)**, and **emerging borrowers**.
It focuses on building **scalable, tech-enabled lending systems** through **integrated digital platforms** for faster loan origination and distribution.
A key feature of the partnership is the integration of Northern Arc Capital's **digital lending platforms**, including **nPOS, NIMBUS, and NuScore**, with YES Bank's **digital lending architecture**.

383. In news, the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) launched "RBI Reelathon 2026", a cyber fraud awareness campaign across approximately 150 colleges in which state?
A.Tamil Nadu
B.Karnataka
C.Telangana
D.Andhra Pradesh
E.Kerala
Answer: E
Short Explanation:
The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** launched **"RBI Reelathon 2026"**, a statewide **cyber fraud awareness campaign** across approximately **150 colleges in Kerala**.
The initiative aims to promote **financial literacy, cyber hygiene, safe digital banking, smart borrowing**, and awareness of emerging online financial threats through student engagement and **reel-making competitions**.
The campaign was inaugurated at the **RBI Office, Thiruvananthapuram, Kerala**, by Kerala **DGP Ravada Chandrasekhar**.
Detailed Explanation:

The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** launched **"RBI Reelathon 2026"**, a statewide **cyber fraud awareness campaign** across approximately **150 colleges in Kerala**.

The initiative aims to promote **financial literacy, cyber hygiene, safe digital banking, smart borrowing**, and awareness of emerging online financial threats through student engagement and **reel-making competitions**.

The campaign was inaugurated at the **RBI Office, Thiruvananthapuram, Kerala**, by Kerala **DGP Ravada Chandrasekhar**.

The RBI Reelathon 2026 is designed to target **students vulnerable to cyber frauds** and spread awareness through **creative digital content**.

The programme is implemented in **three phases**, including **financial literacy awareness sessions**, **reel-making competitions** on cyber fraud themes, and a **grand finale in 2026** after multiple evaluation rounds.

The initiative encourages students to create content highlighting **cyber safety, digital awareness**, and **fraud prevention measures**.

Rewards: The top three winners will receive cash prizes of **₹75,000, ₹50,000, and ₹25,000** respectively.

384. What is the maturity period of the recently launched Bank of Baroda (BOB) "bob Golden Goal Deposit Scheme" with interest rates of up to 7.40% per annum (p.a.)?

A.365 days

B.444 days

C.500 days

D.555 days

E.777 days

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

Bank of Baroda (BOB) has launched the **bob Golden Goal Deposit Scheme**, a **555-day retail term deposit scheme** for deposits **below ₹3 crore**.

The scheme offers attractive and stable returns, with interest rates of **up to 7.40% per annum (p.a.)**.

The scheme is accessible through **bank branches, net banking**, and the **bob World mobile app**.

It is available to a wide range of customers including **individuals, joint account holders, clubs, associations, educational institutions, partnerships**, and other eligible entities.

The scheme has a **fixed maturity period of 555 days**.

Detailed Explanation:

Bank of Baroda (BOB) has launched the **bob Golden Goal Deposit Scheme**, a **555-day retail term deposit scheme** for deposits **below ₹3 crore**.

The scheme offers attractive and stable returns, with interest rates of **up to 7.40% per annum (p.a.)**.

The scheme is accessible through **bank branches, net banking**, and the **bob World mobile app**.

It is available to a wide range of customers including **individuals, joint account holders, clubs, associations, educational institutions, partnerships**, and other eligible entities.

The scheme has a **fixed maturity period of 555 days**.

It offers two categories of deposits: **callable deposits** and **non-callable deposits**.

Non-callable deposits provide an **additional 5 basis points (bps)** over callable deposits in exchange for **restrictions on premature withdrawal**.

Under **callable deposits**, interest rates are **6.75% p.a. (general/NRO/NRE)**, **7.25% p.a. (resident senior citizens)**, and **7.35% p.a. (resident super senior citizens)**.

Under **non-callable deposits**, interest rates are **6.80% p.a. (general/NRO/NRE)**, **7.30% p.a. (resident senior citizens)**, and **7.40% p.a. (resident super senior citizens)**.

385. Which authority, chaired by Chief Minister Mohan Charan Majhi, approved investment proposals worth ₹76,611.86 crore across 20 projects in Odisha?

A.State Investment Promotion Board (SIPB)

B.Odisha Industrial Infrastructure Development Corporation (IDCO)

C.High-Level Clearance Authority (HLCA)

D.Odisha Mining Corporation (OMC)

E.Industrial Promotion and Investment Corporation of Odisha (IPICOL)

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The **High-Level Clearance Authority (HLCA)** of Odisha, chaired by Chief Minister **Mohan Charan Majhi**, approved investment proposals worth **₹76,611.86 crore** across **20 projects**.

The projects are expected to generate more than **50,500 employment opportunities** across **nine districts** of the state.

The approved investments cover sectors such as **lab-grown diamonds, renewable energy, critical minerals, steel manufacturing, healthcare, railways and infrastructure**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **High-Level Clearance Authority (HLCA)** of Odisha, chaired by Chief Minister **Mohan Charan Majhi**, approved investment proposals worth **₹76,611.86 crore** across **20 projects**.

The projects are expected to generate more than **50,500 employment opportunities** across **nine districts** of the state.

The approved investments cover sectors such as **lab-grown diamonds, renewable energy, critical minerals, steel manufacturing, healthcare, railways and infrastructure**.

Odisha has approved three major **lab-grown diamond manufacturing projects** in **Khordha district**, marking its entry into the emerging diamond manufacturing industry.

Kira Diam LLP will invest **₹7,000 crore** and create around **5,100 jobs**.

Anjali Labtech Limited will invest **₹1,617.50 crore** and generate approximately **2,000 jobs**.

Grow Magnificent Private Limited will invest **₹1,200 crore** and create around **1,000 jobs**.

In the critical minerals and advanced materials sector, **N A N Magnetech Private Limited** will invest **₹1,250 crore** to manufacture Electric Vehicle (EV)-grade **Neodymium-Iron-Boron (NdFeB) magnets**.

386. What is the total outlay of the startup funding programme under the National Green Hydrogen Mission (NGHM), under which ₹22 crore was approved for nine startups in the first batch?

A.₹50 crore

B.₹75 crore

C.₹150 crore

D.₹100 crore

E.₹200 crore

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

The **Central Government approved ₹22 crore in financial assistance** for **nine startups** under the **National Green Hydrogen Mission (NGHM)**.

This is the first batch of support under the mission's dedicated **₹100 crore startup funding programme**, aimed at promoting innovation and commercialization in the green hydrogen sector.

The announcement was made by Union Minister for New and Renewable Energy **Pralhad Joshi** during a National Green Hydrogen Mission workshop organized by the **Ministry of New and Renewable Energy (MNRE)**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Central Government approved ₹22 crore in financial assistance** for **nine startups** under the **National Green Hydrogen Mission (NGHM)**.

This is the first batch of support under the mission's dedicated **₹100 crore startup funding programme**, aimed at promoting innovation and commercialization in the green hydrogen sector.

The announcement was made by Union Minister for New and Renewable Energy **Pralhad Joshi** during a National Green Hydrogen Mission workshop organized by the **Ministry of New and Renewable Energy (MNRE)**.

The funding programme seeks to support startups working in green hydrogen production, storage, transportation and related technologies.

The government expects startups to play a key role in developing cost-effective solutions and strengthening India's position as a global hub for green hydrogen production and exports.

During the workshop, the government also launched the **Green Hydrogen Certification Portal of India (GHCI)**.

The portal has been developed to facilitate certification and regulatory compliance under the **Green Hydrogen Certification Scheme of India**.

387. Recently, the Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement (CETA) between India

and the United Kingdom was concluded after how many rounds of negotiations?

A.14 rounds

B.12 rounds

C.15 rounds

D.16 rounds

E.18 rounds

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

The **Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement (CETA)** and the **Double Contribution Convention (DCC)** between **India and the United Kingdom** are set to come into force on **15 June 2026**.

The foundation for the agreement was laid through the **Enhanced Trade Partnership (2021)** and the **India–United Kingdom Roadmap 2030**.

After **14 rounds of negotiations**, the CETA was concluded on **6 May 2025**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement (CETA)** and the **Double Contribution Convention (DCC)** between **India and the United Kingdom** are set to come into force on **15 June 2026**.

The agreements are expected to boost bilateral trade, strengthen investment flows, improve market access and provide significant benefits to Indian professionals working temporarily in the United Kingdom.

The foundation for the agreement was laid through the **Enhanced Trade Partnership (2021)** and the **India–United Kingdom Roadmap 2030**.

After **14 rounds of negotiations**, the CETA was concluded on **6 May 2025**.

The agreement was signed in **London** on **24 July 2025** by Union Minister of Commerce and Industry **Piyush Goyal** and United Kingdom Secretary of State for Business and Trade **Jonathan Reynolds**, in the presence of Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** and United Kingdom Prime Minister **Keir Starmer**.

The **Double Contribution Convention (DCC)** was signed on **10 February 2026** to complement the broader economic partnership framework.

388. Who has been appointed as the new Chairperson of the National Statistical Commission (NSC) by the Appointments Committee of the Cabinet (ACC)?

A.Dr. Bibek Debroy

B.Dr. Arvind Panagariya

C.Dr. Saibal Chattopadhyay

D.Dr. Rajiv Kumar

E.Dr. Suman K. Bery

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The **National Statistical Commission (NSC)** was established in **2005** as a **nodal body** for coordinating all **core statistical activities in India**.

The **Appointments Committee of the Cabinet (ACC)** has approved new appointments to the **NSC Chairperson and Members**.

The newly appointed NSC Chairperson is **Dr. Saibal Chattopadhyay**, former **Director of IIM Kolkata**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **National Statistical Commission (NSC)** was established in **2005** as a **nodal body** for coordinating all **core statistical activities in India**.

The NSC is responsible for **evolving, monitoring, and enforcing statistical priorities, standards, and coordination** across the national statistical system.

The Commission ensures **statistical coordination** between **Central Government Ministries, Departments, and State/UT administrations**.

The NSC consists of a **part-time Chairperson**, **four part-time Members** with expertise in statistics, and the **CEO of NITI Aayog (ex-officio Member)**.

The **Secretary, Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI)** serves as the **Secretary of the NSC**.

The **Appointments Committee of the Cabinet (ACC)** has approved new appointments to the **NSC Chairperson and Members**.

The newly appointed NSC Chairperson is **Dr. Saibal Chattopadhyay**, former **Director of IIM Kolkata**.

389. What was the private sector's defence production output in India during FY 2025–26, reaching an all-time high amid increasing participation in the defence ecosystem?

A.₹32,000 crore

B.₹36,000 crore

C.₹40,000 crore

D.₹42,000 crore

E.₹45,000 crore

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

India's annual defence production has reached an all-time high of **₹1.78 lakh crore in FY 2025–26**, marking a major milestone in the country's defence manufacturing sector.

Defence Public Sector Undertakings (DPSUs) and other PSUs contributed around **76%** of total defence production.

The **private sector** contributed **24%**, up from **22% in FY 2024–25**, indicating increasing private participation in the defence ecosystem.

The private sector's output reached an all-time high of around **₹42,000 crore in FY 2025–26**.

Detailed Explanation:

India's annual defence production has reached an all-time high of **₹1.78 lakh crore in FY 2025–26**, marking a major milestone in the country's defence manufacturing sector.

The production figure shows a **15.6% increase** over FY 2024–25 output of **₹1.54 lakh crore**.

Compared to FY 2020–21, when production stood at **₹84,643 crore**, the growth is a remarkable **110% increase**.

Indigenous defence production has grown nearly four times, rising from **₹43,746 crore in FY 2013–14**.

The achievement reflects India's strengthening push for **self-reliance (Aatmanirbhar Bharat)** in defence manufacturing under the leadership of Prime Minister Narendra Modi.
Defence Public Sector Undertakings (DPSUs) and other PSUs contributed around **76%** of total defence production.
The **private sector** contributed **24%**, up from **22% in FY 2024–25**, indicating increasing private participation in the defence ecosystem.
The private sector's output reached an all-time high of around **₹42,000 crore in FY 2025–26**.

390. Which edition of the Thailand–India Defence Dialogue was held in Bangkok on 16 June 2026 to review the full spectrum of bilateral defence cooperation?

A.7th
B.8th
C.9th
D.11th
E.10th

Answer: E

Short Explanation:
The **10th Thailand–India Defence Dialogue** was held in **Bangkok on 16 June 2026** to review the full spectrum of **bilateral defence cooperation**.
The dialogue focused on exchanging views on **regional and global security issues** of mutual interest.

Detailed Explanation:
The **10th Thailand–India Defence Dialogue** was held in **Bangkok on 16 June 2026** to review the full spectrum of **bilateral defence cooperation**.
The dialogue focused on exchanging views on **regional and global security issues** of mutual interest.
The meeting was co-chaired by Thailand's **Deputy Permanent Secretary for Defence Admiral Nuttapol Diewvanich** and **Joint Secretary, Ministry of Defence, Government of India Shri Satyajit Mohanty**.
Both sides discussed the evolving security situation in the **Indo-Pacific region**.
They exchanged perspectives on regional developments and reaffirmed commitment to **peace, stability, and prosperity** in the region.
The delegations reviewed progress in bilateral defence cooperation since the **previous dialogue**.

391. How many JK 250e drones were delivered in the first batch by Drogo Aerospace Private Limited to the Indian Army's Southern Command under the ₹72-crore contract?

A.31
B.41
C.51
D.71
E.81

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Drogo Aerospace Private Limited (formerly Drogo Drones Private Limited) delivered the first batch of **41 JK 250e drones** to the **Indian Army (IA) Southern Command** in **Nashik, Maharashtra**.

The delivery was made under a **₹72-crore contract** for the supply of **217 JK 250e drones** to the Indian Army.

The remaining **176 drones** are scheduled to be delivered by **August 2026**.

The **JK 250e** is an **indigenous electric unmanned aerial system (UAS)** developed specifically for the Indian Army's **Intelligence, Surveillance and Reconnaissance (ISR) operations**.

Detailed Explanation:

Drogo Aerospace Private Limited (formerly Drogo Drones Private Limited) delivered the first batch of **41 JK 250e drones** to the **Indian Army (IA) Southern Command** in **Nashik, Maharashtra**.

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The remaining **176 drones** are scheduled to be delivered by **August 2026**.

The **JK 250e** is an **indigenous electric unmanned aerial system (UAS)** developed specifically for the Indian Army's **Intelligence, Surveillance and Reconnaissance (ISR) operations**.

The drone has been designed to meet the **frontline operational requirements** of the Indian Army.

The JK 250e drone provides up to **three hours of flight endurance** on a single battery charge.

It is capable of performing **surveillance, reconnaissance, tactical overwatch, border security**, and other critical military missions.

The drone enhances the Army's capability for **real-time monitoring and situational awareness** in operational areas.

392. As of 2026, the Sea King Mk42B helicopters, recently decommissioned by the Indian Navy after 36 years of service, were operated by which Indian Naval Air Squadron (INAS)?

A.INAS 300 – White Tigers

B.INAS 310 – Cobras

C.INAS 315 – Wingers

D.INAS 330 – Harpoons

E.INAS 339 – Falcons

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

Indian Navy (IN) decommissioned its **Sea King Mk42B helicopters**, popularly known as the **"Flying Frigates"**, after **36 years** of distinguished operational service.

The fleet was operated by **Indian Naval Air Squadron (INAS) 330**, also known as the **"Harpoons"**.

The decommissioning ceremony concluded with a final ceremonial flight from **INS Shikra**, the Western Naval Command (WNC) air station located in **Colaba, Mumbai, Maharashtra**.

Detailed Explanation:

Indian Navy (IN) decommissioned its **Sea King Mk42B helicopters**, popularly known as the **"Flying Frigates"**, after **36 years** of distinguished operational service.

The fleet was operated by **Indian Naval Air Squadron (INAS) 330**, also known as the **"Harpoons"**.

The decommissioning ceremony concluded with a final ceremonial flight from **INS Shikra**, the Western Naval Command (WNC) air station located in **Colaba, Mumbai, Maharashtra**.

The Sea King Mk42B (Bravo) fleet was procured between **1989 and 1990** and inducted to strengthen the Navy's **anti-submarine warfare (ASW)** capabilities.

The Sea King helicopters were equipped with **advanced torpedoes, depth charges, and missiles**, making them a key maritime combat platform.

Their primary roles included **anti-submarine warfare (ASW), anti-ship operations**, and **Search and Rescue (SAR)** missions.

India signed a **USD 2.12 billion contract in 2020** to procure **24 MH-60R Seahawk helicopters**.

393. Under the National Green Hydrogen Mission, incentives have been provided to 15 companies to develop what annual electrolyser manufacturing capacity in India?

A.1,000 MW per annum

B.2,000 MW per annum

C.3,000 MW per annum

D.4,000 MW per annum

E.5,000 MW per annum

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The **Union Minister for New and Renewable Energy, Shri Pralhad Joshi**, launched the **Green Hydrogen Certification Portal of India (GHCI)** during a national workshop on "Strengthening the National Green Hydrogen Mission: Through State Policies, Hubs & Infrastructure."

7 States have integrated hydrogen policies into their existing **industrial and renewable energy frameworks**, while **4 States** are in the process of finalisation.

Under domestic manufacturing promotion, incentives have been provided to **15 companies** to develop **3,000 MW per annum electrolyser manufacturing capacity**.

This aims to reduce dependence on imported supply chains and strengthen **indigenous green hydrogen production infrastructure**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Union Minister for New and Renewable Energy, Shri Pralhad Joshi**, launched the **Green Hydrogen Certification Portal of India (GHCI)** during a national workshop on "Strengthening the National Green Hydrogen Mission: Through State Policies, Hubs & Infrastructure."

The portal has been developed by the **Ministry of New and Renewable Energy (MNRE)** to ensure **transparent certification and regulatory compliance** under the Green Hydrogen Certification Scheme of India.

The initiative supports India's broader push for **clean energy transition** and development of a **green hydrogen ecosystem**.

The Minister urged States to actively participate in the **National Green Hydrogen Mission (NGHM)**, highlighting that **6 States** have already notified dedicated **Green Hydrogen Policies**.

7 States have integrated hydrogen policies into their existing **industrial and renewable energy frameworks**, while **4 States** are in the process of finalisation.

Under domestic manufacturing promotion, incentives have been provided to **15 companies** to develop **3,000 MW per annum electrolyser manufacturing capacity**.

This aims to reduce dependence on imported supply chains and strengthen **indigenous green hydrogen production infrastructure**.

In the refinery sector, contracts have been awarded for the supply of **30,000 MTPA green hydrogen** to **IOCL, BPCL, HPCL, and NRL**.

₹84 crore has been sanctioned for **pilot projects** for testing **100% hydrogen injection in the steel sector**.

For clean mobility, around **₹208 crore** has been allocated for **37 hydrogen-fuelled vehicles** and **9 hydrogen refuelling stations**.

An additional **₹193.35 crore investment** has been made for **7 national testing facilities** related to hydrogen technologies.

394. In 2026, the Competition Commission of India (CCI) has approved the subscription of equity shareholding in which company by Kedaara Pearl Holding and Kedaara Capital Fund IV AIF?

A.Bajaj Finance Limited

B.Tata Capital Limited

C.Poonawalla Fincorp Limited

D.L&T Finance Limited

E.Axis Finance Limited

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

The **Competition Commission of India (CCI)** has approved the subscription of **equity shareholding in Axis Finance Limited** by **Kedaara Pearl Holding** and **Kedaara Capital Fund IV AIF**.

The proposed transaction involves the **acquisition of equity stake** in the target company by the **Kedaara Group investment vehicles**.

The acquirers in the deal are **Kedaara Pearl Holding** and **Kedaara Capital Fund IV AIF**, collectively referred to as the **Kedaara Group entities**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Competition Commission of India (CCI)** has approved the subscription of **equity shareholding in Axis Finance Limited** by **Kedaara Pearl Holding** and **Kedaara Capital Fund IV AIF**.

The proposed transaction involves the **acquisition of equity stake** in the target company by the **Kedaara Group investment vehicles**.

The acquirers in the deal are **Kedaara Pearl Holding** and **Kedaara Capital Fund IV AIF**,

collectively referred to as the **Kedaara Group entities**.

The target company, **Axis Finance Limited**, is a **financial services provider** operating across India.

Axis Finance Limited is engaged in **wholesale lending, MSME financing**, and **retail lending** to individuals and businesses.

The company is also involved in the **distribution of insurance products**.

395. During the ICC Women's T20 World Cup 2026, Deepti Sharma became the joint-highest wicket-taker in women's international cricket by equalling whose record of 355 international wickets?

A.Jhulan Goswami

B.Harmanpreet Kaur

C.Mithali Raj

D.Shabnim Ismail

E.Ellyse Perry

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

Indian all-rounder **Deepti Sharma** created history by becoming the **joint-highest wicket-taker in women's international cricket**.

With this wicket, she equalled the record of former Indian captain **Jhulan Goswami**, who also has **355 international wickets**.

Detailed Explanation:

Indian all-rounder **Deepti Sharma** created history by becoming the **joint-highest wicket-taker in women's international cricket**.

She achieved the milestone during India's **ICC Women's T20 World Cup 2026** Group A match against the **Netherlands** at **Headingley, Leeds**.

Deepti claimed her **355th international wicket** by dismissing Dutch opener **Phebe Molkenboer**.

With this wicket, she equalled the record of former Indian captain **Jhulan Goswami**, who also has **355 international wickets**.

Deepti Sharma now shares the top position among the leading wicket-takers in women's international cricket.

396. Recently, Lieutenant General Vijay Oberoi, who recently passed away, served as the Vice Chief of Army Staff (VCOAS) of the Indian Army during which period?

A.1996–1997

B.1998–1999

C.1999–2000

D.2000–2001

E.2001–2002

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

Lieutenant General (Lt Gen) Vijay Oberoi, former **Vice Chief of Army Staff (VCOAS)** of the **Indian Army (IA)**, passed away at the age of **84**.

Lt Gen Vijay Oberoi was born on **29 September 1941** in **Chakwal (now in Pakistan)**.

Later, he held the prestigious post of **GOC-in-C Western Command**, one of the Indian Army's most important operational commands.

Lt Gen Vijay Oberoi served as **Vice Chief of Army Staff (VCOAS)** from **2000 to 2001**.
He retired from the Indian Army on **30 September 2001**.
Detailed Explanation:
Lieutenant General (Lt Gen) Vijay Oberoi, former **Vice Chief of Army Staff (VCOAS)** of the **Indian Army (IA)**, passed away at the age of **84**.
Lt Gen Vijay Oberoi was born on **29 September 1941** in **Chakwal (now in Pakistan)**.
He was widely recognized for leading **post-Kargil military reforms**, **revising Army doctrines**, and promoting the **welfare of war-disabled soldiers**.
Lt Gen Vijay Oberoi joined the Indian Army in **1961** through the **1st Battalion, Maratha Light Infantry**.
Despite **losing his right leg in action** during the **1965 war**, he rose to some of the highest positions in the Indian Army.
He served as **Director General of Military Operations (DGMO)**, a key position responsible for operational planning and military strategy.
He also served as **General Officer Commanding-in-Chief (GOC-in-C)**, **Army Training Command (ARTRAC)**.
Later, he held the prestigious post of **GOC-in-C Western Command**, one of the Indian Army's most important operational commands.
Lt Gen Vijay Oberoi served as **Vice Chief of Army Staff (VCOAS)** from **2000 to 2001**.
He retired from the Indian Army on **30 September 2001**.
For his distinguished military service, he was awarded the **Param Vishisht Seva Medal (PVSM)** in **1998**.
He was also honoured with the **Ati Vishisht Seva Medal (AVSM)**, **Sena Medal (SM)**, and **Vishisht Seva Medal (VSM)**.
Following retirement, he founded the **Centre for Land Warfare Studies (CLAWS)**, a leading defence and strategic studies think tank in India.
He also established the **War Wounded Foundation**, dedicated to supporting and rehabilitating injured military personnel.
His contributions played a major role in strengthening the Indian Army after the **Kargil War (1999)** through **structural and doctrinal reforms**.
Lt Gen Vijay Oberoi became a symbol of resilience by completing the **Mumbai Marathon** at the age of **72** using a **prosthetic leg**.

397. As per the news, World Sickle Cell Awareness Day is observed globally every year on which date?

A.8 March
B.12 May
C.19 June
D.1 July
E.28 September

Answer: C

World Sickle Cell Awareness Day 2026 is observed globally on **19 June** to raise awareness about **Sickle Cell Disease (SCD)**, a hereditary blood disorder.

The United Nations General Assembly (UNGA) officially recognized **World Sickle Cell Day** in **2008** to promote awareness of the disease and its social, economic and health impacts.

The first **World Sickle Cell Day** was observed on **19 June 2009**.

398. Every year on 19 June observed as World Sauntering Day. Who was established in 1979?

A.W. T. Rabe

B.W. T. Ramesh

C.W. T. Randal

D.W. T. Rober

E.W. T. Ryan

Answer: A

World Sauntering Day 2026 is observed globally on **19 June** to encourage people to slow down, relax and appreciate the world around them.

The day promotes mindful walking, connecting with nature and enjoying life's simple pleasures instead of rushing through daily activities.

It is also popularly known as **International Sauntering Day**.

World Sauntering Day was established in **1979** by **W. T. Rabe**.

399. On which date Bank of Baroda was founded ?

A.15 August 1907

B.20 July 1908

C.1 April 1909

D.2 October 1910

E.26 January 1908

Answer: B

About Bank of Baroda

Founded : 20 July 1908

Headquarters : Vadodara, Gujarat, India

MD & CEO : Debadatta Chand

400. What is the nickname of INAS 350, which operates the Sea King Mk42C variant from INS Dega, Visakhapatnam?

A.Harpoons

B.Cobras

C.Wingers

D.Saaras

E.Falcons

Answer: D

Despite the retirement of the Mk42B variant, the Sea King remains in service through **INAS 350**, nicknamed the **"Saaras"**.

INAS 350 operates the **Sea King Mk42C variant** from **INS Dega, Visakhapatnam, Andhra Pradesh**.

401. As per the RBI's revised capital adequacy norms for loans backed by the Emergency Credit Line Guarantee Scheme (ECLGS 5.0), what risk weight will be applicable to 75% of the guaranteed portion of such loans, provided settlement is expected within 30 days of guarantee invocation?

A.100%

B.50%

C.20%

D.0%

E.10%

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** has **relaxed capital requirements** for banks under loans backed by the **Emergency Credit Line Guarantee Scheme (ECLGS 5.0)**.

The revised norms came into effect with **immediate implementation** through an amendment to the **RBI (Commercial Banks – Prudential Norms on Capital Adequacy) Directions, 2025**.

Under the new framework, **75% of the guaranteed portion** of ECLGS loans will attract a **0% risk weight**.

The **remaining 25% exposure** will continue to attract a **20% risk weight** as per existing norms.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** has **relaxed capital requirements** for banks under loans backed by the **Emergency Credit Line Guarantee Scheme (ECLGS 5.0)**.

The revised norms came into effect with **immediate implementation** through an amendment to the **RBI (Commercial Banks – Prudential Norms on Capital Adequacy) Directions, 2025**.

Under the new framework, **75% of the guaranteed portion** of ECLGS loans will attract a **0% risk weight**.

The **remaining 25% exposure** will continue to attract a **20% risk weight** as per existing norms.

The **0% risk weight benefit** is applicable only when banks expect **settlement within 30 days** of guarantee invocation.

Banks must ensure **timely settlement within 30 days** to avail the zero-risk treatment.

The relaxation **reduces the capital requirement burden** on banks, potentially supporting **higher credit flow** under the scheme.

Risk weight determines the **amount of capital banks must hold** against loans, impacting **lending capacity**.

402. In June 2026, NSE Indices Limited expanded its index portfolio by launching 11 new sector-specific indices. Which of the following is one of the newly launched indices?

A.Nifty Hospitals

B.Nifty Metals

C.Nifty IT Services

D.Nifty Media Plus

E.Nifty Aviation

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

The **NSE Indices Limited**, a subsidiary of the **National Stock Exchange (NSE)**, has expanded its index portfolio by launching **11 new sector-specific indices**.

With this addition, the total number of **NSE indices** has increased to **34**.

The newly launched **11 sectoral indices** are: **Nifty Power**, **Nifty Capital Goods**, **Nifty Telecommunications**, **Nifty**

Construction, **Nifty Consumer Services**, **Nifty Commercial & Transport Services**, **Nifty Retail**, **Nifty Hospitals**, **Nifty NBFC**, **Nifty Housing Finance**, and **Nifty Insurance**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **NSE Indices Limited**, a subsidiary of the **National Stock Exchange (NSE)**, has expanded its index portfolio by launching **11 new sector-specific indices**.

With this addition, the total number of **NSE indices** has increased to **34**.

The expansion aims to provide **broader market representation** across traditional and emerging sectors of the **Indian economy**.

The new indices cover **key sectors** such as power, capital goods, telecommunications, construction, consumer services, retail, healthcare, and financial services.

The newly launched **11 sectoral indices** are: **Nifty Power**, **Nifty Capital Goods**, **Nifty Telecommunications**, **Nifty Construction**, **Nifty Consumer Services**, **Nifty Commercial & Transport Services**, **Nifty Retail**, **Nifty Hospitals**, **Nifty NBFC**, **Nifty Housing Finance**, and **Nifty Insurance**.

The initiative enhances **sectoral market tracking**, **investment benchmarking**, and **index-based financial products**.

403. What is the name of the national industry platform launched by India's financial sector to strengthen the Anti-Money Laundering (AML) and Combating the Financing of Terrorism (CFT) framework?

A.FINSAFE

B.ARIFAC

C.AMLNET India

D.SAFE-CFT

E.FINSEC Alliance

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

India's financial sector has launched a national industry platform called the **Alliance of Reporting Entities in AML/CFT (ARIFAC)** to strengthen the country's **Anti-Money Laundering (AML)** and **Combating the Financing of Terrorism (CFT)** framework.

The initiative aims to enhance the **AML/CFT ecosystem** in response to rising **financial crimes** and **cyber fraud risks**.

Detailed Explanation:

India's financial sector has launched a national industry platform called the **Alliance of Reporting Entities in AML/CFT (ARIFAC)** to strengthen the country's **Anti-Money Laundering (AML)** and **Combating the Financing of Terrorism (CFT)** framework.

The initiative aims to enhance the **AML/CFT ecosystem** in response to rising **financial crimes** and **cyber fraud risks**.

The **secretariat of ARIFAC** is jointly managed by the **Payments Council of India (PCI)** and the **Fintech Convergence Council (FCC)**.

The **Financial Intelligence Unit–India (FIU-IND)** will participate as an **observer** in the platform.

The platform focuses on **training, certification, workshops, and continuous learning**

programmes to strengthen AML/CFT awareness and **capacity building**. Membership includes all **reporting entities** under the **Prevention of Money Laundering Act (PMLA)**.

404. In June 2026, Prime Minister Narendra Modi laid the foundation stone of a ₹25,016 crore Coal Gasification Project at Lakhanpur in Odisha. Coal gasification converts coal into which of the following products?

A.Bioethanol

B.Synthesis gas (Syngas)

C.Biodiesel

D.Green Hydrogen

E.Compressed Biogas

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Prime Minister Narendra Modi will lay the foundation stone of a **₹25,016 crore Coal Gasification Project** at **Lakhanpur, Jharsuguda district, Odisha** on **20 June 2026**. The project is a major step towards strengthening India's **energy security**, promoting **import substitution**, and advancing **Aatmanirbhar Bharat (self-reliance)**.

Coal Gasification is a process that converts coal into **synthesis gas (syngas)**, which can be used to manufacture **methanol, urea, ammonium nitrate, synthetic natural gas (SNG),** and other chemical feedstocks.

Detailed Explanation:

Prime Minister Narendra Modi will lay the foundation stone of a **₹25,016 crore Coal Gasification Project** at **Lakhanpur, Jharsuguda district, Odisha** on **20 June 2026**. The project is a major step towards strengthening India's **energy security**, promoting **import substitution**, and advancing **Aatmanirbhar Bharat (self-reliance)**.

Coal Gasification is a process that converts coal into **synthesis gas (syngas)**, which can be used to manufacture **methanol, urea, ammonium nitrate, synthetic natural gas (SNG),** and other chemical feedstocks.

The technology helps **reduce dependence on imports** of natural gas, ammonia, methanol, and critical industrial chemicals while promoting **value addition to domestic coal resources**.

India is the world's **second-largest producer and consumer of coal** and possesses the world's **fifth-largest coal reserves**, exceeding **400 billion tonnes**.

Coal India Limited (CIL) is the **largest coal-producing company** in the world.

To promote coal gasification, the **Government of India** has approved incentive schemes with a cumulative outlay of up to **₹46,000 crore** for **Surface Coal and Lignite Gasification Projects**.

India currently **imports** end-use and intermediate chemical products worth about **₹2.7 lakh crore annually**, creating significant

opportunities for **import reduction** through coal gasification.

405. Which organization launched the Smart Warehousing System for foodgrain storage, described as the world's largest deployment of AI and IoT-based technologies in public sector warehousing?

A.Food Corporation of India (FCI)

B.Central Warehousing Corporation (CWC)

C.Department of Food and Public Distribution (DFPD)

D.Warehousing Development and Regulatory Authority (WDRA)

E.NITI Aayog

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The **Department of Food and Public Distribution (DFPD)** under the Ministry of Consumer Affairs, Food and Public Distribution launched the **Smart Warehousing System** for foodgrain storage at **Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi**.

The system was inaugurated by Union Minister **Shri Pralhad Joshi**, in the presence of MoS **Smt. Nimuben Jayantibhai Bambhaniya**.

The initiative represents the **world's largest deployment of AI and IoT-based technologies** in public sector foodgrain warehousing.

The system has been implemented across **215** Central Warehousing Corporation (CWC) **warehouses**, while the **Food Corporation of India (FCI)** is deploying it in an additional **150 warehouses**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Department of Food and Public Distribution (DFPD)** under the Ministry of Consumer Affairs, Food and Public Distribution launched the **Smart Warehousing System** for foodgrain storage at **Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi**.

The system was inaugurated by Union Minister **Shri Pralhad Joshi**, in the presence of MoS **Smt. Nimuben Jayantibhai Bambhaniya**.

The initiative represents the **world's largest deployment of AI and IoT-based technologies** in public sector foodgrain warehousing.

The system has been implemented across **215** Central Warehousing Corporation (CWC) **warehouses**, while the **Food Corporation of India (FCI)** is deploying it in an additional **150 warehouses**.

The Smart Warehousing System integrates **Artificial Intelligence (AI), Internet of Things (IoT), FASTag,** and **ANPR-based automation technologies**.

Key features include **geo-tagged smart locks, AI-based bag counting, facial recognition, object detection,** and **IoT-based environmental monitoring systems**.

It also enables **AI-powered surveillance** for **fire, smoke, and rodent detection**, improving warehouse safety and security.

The system supports **ERP integration, automated record generation,** and **advanced analytics** for efficient warehouse management.
It is expected to improve **operational efficiency**, reduce **vehicle turnaround time (TAT)**, enhance **transparency**, and strengthen **compliance monitoring**.
The initiative will also improve **manpower productivity, real-time visibility,** and **early hazard detection** in warehouses.

406. Recently (June 2026), Union Minister Shri Pralhad Joshi visited the National Test House (NTH), Western Region, located in which city?

A.New Delhi
B.Mumbai
C.Chennai
D.Bengaluru
E.Hyderabad

Answer: B

Short Explanation:
The Union Minister Shri Pralhad Joshi (Consumer Affairs, Food and Public Distribution; New & Renewable Energy) will visit the **National Test House (NTH), Western Region, Mumbai** on **19 June 2026**.
At **NTH Northern Region, Ghaziabad**, a **Shoe Testing Facility** will be inaugurated to support the footwear industry quality testing ecosystem.
At **NTH–AURIC, Chhatrapati Sambhajinagar**, a **Satellite Testing Laboratory and Sample Collection Centre** will be inaugurated in collaboration with **NICDC (National Industrial Corridor Development Corporation)**.

Detailed Explanation:
The Union Minister Shri Pralhad Joshi (Consumer Affairs, Food and Public Distribution; New & Renewable Energy) will visit the **National Test House (NTH), Western Region, Mumbai** on **19 June 2026**.
He will lay the foundation stone of a **Multi-Storeyed Residential Accommodation Project** at the NTH campus, Mumbai to strengthen residential infrastructure for officers and staff.
The project aims to improve the overall **institutional ecosystem** and **working environment** of NTH.
The Minister will also inaugurate several **modern testing facilities** to strengthen India's **quality assurance infrastructure**.
At **NTH Western Region, Mumbai**, a **Microbiological Testing Laboratory** will be inaugurated to enhance capabilities in microbiological analysis and testing across sectors.
At **NTH Northern Region, Ghaziabad**, a **Shoe Testing Facility** will be inaugurated to support the footwear industry quality testing ecosystem.
At **NTH–AURIC, Chhatrapati Sambhajinagar**, a **Satellite Testing Laboratory and Sample Collection Centre** will be inaugurated in collaboration with **NICDC (National Industrial Corridor Development Corporation)**.
The AURIC facility will improve access to **testing and calibration services** for

industries in Maharashtra's industrial corridor region.

The initiative will benefit **industry, government agencies, and consumers** by strengthening **standardised testing and compliance systems**.

These developments reflect the government's focus on strengthening **National Quality Infrastructure (NQI)** and improving **consumer protection and industrial competitiveness**.

407. At the National Test House (NTH), Western Region, Mumbai, Union Minister Shri Pralhad Joshi inaugurated which new facility to strengthen India's quality assurance infrastructure?

A.Advanced Materials Testing Laboratory

B.Microbiological Testing Laboratory

C.Renewable Energy Certification Centre

D.Food Packaging Testing Laboratory

E.Environmental Monitoring Laboratory

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The Union Minister Shri Pralhad Joshi (Consumer Affairs, Food and Public Distribution; New & Renewable Energy) will visit the **National Test House (NTH), Western Region, Mumbai** on **19 June 2026**.

He will lay the foundation stone of a **Multi-Storeyed Residential Accommodation Project** at the NTH campus, Mumbai to strengthen residential infrastructure for officers and staff.

The project aims to improve the overall **institutional ecosystem** and **working environment** of NTH.

The Minister will also inaugurate several **modern testing facilities** to strengthen India's **quality assurance infrastructure**.

At **NTH Western Region, Mumbai**, a **Microbiological Testing Laboratory** will be inaugurated to enhance capabilities in microbiological analysis and testing across sectors.

Detailed Explanation:

The Union Minister Shri Pralhad Joshi (Consumer Affairs, Food and Public Distribution; New & Renewable Energy) will visit the **National Test House (NTH), Western Region, Mumbai** on **19 June 2026**.

He will lay the foundation stone of a **Multi-Storeyed Residential Accommodation Project** at the NTH campus, Mumbai to strengthen residential infrastructure for officers and staff.

The project aims to improve the overall **institutional ecosystem** and **working environment** of NTH.

The Minister will also inaugurate several **modern testing facilities** to strengthen India's **quality assurance infrastructure**.

At **NTH Western Region, Mumbai**, a **Microbiological Testing Laboratory** will be inaugurated to enhance capabilities in microbiological analysis and testing across sectors.

At **NTH Northern Region, Ghaziabad**, a **Shoe Testing Facility** will be inaugurated to support the footwear industry quality testing ecosystem.
At **NTH–AURIC, Chhatrapati Sambhajinagar**, a **Satellite Testing Laboratory and Sample Collection Centre** will be inaugurated in collaboration with **NICDC (National Industrial Corridor Development Corporation)**.
The AURIC facility will improve access to **testing and calibration services** for industries in Maharashtra's industrial corridor region.
The initiative will benefit **industry, government agencies, and consumers** by strengthening **standardised testing and compliance systems**.
These developments reflect the government's focus on strengthening **National Quality Infrastructure (NQI)** and improving **consumer protection and industrial competitiveness**

408. Under the MoU signed between IITM Pune and ARIES Nainital in June 2026, a Climate Observation Station will be established at ARIES, Devasthal under which national initiative?

A.Mission Mausam
B.Bharat Climate Observation Network (BCON)
C.National Atmospheric Monitoring Programme
D.India Climate Action Network
E.Himalayan Weather Observation Mission
Answer: B
Short Explanation:
The Indian Institute of Tropical Meteorology (IITM), Pune signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** with the **Aryabhatta Research Institute of Observational Sciences (ARIES), Nainital** on **18 June 2026** through online mode.
The MoU was signed by **Dr. A. Suryachandra Rao** (Director of IITM) and **Dr. Manish Kumar Naja** (Director of ARIES).
The agreement aims to strengthen **collaborative research on climate change** through long-term observations of climate variables and atmospheric parameters.
The collaboration will establish a **Climate Observation Station at ARIES, Devasthal** under the **Bharat Climate Observation Network (BCON)**.
Detailed Explanation:
The Indian Institute of Tropical Meteorology (IITM), Pune signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** with the **Aryabhatta Research Institute of Observational Sciences (ARIES), Nainital** on **18 June 2026** through online mode.
The MoU was signed by **Dr. A. Suryachandra Rao** (Director of IITM) and **Dr. Manish Kumar Naja** (Director of ARIES).
The agreement aims to strengthen **collaborative research on climate change** through long-term observations of climate variables and atmospheric parameters.
The collaboration will establish a **Climate Observation Station at ARIES,**

Devasthal under the **Bharat Climate Observation Network (BCON)**.

ARIES, Devasthal, a high-altitude hilltop observatory, provides ideal conditions for studying **greenhouse gases, climate-relevant pollutants, atmospheric transport processes,** and **Himalayan climate dynamics**.

The MoU has been signed for a period of **more than 50 years**, reflecting a **long-term commitment** to climate and atmospheric science research.

The initiative supports the **Mission Mausam programme** of the **Ministry of Earth Sciences (MoES)**.

BCON (Bharat Climate Observation Network) is a national climate-monitoring initiative conceptualized and implemented by **IITM under MoES** to create a **high-precision, long-term climate observation framework** across India.

BCON will monitor **meteorological parameters, climate-active trace gases, greenhouse gases, short-lived climate forcers, atmospheric chemistry,** and **soil moisture**.

409. As of 2026, Jeh Aerospace Private Limited and the Solestra Group signed a multi-year agreement to establish a Global Manufacturing Centre (GMC) in which city?

A.Bengaluru

B.Chennai

C.Hyderabad

D.Pune

E.Ahmedabad

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

Jeh Aerospace Private Limited (India) and **Solestra Group (USA)** signed a **multi-year, multi-million-dollar agreement** to establish a **Global Manufacturing Centre (GMC)** in **Hyderabad, Telangana**.

The agreement was formalised during the visit of **Joe DeMartino** (CEO, Solestra Group) and **Rocky Barnhart** (VP & General Manager, Solestra Group) to India.

The initiative aims to **enhance aerospace manufacturing capacity** and support **New Product Introduction (NPI)**.

Detailed Explanation:

Jeh Aerospace Private Limited (India) and **Solestra Group (USA)** signed a **multi-year, multi-million-dollar agreement** to establish a **Global Manufacturing Centre (GMC)** in **Hyderabad, Telangana**.

The agreement was formalised during the visit of **Joe DeMartino** (CEO, Solestra Group) and **Rocky Barnhart** (VP & General Manager, Solestra Group) to India.

The initiative aims to **enhance aerospace manufacturing capacity** and support **New Product Introduction (NPI)**.

It will also **accelerate industrialisation** and strengthen **global supply chain resilience** in the aerospace sector.

The proposed facility will manufacture **high-precision aerospace components** for **aero-engine and aircraft system applications**.

The centre will ensure **digital transparency** and strong **intellectual property (IP) protection mechanisms**.

410. In 2026, the Essar Group and Abu Dhabi-based International Resources Holding (IRH) signed a crude oil sourcing and product supply facility agreement worth:

A.USD 250 million

B.USD 500 million

C.USD 750 million

D.USD 1 billion

E.USD 1.5 billion

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The Essar Group (India) and Abu Dhabi-based **International Resources Holding (IRH)** signed a **USD 500 million crude oil sourcing and product supply facility agreement**.

The agreement is between **Essar Energy Transition Fuels** and **IRH Global Trading**.

Detailed Explanation:

The Essar Group (India) and Abu Dhabi-based **International Resources Holding (IRH)** signed a **USD 500 million crude oil sourcing and product supply facility agreement**.

The agreement is between **Essar Energy Transition Fuels** and **IRH Global Trading**.

The facility establishes a **USD 500 million structured sourcing arrangement** for crude oil and petroleum products in global energy markets.

The objective is to strengthen **supply chain optimisation, procurement efficiency,** and **energy trading operations**.

It aims to ensure **diversified crude sourcing channels** and improve **working capital efficiency**.

The agreement enhances **feedstock security** in a volatile global energy environment.

It enables better response to **global price fluctuations** and **demand changes** in the energy market.

411. Who has been appointed as the Chairman-cum-Managing Director (CMD) of General Insurance Corporation of India (GIC Re) by the Department of Financial Services in June 2026?

A.Narayanan Ramaswamy

B.Hitesh Rameshchandra Joshi

C.R. Doraiswamy

D.T. C. Suseel Kumar

E.Debasish Panda

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The **Department of Financial Services (DFS), Ministry of Finance (MoF)** has approved the appointment of **Hitesh Rameshchandra Joshi** as **Chairman-cum-Managing Director (CMD)** of **General Insurance Corporation of India (GIC Re)**.

He assumed charge as CMD of GIC Re (**India's national reinsurer**) with effect from **16 June 2026**, with a tenure up to **30 September 2028**.

He succeeded **Narayanan Ramaswamy**, whose tenure as CMD ended on **30 September 2025**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Department of Financial Services (DFS), Ministry of Finance (MoF)** has approved the appointment of **Hitesh Rameshchandra Joshi** as **Chairman-cum-Managing Director (CMD)** of **General Insurance Corporation of India (GIC Re)**.

He assumed charge as CMD of GIC Re (**India's national reinsurer**) with effect from **16 June 2026**, with a tenure up to **30 September 2028**.

He succeeded **Narayanan Ramaswamy**, whose tenure as CMD ended on **30 September 2025**.

Hitesh Rameshchandra Joshi has over **30 years of experience** in the insurance and reinsurance sector.

He had been serving as **interim CMD of GIC Re since 1 October 2025** prior to his full-time appointment.

He previously worked as **Executive Director (ED) at GIC Re**, handling international business operations, HR, IT, actuarial services, and business intelligence.

His expertise includes **domestic and international reinsurance, retrocession, risk management, strategic planning, finance, internal audit, credit rating, investor relations,** and **budget control**.

412. In the 23rd edition of the Multilateral Joint Military Exercise "KHAAN QUEST" will be conducted in which country?

A.Kazakhstan

B.Vietnam

C.South Korea

D.Japan

E.Mongolia

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

The **Indian Army contingent** is set to participate in the **Multilateral Joint Military Exercise "KHAAN QUEST"** scheduled in **Mongolia**.

The exercise will be held from **20 June to 03 July 2026** at the **Five Hills Training Area, Ulaanbaatar, Mongolia**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Indian Army contingent** is set to participate in the **Multilateral Joint Military Exercise "KHAAN QUEST"** scheduled in **Mongolia**.

The exercise will be held from **20 June to 03 July 2026** at the **Five Hills Training Area, Ulaanbaatar, Mongolia**.

The **23rd edition of Exercise KHAAN QUEST** aims to enhance **interoperability and coordination** among participating nations in **peace support operations** under **Chapter VII of the United Nations Charter**.

The exercise reflects India's strong commitment to **global peace, multilateral cooperation,** and **strategic partnership with Mongolia**.

413. As of 2026, Raksha Mantri Rajnath Singh performed the Bhoomi Pujan of a

₹10,000-Ton Aluminium Extrusion Press at Ordnance Factory Ambajhari in which city?

A.Pune

B.Nashik

C.Nagpur

D.Aurangabad

E.Mumbai

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

Raksha Mantri Rajnath Singh performed **Bhoomi Pujan** of a **₹10,000-Ton Aluminium Extrusion Press** at **Ordnance Factory Ambajhari, Nagpur (Maharashtra)** on **19 June 2026**, in the presence of **Maharashtra CM Devendra Fadnavis**.

The facility is being developed under **Yantra India Limited (YIL)** and is aimed at strengthening **Aatmanirbhar Bharat** and **import substitution** in critical defence materials.

The **Aluminium Extrusion Press** is a state-of-the-art industrial facility designed to produce **large and complex aluminium alloy profiles**.

These aluminium components will be used in **defence systems, aerospace structures, aviation platforms, missile programmes, railways,** and **strategic industrial applications**.

Detailed Explanation:

Raksha Mantri Rajnath Singh performed **Bhoomi Pujan** of a **₹10,000-Ton Aluminium Extrusion Press** at **Ordnance Factory Ambajhari, Nagpur (Maharashtra)** on **19 June 2026**, in the presence of **Maharashtra CM Devendra Fadnavis**.

The facility is being developed under **Yantra India Limited (YIL)** and is aimed at strengthening **Aatmanirbhar Bharat** and **import substitution** in critical defence materials.

The **Aluminium Extrusion Press** is a state-of-the-art industrial facility designed to produce **large and complex aluminium alloy profiles**.

These aluminium components will be used in **defence systems, aerospace structures, aviation platforms, missile programmes, railways,** and **strategic industrial applications**.

The project will help **reduce dependence on imports** of critical aluminium extrusions and strengthen the **domestic defence and industrial supply chain**.

The press will support production of materials required for **modern fighter jets, missiles, and space programmes**, which require **lightweight and high-strength alloys** capable of withstanding extreme conditions.

Raksha Mantri highlighted that **indigenous manufacturing** is crucial for **national security** and **future readiness** in changing geopolitical conditions.

He stressed that **Made-in-India defence equipment** played a key role in **Operation**

Sindoor, showcasing the importance of domestic capability.

414. As per the news, the Ministry of Defence has granted in-principle approval for a ₹500 crore National Military Drone Technology Hub at which institution?

A.IIT Delhi

B.IIT Madras

C.IIT Bombay

D.IIT Kanpur

E.IIT Kharagpur

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

The **Ministry of Defence (MoD)** has granted in-principle approval for a **₹500 crore National Military Drone Technology Hub** at Indian Institute of Technology Kanpur (IIT-K) in Uttar Pradesh (UP).

The initiative aims to strengthen India's capabilities in **advanced unmanned systems** and **military drone technologies**.

The proposed hub will provide a **full-stack capability**, including design, testing, certification of military payloads, data links, ground stations, and **counter-drone systems**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Ministry of Defence (MoD)** has granted in-principle approval for a **₹500 crore National Military Drone Technology Hub** at Indian Institute of Technology Kanpur (IIT-K) in Uttar Pradesh (UP).

The initiative aims to strengthen India's capabilities in **advanced unmanned systems** and **military drone technologies**.

The proposed hub will provide a **full-stack capability**, including design, testing, certification of military payloads, data links, ground stations, and **counter-drone systems**.

The **Army Design Bureau (ADB)** has been designated as the **single point of contact** for coordination between MoD, IIT Kanpur, and the Uttar Pradesh government.

A **nodal officer system** will be established to ensure streamlined inter-departmental coordination under the guidance of MoD, ADB, and IIT-K.

The proposal was spearheaded by the **Uttar Pradesh Expressways Industrial Development Authority (UPEIDA)** under the **UP Defence Industrial Corridor (UP DIC)** framework.

The hub aims to position Uttar Pradesh as a **national centre for defence drone technology development** and manufacturing.

The project will promote a **civil–military fusion model** and scale up **dual-use drone technologies** under **Drone Shakti**.

415. As of 2026, the first of six indigenous Air Cushion Vehicles (ACVs) inducted into service by the Indian Coast Guard in June 2026 was constructed by which company?

A.Garden Reach Shipbuilders & Engineers (GRSE)

B.Goa Shipyard Limited (GSL)

C.Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders Limited (MDL)
D.Cochin Shipyard Limited (CSL)
E.Chowgule & Company Private Limited
Answer: E
Short Explanation:
The first of six **indigenous Air Cushion Vehicles (ACVs)** for the **Indian Coast Guard (ICG)** was inducted into service in **Goa** on **18 June 2026**.
The ACVs are being constructed by **Chowgule & Company Private Limited** under a contract with the **Ministry of Defence (MoD)**.
These **hovercraft-based ACVs** are designed to enhance the **operational effectiveness** of the Indian Coast Guard across a wide range of **maritime security and surveillance duties**.
Detailed Explanation:
The first of six **indigenous Air Cushion Vehicles (ACVs)** for the **Indian Coast Guard (ICG)** was inducted into service in **Goa** on **18 June 2026**.
The ACVs are being constructed by **Chowgule & Company Private Limited** under a contract with the **Ministry of Defence (MoD)**.
These **hovercraft-based ACVs** are designed to enhance the **operational effectiveness** of the Indian Coast Guard across a wide range of **maritime security and surveillance duties**.
The induction strengthens the vision of **Aatmanirbhar Bharat**, promoting **indigenous defence manufacturing** and **maritime capability development**.
The ceremony was attended by senior **ICG officials** and representatives from the **shipbuilding industry**, highlighting **industry–defence collaboration**.
The ACVs will improve the ICG's ability to respond to emerging **maritime challenges, coastal threats,** and **security requirements**.
The induction reflects the ICG's continued focus on **modernisation, capability enhancement,** and **maritime preparedness**.

416. On which date did the Vikram Lander of Chandrayaan-3 successfully land near the Moon's south pole?
A.14 July 2023
B.23 August 2023
C.2 September 2023
D.22 October 2023
E.1 January 2024
Answer: B
Short Explanation:
The **Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO)**, in collaboration with the **Department of Atomic Energy (DAE)**, is developing an **advanced artificial heating system** to extend the operational life of lunar landers.
The technology aims to increase the **operational lifespan** of lunar landers from about 14 Earth days (one lunar day) to **up to 200 days**.
The **Vikram Lander (Chandrayaan-3)** successfully landed near the Moon's south pole on **23 August 2023** and operated for one lunar day using solar power.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO)**, in collaboration with the **Department of Atomic Energy (DAE)**, is developing an **advanced artificial heating system** to extend the operational life of lunar landers.

The technology aims to increase the **operational lifespan** of lunar landers from about 14 Earth days (one lunar day) to **up to 200 days**.

The system is designed to help spacecraft survive **extreme lunar night temperatures** (below –129°C to –180°C).

It will provide **continuous thermal support** to protect onboard instruments and critical systems during harsh lunar conditions.

The initiative marks a major advancement in addressing the challenge of **long lunar nights** and **loss of solar power**.

The **Vikram Lander (Chandrayaan-3)** successfully landed near the Moon's south pole on **23 August 2023** and operated for one lunar day using solar power.

However, its mission ended after lunar night due to **power loss** caused by **lack of sunlight** and extreme cold conditions.

417. In news, Robert A.F. Thurman, the renowned scholar of Tibetan Buddhism who recently passed away, was awarded the Padma Shri in the field of Literature and Education in which year?

A.2018

B.2019

C.2020

D.2021

E.2022

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The renowned American scholar of Tibetan Buddhism **Robert Alexander Farrar (Robert A.F.) Thurman** passed away on **16 June 2026** in **New York, USA**, at the age of **84**.

He was a distinguished **author, translator, educator, and Padma Shri awardee**, known for his contributions to **literature, education, and Buddhist studies**.

Robert A.F. Thurman was awarded India's **Padma Shri (Literature and Education) in 2020**, one of the country's highest civilian honours, for his contributions to literature, education, and the promotion of Buddhist thought. .

Detailed Explanation:

The renowned American scholar of Tibetan Buddhism **Robert Alexander Farrar (Robert A.F.) Thurman** passed away on **16 June 2026** in **New York, USA**, at the age of **84**.

He was a distinguished **author, translator, educator, and Padma Shri awardee**, known for his contributions to **literature, education, and Buddhist studies**.

He was born on **3 August 1941** in New York City, USA, and earned his **Ph.D. from Harvard University**.

He served as the **Jey Tsong Khapa Professor of Indo-Tibetan Buddhist Studies** in the

Department of Religion at **Columbia University, New York**.

He was the **first American to be ordained in the Tibetan Buddhist tradition** under the **14th Dalai Lama**.

He translated the **Vimalakirti Sutra** into English and authored over 20 books, including **Inner Revolution**.

He was a close associate of the **14th Dalai Lama, Tenzin Gyatso**, and **co-founded Tibet House US in 1986** to preserve and promote Tibetan culture and Buddhist traditions.

He was widely recognised internationally and was listed among the **25 Most Influential Americans (1997)** and featured by **New York Magazine** in 2006.

Robert A.F. Thurman was awarded India's **Padma Shri (Literature and Education) in 2020**, one of the country's highest civilian honours, for his contributions to literature, education, and the promotion of Buddhist thought.

418. As of 2026, what is the currency of Mongolia?

A.Tenge

B.Som

C.Kina

D.Tögrög

E.Yuan

Answer: D

About Mongolia :

President : Ukhnaagiin Khürelsükh

Prime Minister : Nyam-Osoryn Uchral

Capital : Ulaanbaatar

Currency : Tögrög (or Tugrik)

419. As of 2026, what is the currency of Uzbekistan?

A.Tenge

B.Somoni

C.Afghani

D.Manat

E.Sum

Answer: E

About Uzbekistan :

President : Shavkat Mirziyoyev

Prime Minister : Abdulla Aripov

Capital : Tashkent

Currency : Uzbek sum

420. The New Development Bank (NDB), established by BRICS countries in 2015, has approved approximately how many projects across its member nations so far?

A.95 projects worth US$25 billion

B.112 projects worth US$35 billion

C.125 projects worth US$40 billion

D.139 projects worth US$43 billion

E.150 projects worth US$50 billion

Answer: D

The **New Development Bank (NDB)** was established in **2015** by **BRICS countries** to fund infrastructure and sustainable development projects.

So far, the NDB has approved **139 projects** worth approximately **US$43 billion** across member nations.

With Uzbekistan's inclusion, the NDB continues expanding beyond its founding members, including **Brazil, Russia, India, China, South Africa, Egypt, UAE, Bangladesh, and Algeria**.

421. As per the market reforms approved by SEBI in June 2026, what is the name of the new category introduced to facilitate faster transmission of securities to legal heirs or claimants in small-value cases with minimal documentation?

A.Simplified Inheritance Transfer (SIT)
B.Fast Securities Settlement (FSS)
C.Quick Transmission Processing (QTP)
D.Electronic Claim Transfer System (ECTS)
E.Rapid Succession Mechanism (RSM)

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The **Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI)** approved a set of **market reforms** aimed at improving efficiency, transparency, investor convenience, and regulatory compliance in India's capital markets.

The decisions were taken at the **214th SEBI Board Meeting** held in Mumbai, focusing on strengthening the capital market ecosystem.

SEBI introduced a new framework for **simplified transmission of securities** to the legal heirs or claimants of deceased investors, reducing procedural delays.

A new category called **Quick Transmission Processing (QTP)** has been introduced for small-value claims to enable faster processing with minimal documentation.

Under QTP, simplified processing applies **up to ₹10,000 for physical holdings** and **up to ₹30,000 for dematerialised holdings**

Detailed Explanation:

The **Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI)** approved a set of **market reforms** aimed at improving efficiency, transparency, investor convenience, and regulatory compliance in India's capital markets.

The decisions were taken at the **214th SEBI Board Meeting** held in Mumbai, focusing on strengthening the capital market ecosystem.

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A new category called **Quick Transmission Processing (QTP)** has been introduced for small-value claims to enable faster processing with minimal documentation.

Under QTP, simplified processing applies **up to ₹10,000 for physical holdings** and **up to ₹30,000 for dematerialised holdings**.

SEBI also **doubled documentation limits**, increasing thresholds to **₹10 lakh for physical holdings** and **₹30 lakh for demat holdings** per beneficial owner/listed company.

Key reforms include **removal of mandatory PAN submission** in certain transmission cases, as PAN details are already linked to demat accounts.

SEBI has also **discarded the mandatory probate of will requirement**, aligning with updated succession law provisions.

The regulator has permitted a **combined affidavit-cum-NOC format**, replacing separate affidavits and no-objection certificates to simplify procedures.

SEBI now allows **QR code-enabled death certificates** for faster verification and easier processing.

422. As per the news, the Asian Development Bank (ADB) signed a USD 10 million financing package with Schoolnet India Limited (SIL) to strengthen digital learning infrastructure in government schools across India. This marks ADB's first private sector financing in India for which sector?

A.Renewable Energy

B.Healthcare Infrastructure

C.Digital Education

D.Urban Transport

E.Agriculture Technology

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The **Asian Development Bank (ADB)** signed a **USD 10 million financing package** with **Schoolnet India Limited (SIL)** to strengthen **digital learning infrastructure** in government schools across India.

The initiative aims to **improve learning outcomes for 45 million students** by scaling digital education in around **30,000 government schools**.

The project focuses on expanding **human capital development** along with **upgrading digital hardware infrastructure**.

Under the programme, **computer laboratories** will be installed in **at least 1,000 government schools**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Asian Development Bank (ADB)** signed a **USD 10 million financing package** with **Schoolnet India Limited (SIL)** to strengthen **digital learning infrastructure** in government schools across India.

The initiative aims to **improve learning outcomes for 45 million students** by scaling digital education in around **30,000 government schools**.

The project focuses on expanding **human capital development** along with **upgrading digital hardware infrastructure**.

Under the programme, **computer laboratories** will be installed in **at least 1,000 government schools**.

The project will establish around **58,000 digital classrooms** to support technology-enabled learning.

A total of **56,000 educators will be trained** in digital teaching methods and pedagogy.

This is **ADB's first private sector financing** for a digital education project in India.

The initiative aims to address **gaps in digital access** in education, aligning with the **National Education Policy (NEP) 2020**.

Currently, only **26% of K–12 schools** in India have **computer laboratories**, and **29% have smart classrooms**, highlighting infrastructure gaps.

423. As per the news, Axis Bank and BITS Pilani signed an agreement to establish the Axis Bank–BITS Industry Research, Technology and Innovation Park at which BITS Pilani campus?

A.Pilani Campus, Rajasthan

B.Goa Campus, Goa

C.Dubai Campus, UAE

D.Hyderabad Campus, Telangana

E.Mumbai Extension Centre, Maharashtra

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

Birla Institute of Technology and Science (BITS) Pilani and **Axis Bank Limited** signed an agreement to establish the **Axis Bank–BITS Industry Research, Technology and Innovation Park** at the **Hyderabad Campus, Telangana**.

The project is supported by a **₹100 crore Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) grant** from Axis Bank.

The initiative aims to strengthen India's **innovation ecosystem**, **deep-tech sector**, and **translational research capabilities** through industry–academia collaboration.

Detailed Explanation:

Birla Institute of Technology and Science (BITS) Pilani and **Axis Bank Limited** signed an agreement to establish the **Axis Bank–BITS Industry Research, Technology and Innovation Park** at the **Hyderabad Campus, Telangana**.

The project is supported by a **₹100 crore Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) grant** from Axis Bank.

The initiative aims to strengthen India's **innovation ecosystem**, **deep-tech sector**, and **translational research capabilities** through industry–academia collaboration.

The Innovation Park will focus on key sectors such as **Life Sciences, Biopharma, Healthcare, Medical Devices, and Deep-Tech Innovation**.

It will promote **research-driven solutions** with strong societal impact.

The facility will be spread across approximately **1.2 lakh square feet**, supporting large-scale research and innovation activities.

The infrastructure will include **advanced laboratories**, **incubation centres**, and **shared research facilities**.

The project will support **startups, researchers, and MSMEs** (Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises) through a collaborative innovation ecosystem.

A key focus will be on enabling **technology transfer** and strengthening **industry-research linkages**.

424. As per the decision of the Maharashtra Cabinet, the High-Energy Medical Cyclotron Project (HEMCP) approved in Nagpur will primarily function as a:

A.Biotechnology Research Centre

B.Radiopharmaceutical Innovation Hub

C.Artificial Intelligence Healthcare Lab

D.National Cancer Registry Centre

E.Medical Equipment Manufacturing Park

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The **Maharashtra Cabinet** has approved the establishment of the **High-Energy Medical Cyclotron Project (HEMCP)** in **Nagpur** with an estimated investment of **₹300 crore** to strengthen cancer diagnosis and treatment infrastructure in Central India.

The project will function as a **Radiopharmaceutical Innovation Hub** and will ensure local production of critical radioisotopes used in **Positron Emission Tomography–Computed Tomography (PET-CT) scans**, nuclear medicine and cancer treatment.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Maharashtra Cabinet** has approved the establishment of the **High-Energy Medical Cyclotron Project (HEMCP)** in **Nagpur** with an estimated investment of **₹300 crore** to strengthen cancer diagnosis and treatment infrastructure in Central India.

The project will function as a **Radiopharmaceutical Innovation Hub** and will ensure local production of critical radioisotopes used in **Positron Emission Tomography–Computed Tomography (PET-CT) scans**, nuclear medicine and cancer treatment.

The facility is expected to reduce dependence on major healthcare centres such as **Mumbai** and **Hyderabad** for radioisotope supplies and improve timely access to diagnostic services.

Nagpur was selected due to its strategic location and is expected to serve patients within a radius of nearly **500 kilometres**, covering parts of **Maharashtra, Madhya Pradesh, Chhattisgarh, Telangana and Andhra Pradesh**.

A **30-hectare land parcel at Bhansoli (Kinhi), Hingna Taluka**, has been allocated for the project.

425. As per the Maharashtra Rural Drinking Water Policy 2026, which mobile application will support the three-tier grievance redressal mechanism for rural drinking water services?

A.Nal Jal Seva App

B.Gram Jal Portal

C.Jal Doot App

D.Water Mitra Connect

E.Jal Jeevan Tracker

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

The Maharashtra Cabinet has also approved the **Maharashtra Rural Drinking Water Policy 2026** to ensure sustainable and uninterrupted drinking water supply in rural areas.

The policy supports the objectives of **Jal Jeevan Mission 2.0** and focuses on long-term operation and maintenance of rural water supply schemes.

A three-tier grievance redressal mechanism will be established and supported by the **Nal Jal**

Seva mobile application and **Nal Jal Mitra** initiative.

Detailed Explanation:

The Maharashtra Cabinet has also approved the **Maharashtra Rural Drinking Water Policy 2026** to ensure sustainable and uninterrupted drinking water supply in rural areas.

The policy supports the objectives of **Jal Jeevan Mission 2.0** and focuses on long-term operation and maintenance of rural water supply schemes.

Dedicated corpus funds will be created at the **Gram Panchayat, Zilla Parishad and Maharashtra Jeevan Pradhikaran** levels.

The policy promotes technology-based monitoring through **Supervisory Control and Data Acquisition (SCADA)** systems, **Geographic Information System (GIS)-based dashboards** and digital monitoring of water assets.

Household water tariffs will range between **₹150 and ₹400 per month**.

If revenue collection is insufficient, Gram Panchayats may utilise grants received under the **15th and 16th Finance Commissions** to bridge the funding gap.

Women Self-Help Groups (SHGs) and **Primary Agricultural Credit Societies (PACS)** will receive priority in water billing, collection and maintenance contracts.

A three-tier grievance redressal mechanism will be established and supported by the **Nal Jal Seva mobile application** and **Nal Jal Mitra** initiative.

426. In a landmark judgment delivered in June 2026, the Supreme Court of India held that the right to walk on safe and demarcated footpaths is a Fundamental Right primarily linked to which Article of the Constitution?

A.Article 14 – Right to Equality

B.Article 17 – Abolition of Untouchability

C.Article 32 – Right to Constitutional Remedies

D.Article 21 – Right to Life and Personal Liberty

E.Article 51A – Fundamental Duties

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

The **Supreme Court of India** has ruled that the right to walk on safe and demarcated footpaths is a **Fundamental Right** guaranteed under the Constitution of India.

The landmark judgment was delivered by a Bench comprising **Justice P. S. Narasimha** and **Justice Atul S. Chandurkar** while hearing a motor accident case involving the death of a five-year-old child.

The Court held that the right to walk is protected under **Part III of the Constitution** and is intrinsically linked to **Article 19(1)(a) (Freedom of Speech and Expression), Article 19(1)(b) (Right to Assemble Peacefully), Article 19(1)(c) (Right to Form Associations), Article 19(1)(d) (Freedom of Movement)** and **Article 21 (Right to Life and Personal Liberty)**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Supreme Court of India** has ruled that the right to walk on safe and demarcated footpaths is a **Fundamental Right** guaranteed under the Constitution of India.

The landmark judgment was delivered by a Bench comprising **Justice P. S. Narasimha** and **Justice Atul S. Chandurkar** while hearing a motor accident case involving the death of a five-year-old child.

The Court held that the right to walk is protected under **Part III of the Constitution** and is intrinsically linked to **Article 19(1)(a) (Freedom of Speech and Expression), Article 19(1)(b) (Right to Assemble Peacefully), Article 19(1)(c) (Right to Form Associations), Article 19(1)(d) (Freedom of Movement)** and **Article 21 (Right to Life and Personal Liberty)**.

The Court observed that the right to walk naturally includes the right to access safe, well-maintained and clearly demarcated footpaths and pedestrian infrastructure.

The judgment arose from a case in which a five-year-old child lost his life after being hit by a tanker while walking to school with his father on a road that lacked footpaths and pedestrian crossings.

The Supreme Court restored and enhanced the compensation awarded to the victim's family to **₹11.44 lakh** and directed that the amount be paid within two months.

427. As per the news, Bharat Coal Gasification and Chemicals Limited (BCGCL), which is developing India's first commercial-scale Coal-to-Ammonium Nitrate Project in Odisha, is a joint venture between which two companies?

A.Coal India Limited and NTPC Limited

B.Bharat Heavy Electricals Limited and Coal India Limited

C.ONGC Limited and BHEL

D.GAIL India Limited and Coal India Limited

E.BHEL and Indian Oil Corporation Limited

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** is set to lay the foundation stone of India's first commercial-scale **Coal-to-Ammonium Nitrate Project** at **Lakhanpur in Jharsuguda district, Odisha**.

The project will be developed at an investment of **₹25,016 crore** by **Bharat Coal Gasification and Chemicals Limited (BCGCL)**.

Bharat Coal Gasification and Chemicals Limited (BCGCL) is a joint venture between **Bharat Heavy Electricals Limited (BHEL)** and **Coal India Limited (CIL)**.

Detailed Explanation:

Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** is set to lay the foundation stone of India's first commercial-scale **Coal-to-Ammonium Nitrate Project** at **Lakhanpur in Jharsuguda district, Odisha**.

The project will be developed at an investment of **₹25,016 crore** by **Bharat Coal Gasification and Chemicals Limited (BCGCL)**.

Bharat Coal Gasification and Chemicals Limited (BCGCL) is a joint venture between **Bharat Heavy Electricals Limited (BHEL)** and **Coal India Limited (CIL)**.

The project will be the first commercial-scale facility in India to convert coal into ammonium nitrate using indigenous technology.

The plant will have a production capacity of **2,000 tonnes of ammonium nitrate per day**, helping reduce dependence on imports and conventional feedstocks for this important industrial chemical.

Coal gasification is a process that converts coal into **synthesis gas (syngas)**, which mainly contains hydrogen and carbon monoxide and can be used to manufacture products such as methanol, urea, ammonium nitrate, synthetic natural gas and other chemical feedstocks

428. As per the news, Rajasthan's first Multi-Lane Free Flow (MLFF) tolling system has been launched by NHAI at which toll plaza?

A.Shahjahanpur Toll Plaza

B.Manoharpur Toll Plaza

C.Daulatpura Toll Plaza

D.Kishangarh Toll Plaza

E.Jaipur Ring Road Toll Plaza

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The **National Highways Authority of India (NHAI)** has launched Rajasthan's first **Multi-Lane Free Flow (MLFF)** tolling system at **Daulatpura Toll Plaza** on the **Delhi–Jaipur section of National Highway-48 (NH-48)**.

The MLFF system is a barrier-less toll collection mechanism that allows vehicles to pass through toll plazas without stopping or significantly slowing down.

The system integrates **Automatic Number Plate Recognition (ANPR)** technology and **FASTag-based Electronic Toll Collection (ETC)** to automatically identify vehicles and collect toll charges digitally.

Detailed Explanation:

The **National Highways Authority of India (NHAI)** has launched Rajasthan's first **Multi-Lane Free Flow (MLFF)** tolling system at **Daulatpura Toll Plaza** on the **Delhi–Jaipur section of National Highway-48 (NH-48)**.

The MLFF system is a barrier-less toll collection mechanism that allows vehicles to pass through toll plazas without stopping or significantly slowing down.

The system integrates **Automatic Number Plate Recognition (ANPR)** technology and **FASTag-based Electronic Toll Collection (ETC)** to automatically identify vehicles and collect toll charges digitally.

High-resolution cameras capture vehicle registration numbers and the toll amount is automatically deducted from the vehicle's FASTag account.

The new system eliminates physical barriers and manual verification, ensuring seamless traffic movement and reducing congestion at toll plazas.

The launch marks a major step towards the modernization and digitization of highway infrastructure in Rajasthan.

Following the successful implementation at Daulatpura, NHAI plans to convert **Shahjahanpur Toll**

Plaza and **Manoharpur Toll Plaza** into Multi-Lane Free Flow tolling facilities.

429. As per the news, Indian-origin theoretical physicist Jainendra Kumar Jain, who became the first person of Indian origin to receive the Wolf Prize in Physics, was honoured for discovering which concept?

A.Quantum Entanglement States

B.Higgs Boson Mechanism

C.Bose–Einstein Condensates

D.Composite Fermions

E.Gravitational Wave Resonance

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

Indian-origin theoretical physicist **Jainendra Kumar Jain** became the first person of Indian origin to receive the prestigious **Wolf Prize in Physics**.

He was honoured for his groundbreaking discovery of **composite fermions**, a revolutionary concept that transformed the understanding of the **Fractional Quantum Hall Effect** and opened new avenues in quantum physics research.

The award was presented by Israeli President **Isaac Herzog** at a state ceremony in **Jerusalem, Israel**.

Detailed Explanation:

Indian-origin theoretical physicist **Jainendra Kumar Jain** became the first person of Indian origin to receive the prestigious **Wolf Prize in Physics**.

He was honoured for his groundbreaking discovery of **composite fermions**, a revolutionary concept that transformed the understanding of the **Fractional Quantum Hall Effect** and opened new avenues in quantum physics research.

The award was presented by Israeli President **Isaac Herzog** at a state ceremony in **Jerusalem, Israel**.

The **Wolf Prize** is regarded as one of the world's most prestigious scientific awards and is often considered a precursor to the **Nobel Prize**, with several Wolf Prize recipients later becoming Nobel laureates.

Jain made the discovery of composite fermions in **1989** while serving as a postdoctoral researcher at **Yale University**.

He proposed that electrons can combine with quantum vortices to form new particles called **composite fermions**, providing a unified explanation for the Fractional Quantum Hall Effect.

430. As of 2026, who became the first Indian to be elected and appointed as the Vice-President of the Financial Action Task Force (FATF)?

A.T. V. Somanathan

B.Ajay Seth

C.Vivek Aggarwal

D.Rajiv Kumar

E.Sanjay Malhotra

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

India achieved a historic milestone as **Shri Vivek Aggarwal** was elected and appointed as the **Vice-President of the Financial Action Task Force (FATF)**.

This is the **first time India will hold the Vice-Presidency of the FATF**, reflecting the country's growing global influence in combating financial crimes.

Vivek Aggarwal is a **1994-batch IAS officer** of the Madhya Pradesh cadre and is currently serving as **Secretary, Ministry of Culture, Government of India**.

Detailed Explanation:

India achieved a historic milestone as **Shri Vivek Aggarwal** was elected and appointed as the **Vice-President of the Financial Action Task Force (FATF)**.

This is the **first time India will hold the Vice-Presidency of the FATF**, reflecting the country's growing global influence in combating financial crimes.

Vivek Aggarwal is a **1994-batch IAS officer** of the Madhya Pradesh cadre and is currently serving as **Secretary, Ministry of Culture, Government of India**.

He was elected by the **FATF Plenary**, the highest decision-making body of the FATF.

His tenure as FATF Vice-President will be from **July 2026 to June 2027**.

The **Vice-President of FATF** assists the President in guiding the organization's work and implementing its **global mandate**.

431. As per the RBI approval in June 2026, whose tenure as Interim Part-Time Chairman of HDFC Bank Limited was extended until 18 September 2026?

A.Atanu Chakraborty

B.Sashidhar Jagdishan

C.Kaizad Bharucha

D.Deepak Parekh

E.Keki Mistry

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** approved the extension of **Keki Mistry's** tenure as **Interim Part-Time Chairman** of **HDFC Bank Limited** for an additional three months, valid until **18 September 2026**.

The extension allows him to continue in the role until the appointment of a **permanent non-executive part-time chairman**, or until the tenure ends, whichever is earlier.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** approved the extension of **Keki Mistry's** tenure as **Interim Part-Time Chairman** of **HDFC Bank Limited** for an additional three months, valid until **18 September 2026**.

The extension allows him to continue in the role until the appointment of a **permanent non-executive part-time chairman**, or until the tenure ends, whichever is earlier.

Keki Mistry was initially appointed as Interim Part-Time Chairman of HDFC Bank with effect from **19 March 2026**, after RBI approval for a three-month tenure ending **19 June 2026**.

He succeeded **Atanu Chakraborty**, who stepped down as Chairman on **18 March 2026**.
Keki Mistry previously served as the **Vice Chairman and CEO of HDFC Limited** and later as **Vice Chairman of HDFC Bank Limited**.
Under RBI norms, the bank chairman must be a **non-executive and independent director**, ensuring governance compliance.

432. As per the news, renowned Indian jurist Bimal N. Patel has been elected as a Judge of which international judicial body for the 2026–2035 term?

A.International Court of Justice (ICJ)
B.International Tribunal for the Law of the Sea (ITLOS)
C.Permanent Court of Arbitration (PCA)
D.International Criminal Court (ICC)
E.World Trade Organization Appellate Body
Answer: B
Short Explanation:
Renowned Indian jurist **Bimal N. Patel** has been elected as a **Judge of the International Tribunal for the Law of the Sea (ITLOS)** for the **2026–2035 term**.
He will **assume office on 1 October 2026**, succeeding **Neeru Chadha**, whose nine-year tenure ends in September 2026.
Detailed Explanation:
Renowned Indian jurist **Bimal N. Patel** has been elected as a **Judge of the International Tribunal for the Law of the Sea (ITLOS)** for the **2026–2035 term**.
He will **assume office on 1 October 2026**, succeeding **Neeru Chadha**, whose nine-year tenure ends in September 2026.
The election took place during the **36th Meeting of States Parties to the United Nations Convention on the Law of the Sea (UNCLOS)** held at the UN Headquarters in New York, USA.
A total of **7 new judges** were elected to ITLOS from among **172 UNCLOS signatory countries**, representing India, Vietnam, Ghana, Tunisia, Russia, Brazil, and the Netherlands.

433. As per the approval of the Appointments Committee of the Cabinet (ACC) in 2026, who has been appointed as the Chairperson of the National Statistical Commission (NSC)?

A.Shubhabrata Das
B.Madhavan Mukund
C.Satyendra Bahadur Singh
D.Saibal Chattopadhyay
E.Bibek Debroy
Answer: D
Short Explanation:
The **Appointments Committee of the Cabinet (ACC)** approved the appointment of **Saibal Chattopadhyay**, former Director of Indian Institute of Management (IIM), Calcutta, West Bengal (WB), as the **Chairperson of the National Statistical Commission (NSC)** under the **Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI)**.
Along with him, **Shubhabrata Das**, **Satyendra Bahadur Singh**, and **Madhavan Mukund** have

been appointed as **part-time members** to strengthen the NSC's operational capacity.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Appointments Committee of the Cabinet (ACC)** approved the appointment of **Saibal Chattopadhyay**, former Director of Indian Institute of Management (IIM), Calcutta, West Bengal (WB), as the **Chairperson of the National Statistical Commission (NSC)** under the **Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI)**.

Along with him, **Shubhabrata Das**, **Satyendra Bahadur Singh**, and **Madhavan Mukund** have been appointed as **part-time members** to strengthen the NSC's operational capacity.

The **National Statistical Commission (NSC)** was established by the Government of India through a resolution dated **1 June 2005** and became operational on **12 July 2006**, based on the recommendations of the **Rangarajan Commission (2001)**.

The NSC is structured with a **part-time Chairperson**, **four part-time technical members**, **one permanent ex-officio member**, and a **Secretary**.

The Commission is responsible for **formulating policies and standards** for India's statistical system.

434. As per the news, the Ministry of Defence signed a contract worth approximately ₹425 crore for the procurement of 12 sets of 1.25 MW Marine Gas Turbine Generators with which company?

A.Hindustan Aeronautics Limited (HAL)

B.Bharat Electronics Limited (BEL)

C.Bharat Forge Limited

D.Garden Reach Shipbuilders & Engineers (GRSE)

E.Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders Limited (MDL)

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The **Ministry of Defence (MoD)** signed a contract with **Bharat Forge Limited, Pune** for the acquisition of **12 sets of 1.25 MW Marine Gas Turbine Generators** for the **Indian Navy**.

The total value of the contract is approximately **₹425 crore**, signed under the **Buy (Indian) category**.

The contract mandates a **minimum of 60% indigenous content**, promoting **Aatmanirbhar Bharat** and **Make in India** initiatives.

The agreement was signed in the presence of **Defence Secretary Shri Rajesh Kumar Singh** in New Delhi on **19 June 2026**.

Detailed Explanation:

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The agreement was signed in the presence of **Defence Secretary Shri Rajesh Kumar Singh** in New Delhi on **19 June 2026**.

The project aims to **strengthen domestic defence manufacturing capability** and develop a **robust indigenous marine technology ecosystem**.

The **marine gas turbine generator** acts as a **critical power source for modern naval combat ships**, supporting combat systems, weapons, and sensors.

The initiative enhances **maritime self-reliance** in strategic defence technologies and improves the **operational readiness of the Indian Navy**.

It provides **end-to-end life-cycle support** for naval platforms through **indigenous production**.

435. As per the news, the three indigenously built naval platforms—Dunagiri, Sanshodhak, and Agray—have been constructed by which shipbuilding company?

A.Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders Limited (MDL)

B.Cochin Shipyard Limited (CSL)

C.Hindustan Shipyard Limited (HSL)

D.Garden Reach Shipbuilders & Engineers (GRSE)

E.Goa Shipyard Limited (GSL)

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

The **Indian Navy** is set to commission **three indigenously built frontline warships—Dunagiri, Sanshodhak, and Agray**—on **21 June 2026** in Kolkata, in a ceremony to be presided over by the **Hon'ble Prime Minister**.

The three platforms have been designed by the **Indian Navy's Warship Design Bureau** and constructed by **Garden Reach Shipbuilders & Engineers (GRSE), Kolkata**.

These vessels represent key capabilities in **maritime combat, hydrographic surveying, and anti-submarine warfare**, strengthening India's overall **naval operational readiness**.

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These vessels represent key capabilities in **maritime combat, hydrographic surveying, and anti-submarine warfare**, strengthening India's overall **naval operational readiness**.

The commissioning reflects the Navy's focus on enhancing **blue-water operations**, improving **maritime domain awareness**, and **securing coastal waters** against emerging threats.

INS Dunagiri, the fifth **Project 17A stealth frigate**, is equipped with advanced systems including **BrahMos surface-to-surface missiles** and **Medium Range Surface-to-Air**

Missile (MR-SAM), significantly boosting combat capability.

INS Sanshodhak, the fourth **Survey Vessel (Large)**, is designed for **coastal and deep-water hydrographic surveys** and collects oceanographic and geophysical data for both defence and civilian use.

436. As per the news, the Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre (I4C) launched which new portal to enable victims of cyber financial fraud to claim refunds of frozen or recovered money?

A.Cyber Refund Facilitation Portal (CRFP)

B.Grievance Redressal Mechanism (GRM)

C.Financial Fraud Compensation Portal (FFCP)

D.National Cyber Recovery System (NCRS)

E.Money Restoration Module (MRM)

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

The **Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre (I4C)** under the **Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA)** launched two new digital platforms: **Grievance Redressal Mechanism (GRM)** and **Money Restoration Module (MRM)**.

These portals aim to **strengthen coordination** between police forces, banking systems, and the **National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal (NCRP)** for faster cybercrime response.

The initiative was reviewed in a high-level meeting chaired by **Union Home Minister Shri Amit Shah** in New Delhi, focusing on the **National Cyber Crime Helpline 1930**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre (I4C)** under the **Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA)** launched two new digital platforms: **Grievance Redressal Mechanism (GRM)** and **Money Restoration Module (MRM)**.

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The initiative was reviewed in a high-level meeting chaired by **Union Home Minister Shri Amit Shah** in New Delhi, focusing on the **National Cyber Crime Helpline 1930**.

The **GRM portal** is designed to address complaints of **bank account freezing, lien, or hold status** due to suspicious cyber transaction alerts during investigations.

The **MRM portal** provides a mechanism for victims of cyber financial fraud to **claim refund of frozen or recovered money** after filing complaints.

The **National Cyber Crime Helpline 1930** is a key platform for **registering cybercrime and financial fraud complaints** in a quick and simplified manner.

Shri Amit Shah directed that the **1930 system should be upgraded using Artificial Intelligence (AI)** for improved complaint handling, call routing, and efficiency.

He emphasized that **no complaint should remain unattended or pending**, ensuring timely support to every victim.

437. As per the news, scientists from the Zoological Survey of India (ZSI) and the University of Calcutta discovered a new lynx spider species in Meghalaya. What is the name of the newly discovered species?

A.Oxyopes meghalayensis

B.Hamataliwa mawlyngot

C.Peucetia khasiensis

D.Hamataliwa indica

E.Oxyopes mawphlangensis

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Scientists from the **Zoological Survey of India (ZSI)** and the **University of Calcutta, West Bengal** discovered a new **lynx spider species** named **Hamataliwa mawlyngot** in **Meghalaya**.

The species was found in **Mawlyngot village, East Khasi Hills**, marking the **first recorded presence of the genus Hamataliwa in Meghalaya**.

The discovery expands the known distribution of the genus Hamataliwa across Asia, bridging a **key geographical gap** in its range.

The research findings were published in the journal **National Academy Science Letters**.

The new species belongs to the spider family **Oxyopidae (lynx spiders)** and inhabits dense vegetation on hillside slopes with **tea plantations**.

Detailed Explanation:

Scientists from the **Zoological Survey of India (ZSI)** and the **University of Calcutta, West Bengal** discovered a new **lynx spider species** named **Hamataliwa mawlyngot** in **Meghalaya**.

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The research findings were published in the journal **National Academy Science Letters**.

The new species belongs to the spider family **Oxyopidae (lynx spiders)** and inhabits dense vegetation on hillside slopes with **tea plantations**.

Hamataliwa mawlyngot is an **extremely small spider**, smaller than a fingernail, known for **hunting using speed, agility, and sharp vision** instead of web-building.

The species plays an important ecological role as a **natural biological control agent**, helping in the **reduction of agricultural pest populations**.

The discovery highlights the **rich biodiversity of Meghalaya's ecosystem**, especially in biodiversity-rich hillside habitats.

The study was authored by **Souvik Sen, Upasana Bhattacharya, and Puthoor Pattammal Sudhin**.

438. As per the QS World University Rankings 2027, which Indian institution emerged as the highest-ranked Indian

institution, securing the 118th position globally?

A.Indian Institute of Science (IISc), Bengaluru

B.IIT Delhi

C.IIT Madras

D.IIT Bombay

E.Jawaharlal Nehru University (JNU)

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

India secured the **fifth position globally** in the **QS World University Rankings 2027**, with **52 Indian institutions** featuring in the rankings, highlighting the country's growing academic influence, research capabilities and global reputation.

The **Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) Delhi** emerged as the highest-ranked Indian institution, securing the **118th position globally**.

Detailed Explanation:

India secured the **fifth position globally** in the **QS World University Rankings 2027**, with **52 Indian institutions** featuring in the rankings, highlighting the country's growing academic influence, research capabilities and global reputation.

The **QS World University Rankings 2027** evaluated more than **1,500 institutions across 106 countries and territories**, making it one of the world's most comprehensive higher education assessments.

India's representation increased from **14 institutions in 2017** to **52 institutions in 2027**, registering a growth of over **271%** during the last decade.

India is now the **fifth most represented higher education system** in the world after:

United States – 184 institutions

United Kingdom – 93 institutions

China – 85 institutions

Germany – 60 institutions

India – 52 institutions

The **Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) Delhi** emerged as the highest-ranked Indian institution, securing the **118th position globally**.

439. As per the QS World University Rankings 2027, which university secured the 1st rank globally?

A.Stanford University

B.University of Oxford

C.Harvard University

D.Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT)

E.University of Cambridge

Answer: D

Rank	University
1	Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT
2	Stanford University
3	Imperial College London
4	University of Oxford
5	Harvard University

440. As of the FIFA World Cup 2026, which footballer became the first player in history to appear in six FIFA World Cups?

A.Lionel Messi
B.Miroslav Klose
C.Cristiano Ronaldo
D.Luka Modrić
E.Sergio Ramos
Answer: A
Short Explanation:
Argentine football legend Lionel Messi became the first player in history to appear in **six FIFA World Cups** after featuring in Argentina's opening match against Algeria in the **FIFA World Cup 2026**.
Messi celebrated the historic milestone by scoring his **first-ever FIFA World Cup hat-trick**, leading Argentina to a **3–0 victory** over Algeria in their Group J opener.
Detailed Explanation:
Argentine football legend Lionel Messi became the first player in history to appear in **six FIFA World Cups** after featuring in Argentina's opening match against Algeria in the **FIFA World Cup 2026**.
Messi celebrated the historic milestone by scoring his **first-ever FIFA World Cup hat-trick**, leading Argentina to a **3–0 victory** over Algeria in their Group J opener.
The match took place exactly **20 years after Messi made his FIFA World Cup debut** for Argentina in 2006.
With this appearance, Messi surpassed all previous records for World Cup participation and became the first male footballer to feature in six editions of the tournament.
Messi's hat-trick took his FIFA World Cup tally to **16 goals**, equalling the all-time men's FIFA World Cup scoring record held by former German striker **Miroslav Klose**.

441. As per the news, World Music Day, observed annually on 21 June, is also popularly known by which French name?
A.Journée de la Musique
B.Festival de Musique Mondiale
C.Harmonie de la Musique
D.Musique pour Tous
E.Fête de la Musique
Answer: E
World Music Day 2026 is observed across the world on **21 June** to celebrate music, honor musicians and promote the universal language of music.
The day encourages people to perform and enjoy music in public spaces, making music accessible to everyone regardless of age, background or skill level.
World Music Day is also known as **Fête de la Musique**, a French term meaning **"Festival of Music."**

442. As per the news, the proposal to observe the International Day of Yoga was introduced by Prime Minister Narendra Modi during his address to the United Nations General Assembly (UNGA) on_____
A.21 June 2014
B.15 August 2014
C.27 September 2014

D.2 October 2014

E.11 December 2014

Answer: C

International Day of Yoga 2026 is observed across the world on **21 June** to create awareness about the importance of yoga and its benefits for physical, mental and spiritual well-being.

The year **2026 marks the 12th International Day of Yoga**, as the first observance was held in **2015**.

The proposal to observe an International Day of Yoga was introduced by **Prime Minister Narendra Modi** during his address to the **United Nations General Assembly (UNGA)** on **27 September 2014**.

21 June was chosen as it is the **Summer Solstice**, the longest day of the year in the Northern Hemisphere, and holds special significance in many cultures.

The **first International Day of Yoga** was observed worldwide on **21 June 2015**.

443. In news, World Hydrography Day is observed annually on which date to promote awareness about hydrography, maritime safety, and marine environmental conservation?

A.8 June

B.15 June

C.20 June

D.21 June

E.29 June

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

World Hydrography Day 2026 is observed across the world on **21 June** to raise awareness about the importance of **hydrography**, safe navigation, maritime safety and conservation of the marine environment.

Detailed Explanation:

World Hydrography Day 2026 is observed across the world on **21 June** to raise awareness about the importance of **hydrography**, safe navigation, maritime safety and conservation of the marine environment.

In **1970**, the International Hydrographic Bureau was renamed the **International Hydrographic Organization (IHO)**.

In **2005**, the **United Nations General Assembly (UNGA)** adopted a resolution designating **21 June** as **World Hydrography Day**. The first international observance of **World Hydrography Day** was held in **2006**.

444. As per the news, India has been an active member of the International Hydrographic Organization (IHO) since 1955 and is represented nationally by the Indian Naval Hydrographic Department (INHD), which is based in_____city.

A.Mumbai

B.Visakhapatnam

C.Kochi

D.Chennai

E.Kolkata

Answer: E

About International Hydrographic Organization (IHO)

Established: 1921 (as International Hydrographic Bureau)

Renamed as IHO: 1970

Headquarters: Monaco

I**ndia has been an active member of the IHO since 1955**, represented nationally by the Indian Naval Hydrographic Department (INHD) based in Kolkata

445. As per the reforms approved by SEBI at its 214th Board Meeting, a new Code of Conduct was adopted primarily to strengthen which of the following?

A.Foreign portfolio investment limits

B.IPO pricing regulations

C.Conflict-of-interest and disclosure norms

D.Corporate tax compliance requirements

E.Mutual fund distribution guidelines

Answer: C

The **Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI)** approved a set of **market reforms** at the **214th SEBI Board Meeting,** aimed at improving efficiency, transparency, investor convenience, and regulatory compliance in India's capital markets.

SEBI has also approved reforms for **securitised debt instruments** in line with RBI guidelines.

Measures were introduced to strengthen the **municipal bond market**, including **refinancing and pooled financing mechanisms**.

The regulator reviewed the **SME capital-raising framework for FY 2026–27** to improve fundraising efficiency for small businesses.

A new **Code of Conduct for SEBI members and employees** was adopted to strengthen **conflict-of-interest and disclosure norms**.

446. In June 2026, the Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (IRDAI) constituted a 7-member Working Group on Artificial Intelligence (WG-AI). Who has been appointed as its Chairperson?

A.Deepak Gaikwad

B.Prof. Sandeep K. Shukla

C.Debasish Panda

D.Nandan Nilekani

E.Amitabh Kant

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (IRDAI) constituted a **7-member Working Group on Artificial Intelligence (WG-AI)** under the chairmanship of **Prof. Sandeep K. Shukla, Director of IIIT Hyderabad**, to guide adoption, governance, and oversight of **AI technologies in the insurance sector**.

The WG-AI comprises a total of **7 members including the chairperson and 6 members**, with **Deepak Gaikwad (GM & CISO, IRDAI)** appointed as **Member-Convener**.

Detailed Explanation:

Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (IRDAI) constituted a **7-member Working Group on Artificial Intelligence (WG-AI)** under the chairmanship of **Prof. Sandeep K. Shukla, Director of IIIT Hyderabad**, to guide adoption, governance, and oversight of **AI technologies in the insurance sector**.

The WG-AI comprises a total of **7 members including the chairperson and 6 members**, with **Deepak Gaikwad (GM & CISO, IRDAI)** appointed as **Member-Convener**.

The Working Group on AI will **assess AI adoption and maturity** in the insurance sector, **review global AI regulatory practices**, and recommend an **ethical, transparent AI governance framework** for applications such as **claims management and fraud prevention**.

The WG-AI has been mandated to **submit its recommendations to the Member (Finance and Investment, F&I) within 3 months** from its formation.

The IRDAI aims to ensure that AI adoption in the insurance sector is **fair, transparent, resilient, and protects policyholders' data** at all times.

447. In June 2026, Chennai Petroleum Corporation Limited (CPCL) was granted Navratna CPSE status. With this upgradation, CPCL became which numbered Navratna Central Public Sector Enterprise (CPSE) in India?

A.25th

B.26th

C.27th

D.28th

E.29th

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

The **Department of Public Enterprises (DPE), Ministry of Finance (MoF)** has upgraded **Chennai Petroleum Corporation Limited (CPCL)** from **Miniratna Category-I to Navratna Central Public Sector Enterprise (CPSE) status**.

The approval was granted by **Union Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman**.

With this upgradation, **CPCL becomes India's 28th Navratna CPSE**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Department of Public Enterprises (DPE), Ministry of Finance (MoF)** has upgraded **Chennai Petroleum Corporation Limited (CPCL)** from **Miniratna Category-I to Navratna Central Public Sector Enterprise (CPSE) status**.

The approval was granted by **Union Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman**.

With this upgradation, **CPCL becomes India's 28th Navratna CPSE**.

In **FY 2025–26**, CPCL recorded a **turnover of ₹59,400 crore** and a **net profit of ₹3,062 crore**, showing a major rise from ₹174 crore in the previous year.

The company's **revenue increased to ₹78,611 crore**, up from ₹71,050 crore in **FY 2024–25**.

The **Navratna status** provides CPSEs with **enhanced financial and operational autonomy**.

As a Navratna company, CPCL can now **invest up to ₹1,000 crore or 15% of its net worth** in a single project **without prior government approval**.

It can also **invest up to 30% of net worth annually**, subject to a maximum ceiling of **₹1,000 crore**.

Navratna CPSEs are allowed to undertake **capital expenditure for new projects or replacement without monetary ceiling restrictions**.

They can also **enter into technology joint ventures and strategic alliances** to expand business operations.

448. In June 2026, BSE Index Services launched India's first "BSE Saatvik 100 Index". The constituents of this index are selected from which broader index?

A.BSE Sensex

B.BSE 500

C.BSE 200

D.BSE 100

E.BSE MidCap

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

BSE Index Services Private Limited, a wholly-owned subsidiary of **Bombay Stock Exchange (BSE)**, launched India's first **"Saatvik 100 Index"** to promote **ethical and value-based investing**.

BSE is **Asia's oldest exchange** and the **world's largest exchange** in terms of number of listed companies.

The new index is named **"BSE Saatvik 100"** and is designed to promote **ethical investing based on Saatvik principles**.

The index is derived from the constituents of the **BSE 500 Index**, selecting companies aligned with **ethical and value-based principles**.

Detailed Explanation:

BSE Index Services Private Limited, a wholly-owned subsidiary of **Bombay Stock Exchange (BSE)**, launched India's first **"Saatvik 100 Index"** to promote **ethical and value-based investing**.

BSE is **Asia's oldest exchange** and the **world's largest exchange** in terms of number of listed companies.

The new index is named **"BSE Saatvik 100"** and is designed to promote **ethical investing based on Saatvik principles**.

The index is derived from the constituents of the **BSE 500 Index**, selecting companies aligned with **ethical and value-based principles**.

The objective is to provide investors a new avenue for investing in companies that follow **responsible and ethical business practices**.

The index has a **base value of 1000**, with the first value date set as **20 June 2005**.

It will be **reconstituted every 6 months**, in **June and December** each year.

The **"Saatvik" concept** represents **purity, responsibility, and ethical conduct** in business practices.

The index aligns with the growing trend of **ESG (Environmental, Social, and Governance) investing**.

449. In June 2026, Federal Bank launched the FCNR Max Deposit Scheme for NRIs. What interest rate does the scheme offer on USD-denominated deposits with a tenure of 3–5 years?

A.5.25% per annum

B.5.75% per annum

C.6.00% per annum

D.6.50% per annum

E.6.25% per annum

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

Federal Bank Limited launched the **FCNR Max Deposit Scheme**, a special **Foreign Currency Non-Resident (Bank) [FCNR(B)] deposit product** for **Non-Resident Indians (NRIs)**.

The scheme offers an attractive interest rate of **6.25% per annum on USD-denominated deposits** with a tenure of **3–5 years**.

The objective of the scheme is to provide NRIs a **secure and high-yield foreign currency investment option** while **boosting foreign currency inflows** into India.

Detailed Explanation:

Federal Bank Limited launched the **FCNR Max Deposit Scheme**, a special **Foreign Currency Non-Resident (Bank) [FCNR(B)] deposit product** for **Non-Resident Indians (NRIs)**.

The scheme offers an attractive interest rate of **6.25% per annum on USD-denominated deposits** with a tenure of **3–5 years**.

The objective of the scheme is to provide NRIs a **secure and high-yield foreign currency investment option** while **boosting foreign currency inflows** into India.

The scheme is **valid until 30 September 2026** and was introduced following **RBI FCNR(B) swap facility and regulatory relaxations**.

The scheme benefits from regulatory relaxations including **CRR (Cash Reserve Ratio) and SLR (Statutory Liquidity Ratio) exemptions**.

The scheme is exclusively available for NRIs, with a **minimum deposit requirement of USD 500**.

It offers **uniform interest rates**, applicable even for deposits **above USD 1 million**.

A **one-year lock-in period** is applicable from the date of account opening, during which **premature withdrawal is not allowed**.

450. In June 2026, four traditional products of Assam received the Geographical Indication (GI) Tag. With these additions, how many NABARD-supported GI-certified products does Assam have?

A.8

B.10

C.12

D.14

E.16

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

Four traditional products of Assam — **Karbi Anglong Handloom Products, Assam Bihu Pepa, Assam Bamboo Crafts and Deuri Handloom Products** — have received the prestigious **Geographical Indication (GI) Tag**. The recognition highlights Assam's rich cultural heritage, traditional craftsmanship and indigenous knowledge systems while promoting the preservation of unique regional products. With these additions, the number of **National Bank for Agriculture and Rural Development (NABARD)**-supported GI-certified products in Assam has increased to **12**.

Detailed Explanation:

Four traditional products of Assam — **Karbi Anglong Handloom Products, Assam Bihu Pepa, Assam Bamboo Crafts and Deuri Handloom Products** — have received the prestigious **Geographical Indication (GI) Tag**. The recognition highlights Assam's rich cultural heritage, traditional craftsmanship and indigenous knowledge systems while promoting the preservation of unique regional products. With these additions, the number of **National Bank for Agriculture and Rural Development (NABARD)**-supported GI-certified products in Assam has increased to **12**.

Karbi Anglong Handloom Products represent the weaving traditions of the Karbi community and are known for their distinctive designs, vibrant colours and traditional weaving techniques passed down through generations.

Assam Bihu Pepa is a traditional musical instrument made from buffalo horn and is an integral part of the state's famous Bihu festival, symbolising Assam's rich folk culture.

Assam Bamboo Crafts showcase the skills of local artisans who create a variety of utility and decorative products using bamboo, reflecting sustainable and eco-friendly traditional practices.

Deuri Handloom Products are known for their intricate weaving patterns and traditional motifs that preserve the textile heritage of the Deuri community.

A **Geographical Indication (GI) Tag** is an intellectual property right granted to products that possess unique qualities, characteristics or reputation linked to a specific geographical region.

451. In June 2026, Prime Minister Narendra Modi participated in the 52nd G7 Summit in France. This marked India's how many-th participation as a partner country in the G7 Summit?

A.10th

B.11th

C.12th

D.13th

E.15th

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

The **52nd Group of Seven (G7) Summit** was held from **15–17 June 2026** in **Évian-les-Bains, Haute-Savoie, France**, under the **French Presidency** led by **President Emmanuel Macron**.

The summit was conducted under the theme **"Working Together to Address Major International Challenges"** focusing on **global cooperation in energy, peace, and security**.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi represented India, marking India's **13th participation** as a partner country in the G7 Summit.

Detailed Explanation:

The **52nd Group of Seven (G7) Summit** was held from **15–17 June 2026** in **Évian-les-Bains, Haute-Savoie, France**, under the **French Presidency** led by **President Emmanuel Macron**.

The summit was conducted under the theme **"Working Together to Address Major International Challenges"** focusing on **global cooperation in energy, peace, and security**.

The G7 Summit 2026 brought together leaders of the **world's major advanced economies** to address key global issues.

Major focus areas of the French Presidency included **reducing macroeconomic imbalances**, **strengthening critical mineral value chains**, **resolving geopolitical crises**, and **combating organised crime**.

India participated as a **partner country** at the G7 Summit 2026 on the invitation of French President Emmanuel Macron.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi represented India, marking India's **13th participation** as a partner country in the G7 Summit.

One of the key outcomes was the adoption of the **"Leaders' Declaration on Tackling Migrant Smuggling"** to address migrant smuggling and human trafficking.

452. In June 2026, who was appointed by the Department of Financial Services (DFS) to hold additional charge as Managing Director (MD) & Chief Executive Officer (CEO) of UCO Bank?

A.Ashwani Kumar

B.Rajendra Kumar Saboo

C.Atul Kumar Goel

D.Binod Kumar

E.A. Manimekhalai

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The **Department of Financial Services (DFS), Ministry of Finance (MoF)** approved the appointment of **Rajendra Kumar Saboo**, Executive Director (ED) of UCO Bank, to hold **additional charge as Managing Director (MD) & Chief Executive Officer (CEO)** of the bank.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Department of Financial Services (DFS), Ministry of Finance (MoF)** approved the appointment of **Rajendra Kumar Saboo**, Executive Director (ED) of UCO Bank, to hold **additional charge as Managing Director**

(MD) & Chief Executive Officer (CEO) of the bank.

He assumed charge with effect from **19 June 2026** and will continue until **31 August 2026**, or until a regular MD & CEO is appointed, or until further orders.

The appointment was made following the completion of the tenure of former MD & CEO **Ashwani Kumar** on **31 May 2026**.

Rajendra Kumar Saboo is a career banker who began his professional journey as a **Probationary Officer (PO)** in the erstwhile **Oriental Bank of Commerce in 1994**.

He has **extensive experience** in field and administrative banking operations across multiple roles.

453. In June 2026, Kalyani Strategic Systems Limited (KSSL) signed a strategic partnership with AM General (USA) to jointly develop and market which defence system for global markets?

A.105 mm Towed Artillery Gun System

B.155 mm Mounted Artillery Gun System

C.Anti-Tank Guided Missile System

D.Short-Range Air Defence System

E.Multiple Rocket Launch System

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Kalyani Strategic Systems Limited (KSSL), a subsidiary of **Bharat Forge Limited (BFL)**, signed a **strategic partnership** with **AM General (USA)** at **Eurosatory 2026, Paris** (15–19 June 2026) for **defence cooperation**.

The collaboration aims to jointly **develop and market next-generation 155 mm mounted artillery gun systems** for global defence markets, enhancing **mobile firepower** and supporting **military modernisation**.

Detailed Explanation:

Kalyani Strategic Systems Limited (KSSL), a subsidiary of **Bharat Forge Limited (BFL)**, signed a **strategic partnership** with **AM General (USA)** at **Eurosatory 2026, Paris** (15–19 June 2026) for **defence cooperation**.

The collaboration aims to jointly **develop and market next-generation 155 mm mounted artillery gun systems** for global defence markets, enhancing **mobile firepower** and supporting **military modernisation**.

The platform is based on **KSSL's Mounted Artillery Gun (MARG) system** integrated with **AM General's mobility platforms and vehicle expertise**.

The system features a **52-calibre 155 mm cannon**, **Soft Recoil Technology (SRT)**, **automated loading assistance**, and **advanced fire-control systems** for both direct and indirect fire missions.

The technology helps **reduce vehicle weight, mechanical stress**, and **improves operational efficiency**.

454. In June 2026, the Indian Coast Guard celebrated the 12th International Day of Yoga through "Yoga Sangam 2026". What was the theme of International Day of Yoga 2026?

A.Yoga for Humanity

B.Yoga for Wellness

C.Yoga for One Earth, One Health

D.Yoga for Healthy Ageing

E.Yoga for Sustainable Living

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

The **Indian Coast Guard (ICG)** celebrated the **12th International Day of Yoga (IDY) 2026** through its flagship initiative **"Yoga Sangam 2026."**

The theme of International Day of Yoga 2026 was **"Yoga for Healthy Ageing."**

The celebrations highlighted the role of yoga in promoting **holistic health, resilience, fitness, and well-being** across all age groups.

Coordinated yoga sessions were conducted across **all ICG ships and establishments** throughout the country.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Indian Coast Guard (ICG)** celebrated the **12th International Day of Yoga (IDY) 2026** through its flagship initiative **"Yoga Sangam 2026."**

The theme of International Day of Yoga 2026 was **"Yoga for Healthy Ageing."**

The celebrations highlighted the role of yoga in promoting **holistic health, resilience, fitness, and well-being** across all age groups.

Coordinated yoga sessions were conducted across **all ICG ships and establishments** throughout the country.

Thousands of Coast Guard personnel and their family members participated in the nationwide yoga programme.

The sessions were led by **trained yoga instructors** and included **asanas** (yogic postures), **pranayama** (breathing techniques), and **meditation practices**.

Special emphasis was placed on incorporating yoga into daily life to improve **physical fitness, mental clarity, emotional balance, stress management, and operational resilience**.

455. In June 2026, Indian Naval Ship (INS) Tarkash arrived at Port Louis during its operational deployment in the South West Indian Ocean Region. INS Tarkash visited which country?

A.Seychelles

B.Madagascar

C.Mauritius

D.Maldives

E.Sri Lanka

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

Indian Naval Ship (INS) Tarkash, a stealth frigate of the Indian Navy, arrived at **Port Louis, Mauritius**, on **20 June 2026** during its operational deployment in the **South West Indian Ocean Region**.

The visit is aimed at **strengthening maritime cooperation and enhancing bilateral relations** between India and Mauritius.

Detailed Explanation:

Indian Naval Ship (INS) Tarkash, a stealth frigate of the Indian Navy, arrived at **Port Louis, Mauritius**, on **20 June 2026** during its

operational deployment in the **South West Indian Ocean Region**.

The visit is aimed at **strengthening maritime cooperation and enhancing bilateral relations** between India and Mauritius.

Captain Rohit Mishra, the Commanding Officer of INS Tarkash, will call on senior **Government of Mauritius and Mauritius Coast Guard officials** during the port visit.

INS Tarkash will conduct **professional training capsules** for personnel of the **Mauritius National Coast Guard**.

The training programme focuses on **harbour watchkeeping, sea watchkeeping, firefighting, damage control, maritime safety, and seamanship**.

The initiative reflects **India's commitment to capacity building and capability enhancement** of friendly maritime forces in the **Indian Ocean Region (IOR)**.

456. In June 2026, NAFED launched the DRISHTI Portal and ERP Portal along with the NAFEX.in Auction Portal. Which of the following is correctly matched?

A.DRISHTI Portal – Crop Insurance Management; ERP Portal – Soil Health Monitoring

B.DRISHTI Portal – Inventory Management of Pulses & Oilseeds; ERP Portal – Enterprise Resource Planning and Operational Efficiency

C.DRISHTI Portal – Agricultural Export Promotion; ERP Portal – Farmer Scholarship Management

D.DRISHTI Portal – Fertilizer Distribution Tracking; ERP Portal – Warehouse Construction Monitoring

E.DRISHTI Portal – MSP Payment Processing; ERP Portal – Weather Forecasting Services

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Union Home Minister and Minister of Cooperation Amit Shah will launch **NAFED's auction portal 'NAFEX.in'** on **23 June 2026** at **Atal Akshay Urja Bhawan, New Delhi**. **Union Agriculture and Farmers Welfare Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan** will also attend the launch event.

The **DRISHTI Portal** has been developed for **inventory management of pulses and oilseeds**.

The **ERP Portal** is designed to strengthen **enterprise resource planning and operational efficiency** within NAFED.

Detailed Explanation:

Union Home Minister and Minister of Cooperation Amit Shah will launch **NAFED's auction portal 'NAFEX.in'** on **23 June 2026** at **Atal Akshay Urja Bhawan, New Delhi**. **Union Agriculture and Farmers Welfare Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan** will also attend the launch event.

The programme will be attended by **NAFED Chairman Jethabhai Ahir**, **Managing Director Deepak Agarwal**, and other senior officials.

During the event, **Amit Shah** will launch several **digital and farmer-centric initiatives** of NAFED.

Key initiatives include the **NAFEX.in Auction Portal**, **NAFED-KALYAN Scholarship Scheme**, **DRISHTI Portal**, and **ERP (Enterprise Resource Planning) Portal**.

NAFED-KALYAN is a scholarship initiative aimed at **supporting the education of farmers' children**.

The **DRISHTI Portal** has been developed for **inventory management of pulses and oilseeds**.

The **ERP Portal** is designed to strengthen **enterprise resource planning and operational efficiency** within NAFED.

457. In June 2026, India's first digital repository of space-sector capabilities, the "Indian Space Industry E-Catalogue", was launched at the 5th Indian Space Congress. Which organization developed this e-catalogue?

A.ISRO

B.IN-SPACe

C.NewSpace India Limited (NSIL)

D.Satcom Industry Association (SIA-India)

E.Antrix Corporation

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

India's first digital repository of space-sector capabilities, named the **"Indian Space Industry E-Catalogue"**, was launched at the **5th Indian Space Congress (ISC) 2026** held in **New Delhi** (June 15–17, 2026).

The platform is a **comprehensive digital database** developed by **Satcom Industry Association (SIA-India)**, covering **over 200 verified space and defence companies** across nearly **20 domains and 120+ sub-domains**.

Detailed Explanation:

India's first digital repository of space-sector capabilities, named the **"Indian Space Industry E-Catalogue"**, was launched at the **5th Indian Space Congress (ISC) 2026** held in **New Delhi** (June 15–17, 2026).

The initiative aims to create a **single, trusted platform for capability discovery, collaboration, and business development** across the Indian space ecosystem.

The platform is a **comprehensive digital database** developed by **Satcom Industry Association (SIA-India)**, covering **over 200 verified space and defence companies** across nearly **20 domains and 120+ sub-domains**.

The e-catalogue strengthens **India's space-tech ecosystem** by enabling **better industry connectivity, innovation, and partnerships**.

The event also saw the **launch of two important reports**.

The first report titled **"Building India's On-Orbit Servicing and Refuelling Ecosystem: Policy, Partnerships, and Pathways Forward"** was developed in collaboration with **OrbitAID**, focusing on **on-orbit satellite servicing capabilities**.

458. In June 2026, which university became the first in India to receive four ISO Management System Certifications

simultaneously from the Bureau of Indian Standards (BIS)?

A.University of Hyderabad

B.Jawaharlal Nehru University

C.Osmania University

D.Banaras Hindu University

E.Anna University

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

Osmania University, Hyderabad (Telangana) became the **first university in India** to receive **four ISO Management System Certifications simultaneously** from the **Bureau of Indian Standards (BIS)** under the Ministry of Consumer Affairs, Food and Public Distribution (MoCAF&PD).

The four certifications include **ISO 21001:2018** (Educational Organisations Management System – EOMS), **ISO 14001:2015** (Environmental Management System – EMS), **ISO 50001:2018** (Energy Management System – EnMS), and **ISO 22000:2018** (Food Safety Management System – FSMS).

Detailed Explanation:

Osmania University, Hyderabad (Telangana) became the **first university in India** to receive **four ISO Management System Certifications simultaneously** from the **Bureau of Indian Standards (BIS)** under the Ministry of Consumer Affairs, Food and Public Distribution (MoCAF&PD).

The four certifications include **ISO 21001:2018** (Educational Organisations Management System – EOMS), **ISO 14001:2015** (Environmental Management System – EMS), **ISO 50001:2018** (Energy Management System – EnMS), and **ISO 22000:2018** (Food Safety Management System – FSMS).

The certification reflects the university's commitment to **quality education, environmental sustainability, energy efficiency, food safety**, and **global management standards**.

The **Certificates of Grant of Licence** were presented at the Senate Hall of Osmania University by **Sandeep Kumar Kanojia**, Scientist-F and Deputy Director General (Southern Region), BIS.

The certifications were granted after a **comprehensive evaluation of management systems and processes** by BIS.

459. In June 2026, India and Japan adopted the Rules of Implementation for the Joint Crediting Mechanism (JCM). The JCM operates under which Article of the Paris Agreement?

A.Article 6.2

B.Article 5.2

C.Article 4.1

D.Article 7.1

E.Article 13.2

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

India and Japan have adopted the **Rules of Implementation for the Joint Crediting**

Mechanism (JCM) under **Article 6.2 of the Paris Agreement**, strengthening bilateral cooperation on climate action.

The adoption of these rules provides a structured framework for implementing climate mitigation projects and supporting the climate goals of both countries.

The **Joint Crediting Mechanism (JCM)** is a bilateral carbon market cooperation framework that facilitates projects aimed at reducing or removing greenhouse gas emissions.

Detailed Explanation:

India and Japan have adopted the **Rules of Implementation for the Joint Crediting Mechanism (JCM)** under **Article 6.2 of the Paris Agreement**, strengthening bilateral cooperation on climate action.

The adoption of these rules provides a structured framework for implementing climate mitigation projects and supporting the climate goals of both countries.

The **Joint Crediting Mechanism (JCM)** is a bilateral carbon market cooperation framework that facilitates projects aimed at reducing or removing greenhouse gas emissions.

Under this mechanism, one country supports low-carbon projects in another country through **investment, technology transfer and capacity building**.

The emission reductions achieved through these projects are quantified and shared between participating countries as carbon credits.

India and Japan signed a **Memorandum of Cooperation (MoC)** on the Joint Crediting Mechanism in **2025**, laying the foundation for climate collaboration under the Paris Agreement.

460. In June 2026, India agreed to begin negotiations on a General Security of Information Agreement (GSOIA) and accelerate efforts to conclude the Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement (CEPA) with which country?

A.Australia

B.United Kingdom

C.Germany

D.France

E.Canada

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

India and Canada have agreed to begin negotiations on a **General Security of Information Agreement (GSOIA)** and accelerate efforts to conclude the **Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement (CEPA)** in **2026**.

The decision was announced following talks between **Prime Minister Narendra Modi** and **Canadian Prime Minister Mark Carney** on the sidelines of the **G7 Summit**.

Detailed Explanation:

India and Canada have agreed to begin negotiations on a **General Security of Information Agreement (GSOIA)** and accelerate efforts to conclude the **Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement (CEPA)** in **2026**.

The decision was announced following talks between **Prime Minister Narendra Modi** and **Canadian Prime Minister Mark Carney** on the sidelines of the **G7 Summit**.

The discussions marked an important step towards strengthening bilateral cooperation in trade, security, technology, energy and strategic affairs.

The proposed **General Security of Information Agreement (GSOIA)** will provide a framework for the secure exchange, handling and protection of classified information between the two countries.

The agreement is expected to facilitate deeper cooperation in defence technology, intelligence sharing, strategic planning and national security matters.

GSOIA is considered a foundational arrangement for enhancing defence and security partnerships between countries.

Both nations also reaffirmed their commitment to conclude the **Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement (CEPA)** in 2026.

461. In June 2026, which Indian cricketer became the first player in the history of men's and women's cricket to play 200 Twenty20 International (T20I) matches?

A.Smriti Mandhana

B.Mithali Raj

C.Harmanpreet Kaur

D.Deepti Sharma

E.Shafali Verma

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

Indian captain **Harmanpreet Kaur** has created history by becoming the first cricketer, in both men's and women's cricket, to play **200 Twenty20 International (T20I)** matches.

She achieved the milestone during India's match against **South Africa** in the **International Cricket Council (ICC) Women's T20 World Cup 2026** at **Old Trafford, Manchester**.

Detailed Explanation:

Indian captain **Harmanpreet Kaur** has created history by becoming the first cricketer, in both men's and women's cricket, to play **200 Twenty20 International (T20I)** matches.

She achieved the milestone during India's match against **South Africa** in the **International Cricket Council (ICC) Women's T20 World Cup 2026** at **Old Trafford, Manchester**.

With this appearance, Harmanpreet surpassed all male and female cricketers to become the first player to reach the landmark of 200 T20I matches.

Before the match, she was felicitated by India's head coach **Amol Muzumdar** and vice-captain **Smriti Mandhana**, who presented her with a special jersey and commemorative cap bearing the number "200".

Harmanpreet began her international career with a **One Day International (ODI)** debut against Pakistan in **March 2009**.

She made her **Twenty20 International (T20I)** debut against England at Taunton in **June 2009**.

462. As per the news, International Widows' Day is observed every year on which date to raise awareness about the challenges faced by widows and their children worldwide?

A.21 June

B.22 June

C.23 June

D.24 June

E.25 June

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

International Widows' Day is observed every year on **23 June** to raise awareness about the challenges, discrimination and hardships faced by widows and their children across the world.

International Widows' Day was first established in **2005** by the Loomba Foundation.

Detailed Explanation:

International Widows' Day is observed every year on **23 June** to raise awareness about the challenges, discrimination and hardships faced by widows and their children across the world.

International Widows' Day was first established in **2005** by the Loomba Foundation.

The day was chosen in memory of the foundation founder's mother, who became a widow on **23 June 1954**.

The initiative sought to bring global attention to the social and economic difficulties faced by widows in many parts of the world.

The **United Nations General Assembly** officially recognized **23 June as International Widows' Day in 2010**.

463. In the news, United Nations Public Service Day is observed every year on which date?

A.21 June

B.22 June

C.23 June

D.24 June

E.25 June

Answer: C

United Nations Public Service Day is observed every year on **23 June** to recognize the value and importance of public service in society.

The **United Nations General Assembly** proclaimed **23 June as United Nations Public Service Day** through **Resolution 57/277**, adopted on **20 December 2002**.

464. Recently, United Nations Public Service Day is observed annually on 23 June, while the first International Olympic Day was celebrated in which year?

A.1945

B.1946

C.1947

D.1948

E.1949

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

International Olympic Day is observed every year on **23 June** to promote sports, physical activity and the Olympic values of excellence, friendship and respect.

The **first Olympic Day** was celebrated on **23 June 1948** by nine countries: **Belgium, Canada, Greece, Portugal, Switzerland, Austria, the United Kingdom, Uruguay and Venezuela**.

Detailed Explanation:

International Olympic Day is observed every year on **23 June** to promote sports, physical activity and the Olympic values of excellence, friendship and respect.

The idea of celebrating Olympic Day was proposed in **1947** during the **41st Session of the International Olympic Committee (IOC)** held in Stockholm, Sweden.

The proposal was approved at the next IOC Session held in **St. Moritz, Switzerland**, in January 1948.

The date **23 June** was chosen to commemorate the establishment of the **International Olympic Committee (IOC)** on **23 June 1894**.

The **first Olympic Day** was celebrated on **23 June 1948** by nine countries: **Belgium, Canada, Greece, Portugal, Switzerland, Austria, the United Kingdom, Uruguay and Venezuela**.

465. Which country will host the 53rd G7 Summit?

A.France

B.Canada

C.Germany

D.United States of America

E.Japan

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

India participated as a **partner country** at the G7 Summit 2026 on the invitation of French President Emmanuel Macron.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi represented India, marking India's **13th participation** as a partner country in the G7 Summit.

The **53rd G7 Summit** will be hosted by the **United States of America (USA)**.

Detailed Explanation:

India participated as a **partner country** at the G7 Summit 2026 on the invitation of French President Emmanuel Macron.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi represented India, marking India's **13th participation** as a partner country in the G7 Summit.

One of the key outcomes was the adoption of the **"Leaders' Declaration on Tackling Migrant Smuggling"** to address migrant smuggling and human trafficking.

Another key initiative was the launch of **"Partnership on Wide Energy and Resources Resilience (POWERR Asia)"** by **Japan**, aimed at strengthening **energy and critical minerals supply chains** with nearly **USD 10 billion support**.

The summit also saw the unveiling of a **Declaration on Critical Minerals Supply Chains**.

A **14-point Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** was signed between the **USA and Iran** to help **de-escalate the ongoing West Asia conflict**.

The **53rd G7 Summit** will be hosted by the **United States of America (USA)**.

466. As per the RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra's remarks ahead of International MSME Day 2026, which Digital Public Infrastructure (DPI) framework is a consent-based financial data-sharing system under India's digital financial architecture?

A.Unified Payments Interface (UPI)

B.Account Aggregator (AA) Framework

C.Trade Receivables Discounting System (TReDS)

D.Unified Lending Interface (ULI)

E.Open Credit Enablement Network (OCEN)

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** has urged banks and **Non-Banking Financial Companies (NBFCs)** to use India's **Digital Public Infrastructure (DPI)** to expand **credit access to** Micro, Small, and Medium Enterprises (MSMEs).

RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra made these remarks in **Kochi** ahead of **International MSME Day 2026** (22 June 2026).

Digital Public Infrastructure (DPI) refers to **shared digital systems** enabling identity, payments, data exchange, and service delivery at scale.

The **Account Aggregator (AA) framework** is a **consent-based financial data-sharing system** under India's digital financial architecture.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** has urged banks and **Non-Banking Financial Companies (NBFCs)** to use India's **Digital Public Infrastructure (DPI)** to expand **credit access to** Micro, Small, and Medium Enterprises (MSMEs).

RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra made these remarks in **Kochi** ahead of **International MSME Day 2026** (22 June 2026).

Digital Public Infrastructure (DPI) refers to **shared digital systems** enabling identity, payments, data exchange, and service delivery at scale.

Key DPI tools highlighted for MSME credit include **Account Aggregator (AA) framework**, **Unified Lending Interface (ULI)**, **Trade Receivables Discounting System (TReDS)**, **GST data trails**, and **Aadhaar-enabled authentication**.

The **Account Aggregator (AA) framework** is a **consent-based financial data-sharing system** under India's digital financial architecture.

The AA framework enabled **lending worth ₹3.5 trillion in FY26**, showing strong potential for expansion in digital credit delivery.

The **Unified Lending Interface (ULI)** enables lenders to **access borrower data** such as GST filings, bank statements, utility records, and land records through a **single consent-based system**.

467. Which Asset Management Company (AMC) launched India's first Lifecycle (Target-Date) Mutual Funds in 2026?

A.SBI Mutual Fund

B.HDFC Mutual Fund

C.ICICI Prudential Mutual Fund

D.Zerodha Fund House

E.Nippon India Mutual Fund

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

Zerodha Fund House, India's first passive-only, direct-only Asset Management Company (AMC), launched **India's first Lifecycle (Target-Date) Mutual Funds**.

The newly launched schemes are **Zerodha Life Cycle Fund 2036** and **Zerodha Life Cycle Fund 2041**, with **10-year and 15-year maturity periods** respectively.

These funds received approval from the **Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI)** in **February 2026** and are designed for **automated goal-based long-term investing**.

Detailed Explanation:

Zerodha Fund House, India's first passive-only, direct-only Asset Management Company (AMC), launched **India's first Lifecycle (Target-Date) Mutual Funds**.

The newly launched schemes are **Zerodha Life Cycle Fund 2036** and **Zerodha Life Cycle Fund 2041**, with **10-year and 15-year maturity periods** respectively.

These funds received approval from the **Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI)** in **February 2026** and are designed for **automated goal-based long-term investing**.

The funds allow investors to choose a target year, after which the portfolio is automatically managed through a **glide-path strategy**.

Lifecycle funds (Target-Date Funds) are structured to gradually **shift asset allocation from high-risk equity to low-risk debt** as the maturity year approaches.

The asset allocation includes **equity (Nifty LargeMidcap 250 Index)**, **debt (Government Securities)**, **gold and silver commodities**, and **arbitrage strategies**.

These funds are treated as **equity funds for taxation purposes**, offering **Long-Term Capital Gains (LTCG) benefits**, with **no lock-in period** and a **minimum investment of ₹100**.

468. In June 2026, the World Bank approved $1.5 billion financing for India under the Boosting Job Creation in the Private Sector DPF Operation. What does DPF stand for?

A.Development Policy Financing

B.Digital Partnership Fund

C.Domestic Production Facility

D.Development Promotion Framework

E.Direct Private Financing

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

The **World Bank's Board of Executive Directors** approved **$1.5 billion financing for India** to support **structural reforms for private sector-led job creation** and economic growth.

The funding is part of the **Boosting Job Creation in the Private Sector Development Policy Financing (DPF) Operation**, aimed at strengthening **employment generation and investment-led growth**.

The **Development Policy Financing (DPF)** is a World Bank instrument that provides **budget support for policy and institutional reforms**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **World Bank's Board of Executive Directors** approved **$1.5 billion financing for India** to support **structural reforms for private sector-led job creation** and economic growth.

The funding is part of the **Boosting Job Creation in the Private Sector Development Policy Financing (DPF) Operation**, aimed at strengthening **employment generation and investment-led growth**.

The **Development Policy Financing (DPF)** is a World Bank instrument that provides **budget support for policy and institutional reforms**.

The operation focuses on **reforms in taxation, trade, investment, labour regulation, entrepreneurship, and access to capital**.

India consolidated **29 labour laws into 4 Labour Codes in November 2025**, improving **regulatory simplification and ease of doing business**.

The four Labour Codes are:

Code on Wages

Industrial Relations Code

Code on Social Security

Occupational Safety, Health and Working Conditions Code

The reforms aim to **enhance labour participation of women**, reduce barriers to entrepreneurship, and **streamline trade and investment systems**.

469. As per the news, Punjab National Bank (PNB) partnered with Zaggle Prepaid Ocean Services Limited to launch biodegradable PNB–Zaggle Co-branded Twin Credit Cards. Which two payment networks are integrated in this twin-card proposition?

A.Visa and Mastercard

B.RuPay and Mastercard

C.Visa and RuPay

D.RuPay and American Express

E.Visa and Diners Club

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

Punjab National Bank (PNB), a leading Public Sector Bank (PSB) of India, has partnered with **Zaggle Prepaid Ocean Services Limited** to launch biodegradable **"PNB–Zaggle Co-branded Twin Credit Cards"**.

The initiative offers customers access to both **Visa and RuPay networks** through a **twin-card proposition**, combining global reach with domestic payment convenience.

The cards are designed to merge **lifestyle benefits with sustainability**, and will be available across India.

Detailed Explanation:

Punjab National Bank (PNB), a leading Public Sector Bank (PSB) of India, has partnered with **Zaggle Prepaid Ocean Services**

Limited to launch biodegradable **"PNB–Zaggle Co-branded Twin Credit Cards"**.

The initiative offers customers access to both **Visa and RuPay networks** through a **twin-card proposition**, combining global reach with domestic payment convenience.

The cards are designed to merge **lifestyle benefits with sustainability**, and will be available across India.

PNB and Zaggle have signed a **5-year partnership agreement** for the issuance and distribution of these co-branded credit cards.

The **twin-card system** integrates the **global acceptance and travel privileges of Visa** with the **lifestyle and domestic benefits of RuPay**, along with **UPI-enabled payment convenience**.

The cards will be accessible through the **zagg.money mobile application**.

Key benefits include **railway and airport lounge access,** Over-The-Top(OTT) **subscriptions, fitness memberships, travel and shopping vouchers, dining offers, fuel surcharge waivers, personal accident insurance cover**, and a **1.5% discount on jewellery purchases**.

470. As per the RBI's revised guidelines under the Kisan Credit Card (KCC) scheme, agricultural and allied sector loans up to what amount per borrower are exempt from collateral security and margin requirements?

A.₹1 lakh

B.₹1.5 lakh

C.₹2.5 lakh

D.₹2 lakh

E.₹5 lakh

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** directed banks to **exempt agricultural and allied sector loans up to ₹2 lakh** per borrower from **collateral security and margin requirements** under the **Kisan Credit Card (KCC) scheme**.

The move aims to strengthen **collateral-free lending** to the agriculture sector and **improve credit access for farmers**.

Banks are required to **waive collateral security and margin requirements** for agricultural and allied activity loans **up to ₹2 lakh per borrower**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** directed banks to **exempt agricultural and allied sector loans up to ₹2 lakh** per borrower from **collateral security and margin requirements** under the **Kisan Credit Card (KCC) scheme**.

The move aims to strengthen **collateral-free lending** to the agriculture sector and **improve credit access for farmers**.

Banks are required to **waive collateral security and margin requirements** for agricultural and allied activity loans **up to ₹2 lakh per borrower**.

The RBI clarified that **voluntary pledge of gold and silver** as collateral within the collateral-free limit **will not be treated as a violation** of lending norms.

Banks must **obtain and retain an explicit declaration** from borrowers in such cases of voluntary collateral pledge.

The RBI also released the **final guidelines for the Lead Bank Scheme (LBS)** to strengthen **district-level banking coordination**.

Under the Lead Bank Scheme, the RBI will **designate a commercial bank as Lead Bank** in each district to **coordinate banking activities** with the Government and National Bank for Agriculture and Rural Development (NABARD).

Every Lead Bank must **appoint a Lead District Manager (LDM)** exclusively for each district under its jurisdiction.

471. Recently, the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) issued the Kisan Credit Card (KCC) Directions, 2026, which will be applicable to KCC loans sanctioned from which date?

A.1 July 2026

B.1 October 2026

C.1 January 2027

D.1 April 2027

E.1 January 2028

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** has revamped the **Kisan Credit Card (KCC) Scheme**, introducing a **standardised crop season definition** to ensure **uniform loan processing and repayment**.

The updated framework is issued under the **KCC Directions, 2026**, which will be applicable to loans sanctioned from **1 January 2027**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** has revamped the **Kisan Credit Card (KCC) Scheme**, introducing a **standardised crop season definition** to ensure **uniform loan processing and repayment**.

The updated framework is issued under the **KCC Directions, 2026**, which will be applicable to loans sanctioned from **1 January 2027**.

The reform aims to provide **adequate and timely credit support** from the banking system for borrowers engaged in **agriculture and allied activities**.

The scheme covers both **working capital requirements** and **investment credit needs** of farmers under the KCC framework.

Loans sanctioned prior to 1 January 2027 will **continue to follow the existing guidelines** until their maturity or next renewal.

The directions apply to all **major lending institutions** including **Commercial Banks (CBs), Small Finance Banks (SFBs), Regional Rural Banks (RRBs), and Rural Co-operative Banks (RCBs)**.

472. The newly constituted Snow Leopard and High-Altitude Nature (SHAN) Conservation Society, a first-of-its-kind institutional mechanism for wildlife

conservation, has been established in which Union Territory?

A.Jammu & Kashmir

B.Himachal Pradesh

C.Uttarakhand

D.Sikkim

E.Ladakh

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

Lieutenant Governor **Vinai Kumar Saxena** approved the constitution of the **Snow Leopard and High-Altitude Nature (SHAN) Conservation Society** in Ladakh.

It is the **first-of-its-kind dedicated institutional mechanism** for wildlife conservation, biodiversity management and community-led environmental stewardship in Ladakh.

The Society has been constituted under the **Department of Forest, Ecology and Environment, Ladakh**.

The **Lieutenant Governor of Ladakh** will serve as the **Chairman** of the Society.

Detailed Explanation:

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The Society has been constituted under the **Department of Forest, Ecology and Environment, Ladakh**.

The **Lieutenant Governor of Ladakh** will serve as the **Chairman** of the Society.

The Society aims to strengthen conservation efforts across Ladakh's fragile mountain and cold desert ecosystems.

Its mandate includes conservation of **snow leopards, co-existing wildlife species, alpine flora, wetlands and other ecologically sensitive habitats**.

The Society will undertake **scientific monitoring, biodiversity research, mitigation of human-wildlife conflicts, community-based conservation programmes, promotion of eco-tourism and sustainable livelihood initiatives**.

The **Snow Leopard (Panthera uncia)** is the **State Animal of Ladakh**.

473. Under the National Green Hydrogen Mission (NGHM), the Government approved the first batch of financial support for startups under a dedicated Startup Support Programme. What is the total outlay of this programme?

A.₹50 crore

B.₹75 crore

C.₹200 crore

D.₹150 crore

E.₹100 crore

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

Union Minister for Consumer Affairs, Food and Public Distribution **Pralhad Joshi** approved the **first batch of ₹22 crore support** for **9**

startups under the **₹100 crore Startup Support Programme** of the **National Green Hydrogen Mission (NGHM)**.

The announcement was made during a workshop on the **National Green Hydrogen Mission (NGHM)** organised by the **Ministry of New and Renewable Energy (MNRE)**.

During the event, the Minister launched the **Green Hydrogen Certification Portal of India (GHCI)**.

Detailed Explanation:

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The announcement was made during a workshop on the **National Green Hydrogen Mission (NGHM)** organised by the **Ministry of New and Renewable Energy (MNRE)**.

During the event, the Minister launched the **Green Hydrogen Certification Portal of India (GHCI)**.

The **Green Hydrogen Certification Portal of India (GHCI)** will facilitate certification and regulatory compliance under the **Green Hydrogen Certification Scheme of India**.

The Startup Support Programme aims to promote innovation, indigenous technology development and entrepreneurship in the green hydrogen sector.

According to the Minister, **6 states** have notified dedicated Green Hydrogen Policies.

7 states have integrated hydrogen into their existing industrial and renewable energy policy frameworks.

4 states are currently in the process of finalising their Green Hydrogen Policies.

474. Recently GI-tagged Khurasani Imli from Mandu, Madhya Pradesh, is the fruit of which tree?

A.Tamarind Tree (Tamarindus indica)

B.Baobab Tree (Adansonia digitata)

C.Neem Tree (Azadirachta indica)

D.Mahua Tree (Madhuca longifolia)

E.Amla Tree (Phyllanthus emblica)

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Khurasani Imli from **Mandu in Dhar district, Madhya Pradesh**, has been awarded the prestigious **Geographical Indication (GI) Tag**.

The recognition protects the authenticity, identity and cultural heritage of this unique fruit while promoting its commercial value and market recognition.

Despite its name, Khurasani Imli is not the common tamarind (**Tamarindus indica**); it is the fruit of the **African Baobab Tree (Adansonia digitata)**.

Detailed Explanation:

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promoting its commercial value and market recognition.

Despite its name, Khurasani Imli is not the common tamarind (**Tamarindus indica**); it is the fruit of the **African Baobab Tree (Adansonia digitata)**.

The fruit is known for its distinctive sweet-sour taste, cream-of-tartar flavour, nutritional value and medicinal properties.

The Baobab tree is popularly known as **Mandu Imli, Gorilla Tamarind, Monkey Bread Tree** and **Upside-Down Tree**.

The tree is famous for its massive bottle-shaped trunk and ability to store large quantities of water, helping it survive prolonged drought conditions.

Mandu hosts India's largest natural cluster of Baobab trees, making the region uniquely associated with Khurasani Imli.

The **Geographical Indication (GI) Tag** was granted because of the fruit's unique geographical association, historical significance and distinctive characteristics linked to the Mandu region.

475. In the West Bengal Budget 2026–27, what total Dearness Allowance (DA) was announced for state government employees after the additional increase?

A.28%

B.33%

C.36%

D.38%

E.40%

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

The **Government of West Bengal** presented a **₹4.38 lakh crore Budget for 2026-27**, focusing on employment generation, infrastructure development, women's welfare, education and social security.

The Budget was presented by Finance Minister **Swapan Dasgupta** in the State Legislative Assembly.

The government announced the filling of **1 lakh government vacancies** and provided **33% reservation for women** in state government recruitment.

An additional **20% Dearness Allowance (DA)** was announced over the existing 18%, taking the total **Dearness Allowance (DA)** for state government employees to **38%**.

Detailed Explanation:

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The Budget was presented by Finance Minister **Swapan Dasgupta** in the State Legislative Assembly.

The government announced the filling of **1 lakh government vacancies** and provided **33% reservation for women** in state government recruitment.

An additional **20% Dearness Allowance (DA)** was announced over the existing 18%,

taking the total **Dearness Allowance (DA)** for state government employees to **38%**.

Pensioners will receive an additional **20% Dearness Relief (DR)** with effect from **1 October 2026**.

A major infrastructure announcement was the development of a **second greenfield airport near Kolkata** on 1,000–1,500 acres near Kalyani to reduce congestion at **Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose International Airport** and improve regional connectivity.

The Budget also proposed a **deep-sea port at Dadanpatrabar in Purba Medinipur** to strengthen maritime trade, logistics and industrial development.

₹10 crore was allocated for the expansion of **Cooch Behar Airport**, while land will be provided for the expansion of **Hasimara Air Force Station** and **Kalaikunda Air Force Station**.

476. What is the theme of the BRICS National Security Advisers (NSA) Meeting to be hosted by India under its BRICS Presidency?

A.Strengthening Global Economic Cooperation

B.Sustainable Development and Climate Action

C.Non-Traditional Security Challenges Confronting the World Today

D.Building Resilient Supply Chains for Growth

E.Digital Transformation for Inclusive Development

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

India will host the **two-day BRICS National Security Advisers (NSA) Meeting** under its BRICS Presidency.

The meeting will be chaired by **National Security Adviser Ajit Doval** and will bring together National Security Advisers and senior security officials from BRICS member countries.

The meeting serves as an important platform for discussing global and regional security issues, strategic cooperation and policy coordination among BRICS nations.

The theme of the meeting is **"Non-Traditional Security Challenges Confronting the World Today."**

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The meeting serves as an important platform for discussing global and regional security issues, strategic cooperation and policy coordination among BRICS nations.

The theme of the meeting is **"Non-Traditional Security Challenges Confronting the World Today."**

Discussions will focus on emerging security threats such as **cybersecurity, artificial intelligence-related risks, information warfare, terrorism, critical infrastructure**

security, cross-border organised crime and digital security.

Member countries are expected to exchange views on evolving global security trends and explore areas for enhanced cooperation.

A major focus of the meeting will be the security implications of emerging technologies, including **Artificial Intelligence (AI), machine learning, deepfakes, autonomous systems and cyber tools**.

477. As of 2026, Neeraj Dangi, who recently took oath as a re-elected member of the Rajya Sabha, represents which state in the Upper House of Parliament?

A.Rajasthan

B.Madhya Pradesh

C.Gujarat

D.Haryana

E.Uttar Pradesh

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

Vice President of India and **Chairman, Rajya Sabha**, **C.P. Radhakrishnan** administered the **oath of office** to re-elected Rajya Sabha member **Neeraj Dangi** at **Parliament House, New Delhi**.

Neeraj Dangi represents the state of **Rajasthan** in the **Rajya Sabha** (Upper House of Parliament).

Detailed Explanation:

Vice President of India and **Chairman, Rajya Sabha**, **C.P. Radhakrishnan** administered the **oath of office** to re-elected Rajya Sabha member **Neeraj Dangi** at **Parliament House, New Delhi**.

Neeraj Dangi represents the state of **Rajasthan** in the **Rajya Sabha** (Upper House of Parliament).

He took the oath in **Hindi** after being **re-elected** to the Rajya Sabha.

The oath ceremony was held in the presence of **Harivansh**, **Deputy Chairman, Rajya Sabha**. **Kiren Rijiju**, **Union Minister for Parliamentary Affairs and Minority Affairs**, attended the ceremony.

478. Recently, Tushar Mehta, whose tenure was extended by the Appointments Committee of the Cabinet (ACC), serves as the Solicitor General of India (SGI). The Solicitor General is the _____ law officer of the Union Government after the Attorney General for India.

A.First-highest

B.Second-highest

C.Third-highest

D.Fourth-highest

E.Fifth-highest

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The **Appointments Committee of the Cabinet (ACC)**, chaired by **Prime Minister Narendra Modi**, approved the **reappointment of Solicitor General of India (SGI) Tushar Mehta** for a further **three-year term effective from 1 July 2026**, making him one of the longest-serving Solicitors General in India.

Tushar Mehta will continue as the **second-highest law officer of the Union Government**, next only to the **Attorney General for India (AGI)**.

Detailed Explanation:

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Tushar Mehta will continue as the **second-highest law officer of the Union Government**, next only to the **Attorney General for India (AGI)**.

The ACC also approved the **reappointment of five Additional Solicitors General (ASGs) for the Supreme Court**, including **Vikramjit Banerjee, K.M. Nataraj, Suryaprakash V. Raju, N. Venkataraman, and Aishwarya Bhati**. Additionally, **Chetan Sharma** has been **reappointed as ASG for the Delhi High Court** for a further term of **six months from 1 July 2026** or until further orders.

479. As per the news, the Ministry of Defence (MoD) granted permission to utilise defence land at Golconda, Hyderabad, for the Gandhi Sarovar Project under which policy?

A.Defence Infrastructure Development Policy

B.Equal Value Infrastructure (EVI) Policy

C.National Land Monetisation Policy

D.Strategic Assets Exchange Policy

E.Defence Modernisation Policy

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The **Ministry of Defence (MoD)** granted working permission to the **Musi Riverfront Development Corporation Limited (MRDCL)** to utilise **83.814 acres of defence land** under the **Artillery Centre, Golconda, Hyderabad (Telangana)**.

The land, valued at approximately **₹533.42 crore**, has been allocated for the **Gandhi Sarovar Project at Bapu Ghat, Hyderabad**.

The allocation is made under the **Equal Value Infrastructure (EVI) Policy**, which ensures balanced exchange between defence land usage and infrastructure development.

Detailed Explanation:

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The land, valued at approximately **₹533.42 crore**, has been allocated for the **Gandhi Sarovar Project at Bapu Ghat, Hyderabad**.

The allocation is made under the **Equal Value Infrastructure (EVI) Policy**, which ensures balanced exchange between defence land usage and infrastructure development.

Under the EVI Policy, MRDCL will **develop equivalent-value infrastructure assets for the Indian Army (IA)** in return for the use of defence land.

The **Gandhi Sarovar Project** is part of the **Musi Riverfront Development Programme (MRDP)** at the confluence of the **Esa and Musi rivers** in Hyderabad.

The site holds **historical significance**, as it is the location where **Mahatma Gandhi's ashes were immersed in 1948**.

480. Which organization developed the Aadhaar App, which recently crossed 31 million downloads within five months of its launch?

A.National Informatics Centre (NIC)

B.Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY)

C.Centre for Development of Advanced Computing (C-DAC)

D.Unique Identification Authority of India (UIDAI)

E.Digital India Corporation

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

The **Aadhaar App** has achieved over **31 million downloads** across India within less than **5 months of its launch**, reflecting strong public acceptance and trust.

The app was developed by the **Unique Identification Authority of India (UIDAI)** to improve **ease of living** and provide Aadhaar-related services directly through **smartphones**.

Nearly **4 million users** have **updated their mobile numbers** using the Aadhaar App since ts launch.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Aadhaar App** has achieved over **31 million downloads** across India within less than **5 months of its launch**, reflecting strong public acceptance and trust.

The app was developed by the **Unique Identification Authority of India (UIDAI)** to improve **ease of living** and provide Aadhaar-related services directly through **smartphones**.

Nearly **4 million users** have **updated their mobile numbers** using the Aadhaar App since ts launch.

Around **850,000 users** have successfully **updated their addresses** through the Aadhaar App.

The Aadhaar App provides **Aadhaar Number Holders (ANH)** with a **privacy-first, secure, and convenient** method to **show, share, and verify identity digitally**.

A key feature of the app is **biometric lock/unlock**, allowing users to secure or unlock their Aadhaar biometrics with a **single click**.

The app supports **face authentication/face verification** as proof of presence for identity verification purposes.

Users can access their **authentication history** directly through the Aadhaar App for better **transparency and monitoring**.

The Aadhaar App offers a **QR-based editable contact card**, enabling **digital sharing of contact details** instead of traditional physical visiting cards.

481. On its 23rd Foundation Day, the National Internet Exchange of India (NIXI) launched

four major digital platforms. Which of the following is NOT one of the platforms launched by NIXI?

A.IX Portal

B.myIRINN Portal

C.IN Auction Portal

D.AI-enabled WHOIS Screening Platform

E.DigiLocker Integration Portal

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

The **National Internet Exchange of India (NIXI)** launched **four major digital platforms** on its **23rd Foundation Day in New Delhi** to strengthen India's internet ecosystem.

The newly launched platforms include **Internet Exchange (IX) Portal, myIRINN Portal, .IN Auction Portal, and an AI-enabled WHOIS Screening Platform**.

The initiatives were inaugurated by **S. Krishnan, Secretary, MeitY and Chairman, NIXI**, highlighting the government's focus on digital infrastructure and internet governance.

Detailed Explanation:

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The newly launched platforms include **Internet Exchange (IX) Portal, myIRINN Portal, .IN Auction Portal, and an AI-enabled WHOIS Screening Platform**.

The initiatives were inaugurated by **S. Krishnan, Secretary, MeitY and Chairman, NIXI**, highlighting the government's focus on digital infrastructure and internet governance.

The **IX Portal** is designed to improve the management and operation of **Internet Exchange Points (IXPs)** across India for **better traffic optimization**.

The **myIRINN Portal** supports the management of **internet number resources** under the **Indian Registry for Internet Names and Numbers (IRINN)** in a secure digital environment

482. As of 2026, the indigenous "Garudastra" 120 mm vehicle-mounted mortar system can be deployed in under how much time, demonstrating its rapid shoot-and-scoot capability?

A.15 seconds

B.20 seconds

C.30 seconds

D.42 seconds

E.60 seconds

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

India successfully tested **"Garudastra"**, an **indigenous 120 mm vehicle-mounted mortar system**, developed by **Nibe Limited**, at the **Infantry School, Mhow (MP)** under the Military Headquarters of War, for the **Indian Army (IA)**.

The system was operated by a **two-member crew** and can be deployed in **under 30 seconds**, showcasing strong **shoot-and-scoot capability**.

Detailed Explanation:

India successfully tested **"Garudastra"**, an **indigenous 120 mm vehicle-mounted mortar system**, developed by **Nibe Limited**, at the **Infantry School, Mhow (MP)** under the Military Headquarters of War, for the **Indian Army (IA)**.

The system demonstrated **high mobility, precision strike capability, and rapid deployment** features, enhancing battlefield effectiveness and operational readiness.

Garudastra is one of India's **heaviest indigenous vehicle-mounted mortar systems**, designed for accurate fire support, mobility, and **battlefield survivability**.

The system was operated by a **two-member crew** and can be deployed in **under 30 seconds**, showcasing strong **shoot-and-scoot capability**.

It was evaluated under the **NC-NC (No Cost–No Commitment) framework**, allowing the Indian Army to assess its capabilities without any procurement obligation.

483. As per the news, Teplizumab (Tzield), recently in the news, is the first medicine designed to delay the onset of which disease?

A.Type 2 Diabetes

B.Type 1 Diabetes

C.Gestational Diabetes

D.Rheumatoid Arthritis

E.Multiple Sclerosis

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Teplizumab (brand name: Tzield) is an **immunotherapy drug** for **Type 1 Diabetes** and is the **first medicine designed to delay the onset of symptomatic Stage 3 Type 1 diabetes**.

The **National Institute for Health and Care Excellence (NICE)** issued **final draft guidance on 22 June 2026** for its use under the **NHS in England and Wales**.

Type 1 diabetes is an **autoimmune disease** where the immune system destroys **insulin-producing beta cells in the pancreas**.

Detailed Explanation:

Teplizumab (brand name: Tzield) is an **immunotherapy drug** for **Type 1 Diabetes** and is the **first medicine designed to delay the onset of symptomatic Stage 3 Type 1 diabetes**.

The **National Institute for Health and Care Excellence (NICE)** issued **final draft guidance on 22 June 2026** for its use under the **NHS in England and Wales**.

Type 1 diabetes is an **autoimmune disease** where the immune system destroys **insulin-producing beta cells in the pancreas**.

Stage 2 Type 1 diabetes involves the presence of **autoantibodies and abnormal blood sugar levels**, without the need for insulin therapy.

Stage 3 Type 1 diabetes is the **symptomatic stage requiring lifelong insulin therapy**.

Teplizumab is manufactured by **Sanofi** and is approved for **adults and children aged 8 years and above**.

The drug is administered as a **one-time 14-day course of intravenous (IV) infusions**, each lasting around 30 minutes.

484. In news, Researchers at the Central University of Rajasthan (CURAJ) developed a low-cost sensor to detect minute amounts of which toxic heavy metal in drinking water?

A.Mercury

B.Arsenic

C.Cadmium

D.Lead

E.Chromium

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

Researchers at the Central University of Rajasthan (CURAJ), Jaipur developed a **low-cost sensor** on 22 June 2026 to **detect minute amounts of toxic lead ions in drinking water**.

The device can **test water directly without using chemicals, buffers, or reagents**, making it a simple and **user-friendly solution for water quality monitoring**.

Lead is a **toxic heavy metal** that can enter drinking water through pipes, fittings, and plumbing materials.

Detailed Explanation:

Researchers at the Central University of Rajasthan (CURAJ), Jaipur developed a **low-cost sensor** on 22 June 2026 to **detect minute amounts of toxic lead ions in drinking water**.

The device can **test water directly without using chemicals, buffers, or reagents**, making it a simple and **user-friendly solution for water quality monitoring**.

Lead is a **toxic heavy metal** that can enter drinking water through pipes, fittings, and plumbing materials.

Lead contamination is **invisible to the naked eye** as it does not change the colour or appearance of water.

Lead exposure is highly dangerous, especially for children, as it can **damage the nervous system and affect brain development**.

The research project was led by **Pankaj Gupta**, Assistant Professor, Department of Chemistry, CURAJ, in collaboration with the Finnish nanotechnology company **CANATU**.

The sensor uses **special electrodes** tested in tap water and major river systems like the **Ganges and Brahmaputra**.

485. Which company, along with its electric vehicle subsidiary Switch Mobility, became the first OEM to formally partner with the Government of India under the scheme to replace old trucks and buses in the Delhi-NCR?

A.Tata Motors

B.Mahindra & Mahindra

C.Force Motors

D.VE Commercial Vehicles

E.Ashok Leyland

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

The **Ministry of Road Transport and Highways (MoRTH)** signed two **Memorandums of Understanding (MoUs)** with leading **Original Equipment Manufacturers (OEMs)** for implementing the Government of India's scheme to replace old trucks and buses in the **Delhi-National Capital Region (Delhi-NCR)**.

The **first MoU** was signed with **Ashok Leyland** and its electric vehicle subsidiary **Switch Mobility**, making them the first OEMs to formally partner with the Government under the scheme.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Ministry of Road Transport and Highways (MoRTH)** signed two **Memorandums of Understanding (MoUs)** with leading **Original Equipment Manufacturers (OEMs)** for implementing the Government of India's scheme to replace old trucks and buses in the **Delhi-National Capital Region (Delhi-NCR)**.

The **first MoU** was signed with **Ashok Leyland** and its electric vehicle subsidiary **Switch Mobility**, making them the first OEMs to formally partner with the Government under the scheme.

The **second MoU** was signed with **Tata Motors**. Together, Ashok Leyland, Switch Mobility and Tata Motors account for nearly **50% of India's truck and bus market**.

The scheme aims to:

Reduce vehicular pollution in Delhi-NCR.

Accelerate fleet modernisation.

Promote cleaner and environmentally sustainable transportation.

486. Recently, the Government of Gujarat signed an MoU with HUDCO for long-term financial assistance of up to how much amount for infrastructure development projects in the state?

A.₹25,000 crore

B.₹50,000 crore

C.₹75,000 crore

D.₹1 lakh crore

E.₹1.5 lakh crore

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

The **Government of Gujarat** signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** with **Housing and Urban Development Corporation Limited (HUDCO)** for long-term financial assistance of up to **₹1 lakh crore** over a period of **two years**, beginning from **May 2026**.

The agreement aims to accelerate infrastructure development and support large-scale projects across the state.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Government of Gujarat** signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** with **Housing and Urban Development Corporation Limited (HUDCO)** for long-term financial assistance of up to **₹1 lakh crore** over a period of **two years**, beginning from **May 2026**.

The agreement aims to accelerate infrastructure development and support large-scale projects across the state.

The funding will be utilized for key infrastructure projects, including:

Gujarat Metro Rail Phase-II and Phase-III projects

Expressway development

Sports infrastructure projects

Development of world-class infrastructure in **Dholera Smart City**

HUDCO will provide financial assistance on flexible terms, including:

Moratorium period on repayments

Flexible repayment schedule

The Gujarat Government will facilitate necessary approvals, clearances and permissions from relevant departments to ensure smooth project implementation.

In a separate development, the Gujarat Government also signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** with the **Indian Institute of Management Ahmedabad (IIM Ahmedabad)**.

487. Consider the following statements regarding the World Economic Forum's (WEF) Energy Transition Index (ETI) 2026:

Sweden, Finland, and Denmark secured the top three positions in the rankings.

India improved by two places to rank 70th in ETI 2026.

Singapore was among the biggest gainers, climbing 10 places to 42nd position.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

A.1 only

B.2 and 3 only

C.1 and 2 only

D.All of the above

E.None of the above

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

The **World Economic Forum (WEF)** released the **16th edition of the Energy Transition Index (ETI) 2026**, which evaluates energy system performance and transition readiness across **120 countries** using **44 indicators**.

Singapore emerged as one of the biggest gainers, climbing **10 places to 42nd position**.

India improved by two places to rank 70th in ETI 2026 and recorded a **1.9% year-on-year score improvement**, making it one of the fastest-improving countries in transition readiness.

Sweden, Finland and Denmark retained the top three positions in the rankings.

Detailed Explanation:

The **World Economic Forum (WEF)** released the **16th edition of the Energy Transition Index (ETI) 2026**, which evaluates energy system performance and transition readiness across **120 countries** using **44 indicators**.

The report recorded a **global decline in energy transition readiness for the first time in more than a decade**, mainly due to rising geopolitical risks and concentration of clean energy investments in a few markets.

Sweden, Finland and Denmark retained the top three positions in the rankings.

Other major economies ranked as follows:

Germany – 9th

France – 10th

United Kingdom – 11th

China – 14th

Brazil – 17th

United States – 19th

Singapore emerged as one of the biggest gainers, climbing **10 places to 42nd position**.

India improved by two places to rank 70th in ETI 2026 and recorded a **1.9% year-on-year score improvement**, making it one of the fastest-improving countries in transition readiness.

488. Which team did the Indian women's hockey team defeat in the final to win the FIH Nations Cup 2026?

A.New Zealand

B.Germany

C.Argentina

D.Australia

E.Spain

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

The Indian women's hockey team won the **International Hockey Federation (FIH) Nations Cup 2026** after defeating **New Zealand 2-0** in the final.

With this victory, India not only lifted the trophy but also secured promotion to the **International Hockey Federation (FIH) Pro League**, the highest level of annual international hockey competition.

Detailed Explanation:

The Indian women's hockey team won the **International Hockey Federation (FIH) Nations Cup 2026** after defeating **New Zealand 2-0** in the final.

With this victory, India not only lifted the trophy but also secured promotion to the **International Hockey Federation (FIH) Pro League**, the highest level of annual international hockey competition.

India captured its **second FIH Nations Cup title**, having previously won the inaugural edition in **2022**.

The team remained **unbeaten throughout the tournament**, showcasing strong performances in both attack and defence.

India took the lead in the **4th minute** when **Navneet Kaur** converted a penalty corner.

Sunelita Toppo doubled India's advantage in the **15th minute** by deflecting a drag flick from **Deepika** into the net.

489. As per the news, India's Vaibhav Sooryavanshi created history by scoring the fastest half-century in List A cricket in how many balls?

A.10 balls

B.11 balls

C.12 balls

D.13 balls

E.14 balls

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

India's teenage cricket sensation **Vaibhav Sooryavanshi** created history by scoring the **fastest half-century in List A cricket**, reaching the milestone in just **11 balls** during the **Tri-Nation Series Final** between **India A** and **Sri Lanka A** at the **Rangiri Dambulla International Stadium, Sri Lanka**.

With this achievement, Sooryavanshi broke a **20-year-old world record** and emerged as one of the brightest young talents in world cricket.

Detailed Explanation:

India's teenage cricket sensation **Vaibhav Sooryavanshi** created history by scoring the **fastest half-century in List A cricket**, reaching the milestone in just **11 balls** during the **Tri-Nation Series Final** between **India A** and **Sri Lanka A** at the **Rangiri Dambulla International Stadium, Sri Lanka**.

With this achievement, Sooryavanshi broke a **20-year-old world record** and emerged as one of the brightest young talents in world cricket.

The previous record was held by **Kaushalya Weeratne** of Sri Lanka, who scored a List A fifty in **12 balls** during the **2005-06 season**.

Sooryavanshi surpassed the long-standing record by reaching his half-century in just **11 deliveries**.

The innings came in the final of the Tri-Nation Series and played a crucial role in India's performance.

490. Who was named Best Male Athlete of the Year at the inaugural Indian Athletics Awards 2025?

A.Avinash Sable

B.Kishore Jena

C.Neeraj Chopra

D.Tajinderpal Singh Toor

E.Murali Sreeshankar

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

Olympic medal-winning javelin thrower **Neeraj Chopra** was named **Best Male Athlete of the Year**, while national record holder **Parul Chaudhary** received the **Best Female Athlete of the Year** award at the inaugural **Indian Athletics Awards 2025** held in **New Delhi**.

The awards were organized by the **Athletics Federation of India (AFI)** to recognize athletes, coaches, officials, state associations and contributors who have played a significant role in the growth of athletics in India.

Detailed Explanation:

Olympic medal-winning javelin thrower **Neeraj Chopra** was named **Best Male Athlete of the Year**, while national record holder **Parul Chaudhary** received the **Best Female Athlete of the Year** award at the inaugural **Indian Athletics Awards 2025** held in **New Delhi**.

The awards were organized by the **Athletics Federation of India (AFI)** to recognize athletes, coaches, officials, state associations and contributors who have played a significant role in the growth of athletics in India.

Neeraj Chopra received the honour following another successful season in international athletics despite recovering from a back injury suffered before the 2025 World Athletics Championships.

He became the **first Indian athlete to cross the 90-metre mark in javelin throw**, recording a throw of **90.23 metres** at the Doha Diamond League.

Parul Chaudhary was named Best Female Athlete of the Year after winning **gold medals in the women's 3,000-metre steeplechase and 5,000-metre events** at the Asian Championships.

491. In news, Bharat Metal Exchange (BME), which recently signed an MoU with the National Stock Exchange of India (NSE), was formerly known as:

A.National Metal Exchange Limited

B.Indian Metal Exchange Limited

C.Bombay Metal Exchange Limited

D.Bharat Commodities Exchange Limited

E.Mumbai Metal Trading Exchange Limited

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The **National Stock Exchange of India Limited (NSE)** signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** with **Bharat Metal Exchange (BME)** to promote the development and adoption of **non-ferrous metal derivatives** in India.

Bharat Metal Exchange (BME) was formerly known as **Bombay Metal Exchange Limited**.

The partnership aims to strengthen **price risk management** and enhance the **derivatives ecosystem** for non-ferrous metals in India.

Detailed Explanation:

The **National Stock Exchange of India Limited (NSE)** signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** with **Bharat Metal Exchange (BME)** to promote the development and adoption of **non-ferrous metal derivatives** in India.

Bharat Metal Exchange (BME) was formerly known as **Bombay Metal Exchange Limited**.

The partnership aims to strengthen **price risk management** and enhance the **derivatives ecosystem** for non-ferrous metals in India.

The primary objective of the MoU is to **increase market participation** in the non-ferrous metals derivatives segment.

The collaboration seeks to develop **efficient hedging tools** for participants in the metal industry.

Another key objective is to **promote awareness and usage** of exchange-traded derivatives in the non-ferrous metals sector.

The partnership focuses on major non-ferrous metals including **Copper (Cu), Aluminium (Al), Zinc (Zn), Lead (Pb), and Nickel (Ni)**.

These metals play a crucial role in India's **industrial, manufacturing, and infrastructure sectors**.

492. The International Finance Corporation (IFC) pledged USD 371 million to which company for developing AI-ready and

energy-efficient data centre infrastructure in India?

A.Reliance Jio Infocomm Limited

B.CtrlS Datacenters Limited

C.AdaniConneX Private Limited

D.Sify Infinit Spaces Limited (SISL)

E.Tata Communications Limited

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

The **International Finance Corporation (IFC)**, the private-sector arm of the **World Bank Group (WBG)**, pledged **USD 371 million** to **Sify Infinit Spaces Limited (SISL)**.

Sify Infinit Spaces Limited (SISL) is a wholly-owned subsidiary of **Sify Technologies Limited**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **International Finance Corporation (IFC)**, the private-sector arm of the **World Bank Group (WBG)**, pledged **USD 371 million** to **Sify Infinit Spaces Limited (SISL)**.

Sify Infinit Spaces Limited (SISL) is a wholly-owned subsidiary of **Sify Technologies Limited**.

The funding aims to support the development of **Artificial Intelligence (AI)-ready and energy-efficient Data Centre (DC) infrastructure** in India.

The **total financing package** amounts to **USD 371 million**.

Out of the total commitment, **IFC will provide USD 71 million as a loan**, equivalent to approximately **₹675 crore**.

The remaining up to **USD 300 million will be mobilized** from other lenders.

The financing has been structured as a **sustainability-linked financing package**.

Under the project, Sify will establish **two next-generation Data Centres (DCs)** in **Navi Mumbai, Maharashtra**, and **Chennai, Tamil Nadu**.

493. The World Bank approved a ₹4,000 crore loan for Haryana's 'Jal Sanrakshit Haryana' Project, which will be implemented during which period?

A.2025–2030

B.2026–2032

C.2026–2030

D.2027–2032

E.2026–2035

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The **World Bank** approved a **₹4,000 crore loan** for Haryana's **'Jal Sanrakshit Haryana' Project**, aimed at making the state water-secure and self-reliant in the water sector.

The **total cost** of the Jal Sanrakshit Haryana Project is **₹5,714 crore**.

The project will be implemented in phases from **2026 to 2032**.

The initiative focuses on **improved water management, water conservation, and efficient water distribution** across Haryana.

The project covers **15 clusters** spread across **48.94 lakh acres** of land in Haryana.

Detailed Explanation:

The **World Bank** approved a **₹4,000 crore loan** for Haryana's **'Jal Sanrakshit Haryana' Project**, aimed at making the state water-secure and self-reliant in the water sector.

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The project will be implemented in phases from **2026 to 2032**.

The initiative focuses on **improved water management, water conservation, and efficient water distribution** across Haryana.

The project covers **15 clusters** spread across **48.94 lakh acres** of land in Haryana.

Village-level Water Committees will be formed to participate in the development and maintenance of water channels.

A **dedicated maintenance fund** will be created for water channels with financial support from the Haryana Government.

The project includes the **rehabilitation of the remaining 678 canals** across Haryana.

Out of the 678 canals, **106 canals** will be rehabilitated with **World Bank assistance** at a cost of **₹2,484.87 crore**.

293 canals will be restored through **State Government funding** at a cost of **₹2,230 crore**.

279 canals will be rehabilitated under projects supported by the **National Bank for Agriculture and Rural Development (NABARD)**.

The programme will rehabilitate **620 water channels**, benefiting approximately **3.18 lakh acres** of agricultural land.

A total of **120 canal-based micro-irrigation projects** will be upgraded under the initiative.

494. Recently, the Mombasa Declaration, aimed at strengthening global efforts against Illegal, Unreported and Unregulated (IUU) Fishing, was adopted by how many countries?

A.10

B.12

C.15

D.18

E.20

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The **Mombasa Declaration** was adopted by **15 countries** from Africa, Asia, Europe, the Caribbean, and the Pacific to strengthen global efforts against **Illegal, Unreported and Unregulated (IUU) Fishing**.

The declaration was adopted during the **11th Our Ocean Conference** held in **Mombasa, Kenya**.

The primary objective of the Mombasa Declaration is to improve **transparency, accountability, and international cooperation** in fisheries governance.

The declaration calls on governments to improve access to information regarding **fishing vessels, vessel ownership, licensing, and fishing activities**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Mombasa Declaration** was adopted by **15 countries** from Africa, Asia, Europe, the

Caribbean, and the Pacific to strengthen global efforts against **Illegal, Unreported and Unregulated (IUU) Fishing**.

The declaration was adopted during the **11th Our Ocean Conference** held in **Mombasa, Kenya**.

The primary objective of the Mombasa Declaration is to improve **transparency, accountability, and international cooperation** in fisheries governance.

The declaration calls on governments to improve access to information regarding **fishing vessels, vessel ownership, licensing, and fishing activities**.

It also emphasizes strengthening **data-sharing mechanisms** to improve monitoring, tracking, and enforcement of fisheries regulations.

The declaration supports the **Global Charter for Fisheries Transparency**, which contains **10 policy principles** aimed at improving fisheries governance.

Key reforms promoted under the charter include **modernizing vessel registries and publishing fishing authorizations**.

Illegal, Unreported and Unregulated (IUU) Fishing is estimated to cost the global economy up to **US$50 billion annually**.

IUU fishing poses serious threats to **food security, coastal livelihoods, marine resources, and labor rights**.

495. As of 2026, the North East's largest organic spice processing unit, inaugurated by Union Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman, is located in which state?

A.Assam

B.Manipur

C.Nagaland

D.Meghalaya

E.Sikkim

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

Union Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman and Minister of Corporate Affairs, along with **Conrad K. Sangma**, Chief Minister of Meghalaya, and **Prem Singh Tamang**, Chief Minister of Sikkim, inaugurated the **North East's largest organic spice processing unit** at **Lumdaitkhla, Bhoirymbong, Ri-Bhoi District, Meghalaya**.

Detailed Explanation:

Union Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman and Minister of Corporate Affairs, along with **Conrad K. Sangma**, Chief Minister of Meghalaya, and **Prem Singh Tamang**, Chief Minister of Sikkim, inaugurated the **North East's largest organic spice processing unit** at **Lumdaitkhla, Bhoirymbong, Ri-Bhoi District, Meghalaya**.

The facility has been established with an investment of approximately **₹32 crore**.

The project has been implemented by the **Eastern Ri-Bhoi Organic Farmer Producer Company Limited (FPC)**, a farmer-owned enterprise.

The unit has been set up under the **Mission Organic Value Chain Development for North Eastern Region (MOVCD-NER)**.

The project received support under:

Mission for Integrated Development of Horticulture (MIDH)

Mission Organic Value Chain Development for North Eastern Region (MOVCD-NER)

Meghalaya Government schemes

International Fund for Agricultural Development (IFAD)-supported initiatives

496. As per the news, India's first private-sector 91 KLPD Hybrid Second-Generation (2G) Ethanol Biorefinery, which received ₹150 crore financial assistance under the PM JI-VAN Yojana, is located in:

A.Maharashtra

B.Gujarat

C.Uttar Pradesh

D.Punjab

E.Haryana

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The **Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas (MoPNG)** approved **₹150 crore** financial assistance for India's first private-sector **91 Kilo Litres Per Day (KLPD) Hybrid Second-Generation (2G) Ethanol Biorefinery** at **Wave Sugar, Dhanaura, Uttar Pradesh**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas (MoPNG)** approved **₹150 crore** financial assistance for India's first private-sector **91 Kilo Litres Per Day (KLPD) Hybrid Second-Generation (2G) Ethanol Biorefinery** at **Wave Sugar, Dhanaura, Uttar Pradesh**.

The financial assistance has been approved through the **Centre for High Technology (CHT)** under the **Pradhan Mantri JI-VAN (Jaiv Indhan-Vatavaran Anukool Fasal Awashesh Nivaran) Yojana**.

The project aims to support commercial-scale production of **Second-Generation (2G) Ethanol** from agricultural residues such as bagasse and crop stalks.

The integrated biorefinery will convert underutilized biomass waste into clean transportation fuel, helping reduce stubble burning and environmental pollution.

497. Under the Bharat Climate Observation Network (BCON), the proposed long-term Climate Observation Station will be established at_____

A.Leh, Ladakh

B.Devasthal, Nainital

C.Mussoorie, Uttarakhand

D.Shimla, Himachal Pradesh

E.Pune, Maharashtra

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The **Indian Institute of Tropical Meteorology (IITM), Pune, Maharashtra**, signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** with the **Aryabhatta Research Institute of Observational Sciences (ARIES), Nainital, Uttarakhand**, to establish a long-term climate

observation station under the **Bharat Climate Observation Network (BCON)**.

The MoU was signed on **18 June 2026** through online mode by **A. Suryachandra Rao**, Director of IITM, and **Manish Kumar Naja**, Director of ARIES.

The proposed **BCON Climate Observation Station** will be established at **Devasthal, Nainital district, Uttarakhand**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Indian Institute of Tropical Meteorology (IITM), Pune, Maharashtra**, signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** with the **Aryabhatta Research Institute of Observational Sciences (ARIES), Nainital, Uttarakhand**, to establish a long-term climate observation station under the **Bharat Climate Observation Network (BCON)**.

The MoU was signed on **18 June 2026** through online mode by **A. Suryachandra Rao**, Director of IITM, and **Manish Kumar Naja**, Director of ARIES.

The proposed **BCON Climate Observation Station** will be established at **Devasthal, Nainital district, Uttarakhand**.

The agreement has a validity of **more than 50 years**, making it a significant long-term initiative for climate and atmospheric research.

The project aims to strengthen climate monitoring and scientific research under **Mission Mausam**, an initiative of the **Ministry of Earth Sciences (MoES)**.

The station will conduct long-term monitoring of:

Meteorological parameters

Greenhouse gases

Short-lived climate forcers

Atmospheric chemistry

Soil moisture

498. In news, following Kunal Shah's reported appointment to lead WhatsApp globally, who was appointed as the Interim CEO of CRED?

A.Nikhil Kamath

B.Miten Sampat

C.Kunal Bahl

D.Bhavish Aggarwal

E.Deep Kalra

Answer: B

Kunal Shah, Founder of **CRED**, reportedly joined **Meta Platforms Inc.** and was appointed to lead **WhatsApp globally**.

Following his appointment at Meta, Kunal Shah **stepped away from his operational role as the Chief Executive Officer (CEO) of CRED**.

Meta Platforms Inc. remains a **minority investor in CRED** and **does not have access to CRED user data**.

Miten Sampat, who has been leading strategy and finance at CRED since 2020, was appointed as the **Interim CEO of CRED**.

499. Who chaired the 15th meeting of the Defence Information Technology Consultative Committee (DITCC) held in New Delhi on 23 June 2026?

A.Rajnath Singh

B.Ajit Doval

C.Sanjay Seth

D.General Upendra Dwivedi

E.Giridhar Aramane

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

Raksha Rajya Mantri Sanjay Seth chaired the **15th meeting** of the **Defence Information Technology Consultative Committee (DITCC)** on **23 June 2026** in **New Delhi**.

The meeting was conducted by the **Headquarters Integrated Defence Staff (HQ IDS)**.

A key focus of the meeting was **Aatma-Nirbharta (Self-Reliance)** in **Information Technology (IT)** and the **time-bound adoption of cutting-edge technologies**.

Detailed Explanation:

Raksha Rajya Mantri Sanjay Seth chaired the **15th meeting** of the **Defence Information Technology Consultative Committee (DITCC)** on **23 June 2026** in **New Delhi**.

The meeting was conducted by the **Headquarters Integrated Defence Staff (HQ IDS)**.

A key focus of the meeting was **Aatma-Nirbharta (Self-Reliance)** in **Information Technology (IT)** and the **time-bound adoption of cutting-edge technologies**.

Subject Matter Experts (SMEs) deliberated on important policy decisions related to the use of **disruptive technologies** in **Defence Services** amid the **changing nature of warfare**.

The Committee discussed the **changing paradigm of warfare** and the increasing role of **advanced digital technologies** in **defence preparedness**.

Members deliberated on the **indigenisation of advanced chip manufacturing** for strengthening India's **technological self-reliance**.

The development of a **sovereign Operating System (OS)** was a **major topic of discussion** during the meeting.

500. In news, INS Udaygiri and INS Kavaratti recently arrived at Nha Rong Port, Ho Chi Minh City during their operational deployment to which country?

A.Indonesia

B.Thailand

C.Malaysia

D.Vietnam

E.Philippines

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

INS Udaygiri is a **stealth frigate** of the **Indian Navy** and is **indigenously designed and constructed**.

INS Kavaratti is an **Anti-Submarine Warfare (ASW) Corvette** of the **Indian Navy** and is also **indigenously designed and constructed**.

INS Udaygiri and **INS Kavaratti** arrived at **Nha Rong Port, Ho Chi Minh City, Vietnam**, on **22 June 2026** during their **operational deployment** to the **South East Asia region**.

Detailed Explanation:

INS Udaygiri is a **stealth frigate** of the **Indian Navy** and is **indigenously designed and constructed**.

INS Kavaratti is an **Anti-Submarine Warfare (ASW) Corvette** of the **Indian Navy** and is also **indigenously designed and constructed**.

INS Udaygiri and **INS Kavaratti** arrived at **Nha Rong Port, Ho Chi Minh City, Vietnam**, on **22 June 2026** during their **operational deployment** to the **South East Asia region**.

The deployment was led by **Rear Admiral (RAdm) Alok Ananda**, **Flag Officer Commanding Eastern Fleet (FOCEF)**.

The Indian warships received a **warm ceremonial welcome** from the **Vietnam People's Navy**, representatives of the **Ho Chi Minh City (HCMC) People's Committee**, and **port authorities**.

The visit highlighted the **close and longstanding ties** between the **Indian Navy** and the **Vietnam People's Navy**.

The **port call** reflects the **growing maritime partnership** between **India and Vietnam**.

501. Recent in news, Exercise Pitch Black 2026, in which the Indian Air Force (IAF) will participate, is hosted by which country's air force?

A.United States Air Force

B.Royal Air Force (United Kingdom)

C.French Air and Space Force

D.Royal New Zealand Air Force

E.Royal Australian Air Force (RAAF)

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

The **Indian Air Force (IAF)** will participate in **Exercise Pitch Black 2026**, a major multinational air combat exercise hosted by the **Royal Australian Air Force (RAAF)**.

Exercise Pitch Black 2026 will be conducted in **Australia's Northern Territory** from **20 July to 7 August 2026**.

The exercise is regarded as one of the **largest and most significant air warfare exercises in the Indo-Pacific region**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Indian Air Force (IAF)** will participate in **Exercise Pitch Black 2026**, a major multinational air combat exercise hosted by the **Royal Australian Air Force (RAAF)**.

Exercise Pitch Black 2026 will be conducted in **Australia's Northern Territory** from **20 July to 7 August 2026**.

The exercise is regarded as one of the **largest and most significant air warfare exercises in the Indo-Pacific region**.

More than **100 aircraft and military personnel** will participate in the exercise.

The exercise will involve participation from **19 allied and partner nations**.

Exercise Pitch Black is the **premier multinational air combat exercise** of the Royal Australian Air Force (RAAF).

It is also the **largest international exercise** conducted by the RAAF.

The exercise is held across **one of the world's largest military training areas** in Australia.

The primary objective is to **enhance operational interoperability, strengthen military cooperation, and refine air combat tactics** under realistic and complex operational scenarios.

The exercise focuses on **air combat integration and advanced operational training** in challenging environments.

502. During the FIFA World Cup 2026, Lionel Messi became the highest goal scorer in FIFA World Cup history with a record tally of_____

A.16 goals

B.17 goals

C.18 goals

D.19 goals

E.20 goals

Answer: C

Argentina captain **Lionel Messi** became the highest goal scorer in **FIFA World Cup** history during the 2026 edition jointly hosted by the **United States**, **Canada** and **Mexico**.

Messi surpassed former Germany striker **Miroslav Klose** and reached a record tally of **18 FIFA World Cup goals**.

The achievement further strengthened Messi's status as one of the greatest footballers in the history of the sport.

Messi made his FIFA World Cup debut in **2006** and became the first player to participate in **six FIFA World Cup tournaments**.

503. In news, Argentina recently unveiled the world's tallest statue of Lionel Messi. What is the height of the statue?

A.20 metres

B.22 metres

C.24 metres

D.26 metres

E.30 metres

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

Argentina has unveiled the **world's tallest statue of Lionel Messi**, celebrating his legacy as one of the greatest footballers in history and the all-time leading scorer in **FIFA World Cup** history.

The massive monument stands **26 metres tall**, making it the largest statue dedicated to Lionel Messi anywhere in the world.

The statue is located near **National Route 22** in **Manuel Savio**, in **Neuquén Province**.

Detailed Explanation:

Argentina has unveiled the **world's tallest statue of Lionel Messi**, celebrating his legacy as one of the greatest footballers in history and the all-time leading scorer in **FIFA World Cup** history.

The massive monument stands **26 metres tall**, making it the largest statue dedicated to Lionel Messi anywhere in the world.

The statue is located near **National Route 22** in **Manuel Savio**, in **Neuquén Province**.

It depicts Messi wearing the Argentina national team jersey and holding the **FIFA World**

Cup trophy, commemorating Argentina's triumph at the **2022 FIFA World Cup**.
The monument has been constructed using a steel framework and concrete exterior and weighs approximately **70 tonnes**.
The project was designed and created by Argentine artist **Aldo Beroisa**.

504. As per the news, the Competition Commission of India (CCI) approved Honda Motor Co., Ltd.'s acquisition of what percentage of voting interest in Astemo, Ltd.?

A.15%
B.21%
C.18%
D.25%
E.30%

Answer: B

Short Explanation:
The **Competition Commission of India (CCI)** has approved the acquisition of a **21% voting interest** in **Astemo, Ltd.** by **Honda Motor Co., Ltd.**
The proposed combination involves **Honda Motor Co., Ltd. (Acquirer)** acquiring a **21% voting stake** in **Astemo, Ltd. (Target)** from **Hitachi, Ltd. (Seller)**.
Honda Motor Co., Ltd. is a limited liability joint stock corporation incorporated under the Companies Act of Japan as **Honda Giken Kogyo Kabushiki Kaisha**.
Honda Motor Co., Ltd. is the **flagship company** of the **Honda Group**.

Detailed Explanation:
The **Competition Commission of India (CCI)** has approved the acquisition of a **21% voting interest** in **Astemo, Ltd.** by **Honda Motor Co., Ltd.**
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Honda Motor Co., Ltd. is a limited liability joint stock corporation incorporated under the Companies Act of Japan as **Honda Giken Kogyo Kabushiki Kaisha**.
Honda Motor Co., Ltd. is the **flagship company** of the **Honda Group**.
In India, **Honda Motor Co., Ltd.** is engaged in the **manufacture and sale** of **automobiles, two-wheelers, and power products**.
In India, **Honda** is also involved in the **manufacture and sale of automotive components** for automobiles and two-wheelers.
The company additionally undertakes **research and development (R&D) activities** in India.
Astemo, Ltd. was originally incorporated in **2009** under the laws of Japan.
Astemo, Ltd. was **merged and integrated** in **2021**.

505. Recently, the PFRDA Pension Sahayak, recently launched by the Pension Fund Regulatory and Development Authority (PFRDA), replaced which earlier grievance redressal system?

A.Central Grievance Management System (CGMS)
B.Pension Facilitation System (PFS)
C.National Pension Grievance Portal (NPGP)
D.Unified Pension Service Platform (UPSP)
E.Pension Monitoring and Tracking System (PMTS)
Answer: A
Short Explanation:
The **Pension Fund Regulatory and Development Authority (PFRDA)** launched **PFRDA Pension Sahayak**, an **Artificial Intelligence (AI)-enabled** grievance redressal platform for pension subscribers.
PFRDA Pension Sahayak is designed for subscribers of pension schemes regulated by the **PFRDA**.
The primary objective of PFRDA Pension Sahayak is to provide a **simple, accessible, transparent, and efficient** grievance resolution mechanism.
The platform **consolidates multiple pension service channels** into a single integrated digital system.
PFRDA Pension Sahayak enables subscribers to **register complaints, track grievance status, and receive timely resolutions**.
The platform **replaces** the earlier **Central Grievance Management System (CGMS)**.
Detailed Explanation:
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The platform **consolidates multiple pension service channels** into a single integrated digital system.
PFRDA Pension Sahayak enables subscribers to **register complaints, track grievance status, and receive timely resolutions**.
The platform **replaces** the earlier **Central Grievance Management System (CGMS)**.
The new system integrates **web-based, mobile-based, and WhatsApp-based services** on a single platform.
A key feature of PFRDA Pension Sahayak is its **AI-enabled functionality**, which enhances grievance handling and user experience.
Subscribers can access the platform using their **mobile number and One-Time Password (OTP)**.
The new login process **eliminates the need to remember** the **Permanent Retirement Account Number (PRAN)** or account password.
All **PRANs linked to a single mobile number** are **automatically displayed** under one common login.

506. What is the name of India's first dedicated Wind Turbine Supply Chain Management Portal, launched by Union Minister Pralhad Joshi during the Global Wind Day Conference 2026?

A.WINDNET

B.WT-MARUT

C.VAYUSETU

D.WINDSARTHI

E.TURBINE INDIA

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Union Minister Pralhad Joshi launched **WT-MARUT** (Wind Turbine Materials and Resources Utility Tracker), India's **first dedicated Wind Turbine Supply Chain Management Portal**, during the **Global Wind Day Conference 2026** held in **Goa**.

WT-MARUT has been developed by the **Ministry of New and Renewable Energy (MNRE)** with support from the **Indian Wind Turbine Manufacturers Association (IWTMA)**.

Detailed Explanation:

Union Minister Pralhad Joshi launched **WT-MARUT** (Wind Turbine Materials and Resources Utility Tracker), India's **first dedicated Wind Turbine Supply Chain Management Portal**, during the **Global Wind Day Conference 2026** held in **Goa**.

WT-MARUT has been developed by the **Ministry of New and Renewable Energy (MNRE)** with support from the **Indian Wind Turbine Manufacturers Association (IWTMA)**.

The portal aims to **strengthen India's domestic wind energy manufacturing ecosystem** and **improve supply-chain transparency**.

Key objectives of WT-MARUT include **visibility into component sourcing, supplier discovery, ALMM compliance, supply-chain collaboration, and export readiness enhancement**.

ALMM stands for **Approved List of Models and Manufacturers**.

The conference theme was **"Wind Energy: From Ambition to Acceleration."**

India added a **record 6.1 GW of new wind capacity** in FY 2025-26, the **highest annual wind installation** achieved by the country.

The 6.1 GW addition represented a **46% year-on-year growth** over the previous year.

507. As of 2026, Researchers from which of the following locations recently used the GRAPES-3 (Gamma Ray Astronomy PeV EnergieS Phase-3) telescope to study how the Earth's upper atmospheric temperature and the Sun's magnetic field influence muons?

A.Delhi, Chennai, and Singapore

B.Bengaluru, Hyderabad, and Germany

C.Mumbai, Kochi, and Japan

D.Pune, Kolkata, and France

E.Ahmedabad, Thiruvananthapuram, and Australia

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

GRAPES-3 (Gamma Ray Astronomy PeV EnergieS Phase-3) is a **high-energy cosmic ray observatory** located in **Ooty, Tamil Nadu**.
GRAPES-3 is operated by the **Tata Institute of Fundamental Research (TIFR)**.
The primary objective of GRAPES-3 is to study the **origin, acceleration, and propagation of cosmic rays**.
Recently, researchers from **Mumbai, Kochi, and Japan** used the GRAPES-3 telescope to examine how the **Earth's upper atmospheric temperature and the Sun's magnetic field** influence muons.
Detailed Explanation:
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GRAPES-3 is operated by the **Tata Institute of Fundamental Research (TIFR)**.
The primary objective of GRAPES-3 is to study the **origin, acceleration, and propagation of cosmic rays**.
The observatory measures **Extensive Air Showers (EAS)** produced when high-energy cosmic rays or gamma rays enter the Earth's atmosphere.
GRAPES-3 studies cosmic rays in the **tera electronvolt (TeV) to peta electronvolt (PeV)** energy range.
Recently, researchers from **Mumbai, Kochi, and Japan** used the GRAPES-3 telescope to examine how the **Earth's upper atmospheric temperature and the Sun's magnetic field** influence muons.
Muons are **subatomic particles** generated when cosmic rays interact with Earth's atmosphere.

508. Recently, India has set a target of achieving how much Non-Fossil Fuel Capacity by the year 2030?
A.300 GW
B.400 GW
C.450 GW
D.500 GW
E.600 GW
Answer: D
India has set a target of achieving **500 GW of Non-Fossil Fuel Capacity by 2030**.
India has also committed to achieving **Net Zero Emissions by 2070**.
Nearly **250 participants** attended the Global Wind Day Conference 2026.
The conference was organized by **MNRE** in association with **IWTMA** (Indian Wind Turbine Manufacturers Association), **WIPPA** (Wind Independent Power Producers Association), and **IWPA** (Indian Wind Power Association).

509. In which city is the headquarters of the Fédération Internationale de Football Association (FIFA) situated?
A.Zurich
B.Paris
C.Geneva
D.Vienna
E.Brussels
Answer: A

About FIFA

Full Form: Fédération Internationale de Football Association (FIFA)

Established: 1904

Headquarters: Zurich, Switzerland

President: Gianni Infantino

510. In which state is ARIES (Aryabhatta Research Institute of Observational Sciences) situated?

A.Himachal Pradesh

B.Uttarakhand

C.Sikkim

D.Arunachal Pradesh

E.Jammu and Kashmir

Answer: B

About Aryabhatta Research Institute of Observational Sciences (ARIES)

Location: Nainital, Uttarakhand

Parent Department: Department of Science and Technology (DST)

Director: Manish Kumar Naja

Established: 1954

511. As of 2026, the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) issued the "RBI (Trade Receivables Discounting System) Directions, 2026" primarily to simplify onboarding for which category of enterprises and strengthen invoice financing?

A.Large Corporate Enterprises

B.Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises (MSMEs)

C.Startups registered under DPIIT only

D.Non-Banking Financial Companies (NBFCs)

E.Cooperative Banks

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** issued the **"RBI (Trade Receivables Discounting System) Directions, 2026"** to **simplify onboarding** for **Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises (MSMEs)** and strengthen **invoice financing**.

The revised directions aim to improve **ease of doing business**, enhance **operational efficiency**, and encourage **greater participation** on **TReDS platforms**.

TReDS (Trade Receivables Discounting System) is an **electronic marketplace** that enables MSMEs to convert approved invoices into **immediate cash** by **discounting their trade receivables**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** issued the **"RBI (Trade Receivables Discounting System) Directions, 2026"** to **simplify onboarding** for **Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises (MSMEs)** and strengthen **invoice financing**.

The revised directions aim to improve **ease of doing business**, enhance **operational efficiency**, and encourage **greater participation** on **TReDS platforms**.

TReDS (Trade Receivables Discounting System) is an **electronic marketplace** that enables MSMEs to convert approved invoices

into **immediate cash** by **discounting their trade receivables**.

The platform facilitates **financing of MSME trade receivables** from **corporate buyers**, **government departments**, and **Public Sector Undertakings (PSUs)**.

TReDS brings together participants for **invoice uploading**, **acceptance**, **bidding**, **discounting**, and **settlement**, thereby **improving liquidity** for MSMEs.

Under the new framework, **MSME sellers** will benefit from a **simplified onboarding process** on TReDS platforms.

The **RBI** has allowed financiers to avail **insurance cover** for TReDS transactions, provided the **insurance premium** is **not borne by the MSME seller**.

Such **credit insurance** cannot be treated as a **credit risk mitigant** for availing **prudential regulatory benefits**.

512. As of June 2026, which country became the 27th member nation of the International Big Cat Alliance (IBCA)?

A.Nepal

B.Sri Lanka

C.Myanmar

D.Bhutan

E.Bangladesh

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

Bangladesh joined the **International Big Cat Alliance (IBCA)** on **24 June 2026**, becoming the **27th member nation** of the alliance.

The **International Big Cat Alliance (IBCA)** is a **treaty-based inter-governmental international organisation** and a legal entity headquartered in **New Delhi, India**.

The **IBCA** was launched in **April 2023** by **Narendra Modi** during the commemoration of **50 years of Project Tiger**.

The alliance became a full-fledged **treaty-based international organisation** on **23 January 2025**.

Detailed Explanation:

Bangladesh joined the **International Big Cat Alliance (IBCA)** on **24 June 2026**, becoming the **27th member nation** of the alliance.

The **International Big Cat Alliance (IBCA)** is a **treaty-based inter-governmental international organisation** and a legal entity headquartered in **New Delhi, India**.

The **IBCA** was launched in **April 2023** by **Narendra Modi** during the commemoration of **50 years of Project Tiger**.

The alliance became a full-fledged **treaty-based international organisation** on **23 January 2025**.

The main objective of the IBCA is the **conservation, protection, and sustainable management of big cat species** through **international cooperation**.

The alliance promotes **knowledge-sharing**, **capacity building**, **technical expertise**, and **collaborative conservation efforts** among member countries.

The IBCA focuses on the conservation of **seven big cat species**: **Tiger, Lion, Leopard, Snow Leopard, Cheetah, Jaguar, and Puma**.

Bangladesh's Cabinet approved the proposal to join the IBCA on **22 May 2026**.

The proposal was initiated by **Bangladesh's Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change**.

513. In 2026, according to the United Nations Conference on Trade and Development (UNCTAD) report "Review of Maritime Transport 2025", what was India's share in global ship recycling in 2025?

A.30.1%

B.32.8%

C.35.4%

D.38.6%

E.40.0%

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The **Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways (MoPSW)** announced that India became the **world's leading ship recycling nation in 2025**.

India's share in global ship recycling increased to **35.4% in 2025** from **30.1% in 2024**.

The country's ship recycling volume rose to **2.99 million Gross Tons (GT)** from **1.86 million Gross Tons (GT)** in 2024, registering a growth of nearly **60%**.

With this achievement, India surpassed the target set under **Maritime India Vision (MIV) 2030 five years ahead of schedule**.

Detailed Explanation:

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With this achievement, India surpassed the target set under **Maritime India Vision (MIV) 2030 five years ahead of schedule**.

The achievement was highlighted in the **United Nations Conference on Trade and Development (UNCTAD)** report titled **"Review of Maritime Transport 2025"**.

A key factor behind this success is the **Ship-breaking Credit Note (SbCN) Scheme**.

Under the scheme, ship owners receive credits worth **40% of the scrap value**, which can be utilised up to **5% of the cost of a new vessel**.

The Government has also provided **₹53.5 crore** as modernization support to promote environmentally sustainable ship recycling practices.

The support has enabled **115 Hong Kong International Convention (HKC)-compliant ship recycling facilities** in the country.

514. In 2026, V.O. Chidambaranar Port Authority (VOCPA) achieved what percentage reduction in net carbon

emissions, emerging as a model for sustainable maritime development in India?

A.25%

B.35%

C.40%

D.45%

E.50%

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

Union Minister **Sarbananda Sonowal**, Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways (**MoPS&W**), announced that **V.O. Chidambaranar Port Authority (VOCPA)** has emerged as a model for sustainable maritime development in India.

The announcement was made at an event held at **Transport Bhawan, New Delhi**.

VOCPA achieved a **45% reduction in net carbon emissions**, highlighting its commitment to green and sustainable port operations.

Detailed Explanation:

Union Minister **Sarbananda Sonowal**, Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways (**MoPS&W**), announced that **V.O. Chidambaranar Port Authority (VOCPA)** has emerged as a model for sustainable maritime development in India.

The announcement was made at an event held at **Transport Bhawan, New Delhi**.

VOCPA achieved a **45% reduction in net carbon emissions**, highlighting its commitment to green and sustainable port operations.

The Union Minister dedicated **six key initiatives** undertaken by VOCPA in the fields of **education, green energy and digital transformation**.

During the event, VOCPA released its first comprehensive sustainability disclosure report titled **"VOCPA Sustainability Report 2026: Towards a Green Maritime Future"**.

A case study titled **"The Hydrogen Pivot: Orchestrating the Green Transition at V.O. Chidambaranar Port Authority"** was also released.

The case study was prepared by **Indian Institute of Management Calcutta** and highlights VOCPA's transition towards sustainable and hydrogen-based port operations.

515. In 2026, which city is hosting the BRICS Heads of Space Agencies (HOSA) Meeting, organised by ISRO and the Department of Space?

A.Bengaluru

B.New Delhi

C.Hyderabad

D.Chennai

E.Ahmedabad

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

India is hosting the **BRICS Heads of Space Agencies (HOSA) Meeting 2026** in Bengaluru, bringing together senior representatives and heads of space agencies from all **11 BRICS member countries**.

The meeting is being hosted by the **Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO)** and the **Department of Space (DoS)** with support from the **Ministry of External Affairs (MEA)**.

The event aligns with India's BRICS Chairship theme: **"Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability."**

Detailed Explanation:

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The meeting is being hosted by the **Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO)** and the **Department of Space (DoS)** with support from the **Ministry of External Affairs (MEA)**.

The event aligns with India's BRICS Chairship theme: **"Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability."**

The meeting serves as a platform for strengthening cooperation in **space exploration, satellite applications, Earth observation, remote sensing and emerging space technologies**.

Participating countries include **Brazil, Russia, India, China, South Africa, Egypt, Ethiopia, Indonesia, Iran, Saudi Arabia and the United Arab Emirates**.

A major focus of the meeting is **space sustainability**, including issues related to **space debris, orbital congestion, sustainable space operations and responsible satellite deployment**.

Member countries are expected to discuss **space debris mitigation measures, national regulatory frameworks and best practices for safe and sustainable space activities**.

516. In 2026, who was appointed as the Chairperson of the five-member committee constituted by the Rajasthan Government to prepare a draft law for the Uniform Civil Code (UCC)?

A.Justice Indu Malhotra

B.Justice Ranjana Prakash Desai

C.Justice R. Banumathi

D.Justice Gyan Sudha Misra

E.Justice Hima Kohli

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The **Government of Rajasthan** has constituted a **five-member committee** to prepare a draft law for the **Uniform Civil Code (UCC)** in the state.

The committee will be chaired by former Supreme Court judge **Ranjana Prakash Desai**.

The panel has been tasked with examining legal, social and administrative aspects related to the implementation of a Uniform Civil Code in Rajasthan.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Government of Rajasthan** has constituted a **five-member committee** to prepare a draft law for the **Uniform Civil Code (UCC)** in the state.

The committee will be chaired by former Supreme Court judge **Ranjana Prakash Desai**.

The panel has been tasked with examining legal, social and administrative aspects related

to the implementation of a Uniform Civil Code in Rajasthan.

The committee will hold consultations with citizens, legal experts, community representatives, religious leaders, women's organisations and social groups before submitting its recommendations.

To ensure wider public participation, the committee will visit divisional headquarters across Rajasthan and gather views from various stakeholders.

The state government will also launch a dedicated online portal through which citizens can submit suggestions and opinions.

A **Uniform Civil Code (UCC)** refers to a common set of civil laws applicable to all citizens irrespective of religion, caste or community.

517. In 2026, Indian-origin physicist Jainendra K. Jain received the 2025 Wolf Prize in Physics for his discovery of which concept that revolutionised the understanding of the Fractional Quantum Hall Effect (FQHE)?

A.Higgs Boson

B.Quantum Entanglement Network

C.Graphene Lattice Theory

D.Composite Fermions

E.Bose–Einstein Condensate

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

Jainendra K. Jain, an Indian-origin theoretical physicist based in the **United States of America (USA)**, received the **2025 Wolf Prize in Physics** for his discovery of **composite fermions**, a breakthrough that revolutionised the understanding of the **Fractional Quantum Hall Effect (FQHE)**.

He shared the award with **James P. Eisenstein** and **Mordehai Heiblum** for advancing the understanding of **two-dimensional electron systems in strong magnetic fields**.

Jain became the **first person of Indian origin** to receive the **Wolf Prize in Physics** since the award was established in **1978**.

Detailed Explanation:

Jainendra K. Jain, an Indian-origin theoretical physicist based in the **United States of America (USA)**, received the **2025 Wolf Prize in Physics** for his discovery of **composite fermions**, a breakthrough that revolutionised the understanding of the **Fractional Quantum Hall Effect (FQHE)**.

He shared the award with **James P. Eisenstein** and **Mordehai Heiblum** for advancing the understanding of **two-dimensional electron systems in strong magnetic fields**.

Jain became the **first person of Indian origin** to receive the **Wolf Prize in Physics** since the award was established in **1978**.

The discovery that earned him the award dates back to **1989**, when he was a postdoctoral scholar at **Yale University**.

The award was presented by **Isaac Herzog** at a state ceremony held in the **Knesset**, Jerusalem, Israel.

Jain is the **Founding Director** of the **Lodha Theoretical Physics Institute**, India's first fully privately funded institute dedicated to fundamental research in theoretical physics.

He also serves as **Evan Pugh University Professor** and **Eberly Family Chair in Physics** at **Pennsylvania State University**.

518. In 2026, consider the following statements regarding the Padma Awards:

1. **The Government of India announced a total of 131 Padma Awards for 2026.**
2. **The awards included 5 Padma Vibhushan, 13 Padma Bhushan, and 113 Padma Shri.**
3. **President Droupadi Murmu conferred 65 Padma Awards during the second phase of the investiture ceremony at Rashtrapati Bhavan.**

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

A.1 only

B.2 only

C.1 and 3 only

D.All are correct

E.2 and 3 only

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

President **Droupadi Murmu** conferred **65 Padma Awards** during the second phase of the **Padma Awards 2026** investiture ceremony held at **Rashtrapati Bhavan**.

The awards recognised distinguished contributions in fields such as sports, cinema, music, literature, public affairs, social service, science and culture.

The awards presented during the ceremony included:

2 Padma Vibhushan

7 Padma Bhushan

56 Padma Shri

Earlier, the Government of India had announced a total of **131 Padma Awards** for 2026, comprising:

5 Padma Vibhushan

13 Padma Bhushan

113 Padma Shri

Detailed Explanation:

President **Droupadi Murmu** conferred **65 Padma Awards** during the second phase of the **Padma Awards 2026** investiture ceremony held at **Rashtrapati Bhavan**.

The awards recognised distinguished contributions in fields such as sports, cinema, music, literature, public affairs, social service, science and culture.

The awards presented during the ceremony included:

2 Padma Vibhushan

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56 Padma Shri

Earlier, the Government of India had announced a total of **131 Padma Awards** for 2026, comprising:

5 Padma Vibhushan

13 Padma Bhushan

113 Padma Shri

Prominent personalities honoured during the ceremony included:

Rohit Sharma – Cricket

R. Madhavan – Cinema

Mammootty – Cinema

Alka Yagnik – Music

Vijay Amritraj – Sports

519. In 2026, who was appointed as the Executive Advisor to Air India Chairman N. Chandrasekaran?

A.Rajiv Bansal

B.Pradeep Singh Kharola

C.Campbell Wilson

D.Vistara Shankar

E.Ashwani Lohani

Answer: B

Pradeep Singh Kharola, former Chairman and Managing Director (**CMD**) of **Air India** and former **Secretary, Ministry of Civil Aviation (MoCA)**, has rejoined Air India as **Executive Advisor** to Chairman **N. Chandrasekaran**.

The appointment became **effective immediately** and is aimed at strengthening Air India's **leadership** during a period of **transition**.

Pradeep Singh Kharola will work closely with **N. Chandrasekaran**, Chairman of **Air India** and the **Tata Group**, on **strategic and operational matters**.

520. As of June 2026, approximately how many Indian Air Force (IAF) Su-30MKI fighter aircraft have been integrated with BrahMos-A supersonic cruise missiles?

A.20

B.30

C.40

D.50

E.60

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

As of **25 June 2026**, around **40 Indian Air Force (IAF) Su-30MKI fighter aircraft** have been integrated with **BrahMos-A supersonic cruise missiles**.

The **Su-30MKI** is a **twin-engine multirole fighter aircraft** developed by **Sukhoi (Russia)** and manufactured in India by **Hindustan Aeronautics Limited (HAL)** under licence.

The **Indian Air Force** currently operates a fleet of approximately **270 Su-30MKI fighter jets**, making it the **backbone of India's combat air power**.

Detailed Explanation:

As of **25 June 2026**, around **40 Indian Air Force (IAF) Su-30MKI fighter aircraft** have been integrated with **BrahMos-A supersonic cruise missiles**.

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The **Indian Air Force** currently operates a fleet of approximately **270 Su-30MKI fighter jets**, making it the **backbone of India's combat air power**.

BrahMos-A is the **air-launched version** of the **BrahMos supersonic cruise missile**.

BrahMos is a **joint India-Russia missile programme** developed by **BrahMos Aerospace** in collaboration with the **Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO)**.

The **BrahMos Joint Venture** between India and Russia was established in **1998**.

The **BrahMos missile** is among the world's **fastest operational supersonic cruise missiles**.

The missile can be launched from **land, sea, air, and submarine platforms**, making it a versatile **strategic weapon system**.

The air-launched **BrahMos-A weighs approximately 2.5 tonnes**, compared to nearly **3 tonnes for the land-based version**.

521. In 2026, AIR SUVIDHA 2.0 was launched by the Ministry of Civil Aviation (MoCA) and Delhi International Airport Limited (DIAL) primarily in response to the outbreak of which disease?

A.Monkeypox

B.COVID-19

C.Marburg Virus Disease

D.Nipah Virus Disease

E.Ebola (Bundibugyo Virus Disease)

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

The Ministry of Civil Aviation (MoCA) and **Delhi International Airport Limited (DIAL)** launched **AIR SUVIDHA 2.0**, an upgraded contactless **Passenger Health Self-Declaration Portal**.

AIR SUVIDHA 2.0 has been launched to strengthen **public health surveillance** at **Points of Entry (PoE)** in response to the ongoing **Ebola disease outbreak**.

The launch follows the **World Health Organization (WHO)** declaration of the **Ebola/Bundibugyo Virus Disease outbreak** as a **Public Health Emergency of International Concern (PHEIC)**.

Detailed Explanation:

The Ministry of Civil Aviation (MoCA) and **Delhi International Airport Limited (DIAL)** launched **AIR SUVIDHA 2.0**, an upgraded contactless **Passenger Health Self-Declaration Portal**.

AIR SUVIDHA 2.0 has been launched to strengthen **public health surveillance** at **Points of Entry (PoE)** in response to the ongoing **Ebola disease outbreak**.

The launch follows the **World Health Organization (WHO)** declaration of the **Ebola/Bundibugyo Virus Disease outbreak** as a **Public Health Emergency of International Concern (PHEIC)**.

The **PHEIC declaration** was made on **17 May 2026** under the **International Health Regulations (IHR) 2005**.

The current outbreak has been confirmed as **Bundibugyo Virus Disease (BVD)**.

Countries bordering the **Democratic Republic of the Congo (DRC)** and **Uganda**, including **South Sudan**, have been classified as **high-risk areas** for transmission.

AIR SUVIDHA 2.0 was developed in collaboration with the **Directorate General of Health Services (DGHS)** under the **Ministry of Health & Family Welfare (MoHFW)**.

522. In 2026, the National Pharmaceutical Pricing Authority (NPPA) integrated the Pharma Jan Samadhan Portal with which portal to provide a unified platform for medicine price verification and grievance redressal?

A.eSanjeevani Portal

B.Pharma Sahi Daam Portal

C.Jan Aushadhi Portal

D.National Digital Health Portal

E.PMBJP Portal

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The National Pharmaceutical Pricing Authority (NPPA) has integrated the **Pharma Jan Samadhan Portal** with the **Pharma Sahi Daam Portal** to strengthen citizen-centric digital governance.

The integration has been carried out under the **Department of Pharmaceuticals (DoP)**, **Ministry of Chemicals and Fertilizers**.

The **unified platform** combines **medicine price information** and **grievance redressal services** on a single digital portal.

Detailed Explanation:

The National Pharmaceutical Pricing Authority (NPPA) has integrated the **Pharma Jan Samadhan Portal** with the **Pharma Sahi Daam Portal** to strengthen citizen-centric digital governance.

The integration has been carried out under the **Department of Pharmaceuticals (DoP)**, **Ministry of Chemicals and Fertilizers**.

The **unified platform** combines **medicine price information** and **grievance redressal services** on a single digital portal.

Citizens can now seamlessly access both **medicine price verification** and **complaint registration services** through the integrated **Pharma Sahi Daam interface**.

The **Pharma Sahi Daam Portal** was developed to provide consumers with **instant access to prices** of scheduled and non-scheduled medicines.

The platform helps consumers verify whether medicines are being sold within **government-approved price limits**.

The **Pharma Jan Samadhan Portal** was designed to facilitate the **reporting and resolution of complaints** related to medicine pricing.

Prior to this integration, both services were connected through the mobile application, but operated through **separate web portals**.

523. In 2026, which of the following applications was launched by Union Minister Amit Shah to enhance biometric identification and criminal investigation capabilities?

A.e-Prosecution 2.0

B.CrPI (Criminal Procedure Identification)

C.Abhigyan

D.e-Forensics 2.0

E.ICJS Connect

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

Union Minister Amit Shah, holding the portfolios of **Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA)** and **Ministry of Cooperation**, launched **four digital policing applications** at the **26th All India Fingerprint Conference 2026** in **New Delhi**.

The four applications launched by the **National Crime Records Bureau (NCRB)** are **Abhigyan**, **Criminal Procedure Identification (CrPI)**, **e-Prosecution 2.0**, and **e-Forensics 2.0**.

These applications are designed to strengthen the **Integrated Criminal Justice System (ICJS)** through **Artificial Intelligence (AI)-driven biometric identification**, **forensic integration**, and **digital prosecution management**.

Detailed Explanation:

Union Minister Amit Shah, holding the portfolios of **Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA)** and **Ministry of Cooperation**, launched **four digital policing applications** at the **26th All India Fingerprint Conference 2026** in **New Delhi**.

The four applications launched by the **National Crime Records Bureau (NCRB)** are **Abhigyan**, **Criminal Procedure Identification (CrPI)**, **e-Prosecution 2.0**, and **e-Forensics 2.0**.

These applications are designed to strengthen the **Integrated Criminal Justice System (ICJS)** through **Artificial Intelligence (AI)-driven biometric identification**, **forensic integration**, and **digital prosecution management**.

The primary objective of the initiative is to ensure **faster investigation, prosecution, and conviction** through seamless integration of **police**, **forensic**, and **judicial systems**.

The government aims to complete the entire **criminal justice process within three years**, from **First Information Report (FIR) registration** to **conviction**.

The **National Crime Records Bureau (NCRB)**, an organization under the **Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA)**, developed all four digital applications.

Abhigyan is designed to enhance **biometric identification and criminal investigation capabilities**.

CrPI (Criminal Procedure Identification) supports digital management of criminal identification records and procedures.

e-Prosecution 2.0 aims to improve the efficiency of **prosecution management** and facilitate the **speedy disposal of pending cases**.

e-Forensics 2.0 strengthens the integration of **forensic science** into criminal investigations and judicial proceedings.

524. In 2026, NASA's Swift Boost Mission is primarily aimed at extending the operational life of which space observatory?

A.Hubble Space Telescope

B.Chandra X-ray Observatory

C.James Webb Space Telescope

D.Neil Gehrels Swift Observatory

E.Spitzer Space Telescope

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

The **National Aeronautics and Space Administration (NASA)** is preparing the **Swift Boost Mission** to **raise the orbit** of the **Neil Gehrels Swift Observatory**, a space telescope launched in **November 2004**.

The **Neil Gehrels Swift Observatory** is a U.S. government scientific satellite designed for **astrophysical observations**, particularly the study of **gamma-ray bursts** and other cosmic phenomena.

Detailed Explanation:

The **National Aeronautics and Space Administration (NASA)** is preparing the **Swift Boost Mission** to **raise the orbit** of the **Neil Gehrels Swift Observatory**, a space telescope launched in **November 2004**.

The **Neil Gehrels Swift Observatory** is a U.S. government scientific satellite designed for **astrophysical observations**, particularly the study of **gamma-ray bursts** and other cosmic phenomena.

The observatory is gradually **losing altitude** due to **atmospheric drag** caused by **increased solar activity**.

Without intervention, the observatory could **re-enter Earth's atmosphere** by **late 2026**.

The primary objective of the **Swift Boost Mission** is to **increase the satellite's orbit** and **extend its operational life**.

The mission is scheduled for launch on **27 June 2026**.

The mission will be launched aboard a **Pegasus XL rocket** developed by **Northrop Grumman**

225. In 2026, the Biopolymer-Based Smart Seed Coating Technology developed by ICAR–Indian Institute of Oilseeds Research (ICAR-IIOR) has the potential to increase crop yields by up to_____

A.25%

B.30%

C.37%

D.42%

E.50%

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The **Indian Institute of Oilseeds Research (ICAR-IIOR), Hyderabad**, has developed and patented a **Biopolymer-Based Smart Seed Coating Technology** to improve seed quality, crop establishment, and resilience against biotic and abiotic stresses.

According to the **Indian Council of Agricultural Research (ICAR)**, the technology has the potential to **increase crop yields by up to 37%**.

Extensive **field trials** were conducted across **seven major crops**: **Soybean, Maize, Groundnut, Chickpea, Cotton, Mustard, and Pigeon Pea**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Indian Institute of Oilseeds Research (ICAR-IIOR), Hyderabad**, has developed and patented a **Biopolymer-Based Smart Seed Coating Technology** to improve seed quality, crop establishment, and resilience against biotic and abiotic stresses.

The **Smart Seed Coating Technology** is an **Indian-patented, biodegradable seed enhancement platform** designed to improve crop performance from the earliest stages of growth.

The innovation replaces conventional single-purpose seed treatments with a **multifunctional protective shield** that enhances **germination, seedling vigor, and crop productivity**.

The technology aligns with national priorities related to **sustainable agriculture, climate resilience, improved seed systems**, and **resource-use efficiency**.

According to the **Indian Council of Agricultural Research (ICAR)**, the technology has the potential to **increase crop yields by up to 37%**.

Extensive **field trials** were conducted across **seven major crops**: **Soybean, Maize, Groundnut, Chickpea, Cotton, Mustard, and Pigeon Pea**.

Field trials demonstrated **productivity gains ranging from 12% to 37%** compared to untreated seeds.

526. In 2026, which state government signed a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) with Google for Education to provide Artificial Intelligence (AI) and digital technology training to more than 4 lakh teachers?

A.Karnataka

B.Gujarat

C.Telangana

D.Tamil Nadu

E.Maharashtra

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

The **Maharashtra School Education Department** signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** with **Google for Education** to provide **Artificial Intelligence (AI)** and digital technology training to more than **4 lakh teachers** across the state.

Under the programme, selected **Master Trainers** will first receive specialised training and will subsequently train teachers throughout Maharashtra.

The initiative aims to enhance **Artificial Intelligence literacy**, digital skills and technology-enabled teaching practices among educators.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Maharashtra School Education Department** signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** with **Google for Education** to provide **Artificial Intelligence (AI)** and digital technology training to more than **4 lakh teachers** across the state.

Under the programme, selected **Master Trainers** will first receive specialised training and will subsequently train teachers throughout Maharashtra.

The initiative aims to enhance **Artificial Intelligence literacy**, digital skills and technology-enabled teaching practices among educators.

Training content will be provided in **Marathi, Hindi and English** to ensure wider accessibility and effective learning.

The programme will promote the use of **Google's Artificial Intelligence tools** for educational purposes and support teachers' professional development.

The entire training programme will be provided **free of cost by Google**, resulting in **no financial burden on the Maharashtra Government**.

The Maharashtra Government will retain full control over the implementation process while ensuring **digital safety and security** for teachers.

527. In 2026, consider the following statements regarding the QS World Future Skills Index 2027:

1. **The United States secured the 1st position in the index.**
2. **The QS World Future Skills Index 2027 assessed 89 countries.**
3. **India secured the 12th position globally in the index.**

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

A.1 only

B.2 and 3 only

C.1 and 3 only

D.1 and 2 only

E.All are correct

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

India secured the **13th position globally** in the **QS World Future Skills Index 2027**, released by **QS Quacquarelli Symonds (QS)**, a global higher education analytics firm.

The **QS World Future Skills Index 2027** assessed **89 countries** using higher education data, labour market indicators, Artificial Intelligence readiness metrics and economic transformation measures.

The **top three countries** in the **QS World Future Skills Index 2027** are:

United States

Australia

United Kingdom

Detailed Explanation:

India secured the **13th position globally** in the **QS World Future Skills Index 2027**, released by **QS Quacquarelli Symonds (QS)**, a global higher education analytics firm.

The index highlights India's growing readiness for an **Artificial Intelligence (AI)-driven economy** and recognises India as one of the strongest-performing **lower-middle-income economies** in preparing for AI-led economic transformation.

The **QS World Future Skills Index 2027** assessed **89 countries** using higher education data, labour market indicators, Artificial Intelligence readiness metrics and economic transformation measures.

India achieved an overall score of **89.4 out of 100** and was described in the report as possessing **"exceptional system scale"**.

The report identified India as one of the countries best positioned to accelerate **Artificial Intelligence-led economic growth** among developing economies.

The **top three countries** in the **QS World Future Skills Index 2027** are:

United States

Australia

United Kingdom

With its 13th rank, India is among the leading countries preparing for future digital and technology-driven economies and ranks ahead of many emerging economies.

528. In 2026, Cristiano Ronaldo became the first footballer to score in how many different FIFA World Cup tournaments?

A.Three

B.Four

C.Five

D.Six

E.Seven

Answer: D

Portugal captain **Cristiano Ronaldo** created football history by becoming the **first player to score in six different FIFA World Cup tournaments**.

He achieved the milestone during Portugal's **5-0 victory over Uzbekistan** in the **2026 FIFA World Cup**.

At **41 years of age**, Ronaldo continued his remarkable international career by scoring twice in the match.

His first goal came in the sixth minute after receiving a cross from **João Cancelo**.

The goal ensured that Ronaldo had scored in six separate FIFA World Cup editions, a feat never achieved before in men's or women's football.

529. As of 2026, the International Day Against Drug Abuse and Illicit Trafficking is observed every year on_____

A.21 June

B.23 June

C.26 June

D.30 June

E.1 July

Answer: C

The **International Day Against Drug Abuse and Illicit Trafficking** is observed every year on **26 June** to raise awareness about the harmful effects of drug abuse and illicit drug trafficking on individuals, families, and society. The day promotes global action to prevent drug abuse, strengthen rehabilitation efforts, and combat illegal drug trade.

The observance was established by the **United Nations General Assembly (UNGA)** through **Resolution 42/112** on **7 December 1987**.

530. In 2026, Francois Englert, who passed away at the age of 93, was jointly awarded the 2013 Nobel Prize in Physics with whom?

A.Stephen Hawking

B.Peter Higgs

C.David Gross

D.Frank Wilczek

E.Gerard 't Hooft

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Francois Englert, the renowned **Belgian theoretical physicist**, passed away at the age of **93 years** in **Uccle, Brussels, Belgium**.

Francois Englert was one of the key scientists behind the **theoretical framework** that led to the discovery of the **Higgs Boson**, often referred to as the **"God Particle."**

Francois Englert was awarded the **2013 Nobel Prize in Physics** jointly with **Peter Higgs**.

Detailed Explanation:

Francois Englert, the renowned **Belgian theoretical physicist**, passed away at the age of **93 years** in **Uccle, Brussels, Belgium**.

Francois Englert was one of the key scientists behind the **theoretical framework** that led to the discovery of the **Higgs Boson**, often referred to as the **"God Particle."**

His work helped explain how **fundamental particles acquire mass**, one of the most important questions in **modern physics**.

Francois Englert was awarded the **2013 Nobel Prize in Physics** jointly with **Peter Higgs**.

The **Nobel Prize** was awarded for the **theoretical discovery of a mechanism** that contributes to our understanding of the **origin of mass of subatomic particles**.

531. In 2026, under the RBI's Responsible Business Conduct Third Amendment Directions, 2026, what is the compensation payable to an eligible bona fide individual victim of a fraudulent Electronic Banking Transaction (EBT) involving a loss of up to ₹50,000?

A.100% of the net loss without any upper limit

B.85% of the net loss or ₹25,000, whichever is lower

C.75% of the net loss or ₹50,000, whichever is lower

D.90% of the net loss or ₹30,000, whichever is lower

E.Fixed compensation of ₹50,000

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** has issued the **Responsible Business Conduct Third Amendment Directions, 2026** to introduce a **revised compensation framework** for victims of **fraudulent Electronic Banking Transactions (EBTs)**.

The **new RBI directions** will come into effect from **1 January 2027**.

Under the revised framework, a **bona fide individual victim** who suffers a **digital payment fraud** involving a loss of up to **₹50,000** will be eligible for compensation if the fraud is reported **within 5 calendar days**.

Eligible customers will receive **85% of the net loss or ₹25,000, whichever is lower**, as compensation.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** has issued the **Responsible Business Conduct Third Amendment Directions, 2026** to introduce a **revised compensation framework** for victims of **fraudulent Electronic Banking Transactions (EBTs)**.

The **new RBI directions** will come into effect from **1 January 2027**.

Under the revised framework, a **bona fide individual victim** who suffers a **digital payment fraud** involving a loss of up to **₹50,000** will be eligible for compensation if the fraud is reported **within 5 calendar days**.

The fraud must be reported to both the **National Cyber Crime Portal/Helpline 1930** and the **concerned bank** within the prescribed timeline.

Eligible customers will receive **85% of the net loss or ₹25,000, whichever is lower**, as compensation.

The **compensation benefit** under this scheme can be availed **only once in a lifetime**.

Customers will have **zero liability** if the fraud occurs due to **bank negligence** or a **third-party system breach**, provided the incident is reported within the specified time.

532. In 2026, under the revised Scale-Based Regulatory (SBR) Framework, an NBFC will be automatically classified as an NBFC-Upper Layer (NBFC-UL) if it has an asset size of at least:

A.₹50,000 crore

B.₹75,000 crore

C.₹1,00,000 crore

D.₹1,50,000 crore

E.₹2,00,000 crore

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** has revised the **Scale-Based Regulatory (SBR) Framework** for **Non-Banking Financial Companies (NBFCs)** to simplify the identification of **NBFC-Upper Layer (NBFC-UL)** entities.

Under the revised framework, any NBFC with an **asset size of ₹1,00,000 crore (₹1 lakh crore) or more**, based on its latest audited balance sheet, will be **automatically classified as an NBFC-Upper Layer (NBFC-UL)**.

The **₹1 lakh crore asset-size threshold** for identifying NBFC-ULs will be **reviewed by RBI every three years**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** has revised the **Scale-Based Regulatory (SBR) Framework** for **Non-Banking Financial Companies (NBFCs)** to simplify the identification of **NBFC-Upper Layer (NBFC-UL)** entities.

Under the revised framework, any NBFC with an **asset size of ₹1,00,000 crore (₹1 lakh crore) or more**, based on its latest audited balance sheet, will be **automatically classified as an NBFC-Upper Layer (NBFC-UL)**.

The **₹1 lakh crore asset-size threshold** for identifying NBFC-ULs will be **reviewed by RBI every three years**.

For the first time, **eligible Government-owned NBFCs** will also be included in the **NBFC-Upper Layer (NBFC-UL)** based on the revised asset-size criterion.

Fully Government-owned and controlled NBFC-ULs have been **exempted from certain governance and financial disclosure requirements**.

The RBI has **withdrawn earlier exemptions** granted to Government-owned NBFCs from **credit concentration and investment concentration norms**.

Government-owned NBFCs must now **comply with the prudential exposure limits** applicable to the regulatory layer in which they are classified.

The RBI has **permitted all NBFC-Upper Layer (NBFC-UL) entities** to use **State Government guarantees** as eligible **credit risk transfer instruments** without any limit, subject to prescribed conditions.

Exposures backed by State Government guarantees will carry a **20% risk weight** and will be treated as exposures to the respective State Governments.

The **Scale-Based Regulatory (SBR) Framework** was introduced by the RBI on **22 October 2021** and became effective from **1 October 2022**.

533. In 2026, Skydo became the first Indian cross-border payments company to receive overseas regulatory approval after securing an international payment license under which country's Retail Payment Activities Act (RPAA)?

A.Canada

B.Singapore

C.Australia

D.United Kingdom

E.United States

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

Skydo, an Indian **Business-to-Business (B2B)** cross-border payments platform, secured an **international payment license in Canada**, marking its first regulatory approval outside India.

With this achievement, Skydo became the **first Indian cross-border payments company** to receive regulatory approval overseas.

The payment license was granted under Canada's **Retail Payment Activities Act (RPAA)**.

Detailed Explanation:

Skydo, an Indian **Business-to-Business (B2B)** cross-border payments platform, secured an **international payment license in Canada**, marking its first regulatory approval outside India.

With this achievement, Skydo became the **first Indian cross-border payments company** to receive regulatory approval overseas.

The payment license was granted under Canada's **Retail Payment Activities Act (RPAA)**.

The licensed payment activities are regulated and monitored by the **Bank of Canada**.

The approval enables Skydo to facilitate cross-border payment flows between India and Canada with **settlement timelines of approximately two days**.

534. In 2026, according to S&P Global Ratings' Economic Outlook Asia-Pacific Q3 2026 report, what is the revised GDP growth forecast for India for FY2026–27 (FY27)?

A.6.2%

B.6.6%

C.6.4%

D.6.8%

E.7.0%

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Standard & Poor's (S&P) Global Ratings released its **Economic Outlook Asia-Pacific Q3 2026** report titled **"AI (Artificial Intelligence)-Exposed Markets to Outperform."**

In the report, S&P Global Ratings revised **India's Gross Domestic Product** (**GDP**) **growth forecast for** Financial Year 2026-27 **(FY27) downward to 6.6%**.

The revised **6.6% GDP growth forecast** is in line with the **Reserve Bank of India's (RBI)** projection for FY27.

Detailed Explanation:

Standard & Poor's (S&P) Global Ratings released its **Economic Outlook Asia-Pacific Q3 2026** report titled **"AI (Artificial Intelligence)-Exposed Markets to Outperform."**

In the report, S&P Global Ratings revised **India's Gross Domestic Product** (**GDP**) **growth forecast for** Financial Year 2026-27 **(FY27) downward to 6.6%**.

The revised **6.6% GDP growth forecast** is in line with the **Reserve Bank of India's (RBI)** projection for FY27.

According to S&P, the downward revision is primarily due to **energy stress**, a **sub-par monsoon**, and **slowing global economic growth**.

The report states that India's economy grew by **7.7% in FY26**.

India's GDP growth was **7.1% in FY25**.

S&P projects India's economic growth to improve to **7.2% in FY28**.

The agency further forecasts GDP growth of **7.0% in FY29**.

Retail Inflation is expected to be **0.5–0.6 percentage points higher** during **Q3 of FY27 (October–December 2026)**.

S&P projects India's inflation rate to rise to **5.1% during FY27**.

The report notes that the impact of **El Niño** has weakened the **South-West Monsoon**, leading to a **43% rainfall deficit as of 22 June 2026**.

535. In 2026, consider the following statements regarding the Revised Budget 2026–27 of Kerala:

1. **The Fiscal Deficit is estimated at 3.46% of Gross State Domestic Product (GSDP) for FY2026–27.**
2. **Mission Samudra has been allocated ₹400 crore to integrate the state's coastline, ports, and inland waterways.**
3. **The Oommen Chandy Health Insurance Scheme provides health insurance coverage of up to ₹10 lakh per family.**

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

A.1 and 2 only

B.2 and 3 only

C.1 and 3 only

D.All are correct

E.2 only

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

Kerala Chief Minister V.D. Satheesan, who also holds the **Finance portfolio**, presented the **Revised Budget for Financial Year 2026-27** in the **Kerala Legislative Assembly** at **Thiruvananthapuram**.

The revised budget focuses on **infrastructure development, social welfare, education, healthcare, and employment generation**, while ensuring fiscal consolidation.

The budget estimates **Revenue Receipts** at **Rs. 1,69,646.37 crore** and **Revenue Expenditure** at **Rs. 2,05,001.67 crore**.

The **Fiscal Deficit** is estimated at **3.46% of Gross State Domestic Product (GSDP)** for Financial Year 2026-27, compared to **3.78%** in the previous financial year.

The budget announced **Mission Samudra** with an allocation of **Rs. 400 crore** to integrate the state's coastline, ports, and inland waterways.

Under aviation and corridor development, **Rs. 200 crore** has been allocated for an **Aviation Hub**.

Detailed Explanation:

Kerala Chief Minister V.D. Satheesan, who also holds the **Finance portfolio**, presented the **Revised Budget for Financial Year 2026-27** in the **Kerala Legislative Assembly** at **Thiruvananthapuram**.

The revised budget focuses on **infrastructure development, social welfare, education, healthcare, and employment generation**, while ensuring fiscal consolidation.

The budget estimates **Revenue Receipts** at **Rs. 1,69,646.37 crore** and **Revenue Expenditure** at **Rs. 2,05,001.67 crore**.

The **Fiscal Deficit** is estimated at **3.46% of Gross State Domestic Product (GSDP)** for Financial Year 2026-27, compared to **3.78%** in the previous financial year.

The budget announced **Mission Samudra** with an allocation of **Rs. 400 crore** to integrate the state's coastline, ports, and inland waterways.

Under aviation and corridor development, **Rs. 200 crore** has been allocated for an **Aviation Hub**.

The budget earmarked **Rs. 50 crore** for an **Economic Corridor** and **Rs. 100 crore** for a **Mineral Corridor**.

In the education and healthcare sector, **Rs. 100 crore** has been allocated for the **Life Science City** project.

An allocation of **Rs. 10 crore** has been made for the **Oommen Chandy Health Insurance Scheme**.

The scheme provides health insurance coverage of up to **Rs. 25 lakh per family**.

536. In 2026, Garden Reach Shipbuilders and Engineers (GRSE) Limited was upgraded to Navratna status. It became the ____ Navratna Central Public Sector Enterprise (CPSE) in India

A.25th

B.27th

C.28th

D.29th

E.30th

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

The **Department of Public Enterprises (DPE)** under the **Ministry of Finance (MoF)** upgraded **Garden Reach Shipbuilders and Engineers (GRSE) Limited** from **Miniratna Category-I** to **Navratna Central Public Sector Enterprise (CPSE)** status.

The upgrade was approved by **Union Minister for Finance Nirmala Sitharaman**.

Garden Reach Shipbuilders and Engineers Limited functions under the **Ministry of Defence (MoD)**.

With this recognition, **GRSE became the 29th Navratna Central Public Sector Enterprise in India**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Department of Public Enterprises (DPE)** under the **Ministry of Finance (MoF)** upgraded **Garden Reach Shipbuilders and Engineers (GRSE) Limited** from **Miniratna Category-I** to **Navratna Central Public Sector Enterprise (CPSE)** status.

The upgrade was approved by **Union Minister for Finance Nirmala Sitharaman**.

Garden Reach Shipbuilders and Engineers Limited functions under the **Ministry of Defence (MoD)**.

With this recognition, **GRSE became the 29th Navratna Central Public Sector Enterprise in India**.

The company reported strong financial performance, with revenue increasing

nearly **300%** from **Rs.1,754 crore in Financial Year 2021-22** to **Rs.7,002 crore in Financial Year 2025-26**.

The Navratna status provides enhanced autonomy for investment decisions and strategic business expansion.

Under Navratna status, the company can invest up to **Rs.1,000 crore** or **15% of its net worth per project** without prior Government approval.

The enhanced autonomy will enable faster financial and operational decision-making and support the company's growth in the defence sector.

537. In 2026, the Defence Security Cooperation Agency (DSCA) of the United States proposed a Foreign Military Sales (FMS) package worth approximately how much for sustainment support of India's AH-64E Apache Attack Helicopters and M777A2 Ultra-Light Howitzers?

A.USD 382.2 million

B.USD 432.2 million

C.USD 482.2 million

D.USD 520.0 million

E.USD 582.2 million

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The **Defence Security Cooperation Agency (DSCA)** of the United States of America (USA) notified the proposed sale of **sustainment support services and related equipment** for India's **AH-64E Apache Attack Helicopters** and **M777A2 Ultra-Light Howitzers**.

The proposed **Foreign Military Sales (FMS)** package is valued at an estimated **USD 482.2 million**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Defence Security Cooperation Agency (DSCA)** of the United States of America (USA) notified the proposed sale of **sustainment support services and related equipment** for India's **AH-64E Apache Attack Helicopters** and **M777A2 Ultra-Light Howitzers**.

The proposed **Foreign Military Sales (FMS)** package is valued at an estimated **USD 482.2 million**.

The DSCA administers the **Foreign Military Sales (FMS) Programme** of the United States, which facilitates defence equipment sales to allied countries.

The proposed package includes a **USD 230 million** long-term sustainment support programme for **M777A2 Ultra-Light Howitzers**.

It also includes a **USD 198.2 million** sustainment package for **AH-64E Apache Attack Helicopters**.

The support package aims to improve the **maintenance, operational readiness, logistics, and long-term serviceability** of India's defence platforms.

Boeing and Lockheed Martin will serve as the principal contractors for the Apache helicopter support programme.

BAE Systems will be the principal contractor for the M777A2 Ultra-Light Howitzer sustainment package.

538. Who administered the oath/affirmation to the 10 newly elected/re-elected Members of the Rajya Sabha in 2026?

A.Jagdeep Dhankhar

B.Om Birla

C.Harivansh Narayan Singh

D.Arjun Ram Meghwal

E.C. P. Radhakrishnan

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

C. P. Radhakrishnan, Chairman of the Rajya Sabha, administered the oath/affirmation to **10 newly elected/re-elected Members of Rajya Sabha** in the Rajya Sabha Chamber.

The **10 Members** who took the oath/affirmation are **Praveen Chakravarty, Debashish Samantaray, Sana Satish Babu, Vijay Chintakayala, Bhashyam Rama Krishna, Lingamaneni Ramesh, Rajesh Parmanand Shukla, Baidyanath Ram, Nathwani Parimal, and Tai Tagak**.

Among the Members, **5 took the oath/affirmation in Hindi, 1 in English, 1 in Tamil, and 3 in Telugu**.

Detailed Explanation:

C. P. Radhakrishnan, Chairman of the Rajya Sabha, administered the oath/affirmation to **10 newly elected/re-elected Members of Rajya Sabha** in the Rajya Sabha Chamber.

The **10 Members** who took the oath/affirmation are **Praveen Chakravarty, Debashish Samantaray, Sana Satish Babu, Vijay Chintakayala, Bhashyam Rama Krishna, Lingamaneni Ramesh, Rajesh Parmanand Shukla, Baidyanath Ram, Nathwani Parimal, and Tai Tagak**.

Among the Members, **5 took the oath/affirmation in Hindi, 1 in English, 1 in Tamil, and 3 in Telugu**.

Andhra Pradesh contributed the **highest number of Members (4)** among those who took the oath.

Jharkhand was represented by **2 Members**.

Tamil Nadu, Gujarat, Arunachal Pradesh, and Odisha were represented by **1 Member each**.

Arjun Ram Meghwal, Minister of State for Law and Justice, attended the oath-taking ceremony.

539. In news, the Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO) handed over the Final Operational Clearance (FOC) certificate of which indigenously developed system to the Indian Air Force (IAF) in 2026?

A.Akash-NG Air Defence System

B.Netra Airborne Early Warning and Control (AEW&C) System

C.Astra Mk-II Missile System

D.Arudhra Medium Power Radar

E.QRSAM Air Defence System

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO) handed over the **Final**

Operational Clearance (FOC) certificate of the indigenous **Netra Airborne Early Warning and Control (AEW&C) System** to the **Indian Air Force (IAF)**.

The Netra AEW&C System has been **indigenously developed** through close collaboration between the **DRDO, Indian Air Force (IAF), and Indian defence industry**.

Detailed Explanation:

Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO) handed over the **Final Operational Clearance (FOC) certificate** of the indigenous **Netra Airborne Early Warning and Control (AEW&C) System** to the **Indian Air Force (IAF)**.

The Netra AEW&C System has been **indigenously developed** through close collaboration between the **DRDO, Indian Air Force (IAF), and Indian defence industry**.

The system significantly enhances **airborne surveillance, situational awareness, battle management, and air defence capabilities** of the Indian Air Force.

The Netra AEW&C programme is a major milestone in India's **self-reliance (Aatmanirbhar Bharat)** in advanced aerospace and defence technologies.

The **Initial Operational Clearance (IOC)** for the Netra AEW&C System was granted in **2017**.

The **Final Operational Clearance (FOC)** ceremony was held on **25 June 2026** in **Bengaluru, Karnataka**.

The ceremony was presided over by **Awadhesh Kumar Bharti**, Deputy Chief of the Air Staff.

540. Which company is constructing the six Next Generation Offshore Patrol Vessels (NGOPVs) for the Indian Coast Guard (ICG) under a contract signed in December 2023?

A.Cochin Shipyard Limited (CSL)

B.Garden Reach Shipbuilders & Engineers (GRSE)

C.Goa Shipyard Limited (GSL)

D.Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders Limited (MDL)

E.Hindustan Shipyard Limited (HSL)

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

The **keel-laying ceremony** of the **4th Next Generation Offshore Patrol Vessel (NGOPV)** for the **Indian Coast Guard (ICG)** was held on **25 June 2026** in **Mumbai, Maharashtra**.

The 4th NGOPV is one of the **six Next Generation Offshore Patrol Vessels** being constructed by **Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders Limited (MDL)** for the Indian Coast Guard (ICG).

The contract for the construction of six NGOPVs between MDL and the Indian Coast Guard was signed on **20 December 2023**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **keel-laying ceremony** of the **4th Next Generation Offshore Patrol Vessel (NGOPV)** for the **Indian Coast Guard (ICG)** was held on **25 June 2026** in **Mumbai, Maharashtra**.

The 4th NGOPV is one of the **six Next Generation Offshore Patrol Vessels** being

constructed by **Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders Limited (MDL)** for the Indian Coast Guard (ICG).

The contract for the construction of six NGOPVs between MDL and the Indian Coast Guard was signed on **20 December 2023**.

The NGOPVs are being **indigenously designed, developed, and constructed** under the Government of India's **Aatmanirbhar Bharat** initiative.

The keel-laying ceremony marks a **major milestone** in the ship construction process and reflects the steady progress of the **NGOPV Programme**.

The ceremony was held at **MDL's Nhava Yard** in Mumbai.

The Next Generation Offshore Patrol Vessels are equipped with **modern machinery and state-of-the-art systems** to enhance operational efficiency.

541. As per the news, the IndiaAI Fellowship 2025–26, awarded by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY), provides financial assistance of how much to each selected recipient for research and innovation projects?

A.₹50,000

B.₹75,000

C.₹1 lakh

D.₹2 lakh

E.₹5 lakh

Answer: C

The **Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY)** awarded the **IndiaAI Fellowship 2025-26** to **seven students** of **Chandigarh University (CU)**, Chandigarh.

The **IndiaAI Fellowship** is a flagship initiative launched in **2024** under the **IndiaAI Mission's Future Skills Pillar**.

The fellowship supports engineering students undertaking innovative projects in **Artificial Intelligence (AI)** and **Machine Learning (ML)**.

The selected students include **Shreyam Sinha, Harpreet Singh, Ashirvad Satyendra Singh, Kirti Upadhyay, Muskan, Saurav Yadav, and Shubham Bajaj**.

Under the fellowship, each recipient will receive **Rs. 1 lakh** for their research and innovation projects.

542. As of 2026, Himachal Pradesh Government signed implementation agreements for 19 hydropower projects with a combined power generation capacity of _____ MW.

A.150 MW

B.278 MW

C.288 MW

D.336 MW

E.500 MW

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The **Himachal Pradesh Government**, under **Chief Minister Sukhvinder Singh**

Sukhu, signed implementation agreements for **19 hydropower projects** in 2026.

The projects have a combined generation capacity of **278 Megawatts (MW)** and involve an investment of **Rs. 3,336 crore**.

The initiative aims to strengthen the state's **renewable energy sector**, attract investments, and promote sustainable energy development.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Himachal Pradesh Government**, under **Chief Minister Sukhvinder Singh Sukhu**, signed implementation agreements for **19 hydropower projects** in 2026.

The projects have a combined generation capacity of **278 Megawatts (MW)** and involve an investment of **Rs. 3,336 crore**.

The initiative aims to strengthen the state's **renewable energy sector**, attract investments, and promote sustainable energy development.

The hydropower projects include **Soyal Dashal, Khauli-II, Gramang, Umli, Bharmour Stage-I, Bharmour Stage-II, Harsar Stage-II, Harsar Stage-III, Tundah Stage-II, Janglik, Rupin Stage-II, Dunali-I & II, Jari, Toral Kundli, Tundan, Kot Dogri, Upper Kurmi, Kalal Khol, and Melan**.

These projects are expected to enhance hydropower infrastructure and increase clean energy generation in the state.

The construction of the **150 MW Tidong Stage-I Hydroelectric Project** has been completed.

543. In news, Safran Electronics & Defence signed a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) with which Indian company to develop Geospatial Intelligence (GEOINT) solutions for the Indian market?

A.Pixxel Space Technologies

B.SatSure Analytics India Private Limited

C.Digantara Research and Technologies

D.Skyroot Aerospace

E.Bellatrix Aerospace

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Safran Electronics & Defence, a France-based aerospace and defence company, signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** with **SatSure Analytics India Private Limited**.

The collaboration aims to develop **Geospatial Intelligence (GEOINT) solutions** for the Indian market.

The partnership has been launched under the **France-India Year of Innovation** initiative.

Detailed Explanation:

Safran Electronics & Defence, a France-based aerospace and defence company, signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** with **SatSure Analytics India Private Limited**.

The collaboration aims to develop **Geospatial Intelligence (GEOINT) solutions** for the Indian market.

The partnership has been launched under the **France-India Year of Innovation** initiative.

The initiative seeks to strengthen cooperation between India and France in **aerospace and defence technologies**.

The partnership aims to develop end-to-end GEOINT solutions by integrating **satellite imagery, Artificial Intelligence (AI) models, and intelligence systems**.

It will enhance decision-making capabilities across multiple sectors through advanced geospatial intelligence.

The collaboration combines **Safran.AI's Artificial Intelligence capabilities** with **SatSure's geospatial and satellite data expertise**.

KaleidEO Space Systems Private Limited will provide a fully integrated **Earth observation-to-intelligence system**.

544. In news, the National Highways Authority of India (NHAI) signed an MoU with which organisation to establish India's first permanent and independent research centre dedicated to the economics of transportation, mobility, and logistics?

A.NITI Aayog

B.Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) Delhi

C.National Institute of Public Finance and Policy (NIPFP)

D.Indian Institute of Management (IIM) Ahmedabad

E.National Council of Applied Economic Research (NCAER)

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

The **National Highways Authority of India (NHAI)**, under the **Ministry of Road Transport and Highways (MoRTH)**, signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** with the **National Council of Applied Economic Research (NCAER)**.

The MoU aims to establish **NHAI's Research Centre on Transportation, Mobility and Logistics** at the **NCAER headquarters in New Delhi, Delhi**.

The centre will be **India's first permanent and independent research facility** dedicated to the economics of transportation, mobility and logistics.

Detailed Explanation:

The **National Highways Authority of India (NHAI)**, under the **Ministry of Road Transport and Highways (MoRTH)**, signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** with the **National Council of Applied Economic Research (NCAER)**.

The MoU aims to establish **NHAI's Research Centre on Transportation, Mobility and Logistics** at the **NCAER headquarters in New Delhi, Delhi**.

The centre will be **India's first permanent and independent research facility** dedicated to the economics of transportation, mobility and logistics.

It aims to strengthen **evidence-based policymaking, research, and data-driven decision-making** in the road transport sector.

The centre will undertake **applied economic research** in transportation, mobility, and

logistics and generate actionable insights for long-term planning, investment decisions, and policy formulation.

Research areas will include **National Highway economics, freight logistics, modal integration, regional economic impacts of National Highway investments, toll policy, asset monetization, and road safety interventions**.

The centre will be guided by an **Advisory Committee** comprising leading economists, transportation specialists, public policy experts, and eminent academicians.

545. As per the news, the Comptroller and Auditor General (CAG) of India signed an MoU with the Supreme Audit Institution (SAI) of which country to strengthen cooperation in public sector auditing?

A.Israel

B.Germany

C.France

D.Japan

E.United Kingdom

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

The **Comptroller and Auditor General (CAG) of India** signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** with the **Supreme Audit Institution (SAI) of Israel** to strengthen cooperation in **public sector auditing**.

The MoU was signed following a bilateral meeting held in **New Delhi, Delhi**.

The meeting was attended by **K. Sanjay Murthy, Comptroller and Auditor General of India**, and **Matanyahu Englman, State Comptroller and Ombudsman of Israel**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Comptroller and Auditor General (CAG) of India** signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** with the **Supreme Audit Institution (SAI) of Israel** to strengthen cooperation in **public sector auditing**.

The MoU was signed following a bilateral meeting held in **New Delhi, Delhi**.

The meeting was attended by **K. Sanjay Murthy, Comptroller and Auditor General of India**, and **Matanyahu Englman, State Comptroller and Ombudsman of Israel**.

Matanyahu Englman also serves as the **President of the European Organisation of Supreme Audit Institutions**.

The agreement focuses on strengthening auditing practices through the use of **Artificial Intelligence (AI)**.

It promotes the adoption of **data analytics** and **digital audit tools** to improve audit efficiency and accuracy.

The MoU emphasizes enhancing **performance auditing** and **compliance auditing**.

The agreement aims to promote innovation in public sector oversight and strengthen **transparency, accountability, and governance**.

During the visit, Matanyahu Englman delivered a lecture under the **Dr. B.R. Ambedkar Lecture Series**.

546. According to the Hurun India 500 Report 2026, which company emerged as the highest wealth creator over the last five years?

A.Reliance Industries Limited

B.HDFC Bank Limited

C.ICICI Bank Limited

D.Tata Consultancy Services (TCS)

E.Bharti Airtel Limited

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

The **Hurun India 500 Report 2026** was released in partnership with **Axis Bank** and **Burgundy Private**.

The **top 10 companies** accounted for **27% of the total valuation** of the 500 companies featured in the ranking.

The combined valuation of the top 10 companies stood at **Rs. 86 trillion** in 2026 compared to **Rs. 97 trillion** in the previous year.

The total value of the top 10 companies has increased by **3.5 times over the last decade**.

Seven companies have retained their place among the top 10 for five consecutive years.

Bharti Airtel Limited emerged as the highest wealth creator over the last five years.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Hurun India 500 Report 2026** was released in partnership with **Axis Bank** and **Burgundy Private**.

The report ranks India's most valuable companies based on market valuation.

The **top 10 companies** accounted for **27% of the total valuation** of the 500 companies featured in the ranking.

The combined valuation of the top 10 companies stood at **Rs. 86 trillion** in 2026 compared to **Rs. 97 trillion** in the previous year.

The total value of the top 10 companies has increased by **3.5 times over the last decade**.

Seven companies have retained their place among the top 10 for five consecutive years.

Bharti Airtel Limited emerged as the highest wealth creator over the last five years.

The report highlighted the growing dominance of the **Financial Services sector**.

Rank	Company	Valuation (Rs. Crore)
1	Reliance Industries Limited	19,36,239
2	HDFC Bank Limited	11,87,800
3	Bharti Airtel Limited	11,49,650

547. As of 2026, Scientists from the Ashoka Trust for Research in Ecology and the Environment (ATREE) discovered two new microscopic snail species in the limestone caves of which Indian state?

A.Assam

B.Meghalaya

C.Nagaland

D.Mizoram

E.Arunachal Pradesh

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Scientists from the **Ashoka Trust for Research in Ecology and the Environment (ATREE)** discovered **two new microscopic snail species** in the **limestone caves of Meghalaya**.

The discovery was made in **Krem Puri Cave** and **Arwah Cave**, two important limestone cave systems in Meghalaya.

The findings were published in the **European Journal of Taxonomy**.

The newly discovered species are **Georissa meghalayaensis** and **Acmella bensoni**.

Detailed Explanation:

Scientists from the **Ashoka Trust for Research in Ecology and the Environment (ATREE)** discovered **two new microscopic snail species** in the **limestone caves of Meghalaya**.

The discovery was made in **Krem Puri Cave** and **Arwah Cave**, two important limestone cave systems in Meghalaya.

The findings were published in the **European Journal of Taxonomy**.

The newly discovered species are **Georissa meghalayaensis** and **Acmella bensoni**.

Georissa meghalayaensis is **endemic to Meghalaya**, meaning it is naturally found only in the state.

Georissa meghalayaensis was discovered near the entrance of **Krem Puri Cave**.

This species has a distinctive **orangish-red shell** with **intricate mesh-like ridges**.

Acmella bensoni was discovered deeper inside **Krem Puri Cave** and **Arwah Cave**.

Acmella bensoni is named in honour of **William Henry Benson**, a noted British malacologist.

548. In news, the Zoological Survey of India (ZSI), in collaboration with the Natural History Museum, London, discovered two new moth species in which biodiversity hotspot?

A.Eastern Himalayas

B.Western Ghats

C.Sundarbans

D.Thar Desert

E.Indo-Gangetic Plains

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The **Zoological Survey of India (ZSI), Pune**, in collaboration with the **Natural History Museum, London**, discovered **two new moth species** in the **Western Ghats**, enriching the region's biodiversity records.

The newly discovered species are **Antaram idukki** (a **Tiger Moth**) and **Mimeusemia kali** (a **Forester Moth**).

Antaram idukki was discovered in **Idukki, Kerala**, while **Mimeusemia kali** was discovered in the **Kali Tiger Reserve, Karnataka**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Zoological Survey of India (ZSI), Pune**, in collaboration with the **Natural History Museum, London**, discovered **two new moth species** in the **Western Ghats**, enriching the region's biodiversity records.

The newly discovered species are **Antaram idukki** (a **Tiger Moth**) and **Mimeusemia kali** (a **Forester Moth**).

Antaram idukki was discovered in **Idukki, Kerala**, while **Mimeusemia kali** was discovered in the **Kali Tiger Reserve, Karnataka**.

The discovery of **Antaram idukki** was published in the **Journal of the Lepidopterists' Society**.

The discovery of **Mimeusemia kali** was published in **Zootaxa**, an internationally recognized journal for zoological taxonomy.

Antaram idukki belongs to the **Subfamily Arctiinae** under the **Family Erebidae** and is classified as a **Tiger Moth**.

549. In 2026, the Department of Telecommunications (DoT) has started accepting applications for telecom service authorisations under which legislation?

A.Indian Telegraph Act, 1885

B.Indian Wireless Telegraphy Act, 1933

C.Telecommunications Act, 2023

D.Information Technology Act, 2000

E.Telecom Regulatory Authority of India Act, 1997

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The **Department of Telecommunications (DoT)** has officially commenced **accepting applications** for obtaining **authorisations** to provide **telecommunication services** under the **Telecommunications Act, 2023**.

The DoT has also started accepting applications for the **migration of existing telecom licenses** to the **new authorisation framework** under the Telecommunications Act, 2023.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Department of Telecommunications (DoT)** has officially commenced **accepting applications** for obtaining **authorisations** to provide **telecommunication services** under the **Telecommunications Act, 2023**.

The DoT has also started accepting applications for the **migration of existing telecom licenses** to the **new authorisation framework** under the Telecommunications Act, 2023.

The **Telecommunication Rules for Authorisation of Telecommunication Services** under **Section 3(1)(a)** of the Telecommunications Act, 2023 were notified on **23 June 2026**.

The **Telecommunication Rules for Migration of Existing Licenses** under **Section 3(6)** of the Telecommunications Act, 2023 were also notified on **23 June 2026**.

The new authorisation framework has been implemented based on the **"Digital by Design"** principle to ensure a **fully digital, transparent, and efficient application process**.

The DoT has operationalised **online application modules** for both **fresh authorisations** and **migration of existing telecom licenses**.

550. In news, the Department of Social Justice & Empowerment (DoSJE) has removed the mandatory submission of which document for applications under the Pre-Matric and Post-Matric Scholarship Schemes for SC and OBC students?

A.Domicile Certificate

B.Aadhaar Card

C.Income Certificate

D.Caste Certificate

E.Transfer Certificate

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

The **Department of Social Justice & Empowerment (DoSJE)** has introduced major reforms to simplify access to scholarships for **Scheduled Caste (SC) and Other Backward Classes (OBC)** students across India.

The mandatory requirement of submitting a **Domicile Certificate has been removed** for applications under the **Pre-Matric and Post-Matric Scholarship Schemes** for SC and OBC students.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Department of Social Justice & Empowerment (DoSJE)** has introduced major reforms to simplify access to scholarships for **Scheduled Caste (SC) and Other Backward Classes (OBC)** students across India.

The mandatory requirement of submitting a **Domicile Certificate has been removed** for applications under the **Pre-Matric and Post-Matric Scholarship Schemes** for SC and OBC students.

The reform is expected to benefit nearly **1.2 crore students annually**, making the scholarship application process simpler, faster, and more student-friendly.

The removal of the Domicile Certificate requirement will **reduce documentation, lower compliance costs**, and **minimise application delays** for eligible students.

The reform will particularly benefit students pursuing education in **institutions located outside their home States**, ensuring easier access to scholarship benefits.

The Department of Social Justice & Empowerment (DoSJE) has launched **SETU (Scholarship for Educational Transformation and Upliftment)** on the **UMANG platform** as a unified digital portal for scholarship-related services.

551. As per the news, the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) issued the "Master Directions – RBI (Credit Derivatives) Directions, 2026" under which section of the Reserve Bank of India Act, 1934?

A.Section 17

B.Section 24

C.Section 35A

D.Section 45W

E.Section 58

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** has issued the **"Master Directions – RBI (Credit Derivatives) Directions, 2026"** to deepen India's **corporate bond market** and expand the range of **credit risk-management tools** available to market participants.

The Directions have been issued under **Section 45W of the Reserve Bank of India Act, 1934**, and came into effect from **25 June 2026**.

The revised framework introduces **new credit derivative products**, including **Total Return Swaps (TRS)** linked to corporate bonds and **credit index derivatives**, to enhance market efficiency and risk management.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** has issued the **"Master Directions – RBI (Credit Derivatives) Directions, 2026"** to deepen India's **corporate bond market** and expand the range of **credit risk-management tools** available to market participants.

The Directions have been issued under **Section 45W of the Reserve Bank of India Act, 1934**, and came into effect from **25 June 2026**.

The revised framework introduces **new credit derivative products**, including **Total Return Swaps (TRS)** linked to corporate bonds and **credit index derivatives**, to enhance market efficiency and risk management.

A **Total Return Swap (TRS)** is a credit derivative in which one party transfers the **total economic return** (income and capital gains/losses) of an underlying asset, such as a **corporate bond**, to another party.

The new framework allows **Residents** as well as **Persons Resident Outside India** to participate in the credit derivatives market, broadening the **investor base**.

To strengthen market governance, the **RBI** has mandated the establishment of a **Credit Derivatives Determinations Committee** under the **Fixed Income Money Market and Derivatives Association of India (FIMMDA)**.

552. As of 2026, the SBM Paisabazaar Paisa+ Credit Card, launched in partnership with SBM Bank (India) Limited, is backed by which financial instrument?

A.Recurring Deposit (RD)

B.Fixed Deposit (FD)

C.Public Provident Fund (PPF)

D.National Savings Certificate (NSC)

E.Sovereign Gold Bond (SGB)

Answer: B

Paisabazaar, India's largest financial marketplace, in partnership with **SBM Bank (India) Limited**, has launched the **SBM Paisabazaar Paisa+ Credit Card**, a **Fixed Deposit (FD)-backed secured credit card**.

The **SBM Paisabazaar Paisa+ Credit Card** is designed to help users **build or improve their credit profile** while earning **cashback rewards** on everyday spending.

The card is a **secured credit card**, where the **credit limit is backed by a Fixed Deposit (FD)**, making it suitable for **first-time credit users** and individuals with **limited credit history**.

Customers can open a **Fixed Deposit (FD) starting from ₹2,000** to obtain the **SBM Paisabazaar Paisa+ Credit Card**.

553. As of 2026, LEXI Money IFSC Private Limited (LEXI) received in-principle approval from the International Financial Services Centres Authority (IFSCA) to operate as what at GIFT-IFSC?

A.Banking Unit

B.Payment Service Provider (PSP)

C.Stock Exchange

D.Insurance Intermediary

E.Asset Management Company

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

LEXI Money IFSC Private Limited (LEXI), an **Artificial Intelligence (AI)-powered trade and payments platform**, has received **in-principle approval** from the **International Financial Services Centres Authority (IFSCA)** to operate as a **Payment Service Provider (PSP)** at **GIFT-IFSC**.

With this approval, **LEXI** joins a select group of fintech companies authorised to provide **cross-border payment services** from the **Gujarat International Finance Tec-City International Financial Services Centre (GIFT-IFSC)** in **Gandhinagar, Gujarat**.

Detailed Explanation:

LEXI Money IFSC Private Limited (LEXI), an **Artificial Intelligence (AI)-powered trade and payments platform**, has received **in-principle approval** from the **International Financial Services Centres Authority (IFSCA)** to operate as a **Payment Service Provider (PSP)** at **GIFT-IFSC**.

With this approval, **LEXI** joins a select group of fintech companies authorised to provide **cross-border payment services** from the **Gujarat International Finance Tec-City International Financial Services Centre (GIFT-IFSC)** in **Gandhinagar, Gujarat**.

The **in-principle approval** aims to strengthen **AI-powered cross-border payment infrastructure** and simplify **international trade and payment solutions** for **Indian exporters**.

The approval represents the **first regulatory milestone**, and **LEXI** must obtain the **Certificate of Authorisation (CoA)** from the **IFSCA** before commencing operations at **GIFT-IFSC**.

As a **Payment Service Provider (PSP)**, **LEXI** will facilitate **secure, efficient, and technology-driven international payment services** through **GIFT-IFSC**.

554. Which Artificial Intelligence (AI)-driven fintech platform received approval from the National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI) to operate as a Third Party Application Provider (TPAP)?

A.CRED

B.jUMPP

C.Razorpay

D.PhonePe

E.MobiKwik

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

jUMPP, an **Artificial Intelligence (AI)-driven fintech platform**, has received approval from the **National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI)** to operate as a **Third Party Application Provider (TPAP)**.

The **NPCI approval** enables **jUMPP** to integrate **Unified Payments Interface (UPI)** payment capabilities directly into its mobile application (app).

Detailed Explanation:

jUMPP, an **Artificial Intelligence (AI)-driven fintech platform**, has received approval from the **National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI)** to operate as a **Third Party Application Provider (TPAP)**.

The **NPCI approval** enables **jUMPP** to integrate **Unified Payments Interface (UPI)** payment capabilities directly into its mobile application (app).

With **UPI integration**, users will be able to perform **Peer-to-Peer (P2P)** money transfers, **merchant payments**, **bill payments**, and **mobile recharges** seamlessly through the **jUMPP app**.

As a **Third Party Application Provider (TPAP)**, **jUMPP** will facilitate **UPI transactions** through **YES Bank Limited**, which will act as its **Payment Service Provider (PSP) bank**.

jUMPP has also partnered with **YES Bank Limited** for **banking services** and **Bharat Bill Payment System (BBPS)-related services**.

555. How many countries, including India, signed the Statement on Artificial Intelligence (AI) at the 2nd Pax Silica Summit held in Washington, D.C., in 2026?

A.25

B.30

C.45

D.40

E.35

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

Thirty-five (35) countries, including **India**, signed the **Statement on Artificial Intelligence (AI)**, a **United States of America (USA)-led initiative** aimed at building **trusted and resilient supply chains** to support AI technologies.

The **Statement on AI** was signed during the **2nd Pax Silica Summit**, held from **25–26 June 2026** in **Washington, D.C., USA**.

The two-day summit was hosted by **Jacob Helberg**, **Secretary of Economic Affairs, US Department of State**.

The **Indian delegation** at the summit was led by **S. Krishnan**, **Secretary, Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY)**, along with representatives from Indian industry.

Detailed Explanation:

Thirty-five (35) countries, including **India**, signed the **Statement on Artificial Intelligence (AI)**, a **United States of America (USA)-led initiative** aimed at building **trusted and**

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The **Statement on AI** was signed during the **2nd Pax Silica Summit**, held from **25–26 June 2026** in **Washington, D.C., USA**.

The two-day summit was hosted by **Jacob Helberg**, **Secretary of Economic Affairs, US Department of State**.

The **Indian delegation** at the summit was led by **S. Krishnan**, **Secretary, Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY)**, along with representatives from Indian industry.

The initiative seeks to strengthen **secure, trusted, and resilient global supply chains** for critical **Artificial Intelligence (AI)** technologies and related sectors.

During the summit, the initiative expanded with the participation of **Argentina, Germany, the Netherlands, Chile, Costa Rica, Greece, Kazakhstan, Panama**, and the **European Union (EU)**.

Pax Silica is a **flagship initiative of the US Department of State** focused on **Artificial Intelligence (AI)** and **supply chain security**.

The term **"Pax"** is a historical Latin word that signifies **peace, stability, and prosperity**.

556. In news, the Rajolibanda Diversion Scheme (RDS), an interstate irrigation project shared by Telangana, Karnataka, and Andhra Pradesh, is built across which river?

A.Tungabhadra River

B.Krishna River

C.Godavari River

D.Pennar River

E.Bhima River

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

The **Rajolibanda Diversion Scheme (RDS)** is an interstate irrigation project built across the **Tungabhadra River**, a major tributary of the **Krishna River**.

The scheme provides irrigation water to **Telangana, Karnataka, and Andhra Pradesh**, supporting agriculture and rural livelihoods.

The project recently came into focus after **Telangana Chief Minister A. Revanth Reddy** urged the **Central Government** to find a permanent solution to the **Tungabhadra River water-sharing dispute**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Rajolibanda Diversion Scheme (RDS)** is an interstate irrigation project built across the **Tungabhadra River**, a major tributary of the **Krishna River**.

The scheme provides irrigation water to **Telangana, Karnataka, and Andhra Pradesh**, supporting agriculture and rural livelihoods.

The project recently came into focus after **Telangana Chief Minister A. Revanth Reddy** urged the **Central Government** to find a permanent solution to the **Tungabhadra River water-sharing dispute**.

The issue was raised during the inauguration of the **33 newly installed spillway crest gates** at

the **Tungabhadra Dam** in **Hosapete, Karnataka**.

The event was attended by **Union Minister of Jal Shakti C. R. Patil**, **Telangana Chief Minister A. Revanth Reddy**, **Karnataka Chief Minister D. K. Shivakumar**, and **Andhra Pradesh Chief Minister N. Chandrababu Naidu**.

The scheme was developed to provide irrigation to drought-prone regions, improve agricultural productivity, ensure equitable sharing of Tungabhadra River water, and support sustainable water management.

Under the existing water-sharing arrangement, **Telangana has been allocated 17.9 Thousand Million Cubic Feet (TMCFT)** of water through the scheme.

According to Telangana, only **5–6 TMCFT** of the allocated water is currently being utilised, while nearly **10 TMCFT** remains unutilised due to operational and infrastructure-related issues.

557. In 2026, consider the following statements regarding the revised passport fee structure notified by the Government of India:

1. **The revised passport fees came into effect from 1 July 2026.**
2. **The fee for a 36-page normal passport was increased from ₹1,500 to ₹2,500.**
3. **The validity of adult passports has been reduced from 10 years to 5 years.**

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

A.1 and 2 only

B.2 and 3 only

C.1 and 3 only

D.1, 2 and 3

E.3 only

Answer: A

The **Government of India** revised the **passport fee structure** with effect from **1 July 2026**, marking the **first revision since 2012**.

The revised charges apply to **fresh passports, renewals, Tatkal applications, replacement of lost or damaged passports, and passports for minors**.

The revision has been made under the **Passport Rules, 1980** to meet the increasing cost of passport processing and service delivery.

The **validity of passports remains unchanged**, with **10 years for adults**, while the validity for **minors** will continue as per existing rules.

Passport Service	Old Fee	New Fee
36-page Passport (Normal)	₹1,500	₹2,500
36-page Passport (Tatkal)	₹3,500	₹5,000
60-page Passport (Normal)	₹2,000	₹3,500
60-page Passport (Tatkal)	₹4,000	₹6,000
36-page Replacement Passport (Normal)	₹5,000	₹5,000
36-page Replacement Passport (Tatkal)	₹7,500	₹7,500

558. Recently, the indigenous B35 Bullet Train, being developed by the National High-Speed Rail Corporation Limited (NHSRCL), will have a maximum design speed of_____km/h.

A.300 km/h

B.320 km/h

C.330 km/h

D.350 km/h

E.360 km/h

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

The **National High-Speed Rail Corporation Limited (NHSRCL)** is planning to expand India's high-speed rail network through **seven proposed bullet train corridors** connecting major metropolitan cities.

The corporation has initiated the development of the indigenous **B35 Bullet Train**, which will be designed and manufactured in India.

The **B35 Bullet Train** will have a **maximum design speed of 350 kilometres per hour** and an **operational speed of 320 kilometres per hour**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **National High-Speed Rail Corporation Limited (NHSRCL)** is planning to expand India's high-speed rail network through **seven proposed bullet train corridors** connecting major metropolitan cities.

The corporation has initiated the development of the indigenous **B35 Bullet Train**, which will be designed and manufactured in India.

The **B35 Bullet Train** will have a **maximum design speed of 350 kilometres per hour** and an **operational speed of 320 kilometres per hour**.

The train will feature advanced signalling systems, modern train control technology, enhanced passenger safety, and improved comfort.

Proposed Bullet Train Corridor	Expected Travel Time
Mumbai – Pune	48 Minutes
Pune – Hyderabad	2 Hours 8 Minutes
Hyderabad – Bengaluru	2 Hours 10 Minutes
Hyderabad – Chennai	Proposed
Bengaluru – Chennai	73 Minutes
Delhi – Varanasi	3 Hours 15 Minutes
Varanasi – Siliguri	Proposed

India's first **Mumbai–Ahmedabad High-Speed Rail Corridor** is currently under construction.

The corridor has a total length of **508 kilometres**.

The first operational section between **Surat and Vapi** (97 kilometres) is expected to be commissioned by **August 2027**.

559. Under the new LPG regulations notified in 2026, within how many days must a consumer surrender their domestic LPG connection after a new Piped Natural Gas (PNG) connection becomes operational?

A.15 days

B.30 days

C.45 days

D.60 days

E.90 days

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The **Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas** introduced new regulations for domestic **Liquefied Petroleum Gas (LPG)** consumers under the **Petroleum Gas (Regulation of Supply and Distribution) Amendment Order, 2026** and the **Natural Gas and Petroleum Products Distribution Order, 2026**.

Under the **30-Day Rule**, consumers who obtain a new **Piped Natural Gas** connection must surrender their domestic **Liquefied Petroleum Gas** connection within **30 days** after the PNG connection becomes operational.

Failure to surrender the LPG connection within the stipulated period may result in **blocking of the LPG account**, preventing future cylinder refills.

Under the **90-Day Rule**, households residing in areas already covered by **Piped Natural Gas** networks will receive notices to shift to PNG within **30 to 90 days**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas** introduced new regulations for domestic **Liquefied Petroleum Gas (LPG)** consumers under the **Petroleum Gas (Regulation of Supply and Distribution) Amendment Order, 2026** and the **Natural Gas and Petroleum Products Distribution Order, 2026**.

The new regulations aim to **prevent dual domestic gas connections, curb commercial misuse of subsidized LPG cylinders, promote the adoption of Piped Natural Gas (PNG), and improve transparency in gas distribution**.

The rules apply to domestic consumers of **Indane, BharatGas, and HP Gas**, particularly in areas where **Piped Natural Gas** infrastructure is available.

Under the **30-Day Rule**, consumers who obtain a new **Piped Natural Gas** connection must surrender their domestic **Liquefied Petroleum Gas** connection within **30 days** after the PNG connection becomes operational.

Failure to surrender the LPG connection within the stipulated period may result in **blocking of the LPG account**, preventing future cylinder refills.

Under the **90-Day Rule**, households residing in areas already covered by **Piped Natural Gas** networks will receive notices to shift to PNG within **30 to 90 days**.

Consumers who fail to switch to PNG within the prescribed period may have their domestic **Liquefied Petroleum Gas** supply suspended or discontinued, subject to applicable rules.

560. Under the Mukhyamantri Kisan Sahay Yojana (MKSY) of Gujarat, farmers suffering more than 60% crop loss are eligible for financial assistance of_____.

A.₹25,000 per hectare

B.₹20,000 per hectare
C.₹22,500 per hectare
D.₹15,000 per hectare
E.₹30,000 per hectare
Answer: A
Short Explanation:
The **Government of Gujarat** launched the **Mukhyamantri Kisan Sahay Yojana (MKSY)** in **2020** to provide financial assistance to farmers whose **Kharif crops** are damaged due to natural calamities.
The scheme provides compensation **without charging any insurance premium**, unlike conventional crop insurance schemes.
Farmers with **33% to 60% crop loss** are eligible for financial assistance of **Rs. 20,000 per hectare**. Farmers with **more than 60% crop loss** receive **Rs. 25,000 per hectare**.
Detailed Explanation:
The **Government of Gujarat** launched the **Mukhyamantri Kisan Sahay Yojana (MKSY)** in **2020** to provide financial assistance to farmers whose **Kharif crops** are damaged due to natural calamities.
The scheme provides compensation **without charging any insurance premium**, unlike conventional crop insurance schemes.
Farmers with **33% to 60% crop loss** are eligible for financial assistance of **Rs. 20,000 per hectare**.
Farmers with **more than 60% crop loss** receive **Rs. 25,000 per hectare**.
The financial assistance is available for a **maximum of 4 hectares** per farmer.
The scheme covers crop losses caused by **floods, droughts, cyclones, heavy rainfall, and unseasonal rainfall**.
The financial assistance is transferred directly to beneficiaries' bank accounts through **Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT)**.

561. As per the news, India hosted the 11th BRICS Energy Ministers' Meeting in 2026 under the Energy Track theme_____
A.One Earth, One Energy, One Future
B.Powering Sustainable Growth
C.सर्वेषां ऊर्जम् (Energy for All)
D.Green Energy for Global Prosperity
E.Energy Security through Innovation
Answer: C
India hosted the **11th BRICS Energy Ministers' Meeting** in **Gurugram, Haryana**, under its **BRICS Chairship 2026**.
The meeting was organised under the theme **"Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability."**
The **Energy Track Theme** was **"सर्वेषां ऊर्जम् (Energy for All)."**
The meeting was attended by **Energy Ministers, Vice Ministers, senior officials**, and representatives of the **International Solar Alliance**, **Global Biofuels Alliance**, and **New Development Bank**.
The discussions focused on **energy security and sustainability, energy access and equity, and technology and innovation**.

562. As of 2026, the SHATAYU (Senior Holistic Care Assistance and Training for Your Utility) Dashboard, launched by the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment, is designed to connect senior citizens with_____.

A.Telemedicine specialists

B.Certified geriatric caregivers

C.Pension consultants

D.Legal aid volunteers

E.Mental health counsellors

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The **Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment** launched the **SHATAYU (Senior Holistic Care Assistance and Training for Your Utility) Dashboard**.

The dashboard aims to strengthen **elderly care services** by connecting **trained geriatric caregivers** with senior citizens requiring professional care and assistance.

It serves as a **centralized digital platform** for registering certified geriatric caregivers across India.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment** launched the **SHATAYU (Senior Holistic Care Assistance and Training for Your Utility) Dashboard**.

The dashboard aims to strengthen **elderly care services** by connecting **trained geriatric caregivers** with senior citizens requiring professional care and assistance.

It serves as a **centralized digital platform** for registering certified geriatric caregivers across India.

The initiative seeks to improve access to **quality elderly care**, promote an **inclusive and age-friendly support system**, and strengthen the country's elderly care ecosystem.

The dashboard is managed by the **National Institute of Social Defence (NISD)** under the **Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment**.

The **National Institute of Social Defence** is responsible for training geriatric caregivers under various Government programmes.

Caregivers who completed geriatric caregiver training during **2023-24 and earlier** have also been invited to register on the dashboard.

563. Who has been appointed as the next Director of the Intelligence Bureau (IB) in 2026?

A.Mahesh Dixit

B.Tapan Kumar Deka

C.Rajiv Ranjan Verma

D.Sanjay Arora

E.Ajay Kumar Bhalla

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

The Appointments Committee of the Cabinet (ACC), chaired by **Prime Minister Narendra Modi**, has approved the appointment of **Mahesh Dixit** as the next **Director of the Intelligence Bureau (IB)**, India's premier internal intelligence agency.

Mahesh Dixit is a **1993-batch Indian Police Service (IPS)** officer and is currently serving as the **Special Director** and second-in-command of the **Intelligence Bureau (IB)**.

Detailed Explanation:

The Appointments Committee of the Cabinet (ACC), chaired by **Prime Minister Narendra Modi**, has approved the appointment of **Mahesh Dixit** as the next **Director of the Intelligence Bureau (IB)**, India's premier internal intelligence agency.

Mahesh Dixit is a **1993-batch Indian Police Service (IPS)** officer and is currently serving as the **Special Director** and second-in-command of the **Intelligence Bureau (IB)**.

He will assume office as **Director, Intelligence Bureau (IB)** for a **two-year tenure** from the date of assuming charge or until further orders, whichever is earlier.

Mahesh Dixit will succeed **Tapan Kumar Deka**, a **1988-batch IPS** officer, who has been serving as Director of the Intelligence Bureau since **July 2022**, with his second extended tenure ending on **30 June 2026**.

564. Which new-generation Fast Patrol Vessel (FPV) was commissioned into the Bharatiya Tatrakshak (Indian Coast Guard) on 27 June 2026 at Goa Shipyard Limited (GSL), Goa?

A.ICGS Veer

B.ICGS Vikram

C.ICGS Shaurya

D.ICGS Chetak

E.ICGS Akshay

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

Bharatiya Tatrakshak (Indian Coast Guard) achieved another milestone in its force modernisation with the commissioning of the **ICGS Akshay**, a new-generation **Fast Patrol Vessel (FPV)**, on **27 June 2026** at **Goa Shipyard Limited (GSL), Goa**.

The vessel is named **"Akshay"**, which means **"Indestructible"**, symbolising the enduring spirit, resilience, and unwavering commitment of Bharatiya Tatrakshak towards safeguarding India's maritime interests.

ICGS Akshay enhances the operational capability of the **Bharatiya Tatrakshak** by strengthening **maritime security**, **coastal surveillance**, and protection of India's vast maritime domain.

Detailed Explanation:

Bharatiya Tatrakshak (Indian Coast Guard) achieved another milestone in its force modernisation with the commissioning of the **ICGS Akshay**, a new-generation **Fast Patrol Vessel (FPV)**, on **27 June 2026** at **Goa Shipyard Limited (GSL), Goa**.

The vessel is named **"Akshay"**, which means **"Indestructible"**, symbolising the enduring spirit, resilience, and unwavering commitment of Bharatiya Tatrakshak towards safeguarding India's maritime interests.

ICGS Akshay enhances the operational capability of the **Bharatiya Tatrakshak** by strengthening **maritime security**, **coastal**

surveillance, and protection of India's vast maritime domain.

The **Fast Patrol Vessel (FPV)** is equipped to undertake **maritime law enforcement**, **coastal security**, **search and rescue (SAR)**, **marine environmental protection**, and assistance to mariners in distress.

ICGS Akshay was commissioned by **Smt. Parama Sen**, **Additional Secretary (Personnel), Department of Expenditure, Ministry of Finance**.

565. Which Indian Navy Survey Vessel Large (SVL) visited Port Victoria, Seychelles, in June 2026 to participate in the country's 50th National Day celebrations?

A.INS Sandhayak

B.INS Nirdeshak

C.INS Ikshak

D.INS Investigator

E.INS Sutlej

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

INS Ikshak, the Indian Navy's **indigenously built Survey Vessel Large (SVL)**, arrived at **Port Victoria, Seychelles**, on **26 June 2026** as part of its **operational deployment to the South West Indian Ocean Region**.

The visit coincides with the **50th National Day celebrations of Seychelles**, highlighting the strong **maritime partnership** and long-standing friendship between India and Seychelles.

Detailed Explanation:

INS Ikshak, the Indian Navy's **indigenously built Survey Vessel Large (SVL)**, arrived at **Port Victoria, Seychelles**, on **26 June 2026** as part of its **operational deployment to the South West Indian Ocean Region**.

The visit coincides with the **50th National Day celebrations of Seychelles**, highlighting the strong **maritime partnership** and long-standing friendship between India and Seychelles.

During the port call, **INS Ikshak** will participate in the National Day celebrations and hold **professional interactions with the Seychelles Defence Forces** to enhance **maritime cooperation and interoperability**.

As part of its **community outreach initiatives**, the ship will organize **medical camps** and distribute **essential supplies**, strengthening goodwill and people-to-people ties between the two countries.

INS Ikshak will also be **open to visitors**, providing an opportunity to witness the Indian Navy's capabilities and its commitment to **regional maritime security, safety, and cooperation**.

566. Which Indian Navy officer led the Eastern Fleet during its operational deployment to South East Asia, including the port call at Sattahip, Thailand, in 2026?

A.Rear Admiral Alok Ananda

B.Vice Admiral Sanjay J. Singh

C.Vice Admiral Rajesh Pendharkar

D.Rear Admiral Gurcharan Singh

E.Vice Admiral Krishna Swaminathan

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

Indian Naval Ships (INS) Udaygiri, Kavaratti, and Shakti of the **Eastern Fleet** arrived at **Sattahip, Thailand**, as part of their **operational deployment to the South East Asia Region**.

The deployment was led by **Rear Admiral (RAdm) Alok Ananda**, **Flag Officer Commanding Eastern Fleet (FOCEF)**.

The Indian Naval ships were received by the **Royal Thai Navy**, reflecting the strong and long-standing **maritime partnership** between India and Thailand.

Detailed Explanation:

Indian Naval Ships (INS) Udaygiri, Kavaratti, and Shakti of the **Eastern Fleet** arrived at **Sattahip, Thailand**, as part of their **operational deployment to the South East Asia Region**.

The deployment was led by **Rear Admiral (RAdm) Alok Ananda**, **Flag Officer Commanding Eastern Fleet (FOCEF)**.

The Indian Naval ships were received by the **Royal Thai Navy**, reflecting the strong and long-standing **maritime partnership** between India and Thailand.

The **port call** is part of India's continued **maritime engagement with South East Asian nations** to strengthen **regional maritime cooperation**.

The visit includes **professional exchanges**, **cross-deck visits**, **operational interactions**, **sporting engagements**, and **community outreach programmes** to enhance **navy-to-navy cooperation and interoperability**.

The port call aims to strengthen **camaraderie**, **mutual cooperation**, and **bilateral maritime ties** between India and Thailand.

567. Which Indian Navy Sail Training Ship (STS) arrived at the Port of Baltimore, Maryland, USA, in June 2026 as part of the Lokayan 26 transoceanic expedition?

A.INS Tarangini

B.INS Tir

C.INS Shardul

D.INS Sudarshini

E.INS Sujata

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

Indian Navy's Sail Training Ship (STS) INS Sudarshini arrived at the **Port of Baltimore, Maryland, USA**, on **26 June 2026** as part of the landmark **Lokayan 26 transoceanic expedition**.

The voyage from Norfolk to Baltimore included transit through the historic **Chesapeake & Delaware (C&D) Canal**, passing beneath major mid-Atlantic bridges.

Detailed Explanation:

Indian Navy's Sail Training Ship (STS) INS Sudarshini arrived at the **Port of Baltimore, Maryland, USA**, on **26 June 2026** as part of the

landmark **Lokayan 26 transoceanic expedition**.

The voyage from Norfolk to Baltimore included transit through the historic **Chesapeake & Delaware (C&D) Canal**, passing beneath major mid-Atlantic bridges.

The visit of **INS Sudarshini** highlights India's rich **maritime heritage** and strengthens the enduring friendship and **maritime cooperation** between the **Indian Navy** and the **United States Navy (US Navy)**.

During its stay in Baltimore, the ship will participate in **maritime engagement programmes** and **community outreach activities** ahead of the **Sail250 Maryland** celebrations, marking the **250th anniversary of the United States**.

Before arriving in Baltimore, **INS Sudarshini** participated in the **Sail250 Virginia** celebrations held in **Norfolk** from **19–23 June 2026**.

568. As per the news, HELINA, developed by the Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO), is a helicopter-launched version of which indigenous Anti-Tank Guided Missile (ATGM)?

A.Astra

B.Pralay

C.Akash

D.Trishul

E.Nag

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

HELINA (Helicopter-launched Nag) is an **indigenously developed, third-generation, fire-and-forget Anti-Tank Guided Missile (ATGM)** developed by the **Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO)**.

HELINA is the helicopter-launched version of the **Nag Anti-Tank Guided Missile (ATGM)** and is designed to destroy **armoured vehicles, battle tanks, and reinforced bunkers**.

Detailed Explanation:

HELINA (Helicopter-launched Nag) is an **indigenously developed, third-generation, fire-and-forget Anti-Tank Guided Missile (ATGM)** developed by the **Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO)**.

HELINA is the helicopter-launched version of the **Nag Anti-Tank Guided Missile (ATGM)** and is designed to destroy **armoured vehicles, battle tanks, and reinforced bunkers**.

The **Indian Air Force (IAF)** version of the missile is called **Dhruvastra**, while another ATGM version can also be fired by soldiers.

HELINA uses a high-resolution **Imaging Infrared (IIR) Seeker** with **Lock-on Before Launch (LOBL)** capability, enabling the missile to identify and track targets using their heat signatures.

As a **fire-and-forget** missile, HELINA locks onto the target before launch and requires no further guidance from the helicopter after firing, allowing the launch platform to move to safety.

569. What is the title of the memoir released by Air Chief Marshal Amar Preet Singh,

chronicling the journey of Group Captain Shubhanshu Shukla from an Indian Air Force fighter pilot to an astronaut?

A.Beyond the Stars

B.Wings to Space

C.The Second Orbit: Belief of a Man… Dreams of 1.4 billion Hearts

D.Mission Beyond Earth

E.Journey to the International Space Station

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

Chief of the Air Staff, Air Chief Marshal Amar Preet Singh, released the memoir of **Group Captain Shubhanshu Shukla**, titled **"The Second Orbit: Belief of a Man… Dreams of 1.4 billion Hearts"**, at an event held in **New Delhi**.

The memoir chronicles **Group Captain Shubhanshu Shukla's** journey from an **Indian Air Force fighter pilot** to an **astronaut**, including his mission to the **International Space Station** as part of the **Axiom-4 Mission**.

Detailed Explanation:

Chief of the Air Staff, Air Chief Marshal Amar Preet Singh, released the memoir of **Group Captain Shubhanshu Shukla**, titled **"The Second Orbit: Belief of a Man… Dreams of 1.4 billion Hearts"**, at an event held in **New Delhi**.

The memoir chronicles **Group Captain Shubhanshu Shukla's** journey from an **Indian Air Force fighter pilot** to an **astronaut**, including his mission to the **International Space Station** as part of the **Axiom-4 Mission**.

The book highlights his **selection as an astronaut, training, mission preparation, experiences aboard the International Space Station, and personal reflections on representing India in space**.

The event also marked the **first anniversary of the Axiom-4 Mission**, which was launched.

Students from various schools attended the event and interacted with **Group Captain Shubhanshu Shukla**, who shared his experiences of space travel and inspired young minds to pursue careers in science and space exploration.

The memoir showcases India's growing participation in **human spaceflight** and highlights the country's progress in space exploration.

570. Which bank became the first foreign bank to receive a Universal Banking Licence from the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) under the Wholly Owned Subsidiary (WOS) Model?

A.SBM Bank (India) Limited

B.HSBC India

C.DBS Bank India Limited

D.Standard Chartered Bank India

E.Citibank India

Answer: A

SBM Bank (India) Limited is headquartered in **Mumbai, Maharashtra**.

SBM Bank (India) Limited is the **first foreign bank** to receive a **Universal Banking Licence** from the **Reserve Bank of India**

(RBI) under the **Wholly Owned Subsidiary (WOS) Model**.

SBM Bank (India) Limited is a subsidiary of **SBM Holdings Ltd., Mauritius**.

571. In 2026, Goldman Sachs, in its report titled "India: Improved Macro Outlook after the United States–Iran Deal", revised India's Calendar Year (CY26) Real GDP growth forecast to which of the following?

A.6.8%

B.6.5%

C.6.2%

D.7.0%

E.7.8%

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

Goldman Sachs, an American financial services firm, released its latest report titled **"India: Improved Macro Outlook after the United States–Iran Deal"**, raising India's **Calendar Year 2026 (CY26) Real** Gross Domestic Product **(GDP) Growth Forecast to 6.8%**.

Goldman Sachs increased India's **CY26 Real GDP Growth Forecast from 6.5% to 6.8%**, an upward revision of **30 basis points (bps)**.

The firm also raised its **Financial Year 2026–27 (FY27) GDP Growth Forecast** by **40 basis points (bps) to 6.5%**.

Detailed Explanation:

Goldman Sachs, an American financial services firm, released its latest report titled **"India: Improved Macro Outlook after the United States–Iran Deal"**, raising India's **Calendar Year 2026 (CY26) Real** Gross Domestic Product **(GDP) Growth Forecast to 6.8%**.

Goldman Sachs increased India's **CY26 Real GDP Growth Forecast from 6.5% to 6.8%**, an upward revision of **30 basis points (bps)**.

The firm also raised its **Financial Year 2026–27 (FY27) GDP Growth Forecast** by **40 basis points (bps) to 6.5%**.

India's **Real GDP expanded by 7.8% Year-on-Year (Y-o-Y) in Q1 (January–March 2026)**, which was around **50 basis points (bps) higher** than Goldman Sachs' earlier estimate.

Goldman Sachs lowered India's **Retail Inflation Forecast for CY26 to 4.4%**, reducing it by **20 basis points (bps)** from its previous projection.

The report reduced the **Core Goods Inflation Forecast for CY26 by 30 basis points (bps) to 3.2%**.

For **FY27**, **Core Goods Inflation** was revised downward by **50 basis points (bps) to 4.1%**.

572. In 2026, Amazon announced an investment of USD 48 billion in India during 2026–2030. Out of this, how much has been earmarked specifically for Artificial Intelligence (AI) and cloud infrastructure?

A.USD 10 billion

B.USD 13 billion

C.USD 15 billion

D.USD 20 billion

E.USD 35 billion

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Amazon, an American multinational technology company, announced an investment of **USD 48 billion** in India during **2026–2030** to strengthen its **e-commerce, Artificial Intelligence (AI), cloud computing, and logistics** businesses.

The announcement followed a meeting between **Andy Jassy**, President and Chief Executive Officer (CEO) of Amazon, and **Prime Minister Narendra Modi** in New Delhi, Delhi.

Amazon has committed a total investment of **USD 48 billion**, which includes **USD 13 billion specifically for Artificial Intelligence (AI) and cloud infrastructure**.

Detailed Explanation:

Amazon, an American multinational technology company, announced an investment of **USD 48 billion** in India during **2026–2030** to strengthen its **e-commerce, Artificial Intelligence (AI), cloud computing, and logistics** businesses.

The announcement followed a meeting between **Andy Jassy**, President and Chief Executive Officer (CEO) of Amazon, and **Prime Minister Narendra Modi** in New Delhi, Delhi.

Amazon has committed a total investment of **USD 48 billion**, which includes **USD 13 billion specifically for Artificial Intelligence (AI) and cloud infrastructure**.

The latest investment builds upon Amazon's earlier commitment of **USD 35 billion**, announced in **2025**, to expand its operations in India.

Under the expansion plan, **Amazon Web Services (AWS)** will expand its **data centres** in **Mumbai (Maharashtra) and Hyderabad (Telangana)**.

In **2026**, Amazon will establish **more than 20 fulfilment centres and 100 last-mile delivery stations** to strengthen its logistics and supply chain network across India.

By **2030**, Amazon aims to support **3.8 million jobs** across India through its expanding business ecosystem.

573. As of 2026, the Asian Development Bank (ADB) approved a Small Expenditure Financing Facility (SEFF) of how much to support the bamboo industry in India's North Eastern Region (NER)?

A.USD 32.2 million

B.USD 38.5 million

C.USD 42.2 million

D.USD 45.0 million

E.USD 50.0 million

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The **Asian Development Bank (ADB)** approved a **USD 42.2 million Small Expenditure Financing Facility (SEFF)** to support the **bamboo industry** in India's **North Eastern Region (NER)**.

The **SEFF** is aligned with the Government of India's **National Bamboo Mission (NBM)** and aims to strengthen **bamboo cultivation, production, processing, and marketing**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Asian Development Bank (ADB)** approved a **USD 42.2 million Small Expenditure Financing Facility (SEFF)** to support the **bamboo industry** in India's **North Eastern Region (NER)**.

The **SEFF** is aligned with the Government of India's **National Bamboo Mission (NBM)** and aims to strengthen **bamboo cultivation, production, processing, and marketing**.

The financing facility will support **community-based bamboo projects** across **six North Eastern States**: **Assam, Manipur, Meghalaya, Mizoram, Nagaland, and Tripura**.

The **USD 42.2 million assistance** will be provided through **multiple sub-loans** to enhance the growth, sustainable use, and management of bamboo resources in the region.

The initiative aims to **boost agricultural productivity**, **strengthen rural livelihoods**, and **reduce India's dependence on imported bamboo products**.

574. As of 2026, 'Samvidhan Hatya Diwas' commemorates the anniversary of which historical event in India?

A.Adoption of the Constitution in 1950

B.Quit India Movement of 1942

C.Imposition of the Emergency in 1975

D.First General Elections in 1951–52

E.Integration of Princely States in 1947

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The **Ministry of Culture** commemorated **'Samvidhan Hatya Diwas'** through a special programme organised by the **Centre for Cultural Resources and Training (CCRT)** at its campus in **New Delhi**.

The programme marked the **50th anniversary of the Emergency imposed in 1975** and aimed to promote awareness about **democracy, constitutional values, and citizens' rights**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Ministry of Culture** commemorated **'Samvidhan Hatya Diwas'** through a special programme organised by the **Centre for Cultural Resources and Training (CCRT)** at its campus in **New Delhi**.

The programme marked the **50th anniversary of the Emergency imposed in 1975** and aimed to promote awareness about **democracy, constitutional values, and citizens' rights**.

Union Minister for Culture and Tourism Gajendra Singh Shekhawat attended the event as the **Chief Guest**.

The Minister highlighted the importance of **democracy, freedom of speech, freedom of expression, freedom to dissent, independent media, rule of law, and the supremacy of the Constitution**.

An exhibition titled **"Long Live Democracy"** showcased the **impact of the Emergency**, the importance of **protecting constitutional freedoms**, and the role of **democratic institutions**.

575. As of 2026, the book "Sanskritir Ratna Bhandar: Bhaowaiyar Itibritto" released by Vice President C. P. Radhakrishnan is

primarily based on which traditional folk music genre?

A.Bihu

B.Baul

C.Lavani

D.Bhawaiya

E.Pandavani

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

Vice President C. P. Radhakrishnan released the book **"Sanskritir Ratna Bhandar: Bhaowaiyar Itibritto" (Bhawaiya: A Cultural Treasure and Its Historical Journey)** at **Uprashtrapati Bhavan, New Delhi**.

The book is authored by **Dr. Jayanta Kumar Roy**, **Member of Parliament (MP), Lok Sabha**, and **Ms. Sangita Roy**.

Detailed Explanation:

Vice President C. P. Radhakrishnan released the book **"Sanskritir Ratna Bhandar: Bhaowaiyar Itibritto" (Bhawaiya: A Cultural Treasure and Its Historical Journey)** at **Uprashtrapati Bhavan, New Delhi**.

The book is authored by **Dr. Jayanta Kumar Roy**, **Member of Parliament (MP), Lok Sabha**, and **Ms. Sangita Roy**.

The book traces the **history, evolution, and cultural significance** of **Bhawaiya**, a traditional folk music genre of **North Bengal, Assam, and adjoining regions**.

It highlights the contribution of the **Koch Rajbanshi community** in preserving and promoting the **Bhawaiya** tradition.

The Vice President stressed the importance of preserving **India's cultural heritage**, **regional languages**, **folk traditions**, and **traditional knowledge systems** for future generations.

576. As of 2026, India joined 34 other countries in endorsing the Joint Statement on AI Opportunity at the 2nd Pax Silica Summit held in which city?

A.New York, United States

B.San Francisco, United States

C.Chicago, United States

D.Washington, D.C., United States

E.Boston, United States

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

India, along with **34 other countries**, participated in the **2nd Pax Silica Summit** held in **Washington, D.C., United States (US)**.

The participating countries endorsed the **Joint Statement on AI Opportunity**, a **United States (US)-led initiative** to build **trusted and resilient supply chains** for **Artificial Intelligence (AI)** technologies.

Detailed Explanation:

India, along with **34 other countries**, participated in the **2nd Pax Silica Summit** held in **Washington, D.C., United States (US)**.

The participating countries endorsed the **Joint Statement on AI Opportunity**, a **United States (US)-led initiative** to build **trusted and resilient**

supply chains for **Artificial Intelligence (AI)** technologies.

The statement supports a **pro-growth** and **pro-innovation** regulatory approach for the AI ecosystem.

United States (US) Under Secretary of State for Economic Affairs Jacob Helberg highlighted the importance of strengthening the **India–US partnership** and discussed cooperation under the **Quadrilateral Security Dialogue (Quad)** and the **TRUST initiative**.

India was represented by **S. Krishnan**, **Secretary, Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY)**, along with representatives from **Indian industry**.

577. As of 2026, which state government launched the GO-EAST (Eastern Investment Accelerator and Special Task Force) policy to promote investments and manufacturing?

A.West Bengal

B.Jharkhand

C.Chhattisgarh

D.Andhra Pradesh

E.Odisha

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

The **Government of Odisha** launched the **GO-EAST (Government of Odisha Eastern Investment Accelerator and Special Task Force)** policy along with amendments to the **Industrial Policy Resolution (IPR) 2022**.

The initiative was announced by **Chief Minister Mohan Charan Majhi** during the **Confederation of Indian Industry (CII) Eastern Region Council** meeting held in **Bhubaneswar**.

The policy aims to **attract new investments**, **accelerate project implementation**, and **promote manufacturing**, especially in **backward districts**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Government of Odisha** launched the **GO-EAST (Government of Odisha Eastern Investment Accelerator and Special Task Force)** policy along with amendments to the **Industrial Policy Resolution (IPR) 2022**.

The initiative was announced by **Chief Minister Mohan Charan Majhi** during the **Confederation of Indian Industry (CII) Eastern Region Council** meeting held in **Bhubaneswar**.

The policy aims to **attract new investments**, **accelerate project implementation**, and **promote manufacturing**, especially in **backward districts**.

GO-EAST will function as a dedicated **investment facilitation platform** for industries from **Eastern and North-Eastern India**.

Key features of the initiative include **single-window investment facilitation**, **faster project approvals**, **real-time investment tracking**, a dedicated **GO-EAST Cell**, and a **Go SWIFT digital monitoring module**.

The policy aligns with **Prime Minister Narendra Modi's "Purvodaya" vision** for the development of **Eastern India**.

578. As of 2026, India's world's first hydrogen production facility based on nuclear process heat has been commissioned at which research centre?

A.Indira Gandhi Centre for Atomic Research (IGCAR), Kalpakkam

B.Raja Ramanna Centre for Advanced Technology (RRCAT), Indore

C.Variable Energy Cyclotron Centre (VECC), Kolkata

D.Nuclear Fuel Complex (NFC), Hyderabad

E.Bhabha Atomic Research Centre (BARC), Mumbai

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

India has commissioned the **world's first hydrogen production facility based on nuclear process heat** at the **Indira Gandhi Centre for Atomic Research (IGCAR), Kalpakkam, Tamil Nadu**.

The facility was inaugurated by **Ajit Kumar Mohanty**, **Secretary, Department of Atomic Energy (DAE)**.

The project uses the **Fast Breeder Test Reactor (FBTR)** as the heat source for hydrogen production.

Detailed Explanation:

India has commissioned the **world's first hydrogen production facility based on nuclear process heat** at the **Indira Gandhi Centre for Atomic Research (IGCAR), Kalpakkam, Tamil Nadu**.

The facility was inaugurated by **Ajit Kumar Mohanty**, **Secretary, Department of Atomic Energy (DAE)**.

The project uses the **Fast Breeder Test Reactor (FBTR)** as the heat source for hydrogen production.

It produces hydrogen using the **indigenously developed Copper-Chlorine (Cu-Cl) Thermochemical Cycle**, developed by the **Bhabha Atomic Research Centre (BARC), Mumbai**.

The facility has been established as a **technology demonstrator** to validate the feasibility of producing **clean hydrogen using nuclear energy**.

The **Cu-Cl Thermochemical Cycle** uses **high-temperature nuclear process heat (around 500°C)** to split water into **hydrogen and oxygen** through a series of chemical reactions.

579. As of 2026, two Indian conservationists, Parveen Shaikh and Dr. Barkha Subba, were honoured with which international conservation award, popularly known as the "Green Oscars"?

A.UNEP Champions of the Earth Award

B.Goldman Environmental Prize

C.Ramsar Wetland Conservation Award

D.WWF Living Planet Award

E.Whitley Awards

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

Two Indian conservationists, **Parveen Shaikh** and **Dr. Barkha Subba**, were honoured

with the **Whitley Awards 2026**, popularly known as the **'Green Oscars'**.

The awards recognise **grassroots conservation leaders** for their contributions to **biodiversity conservation** and **ecosystem restoration**.

The awards ceremony was held at the **Royal Geographical Society, London**, where the honours were presented by **Princess Anne** of the **United Kingdom**.

Each winner received **£50,000** to support their ongoing conservation projects.

Detailed Explanation:

Two Indian conservationists, **Parveen Shaikh** and **Dr. Barkha Subba**, were honoured with the **Whitley Awards 2026**, popularly known as the **'Green Oscars'**.

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Indian Awardees

Parveen Shaikh, a conservation scientist with the **Bombay Natural History Society (BNHS)**, was recognised for her work in conserving the **Indian Skimmer**, a rare river bird found in the **Chambal River** ecosystem.

Through the **"Guardians of the Skimmer"** initiative, she has trained **over 30 local villagers** to protect and monitor **Indian Skimmer** nesting colonies.

Dr. Barkha Subba, associated with the **Federation of Societies for Environmental Protection (FOSEP), Darjeeling**, was honoured for conserving the **Himalayan Salamander**.

Her work includes **scientific monitoring**, **wetland restoration**, **community participation**, and efforts to control **fungal diseases** affecting amphibians.

Other Whitley Awards 2026 Winners

Farwiza Farhan (Indonesia) – **Gold Award** for protecting the **Leuser Ecosystem**.

Moreangels Mbizah (Zimbabwe) – **Human–wildlife coexistence and lion conservation**.

Issah Seidu (Ghana) – Conservation of **Critically Endangered guitarfish**.

Marina Kameni (Cameroon) – Conservation of **endemic amphibian species**.

580. As of 2026, how many Indian schools were shortlisted among the Top 10 finalists for the World's Best School Prizes 2026?

A.5

B.6

C.7

D.8

E.10

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

Seven Indian schools have been shortlisted among the **Top 10 finalists** for the **World's Best School Prizes 2026**.

India recorded the **highest number of shortlisted schools by any country in a single year** since the awards were launched.

The achievement highlights India's excellence in innovation, community engagement, environmental action, leadership, and quality education.

Detailed Explanation:

Seven Indian schools have been shortlisted among the **Top 10 finalists** for the **World's Best School Prizes 2026**.

India recorded the **highest number of shortlisted schools by any country in a single year** since the awards were launched.

The achievement highlights India's excellence in innovation, community engagement, environmental action, leadership, and quality education.

The **World's Best School Prizes 2026** are organised by **T4 Education**.

Indian schools have been shortlisted across the **five award categories**, including **Innovation** and **Community Collaboration**.

In the **Innovation** category, **PCMC Chhatrapati Shahuji Maharaj English Medium School, Kasarwadi (Pune)** and **Army Goodwill School, Wuzur (Anantnag, Jammu & Kashmir)** were shortlisted.

581. As of 2026, who has been appointed as the Director of the Vikram Sarabhai Space Centre (VSSC), Thiruvananthapuram?

A.Dr. A. Rajarajan

B.Dr. U.P. Rajeev

C.V. Narayanan

D.Dr. K. Sivan

E.Dr. S. Somanath

Answer: B

Dr. U.P. Rajeev has been appointed as the **Director** of the **Vikram Sarabhai Space Centre (VSSC)**, **Thiruvananthapuram, Kerala**, one of the premier centres of the **Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO)**.

Dr. U.P. Rajeev succeeds **Dr. A. Rajarajan**, who retired as **Director of VSSC** upon attaining the **age of superannuation (60 years)**.

582. As of 2026, Sanjay Jaju was appointed as the Chief Secretary of Telangana, succeeding whom?

A.A. Santhi Kumari

B.B. P. Acharya

C.Somesh Kumar

D.K. Ramakrishna Rao

E.Rajat Kumar

Answer: D

The **Telangana Government** appointed **Sanjay Jaju**, a **1992-batch Indian Administrative Service (IAS)** officer of the Telangana cadre, as the new **Chief Secretary of Telangana**.

Sanjay Jaju will succeed **K. Ramakrishna Rao**, who is scheduled to retire on **30 June 2026**.

Along with the post of Chief Secretary, **Sanjay Jaju** has been given **Full Additional Charge (FAC)** of the **Industries, Commerce, and Information Technology, Electronics & Communications (ITE&C) Departments**.

583. As of 2026, Jaime Abelardo de la Espriella was elected as the President of which country for the 2026–2030 term?

A.Colombia

B.Chile

C.Ecuador

D.Argentina

E.Peru

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

Jaime Abelardo de la Espriella, a political newcomer backed by the **Defenders of the Homeland (Defensores de la Patria) Alliance**, won **Colombia's Presidential Runoff Election** for the **2026–2030 term**.

Jaime Abelardo de la Espriella defeated left-wing candidate **Iván Cepeda** of the **Historic Pact (Pacto Histórico)** to become the **President-elect of Colombia**.

Detailed Explanation:

Jaime Abelardo de la Espriella, a political newcomer backed by the **Defenders of the Homeland (Defensores de la Patria) Alliance**, won **Colombia's Presidential Runoff Election** for the **2026–2030 term**.

Jaime Abelardo de la Espriella defeated left-wing candidate **Iván Cepeda** of the **Historic Pact (Pacto Histórico)** to become the **President-elect of Colombia**.

In the presidential runoff election, **Jaime Abelardo de la Espriella secured 49.66% of the votes**, while **Iván Cepeda received 48.70%**.

Jaime Abelardo de la Espriella will officially assume office on **7 August 2026**.

He will succeed the incumbent President **Gustavo Petro** as the next **President of Colombia**.

584. As of 2026, Project BRAHMANK of the Border Roads Organisation (BRO) celebrated its which Raising Day on 29 June 2026?

A.10th

B.12th

C.16th

D.15th

E.14th

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

Project BRAHMANK of the **Border Roads Organisation (BRO)** celebrated its **16th Raising Day** on **29 June 2026** at **Ranaghat, Arunachal Pradesh**, marking **15 years** of dedicated service in developing **strategic infrastructure and connectivity**.

Project BRAHMANK was **raised on 29 June 2011** at **Ranaghat, East Siang District, Arunachal Pradesh**, and became **fully operational on 3 December 2011**.

Detailed Explanation:

Project BRAHMANK of the **Border Roads Organisation (BRO)** celebrated its **16th Raising Day** on **29 June 2026** at **Ranaghat, Arunachal Pradesh**, marking **15 years** of dedicated service in developing **strategic infrastructure and connectivity**.

Project BRAHMANK was **raised on 29 June 2011** at **Ranaghat, East Siang District, Arunachal Pradesh**, and became **fully operational on 3 December 2011**.

The project is responsible for the **development and maintenance of strategic road infrastructure** across **Siang, East Siang, West Siang, Upper Siang, and Shi-Yomi districts of Arunachal Pradesh**, along with parts of **Dhemaji district, Assam**.

Project BRAHMANK currently maintains and develops **811 km of strategic roads** and approximately **86 bridges**, including **culverts, steel bridges, and arch bridges**.

One of its major engineering achievements is the **100-metre Steel Arch Bridge** over **Siyom Nallah**.

585. As of 2026, the Delegation of Financial Powers to DRDO (DFP-2026) was released primarily to enhance the efficiency, accountability, and timely execution of which type of projects?

A.Research & Development (R&D) projects

B.Space exploration projects

C.Digital governance projects

D.Border infrastructure projects

E.Disaster management projects

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

Raksha Mantri Rajnath Singh released the **Delegation of Financial Powers to DRDO (DFP-2026)** on **29 June 2026** to enhance the **efficiency, accountability, and timely execution** of strategic **Research & Development (R&D)** projects.

DFP-2026 is a major financial reform aimed at empowering the **Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO)** with **greater financial autonomy** for faster implementation of defence projects.

Detailed Explanation:

Raksha Mantri Rajnath Singh released the **Delegation of Financial Powers to DRDO (DFP-2026)** on **29 June 2026** to enhance the **efficiency, accountability, and timely execution** of strategic **Research & Development (R&D)** projects.

DFP-2026 is a major financial reform aimed at empowering the **Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO)** with **greater financial autonomy** for faster implementation of defence projects.

The new framework will facilitate the **faster production and induction of indigenously developed systems, platforms, and technologies** emerging from the R&D ecosystem into the **Indian Armed Forces**.

DFP-2026 will promote stronger collaboration among **DRDO, industry, and academia**, reinforcing the Government's vision of **Aatmanirbhar Bharat**.

The revised framework is expected to enhance **self-reliance in defence technologies** and strengthen **India's defence preparedness**.

586. As of 2026, scientists from the Institute of Nano Science and Technology (INST), Mohali developed a new electrolyte additive to improve the performance of which type of batteries?

A.Sodium-Ion Batteries (SIBs)
B.Lithium-Ion Batteries (LIBs)
C.Solid-State Batteries (SSBs)
D.Nickel-Metal Hydride Batteries (NiMH)
E.Aqueous Zinc-Ion Batteries (AZIBs)
Answer: E
Short Explanation:
Scientists from the Institute of Nano Science and Technology (INST), Mohali, an autonomous institute under the Department of Science and Technology (DST), developed a **new electrolyte additive** to improve the performance of **Aqueous Zinc-Ion Batteries (AZIBs)**.
The newly developed electrolyte additive, **1,3-bis (1,3-dicarboxypropyl)-1H-imidazole-3-ium chloride (BDIM)**, enhances the **safety, lifespan, and affordability** of rechargeable zinc batteries.
Aqueous Zinc-Ion Batteries (AZIBs) are emerging as low-cost, safe, and sustainable alternatives to **Lithium-Ion Batteries (LIBs)** for large-scale energy storage.
Detailed Explanation:
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Aqueous Zinc-Ion Batteries (AZIBs) are emerging as low-cost, safe, and sustainable alternatives to **Lithium-Ion Batteries (LIBs)** for large-scale energy storage.
The commercialization of AZIBs has been limited by challenges such as **zinc dendrite growth, Hydrogen Evolution Reaction (HER), corrosion, and poor cycling stability**.
Instead of expensive material redesign, the research uses **interface engineering** to improve **zinc anode stability and battery performance**.
The **BDIM additive** selectively adsorbs onto the zinc metal surface and regulates the **Inner Helmholtz Plane (IHP)**, where key electrochemical reactions occur.
BDIM contains **multiple oxygen and nitrogen donor sites**, enabling strong interaction with the zinc anode during battery operation.

587. As of 2026, which of the following is India's largest integrated digital agro-

advisory platform that provides timely, authentic, multilingual, and personalized agricultural advisories to farmers?

A.AgriStack

B.Digital Kisan Portal

C.e-NAM

D.PM-Kisan Portal

E.Kisan Sarathi

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

Kisan Sarathi was launched in **July 2021** and is India's **largest integrated digital agro-advisory platform** providing timely, authentic, multilingual, and personalized agricultural advisories to farmers.

Kisan Sarathi is a joint initiative of the **Ministry of Electronics & Information Technology (MeitY)** and the **Ministry of Agriculture & Farmers Welfare (MoA&FW)**.

The platform is implemented by the **Indian Agricultural Statistics Research Institute (IASRI)** and the **Digital India Corporation (DIC)**.

Detailed Explanation:

Kisan Sarathi was launched in **July 2021** and is India's **largest integrated digital agro-advisory platform** providing timely, authentic, multilingual, and personalized agricultural advisories to farmers.

Kisan Sarathi is a joint initiative of the **Ministry of Electronics & Information Technology (MeitY)** and the **Ministry of Agriculture & Farmers Welfare (MoA&FW)**.

The platform is implemented by the **Indian Agricultural Statistics Research Institute (IASRI)** and the **Digital India Corporation (DIC)**.

Kisan Sarathi is powered by the **Interactive Information Dissemination System (IIDS)**, a **two-way communication platform** that enables seamless interaction between farmers and agricultural experts.

IIDS supports **voice calls, video calls, text messages, image sharing, and video exchange**, ensuring effective **lab-to-land transfer** of agricultural knowledge.

The platform connects farmers with **730+ Krishi Vigyan Kendras (KVKs), 100+ ICAR Institutes, and 65+ Agricultural Universities**, creating a national agricultural advisory ecosystem.

588. As of 2026, which Union Minister launched the AI-enabled Rural Internal Audit Portal during the Rashtriya Gramin Vikas Sammelan in New Delhi?

A.Rajnath Singh

B.Shivraj Singh Chouhan

C.Piyush Goyal

D.J. P. Nadda

E.Nitin Gadkari

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Union Minister for Rural Development Shri Shivraj Singh Chouhan launched the **AI-enabled Rural Internal Audit Portal** during the **Rashtriya Gramin Vikas Sammelan at**

Pusa Campus, New Delhi, to strengthen **transparency, accountability, and technology-driven governance**.

The **Rural Internal Audit Portal** is the **first-of-its-kind unified digital platform** for end-to-end management of internal audits, covering both **risk-based audits and compliance audits**.

The Portal was conceived by the **Office of the Chief Controller of Accounts (CCA), Ministry of Rural Development**, and developed in collaboration with the **National Informatics Centre (NIC)**.

Detailed Explanation:

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The **Rural Internal Audit Portal** is the **first-of-its-kind unified digital platform** for end-to-end management of internal audits, covering both **risk-based audits and compliance audits**.

The Portal was conceived by the **Office of the Chief Controller of Accounts (CCA), Ministry of Rural Development**, and developed in collaboration with the **National Informatics Centre (NIC)**.

The Portal transforms the audit process from a paper-based, fragmented, and manual system into a **transparent, data-driven, technology-enabled digital ecosystem**.

It integrates **audit planning, execution, reporting, compliance management, monitoring, analytics, Action Taken Reports (ATRs), para settlement, and archival of records** on a single platform.

The **pilot project** of the Portal was launched in **Chandauli district, Uttar Pradesh, on 1 April 2025**, while **all core modules became operational from October 2025**.

The Portal was developed to address challenges such as **manual correspondence, delayed reporting, dispersed records, inadequate monitoring, and the absence of a centralized audit repository**.

589. As of 2026, the Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) Bombay signed a Letter of Intent (LoI) for academic and research collaboration with which foreign university?

A.University of California, Berkeley

B.State University of New York (SUNY) Old Westbury

C.Stanford University

D.Harvard University

E.Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT)

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The **Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) Bombay** and the **State University of New York (SUNY) Old Westbury** signed a **Letter of Intent (LoI)** in **New York, United States (US)** to

strengthen academic and research collaboration.

The **LoI** was signed by **Professor Shireesh Kedare**, Director of **IIT Bombay**, and **Dr. Timothy E. Sams**, President of **SUNY Old Westbury**, in the presence of **Binaya Pradhan**, **Consul General of India in New York**.

The collaboration will focus on **engineering, Artificial Intelligence (AI), multidisciplinary research, technology**, and other **emerging fields**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) Bombay** and the **State University of New York (SUNY) Old Westbury** signed a **Letter of Intent (LoI)** in **New York, United States (US)** to strengthen academic and research collaboration.

The **LoI** was signed by **Professor Shireesh Kedare**, Director of **IIT Bombay**, and **Dr. Timothy E. Sams**, President of **SUNY Old Westbury**, in the presence of **Binaya Pradhan**, **Consul General of India in New York**.

The collaboration will focus on **engineering, Artificial Intelligence (AI), multidisciplinary research, technology**, and other **emerging fields**.

Union Minister for Education Dharmendra Pradhan stated that the partnership aligns with the vision of the **National Education Policy (NEP) 2020**, which promotes the **internationalisation of Indian higher education**.

The partnership aims to promote **faculty and researcher exchanges**, **joint research projects**, and the organisation of **joint conferences and symposia**.

The collaboration is expected to strengthen **research, innovation, and global academic engagement**, while creating new opportunities for **students, scholars, and researchers**.

Ambassador of India to the United States Vinay Mohan Kwatra also participated virtually during the announcement.

590. As of 2026, England Test captain Ben Stokes announced his retirement from international cricket after the third Rothesay Test against which country?

A.New Zealand

B.India

C.South Africa

D.Pakistan

E.Australia

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

England Test captain Ben Stokes has announced his retirement from **international cricket** after the **third Rothesay Test** against **New Zealand** at **Trent Bridge**.

The **England and Wales Cricket Board (ECB)** confirmed that the **Trent Bridge Test** will be his final international match.

Stokes will also step down as **England Men's Test captain**, a position he has held since **April 2022**.

Detailed Explanation:

England Test captain Ben Stokes has announced his retirement from **international cricket** after the **third Rothesay Test** against **New Zealand** at **Trent Bridge**.

The **England and Wales Cricket Board (ECB)** confirmed that the **Trent Bridge Test** will be his final international match.

Stokes will also step down as **England Men's Test captain**, a position he has held since **April 2022**.

He made his **international debut** in **2011** and his **Test debut** during the **2013 Ashes series** against **Australia**.

Stokes played a crucial role in **England's first ICC Men's Cricket World Cup victory** in **2019**, scoring an unbeaten **84** in the final against **New Zealand**.

He produced a historic unbeaten **135** at **Headingley** during the **2019 Ashes**, leading England to a famous **one-wicket victory** over **Australia**.

591. As of 2026, veteran Tamil filmmaker Krishnaswamy Bhagyaraj, who passed away at the age of 73, made his directorial debut with which film?

A.16 Vayathinile

B.Mundhanai Mudichu

C.Andha 7 Naatkal

D.Darling Darling Darling

E.Suvarilladha Chiththirangal

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

Veteran Tamil filmmaker, actor, screenwriter, and director Krishnaswamy Bhagyaraj passed away at the age of **73** in **Chennai, Tamil Nadu (TN)**.

Krishnaswamy Bhagyaraj was born on **7 January 1953** in **Gobichettipalayam**, **Erode district**, **Tamil Nadu**.

He began his film career as an **Assistant Director** under renowned filmmaker **Bharathiraja**.

Bhagyaraj made his **acting debut** with the Tamil film **16 Vayathinile (1977)** before establishing himself as a successful **screenplay** and **dialogue writer**.

He made his **directorial debut** with **Suvarilladha Chiththirangal (1979)**.

Detailed Explanation:

Veteran Tamil filmmaker, actor, screenwriter, and director Krishnaswamy Bhagyaraj passed away at the age of **73** in **Chennai, Tamil Nadu (TN)**.

Krishnaswamy Bhagyaraj was born on **7 January 1953** in **Gobichettipalayam**, **Erode district**, **Tamil Nadu**.

He began his film career as an **Assistant Director** under renowned filmmaker **Bharathiraja**.

Bhagyaraj made his **acting debut** with the Tamil film **16 Vayathinile (1977)** before establishing himself as a successful **screenplay** and **dialogue writer**.

He made his **directorial debut** with **Suvarilladha Chiththirangal (1979)**. During a career spanning **nearly five decades**, **Bhagyaraj** directed **more than 25 films** and acted in **over 75 films**.

592. As of 2026, International Asteroid Day is observed every year on which date?

A.22 April

B.30 June

C.21 June

D.15 July

E.25 June

Answer: B

International Asteroid Day is observed every year on **30 June** to raise awareness about **asteroids**, their role in the **solar system**, and the need for **planetary defence**.

The day commemorates the **Tunguska Event** of **30 June 1908**, when a massive asteroid explosion occurred over **Siberia, Russian Federation**.

In **December 2016**, the **United Nations General Assembly (UNGA)** proclaimed **30 June** as **International Asteroid Day** through **Resolution A/RES/71/90**.

593. As of 2026, Goldman Sachs expects India to record a Balance of Payments (BoP) surplus equivalent to what percentage of GDP?

A.0.3%

B.0.5%

C.0.7%

D.0.9%

E.1.1%

Answer: C

Goldman Sachs reduced India's **Current Account Deficit (CAD) forecast by 20 basis points (bps) to 1.1% of GDP**.

The report now expects India to record a **Balance of Payments (BoP) Surplus** equivalent to **0.7% of GDP**.

594. As of 2026, the revised Industrial Policy Resolution (IPR) 2022 of Odisha provides additional incentives for setting up non-mineral-based industries in how many backward districts?

A.10

B.12

C.14

D.15

E.18

Answer: D

The revised **IPR 2022** provides **additional incentives** for setting up **non-mineral-based industries** in **15 backward districts**, including **Balangir, Kalahandi, Nuapada, Kandhamal, Boudh, and Gajapati**.

The **GO-EAST Cell** and **Go SWIFT platform** will monitor **project approvals**, **incentive disbursement**, **implementation progress**, and improve **transparency**.

During the event, the Odisha Government signed **7 Memorandums of Understanding (MoUs)** involving investments worth **₹24,823 crore** across sectors such as **chemicals,**

power, green energy equipment, apparel, and steel manufacturing.

595. As of 2026, the Bhabha Atomic Research Centre (BARC), India's premier nuclear research and development institution, is headquartered in which city?

A.Chennai

B.Hyderabad

C.Bengaluru

D.New Delhi

E.Mumbai

Answer: E

About Bhabha Atomic Research Centre (BARC)

Headquarters: Mumbai, Maharashtra

Parent Organisation: Department of Atomic Energy (DAE)

Function: India's premier nuclear research and development institution.